

Joseph A. Gallian

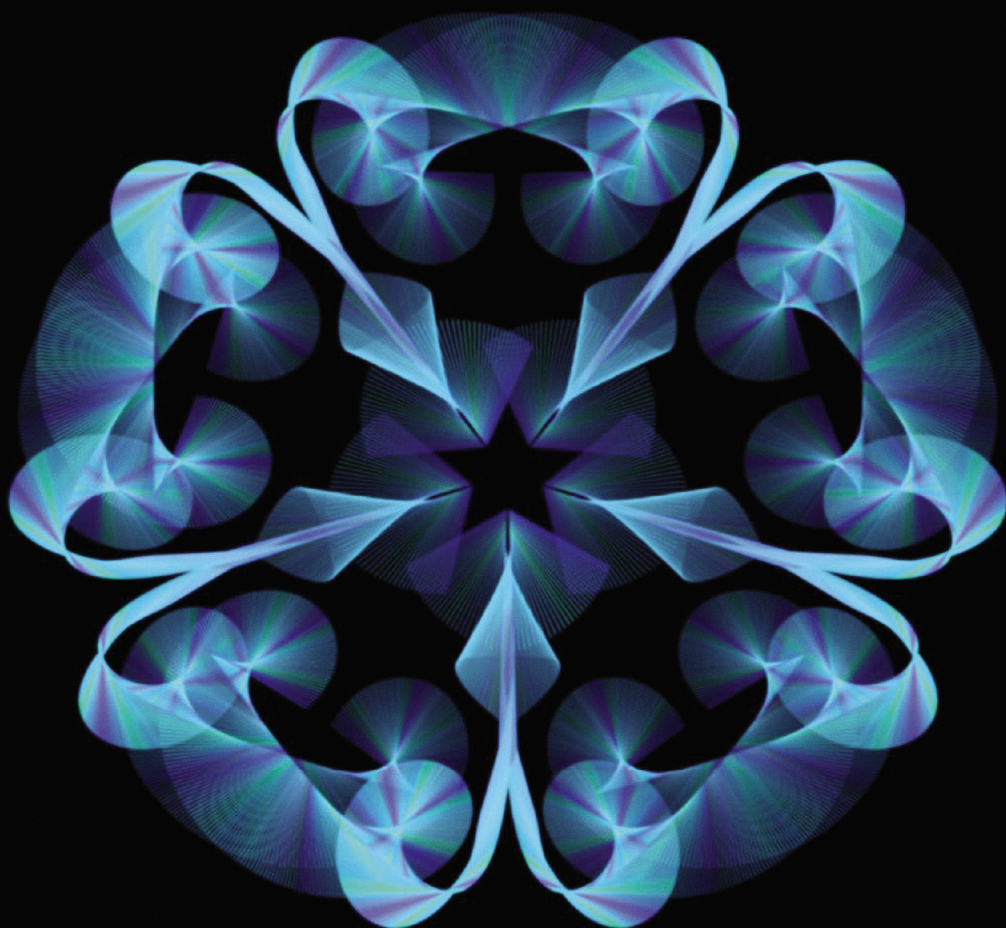
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# CONTEMPORARY ABSTRACT ALGEBRA

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Ninth Edition

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# Notations

(The number after the item indicates the page where the notation is defined.)

## SET THEORY

|                      |                                                                            |
|----------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| $\cap_{i \in I} S_i$ | intersection of sets $S_i$ , $i \in I$                                     |
| $\cup_{i \in I} S_i$ | union of sets $S_i$ , $i \in I$                                            |
| $[a]$                | $\{x \in S \mid x \sim a\}$ , equivalence class of $S$ containing $a$ , 18 |
| $ S $                | number of elements in the set of $S$                                       |

## SPECIAL SETS

|                |                                                         |
|----------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| $\mathbf{Z}$   | integers, additive groups of integers, ring of integers |
| $\mathbf{Q}$   | rational numbers, field of rational numbers             |
| $\mathbf{Q}^+$ | multiplicative group of positive rational numbers       |
| $F^*$          | set of nonzero elements of $F$                          |
| $\mathbf{R}$   | real numbers, field of real numbers                     |
| $\mathbf{R}^+$ | multiplicative group of positive real numbers           |
| $\mathbf{C}$   | complex numbers                                         |

## FUNCTIONS AND ARITHMETIC

|                         |                                                         |
|-------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| $f^{-1}$                | inverse of the function $f$                             |
| $t \mid s$              | $t$ divides $s$ , 3                                     |
| $t \nmid s$             | $t$ does not divide $s$ , 3                             |
| $\gcd(a, b)$            | greatest common divisor of the integers $a$ and $b$ , 4 |
| $\text{lcm}(a, b)$      | least common multiple of the integers $a$ and $b$ , 6   |
| $ a + b $               | $\sqrt{a^2 + b^2}$ , 13                                 |
| $\phi(a)$               | image of $a$ under $\phi$ , 20                          |
| $\phi: A \rightarrow B$ | mapping of $A$ to $B$ , 21                              |
| $gf, \alpha\beta$       | composite function, 21                                  |

## ALGEBRAIC SYSTEMS

|                     |                                                                                                                                         |
|---------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| $D_4$               | group of symmetries of a square, dihedral group of order 8, 33                                                                          |
| $D_n$               | dihedral group of order $2n$ , 34                                                                                                       |
| $e$                 | identity element, 43                                                                                                                    |
| $\mathbf{Z}_n$      | group $\{0, 1, \dots, n-1\}$ under addition modulo $n$ , 44                                                                             |
| $\det A$            | the determinant of $A$ , 45                                                                                                             |
| $U(n)$              | group of units modulo $n$ (that is, the set of integers less than $n$ and relatively prime to $n$ under multiplication modulo $n$ ), 46 |
| $\mathbf{R}^n$      | $\{(a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n) \mid a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n \in \mathbf{R}\}$ , 47                                                              |
| $SL(2, F)$          | group of $2 \times 2$ matrices over $F$ with determinant 1, 47                                                                          |
| $GL(2, F)$          | $2 \times 2$ matrices of nonzero determinants with coefficients from the field $F$ (the general linear group), 48                       |
| $g^{-1}$            | multiplicative inverse of $g$ , 51                                                                                                      |
| $-g$                | additive inverse of $g$ , 51                                                                                                            |
| $ G $               | order of the group $G$ , 60                                                                                                             |
| $ g $               | order of the element $g$ , 60                                                                                                           |
| $H \leq G$          | subgroup inclusion, 61                                                                                                                  |
| $H < G$             | subgroup $H \neq G$ , 61                                                                                                                |
| $\langle a \rangle$ | $\{a^n \mid n \in \mathbf{Z}\}$ , cyclic group generated by $a$ , 65                                                                    |
| $Z(G)$              | $\{a \in G \mid ax = xa \text{ for all } x \text{ in } G\}$ , the center of $G$ , 66                                                    |

|                                          |                                                                                                 |
|------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| $C(a)$                                   | $\{g \in G \mid ga = ag\}$ , the centralizer of $a$ in $G$ , 68                                 |
| $\langle S \rangle$                      | subgroup generated by the set $S$ , 71                                                          |
| $C(H)$                                   | $\{x \in G \mid xh = hx \text{ for all } h \in H\}$ , the centralizer of $H$ , 71               |
| $\phi(n)$                                | Euler phi function of $n$ , 83                                                                  |
| $S_n$                                    | group of one-to-one functions from $\{1, 2, \dots, n\}$ to itself, 95                           |
| $A_n$                                    | alternating group of degree $n$ , 95                                                            |
| $G \approx \bar{G}$                      | $G$ and $\bar{G}$ are isomorphic, 121                                                           |
| $\phi_a$                                 | mapping given by $\phi_a(x) = axa^{-1}$ for all $x$ , 128                                       |
| $\text{Aut}(G)$                          | group of automorphisms of the group $G$ , 129                                                   |
| $\text{Inn}(G)$                          | group of inner automorphisms of $G$ , 129                                                       |
| $aH$                                     | $\{ah \mid h \in H\}$ , 138                                                                     |
| $aHa^{-1}$                               | $\{aha^{-1} \mid h \in H\}$ , 138                                                               |
| $ G:H $                                  | the index of $H$ in $G$ , 142                                                                   |
| $HK$                                     | $\{hk \mid h \in H, k \in K\}$ , 144                                                            |
| $\text{stab}_G(i)$                       | $\{\phi \in G \mid \phi(i) = i\}$ , the stabilizer of $i$ under the permutation group $G$ , 146 |
| $\text{orb}_G(i)$                        | $\{\phi(i) \mid \phi \in G\}$ , the orbit of $i$ under the permutation group $G$ , 146          |
| $G_1 \oplus G_2 \oplus \dots \oplus G_n$ | external direct product of groups $G_1, G_2, \dots, G_n$ , 156                                  |
| $U_k(n)$                                 | $\{x \in U(n) \mid x \bmod k = 1\}$ , 160                                                       |
| $H \triangleleft G$                      | $H$ is a normal subgroup of $G$ , 174                                                           |
| $G/H$                                    | factor group, 176                                                                               |
| $H \times K$                             | internal direct product of $H$ and $K$ , 183                                                    |
| $H_1 \times H_2 \times \dots \times H_n$ | internal direct product of $H_1, \dots, H_n$ , 184                                              |
| $\text{Ker } \phi$                       | kernel of the homomorphism $\phi$ , 194                                                         |
| $\phi^{-1}(g')$                          | inverse image of $g'$ under $\phi$ , 196                                                        |
| $\phi^{-1}(\bar{K})$                     | inverse image of $\bar{K}$ under $\phi$ , 197                                                   |
| $\mathbb{Z}[x]$                          | ring of polynomials with integer coefficients, 228                                              |
| $M_2(\mathbb{Z})$                        | ring of all $2 \times 2$ matrices with integer entries, 228                                     |
| $R_1 \oplus R_2 \oplus \dots \oplus R_n$ | direct sum of rings, 229                                                                        |
| $n\mathbb{Z}$                            | ring of multiples of $n$ , 231                                                                  |
| $\mathbb{Z}[i]$                          | ring of Gaussian integers, 231                                                                  |
| $U(R)$                                   | group of units of the ring $R$ , 233                                                            |
| $\text{char } R$                         | characteristic of $R$ , 240                                                                     |
| $\langle a \rangle$                      | principal ideal generated by $a$ , 250                                                          |
| $\langle a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n \rangle$   | ideal generated by $a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n$ , 250                                                 |
| $R/A$                                    | factor ring, 250                                                                                |
| $A + B$                                  | sum of ideals $A$ and $B$ , 256                                                                 |
| $AB$                                     | product of ideals $A$ and $B$ , 257                                                             |
| $\text{Ann}(A)$                          | annihilator of $A$ , 258                                                                        |
| $N(A)$                                   | nil radical of $A$ , 258                                                                        |
| $F(x)$                                   | field of quotients of $F[x]$ , 269                                                              |
| $R[x]$                                   | ring of polynomials over $R$ , 276                                                              |
| $\deg f(x)$                              | degree of the polynomial, 278                                                                   |
| $\Phi_p(x)$                              | $p$ th cyclotomic polynomial, 294                                                               |
| $M_2(Q)$                                 | ring of $2 \times 2$ matrices over $Q$ , 330                                                    |
| $\langle v_1, v_2, \dots, v_n \rangle$   | subspace spanned by $v_1, v_2, \dots, v_n$ , 331                                                |
| $F(a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n)$                | extension of $F$ by $a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n$ , 341                                                |

|                                                                     |                                                                                            |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| $f'(x)$                                                             | the derivative of $f(x)$ , 346                                                             |
| $[E:F]$                                                             | degree of $E$ over $F$ , 356                                                               |
| $\text{GF}(p^n)$                                                    | Galois field of order $p^n$ , 368                                                          |
| $\text{GF}(p^n)^*$                                                  | nonzero elements of $\text{GF}(p^n)$ , 369                                                 |
| $\text{cl}(a)$                                                      | $\{xax^{-1} \mid x \in G\}$ , the conjugacy class of $a$ , 387                             |
| $n_p$                                                               | the number of Sylow $p$ -subgroups of a group, 393                                         |
| $W(S)$                                                              | set of all words from $S$ , 424                                                            |
| $\langle a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n \mid w_1 = w_2 = \dots = w_t \rangle$ | group with generators $a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n$ and relations $w_1 = w_2 = \dots = w_t$ , 426 |
| $Q_4$                                                               | quaternions, 430                                                                           |
| $Q_6$                                                               | dicyclic group of order 12, 430                                                            |
| $D_\infty$                                                          | infinite dihedral group, 431                                                               |
| $\text{fix}(\phi)$                                                  | $\{i \in S \mid \phi(i) = i\}$ , elements fixed by $\phi$ , 474                            |
| $\text{Cay}(S;G)$                                                   | Cayley digraph of the group $G$ with generating set $S$ , 482                              |
| $k * (a, b, \dots, c)$                                              | concatenation of $k$ copies of $(a, b, \dots, c)$ , 490                                    |
| $(n, k)$                                                            | linear code, $k$ -dimensional subspace of $F^n$ , 508                                      |
| $F^n$                                                               | $F \oplus F \oplus \dots \oplus F$ , direct product of $n$ copies of the field $F$ , 508   |
| $d(u, v)$                                                           | Hamming distance between vectors $u$ and $v$ , 509                                         |
| $\text{wt}(u)$                                                      | the number of nonzero components of the vector $u$ (the Hamming weight of $u$ ), 509       |
| $\text{Gal}(E/F)$                                                   | the automorphism group of $E$ fixing $F$ , 531                                             |
| $E_H$                                                               | fixed field of $H$ , 531                                                                   |
| $\Phi_n(x)$                                                         | $n$ th cyclotomic polynomial, 548                                                          |



# **Contemporary Abstract Algebra**



# Contemporary Abstract Algebra

NINTH EDITION

**Joseph A. Gallian**

University of Minnesota Duluth



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Australia • Brazil • Mexico • Singapore • United Kingdom • United States

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In memory of my brother.





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# Preface

Set your pace to a stroll. Stop whenever you want. Interrupt, jump back and forth, I won't mind. This book should be as easy as laughter. It is stuffed with small things to take away. Please help yourself.

WILLIS GOTH REGIER, *In Praise of Flattery*, 2007

Although I wrote the first edition of this book more than thirty years ago, my goals for it remain the same. I want students to receive a solid introduction to the traditional topics. I want readers to come away with the view that abstract algebra is a contemporary subject—that its concepts and methodologies are being used by working mathematicians, computer scientists, physicists, and chemists. I want students to see the connections between abstract algebra and number theory and geometry. I want students to be able to do computations and to write proofs. I want students to enjoy reading the book. And I want convey to the reader my enthusiasm for this beautiful subject.

Educational research has shown that an effective way of learning mathematics is to interweave worked-out examples and practice problems. Thus, I have made examples and exercises the heart of the book. The examples elucidate the definitions, theorems, and proof techniques. The exercises facilitate understanding, provide insight, and develop the ability of the students to do proofs. There is a large number of exercises ranging from straight forward to difficult and enough at each level so that instructors have plenty to choose from that are most appropriate for their students. The exercises often foreshadow definitions, concepts, and theorems to come. Many exercises focus on special cases and ask the reader to generalize. Generalizing is a skill that students should develop but rarely do. Even if an instructor chooses not to spend class time on the applications in the book, I feel that having them there demonstrates to students the utility of the theory.

Changes for the ninth edition include new exercises, new examples, new biographies, new quotes, new applications, and a freshening of the historical notes and biographies from the 8th edition. These changes accentuate

and enhance the hallmark features that have made previous editions of the book a comprehensive, lively, and engaging introduction to the subject:

- Extensive coverage of groups, rings, and fields, plus a variety of non-traditional special topics
- A good mixture of more nearly 1700 computational and theoretical exercises appearing in each chapter that synthesize concepts from multiple chapters
- Back-of-the-book skeleton solutions and hints to the odd-numbered exercises
- Worked-out examples—totaling more than 300—ranging from routine computations to quite challenging
- Computer exercises that utilize interactive software available on my website that stress guessing and making conjectures
- A large number of applications from scientific and computing fields, as well as from everyday life
- Numerous historical notes and biographies that spotlight the people and events behind the mathematics
- Motivational and humorous quotations.
- More than 275 figures, photographs, tables, and reproductions of currency that honor mathematicians
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Cengage's book companion site [www.cengage.com/math/gallian](http://www.cengage.com/math/gallian) includes an instructor's solution manual with detailed solutions for all exercises and other resources. The website [www.d.umn.edu/~jgallian](http://www.d.umn.edu/~jgallian) also offers a wealth of additional online resources supporting the book, including:

- True/false questions with comments
- Flash cards
- Essays on learning abstract algebra, doing proofs, and reasons why abstract algebra is a valuable subject to learn
- Links to abstract algebra-related websites and software packages and much, much more.

Additionally, Cengage offers a Student Solutions Manual, available for purchase separately, with detailed solutions to the odd-numbered exercises in the book (ISBN13: 978-1-305-65797-7; ISBN10: 1-305-65797-7)

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# **Contemporary Abstract Algebra**



PART

1

# Integers and Equivalence Relations



# 0

## Preliminaries

When we see it [modular arithmetic] for the first time, it looks so abstract that it seems impossible something like this could have any real-world applications.

Edward Frenkel, *Love and Math: The Heart of Hidden Reality*

The whole of science is nothing more than a refinement of everyday thinking.

Albert Einstein, *Physics and Reality*

### Properties of Integers

Much of abstract algebra involves properties of integers and sets. In this chapter we collect the properties we need for future reference.

An important property of the integers, which we will often use, is the so-called Well Ordering Principle. Since this property cannot be proved from the usual properties of arithmetic, we will take it as an axiom.

### Well Ordering Principle

Every nonempty set of positive integers contains a smallest member.

The concept of divisibility plays a fundamental role in the theory of numbers. We say a nonzero integer  $t$  is a *divisor* of an integer  $s$  if there is an integer  $u$  such that  $s = tu$ . In this case, we write  $t \mid s$  (read “ $t$  divides  $s$ ”). When  $t$  is not a divisor of  $s$ , we write  $t \nmid s$ . A *prime* is a positive integer greater than 1 whose only positive divisors are 1 and itself. We say an integer  $s$  is a *multiple* of an integer  $t$  if there is an integer  $u$  such that  $s = tu$  or, equivalently, if  $t$  is a divisor of  $s$ .

As our first application of the Well Ordering Principle, we establish a fundamental property of integers that we will use often.

### ■ Theorem 0.1 Division Algorithm

Let  $a$  and  $b$  be integers with  $b > 0$ . Then there exist unique integers  $q$  and  $r$  with the property that  $a = bq + r$ , where  $0 \leq r < b$ .

**PROOF** We begin with the existence portion of the theorem. Consider the set  $S = \{a - bk \mid k \text{ is an integer and } a - bk \geq 0\}$ . If  $0 \in S$ , then  $b$  divides  $a$  and we may obtain the desired result with  $q = a/b$  and  $r = 0$ . Now assume  $0 \notin S$ . Since  $S$  is nonempty [if  $a > 0$ ,  $a - b \cdot 0 \in S$ ; if  $a < 0$ ,  $a - b(2a) = a(1 - 2b) \in S$ ;  $a \neq 0$  since  $0 \notin S$ ], we may apply the Well Ordering Principle to conclude that  $S$  has a smallest member, say  $r = a - bq$ . Then  $a = bq + r$  and  $r \geq 0$ , so all that remains to be proved is that  $r < b$ .

If  $r \geq b$ , then  $a - b(q + 1) = a - bq - b = r - b \geq 0$ , so that  $a - b(q + 1) \in S$ . But  $a - b(q + 1) < a - bq$ , and  $a - bq$  is the *smallest* member of  $S$ . So,  $r < b$ .

To establish the uniqueness of  $q$  and  $r$ , let us suppose that there are integers  $q, q', r$ , and  $r'$  such that

$$a = bq + r, \quad 0 \leq r < b, \quad \text{and} \quad a = bq' + r', \quad 0 \leq r' < b.$$

For convenience, we may also suppose that  $r' \geq r$ . Then  $bq + r = bq' + r'$  and  $b(q - q') = r' - r$ . So,  $b$  divides  $r' - r$  and  $0 \leq r' - r \leq r' < b$ . It follows that  $r' - r = 0$ , and therefore  $r' = r$  and  $q = q'$ . ■

The integer  $q$  in the division algorithm is called the *quotient* upon dividing  $a$  by  $b$ ; the integer  $r$  is called the *remainder* upon dividing  $a$  by  $b$ .

■ **EXAMPLE 1** For  $a = 17$  and  $b = 5$ , the division algorithm gives  $17 = 5 \cdot 3 + 2$ ; for  $a = -23$  and  $b = 6$ , the division algorithm gives  $-23 = 6(-4) + 1$ . ■

### Definitions Greatest Common Divisor, Relatively Prime Integers

The *greatest common divisor* of two nonzero integers  $a$  and  $b$  is the largest of all common divisors of  $a$  and  $b$ . We denote this integer by  $\gcd(a, b)$ . When  $\gcd(a, b) = 1$ , we say  $a$  and  $b$  are *relatively prime*.

The following property of the greatest common divisor of two integers plays a critical role in abstract algebra. The proof provides an application of the division algorithm and our second application of the Well Ordering Principle.

## ■ Theorem 0.2 GCD Is a Linear Combination

For any nonzero integers  $a$  and  $b$ , there **exist** integers  $s$  and  $t$  such that  $\gcd(a, b) = as + bt$ . Moreover,  $\gcd(a, b)$  is the **smallest positive integer** of the form  $as + bt$ .

**PROOF** Consider the set  $S = \{am + bn \mid m, n \text{ are integers and } am + bn > 0\}$ . Since  $S$  is obviously nonempty (if some choice of  $m$  and



$n$  makes  $am + bn < 0$ , then replace  $m$  and  $n$  by  $-m$  and  $-n$ , the Well Ordering Principle asserts that  $S$  has a smallest member, say,  $d = as + bt$ . We claim that  $d = \gcd(a, b)$ . To verify this claim, use the division algorithm to write  $a = dq + r$ , where  $0 \leq r < d$ . If  $r > 0$ , then  $r = a - dq = a - (as + bt)q = a - asq - btq = a(1 - sq) + b(-tq) \in S$ , contradicting the fact that  $d$  is the smallest member of  $S$ . So,  $r = 0$  and  $d$  divides  $a$ . Analogously (or, better yet, by symmetry),  $d$  divides  $b$  as well. This proves that  $d$  is a common divisor of  $a$  and  $b$ . Now suppose  $d'$  is another common divisor of  $a$  and  $b$  and write  $a = d'h$  and  $b = d'k$ . Then  $d = as + bt = (d'h)s + (d'k)t = d'(hs + kt)$ , so that  $d'$  is a divisor of  $d$ . Thus, among all common divisors of  $a$  and  $b$ ,  $d$  is the greatest. ■

The special case of Theorem 0.2 when  $a$  and  $b$  are relatively prime is so important in abstract algebra that we single it out as a corollary.

### ■ Corollary

*If  $a$  and  $b$  are relatively prime, then there exist integers  $s$  and  $t$  such that  $as + bt = 1$ .*

■ **EXAMPLE 2**  $\gcd(4, 15) = 1$ ;  $\gcd(4, 10) = 2$ ;  $\gcd(2^2 \cdot 3^2 \cdot 5, 2 \cdot 3^3 \cdot 7^2) = 2 \cdot 3^2$ . Note that 4 and 15 are relatively prime, whereas 4 and 10 are not. Also,  $4 \cdot 4 + 15(-1) = 1$  and  $4(-2) + 10 \cdot 1 = 2$ . ■

The next lemma is frequently used. It appeared in Euclid's *Elements*.

### ■ Euclid's Lemma $p \mid ab$ Implies $p \mid a$ or $p \mid b$

*If  $p$  is a prime that divides  $ab$ , then  $p$  divides  $a$  or  $p$  divides  $b$ .*

**PROOF** Suppose  $p$  is a prime that divides  $ab$  but does not divide  $a$ . We must show that  $p$  divides  $b$ . Since  $p$  does not divide  $a$ , there are integers  $s$  and  $t$  such that  $1 = as + pt$ . Then  $b = abs + ptb$ , and since  $p$  divides the right-hand side of this equation,  $p$  also divides  $b$ . ■

Note that Euclid's Lemma may fail when  $p$  is not a prime, since  $6 \mid (4 \cdot 3)$  but  $6 \nmid 4$  and  $6 \nmid 3$ .

Our next property shows that the primes are the building blocks for all integers. We will often use this property without explicitly saying so.

## ■ Theorem 0.3 Fundamental Theorem of Arithmetic

*Every integer greater than 1 is a prime or a product of primes. This product is unique, except for the order in which the factors appear. That is, if  $n = p_1 p_2 \cdots p_r$  and  $n = q_1 q_2 \cdots q_s$ , where the  $p$ 's and  $q$ 's are primes, then  $r = s$  and, after renumbering the  $q$ 's, we have  $p_i = q_i$  for all  $i$ .*

We will prove the existence portion of Theorem 0.3 later in this chapter (Example 11). The uniqueness portion is a consequence of Euclid's Lemma (Exercise 31).

Another concept that frequently arises is that of the least common multiple of two integers.

### Definition Least Common Multiple

The *least common multiple* of two nonzero integers  $a$  and  $b$  is the smallest positive integer that is a multiple of both  $a$  and  $b$ . We will denote this integer by  $\text{lcm}(a, b)$ .

We leave it as an exercise (Exercise 10) to prove that every common multiple of  $a$  and  $b$  is a multiple of  $\text{lcm}(a, b)$ .

■ **EXAMPLE 3**  $\text{lcm}(4, 6) = 12$ ;  $\text{lcm}(4, 8) = 8$ ;  $\text{lcm}(10, 12) = 60$ ;  $\text{lcm}(6, 5) = 30$ ;  $\text{lcm}(2^2 \cdot 3^2 \cdot 5, 2 \cdot 3^3 \cdot 7^2) = 2^2 \cdot 3^3 \cdot 5 \cdot 7^2$ . ■

## Modular Arithmetic

Another application of the division algorithm that will be important to us is modular arithmetic. Modular arithmetic is an abstraction of a method of counting that you often use. For example, if it is now September, what month will it be 25 months from now? Of course, the answer is October, but the interesting fact is that you didn't arrive at the answer by starting with September and counting off 25 months. Instead, without even thinking about it, you simply observed that  $25 = 2 \cdot 12 + 1$ , and you added 1 month to September. Similarly, if it is now Wednesday, you know that in 23 days it will be Friday. This time, you arrived at your answer by noting that  $23 = 7 \cdot 3 + 2$ , so you added 2 days to Wednesday instead of counting off 23 days. If your electricity is off for 26 hours, you must advance your clock 2 hours, since  $26 = 2 \cdot 12 + 2$ . Surprisingly, this simple idea has numerous important

applications in mathematics and computer science. You will see a few of them in this section. The following notation is convenient.

When  $a = qn + r$ , where  $q$  is the quotient and  $r$  is the remainder upon dividing  $a$  by  $n$ , we write  $a \bmod n = r$ . Thus,

$$\begin{aligned} 3 \bmod 2 &= 1 \text{ since } 3 = 1 \cdot 2 + 1, \\ 6 \bmod 2 &= 0 \text{ since } 6 = 3 \cdot 2 + 0, \\ 11 \bmod 3 &= 2 \text{ since } 11 = 3 \cdot 3 + 2, \\ 62 \bmod 85 &= 62 \text{ since } 62 = 0 \cdot 85 + 62, \\ -2 \bmod 15 &= 13 \text{ since } -2 = (-1)15 + 13. \end{aligned}$$

In general, if  $a$  and  $b$  are integers and  $n$  is a positive integer, then  $a \bmod n = b \bmod n$  if and only if  $n$  divides  $a - b$  (Exercise 7).

In our applications, we will use addition and multiplication mod  $n$ . When you wish to compute  $ab \bmod n$  or  $(a + b) \bmod n$ , and  $a$  or  $b$  is greater than  $n$ , it is easier to “mod first.” For example, to compute  $(27 \cdot 36) \bmod 11$ , we note that  $27 \bmod 11 = 5$  and  $36 \bmod 11 = 3$ , so  $(27 \cdot 36) \bmod 11 = (5 \cdot 3) \bmod 11 = 4$ . (See Exercise 9.)

Modular arithmetic is often used in assigning an extra digit to identification numbers for the purpose of detecting forgery or errors. We present two such applications.

■ **EXAMPLE 4** The United States Postal Service money order shown in Figure 0.1 has an identification number consisting of 10 digits together with an extra digit called a *check*. The check digit is the 10-digit number modulo 9. Thus, the number 3953988164 has the check digit 2, since

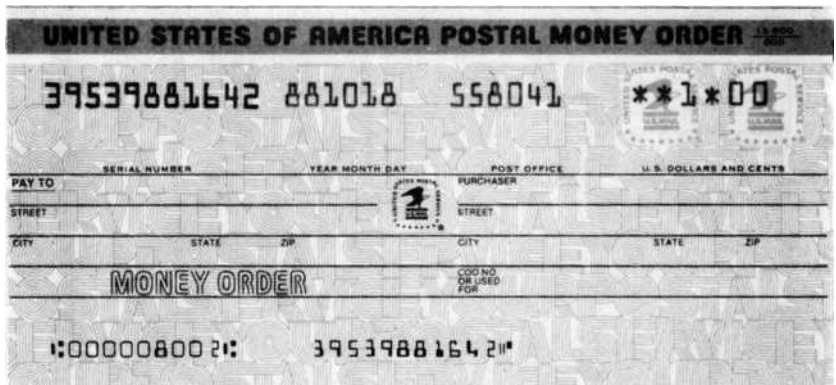


Figure 0.1

$3953988164 \bmod 9 = 2$ .<sup>†</sup> If the number 39539881642 were incorrectly entered into a computer (programmed to calculate the check digit) as, say, 39559881642 (an error in the fourth position), the machine would calculate the check digit as 4, whereas the entered check digit would be 2. Thus, the error would be detected. ■

■ **EXAMPLE 5** Airline companies, the United Parcel Service, and the rental-car companies Avis and National use the mod 7 values of identification numbers to assign check digits. Thus, the identification number 00121373147367 (see Figure 0.2) has the check digit 3 appended

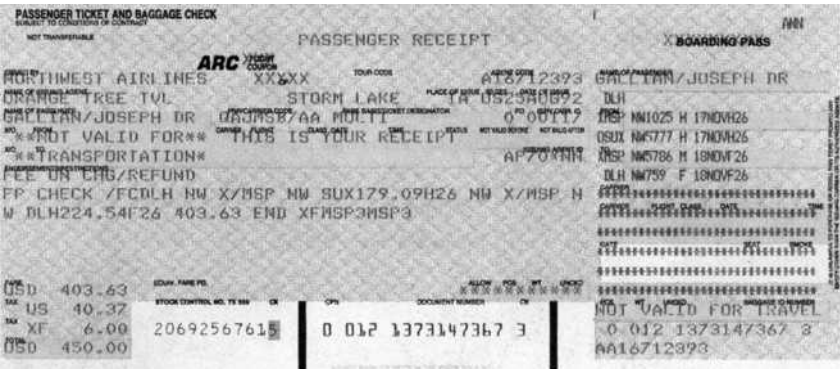


Figure 0.2

Figure 0.3 shows a United Parcel Service (UPS) shipping label form. The form includes fields for pickup record number (768113999), check code (2), and a table for package details. The table has columns for reference number, name, street, city, state, zip code, type of service, ground, air, and declared value. The form also includes a section for "ENTER EACH PACKAGE ON A SEPARATE LINE, IF RECORD IS VOIDED, PLEASE GIVE TO DRIVER, INCREASE FRACTIONS OF A POUND TO NEXT FULL POUND." and a section for "STAMP YOUR UPS SHIPPER NUMBER BELOW."

Figure 0.3

<sup>†</sup>The value of  $N \bmod 9$  is easy to compute with a calculator. If  $N = 9q + r$ , where  $r$  is the remainder upon dividing  $N$  by 9, then on a calculator screen  $N \div 9$  appears as  $q.rrrrr \dots$ , so the first decimal digit is the check digit. For example,  $3953988164 \div 9 = 439332018.222$ , so 2 is the check digit. If  $N$  has too many digits for your calculator, replace  $N$  by the sum of its digits and divide that number by 9. Thus,  $3953988164 \bmod 9 = 56 \bmod 9 = 2$ . The value of  $3953988164 \bmod 9$  can also be computed by searching Google for "3953988164 mod 9."

to it because  $121373147367 \bmod 7 = 3$ . Similarly, the UPS pickup record number 768113999, shown in Figure 0.3, has the check digit 2 appended to it. ■

The methods used by the Postal Service and the airline companies do not detect all single-digit errors (see Exercises 41 and 45). However, detection of all single-digit errors, as well as nearly all errors involving the transposition of two adjacent digits, is easily achieved. One method that does this is the one used to assign the so-called Universal Product Code (UPC) to most retail items (see Figure 0.4). A UPC identification number has 12 digits. The first six digits identify the manufacturer, the next five identify the product, and the last is a check. (For many items, the 12th digit is not printed, but it is always bar-coded.) In Figure 0.4, the check digit is 8.



Figure 0.4

To explain how the check digit is calculated, it is convenient to introduce the dot product notation for two  $k$ -tuples:

$$(a_1, a_2, \dots, a_k) \cdot (w_1, w_2, \dots, w_k) = a_1w_1 + a_2w_2 + \dots + a_kw_k.$$

An item with the UPC identification number  $a_1a_2 \dots a_{12}$  satisfies the condition

$$(a_1, a_2, \dots, a_{12}) \cdot (3, 1, 3, 1, \dots, 3, 1) \bmod 10 = 0.$$

To verify that the number in Figure 0.4 satisfies this condition, we calculate

$$\begin{aligned} &(0 \cdot 3 + 2 \cdot 1 + 1 \cdot 3 + 0 \cdot 1 + 0 \cdot 3 + 0 \cdot 1 + 6 \cdot 3 + 5 \cdot 1 \\ &\quad + 8 \cdot 3 + 9 \cdot 1 + 7 \cdot 3 + 8 \cdot 1) \bmod 10 = 90 \bmod 10 = 0. \end{aligned}$$

The fixed  $k$ -tuple used in the calculation of check digits is called the *weighting vector*.

Now suppose a single error is made in entering the number in Figure 0.4 into a computer. Say, for instance, that 021000958978 is

entered (notice that the seventh digit is incorrect). Then the computer calculates

$$0 \cdot 3 + 2 \cdot 1 + 1 \cdot 3 + 0 \cdot 1 + 0 \cdot 3 + 0 \cdot 1 + 9 \cdot 3 \\ + 5 \cdot 1 + 8 \cdot 3 + 9 \cdot 1 + 7 \cdot 3 + 8 \cdot 1 = 99.$$

Since  $99 \bmod 10 \neq 0$ , the entered number cannot be correct.

In general, any single error will result in a sum that is not 0 modulo 10.

The advantage of the UPC scheme is that it will detect nearly all errors involving the transposition of two adjacent digits as well as all errors involving one digit. For doubters, let us say that the identification number given in Figure 0.4 is entered as 021000658798. Notice that the last two digits preceding the check digit have been transposed. But by calculating the dot product, we obtain  $94 \bmod 10 \neq 0$ , so we have detected an error. In fact, the only undetected transposition errors of adjacent digits  $a$  and  $b$  are those where  $|a - b| = 5$ . To verify this, we observe that a transposition error of the form

$$a_1 a_2 \cdots a_i a_{i+1} \cdots a_{12} \rightarrow a_1 a_2 \cdots a_{i+1} a_i \cdots a_{12}$$

is undetected if and only if

$$(a_1, a_2, \dots, a_{i+1}, a_i, \dots, a_{12}) \cdot (3, 1, 3, 1, \dots, 3, 1) \bmod 10 = 0.$$

That is, the error is undetected if and only if

$$(a_1, a_2, \dots, a_{i+1}, a_i, \dots, a_{12}) \cdot (3, 1, 3, 1, \dots, 3, 1) \bmod 10 \\ = (a_1, a_2, \dots, a_i, a_{i+1}, \dots, a_{12}) \cdot (3, 1, 3, 1, \dots, 3, 1) \bmod 10.$$

This equality simplifies to either

$$(3a_{i+1} + a_i) \bmod 10 = (3a_i + a_{i+1}) \bmod 10$$

or

$$(a_{i+1} + 3a_i) \bmod 10 = (a_i + 3a_{i+1}) \bmod 10,$$

depending on whether  $i$  is even or odd. Both cases reduce to  $2(a_{i+1} - a_i) \bmod 10 = 0$ . It follows that  $|a_{i+1} - a_i| = 5$ , if  $a_{i+1} \neq a_i$ .

In 2005, United States companies began to phase in the use of a 13th digit to be in conformance with the 13-digit product identification numbers used in Europe. The weighting vector for 13-digit numbers is  $(1, 3, 1, 3, \dots, 3, 1)$ .

Identification numbers printed on bank checks (on the bottom left between the two colons) consist of an eight-digit number  $a_1 a_2 \cdots a_8$  and a check digit  $a_9$ , so that

$$(a_1, a_2, \dots, a_9) \cdot (7, 3, 9, 7, 3, 9, 7, 3, 9) \bmod 10 = 0.$$

As is the case for the UPC scheme, this method detects all single-digit errors and all errors involving the transposition of adjacent digits  $a$  and  $b$  except when  $|a - b| = 5$ . But it also detects most errors of the form  $\cdots abc \cdots \rightarrow \cdots cba \cdots$ , whereas the UPC method detects no errors of this form.

In Chapter 5, we will examine more sophisticated means of assigning check digits to numbers.

**What about error correction?** Suppose you have a number such as 73245018 and you would like to be sure that if even a single mistake were made in entering this number into a computer, the computer would nevertheless be able to determine the correct number. (Think of it. You could make a mistake in dialing a telephone number but still get the correct phone to ring!) **This is possible using two check digits.** One of the check digits determines the magnitude of any single-digit error, while the other check digit locates the position of the error. With these two pieces of information, you can fix the error. To illustrate the idea, let us say that we have the eight-digit identification number  $a_1 a_2 \cdots a_8$ . We assign two check digits  $a_9$  and  $a_{10}$  so that

$$(a_1 + a_2 + \cdots + a_9 + a_{10}) \bmod 11 = 0$$

and

$$(a_1, a_2, \dots, a_9, a_{10}) \cdot (1, 2, 3, \dots, 10) \bmod 11 = 0$$

are satisfied.

Let's do an example. Say our number before appending the two check digits is 73245018. Then  $a_9$  and  $a_{10}$  are chosen to satisfy

$$(7 + 3 + 2 + 4 + 5 + 0 + 1 + 8 + a_9 + a_{10}) \bmod 11 = 0 \quad (1)$$

and

$$(7 \cdot 1 + 3 \cdot 2 + 2 \cdot 3 + 4 \cdot 4 + 5 \cdot 5 + 0 \cdot 6 + 1 \cdot 7 + 8 \cdot 8 + a_9 \cdot 9 + a_{10} \cdot 10) \bmod 11 = 0. \quad (2)$$

Since  $7 + 3 + 2 + 4 + 5 + 0 + 1 + 8 = 30$  and  $30 \bmod 11 = 8$ , Equation (1) reduces to

$$(8 + a_9 + a_{10}) \bmod 11 = 0. \quad (1')$$

Likewise, since  $(7 \cdot 1 + 3 \cdot 2 + 2 \cdot 3 + 4 \cdot 4 + 5 \cdot 5 + 0 \cdot 6 + 1 \cdot 7 + 8 \cdot 8) \bmod 11 = 10$ , Equation (2) reduces to

$$(10 + 9a_9 + 10a_{10}) \bmod 11 = 0. \quad (2')$$

Since we are using mod 11, we may rewrite Equation (2') as

$$(-1 - 2a_9 - a_{10}) \bmod 11 = 0$$

and add this to Equation (1') to obtain  $7 - a_9 = 0$ . Thus  $a_9 = 7$ . Now substituting  $a_9 = 7$  into Equation (1') or Equation (2'), we obtain  $a_{10} = 7$  as well. So, the number is encoded as 7324501877.

Now let us suppose that this number is erroneously entered into a computer programmed with our encoding scheme as 7824501877 (an error in position 2). Since the sum of the digits of the received number mod 11 is 5, we know that some digit is 5 too large (assuming only one error has been made). But which one? Say the error is in position  $i$ . Then the second dot product has the form  $a_1 \cdot 1 + a_2 \cdot 2 + \dots + (a_i + 5)i + a_{i+1} \cdot (i + 1) + \dots + a_{10} \cdot 10 = (a_1, a_2, \dots, a_{10}) \cdot (1, 2, \dots, 10) + 5i$ . So,  $(7, 8, 2, 4, 5, 0, 1, 8, 7, 7) \cdot (1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10) \bmod 11 = 5i \bmod 11$ . Since the left-hand side mod 11 is 10, we see that  $i = 2$ . Our conclusion: The digit in position 2 is 5 too large. We have successfully corrected the error.

Modular arithmetic is often used to verify the validity of statements about divisibility regarding all positive integers by checking only finitely many cases.

**EXAMPLE 6** Consider the statement, “The sum of the cubes of any three consecutive integers is divisible by 9.” This statement is equivalent to checking that the equation  $(n^3 + (n + 1)^3 + (n + 2)^3) \bmod 9 = 0$  is true for all integers  $n$ . Because of properties of modular arithmetic, to prove this, all we need to do is check the validity of the equation for  $n = 0, 1, \dots, 8$ . ■

Modular arithmetic is occasionally used to show that certain equations have no rational number solutions.

**EXAMPLE 7** We use mod 4 arithmetic to show that there are no integers  $x$  and  $y$  such that  $x^2 - y^2 = 1002$ . To see this, suppose that there are such integers. Then, taking both sides modulo 4, there is an integer solution to  $x^2 - y^2 \bmod 4 = 2$ . Note that for any integer  $n$ , if  $n \bmod 4 = 0$  or 2, then  $n^2 \bmod 4 = 0$  and if  $n \bmod 4 = 1$  or 3 mod 4, then  $n^2 \bmod 4 = 1$ . But then the only differences of squares of integers modulo 4 are 0, 1, and  $-1 = 3$ , which gives a contradiction. A refinement of this argument shows that **there are no rational numbers that satisfy the equation  $x^2 - y^2 = 1002$**  (see Exercise 64). ■

At the dawn of the 20th century no one would have thought that strings of 0s and 1s added modulo 2 would provide the underpinning for a revolution in business, industry, technology, and science. The next example is an application of mod 2 arithmetic to circuit design. More applications of mod 2 arithmetic are given in later chapters.



■ **EXAMPLE 8 Logic Gates** In electronics a *logic gate* is a device that accepts as inputs two possible states (on or off) and produces one output (on or off). This can be conveniently modeled using 0 and 1 and modulo 2 arithmetic. The AND gate outputs 1 if and only if both inputs are 1; the OR (inclusive or) gate outputs 1 if at least one input is 1; the XOR (exclusive or) outputs 1 if and only if exactly one input is 1; MAJ (majority) takes three inputs and outputs 1 if and only if at least two inputs are 1. These and others can be conveniently modeled as functions using 0 and 1 and modulo 2 arithmetic as follows:

|                       |                  |
|-----------------------|------------------|
| $x$ AND $y$           | $xy$             |
| $x$ OR $y$            | $x + y + xy$     |
| $x$ XOR $y$           | $x + y$          |
| $\text{MAJ}(x, y, z)$ | $xz + xy + yz$ . |

## Complex Numbers

Recall that complex numbers are expressions of the form  $a + b\sqrt{-1}$ , where  $a$  and  $b$  are real numbers. The number  $\sqrt{-1}$  is defined to have the property  $\sqrt{-1}^2 = -1$ . It is customary to use  $i$  to denote  $\sqrt{-1}$ . Then,  $i^2 = -1$ . Complex numbers written in the form  $a + bi$  are said to be in *standard form*. In some instances it is convenient to write a complex number  $a + bi$  in another form. To do this we represent  $a + bi$  as the point  $(a, b)$  in a plane coordinatized by a horizontal axis called the *real axis* and a vertical  $i$  axis called the *imaginary axis*. The distance from the point  $a + bi$  to the origin is  $r = \sqrt{a^2 + b^2}$  and is often denoted by  $|a + bi|$  and called the *norm* of  $a + bi$ . If we draw the line segment from the origin to  $a + bi$  and denote the angle formed by the line segment and the positive real axis by  $\theta$ , we can write  $a + bi$  as  $r(\cos \theta + i \sin \theta)$  (see Figure 0.5).

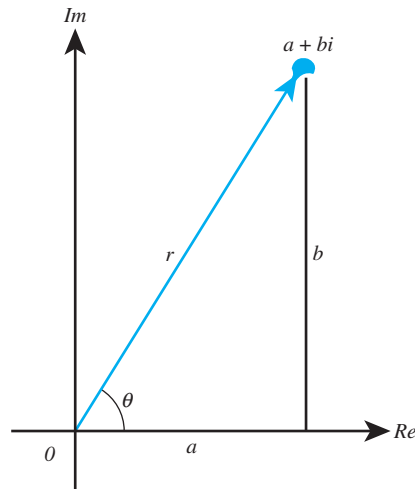


Figure 0.5

This form of  $a + bi$  is called the *polar* form. An advantage of the polar form is demonstrated in parts 5 and 6 of Theorem 0.4.

### ■ Theorem 0.4 Properties of Complex Numbers

1. Closure under addition:  $(a + bi) + (c + di) = (a + c) + (b + d)i$
2. Closure under multiplication:  $(a + bi)(c + di) = (ac) + (ad)i + (bc)i + (bd)i^2 = (ac - bd) + (ad + bc)i$
3. Closure under division ( $c + di \neq 0$ ):  $\frac{(a + bi)}{(c + di)} = \frac{(a + bi)(c - di)}{(c + di)(c - di)} = \frac{(ac + bd) + (bc - ad)i}{c^2 + d^2} = \frac{(ac + bd)}{c^2 + d^2} + \frac{(bc - ad)}{c^2 + d^2}i$
4. Complex conjugation:  $(a + bi)(a - bi) = a^2 + b^2$
5. Inverses: For every nonzero complex number  $a + bi$  there is a complex number  $c + di$  such that  $(a + bi)(c + di) = 1$  (That is,  $(a + bi)^{-1}$  exists in  $\mathbb{C}$ ).
6. Powers: For every complex number  $a + bi = r(\cos \theta + i \sin \theta)$  and every positive integer  $n$ , we have  $(a + bi)^n = (r(\cos \theta + i \sin \theta))^n = r^n(\cos n\theta + i \sin n\theta)$ .
7.  $n^{\text{th}}$ -roots of  $a + bi$ : For any positive integer  $n$  the  $n$  distinct  $n^{\text{th}}$  roots of  $a + bi = r(\cos \theta + i \sin \theta)$  are  $\sqrt[n]{r} \left( \cos \frac{\theta + 2\pi k}{n} + i \sin \frac{\theta + 2\pi k}{n} \right)$  for  $k = 0, 1, \dots, n - 1$ .

**PROOF** Parts 1 and 2 are definitions. Part 4 follows from part 2. Part 6 is proved in Example 12 in the next section of this chapter. Part 7 follows from part 6. ■

The next two examples illustrates properties of complex numbers.

■ **EXAMPLE 9**  $(3 + 5i) + (-5 + 2i) = -2 + 7i$ ;

$$(3 + 5i)(-5 + 2i) = -25 + (-19)i = -25 - 19i;$$

$$\frac{3 + 5i}{-2 + 7i} = \frac{3 + 5i}{-2 + 7i} \cdot \frac{-2 - 7i}{-2 - 7i} = \frac{29 - 31i}{53} = \frac{29}{53} + \frac{-31}{53}i;$$

$$(3 + 5i)(3 - 5i) = 9 + 25 = 34;$$

$$(3 + 5i)^{-1} = \frac{3}{34} - \frac{5}{34}i.$$

■ **EXAMPLE 10**  $(-1 + i)^4 = \left( \sqrt{2} \left( \cos \frac{3\pi}{4} + i \sin \frac{3\pi}{4} \right) \right)^4 =$

$$\sqrt{2}^4 \left( \cos \frac{4 \cdot 3\pi}{4} + i \sin \frac{4 \cdot 3\pi}{4} \right) = 4(\cos 3\pi + i \sin 3\pi) = -4.$$

The three cube roots of  $i = \cos \frac{\pi}{2} + i \sin \frac{\pi}{2}$  are

$$\cos \frac{\pi}{6} + i \sin \frac{\pi}{6} = \frac{\sqrt{3}}{2} + \frac{1}{2}i$$

$$\cos \left( \frac{\pi}{6} + \frac{2\pi}{3} \right) + i \sin \left( \frac{\pi}{6} + \frac{2\pi}{3} \right) = -\frac{\sqrt{3}}{2} + \frac{1}{2}i$$

$$\cos \left( \frac{\pi}{6} + \frac{4\pi}{3} \right) + i \sin \left( \frac{\pi}{6} + \frac{4\pi}{3} \right) = -i.$$

## Mathematical Induction

There are two forms of proof by mathematical induction that we will use. Both are equivalent to the Well Ordering Principle. The explicit formulation of the method of **mathematical induction** came in the 16th century. Francisco Maurolico (1494–1575), a teacher of Galileo, used it in 1575 to prove that  $1 + 3 + 5 + \cdots + (2n - 1) = n^2$ , and Blaise Pascal (1623–1662) used it when he presented what we now call Pascal's triangle for the coefficients of the binomial expansion. The term *mathematical induction* was coined by Augustus De Morgan.

### ■ Theorem 0.5 First Principle of Mathematical Induction

*Let  $S$  be a set of integers containing  $a$ . Suppose  $S$  has the property that whenever some integer  $n \geq a$  belongs to  $S$ , then the integer  $n + 1$  also belongs to  $S$ . Then,  $S$  contains every integer greater than or equal to  $a$ .*

**PROOF** The proof is left as an exercise (Exercise 33). ■

So, to use induction to prove that a statement involving positive integers is true for every positive integer, we must first verify that the statement is true for the integer 1. We then *assume* the statement is true for the integer  $n$  and use this assumption to prove that the statement is true for the integer  $n + 1$ .

Our next example uses some facts about plane geometry. Recall that given a straightedge and compass, we can construct a right angle.

■ **EXAMPLE 11** We use induction to prove that given a straightedge, a compass, and a unit length, we can **construct a line segment of length  $\sqrt{n}$  for every positive integer  $n$** . The case when  $n = 1$  is given. Now we assume that we can construct a line segment of length  $\sqrt{n}$ . Then use the straightedge and compass to construct a right triangle with height 1 and base  $\sqrt{n}$ . The hypotenuse of the triangle has length  $\sqrt{n + 1}$ . So, by induction, we can construct a line segment of length  $\sqrt{n}$  for every positive integer  $n$ . ■

■ **EXAMPLE 12 DeMOIVRE'S THEOREM** We use induction to prove that for every positive integer  $n$  and every real number  $\theta$ ,  $(\cos \theta + i \sin \theta)^n = \cos n\theta + i \sin n\theta$ , where  $i$  is the complex number  $\sqrt{-1}$ . Obviously, the statement is true for  $n = 1$ . Now assume it is true for  $n$ . We must prove that  $(\cos \theta + i \sin \theta)^{n+1} = \cos(n+1)\theta + i \sin(n+1)\theta$ . Observe that

$$\begin{aligned} (\cos \theta + i \sin \theta)^{n+1} &= (\cos \theta + i \sin \theta)^n (\cos \theta + i \sin \theta) \\ &= (\cos n\theta + i \sin n\theta)(\cos \theta + i \sin \theta) \\ &= \cos n\theta \cos \theta + i(\sin n\theta \cos \theta \\ &\quad + \sin \theta \cos n\theta) - \sin n\theta \sin \theta. \end{aligned}$$

Now, using trigonometric identities for  $\cos(\alpha + \beta)$  and  $\sin(\alpha + \beta)$ , we see that this last term is  $\cos(n+1)\theta + i \sin(n+1)\theta$ . So, by induction, the statement is true for all positive integers. ■

In many instances, the assumption that a statement is true for an integer  $n$  does not readily lend itself to a proof that the statement is true for the integer  $n + 1$ . In such cases, the following equivalent form of induction may be more convenient. Some authors call this formulation the *strong form* of induction.

## ■ Theorem 0.6 Second Principle of Mathematical Induction

*Let  $S$  be a set of integers containing  $a$ . Suppose  $S$  has the property that  $n$  belongs to  $S$  whenever every integer less than  $n$  and greater than or equal to  $a$  belongs to  $S$ . Then,  $S$  contains every integer greater than or equal to  $a$ .*

**PROOF** The proof is left to the reader. ■

To use this form of induction, we first show that the statement is true for the integer  $a$ . We then *assume* that the statement is true for *all* integers that are greater than or equal to  $a$  and less than  $n$ , and use this assumption to prove that the statement is true for  $n$ .

■ **EXAMPLE 13** We will use the Second Principle of Mathematical Induction with  $a = 2$  to prove the existence portion of the Fundamental Theorem of Arithmetic. Let  $S$  be the set of integers greater than 1 that are primes or products of primes. Clearly,  $2 \in S$ . Now we assume that for some integer  $n$ ,  $S$  contains all integers  $k$  with  $2 \leq k < n$ . We must show that  $n \in S$ . If  $n$  is a prime, then  $n \in S$  by definition. If  $n$  is not a prime, then  $n$  can be written in the form  $ab$ , where  $1 < a < n$  and  $1 < b < n$ .

Since we are assuming that both  $a$  and  $b$  belong to  $S$ , we know that each of them is a prime or a product of primes. Thus,  $n$  is also a product of primes. This completes the proof. ■

Notice that it is more natural to prove the Fundamental Theorem of Arithmetic with the Second Principle of Mathematical Induction than with the First Principle. Knowing that a particular integer factors as a product of primes does not tell you anything about factoring the next larger integer. (Does knowing that 5280 is a product of primes help you to factor 5281 as a product of primes?)

The following problem appeared in the “Brain Boggler” section of the January 1988 issue of the science magazine *Discover*.\*

■ **EXAMPLE 14** The Quakertown Poker Club plays with blue chips worth \$5.00 and red chips worth \$8.00. What is the largest bet that cannot be made?

To gain insight into this problem, we try various combinations of blue and red chips and obtain 5, 8, 10, 13, 15, 16, 18, 20, 21, 23, 24, 25, 26, 28, 29, 30, 31, 32, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37, 38, 39, 40. It appears that the answer is 27. But how can we be sure? Well, we need only prove that every integer greater than 27 can be written in the form  $a \cdot 5 + b \cdot 8$ , where  $a$  and  $b$  are nonnegative integers. This will solve the problem, since  $a$  represents the number of blue chips and  $b$  the number of red chips needed to make a bet of  $a \cdot 5 + b \cdot 8$ . For the purpose of contrast, we will give two proofs—one using the First Principle of Mathematical Induction and one using the Second Principle.

Let  $S$  be the set of all integers greater than or equal to 28 of the form  $a \cdot 5 + b \cdot 8$ , where  $a$  and  $b$  are nonnegative. Obviously,  $28 \in S$ . Now assume that some integer  $n \in S$ , say,  $n = a \cdot 5 + b \cdot 8$ . We must show that  $n + 1 \in S$ . First, note that since  $n \geq 28$ , we cannot have both  $a$  and  $b$  less than 3. If  $a \geq 3$ , then

$$\begin{aligned} n + 1 &= (a \cdot 5 + b \cdot 8) + (-3 \cdot 5 + 2 \cdot 8) \\ &= (a - 3) \cdot 5 + (b + 2) \cdot 8. \end{aligned}$$

(Regarding chips, this last equation says that we may increase a bet from  $n$  to  $n + 1$  by removing three blue chips from the pot and adding two red chips.) If  $b \geq 3$ , then

$$\begin{aligned} n + 1 &= (a \cdot 5 + b \cdot 8) + (5 \cdot 5 - 3 \cdot 8) \\ &= (a + 5) \cdot 5 + (b - 3) \cdot 8. \end{aligned}$$

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\*“Brain Boggler” by Maxwell Carver. Copyright © 1988 by *Discover Magazine*. Used by permission.

(The bet can be increased by 1 by removing three red chips and adding five blue chips.) This completes the proof.

To prove the same statement by the Second Principle, we note that each of the integers 28, 29, 30, 31, and 32 is in  $S$ . Now assume that for some integer  $n > 32$ ,  $S$  contains all integers  $k$  with  $28 \leq k < n$ . We must show that  $n \in S$ . Since  $n - 5 \in S$ , there are nonnegative integers  $a$  and  $b$  such that  $n - 5 = a \cdot 5 + b \cdot 8$ . But then  $n = (a + 1) \cdot 5 + b \cdot 8$ . Thus  $n$  is in  $S$ . ■

## Equivalence Relations

In mathematics, things that are considered different in one context may be viewed as equivalent in another context. We have already seen one such example. Indeed, the sums  $2 + 1$  and  $4 + 4$  are certainly different in ordinary arithmetic, but are the same under modulo 5 arithmetic. Congruent triangles that are situated differently in the plane are not the same, but they are often considered to be the same in plane geometry. In physics, vectors of the same magnitude and direction can produce different effects—a 10-pound weight placed 2 feet from a fulcrum produces a different effect than a 10-pound weight placed 1 foot from a fulcrum. But in linear algebra, vectors of the same magnitude and direction are considered to be the same. What is needed to make these distinctions precise is an appropriate generalization of the notion of equality; that is, we need a formal mechanism for specifying whether or not two quantities are the same in a given setting. This mechanism is an equivalence relation.

### Definition Equivalence Relation

An *equivalence relation* on a set  $S$  is a set  $R$  of ordered pairs of elements of  $S$  such that

1.  $(a, a) \in R$  for all  $a \in S$  (reflexive property).
2.  $(a, b) \in R$  implies  $(b, a) \in R$  (symmetric property).
3.  $(a, b) \in R$  and  $(b, c) \in R$  imply  $(a, c) \in R$  (transitive property).

When  $R$  is an equivalence relation on a set  $S$ , it is customary to write  $aRb$  instead of  $(a, b) \in R$ . Also, since an equivalence relation is just a generalization of equality, a suggestive symbol such as  $\approx$ ,  $\equiv$ , or  $\sim$  is usually used to denote the relation. Using this notation, the three conditions for an equivalence relation become  $a \sim a$ ;  $a \sim b$  implies  $b \sim a$ ; and  $a \sim b$  and  $b \sim c$  imply  $a \sim c$ . If  $\sim$  is an equivalence relation on a set  $S$  and  $a \in S$ , then the set  $[a] = \{x \in S \mid x \sim a\}$  is called the **equivalence class** of  $S$  containing  $a$ .

■ **EXAMPLE 15** Let  $S$  be the set of all triangles in a plane. If  $a, b \in S$ , define  $a \sim b$  if  $a$  and  $b$  are similar—that is, if  $a$  and  $b$  have corresponding angles that are the same. Then  $\sim$  is an equivalence relation on  $S$ . ■

■ **EXAMPLE 16** Let  $S$  be the set of all polynomials with real coefficients. If  $f, g \in S$ , define  $f \sim g$  if  $f' = g'$ , where  $f'$  is the derivative of  $f$ . Then  $\sim$  is an equivalence relation on  $S$ . Since two polynomials with equal derivatives differ by a constant, we see that for any  $f$  in  $S$ ,  $[f] = \{f + c \mid c \text{ is real}\}$ . ■

■ **EXAMPLE 17** Let  $S$  be the set of integers and let  $n$  be a positive integer. If  $a, b \in S$ , define  $a \equiv b$  if  $a \bmod n = b \bmod n$  (that is, if  $a - b$  is divisible by  $n$ ). Then  $\equiv$  is an equivalence relation on  $S$  and  $[a] = \{a + kn \mid k \in S\}$ . Since this particular relation is important in abstract algebra, we will take the trouble to verify that it is indeed an equivalence relation. Certainly,  $a - a$  is divisible by  $n$ , so that  $a \equiv a$  for all  $a$  in  $S$ . Next, assume that  $a \equiv b$ , say,  $a - b = rn$ . Then,  $b - a = (-r)n$ , and therefore  $b \equiv a$ . Finally, assume that  $a \equiv b$  and  $b \equiv c$ , say,  $a - b = rn$  and  $b - c = sn$ . Then, we have  $a - c = (a - b) + (b - c) = rn + sn = (r + s)n$ , so that  $a \equiv c$ . ■

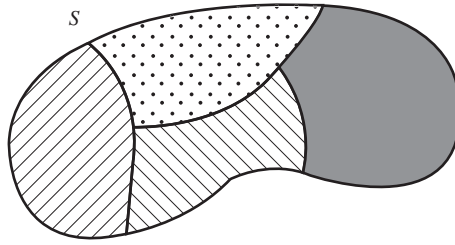
■ **EXAMPLE 18** Let  $\equiv$  be as in Example 17 and let  $n = 7$ . Then we have  $16 \equiv 2$ ;  $9 \equiv -5$ ; and  $24 \equiv 3$ . Also,  $[1] = \{\dots, -20, -13, -6, 1, 8, 15, \dots\}$  and  $[4] = \{\dots, -17, -10, -3, 4, 11, 18, \dots\}$ . ■

■ **EXAMPLE 19** Let  $S = \{(a, b) \mid a, b \text{ are integers, } b \neq 0\}$ . If  $(a, b), (c, d) \in S$ , define  $(a, b) \approx (c, d)$  if  $ad = bc$ . Then  $\approx$  is an equivalence relation on  $S$ . [The motivation for this example comes from fractions. In fact, the pairs  $(a, b)$  and  $(c, d)$  are equivalent if the fractions  $a/b$  and  $c/d$  are equal.]

To verify that  $\approx$  is an equivalence relation on  $S$ , note that  $(a, b) \approx (a, b)$  requires that  $ab = ba$ , which is true. Next, we assume that  $(a, b) \approx (c, d)$ , so that  $ad = bc$ . We have  $(c, d) \approx (a, b)$  provided that  $cb = da$ , which is true from commutativity of multiplication. Finally, we assume that  $(a, b) \approx (c, d)$  and  $(c, d) \approx (e, f)$  and prove that  $(a, b) \approx (e, f)$ . This amounts to using  $ad = bc$  and  $cf = de$  to show that  $af = be$ . Multiplying both sides of  $ad = bc$  by  $f$  and replacing  $cf$  by  $de$ , we obtain  $adf = bcf = bde$ . Since  $d \neq 0$ , we can cancel  $d$  from the first and last terms. ■

### Definition Partition

A *partition* of a set  $S$  is a collection of nonempty disjoint subsets of  $S$  whose union is  $S$ . Figure 0.6 illustrates a partition of a set into four subsets.



**Figure 0.6** Partition of  $S$  into four subsets.

■ **EXAMPLE 20** The sets  $\{0\}$ ,  $\{1, 2, 3, \dots\}$ , and  $\{\dots, -3, -2, -1\}$  constitute a partition of the set of integers. ■

■ **EXAMPLE 21** The set of nonnegative integers and the set of nonpositive integers do not partition the integers, since both contain 0. ■

The next theorem reveals that equivalence relations and partitions are intimately intertwined.

### ■ Theorem 0.7 Equivalence Classes Partition

*The equivalence classes of an equivalence relation on a set  $S$  constitute a partition of  $S$ . Conversely, for any partition  $P$  of  $S$ , there is an equivalence relation on  $S$  whose equivalence classes are the elements of  $P$ .*

**PROOF** Let  $\sim$  be an equivalence relation on a set  $S$ . For any  $a \in S$ , the reflexive property shows that  $a \in [a]$ . So,  $[a]$  is nonempty and the union of all equivalence classes is  $S$ . Now, suppose that  $[a]$  and  $[b]$  are distinct equivalence classes. We must show that  $[a] \cap [b] = \emptyset$ . On the contrary, assume  $c \in [a] \cap [b]$ . We will show that  $[a] \subseteq [b]$ . To this end, let  $x \in [a]$ . We then have  $c \sim a$ ,  $c \sim b$ , and  $x \sim a$ . By the symmetric property, we also have  $a \sim c$ . Thus, by transitivity,  $x \sim c$ , and by transitivity again,  $x \sim b$ . This proves  $[a] \subseteq [b]$ . Analogously,  $[b] \subseteq [a]$ . Thus,  $[a] = [b]$ , in contradiction to our assumption that  $[a]$  and  $[b]$  are distinct equivalence classes.

To prove the converse, let  $P$  be a collection of nonempty disjoint subsets of  $S$  whose union is  $S$ . Define  $a \sim b$  if  $a$  and  $b$  belong to the same subset in the collection. We leave it to the reader to show that  $\sim$  is an equivalence relation on  $S$  (Exercise 61). ■

## Functions (Mappings)

Although the concept of a function plays a central role in nearly every branch of mathematics, the terminology and notation associated with functions vary quite a bit. In this section, we establish ours.



### Definition Function (Mapping)

A *function* (or *mapping*)  $\phi$  from a set  $A$  to a set  $B$  is a rule that assigns to each element  $a$  of  $A$  exactly one element  $b$  of  $B$ . The set  $A$  is called the *domain* of  $\phi$ , and  $B$  is called the *range* of  $\phi$ . If  $\phi$  assigns  $b$  to  $a$ , then  $b$  is called the *image* of  $a$  under  $\phi$ . The subset of  $B$  comprising all the images of elements of  $A$  is called the *image* of  $A$  under  $\phi$ .

We use the shorthand  $\phi: A \rightarrow B$  to mean that  $\phi$  is a mapping from  $A$  to  $B$ . We will write  $\phi(a) = b$  or  $\phi: a \rightarrow b$  to indicate that  $\phi$  carries  $a$  to  $b$ .

There are often different ways to denote the same element of a set. In defining a function in such cases one must verify that the function values assigned to the elements depend not on the way the elements are expressed but on only the elements themselves. For example, the correspondence  $\phi$  from the rational numbers to the integers given by  $\phi(a/b) = a + b$  does not define a function since  $1/2 = 2/4$  but  $\phi(1/2) \neq \phi(2/4)$ . To verify that a correspondence is a function, you assume that  $x_1 = x_2$  and prove that  $\phi(x_1) = \phi(x_2)$ .

### Definition Composition of Functions

Let  $\phi: A \rightarrow B$  and  $\psi: B \rightarrow C$ . The *composition*  $\psi\phi$  is the mapping from  $A$  to  $C$  defined by  $(\psi\phi)(a) = \psi(\phi(a))$  for all  $a$  in  $A$ . The composition function  $\psi\phi$  can be visualized as in Figure 0.7.

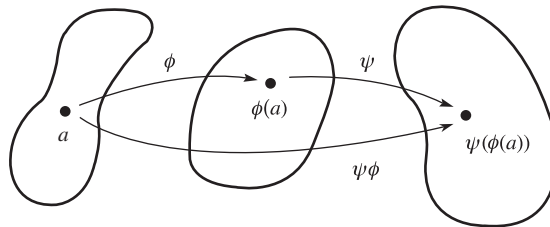


Figure 0.7 Composition of functions  $\phi$  and  $\psi$ .

In calculus courses, the composition of  $f$  with  $g$  is written  $(f \circ g)(x)$  and is defined by  $(f \circ g)(x) = f(g(x))$ . When we compose functions, we omit the “circle.”

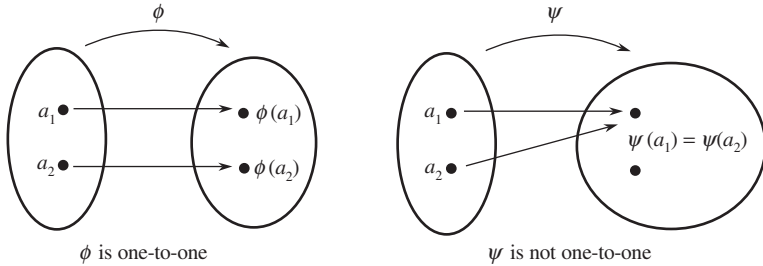
■ **EXAMPLE 22** Let  $f(x) = 2x + 3$  and  $g(x) = x^2 + 1$ . Then  $(fg)(5) = f(g(5)) = f(26) = 55$ ;  $(gf)(5) = g(f(5)) = g(13) = 170$ . More generally,  $(fg)(x) = f(g(x)) = f(x^2 + 1) = 2(x^2 + 1) + 3 = 2x^2 + 5$  and  $(gf)(x) = g(f(x)) = g(2x + 3) = (2x + 3)^2 + 1 = 4x^2 + 12x + 9 + 1 = 4x^2 + 12x + 10$ . Note that the function  $fg$  is not the same as the function  $gf$ . ■

There are several kinds of functions that occur often enough to be given names.

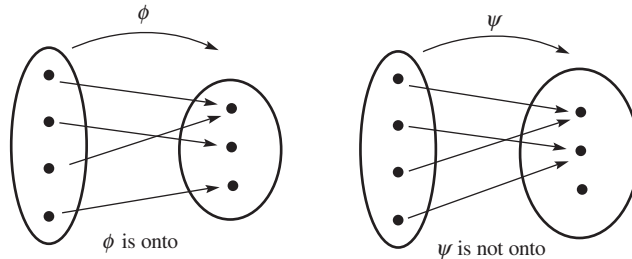
**Definition One-to-One Function**

A function  $\phi$  from a set  $A$  is called *one-to-one* if for every  $a_1, a_2 \in A$ ,  $\phi(a_1) = \phi(a_2)$  implies  $a_1 = a_2$ .

The term *one-to-one* is suggestive, since the definition ensures that one element of  $B$  can be the image of only one element of  $A$ . Alternatively,  $\phi$  is one-to-one if  $a_1 \neq a_2$  implies  $\phi(a_1) \neq \phi(a_2)$ . That is, different elements of  $A$  map to different elements of  $B$ . See Figure 0.8.

**Figure 0.8****Definition Function from A onto B**

A function  $\phi$  from a set  $A$  to a set  $B$  is said to be *onto*  $B$  if each element of  $B$  is the image of at least one element of  $A$ . In symbols,  $\phi: A \rightarrow B$  is onto if for each  $b$  in  $B$  there is at least one  $a$  in  $A$  such that  $\phi(a) = b$ . See Figure 0.9.

**Figure 0.9**

The next theorem summarizes the facts about functions we will need.

**■ Theorem 0.8 Properties of Functions**

Given functions  $\alpha: A \rightarrow B$ ,  $\beta: B \rightarrow C$ , and  $\gamma: C \rightarrow D$ , then

1.  $\gamma(\beta\alpha) = (\gamma\beta)\alpha$  (associativity).
2. If  $\alpha$  and  $\beta$  are one-to-one, then  $\beta\alpha$  is one-to-one.
3. If  $\alpha$  and  $\beta$  are onto, then  $\beta\alpha$  is onto.
4. If  $\alpha$  is one-to-one and onto, then there is a function  $\alpha^{-1}$  from  $B$  onto  $A$  such that  $(\alpha^{-1}\alpha)(a) = a$  for all  $a$  in  $A$  and  $(\alpha\alpha^{-1})(b) = b$  for all  $b$  in  $B$ .

**PROOF** We prove only part 1. The remaining parts are left as exercises (Exercise 57). Let  $a \in A$ . Then  $(\gamma(\beta\alpha))(a) = \gamma((\beta\alpha)(a)) = \gamma(\beta(\alpha(a)))$ . On the other hand,  $((\gamma\beta)\alpha)(a) = (\gamma\beta)(\alpha(a)) = \gamma(\beta(\alpha(a)))$ . So,  $\gamma(\beta\alpha) = (\gamma\beta)\alpha$ . ■

It is useful to note that if  $\alpha$  is one-to-one and onto, the function  $\alpha^{-1}$  described in part 4 of Theorem 0.8 has the property that if  $\alpha(s) = t$ , then  $\alpha^{-1}(t) = s$ . That is, the image of  $t$  under  $\alpha^{-1}$  is the unique element  $s$  that maps to  $t$  under  $\alpha$ . In effect,  $\alpha^{-1}$  “undoes” what  $\alpha$  does.

■ **EXAMPLE 23** Let  $\mathbf{Z}$  denote the set of integers,  $\mathbf{R}$  the set of real numbers, and  $\mathbf{N}$  the set of nonnegative integers. The following table illustrates the properties of one-to-one and onto.

| Domain       | Range        | Rule                | One-to-One | Onto |
|--------------|--------------|---------------------|------------|------|
| $\mathbf{Z}$ | $\mathbf{Z}$ | $x \rightarrow x^3$ | Yes        | No   |
| $\mathbf{R}$ | $\mathbf{R}$ | $x \rightarrow x^3$ | Yes        | Yes  |
| $\mathbf{Z}$ | $\mathbf{N}$ | $x \rightarrow  x $ | No         | Yes  |
| $\mathbf{Z}$ | $\mathbf{Z}$ | $x \rightarrow x^2$ | No         | No   |

To verify that  $x \rightarrow x^3$  is one-to-one in the first two cases, notice that if  $x^3 = y^3$ , we may take the cube roots of both sides of the equation to obtain  $x = y$ . Clearly, the mapping from  $\mathbf{Z}$  to  $\mathbf{Z}$  given by  $x \rightarrow x^3$  is not onto, since 2 is the cube of no integer. However,  $x \rightarrow x^3$  defines an onto function from  $\mathbf{R}$  to  $\mathbf{R}$ , since every real number is the cube of its cube root (that is,  $\sqrt[3]{b} \rightarrow b$ ). The remaining verifications are left to the reader. ■

Exercises

I was interviewed in the Israeli Radio for five minutes and I said that more than 2000 years ago, Euclid proved that there are infinitely many primes. Immediately the host interrupted me and asked: “Are there still infinitely many primes?”

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- 1. For  $n = 5, 8, 12, 20$ , and  $25$ , find all positive integers less than  $n$  and relatively prime to  $n$ .
- 2. Determine
  - a.  $\gcd(2,10)$        $\text{lcm}(2,10)$
  - b.  $\gcd(20,8)$        $\text{lcm}(20,8)$
  - c.  $\gcd(12,40)$        $\text{lcm}(12,40)$
  - d.  $\gcd(21,50)$        $\text{lcm}(21,50)$
  - e.  $\gcd(p^2q^2, pq^3)$        $\text{lcm}(p^2q^2, pq^3)$  where  $p$  and  $q$  are distinct primes

3. Determine  $51 \bmod 13$ ,  $342 \bmod 85$ ,  $62 \bmod 15$ ,  $10 \bmod 15$ ,  $(82 \cdot 73) \bmod 7$ ,  $(51 + 68) \bmod 7$ ,  $(35 \cdot 24) \bmod 11$ , and  $(47 + 68) \bmod 11$ .
4. Find integers  $s$  and  $t$  such that  $1 = 7 \cdot s + 11 \cdot t$ . Show that  $s$  and  $t$  are not unique.
5. Show that if  $a$  and  $b$  are positive integers, then  $ab = \text{lcm}(a, b) \cdot \text{gcd}(a, b)$ .
6. Suppose  $a$  and  $b$  are integers that divide the integer  $c$ . If  $a$  and  $b$  are relatively prime, show that  $ab$  divides  $c$ . Show, by example, that if  $a$  and  $b$  are not relatively prime, then  $ab$  need not divide  $c$ .
7. If  $a$  and  $b$  are integers and  $n$  is a positive integer, prove that  $a \bmod n = b \bmod n$  if and only if  $n$  divides  $a - b$ .
8. Let  $d = \text{gcd}(a, b)$ . If  $a = da'$  and  $b = db'$ , show that  $\text{gcd}(a', b') = 1$ .
9. Let  $n$  be a fixed positive integer greater than 1. If  $a \bmod n = a'$  and  $b \bmod n = b'$ , prove that  $(a + b) \bmod n = (a' + b') \bmod n$  and  $(ab) \bmod n = (a'b') \bmod n$ . (This exercise is referred to in Chapters 6, 8, 10, and 15.)
10. Let  $a$  and  $b$  be positive integers and let  $d = \text{gcd}(a, b)$  and  $m = \text{lcm}(a, b)$ . If  $t$  divides both  $a$  and  $b$ , prove that  $t$  divides  $d$ . If  $s$  is a multiple of both  $a$  and  $b$ , prove that  $s$  is a multiple of  $m$ .
11. Let  $n$  and  $a$  be positive integers and let  $d = \text{gcd}(a, n)$ . Show that the equation  $ax \bmod n = 1$  has a solution if and only if  $d = 1$ . (This exercise is referred to in Chapter 2.)
12. Show that  $5n + 3$  and  $7n + 4$  are relatively prime for all  $n$ .
13. Suppose that  $m$  and  $n$  are relatively prime and  $r$  is any integer. Show that there are integers  $x$  and  $y$  such that  $mx + ny = r$ .
14. Let  $p$ ,  $q$ , and  $r$  be primes other than 3. Show that 3 divides  $p^2 + q^2 + r^2$ .
15. Prove that every prime greater than 3 can be written in the form  $6n + 1$  or  $6n + 5$ .
16. Determine  $7^{1000} \bmod 6$  and  $6^{1001} \bmod 7$ .
17. Let  $a$ ,  $b$ ,  $s$ , and  $t$  be integers. If  $a \bmod st = b \bmod st$ , show that  $a \bmod s = b \bmod s$  and  $a \bmod t = b \bmod t$ . What condition on  $s$  and  $t$  is needed to make the converse true? (This exercise is referred to in Chapter 8.)
18. Determine  $8^{402} \bmod 5$ .
19. Show that  $\text{gcd}(a, bc) = 1$  if and only if  $\text{gcd}(a, b) = 1$  and  $\text{gcd}(a, c) = 1$ . (This exercise is referred to in Chapter 8.)
20. Let  $p_1, p_2, \dots, p_n$  be primes. Show that  $p_1 p_2 \cdots p_n + 1$  is divisible by none of these primes.
21. Prove that there are infinitely many primes. (*Hint*: Use Exercise 20.)
22. Express  $(-7 - 3i)^{-1}$  in standard form.

23. Express  $\frac{-5 + 2i}{4 - 5i}$  in standard form.
24. For any complex numbers  $z_1$  and  $z_2$  prove that  $|z_1 z_2| = |z_1| |z_2|$ .
25. Give an “if and only if” statement that describes when the logic gate  $x$  NAND  $y$  modeled by  $1 + xy$  is 1. Give an “if and only if” statement that describes when the logic gate  $x$  XNOR  $y$  modeled by  $1 + x + y$  is 1.
26. For inputs of 0 and 1 and mod 2 arithmetic describe the output of the formula  $z + xy + xz$  in the form “If  $x \dots$ , else  $\dots$ ”.
27. For every positive integer  $n$ , prove that a set with exactly  $n$  elements has exactly  $2^n$  subsets (counting the empty set and the entire set).
28. Prove that  $2^n 3^{2n} - 1$  is always divisible by 17.
29. Prove that there is some positive integer  $n$  such that  $n, n + 1, n + 2, \dots, n + 200$  are all composite.
30. (Generalized Euclid’s Lemma) If  $p$  is a prime and  $p$  divides  $a_1 a_2 \cdots a_n$ , prove that  $p$  divides  $a_i$  for some  $i$ .
31. Use the Generalized Euclid’s Lemma (see Exercise 30) to establish the uniqueness portion of the Fundamental Theorem of Arithmetic.
32. What is the largest bet that cannot be made with chips worth \$7.00 and \$9.00? Verify that your answer is correct with both forms of induction.
33. Prove that the First Principle of Mathematical Induction is a consequence of the Well Ordering Principle.
34. The Fibonacci numbers are 1, 1, 2, 3, 5, 8, 13, 21, 34,  $\dots$ . In general, the Fibonacci numbers are defined by  $f_1 = 1, f_2 = 1$ , and for  $n \geq 3$ ,  $f_n = f_{n-1} + f_{n-2}$ . Prove that the  $n$ th Fibonacci number  $f_n$  satisfies  $f_n < 2^n$ .
35. Prove by induction on  $n$  that for all positive integers  $n$ ,  $n^3 + (n + 1)^3 + (n + 2)^3$  is a multiple of 9.
36. Suppose that there is a statement involving a positive integer parameter  $n$  and you have an argument that shows that whenever the statement is true for a particular  $n$  it is also true for  $n + 2$ . What remains to be done to prove the statement is true for every positive integer? Describe a situation in which this strategy would be applicable.
37. In the cut “As” from *Songs in the Key of Life*, Stevie Wonder mentions the equation  $8 \times 8 \times 8 = 4$ . Find all integers  $n$  for which this statement is true, modulo  $n$ .
38. Prove that for every integer  $n$ ,  $n^3 \bmod 6 = n \bmod 6$ .

39. If it is 2:00 A.M. now, what time will it be 3736 hours from now?
40. Determine the check digit for a money order with identification number 7234541780.
41. Suppose that in one of the noncheck positions of a money order number, the digit 0 is substituted for the digit 9 or vice versa. Prove that this error will not be detected by the check digit. Prove that all other errors involving a single position are detected.
42. Suppose that a money order identification number and check digit of 21720421168 is erroneously copied as 27750421168. Will the check digit detect the error?
43. A transposition error involving distinct adjacent digits is one of the form  $\dots ab \dots \rightarrow \dots ba \dots$  with  $a \neq b$ . Prove that the money order check-digit scheme will not detect such errors unless the check digit itself is transposed.
44. Determine the check digit for the Avis rental car with identification number 540047. (See Example 5.)
45. Show that a substitution of a digit  $a_i'$  for the digit  $a_i$  ( $a_i' \neq a_i$ ) in a noncheck position of a UPS number is detected if and only if  $|a_i - a_i'| \neq 7$ .
46. Determine which transposition errors involving adjacent digits are detected by the UPS check digit.
47. Use the UPC scheme to determine the check digit for the number 07312400508.
48. Explain why the check digit for a money order for the number  $N$  is the repeated decimal digit in the real number  $N \div 9$ .
49. The 10-digit International Standard Book Number (ISBN-10)  $a_1a_2a_3a_4a_5a_6a_7a_8a_9a_{10}$  has the property  $(a_1, a_2, \dots, a_{10}) \cdot (10, 9, 8, 7, 6, 5, 4, 3, 2, 1) \bmod 11 = 0$ . The digit  $a_{10}$  is the check digit. When  $a_{10}$  is required to be 10 to make the dot product 0, the character X is used as the check digit. Verify the check digit for the ISBN-10 assigned to this book.
50. Suppose that an ISBN-10 has a smudged entry where the question mark appears in the number 0-716?-2841-9. Determine the missing digit.
51. Suppose three consecutive digits  $abc$  of an ISBN-10 are scrambled as  $bca$ . Which such errors will go undetected?
52. The ISBN-10 0-669-03925-4 is the result of a transposition of two adjacent digits not involving the first or last digit. Determine the correct ISBN-10.

53. Suppose the weighting vector for ISBN-10s were changed to (1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10). Explain how this would affect the check digit.
54. Use the two-check-digit error-correction method described in this chapter to append two check digits to the number 73445860.
55. Suppose that an eight-digit number has two check digits appended using the error-correction method described in this chapter and it is incorrectly transcribed as 4302511568. If exactly one digit is incorrect, determine the correct number.
56. The state of Utah appends a ninth digit  $a_9$  to an eight-digit driver's license number  $a_1a_2 \dots a_8$  so that  $(9a_1 + 8a_2 + 7a_3 + 6a_4 + 5a_5 + 4a_6 + 3a_7 + 2a_8 + a_9) \bmod 10 = 0$ . If you know that the license number 149105267 has exactly one digit incorrect, explain why the error cannot be in position 2, 4, 6, or 8.
57. Complete the proof of Theorem 0.8.
58. Let  $S$  be the set of real numbers. If  $a, b \in S$ , define  $a \sim b$  if  $a - b$  is an integer. Show that  $\sim$  is an equivalence relation on  $S$ . Describe the equivalence classes of  $S$ .
59. Let  $S$  be the set of integers. If  $a, b \in S$ , define  $aRb$  if  $ab \geq 0$ . Is  $R$  an equivalence relation on  $S$ ?
60. Let  $S$  be the set of integers. If  $a, b \in S$ , define  $aRb$  if  $a + b$  is even. Prove that  $R$  is an equivalence relation and determine the equivalence classes of  $S$ .
61. Complete the proof of Theorem 0.7 by showing that  $\sim$  is an equivalence relation on  $S$ .
62. Prove that 3, 5, and 7 are the only three consecutive odd integers that are prime.
63. What is the last digit of  $3^{100}$ ? What is the last digit of  $2^{100}$ ?
64. Prove that there are no rational numbers  $x$  and  $y$  such that  $x^2 - y^2 = 1002$ .
65. (Cancellation Property) Suppose  $\alpha$ ,  $\beta$ , and  $\gamma$  are functions. If  $\alpha\gamma = \beta\gamma$  and  $\gamma$  is one-to-one and onto, prove that  $\alpha = \beta$ .

## Computer Exercises

Computer exercises for this chapter are available at the website:

<http://www.d.umn.edu/~jgallian>

## Suggested Readings

Linda Deneen, “Secret Encryption with Public Keys,” *The UMAP Journal* 8 (1987): 9–29.

This well-written article describes several ways in which modular arithmetic can be used to code secret messages. They range from a simple scheme used by Julius Caesar to a highly sophisticated scheme invented in 1978 and based on modular  $n$  arithmetic, where  $n$  has more than 200 digits.

J. A. Gallian, “Assigning Driver’s License Numbers,” *Mathematics Magazine* 64 (1991): 13–22.

This article describes various methods used by the states to assign driver’s license numbers. Several include check digits for error detection.

This article can be downloaded at <http://www.d.umn.edu/~jgallian/license.pdf>

J. A. Gallian, “The Mathematics of Identification Numbers,” *The College Mathematics Journal* 22 (1991): 194–202.

This article is a comprehensive survey of check-digit schemes that are associated with identification numbers. This article can be downloaded at <http://www.d.umn.edu/~jgallian/ident.pdf>

J. A. Gallian and S. Winters, “Modular Arithmetic in the Marketplace,” *The American Mathematical Monthly* 95 (1988): 548–551.

This article provides a more detailed analysis of the check-digit schemes presented in this chapter. In particular, the error detection rates for the various schemes are given. This article can be downloaded at <http://www.d.umn.edu/~jgallian/marketplace.pdf>



PART

2

# Groups



# 1 Introduction to Groups

And symmetry is a powerful guiding principle that has been used in creating these models [for quantum physics]. The more symmetrical a model is, the easier it is to analyze.

Edward Frenkel, *Love and Math*

Symmetry is a vast subject, significant in art and nature. Mathematics lies at its root, and it would be hard to find a better one on which to demonstrate the working of the mathematical intellect.

Hermann Weyl, *Symmetry*

## Symmetries of a Square

Suppose we remove a square region from a plane, move it in some way, then put the square back into the space it originally occupied. Our goal in this chapter is to describe all possible ways in which this can be done. More specifically, we want to describe the possible relationships between the starting position of the square and its final position in terms of motions. However, we are interested in the net effect of a motion, rather than in the motion itself. Thus, for example, we consider a  $90^\circ$  rotation and a  $450^\circ$  rotation as equal, since they have the same net effect on every point. With this simplifying convention, it is an easy matter to achieve our goal.

To begin, we can think of the square region as being transparent (glass, say), with the corners marked on one side with the colors blue, white, pink, and green. This makes it easy to distinguish between motions that have different effects. With this marking scheme, we are now in a position to describe, in simple fashion, all possible ways in which a square object can be repositioned. See Figure 1.1. We now claim that any motion—no matter how complicated—is equivalent to one of these eight. To verify this claim, observe that the final position of the square is completely determined by the location and orientation (that is, face up or face down) of any particular corner. But, clearly, there are only four locations and two orientations for a given corner, so there are exactly eight distinct final positions for the corner.

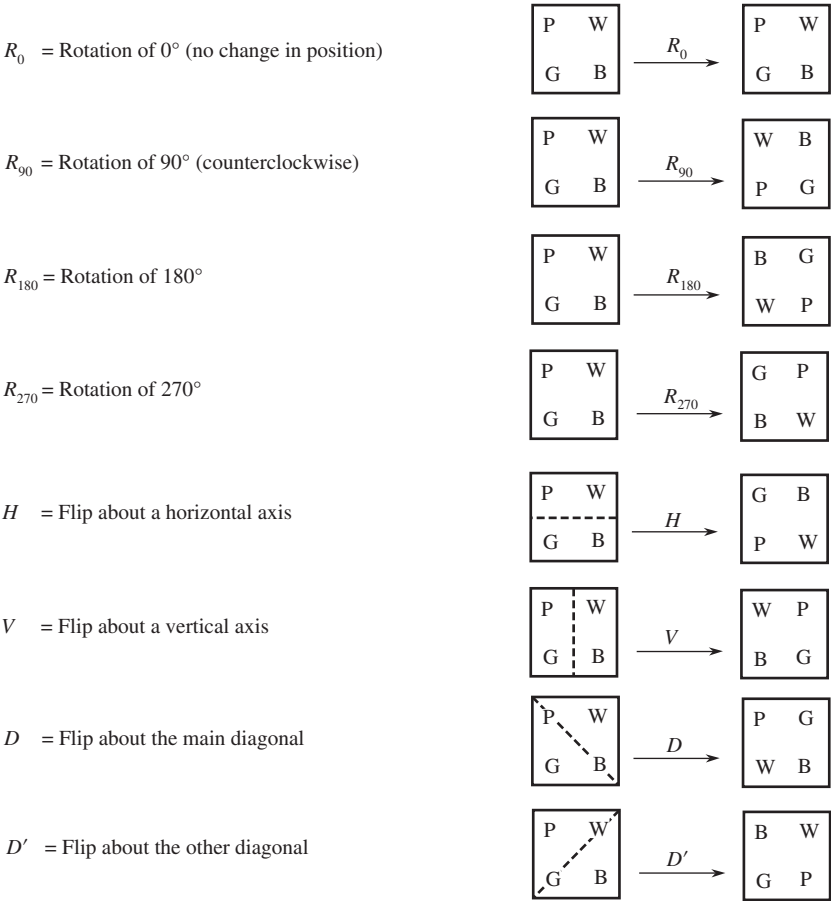
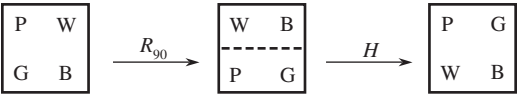


Figure 1.1

Let’s investigate some consequences of the fact that every motion is equal to one of the eight listed in Figure 1.1. Suppose a square is repositioned by a rotation of  $90^\circ$  followed by a flip about the horizontal axis of symmetry.



Thus, we see that this pair of motions—taken together—is equal to the single motion  $D$ . This observation suggests that we can compose two motions to obtain a single motion. And indeed we can, since the

eight motions may be viewed as functions from the square region to itself, and as such we can combine them using function composition.

With this in mind, we write  $HR_{90} = D$  because in lower level math courses function composition  $f \circ g$  means “ $g$  followed by  $f$ .” The eight motions  $R_0, R_{90}, R_{180}, R_{270}, H, V, D$ , and  $D'$ , together with the operation composition, form a mathematical system called the *dihedral group of order 8* (the order of a group is the number of elements it contains). It is denoted by  $D_4$ . Rather than introduce the formal definition of a group here, let’s look at some properties of groups by way of the example  $D_4$ .

To facilitate future computations, we construct an *operation table* or *Cayley table* (so named in honor of the prolific English mathematician Arthur Cayley, who first introduced them in 1854) for  $D_4$  below. The circled entry represents the fact that  $D = HR_{90}$ . (In general,  $ab$  denotes the entry at the intersection of the row with  $a$  at the left and the column with  $b$  at the top.)

|           | $R_0$     | $R_{90}$          | $R_{180}$ | $R_{270}$ | $H$       | $V$       | $D$       | $D'$      |
|-----------|-----------|-------------------|-----------|-----------|-----------|-----------|-----------|-----------|
| $R_0$     | $R_0$     | $R_{90}$          | $R_{180}$ | $R_{270}$ | $H$       | $V$       | $D$       | $D'$      |
| $R_{90}$  | $R_{90}$  | $R_{180}$         | $R_{270}$ | $R_0$     | $D'$      | $D$       | $H$       | $V$       |
| $R_{180}$ | $R_{180}$ | $R_{270}$         | $R_0$     | $R_{90}$  | $V$       | $H$       | $D'$      | $D$       |
| $R_{270}$ | $R_{270}$ | $R_0$             | $R_{90}$  | $R_{180}$ | $D$       | $D'$      | $V$       | $H$       |
| $H$       | $H$       | $\textcircled{D}$ | $V$       | $D'$      | $R_0$     | $R_{180}$ | $R_{90}$  | $R_{270}$ |
| $V$       | $V$       | $D'$              | $H$       | $D$       | $R_{180}$ | $R_0$     | $R_{270}$ | $R_{90}$  |
| $D$       | $D$       | $V$               | $D'$      | $H$       | $R_{270}$ | $R_{90}$  | $R_0$     | $R_{180}$ |
| $D'$      | $D'$      | $H$               | $D$       | $V$       | $R_{90}$  | $R_{270}$ | $R_{180}$ | $R_0$     |

Notice how orderly this table looks! This is no accident. Perhaps the most important feature of this table is that it has been completely filled in without introducing any new motions. Of course, this is because, as we have already pointed out, any sequence of motions turns out to be the same as one of these eight. Algebraically, this says that **if  $A$  and  $B$  are in  $D_4$ , then so is  $AB$** . This property is called **closure**, and it is one of the requirements for a mathematical system to be a group. Next, notice that **if  $A$  is any element of  $D_4$ , then  $AR_0 = R_0A = A$** . Thus, combining any element  $A$  on either side with  $R_0$  yields  $A$  back again. An element  $R_0$  with this property is called an **identity**, and every group must have one. Moreover, we see that **for each element  $A$  in  $D_4$ , there is exactly one element  $B$  in  $D_4$  such that  $AB = BA = R_0$** . In this case,  $B$  is said to be the **inverse** of  $A$  and vice versa. For example,  $R_{90}$  and  $R_{270}$  are inverses of each other, and  $H$  is its own inverse. The term *inverse* is a descriptive one, for if  $A$  and  $B$  are inverses of each other, then  $B$  “undoes” whatever  $A$  “does,” in the sense that  $A$  and  $B$  taken together in either order produce  $R_0$ , representing no change. Another striking feature

of the table is that every element of  $D_4$  appears exactly once in each row and column. This feature is something that all groups must have, and, indeed, it is quite useful to keep this fact in mind when constructing the table in the first place.

Another property of  $D_4$  deserves special comment. Observe that  $HD \neq DH$  but  $R_{90}R_{180} = R_{180}R_{90}$ . Thus, in a group,  $ab$  may or may not be the same as  $ba$ . If it happens that  $ab = ba$  for all choices of group elements  $a$  and  $b$ , we say the group is *commutative* or—better yet—*Abelian* (in honor of the great Norwegian mathematician Niels Abel). Otherwise, we say the group is *non-Abelian*.

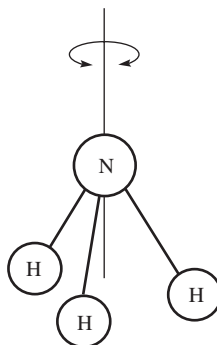
Thus far, we have illustrated, by way of  $D_4$ , three of the four conditions that define a group—namely, closure, existence of an identity, and existence of inverses. The remaining condition required for a group is *associativity*; that is,  $(ab)c = a(bc)$  for all  $a, b, c$  in the set. To be sure that  $D_4$  is indeed a group, we should check this equation for each of the  $8^3 = 512$  possible choices of  $a, b$ , and  $c$  in  $D_4$ . In practice, however, this is rarely done! Here, for example, we simply observe that the eight motions are functions and the operation is function composition. Then, since function composition is associative, we do not have to check the equations.

## The Dihedral Groups

The analysis carried out above for a square can similarly be done for an equilateral triangle or regular pentagon or, indeed, any regular  $n$ -gon ( $n \geq 3$ ). The corresponding group is denoted by  $D_n$  and is called the *dihedral group of order  $2n$* .

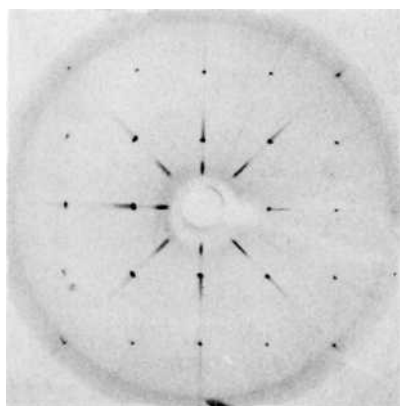
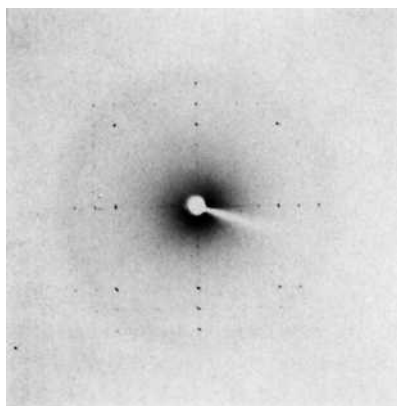
The dihedral groups arise frequently in art and nature. Many of the decorative designs used on floor coverings, pottery, and buildings have one of the dihedral groups as a group of symmetry. Corporation logos are rich sources of dihedral symmetry [1]. Chrysler's logo has  $D_5$  as a symmetry group, and that of Mercedes-Benz has  $D_3$ . The ubiquitous five-pointed star has symmetry group  $D_5$ . The phylum Echinodermata contains many sea animals (such as starfish, sea cucumbers, feather stars, and sand dollars) that exhibit patterns with  $D_5$  symmetry.

Chemists classify molecules according to their symmetry. Moreover, symmetry considerations are applied in orbital calculations, in determining energy levels of atoms and molecules, and in the study of molecular vibrations. The symmetry group of a pyramidal molecule such as ammonia ( $\text{NH}_3$ ), depicted in Figure 1.2, is  $D_3$ .



**Figure 1.2** A pyramidal molecule with symmetry group  $D_3$ .

Mineralogists determine the internal structures of crystals (that is, rigid bodies in which the particles are arranged in three-dimensional repeating patterns—table salt and table sugar are two examples) by studying two-dimensional x-ray projections of the atomic makeup of the crystals. The symmetry present in the projections reveals the internal symmetry of the crystals themselves. Commonly occurring symmetry patterns are  $D_4$  and  $D_6$  (see Figure 1.3). Interestingly, it is mathematically impossible for a crystal to possess a  $D_n$  symmetry pattern with  $n = 5$  or  $n > 6$ .



Tibor Zoltai

**Figure 1.3** X-ray diffraction photos revealing  $D_4$  symmetry patterns in crystals.

The dihedral group of order  $2n$  is often called the *group of symmetries of a regular  $n$ -gon*. A *plane symmetry* of a figure  $F$  in a plane is a function from the plane to itself that carries  $F$  onto  $F$  and preserves distances; that is, for any points  $p$  and  $q$  in the plane, the distance from the image of  $p$  to the image of  $q$  is the same as the

distance from  $p$  to  $q$ . (The term *symmetry* is from the Greek word *symmetros*, meaning “of like measure.”) The **symmetry group of a plane figure** is the set of all symmetries of the figure. Symmetries in three dimensions are defined analogously. Obviously, a rotation of a plane about a point in the plane is a symmetry of the plane, and a rotation about a line in three dimensions is a symmetry in three-dimensional space. Similarly, any translation of a plane or of three-dimensional space is a symmetry. A *reflection across a line  $L$*  is that function that leaves every point of  $L$  fixed and takes any point  $q$ , not on  $L$ , to the point  $q'$  so that  $L$  is the perpendicular bisector of the line segment joining  $q$  and  $q'$  (see Figure 1.4). A reflection across a plane in three dimensions is defined analogously. Notice that the restriction of a  $180^\circ$  rotation about a line  $L$  in three dimensions to a plane containing  $L$  is a reflection across  $L$  in the plane. Thus, in the dihedral groups, the motions that we described as flips about axes of symmetry in three dimensions (for example,  $H$ ,  $V$ ,  $D$ ,  $D'$ ) are reflections across lines in two dimensions. Just as a reflection across a line is a plane symmetry that cannot be achieved by a physical motion of the plane in two dimensions, a reflection across a plane is a three-dimensional symmetry that cannot be achieved by a physical motion of three-dimensional space. A cup, for instance, has reflective symmetry across the plane bisecting the cup, but this symmetry cannot be duplicated with a physical motion in three dimensions.

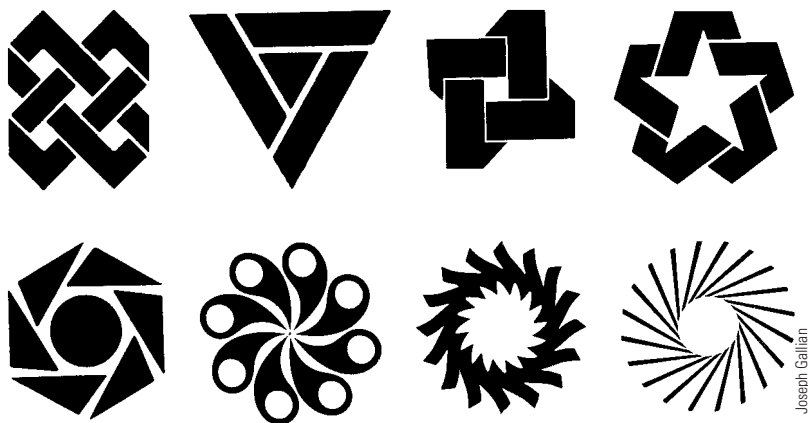


Figure 1.4

Many objects and figures have **rotational symmetry** but not **reflective symmetry**. A symmetry group consisting of the rotational symmetries of  $0^\circ$ ,  $360^\circ/n$ ,  $2(360^\circ)/n$ ,  $\dots$ ,  $(n-1)360^\circ/n$ , and no other symmetries, is called a *cyclic rotation group of order  $n$*  and is denoted by  $\langle R_{360/n} \rangle$ . Cyclic rotation groups, along with dihedral groups, are favorites of artists, designers, and nature. Figure 1.5 illustrates with corporate logos the cyclic rotation groups of orders 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 8, 16, and 20.

A study of symmetry in greater depth is given in Chapters 27 and 28.





**Figure 1.5** Logos with cyclic rotation symmetry groups.

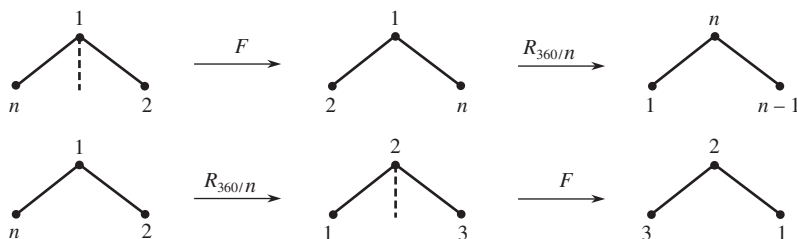
## Exercises

The only way to learn mathematics is to do mathematics.

Paul R. Halmos, *A Hilbert Space Problem Book*

1. With pictures and words, describe each symmetry in  $D_3$  (the set of symmetries of an equilateral triangle).
2. Write out a complete Cayley table for  $D_3$ . Is  $D_3$  Abelian?
3. In  $D_4$ , find all elements  $X$  such that
  - a.  $X^3 = V$ ;
  - b.  $X^3 = R_{90}$ ;
  - c.  $X^3 = R_0$ ;
  - d.  $X^2 = R_0$ ;
  - e.  $X^2 = H$ .
4. Describe in pictures or words the elements of  $D_5$  (symmetries of a regular pentagon).
5. For  $n \geq 3$ , describe the elements of  $D_n$ . (*Hint:* You will need to consider two cases— $n$  even and  $n$  odd.) How many elements does  $D_n$  have?
6. In  $D_n$ , explain geometrically why a reflection followed by a reflection must be a rotation.
7. In  $D_n$ , explain geometrically why a rotation followed by a rotation must be a rotation.
8. In  $D_n$ , explain geometrically why a rotation and a reflection taken together in either order must be a reflection.
9. Associate the number 1 with a rotation and the number  $-1$  with a reflection. Describe an analogy between multiplying these two numbers and multiplying elements of  $D_n$ .

10. If  $r_1, r_2$ , and  $r_3$  represent rotations from  $D_n$  and  $f_1, f_2$ , and  $f_3$  represent reflections from  $D_n$ , determine whether  $r_1 r_2 f_1 r_3 f_2 f_3 r_3$  is a rotation or a reflection.
11. Suppose that  $a, b$ , and  $c$  are elements of a dihedral group. Is  $a^2 b^4 a c^5 a^3 c$  a rotation or a reflection? Explain your reasoning.
12. Which letters of the alphabet written in upper case block style have a symmetry group with four elements? Describe the four symmetries.
13. Find elements  $A, B$ , and  $C$  in  $D_4$  such that  $AB = BC$  but  $A \neq C$ . (Thus, "cross cancellation" is not valid.)
14. Explain what the following diagram proves about the group  $D_n$ .

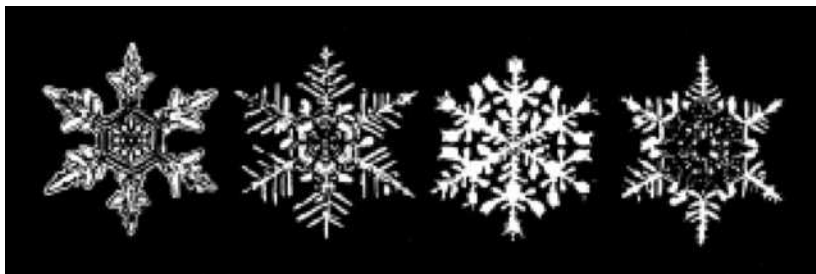


15. Describe the symmetries of a nonsquare rectangle. Construct the corresponding Cayley table.
16. Describe the symmetries of a parallelogram that is neither a rectangle nor a rhombus. Describe the symmetries of a rhombus that is not a rectangle.
17. Describe the symmetries of a noncircular ellipse. Do the same for a hyperbola.
18. Consider an infinitely long strip of equally spaced H's:

$\cdots \text{H H H H} \cdots$

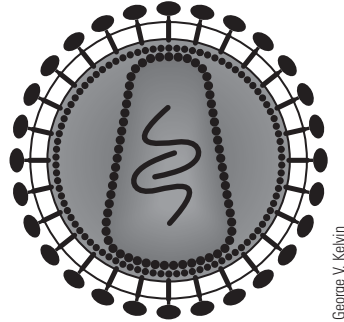
Describe the symmetries of this strip. Is the group of symmetries of the strip Abelian?

19. For each of the snowflakes in the figure, find the symmetry group and locate the axes of reflective symmetry (disregard imperfections).

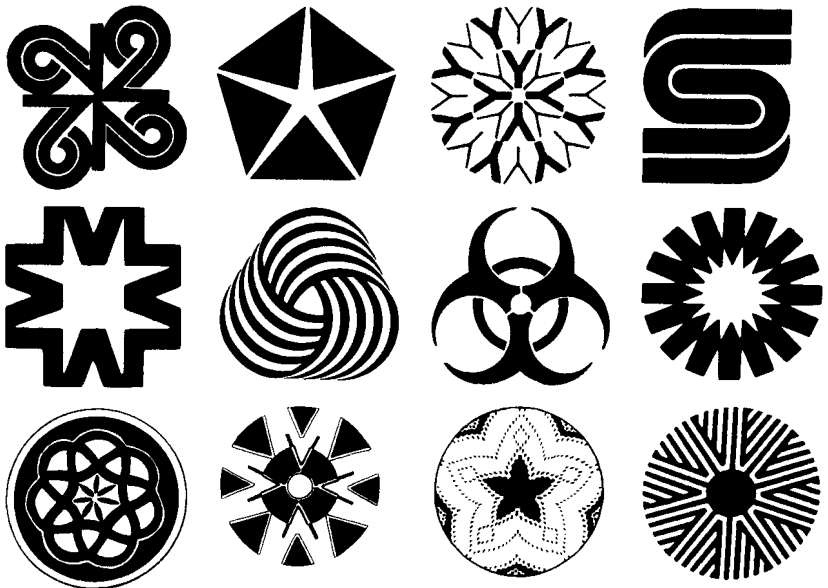


Photographs of snowflakes from the Bentley and Humphreys atlas.

20. Determine the symmetry group of the outer shell of the cross section of the human immunodeficiency virus (HIV) shown below.



21. Let  $X, Y, R_{90}$  be elements of  $D_4$  with  $Y \neq R_{90}$  and  $X^2Y = R_{90}$ . Determine  $Y$ . Show your reasoning.
22. If  $F$  is a reflection in the dihedral group  $D_n$  find all elements  $X$  in  $D_n$  such that  $X^2 = F$  and all elements  $X$  in  $D_n$  such that  $X^3 = F$ .
23. What symmetry property do the words “mow,” “sis,” and “swims” have when written in uppercase letters?
24. For each design below, determine the symmetry group (ignore imperfections).



25. What group theoretic property do uppercase letters F, G, J, L, P, Q, R have that is not shared by the remaining uppercase letters in the alphabet?

## Suggested Reading

Michael Field and Martin Golubitsky, *Symmetry in Chaos*, Oxford University Press, 1992.

This book has many beautiful symmetric designs that arise in chaotic dynamic systems.

## Suggested Website

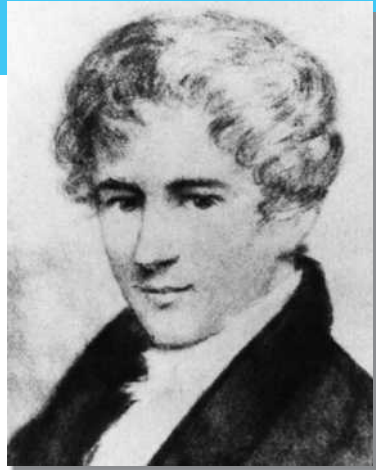
**<http://britton.disted.camosun.bc.ca/jbsymteslk.htm>**

This spectacular website on symmetry and tessellations has numerous activities and links to many other sites on related topics. It is a wonderful website for K–12 teachers and students.

# Niels Abel

He [Abel] has left mathematicians something to keep them busy for five hundred years.

CHARLES HERMITE



Stock Montage



A 500-kroner bank note first issued by Norway in 1948.

NIELS HENRIK ABEL, one of the foremost mathematicians of the 19th century, was born in Norway on August 5, 1802. At the age of 16, he began reading the classic mathematical works of Newton, Euler, Lagrange, and Gauss. When Abel was 18 years old, his father died, and the burden of supporting the family fell upon him. He took in private pupils and did odd jobs, while continuing to do mathematical research. At the age of 19, Abel solved a problem that had vexed leading mathematicians for hundreds of years. He proved that, unlike the situation for equations of degree 4 or less, there is no finite (closed) formula for the solution of the general fifth-degree equation.

Although Abel died long before the advent of the subjects that now make up abstract

algebra, his solution to the quintic problem laid the groundwork for many of these subjects. Just when his work was beginning to receive the attention it deserved, Abel contracted tuberculosis. He died on April 6, 1829, at the age of 26.

In recognition of the fact that there is no Nobel Prize for mathematics, in 2002 Norway established the Abel Prize as the “Nobel Prize in mathematics” in honor of its native son. At approximately the \$1,000,000 level, the Abel Prize is now seen as an award equivalent to a Nobel Prize.

To find more information about Abel, visit:  
**<http://www-groups.dcs.st-and.ac.uk/~history/>**

## 2

## Groups

Whenever groups disclose themselves, or could be introduced, simplicity crystallized out of comparative chaos.

E. T. Bell, *Mathematics: Queen and Servant of Science*

A good stock of examples, as large as possible, is indispensable for a thorough understanding of any concept, and when I want to learn something new, I make it my first job to build one.

Paul R. Halmos

### Definition and Examples of Groups

The term *group* was used by Galois around 1830 to describe sets of one-to-one functions on finite sets that could be grouped together to form a set closed under composition. As is the case with most fundamental concepts in mathematics, the modern definition of a group that follows is the result of a long evolutionary process. Although this definition was given by both Heinrich Weber and Walther von Dyck in 1882, it did not gain universal acceptance until the 20th century.

#### **Definition** Binary Operation

Let  $G$  be a set. A *binary operation* on  $G$  is a function that assigns each ordered pair of elements of  $G$  an element of  $G$ .

A binary operation on a set  $G$ , then, is simply a method (or formula) by which the members of an ordered pair from  $G$  combine to yield a new member of  $G$ . This condition is called *closure*. The most familiar binary operations are ordinary addition, subtraction, and multiplication of integers. Division of integers is not a binary operation on the integers because an integer divided by an integer need not be an integer.

The binary operations addition modulo  $n$  and multiplication modulo  $n$  on the set  $\{0, 1, 2, \dots, n-1\}$ , which we denote by  $Z_n$ , play an extremely important role in abstract algebra. In certain situations we will want to combine the elements of  $Z_n$  by addition modulo  $n$  only; in other situations we will want to use both addition modulo  $n$  and multiplication

modulo  $n$  to combine the elements. It will be clear from the context whether we are using addition only or addition and multiplication. For example, when multiplying matrices with entries from  $Z_n$ , we will need both addition modulo  $n$  and multiplication modulo  $n$ .

### Definition Group

Let  $G$  be a set together with a binary operation (usually called multiplication) that assigns to each ordered pair  $(a, b)$  of elements of  $G$  an element in  $G$  denoted by  $ab$ . We say  $G$  is a group under this operation if the following three properties are satisfied.

1. *Associativity.* The operation is associative; that is,  $(ab)c = a(bc)$  for all  $a, b, c$  in  $G$ .
2. *Identity.* There is an element  $e$  (called the *identity*) in  $G$  such that  $ae = ea = a$  for all  $a$  in  $G$ .
3. *Inverses.* For each element  $a$  in  $G$ , there is an element  $b$  in  $G$  (called an *inverse* of  $a$ ) such that  $ab = ba = e$ .

In words, then, a group is a set together with an associative operation such that there is an identity, every element has an inverse, and any pair of elements can be combined without going outside the set. Be sure to verify closure when testing for a group (see Example 5). Notice that if  $a$  is the inverse of  $b$ , then  $b$  is the inverse of  $a$ .

If a group has the property that  $ab = ba$  for every pair of elements  $a$  and  $b$ , we say the group is *Abelian*. A group is *non-Abelian* if there is some pair of elements  $a$  and  $b$  for which  $ab \neq ba$ . When encountering a particular group for the first time, one should determine whether or not it is Abelian.

Now that we have the formal definition of a group, our first job is to build a good stock of examples. These examples will be used throughout the text to illustrate the theorems. (The best way to grasp the meat of a theorem is to see what it says in specific cases.) As we progress, the reader is bound to have hunches and conjectures that can be tested against the stock of examples. To develop a better understanding of the following examples, the reader should supply the missing details.

■ **EXAMPLE 1** The set of integers  $Z$  (so denoted because the German word for numbers is *Zahlen*), the set of rational numbers  $Q$  (for quotient), and the set of real numbers  $R$  are all groups under ordinary addition. In each case, the identity is 0 and the inverse of  $a$  is  $-a$ . ■

■ **EXAMPLE 2** The set of integers under ordinary multiplication is not a group. Since the number 1 is the identity, property 3 fails. For example, there is no integer  $b$  such that  $5b = 1$ . ■

■ **EXAMPLE 3** The subset  $\{1, -1, i, -i\}$  of the complex numbers is a group under complex multiplication. Note that  $-1$  is its own inverse, whereas the inverse of  $i$  is  $-i$ , and vice versa. ■

■ **EXAMPLE 4** The set  $\mathbb{Q}^+$  of positive rationals is a group under ordinary multiplication. The inverse of any  $a$  is  $1/a = a^{-1}$ . ■

■ **EXAMPLE 5** The set  $S$  of positive irrational numbers together with 1 under multiplication satisfies the three properties given in the definition of a group but is not a group. Indeed,  $\sqrt{2} \cdot \sqrt{2} = 2$ , so  $S$  is not closed under multiplication. ■

■ **EXAMPLE 6** A rectangular array of the form  $\begin{bmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{bmatrix}$  is called a  $2 \times 2$  matrix. The set of all  $2 \times 2$  matrices with real entries is a group under componentwise addition. That is,

$$\begin{bmatrix} a_1 & b_1 \\ c_1 & d_1 \end{bmatrix} + \begin{bmatrix} a_2 & b_2 \\ c_2 & d_2 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} a_1 + a_2 & b_1 + b_2 \\ c_1 + c_2 & d_1 + d_2 \end{bmatrix}$$

The identity is  $\begin{bmatrix} 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 \end{bmatrix}$ , and the inverse of  $\begin{bmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{bmatrix}$  is  $\begin{bmatrix} -a & -b \\ -c & -d \end{bmatrix}$ . ■

■ **EXAMPLE 7** The set  $\mathbb{Z}_n = \{0, 1, \dots, n-1\}$  for  $n \geq 1$  is a group under addition modulo  $n$ . For any  $j > 0$  in  $\mathbb{Z}_n$ , the inverse of  $j$  is  $n - j$ . This group is usually referred to as the *group of integers modulo  $n$* . ■

As we have seen, the real numbers, the  $2 \times 2$  matrices with real entries, and the integers modulo  $n$  are all groups under the appropriate addition. But what about multiplication? In each case, the existence of some elements that do not have inverses prevents the set from being a group under the usual multiplication. However, we can form a group in each case by simply throwing out the rascals. Examples 8, 9, and 11 illustrate this.

■ **EXAMPLE 8** The set  $\mathbb{R}^*$  of nonzero real numbers is a group under ordinary multiplication. The identity is 1. The inverse of  $a$  is  $1/a$ . ■



■ **EXAMPLE 9†** The *determinant* of the  $2 \times 2$  matrix  $\begin{bmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{bmatrix}$  is the number  $ad - bc$ . If  $A$  is a  $2 \times 2$  matrix,  $\det A$  denotes the determinant of  $A$ . The set

$$GL(2, \mathbf{R}) = \left\{ \begin{bmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{bmatrix} \mid a, b, c, d \in \mathbf{R}, ad - bc \neq 0 \right\}$$

of  $2 \times 2$  matrices with real entries and nonzero determinants is a non-Abelian group under the operation

$$\begin{bmatrix} a_1 & b_1 \\ c_1 & d_1 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} a_2 & b_2 \\ c_2 & d_2 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} a_1a_2 + b_1c_2 & a_1b_2 + b_1d_2 \\ c_1a_2 + d_1c_2 & c_1b_2 + d_1d_2 \end{bmatrix}.$$

The first step in verifying that this set is a group is to show that the product of two matrices with nonzero determinants also has a nonzero determinant. This follows from the fact that for any pair of  $2 \times 2$  matrices  $A$  and  $B$ ,  $\det(AB) = (\det A)(\det B)$ .

Associativity can be verified by direct (but cumbersome) calculations. The identity is  $\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$ ; the inverse of  $\begin{bmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{bmatrix}$  is

$$\begin{bmatrix} \frac{d}{ad - bc} & \frac{-b}{ad - bc} \\ \frac{-c}{ad - bc} & \frac{a}{ad - bc} \end{bmatrix}$$

(explaining the requirement that  $ad - bc \neq 0$ ). Another useful fact about determinants is  $\det A^{-1} = (\det A)^{-1}$ .

This very important non-Abelian group is called the *general linear group* of  $2 \times 2$  matrices over  $\mathbf{R}$ . ■

■ **EXAMPLE 10** The set of all  $2 \times 2$  matrices with real entries is not a group under the operation defined in Example 9. Inverses do not exist when the determinant is 0. ■

Now that we have shown how to make subsets of the real numbers and subsets of the set of  $2 \times 2$  matrices into multiplicative groups, we next consider the integers under multiplication modulo  $n$ .

†For simplicity, we have restricted our matrix examples to the  $2 \times 2$  case. However, the examples in this chapter generalize to  $n \times n$  matrices.

■ **EXAMPLE 11 (L. EULER, 1761)** By Exercise 11 in Chapter 0, an integer  $a$  has a multiplicative inverse modulo  $n$  if and only if  $a$  and  $n$  are relatively prime. So, for each  $n > 1$ , we define  $U(n)$  to be the set of all positive integers less than  $n$  and relatively prime to  $n$ . Then  $U(n)$  is a group under multiplication modulo  $n$ . (We leave it to the reader to check that this set is closed under this operation.)

For  $n = 10$ , we have  $U(10) = \{1, 3, 7, 9\}$ . The Cayley table for  $U(10)$  is

| mod 10 | 1 | 3 | 7 | 9 |
|--------|---|---|---|---|
| 1      | 1 | 3 | 7 | 9 |
| 3      | 3 | 9 | 1 | 7 |
| 7      | 7 | 1 | 9 | 3 |
| 9      | 9 | 7 | 3 | 1 |

(Recall that  $ab \bmod n$  is the unique integer  $r$  with the property  $a \cdot b = nq + r$ , where  $0 \leq r < n$  and  $a \cdot b$  is ordinary multiplication.) In the case that  $n$  is a prime,  $U(n) = \{1, 2, \dots, n-1\}$ . ■

In his classic book *Lehrbuch der Algebra*, published in 1895, Heinrich Weber gave an extensive treatment of the groups  $U(n)$  and described them as the most important examples of finite Abelian groups.

■ **EXAMPLE 12** The set  $\{0, 1, 2, 3\}$  is not a group under multiplication modulo 4. Although 1 and 3 have inverses, the elements 0 and 2 do not. ■

■ **EXAMPLE 13** The set of integers under subtraction is not a group, since the operation is not associative. ■

With the examples given thus far as a guide, it is wise for the reader to pause here and think of his or her own examples. Study actively! Don't just read along and be spoon-fed by the book.

■ **EXAMPLE 14** The complex numbers  $\mathbf{C} = \{a + bi \mid a, b \in \mathbf{R}, i^2 = -1\}$  are a group under the operation  $(a + bi) + (c + di) = (a + c) + (b + d)i$ . The inverse of  $a + bi$  is  $-a - bi$ . The nonzero complex numbers  $\mathbf{C}^*$  are a group under the operation  $(a + bi)(c + di) = (ac - bd) + (ad + bc)i$ . The inverse of  $a + bi$  is  $\frac{1}{a + bi} = \frac{1}{a + bi} \frac{a - bi}{a - bi} = \frac{1}{a^2 + b^2} a - \frac{1}{a^2 + b^2} bi$ . ■

■ **EXAMPLE 15** For all integers  $n \geq 1$ , the set of complex  $n$ th roots of unity

$$\left\{ \cos \frac{k \cdot 360^\circ}{n} + i \sin \frac{k \cdot 360^\circ}{n} \mid k = 0, 1, 2, \dots, n-1 \right\}$$

(i.e., complex zeros of  $x^n - 1$ ) is a group under multiplication. (See DeMoivre's Theorem—Example 12 in Chapter 0.) Compare this group with the one in Example 3. ■

Recall from Chapter 0 that the complex number  $\cos \theta + i \sin \theta$  can be represented geometrically as the point  $(\cos \theta, \sin \theta)$  in a plane coordinatized by a real horizontal axis and a vertical imaginary axis, where  $\theta$  is the angle formed by the line segment joining the origin and the point  $(\cos \theta, \sin \theta)$  and the positive real axis. Thus, the six complex zeros of  $x^6 = 1$  are located at points around the circle of radius 1,  $60^\circ$  apart, as shown in Figure 2.1.

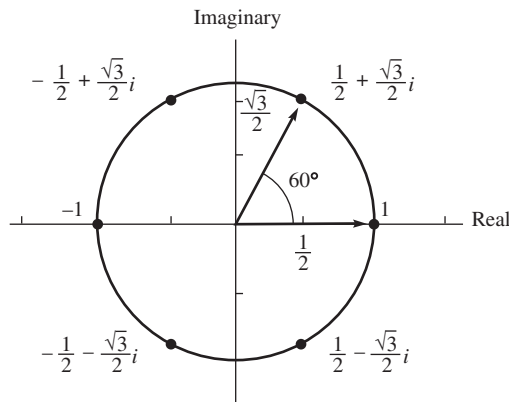


Figure 2.1

■ **EXAMPLE 16** The set  $\mathbf{R}^n = \{(a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n) \mid a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n \in \mathbf{R}\}$  is a group under componentwise addition [i.e.,  $(a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n) + (b_1, b_2, \dots, b_n) = (a_1 + b_1, a_2 + b_2, \dots, a_n + b_n)$ ]. ■

■ **EXAMPLE 17** The set of all  $2 \times 2$  matrices with determinant 1 with entries from  $Q$  (rationals),  $\mathbf{R}$  (reals),  $\mathbf{C}$  (complex numbers), or  $Z_p$  ( $p$  a prime) is a non-Abelian group under matrix multiplication. This group is called the **special linear group** of  $2 \times 2$  matrices over  $Q$ ,  $\mathbf{R}$ ,  $\mathbf{C}$ , or  $Z_p$ , respectively. If the entries are from  $F$ , where  $F$  is any of the above, we denote this group by  $SL(2, F)$ . For the group  $SL(2, F)$ , the formula given in Example 9 for

the inverse of  $\begin{bmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{bmatrix}$  simplifies to  $\begin{bmatrix} d & -b \\ -c & a \end{bmatrix}$ . When the matrix entries are from  $Z_p$ , we use modulo  $p$  arithmetic to compute determinants, matrix products, and inverses. To illustrate the case  $SL(2, Z_5)$ , consider the element  $A = \begin{bmatrix} 3 & 4 \\ 4 & 4 \end{bmatrix}$ . Then  $\det A = (3 \cdot 4 - 4 \cdot 4) \bmod 5 = -4 \bmod 5 = 1$ , and the inverse of  $A$  is  $\begin{bmatrix} 4 & -4 \\ -4 & 3 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 4 & 1 \\ 1 & 3 \end{bmatrix}$ . Note that  $\begin{bmatrix} 3 & 4 \\ 4 & 4 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 4 & 1 \\ 1 & 3 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$  when the arithmetic is done modulo 5. ■

Example 9 is a special case of the following general construction.

■ **EXAMPLE 18** Let  $F$  be any of  $Q$ ,  $R$ ,  $C$ , or  $Z_p$  ( $p$  a prime). The set  $GL(2, F)$  of all  $2 \times 2$  matrices with nonzero determinants and entries from  $F$  is a non-Abelian group under matrix multiplication. As in Example 17, when  $F$  is  $Z_p$ , modulo  $p$  arithmetic is used to calculate determinants, matrix products, and inverses. The formula given in Example 9 for the inverse of  $\begin{bmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{bmatrix}$  remains valid for elements from  $GL(2, Z_p)$ , provided we interpret division by  $ad - bc$  as multiplication by the inverse of  $(ad - bc)$  modulo  $p$ . For example, in  $GL(2, Z_7)$ , consider  $\begin{bmatrix} 4 & 5 \\ 6 & 3 \end{bmatrix}$ . Then the determinant  $(ad - bc) \bmod 7$  is  $(12 - 30) \bmod 7 = -18 \bmod 7 = 3$  and the inverse of 3 is 5 [since  $(3 \cdot 5) \bmod 7 = 1]$ . So, the inverse of  $\begin{bmatrix} 4 & 5 \\ 6 & 3 \end{bmatrix}$  is  $\begin{bmatrix} 3 \cdot 5 & 2 \cdot 5 \\ 1 \cdot 5 & 4 \cdot 5 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 3 \\ 5 & 6 \end{bmatrix}$ . [The reader should check that  $\begin{bmatrix} 4 & 5 \\ 6 & 3 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 3 \\ 5 & 6 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$  in  $GL(2, Z_7)$ ]. ■

The group  $GL(n, F)$  is called the *general linear group* of  $n \times n$  matrices over  $F$ .

■ **EXAMPLE 19** The set  $\{1, 2, \dots, n-1\}$  is a group under multiplication modulo  $n$  if and only if  $n$  is prime. ■

Table 2.1 summarizes many of the specific groups that we have presented thus far.

As the previous examples demonstrate, the notion of a group is a very broad one indeed. The goal of the axiomatic approach is to find properties general enough to permit many diverse examples having these properties and specific enough to allow one to deduce many interesting consequences.

**Table 2.1** Summary of Group Examples ( $F$  can be any of  $\mathcal{Q}$ ,  $\mathcal{R}$ ,  $\mathcal{C}$ , or  $\mathcal{Z}_p$ ;  $L$  is a reflection)

| Group           | Operation              | Identity                                       | Form of Element                                                      | Inverse                                                                                                          | Abelian |
|-----------------|------------------------|------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------|
| $\mathcal{Z}$   | Addition               | 0                                              | $k$                                                                  | $-k$                                                                                                             | Yes     |
| $\mathcal{Q}^+$ | Multiplication         | 1                                              | $m/n$ ,<br>$m, n > 0$                                                | $n/m$                                                                                                            | Yes     |
| $\mathcal{Z}_n$ | Addition mod $n$       | 0                                              | $k$                                                                  | $n - k$                                                                                                          | Yes     |
| $\mathcal{R}^*$ | Multiplication         | 1                                              | $x$                                                                  | $1/x$                                                                                                            | Yes     |
| $\mathcal{C}^*$ | Multiplication         | 1                                              | $a + bi$                                                             | $\frac{1}{a^2 + b^2}a - \frac{1}{a^2 + b^2}bi$                                                                   | Yes     |
| $GL(2, F)$      | Matrix multiplication  | $\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$ | $\begin{bmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{bmatrix}$ ,<br>$ad - bc \neq 0$ | $\begin{bmatrix} \frac{d}{ad - bc} & \frac{-b}{ad - bc} \\ \frac{-c}{ad - bc} & \frac{a}{ad - bc} \end{bmatrix}$ | No      |
| $U(n)$          | Multiplication mod $n$ | 1                                              | $k$ ,<br>$\gcd(k, n) = 1$                                            | Solution to<br>$kx \bmod n = 1$                                                                                  | Yes     |
| $\mathcal{R}^n$ | Componentwise addition | $(0, 0, \dots, 0)$                             | $(a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n)$                                             | $(-a_1, -a_2, \dots, -a_n)$                                                                                      | Yes     |
| $SL(2, F)$      | Matrix multiplication  | $\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$ | $\begin{bmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{bmatrix}$ ,<br>$ad - bc = 1$    | $\begin{bmatrix} d & -b \\ -c & a \end{bmatrix}$                                                                 | No      |
| $D_n$           | Composition            | $R_0$                                          | $R_\alpha, L$                                                        | $R_{360 - \alpha}, L$                                                                                            | No      |

The goal of abstract algebra is to discover truths about algebraic systems (that is, sets with one or more binary operations) that are independent of the specific nature of the operations. All one knows or needs to know is that these operations, whatever they may be, have certain properties. We then seek to deduce consequences of these properties. This is why this branch of mathematics is called *abstract* algebra. It must be remembered, however, that when a specific group is being discussed, a specific operation must be given (at least implicitly).

## Elementary Properties of Groups

Now that we have seen many diverse examples of groups, we wish to deduce some properties that they share. The definition itself raises some fundamental questions. Every group has *an* identity. Could a group have more than one? Every group element has *an* inverse. Could an element have more than one? The examples suggest not. But examples can only

suggest. One cannot prove that every group has a unique identity by looking at examples, because each example inherently has properties that may not be shared by all groups. We are forced to restrict ourselves to the properties that all groups have; that is, we must view groups as abstract entities rather than argue by example. The next three theorems illustrate the abstract approach.

### ■ Theorem 2.1 Uniqueness of the Identity

*In a group  $G$ , there is **only one** identity element.*

**PROOF** Suppose both  $e$  and  $e'$  are identities of  $G$ . Then,

1.  $ae = a$  for all  $a$  in  $G$ , and
2.  $e'a = a$  for all  $a$  in  $G$ .

The choices of  $a = e'$  in (part 1) and  $a = e$  in (part 2) yield  $e'e = e'$  and  $e'e = e$ . Thus,  $e$  and  $e'$  are both equal to  $e'e$  and so are equal to each other. ■

Because of this theorem, we may unambiguously speak of “the identity” of a group and denote it by ‘ $e$ ’ (because the German word for identity is **Einheit**).

### ■ Theorem 2.2 Cancellation

*In a group  $G$ , the right and left cancellation laws hold; that is,  **$ba = ca$  implies  $b = c$** , and  **$ab = ac$  implies  $b = c$** .*

**PROOF** Suppose  $ba = ca$ . Let  $a'$  be an inverse of  $a$ . Then multiplying on the right by  $a'$  yields  $(ba)a' = (ca)a'$ . Associativity yields  $b(aa') = c(aa')$ . Then  $be = ce$  and, therefore,  $b = c$  as desired. Similarly, one can prove that  $ab = ac$  implies  $b = c$  by multiplying by  $a'$  on the left. ■

A consequence of the cancellation property is the fact that in a Cayley table for a group, each group element occurs exactly once in each row and column (see Exercise 31). Another consequence of the cancellation property is the uniqueness of inverses.

### ■ Theorem 2.3 Uniqueness of Inverses

*For each element  $a$  in a group  $G$ , there is a **unique** element  $b$  in  $G$  such that  **$ab = ba = e$** .*

**PROOF** Suppose  $b$  and  $c$  are both inverses of  $a$ . Then  $ab = e$  and  $ac = e$ , so that  $ab = ac$ . Canceling the  $a$  on both sides gives  $b = c$ , as desired. ■

As was the case with the identity element, it is reasonable, in view of Theorem 2.3, to speak of “the inverse” of an element  $g$  of a group; in fact, we may unambiguously denote it by  $g^{-1}$ . This notation is suggested by that used for ordinary real numbers under multiplication. Similarly, when  $n$  is a positive integer, the associative law allows us to use  $g^n$  to denote the unambiguous product

$$\underbrace{gg \cdots g}_{n \text{ factors}}$$

We define  $g^0 = e$ . When  $n$  is negative, we define  $g^n = (g^{-1})^{|n|}$  [for example,  $g^{-3} = (g^{-1})^3$ ]. Unlike for real numbers, in an abstract group we do not permit noninteger exponents such as  $g^{1/2}$ . With this notation, the **familiar laws of exponents hold for groups**; that is, for all integers  $m$  and  $n$  and any group element  $g$ , we have  $g^m g^n = g^{m+n}$  and  $(g^m)^n = g^{mn}$ . Although the way one manipulates the group expressions  $g^m g^n$  and  $(g^m)^n$  coincides with the laws of exponents for real numbers, the laws of exponents **fail to hold for expressions involving two group elements**. Thus, for groups in general,  $(ab)^n \neq a^n b^n$  (see Exercise 23).

The important thing about the existence of a unique inverse for each group element  $a$  is that for every element  $b$  in the group there is a unique solution in the group of the equations  $ax = b$  and  $xa = b$ . Namely,  $x = a^{-1}b$  in the first case and  $x = ba^{-1}$  in the second case. In contrast, in the set  $\{0, 1, 2, 3, 4, 5\}$ , the equation  $2x = 4$  has the solutions  $x = 2$  and  $x = 5$  under the operation multiplication mod 6. However, this set is not a group under multiplication mod 6.

Also, one must be careful with this notation when dealing with a specific group whose binary operation is addition and is denoted by “+.” In this case, the definitions and group properties expressed in multiplicative notation must be translated to additive notation. For example, the inverse of  $g$  is written as  $-g$ . Likewise, for example,  $g^3$  means

Table 2.2

| Multiplicative Group |                               | Additive Group |                         |
|----------------------|-------------------------------|----------------|-------------------------|
| $a \cdot b$ or $ab$  | Multiplication                | $a + b$        | Addition                |
| $e$ or $1$           | Identity or one               | $0$            | Zero                    |
| $a^{-1}$             | Multiplicative inverse of $a$ | $-a$           | Additive inverse of $a$ |
| $a^n$                | Power of $a$                  | $na$           | Multiple of $a$         |
| $ab^{-1}$            | Quotient                      | $a - b$        | Difference              |

$g + g + g$  and is usually written as  $3g$ , whereas  $g^{-3}$  means  $(-g) + (-g) + (-g)$  and is written as  $-3g$ . When additive notation is used, do not interpret “ $ng$ ” as combining  $n$  and  $g$  under the group operation;  $n$  may not even be an element of the group! Table 2.2 shows the common notation and corresponding terminology for groups under multiplication and groups under addition. As is the case for real numbers, we use  $a - b$  as an abbreviation for  $a + (-b)$ .

Because of the associative property, we may unambiguously write the expression  $abc$ , for this can be reasonably interpreted as only  $(ab)c$  or  $a(bc)$ , which are equal. In fact, by using induction and repeated application of the associative property, one can prove a general associative property that essentially means that parentheses can be inserted or deleted at will without affecting the value of a product involving any number of group elements. Thus,

$$a^2(bcdb^2) = a^2b(cd)b^2 = (a^2b)(cd)b^2 = a(abcdb)b,$$

and so on.

Although groups do not have the property that  $(ab)^n = a^n b^n$ , there is a simple relationship between  $(ab)^{-1}$  and  $a^{-1}$  and  $b^{-1}$ .

■ Theorem 2.4 Socks–Shoes Property

For group elements  $a$  and  $b$ ,  $(ab)^{-1} = b^{-1}a^{-1}$ .

**PROOF** Since  $(ab)(ab)^{-1} = e$  and  $(ab)(b^{-1}a^{-1}) = a(bb^{-1})a^{-1} = aea^{-1} = aa^{-1} = e$ , we have by Theorem 2.3 that  $(ab)^{-1} = b^{-1}a^{-1}$ . ■

Historical Note

We conclude this chapter with a bit of history concerning the non-commutativity of matrix multiplication. In 1925, quantum theory was replete with annoying and puzzling ambiguities. It was Werner Heisenberg



who recognized the cause. He observed that the product of the quantum-theoretical analogs of the classical Fourier series did not necessarily commute. For all his boldness, this shook Heisenberg. As he later recalled [2, p. 94]:

In my paper the fact that  $XY$  was not equal to  $YX$  was very disagreeable to me. I felt this was the only point of difficulty in the whole scheme, otherwise I would be perfectly happy. But this difficulty had worried me and I was not able to solve it.

Heisenberg asked his teacher, Max Born, if his ideas were worth publishing. Born was fascinated and deeply impressed by Heisenberg's new approach. Born wrote [1, p. 217]:

After having sent off Heisenberg's paper to the *Zeitschrift für Physik* for publication, I began to ponder over his symbolic multiplication, and was soon so involved in it that I thought about it for the whole day and could hardly sleep at night. For I felt there was something fundamental behind it, the consummation of our endeavors of many years. And one morning, about the 10 July 1925, I suddenly saw light: Heisenberg's symbolic multiplication was nothing but the matrix calculus, well-known to me since my student days from Rosanes' lectures in Breslau.

Born and his student, Pascual Jordan, reformulated Heisenberg's ideas in terms of matrices, but it was Heisenberg who was credited with the formulation. In his autobiography, Born lamented [1, p. 219]:

Nowadays the textbooks speak without exception of Heisenberg's matrices, Heisenberg's commutation law, and Dirac's field quantization.

In fact, Heisenberg knew at that time very little of matrices and had to study them.

Upon learning in 1933 that he was to receive the Nobel Prize with Dirac and Schrödinger for this work, Heisenberg wrote to Born [1, p. 220]:

If I have not written to you for such a long time, and have not thanked you for your congratulations, it was partly because of my rather bad conscience with respect to you. The fact that I am to receive the Nobel Prize alone, for work done in Göttingen in collaboration—you, Jordan, and I—this fact depresses me and I hardly know what to write to you. I am, of course, glad that our common efforts are now appreciated, and I enjoy the recollection of the beautiful time of collaboration. I also believe that all good physicists know how great was your and Jordan's contribution to the structure of quantum mechanics—and this remains unchanged by a wrong decision from outside. Yet I myself can do nothing but thank you again for all the fine collaboration, and feel a little ashamed.

The story has a happy ending, however, because Born received the Nobel Prize in 1954 for his fundamental work in quantum mechanics.

## Exercises

"For example" is not proof.

JEWISH PROVERB

1. Which of the following binary operations are closed?
  - a. subtraction of positive integers
  - b. division of nonzero integers
  - c. function composition of polynomials with real coefficients
  - d. multiplication of  $2 \times 2$  matrices with integer entries
  - e. exponentiation of integers
2. Which of the following binary operations are associative?
  - a. subtraction of integers
  - b. division of nonzero rationals
  - c. function composition of polynomials with real coefficients
  - d. multiplication of  $2 \times 2$  matrices with integer entries
  - e. exponentiation of integers
3. Which of the following binary operations are commutative?
  - a. subtraction of integers
  - b. division of nonzero real numbers
  - c. function composition of polynomials with real coefficients
  - d. multiplication of  $2 \times 2$  matrices with real entries
  - e. exponentiation of integers
4. Which of the following sets are closed under the given operation?
  - a.  $\{0, 4, 8, 12\}$  addition mod 16
  - b.  $\{0, 4, 8, 12\}$  addition mod 15
  - c.  $\{1, 4, 7, 13\}$  multiplication mod 15
  - d.  $\{1, 4, 5, 7\}$  multiplication mod 9
5. In each case, find the inverse of the element under the given operation.
  - a. 13 in  $Z_{20}$
  - b. 13 in  $U(14)$
  - c.  $n-1$  in  $U(n)$  ( $n > 2$ )
  - d.  $3-2i$  in  $\mathbf{C}^*$ , the group of nonzero complex numbers under multiplication
6. In each case, perform the indicated operation.
  - a. In  $\mathbf{C}^*$ ,  $(7 + 5i)(-3 + 2i)$
  - b. In  $GL(2, Z_{13})$ ,  $\det \begin{bmatrix} 7 & 4 \\ 1 & 5 \end{bmatrix}$

c. In  $GL(2, \mathbf{R})$ ,  $\begin{bmatrix} 6 & 3 \\ 8 & 2 \end{bmatrix}^{-1}$

d. In  $GL(2, \mathbf{Z}_7)$ ,  $\begin{bmatrix} 2 & 1 \\ 1 & 3 \end{bmatrix}^{-1}$

7. Give two reasons why the set of odd integers under addition is not a group.
8. List the elements of  $U(20)$ .
9. Show that  $\{1, 2, 3\}$  under multiplication modulo 4 is not a group but that  $\{1, 2, 3, 4\}$  under multiplication modulo 5 is a group.
10. Show that the group  $GL(2, \mathbf{R})$  of Example 9 is non-Abelian by exhibiting a pair of matrices  $A$  and  $B$  in  $GL(2, \mathbf{R})$  such that  $AB \neq BA$ .
11. Let  $a$  belong to a group and  $a^{12} = e$ . Express the inverse of each of the elements  $a$ ,  $a^6$ ,  $a^8$ , and  $a^{11}$  in the form  $a^k$  for some positive integer  $k$ .
12. In  $U(9)$  find the inverse of 2, 7, and 8.
13. Translate each of the following multiplicative expressions into its additive counterpart. Assume that the operation is commutative.
  - a.  $a^2b^3$
  - b.  $a^{-2}(b^{-1}c)^2$
  - c.  $(ab^2)^{-3}c^2 = e$
14. For group elements  $a$ ,  $b$ , and  $c$ , express  $(ab)^3$  and  $(ab^{-2}c)^{-2}$  without parentheses.
15. Suppose that  $a$  and  $b$  belong to a group and  $a^5 = e$  and  $b^7 = e$ . Write  $a^{-2}b^{-4}$  and  $(a^2b^4)^{-2}$  without using negative exponents.
16. Show that the set  $\{5, 15, 25, 35\}$  is a group under multiplication modulo 40. What is the identity element of this group? Can you see any relationship between this group and  $U(8)$ ?
17. Let  $G$  be a group and let  $H = \{x^{-1} \mid x \in G\}$ . Show that  $G = H$  as sets.
18. List the members of  $K = \{x^2 \mid x \in D_4\}$  and  $L = \{x \in D_4 \mid x^2 = e\}$ .
19. Prove that the set of all  $2 \times 2$  matrices with entries from  $\mathbf{R}$  and determinant  $+1$  is a group under matrix multiplication.
20. For any integer  $n > 2$ , show that there are at least two elements in  $U(n)$  that satisfy  $x^2 = 1$ .
21. An abstract algebra teacher intended to give a typist a list of nine integers that form a group under multiplication modulo 91. Instead, one of the nine integers was inadvertently left out, so that the list appeared as 1, 9, 16, 22, 53, 74, 79, 81. Which integer was left out? (This really happened!)

22. Let  $G$  be a group with the property that for any  $x, y, z$  in the group,  $xy = zx$  implies  $y = z$ . Prove that  $G$  is Abelian. (“Left-right cancellation” implies commutativity.)
23. (Law of Exponents for Abelian Groups) Let  $a$  and  $b$  be elements of an Abelian group and let  $n$  be any integer. Show that  $(ab)^n = a^n b^n$ . Is this also true for non-Abelian groups?
24. (Socks–Shoes Property) Draw an analogy between the statement  $(ab)^{-1} = b^{-1} a^{-1}$  and the act of putting on and taking off your socks and shoes. Find distinct nonidentity elements  $a$  and  $b$  from a non-Abelian group such that  $(ab)^{-1} = a^{-1} b^{-1}$ . Find an example that shows that in a group, it is possible to have  $(ab)^{-2} \neq b^{-2} a^{-2}$ . What would be an appropriate name for the group property  $(abc)^{-1} = c^{-1} b^{-1} a^{-1}$ ?
25. Prove that a group  $G$  is Abelian if and only if  $(ab)^{-1} = a^{-1} b^{-1}$  for all  $a$  and  $b$  in  $G$ .
26. Prove that in a group,  $(a^{-1})^{-1} = a$  for all  $a$ .
27. For any elements  $a$  and  $b$  from a group and any integer  $n$ , prove that  $(a^{-1} b a)^n = a^{-1} b^n a$ .
28. If  $a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n$  belong to a group, what is the inverse of  $a_1 a_2 \cdots a_n$ ?
29. The integers 5 and 15 are among a collection of 12 integers that form a group under multiplication modulo 56. List all 12.
30. Give an example of a group with 105 elements. Give two examples of groups with 44 elements.
31. Prove that every group table is a *Latin square*<sup>†</sup>; that is, each element of the group appears exactly once in each row and each column.
32. Construct a Cayley table for  $U(12)$ .
33. Suppose the table below is a group table. Fill in the blank entries.

|     | $e$ | $a$ | $b$ | $c$ | $d$ |
|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|
| $e$ | $e$ | —   | —   | —   | —   |
| $a$ | —   | $b$ | —   | —   | $e$ |
| $b$ | —   | $c$ | $d$ | $e$ | —   |
| $c$ | —   | $d$ | —   | $a$ | $b$ |
| $d$ | —   | —   | —   | —   | —   |

<sup>†</sup>Latin squares are useful in designing statistical experiments. There is also a close connection between Latin squares and finite geometries.

- 34.** Prove that in a group,  $(ab)^2 = a^2b^2$  if and only if  $ab = ba$ .  
 Prove that in a group,  $(ab)^{-2} = b^{-2}a^{-2}$  if and only if  $ab = ba$ .
- 35.** Let  $a$ ,  $b$ , and  $c$  be elements of a group. Solve the equation  $axb = c$  for  $x$ . Solve  $a^{-1}xa = c$  for  $x$ .
- 36.** Let  $a$  and  $b$  belong to a group  $G$ . Find an  $x$  in  $G$  such that  $xabx^{-1} = ba$ .
- 37.** Let  $G$  be a finite group. Show that the number of elements  $x$  of  $G$  such that  $x^3 = e$  is odd. Show that the number of elements  $x$  of  $G$  such that  $x^2 \neq e$  is even.
- 38.** Give an example of a group with elements  $a$ ,  $b$ ,  $c$ ,  $d$ , and  $x$  such that  $axb = cxd$  but  $ab \neq cd$ . (Hence “middle cancellation” is not valid in groups.)
- 39.** Suppose that  $G$  is a group with the property that for every choice of elements in  $G$ ,  $axb = cxd$  implies  $ab = cd$ . Prove that  $G$  is Abelian. (“Middle cancellation” implies commutativity.)
- 40.** Find an element  $X$  in  $D_4$  such that  $R_{90}VXH = D'$ .
- 41.** Suppose  $F_1$  and  $F_2$  are distinct reflections in a dihedral group  $D_n$ . Prove that  $F_1F_2 \neq R_0$ .
- 42.** Suppose  $F_1$  and  $F_2$  are distinct reflections in a dihedral group  $D_n$  such that  $F_1F_2 = F_2F_1$ . Prove that  $F_1F_2 = R_{180}$ .
- 43.** Let  $R$  be any fixed rotation and  $F$  any fixed reflection in a dihedral group. Prove that  $R^kFR^k = F$ .
- 44.** Let  $R$  be any fixed rotation and  $F$  any fixed reflection in a dihedral group. Prove that  $FR^kF = R^{-k}$ . Why does this imply that  $D_n$  is non-Abelian?
- 45.** In the dihedral group  $D_n$ , let  $R = R_{360/n}$  and let  $F$  be any reflection. Write each of the following products in the form  $R^i$  or  $R^iF$ , where  $0 \leq i < n$ .
- In  $D_4$ ,  $FR^{-2}FR^5$
  - In  $D_5$ ,  $R^{-3}FR^4FR^{-2}$
  - In  $D_6$ ,  $FR^5FR^{-2}F$
- 46.** Prove that the set of all  $3 \times 3$  matrices with real entries of the form

$$\begin{bmatrix} 1 & a & b \\ 0 & 1 & c \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

is a group. (Multiplication is defined by

$$\begin{bmatrix} 1 & a & b \\ 0 & 1 & c \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & a' & b' \\ 0 & 1 & c' \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & a + a' & b' + ac' + b \\ 0 & 1 & c' + c \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}.$$

This group, sometimes called the *Heisenberg group* after the Nobel Prize-winning physicist Werner Heisenberg, is intimately related to the Heisenberg Uncertainty Principle of quantum physics.)

47. Prove that if  $G$  is a group with the property that the square of every element is the identity, then  $G$  is Abelian. (This exercise is referred to in Chapter 26.)
48. In a finite group, show that the number of nonidentity elements that satisfy the equation  $x^5 = e$  is a multiple of 5. If the stipulation that the group be finite is omitted, what can you say about the number of nonidentity elements that satisfy the equation  $x^5 = e$ ?
49. List the six elements of  $GL(2, \mathbb{Z}_2)$ . Show that this group is non-Abelian by finding two elements that do not commute. (This exercise is referred to in Chapter 7.)
50. Prove the assertion made in Example 19 that the set  $\{1, 2, \dots, n-1\}$  is a group under multiplication modulo  $n$  if and only if  $n$  is prime.
51. Suppose that in the definition of a group  $G$ , the condition that there exists an element  $e$  with the property  $ae = ea = a$  for all  $a$  in  $G$  is replaced by  $ae = a$  for all  $a$  in  $G$ . Show that  $ea = a$  for all  $a$  in  $G$ . (Thus, a one-sided identity is a two-sided identity.)
52. Suppose that in the definition of a group  $G$ , the condition that for each element  $a$  in  $G$  there exists an element  $b$  in  $G$  with the property  $ab = ba = e$  is replaced by the condition  $ab = e$ . Show that  $ba = e$ . (Thus, a one-sided inverse is a two-sided inverse.)

## Computer Exercises

Software for the computer exercises in this chapter is available at the website:

<http://www.d.umn.edu/~jgallian>

## References

1. Max Born, *My Life: Recollections of a Nobel Laureate*, New York: Charles Scribner's Sons, 1978.
2. J. Mehra and H. Reichenberg, *The Historical Development of Quantum Theory*, Vol. 3, New York: Springer-Verlag, 1982.

## Suggested Readings

Marcia Ascher, *Ethnomathematics*, Pacific Grove, CA: Brooks/Cole, 1991.

Chapter 3 of this book describes how the dihedral group of order 8 can be used to encode the social structure of the kin system of family relationships among a tribe of native people of Australia.

Arie Bialostocki, “An Application of Elementary Group Theory to Central Solitaire,” *The College Mathematics Journal*, May 1998: 208–212.

The author uses properties of groups to analyze the peg board game central solitaire (which also goes by the name peg solitaire).

J. E. White, “Introduction to Group Theory for Chemists,” *Journal of Chemical Education* 44 (1967): 128–135.

Students interested in the physical sciences may find this article worthwhile. It begins with easy examples of groups and builds up to applications of group theory concepts and terminology to chemistry.

# 3 Finite Groups; Subgroups

In our own time, in the period 1960–1980, we have seen particle physics emerge as the playground of group theory.

Freeman Dyson

What brought order and logic to the building blocks of matter... was something called a “symmetry group”—a mathematical beast that Frenkel had never encountered in school. “This was a moment of epiphany,” he recalls, a vision of “an entirely different world.”

Jim Holt in *The New York Review of Books* December 5, 2013

## Terminology and Notation

As we will soon discover, **finite groups**—that is, **groups with finitely many elements**—have interesting arithmetic properties. To facilitate the study of finite groups, it is convenient to introduce some terminology and notation.

### Definition Order of a Group

The number of elements of a group (finite or infinite) is called its **order**. We will use  $|G|$  to denote the **order of  $G$** .

Thus, the group  $Z$  of integers under addition has infinite order, whereas the group  $U(10) = \{1, 3, 7, 9\}$  under multiplication modulo 10 has order 4.

### Definition Order of an Element

The **order** of an element  $g$  in a group  $G$  is the **smallest** positive integer  $n$  such that  $g^n = e$ . (In additive notation, this would be  $ng = 0$ .) If no such integer exists, we say that  $g$  has *infinite order*. The order of an element  $g$  is denoted by  $|g|$ .

So, to find the order of a group element  $g$ , you need only compute the sequence of products  $g, g^2, g^3, \dots$ , until you reach the identity for the first



time. The exponent of this product (or coefficient if the operation is addition) is the order of  $g$ . If the identity never appears in the sequence, then  $g$  has infinite order.

■ **EXAMPLE 1** Consider  $U(15) = \{1, 2, 4, 7, 8, 11, 13, 14\}$  under multiplication modulo 15. This group has order 8. To find the order of the element 7, say, we compute the sequence  $7^1 = 7$ ,  $7^2 = 4$ ,  $7^3 = 13$ ,  $7^4 = 1$ , so  $|7| = 4$ . To find the order of 11, we compute  $11^1 = 11$ ,  $11^2 = 1$ , so  $|11| = 2$ . Similar computations show that  $|1| = 1$ ,  $|2| = 4$ ,  $|4| = 2$ ,  $|8| = 4$ ,  $|13| = 4$ ,  $|14| = 2$ . [Here is a trick that makes these calculations easier. Rather than compute the sequence  $13^1, 13^2, 13^3, 13^4$ , we may observe that  $13 = -2 \pmod{15}$ , so that  $13^2 = (-2)^2 = 4$ ,  $13^3 = -2 \cdot 4 = -8$ ,  $13^4 = (-2)(-8) = 1$ .]<sup>†</sup> ■

■ **EXAMPLE 2** Consider  $Z_{10}$  under addition modulo 10. Since  $1 \cdot 2 = 2$ ,  $2 \cdot 2 = 4$ ,  $3 \cdot 2 = 6$ ,  $4 \cdot 2 = 8$ ,  $5 \cdot 2 = 0$ , we know that  $|2| = 5$ . Similar computations show that  $|0| = 1$ ,  $|7| = 10$ ,  $|5| = 2$ ,  $|6| = 5$ . (Here  $2 \cdot 2$  is an abbreviation for  $2 + 2$ ,  $3 \cdot 2$  is an abbreviation for  $2 + 2 + 2$ , etc.) ■

■ **EXAMPLE 3** Consider  $Z$  under ordinary addition. Here every nonzero element has infinite order, since the sequence  $a, 2a, 3a, \dots$  never includes 0 when  $a \neq 0$ . ■

The perceptive reader may have noticed among our examples of groups in Chapter 2 that some are subsets of others with the same binary operation. The group  $SL(2, \mathbf{R})$  in Example 17, for instance, is a subset of the group  $GL(2, \mathbf{R})$  in Example 9. Similarly, the group of complex numbers  $\{1, -1, i, -i\}$  under multiplication is a subset of the group described in Example 15 for  $n$  equal to any multiple of 4. This situation arises so often that we introduce a special term to describe it.

### Definition Subgroup

If a subset  $H$  of a group  $G$  is itself a group under the operation of  $G$ , we say that  $H$  is a *subgroup* of  $G$ .

We use the notation  $H \leq G$  to mean that  $H$  is a subgroup of  $G$ . If we want to indicate that  $H$  is a subgroup of  $G$  but is not equal to  $G$  itself, we write  $H < G$ . Such a subgroup is called a *proper subgroup*. The subgroup  $\{e\}$  is called the *trivial subgroup* of  $G$ ; a subgroup that is not  $\{e\}$  is called a *nontrivial subgroup* of  $G$ .

Notice that  $Z_n$  under addition modulo  $n$  is *not* a subgroup of  $Z$  under addition, since addition modulo  $n$  is not the operation of  $Z$ .

<sup>†</sup> The website <http://www.google.com> provides a convenient way to do modular arithmetic. For example, to compute  $13^4 \pmod{15}$ , just type “13^4 mod 15” in the search box.

## Subgroup Tests

When determining whether or not a subset  $H$  of a group  $G$  is a subgroup of  $G$ , one need not directly verify the group axioms. The next three results provide simple tests that suffice to show that a subset of a group is a subgroup.

### ■ Theorem 3.1 One-Step Subgroup Test

*Let  $G$  be a group and  $H$  a nonempty subset of  $G$ . If  $ab^{-1}$  is in  $H$  whenever  $a$  and  $b$  are in  $H$ , then  $H$  is a subgroup of  $G$ . (In additive notation, if  $a - b$  is in  $H$  whenever  $a$  and  $b$  are in  $H$ , then  $H$  is a subgroup of  $G$ .)*

**PROOF** Since the operation of  $H$  is the same as that of  $G$ , it is clear that this operation is associative. Next, we show that  $e$  is in  $H$ . Since  $H$  is nonempty, we may pick some  $x$  in  $H$ . Then, letting  $a = x$  and  $b = x$  in the hypothesis, we have  $e = xx^{-1} = ab^{-1}$  is in  $H$ . To verify that  $x^{-1}$  is in  $H$  whenever  $x$  is in  $H$ , all we need to do is to choose  $a = e$  and  $b = x$  in the statement of the theorem. Finally, the proof will be complete when we show that  $H$  is closed; that is, if  $x, y$  belong to  $H$ , we must show that  $xy$  is in  $H$  also. Well, we have already shown that  $y^{-1}$  is in  $H$  whenever  $y$  is; so, letting  $a = x$  and  $b = y^{-1}$ , we have  $xy = x(y^{-1})^{-1} = ab^{-1}$  is in  $H$ . ■

Although we have **dubbed** Theorem 3.1 the One-Step Subgroup Test, there are actually four steps involved in applying the theorem. (After you gain some experience, the first three steps will be routine.) Notice the similarity between the last three steps listed below and the three steps involved in the Second Principle of Mathematical Induction.

1. Identify the property  $P$  that distinguishes the elements of  $H$ ; that is, identify a defining condition.
2. Prove that the identity has property  $P$ . (This verifies that  $H$  is nonempty.)
3. Assume that two elements  $a$  and  $b$  have property  $P$ .
4. Use the assumption that  $a$  and  $b$  have property  $P$  to show that  $ab^{-1}$  has property  $P$ .

The procedure is illustrated in Examples 4 and 5.

■ **EXAMPLE 4** Let  $G$  be an Abelian group with identity  $e$ . Then  $H = \{x \in G \mid x^2 = e\}$  is a subgroup of  $G$ . Here, the defining property of  $H$  is the condition  $x^2 = e$ . So, we first note that  $e^2 = e$ , so that  $H$  is nonempty. Now we assume that  $a$  and  $b$  belong to  $H$ . This means that  $a^2 = e$  and  $b^2 = e$ .

Finally, we must show that  $(ab^{-1})^2 = e$ . Since  $G$  is Abelian,  $(ab^{-1})^2 = ab^{-1}ab^{-1} = a^2(b^{-1})^2 = a^2(b^2)^{-1} = ee^{-1} = e$ . Therefore,  $ab^{-1}$  belongs to  $H$  and, by the One-Step Subgroup Test,  $H$  is a subgroup of  $G$ . ■

In many instances, a subgroup will consist of all elements that have a particular form. Then the property  $P$  is that the elements have that particular form. This is illustrated in the following example.

■ **EXAMPLE 5** Let  $G$  be an Abelian group under multiplication with identity  $e$ . Then  $H = \{x^2 \mid x \in G\}$  is a subgroup of  $G$ . (In words,  $H$  is the set of all “squares.”) Since  $e^2 = e$ , the identity has the correct form. Next, we write two elements of  $H$  in the correct form, say,  $a^2$  and  $b^2$ . We must show that  $a^2(b^2)^{-1}$  also has the correct form; that is,  $a^2(b^2)^{-1}$  is the square of some element. Since  $G$  is Abelian, we may write  $a^2(b^2)^{-1}$  as  $(ab^{-1})^2$ , which is the correct form. Thus,  $H$  is a subgroup of  $G$ . ■

Beginning students often prefer to use the next theorem instead of Theorem 3.1.

### ■ Theorem 3.2 Two-Step Subgroup Test

*Let  $G$  be a group and let  $H$  be a nonempty subset of  $G$ . If  $ab$  is in  $H$  whenever  $a$  and  $b$  are in  $H$  ( $H$  is closed under the operation), and  $a^{-1}$  is in  $H$  whenever  $a$  is in  $H$  ( $H$  is closed under taking inverses), then  $H$  is a subgroup of  $G$ .*

**PROOF** Since  $H$  is nonempty, the operation of  $H$  is associative,  $H$  is closed, and every element of  $H$  has an inverse in  $H$ , all that remains to show is that  $e$  is in  $H$ . To this end, let  $a$  belong to  $H$ . Then  $a^{-1}$  and  $aa^{-1} = e$  are in  $H$ . ■

When applying the Two-Step Subgroup Test, we proceed exactly as in the case of the One-Step Subgroup Test, except we use the assumption that  $a$  and  $b$  have property  $P$  to prove that  $ab$  has property  $P$  and that  $a^{-1}$  has property  $P$ .

■ **EXAMPLE 6** Let  $G$  be an Abelian group. Then  $H = \{x \in G \mid |x| \text{ is finite}\}$  is a subgroup of  $G$ . Since  $e^1 = e$ ,  $H \neq \emptyset$ . To apply the Two-Step Subgroup Test we assume that  $a$  and  $b$  belong to  $H$  and prove that  $ab$  and  $a^{-1}$  belong to  $H$ . Let  $|a| = m$  and  $|b| = n$ . Then, because  $G$  is Abelian, we have  $(ab)^{mn} = (a^m)^n(b^n)^m = e^n e^m = e$ . Thus,  $ab$  has finite order (this does not show that  $|ab| = mn$ ). Moreover,  $(a^{-1})^m = (a^m)^{-1} = e^{-1} = e$  shows that  $a^{-1}$  has finite order. ■

We next illustrate how to use the Two-Step Subgroup Test by introducing an important technique for creating new subgroups of Abelian groups from existing ones. The method will be extended to some subgroups of non-Abelian groups in later chapters.

■ **EXAMPLE 7** Let  $G$  be an Abelian group and  $H$  and  $K$  be subgroups of  $G$ . Then  $HK = \{hk \mid h \in H, k \in K\}$  is a subgroup of  $G$ . First note that  $e = ee$  belongs to  $HK$  because  $e$  is in both  $H$  and  $K$ . Now suppose that  $a$  and  $b$  are in  $HK$ . Then by definition of  $H$  there are elements  $h_1, h_2 \in H$  and  $k_1, k_2 \in K$  such that  $a = h_1k_1$  and  $b = h_2k_2$ . We must prove that  $ab \in HK$  and  $a^{-1} \in HK$ . Observe that because  $G$  is Abelian and  $H$  and  $K$  are subgroups of  $G$ , we have  $ab = h_1k_1h_2k_2 = (h_1h_2)(k_1k_2) \in HK$ . Likewise,  $a^{-1} = (h_1k_1)^{-1} = k_1^{-1}h_1^{-1} = h_1^{-1}k_1^{-1} \in HK$ . ■

How do you prove that a subset of a group is *not* a subgroup? Here are three possible ways, any one of which guarantees that the subset is not a subgroup:

1. Show that the identity is not in the set.
2. Exhibit an element of the set whose inverse is not in the set.
3. Exhibit two elements of the set whose product is not in the set.

■ **EXAMPLE 8** Let  $G$  be the group of nonzero real numbers under multiplication,  $H = \{x \in G \mid x = 1 \text{ or } x \text{ is irrational}\}$  and  $K = \{x \in G \mid x \geq 1\}$ . Then  $H$  is not a subgroup of  $G$ , since  $\sqrt{2} \in H$  but  $\sqrt{2} \cdot \sqrt{2} = 2 \notin H$ . Also,  $K$  is not a subgroup, since  $2 \in K$  but  $2^{-1} \notin K$ . ■

When dealing with finite groups, it is easier to use the following subgroup test.

### ■ Theorem 3.3 Finite Subgroup Test

*Let  $H$  be a nonempty finite subset of a group  $G$ . If  $H$  is closed under the operation of  $G$ , then  $H$  is a subgroup of  $G$ .*

**PROOF** In view of Theorem 3.2, we need only prove that  $a^{-1} \in H$  whenever  $a \in H$ . If  $a = e$ , then  $a^{-1} = a$  and we are done. If  $a \neq e$ , consider the sequence  $a, a^2, \dots$ . By closure, all of these elements belong to  $H$ . Since  $H$  is finite, not all of these elements are distinct. Say  $a^i = a^j$  and  $i > j$ . Then,  $a^{i-j} = e$ ; and since  $a \neq e$ ,  $i - j > 1$ . Thus,  $aa^{i-j-1} = a^{i-j} = e$  and, therefore,  $a^{i-j-1} = a^{-1}$ . But  $i - j - 1 \geq 1$  implies  $a^{i-j-1} \in H$  and we are done. ■

## Examples of Subgroups

The proofs of the next few theorems show how our subgroup tests work. We first introduce an important notation. For any element  $a$  from a group, we let  $\langle a \rangle$  denote the set  $\{a^n \mid n \in \mathbb{Z}\}$ . In particular, observe that the exponents of  $a$  include all negative integers as well as 0 and the positive integers ( $a^0$  is defined to be the identity).

### ■ Theorem 3.4 $\langle a \rangle$ Is a Subgroup

*Let  $G$  be a group, and let  $a$  be any element of  $G$ . Then,  $\langle a \rangle$  is a subgroup of  $G$ .*

**PROOF** Since  $a \in \langle a \rangle$ ,  $\langle a \rangle$  is not empty. Let  $a^n, a^m \in \langle a \rangle$ . Then,  $a^n(a^m)^{-1} = a^{n-m} \in \langle a \rangle$ ; so, by Theorem 3.1,  $\langle a \rangle$  is a subgroup of  $G$ . ■

The subgroup  $\langle a \rangle$  is called the *cyclic subgroup* of  $G$  generated by  $a$ . In the case that  $G = \langle a \rangle$ , we say that  $G$  is *cyclic* and  $a$  is a *generator* of  $G$ . (A cyclic group may have many generators.) Notice that although the list  $\dots, a^{-2}, a^{-1}, a^0, a^1, a^2, \dots$  has infinitely many entries, the set  $\{a^n \mid n \in \mathbb{Z}\}$  might have only finitely many elements. Also note that, since  $a^i a^j = a^{i+j} = a^{j+i} = a^j a^i$ , every cyclic group is Abelian.

■ **EXAMPLE 9** In  $U(10)$ ,  $\langle 3 \rangle = \{3, 9, 7, 1\} = U(10)$ , for  $3^1 = 3$ ,  $3^2 = 9$ ,  $3^3 = 7$ ,  $3^4 = 1$ ,  $3^5 = 3^4 \cdot 3 = 1 \cdot 3$ ,  $3^6 = 3^4 \cdot 3^2 = 9$ ,  $\dots$ ;  $3^{-1} = 7$  (since  $3 \cdot 7 = 1$ ),  $3^{-2} = 9$ ,  $3^{-3} = 3$ ,  $3^{-4} = 1$ ,  $3^{-5} = 3^{-4} \cdot 3^{-1} = 1 \cdot 7$ ,  $3^{-6} = 3^{-4} \cdot 3^{-2} = 1 \cdot 9 = 9$ ,  $\dots$ . ■

■ **EXAMPLE 10** In  $Z_{10}$ ,  $\langle 2 \rangle = \{2, 4, 6, 8, 0\}$ . Remember,  $a^n$  means  $na$  when the operation is addition. ■

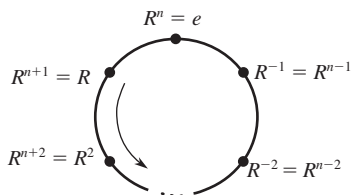
■ **EXAMPLE 11** In  $\mathbb{Z}$ ,  $\langle -1 \rangle = \mathbb{Z}$ . Here each entry in the list  $\dots, -2(-1), -1(-1), 0(-1), 1(-1), 2(-1), \dots$  represents a distinct group element. ■

■ **EXAMPLE 12** In  $D_n$ , the dihedral group of order  $2n$ , let  $R$  denote a rotation of  $360/n$  degrees. Then,

$$R^n = R_{360^\circ} = e, \quad R^{n+1} = R, \quad R^{n+2} = R^2, \dots$$

Similarly,  $R^{-1} = R^{n-1}$ ,  $R^{-2} = R^{n-2}$ ,  $\dots$ , so that  $\langle R \rangle = \{e, R, \dots, R^{n-1}\}$ . We see, then, that the powers of  $R$  “cycle back” periodically with period  $n$ . Visually, raising  $R$  to successive positive powers is the same as moving counterclockwise around the following circle one node at a time,

whereas raising  $R$  to successive negative powers is the same as moving around the circle clockwise one node at a time.



In Chapter 4 we will show that  $|\langle a \rangle| = |a|$ ; that is, the order of the subgroup generated by  $a$  is the order of  $a$  itself. (Actually, the definition of  $|a|$  was chosen to ensure the validity of this equation.)

For any element  $a$  of a group  $G$ , it is useful to think of  $\langle a \rangle$  as the smallest subgroup of  $G$  containing  $a$ . This notion can be extended to any collection  $S$  of elements from a group  $G$  by defining  $\langle S \rangle$  as the subgroup of  $G$  with the property that  $\langle S \rangle$  contains  $S$  and if  $H$  is any subgroup of  $G$  containing  $S$ , then  $H$  also contains  $\langle S \rangle$ . Thus,  $\langle S \rangle$  is the smallest subgroup of  $G$  that contains  $S$ . The set  $\langle S \rangle$  is called *the subgroup generated by  $S$* . We illustrate this concept in the next example.

### EXAMPLE 13

In  $Z_{20}$   $\langle 8, 14 \rangle = \{0, 2, 4, \dots, 18\} = \langle 2 \rangle$ .

In  $Z \langle 8, 13 \rangle = Z$ .

In  $D_4$   $\langle H, V \rangle = \{H, H^2, V, HV\} = \{R_0, R_{180}, H, V\}$ .

In  $D_4$   $\langle R_{90}, V \rangle = \{R_{90}, R_{90}^2, R_{90}^3, R_{90}^4, V, R_{90}V, R_{90}^2V, R_{90}^3V\} = D_4$

In  $\mathbf{R}$ , the group of real numbers under addition,  $\langle 2, \pi, \sqrt{2} \rangle = \{2a + b\pi + c\sqrt{2} \mid a, b, c \in Z\}$ .

In  $\mathbf{C}$ , the group of complex numbers under addition,  $\langle 1, i \rangle = \{a + bi \mid a, b \in Z\}$  (This group is called the “Gaussian integers”);

In  $\mathbf{C}^*$ , the group of nonzero complex numbers under multiplication,  $\langle 1, i \rangle = \{1, -1, i, -i\} = \langle i \rangle$ .

We next consider one of the most important subgroups.

### Definition Center of a Group

The *center*,  $Z(G)$ , of a group  $G$  is the subset of elements in  $G$  that commute with every element of  $G$ . In symbols,

$$Z(G) = \{a \in G \mid ax = xa \text{ for all } x \text{ in } G\}.$$

[The notation  $Z(G)$  comes from the fact that the German word for center is *Zentrum*. The term was coined by J. A. de Séguier in 1904.]

### ■ Theorem 3.5 Center Is a Subgroup

*The center of a group  $G$  is a subgroup of  $G$ .*

**PROOF** For variety, we shall use Theorem 3.2 to prove this result. Clearly,  $e \in Z(G)$ , so  $Z(G)$  is nonempty. Now, suppose  $a, b \in Z(G)$ . Then  $(ab)x = a(bx) = a(xb) = (ax)b = (xa)b = x(ab)$  for all  $x$  in  $G$ ; and, therefore,  $ab \in Z(G)$ .

Next, assume that  $a \in Z(G)$ . Then we have  $ax = xa$  for all  $x$  in  $G$ . What we want is  $a^{-1}x = xa^{-1}$  for all  $x$  in  $G$ . Informally, all we need do to obtain the second equation from the first one is simultaneously to bring the  $a$ 's across the equals sign:

$$\begin{array}{c} \curvearrowright \\ ax = xa \\ \curvearrowleft \end{array}$$

becomes  $xa^{-1} = a^{-1}x$ . (Be careful here; groups need not be commutative. The  $a$  on the left comes across as  $a^{-1}$  on the left, and the  $a$  on the right comes across as  $a^{-1}$  on the right.) Formally, the desired equation can be obtained from the original one by multiplying it on the left and right by  $a^{-1}$ , like so:

$$\begin{aligned} a^{-1}(ax)a^{-1} &= a^{-1}(xa)a^{-1}, \\ (a^{-1}a)xa^{-1} &= a^{-1}x(aa^{-1}), \\ exa^{-1} &= a^{-1}xe, \\ xa^{-1} &= a^{-1}x. \end{aligned}$$

This shows that  $a^{-1} \in Z(G)$  whenever  $a$  is. ■

For practice, let's determine the centers of the dihedral groups.

■ **EXAMPLE 14** For  $n \geq 3$ ,

$$Z(D_n) = \begin{cases} \{R_0, R_{180}\} & \text{when } n \text{ is even,} \\ \{R_0\} & \text{when } n \text{ is odd.} \end{cases}$$

To verify this, first observe that since every rotation in  $D_n$  is a power of  $R_{360/n}$ , rotations commute with rotations. We now investigate when a rotation commutes with a reflection. Let  $R$  be any rotation in  $D_n$  and let  $F$  be any reflection in  $D_n$ . Observe that since  $RF$  is a reflection we have  $RF = (RF)^{-1} = F^{-1}R^{-1} = FR^{-1}$ . Thus, it follows that  $R$  and  $F$  commute if and only if  $FR = RF = FR^{-1}$ . By cancellation, this holds if and only if  $R = R^{-1}$ . But  $R = R^{-1}$  only when  $R = R_0$  or  $R = R_{180}$ , and  $R_{180}$  is in  $D_n$  only when  $n$  is even. So, we have proved that  $Z(D_n) = \{R_0\}$  when  $n$  is odd and  $Z(D_n) = \{R_0, R_{180}\}$  when  $n$  is even. ■

Although an element from a non-Abelian group does not necessarily commute with every element of the group, there are always some elements with which it will commute. For example, every element  $a$  commutes with all powers of  $a$ . This observation prompts the next definition and theorem.

**Definition Centralizer of  $a$  in  $G$**

Let  $a$  be a fixed element of a group  $G$ . The *centralizer of  $a$  in  $G$* ,  $C(a)$ , is the set of all elements in  $G$  that commute with  $a$ . In symbols,  $C(a) = \{g \in G \mid ga = ag\}$ .

■ **EXAMPLE 15** In  $D_4$ , we have the following centralizers:

$$\begin{aligned} C(R_0) &= D_4 = C(R_{180}), \\ C(R_{90}) &= \{R_0, R_{90}, R_{180}, R_{270}\} = C(R_{270}), \\ C(H) &= \{R_0, H, R_{180}, V\} = C(V), \\ C(D) &= \{R_0, D, R_{180}, D'\} = C(D'). \end{aligned}$$

Notice that each of the centralizers in Example 15 is actually a subgroup of  $D_4$ . The next theorem shows that this was not a coincidence.

■ **Theorem 3.6**  $C(a)$  Is a Subgroup

*For each  $a$  in a group  $G$ , the centralizer of  $a$  is a subgroup of  $G$ .*

**PROOF** A proof similar to that of Theorem 3.5 is left to the reader to supply (Exercise 43). ■

Notice that for every element  $a$  of a group  $G$ ,  $Z(G) \subseteq C(a)$ . Also, observe that  $G$  is Abelian if and only if  $C(a) = G$  for all  $a$  in  $G$ .

## Exercises

The purpose of proof is to understand, not to verify.

Arnold Ross

1. For each group in the following list, find the order of the group and the order of each element in the group. What relation do you see between the orders of the elements of a group and the order of the group?

$$Z_{12}, \quad U(10), \quad U(12), \quad U(20), \quad D_4$$



2. Let  $Q$  be the group of rational numbers under addition and let  $Q^*$  be the group of nonzero rational numbers under multiplication. In  $Q$ , list the elements in  $\langle \frac{1}{2} \rangle$ . In  $Q^*$ , list the elements in  $\langle \frac{1}{2} \rangle$ .
3. Let  $Q$  and  $Q^*$  be as in Exercise 2. Find the order of each element in  $Q$  and in  $Q^*$ .
4. Prove that in any group, an element and its inverse have the same order.
5. Without actually computing the orders, explain why the two elements in each of the following pairs of elements from  $Z_{30}$  must have the same order:  $\{2, 28\}$ ,  $\{8, 22\}$ . Do the same for the following pairs of elements from  $U(15)$ :  $\{2, 8\}$ ,  $\{7, 13\}$ .
6. In the group  $Z_{12}$ , find  $|a|$ ,  $|b|$ , and  $|a + b|$  for each case.
  - a.  $a = 6, b = 2$
  - b.  $a = 3, b = 8$
  - c.  $a = 5, b = 4$

Do you see any relationship between  $|a|$ ,  $|b|$ , and  $|a + b|$ ?
7. If  $a$ ,  $b$ , and  $c$  are group elements and  $|a| = 6$ ,  $|b| = 7$ , express  $(a^4c^{-2}b^4)^{-1}$  without using negative exponents.
8. What can you say about a subgroup of  $D_3$  that contains  $R_{240}$  and a reflection  $F$ ? What can you say about a subgroup of  $D_3$  that contains two reflections?
9. What can you say about a subgroup of  $D_4$  that contains  $R_{270}$  and a reflection? What can you say about a subgroup of  $D_4$  that contains  $H$  and  $D$ ? What can you say about a subgroup of  $D_4$  that contains  $H$  and  $V$ ?
10. How many subgroups of order 4 does  $D_4$  have?
11. Determine all elements of finite order in  $R^*$ , the group of nonzero real numbers under multiplication.
12. Complete the statement “A group element  $x$  is its own inverse if and only if  $|x| = \underline{\hspace{2cm}}$ .”
13. For any group elements  $a$  and  $x$ , prove that  $|xax^{-1}| = |a|$ . This exercise is referred to in Chapter 24.
14. Prove that if  $a$  is the only element of order 2 in a group, then  $a$  lies in the center of the group.
15. (1969 Putnam Competition) Prove that no group is the union of two proper subgroups. Does the statement remain true if “two” is replaced by “three”?
16. Let  $G$  be the group of symmetries of a circle and  $R$  be a rotation of the circle of  $\sqrt{2}$  degrees. What is  $|R|$ ?

17. For each divisor  $k > 1$  of  $n$ , let  $U_k(n) = \{x \in U(n) \mid x \bmod k = 1\}$ . [For example,  $U_3(21) = \{1, 4, 10, 13, 16, 19\}$  and  $U_7(21) = \{1, 8\}$ .] List the elements of  $U_4(20)$ ,  $U_5(20)$ ,  $U_5(30)$ , and  $U_{10}(30)$ . Prove that  $U_k(n)$  is a subgroup of  $U(n)$ . Let  $H = \{x \in U(10) \mid x \bmod 3 = 1\}$ . Is  $H$  a subgroup of  $U(10)$ ? (This exercise is referred to in Chapter 8.)
18. Suppose that  $a$  is a group element and  $a^6 = e$ . What are the possibilities for  $|a|$ ? Provide reasons for your answer.
19. If  $a$  is a group element and  $a$  has infinite order, prove that  $a^m \neq a^n$  when  $m \neq n$ .
20. For any group elements  $a$  and  $b$ , prove that  $|ab| = |ba|$ .
21. Show that if  $a$  is an element of a group  $G$ , then  $|a| \leq |G|$ .
22. Show that  $U(14) = \langle 3 \rangle = \langle 5 \rangle$ . [Hence,  $U(14)$  is cyclic.] Is  $U(14) = \langle 11 \rangle$ ?
23. Show that  $U(20) \neq \langle k \rangle$  for any  $k$  in  $U(20)$ . [Hence,  $U(20)$  is not cyclic.]
24. Suppose  $n$  is an even positive integer and  $H$  is a subgroup of  $Z_n$ . Prove that either every member of  $H$  is even or exactly half of the members of  $H$  are even.
25. Let  $n$  be a positive even integer and let  $H$  be a subgroup of  $Z_n$  of odd order. Prove that every member of  $H$  is an even integer.
26. Prove that for every subgroup of  $D_n$ , either every member of the subgroup is a rotation or exactly half of the members are rotations.
27. Let  $H$  be a subgroup of  $D_n$  of odd order. Prove that every member of  $H$  is a rotation.
28. Prove that a group with two elements of order 2 that commute must have a subgroup of order 4.
29. For every even integer  $n$ , show that  $D_n$  has a subgroup of order 4.
30. Suppose that  $H$  is a proper subgroup of  $Z$  under addition and  $H$  contains 18, 30, and 40. Determine  $H$ .
31. Suppose that  $H$  is a proper subgroup of  $Z$  under addition and that  $H$  contains 12, 30, and 54. What are the possibilities for  $H$ ?
32. Suppose that  $H$  is a subgroup of  $Z$  under addition and that  $H$  contains  $2^{50}$  and  $3^{50}$ . What are the possibilities for  $H$ ?
33. Prove that the dihedral group of order 6 does not have a subgroup of order 4.
34. If  $H$  and  $K$  are subgroups of  $G$ , show that  $H \cap K$  is a subgroup of  $G$ . (Can you see that the same proof shows that the intersection of any number of subgroups of  $G$ , finite or infinite, is again a subgroup of  $G$ ?)
35. Let  $G$  be a group. Show that  $Z(G) = \bigcap_{a \in G} C(a)$ . [This means the intersection of *all* subgroups of the form  $C(a)$ .]

36. Let  $G$  be a group, and let  $a \in G$ . Prove that  $C(a) = C(a^{-1})$ .
37. For any group element  $a$  and any integer  $k$ , show that  $C(a) \subseteq C(a^k)$ . Use this fact to complete the following statement: “In a group, if  $x$  commutes with  $a$ , then . . .” Is the converse true?
38. Let  $G$  be an Abelian group and  $H = \{x \in G \mid |x| \text{ is odd}\}$ . Prove that  $H$  is a subgroup of  $G$ .
39. Let  $G$  be an Abelian group and  $H = \{x \in G \mid |x| \text{ is 1 or even}\}$ . Give an example to show that  $H$  need not be a subgroup of  $G$ .
40. If  $a$  and  $b$  are distinct group elements, prove that either  $a^2 \neq b^2$  or  $a^3 \neq b^3$ .
41. Let  $S$  be a subset of a group and let  $H$  be the intersection of all subgroups of  $G$  that contain  $S$ .
- Prove that  $\langle S \rangle = H$ .
  - If  $S$  is nonempty, prove that  $\langle S \rangle = \{s_1^{n_1} s_2^{n_2} \cdots s_m^{n_m} \mid m \geq 1, s_i \in S, n_i \in \mathbb{Z}\}$ . (The  $s_i$  terms need not be distinct.)
42. In the group  $\mathbb{Z}$ , find
- $\langle 8, 14 \rangle$ ;
  - $\langle 8, 13 \rangle$ ;
  - $\langle 6, 15 \rangle$ ;
  - $\langle m, n \rangle$ ;
  - $\langle 12, 18, 45 \rangle$ .
- In each part, find an integer  $k$  such that the subgroup is  $\langle k \rangle$ .
43. Prove Theorem 3.6.
44. If  $H$  is a subgroup of  $G$ , then by the *centralizer*  $C(H)$  of  $H$  we mean the set  $\{x \in G \mid xh = hx \text{ for all } h \in H\}$ . Prove that  $C(H)$  is a subgroup of  $G$ .
45. Must the centralizer of an element of a group be Abelian? Must the center of a group be Abelian?
46. Suppose  $a$  belongs to a group and  $|a| = 5$ . Prove that  $C(a) = C(a^3)$ . Find an element  $a$  from some group such that  $|a| = 6$  and  $C(a) \neq C(a^3)$ .
47. Let  $G$  be an Abelian group with identity  $e$  and let  $n$  be some fixed integer. Prove that the set of all elements of  $G$  that satisfy the equation  $x^n = e$  is a subgroup of  $G$ . Give an example of a group  $G$  in which the set of all elements of  $G$  that satisfy the equation  $x^2 = e$  does not form a subgroup of  $G$ . (This exercise is referred to in Chapter 11.)
48. In each case, find elements  $a$  and  $b$  from a group such that  $|a| = |b| = 2$ .
- $|ab| = 3$
  - $|ab| = 4$
  - $|ab| = 5$
- Can you see any relationship among  $|a|$ ,  $|b|$ , and  $|ab|$ ?

**49.** Prove that a group of even order must have an odd number of elements of order 2.

**50.** Consider the elements  $A = \begin{bmatrix} 0 & -1 \\ 1 & 0 \end{bmatrix}$  and  $B = \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ -1 & -1 \end{bmatrix}$  from  $SL(2, \mathbf{R})$ . Find  $|A|$ ,  $|B|$ , and  $|AB|$ . Does your answer surprise you?

**51.** Let  $a$  be a group element of order  $n$ , and suppose that  $d$  is a positive divisor of  $n$ . Prove that  $|a^d| = n/d$ .

**52.** Give an example of elements  $a$  and  $b$  from a group such that  $a$  has finite order,  $b$  has infinite order and  $ab$  has finite order.

**53.** Consider the element  $A = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$  in  $SL(2, \mathbf{R})$ . What is the order of

$A$ ? If we view  $A = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$  as a member of  $SL(2, \mathbf{Z}_p)$  ( $p$  is a prime), what is the order of  $A$ ?

**54.** For any positive integer  $n$  and any angle  $\theta$ , show that in the group  $SL(2, \mathbf{R})$ ,

$$\begin{bmatrix} \cos \theta & -\sin \theta \\ \sin \theta & \cos \theta \end{bmatrix}^n = \begin{bmatrix} \cos n\theta & -\sin n\theta \\ \sin n\theta & \cos n\theta \end{bmatrix}.$$

Use this formula to find the order of

$$\begin{bmatrix} \cos 60^\circ & -\sin 60^\circ \\ \sin 60^\circ & \cos 60^\circ \end{bmatrix} \text{ and } \begin{bmatrix} \cos \sqrt{2}^\circ & -\sin \sqrt{2}^\circ \\ \sin \sqrt{2}^\circ & \cos \sqrt{2}^\circ \end{bmatrix}.$$

(Geometrically,  $\begin{bmatrix} \cos \theta & -\sin \theta \\ \sin \theta & \cos \theta \end{bmatrix}$  represents a rotation of the plane  $\theta$  degrees.)

**55.** Let  $G$  be the symmetry group of a circle. Show that  $G$  has elements of every finite order as well as elements of infinite order.

**56.** In the group  $\mathbf{R}^*$  find elements  $a$  and  $b$  such that  $|a| = \infty$ ,  $|b| = \infty$  and  $|ab| = 2$ .

**57.** Let  $G$  be the symmetry group of a circle. Explain why  $G$  contains  $D_n$  for all  $n$ .

**58.** Prove that the subset of elements of finite order in an Abelian group forms a subgroup. (This subgroup is called the *torsion subgroup*.) Is the same thing true for non-Abelian groups?

**59.** Let  $H$  be a subgroup of a finite group  $G$ . Suppose that  $g$  belongs to  $G$  and  $n$  is the smallest positive integer such that  $g^n \in H$ . Prove that  $n$  divides  $|g|$ .

60. Compute the orders of the following groups.

- a.  $U(3)$ ,  $U(4)$ ,  $U(12)$
- b.  $U(5)$ ,  $U(7)$ ,  $U(35)$
- c.  $U(4)$ ,  $U(5)$ ,  $U(20)$
- d.  $U(3)$ ,  $U(5)$ ,  $U(15)$

On the basis of your answers, make a conjecture about the relationship among  $|U(r)|$ ,  $|U(s)|$ , and  $|U(rs)|$ .

61. Let  $\mathbf{R}^*$  be the group of nonzero real numbers under multiplication and let  $H = \{x \in \mathbf{R}^* \mid x^2 \text{ is rational}\}$ . Prove that  $H$  is a subgroup of  $\mathbf{R}^*$ . Can the exponent 2 be replaced by any positive integer and still have  $H$  be a subgroup?

62. Compute  $|U(4)|$ ,  $|U(10)|$ , and  $|U(40)|$ . Do these groups provide a counterexample to your answer to Exercise 60? If so, revise your conjecture.

63. Find a noncyclic subgroup of order 4 in  $U(40)$ .

64. Prove that a group of even order must have an element of order 2.

65. Let  $G = \left\{ \begin{bmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{bmatrix} \mid a, b, c, d \in \mathbf{Z} \right\}$  under addition. Let  $H = \left\{ \begin{bmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{bmatrix} \in G \mid a + b + c + d = 0 \right\}$ . Prove that  $H$  is a subgroup of  $G$ .

What if 0 is replaced by 1?

66. Let  $H = \{A \in GL(2, \mathbf{R}) \mid \det A \text{ is an integer power of } 2\}$ . Show that  $H$  is a subgroup of  $GL(2, \mathbf{R})$ .

67. Let  $H$  be a subgroup of  $\mathbf{R}$  under addition. Let  $K = \{2^a \mid a \in H\}$ . Prove that  $K$  is a subgroup of  $\mathbf{R}^*$  under multiplication.

68. Let  $G$  be a group of functions from  $\mathbf{R}$  to  $\mathbf{R}^*$ , where the operation of  $G$  is multiplication of functions. Let  $H = \{f \in G \mid f(2) = 1\}$ . Prove that  $H$  is a subgroup of  $G$ . Can 2 be replaced by any real number?

69. Let  $G = GL(2, \mathbf{R})$  and  $H = \left\{ \begin{bmatrix} a & 0 \\ 0 & b \end{bmatrix} \mid a \text{ and } b \text{ are nonzero integers} \right\}$  under the operation of matrix multiplication. Prove or disprove that  $H$  is a subgroup of  $GL(2, \mathbf{R})$ .

70. Let  $H = \{a + bi \mid a, b \in \mathbf{R}, ab \geq 0\}$ . Prove or disprove that  $H$  is a subgroup of  $\mathbf{C}$  under addition.

71. Let  $H = \{a + bi \mid a, b \in \mathbf{R}, a^2 + b^2 = 1\}$ . Prove or disprove that  $H$  is a subgroup of  $\mathbf{C}^*$  under multiplication. Describe the elements of  $H$  geometrically.

72. Let  $G$  be a finite Abelian group and let  $a$  and  $b$  belong to  $G$ . Prove that the set  $\langle a, b \rangle = \{a^i b^j \mid i, j \in \mathbf{Z}\}$  is a subgroup of  $G$ . What can you say about  $|\langle a, b \rangle|$  in terms of  $|a|$  and  $|b|$ ?

73. Let  $H$  be a subgroup of a group  $G$ . Prove that the set  $HZ(G) = \{hz \mid h \in H, z \in Z(G)\}$  is a subgroup of  $G$ . This exercise is referred to in this chapter.
74. If  $H$  and  $K$  are nontrivial subgroups of the rational numbers under addition, prove that  $H \cap K$  is nontrivial.
75. Let  $H$  be a nontrivial subgroup of the group of rational numbers under addition. Prove that  $H$  has a nontrivial proper subgroup.
76. Prove that a group of order  $n$  greater than 2 cannot have a subgroup of order  $n - 1$ .
77. Let  $a$  belong to a group and  $|a| = m$ . If  $n$  is relatively prime to  $m$ , show that  $a$  can be written as the  $n$ th power of some element in the group.
78. Let  $G$  be a finite group with more than one element. Show that  $G$  has an element of prime order.

## Computer Exercises

Computer exercises for this chapter are available at the website:

**<http://www.d.umn.edu/~jgallian>**

## Suggested Readings

Ruth Berger, “Hidden Group Structure,” *Mathematics Magazine* 78 (2005): 45–48.

In this note, the author investigates groups obtained from  $U(n)$  by multiplying each element by some  $k$  in  $U(n)$ . Such groups have identities that are not obvious.

J. Gallian and M. Reid, “Abelian Forcing Sets,” *American Mathematical Monthly* 100 (1993): 580–582.

A set  $S$  is called *Abelian forcing* if the only groups that satisfy  $(ab)^n = a^n b^n$  for all  $a$  and  $b$  in the group and all  $n$  in  $S$  are the Abelian ones. This paper characterizes the Abelian forcing sets. It can be downloaded at **<http://www.d.umn.edu/~jgallian/forcing.pdf>**

Gina Kolata, “Perfect Shuffles and Their Relation to Math,” *Science* 216 (1982): 505–506.

This is a delightful nontechnical article that discusses how group theory and computers were used to solve a difficult problem about shuffling a deck of cards. Serious work on the problem was begun by an undergraduate student as part of a programming course.

# 4

## Cyclic Groups

The notion of a “group,” viewed only 30 years ago as the epitome of sophistication, is today one of the mathematical concepts most widely used in physics, chemistry, biochemistry, and mathematics itself.

Alexey Sosinsky, 1991

Indeed, group theory achieved precisely that—a unity and indivisibility of the patterns underlying a wide range of seemingly unrelated disciplines.

Mario Livio, *The Equation That Could Not Be Solved*

### Properties of Cyclic Groups

Recall from Chapter 3 that a group  $G$  is called *cyclic* if there is an element  $a$  in  $G$  such that  $G = \{a^n \mid n \in \mathbb{Z}\}$ . Such an element  $a$  is called a *generator* of  $G$ . In view of the notation introduced in the preceding chapter, we may indicate that  $G$  is a cyclic group generated by  $a$  by writing  $G = \langle a \rangle$ .

In this chapter, we examine cyclic groups in detail and determine their important characteristics. We begin with a few examples.

■ **EXAMPLE 1** The set of integers  $\mathbb{Z}$  under ordinary addition is cyclic. Both 1 and  $-1$  are generators. (Recall that, when the operation is addition,  $1^n$  is interpreted as

$$\underbrace{1 + 1 + \cdots + 1}_{n \text{ terms}}$$

when  $n$  is positive and as

$$\underbrace{(-1) + (-1) + \cdots + (-1)}_{|n| \text{ terms}}$$

when  $n$  is negative.)

■ **EXAMPLE 2** The set  $Z_n = \{0, 1, \dots, n-1\}$  for  $n \geq 1$  is a cyclic group under addition modulo  $n$ . Again, 1 and  $-1 = n-1$  are generators. ■

Unlike  $Z$ , which has only two generators,  $Z_n$  may have many generators (depending on which  $n$  we are given).

■ **EXAMPLE 3**  $Z_8 = \langle 1 \rangle = \langle 3 \rangle = \langle 5 \rangle = \langle 7 \rangle$ . To verify, for instance, that  $Z_8 = \langle 3 \rangle$ , we note that  $\langle 3 \rangle = \{3, 3+3, 3+3+3, \dots\}$  is the set  $\{3, 6, 1, 4, 7, 2, 5, 0\} = Z_8$ . Thus, 3 is a generator of  $Z_8$ . On the other hand, 2 is not a generator, since  $\langle 2 \rangle = \{0, 2, 4, 6\} \neq Z_8$ . ■

■ **EXAMPLE 4** (See Example 11 in Chapter 2.)

$U(10) = \{1, 3, 7, 9\} = \{3^0, 3^1, 3^3, 3^2\} = \langle 3 \rangle$ . Also,  $\{1, 3, 7, 9\} = \{7^0, 7^3, 7^1, 7^2\} = \langle 7 \rangle$ . So both 3 and 7 are generators for  $U(10)$ . ■

Quite often in mathematics, a “nonexample” is as helpful in understanding a concept as an example. With regard to cyclic groups,  $U(8)$  serves this purpose; that is,  $U(8)$  is not a cyclic group. How can we verify this? Well, note that  $U(8) = \{1, 3, 5, 7\}$ . But

$$\begin{aligned}\langle 1 \rangle &= \{1\}, \\ \langle 3 \rangle &= \{3, 1\}, \\ \langle 5 \rangle &= \{5, 1\}, \\ \langle 7 \rangle &= \{7, 1\},\end{aligned}$$

so  $U(8) \neq \langle a \rangle$  for any  $a$  in  $U(8)$ .

With these examples under our belts, we are now ready to tackle cyclic groups in an abstract way and state their key properties.

#### ■ Theorem 4.1 Criterion for $a^i = a^j$

*Let  $G$  be a group, and let  $a$  belong to  $G$ . If  $a$  has infinite order, then  $a^i = a^j$  if and only if  $i = j$ . If  $a$  has finite order, say,  $n$ , then  $\langle a \rangle = \{e, a, a^2, \dots, a^{n-1}\}$  and  $a^i = a^j$  if and only if  $n$  divides  $i - j$ .*

**PROOF** If  $a$  has infinite order, there is no nonzero  $n$  such that  $a^n$  is the identity. Since  $a^i = a^j$  implies  $a^{i-j} = e$ , we must have  $i - j = 0$ , and the first statement of the theorem is proved.

Now assume that  $|a| = n$ . We will prove that  $\langle a \rangle = \{e, a, \dots, a^{n-1}\}$ . Certainly, the elements  $e, a, \dots, a^{n-1}$  are in  $\langle a \rangle$ .



Now, suppose that  $a^k$  is an arbitrary member of  $\langle a \rangle$ . By the division algorithm, there exist integers  $q$  and  $r$  such that

$$k = qn + r \quad \text{with} \quad 0 \leq r < n.$$

Then  $a^k = a^{qn+r} = a^{qn}a^r = (a^n)^qa^r = ea^r = a^r$ , so that  $a^k \in \{e, a, a^2, \dots, a^{n-1}\}$ . This proves that  $\langle a \rangle = \{e, a, a^2, \dots, a^{n-1}\}$ .

Next, we assume that  $a^i = a^j$  and prove that  $n$  divides  $i - j$ . We begin by observing that  $a^i = a^j$  implies  $a^{i-j} = e$ . Again, by the division algorithm, there are integers  $q$  and  $r$  such that

$$i - j = qn + r \quad \text{with} \quad 0 \leq r < n.$$

Then  $a^{i-j} = a^{qn+r}$ , and therefore  $e = a^{i-j} = a^{qn+r} = (a^n)^qa^r = e^qa^r = ea^r = a^r$ . Since  $n$  is the least positive integer such that  $a^n$  is the identity, we must have  $r = 0$ , so that  $n$  divides  $i - j$ .

Conversely, if  $i - j = nq$ , then  $a^{i-j} = a^{nq} = e^q = e$ , so that  $a^i = a^j$ . ■

Theorem 4.1 reveals the reason for the dual use of the notation and terminology for the order of an element and the order of a group.

### ■ Corollary 1 $|a| = |\langle a \rangle|$

*For any group element  $a$ ,  $|a| = |\langle a \rangle|$ .*

One special case of Theorem 4.1 occurs so often that it deserves singling out.

### ■ Corollary 2 $a^k = e$ Implies That $|a|$ Divides $k$

*Let  $G$  be a group and let  $a$  be an element of order  $n$  in  $G$ . If  $a^k = e$ , then  $n$  divides  $k$ .*

**PROOF** Since  $a^k = e = a^0$ , we know by Theorem 4.1 that  $n$  divides  $k - 0$ . ■

Exercises 48 and 50 of Chapter 3 demonstrate that, in general, there is no relationship between  $|ab|$  and  $|a|$  and  $|b|$ . However, we have the following.

### ■ Corollary 3 Relationship between $|ab|$ and $|a||b|$

*If  $a$  and  $b$  belong to a finite group and  $ab = ba$ , then  $|ab|$  divides  $|a||b|$ .*

**PROOF** Let  $|a| = m$  and  $|b| = n$ . Then  $(ab)^{mn} = (a^m)^n(b^n)^m = e^n e^m = e$ . So, by Corollary 2 of Theorem 4.1 we have that  $|ab|$  divides  $mn$ . ■

Theorem 4.1 and its corollaries for the case  $|a| = 6$  are illustrated in Figure 4.1.

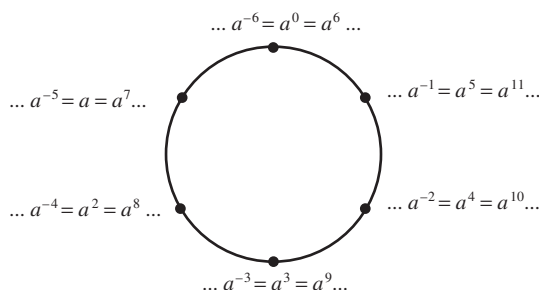


Figure 4.1

What is important about Theorem 4.1 in the finite case is that it says that multiplication in  $\langle a \rangle$  is essentially done by *addition* modulo  $n$ . That is, if  $(i + j) \bmod n = k$ , then  $a^i a^j = a^k$ . Thus, no matter what group  $G$  is, or how the element  $a$  is chosen, multiplication in  $\langle a \rangle$  works the same as addition in  $Z_n$  whenever  $|a| = n$ . Similarly, if  $a$  has infinite order, then multiplication in  $\langle a \rangle$  works the same as addition in  $Z$ , since  $a^i a^j = a^{i+j}$  and no modular arithmetic is done.

For these reasons, the cyclic groups  $Z_n$  and  $Z$  serve as prototypes for all cyclic groups, and algebraists say that there is essentially only one cyclic group of each order. What is meant by this is that, although there may be many different sets of the form  $\{a^n \mid n \in Z\}$ , there is essentially only one way to operate on these sets. Algebraists do not really care what the elements of a set are; they care only about the algebraic properties of the set—that is, the ways in which the elements of a set can be combined. We will return to this theme in the chapter on isomorphisms (Chapter 6).

The next theorem provides a simple method for computing  $|a^k|$  knowing only  $|a|$ , and its first corollary provides a simple way to tell when  $\langle a^i \rangle = \langle a^j \rangle$ .

■ **Theorem 4.2**  $\langle a^k \rangle = \langle a^{\gcd(n,k)} \rangle$  and  $|a^k| = n/\gcd(n, k)$

*Let  $a$  be an element of order  $n$  in a group and let  $k$  be a positive integer. Then  $\langle a^k \rangle = \langle a^{\gcd(n,k)} \rangle$  and  $|a^k| = n/\gcd(n, k)$ .*

**PROOF** To simplify the notation, let  $d = \gcd(n, k)$  and let  $k = dr$ . Since  $a^k = (a^d)^r$ , we have by closure that  $\langle a^k \rangle \subseteq \langle a^d \rangle$ . By Theorem 0.2 (the gcd

theorem), there are integers  $s$  and  $t$  such that  $d = ns + kt$ . So,  $a^d = a^{ns+kt} = a^{ns}a^{kt} = (a^n)^s(a^k)^t = e(a^k)^t = (a^k)^t \in \langle a^k \rangle$ . This proves  $\langle a^d \rangle \subseteq \langle a^k \rangle$ . So, we have verified that  $\langle a^k \rangle = \langle a^{\gcd(n,k)} \rangle$ .

We prove the second part of the theorem by showing first that  $|a^d| = n/d$  for any divisor  $d$  of  $n$ . Clearly,  $(a^d)^{n/d} = a^n = e$ , so that  $|a^d| \leq n/d$ . On the other hand, if  $i$  is a positive integer less than  $n/d$ , then  $(a^d)^i \neq e$  by definition of  $|a|$ . We now apply this fact with  $d = \gcd(n, k)$  to obtain  $|a^k| = |\langle a^k \rangle| = |\langle a^{\gcd(n,k)} \rangle| = |a^{\gcd(n,k)}| = n/\gcd(n, k)$ . ■

By doing simple arithmetic the next two examples illustrate how Theorem 4.2 allows us to easily list the elements of cyclic subgroups and compute the orders of elements of a cyclic group in cases where the elements are inconvenient to work with.

■ **EXAMPLE 5** For  $|a| = 30$  we find  $\langle a^{26} \rangle$ ,  $\langle a^{17} \rangle$ ,  $\langle a^{18} \rangle$  and  $|a^{26}|$ ,  $|a^{17}|$ , and  $|a^{18}|$ . Since  $\gcd(30, 26) = 2$ , we have  $\langle a^{26} \rangle = \langle a^2 \rangle = \{e, a^2, a^4, a^6, \dots, a^{28}\}$  and  $|a^{26}| = |a^2| = 30/2 = 15$ . Since  $\gcd(30, 17) = 1$ , we have  $\langle a^{17} \rangle = \langle a^1 \rangle = \{e, a, a^2, a^3, \dots, a^{29}\}$  and  $|a^{17}| = |a^1| = 30/1 = 30$ . Since  $\gcd(30, 18) = 6$ , we have  $\langle a^{18} \rangle = \langle a^6 \rangle = \{e, a^6, a^{12}, a^{18}, a^{24}\}$  and  $|a^{18}| = |a^6| = 30/6 = 5$ . ■

For large values of  $n$  and  $k$  we find  $\gcd(n, k)$  by using the prime-power factorization of  $n$  and  $k$ .

■ **EXAMPLE 6** For  $|a| = 1000$  we find  $\langle a^{185} \rangle$ ,  $\langle a^{400} \rangle$ ,  $\langle a^{62} \rangle$  and  $|a^{185}|$ ,  $|a^{400}|$ , and  $|a^{62}|$ . Since  $\gcd(1000, 185) = \gcd(2^3 5^3, 2^2 5 \cdot 17) = 2^2 5 = 20$  we have  $\langle a^{185} \rangle = \langle a^{20} \rangle = \{e, a^{20}, a^{40}, a^{60}, \dots, a^{980}\}$  and  $|a^{185}| = |a^{20}| = 1000/20 = 50$ . Since  $\gcd(1000, 400) = \gcd(2^3 5^3, 2^4 5^2) = 2^3 5^2 = 200$  we have  $\langle a^{400} \rangle = \langle a^{200} \rangle = \{e, a^{200}, a^{400}, a^{600}, a^{800}\}$  and  $|a^{400}| = |a^{200}| = 1000/200 = 5$ . Since  $\gcd(1000, 62) = \gcd(2^3 5^3, 2 \cdot 31) = 2$  we have  $\langle a^{62} \rangle = \langle a^2 \rangle = \{e, a^2, a^4, a^6, \dots, a^{998}\}$  and  $|a^{62}| = |a^2| = 1000/2 = 500$ . ■

Theorem 4.2 establishes an important relationship between the order of an element in a finite cyclic group and the order of the group.

### ■ Corollary 1 Orders of Elements in Finite Cyclic Groups

*In a finite cyclic group, the order of an element divides the order of the group.*

### ■ Corollary 2 Criterion for $\langle a^i \rangle = \langle a^j \rangle$ and $|a^i| = |a^j|$

*Let  $|a| = n$ . Then  $\langle a^i \rangle = \langle a^j \rangle$  if and only if  $\gcd(n, i) = \gcd(n, j)$ , and  $|a^i| = |a^j|$  if and only if  $\gcd(n, i) = \gcd(n, j)$ .*

**PROOF** Theorem 4.2 shows that  $\langle a^i \rangle = \langle a^{\gcd(n,i)} \rangle$  and  $\langle a^j \rangle = \langle a^{\gcd(n,j)} \rangle$ , so that the proof reduces to proving that  $\langle a^{\gcd(n,i)} \rangle = \langle a^{\gcd(n,j)} \rangle$  if and only if  $\gcd(n, i) = \gcd(n, j)$ . Certainly,  $\gcd(n, i) = \gcd(n, j)$  implies that  $\langle a^{\gcd(n,i)} \rangle = \langle a^{\gcd(n,j)} \rangle$ . On the other hand,  $\langle a^{\gcd(n,i)} \rangle = \langle a^{\gcd(n,j)} \rangle$  implies that  $|a^{\gcd(n,i)}| = |a^{\gcd(n,j)}|$ , so that by the second conclusion of Theorem 4.2, we have  $n/\gcd(n, i) = n/\gcd(n, j)$ , and therefore  $\gcd(n, i) = \gcd(n, j)$ . ■

The second part of the corollary follows from the first part and Corollary 1 of Theorem 4.1.

The next two corollaries are important special cases of the preceding corollary.

### ■ Corollary 3 Generators of Finite Cyclic Groups

*Let  $|a| = n$ . Then  $\langle a \rangle = \langle a^j \rangle$  if and only if  $\gcd(n, j) = 1$ , and  $|a| = |\langle a^j \rangle|$  if and only if  $\gcd(n, j) = 1$ .*

### ■ Corollary 4 Generators of $Z_n$

*An integer  $k$  in  $Z_n$  is a generator of  $Z_n$  if and only if  $\gcd(n, k) = 1$ .*

The value of Corollary 3 is that once one generator of a cyclic group has been found, all generators of the cyclic group can easily be determined. For example, consider the subgroup of all rotations in  $D_6$ . Clearly, one generator is  $R_{60}$ . And, since  $|R_{60}| = 6$ , we see by Corollary 3 that the only other generator is  $(R_{60})^5 = R_{300}$ . Of course, we could have readily deduced this information without the aid of Corollary 3 by direct calculations. So, to illustrate the real power of Corollary 3, let us use it to find all generators of the cyclic group  $U(50)$ . First, note that direct computations show that  $|U(50)| = 20$  and that 3 is one of its generators. Thus, in view of Corollary 3, the complete list of generators for  $U(50)$  is

$$\begin{array}{ll} 3 \bmod 50 = 3, & 3^{11} \bmod 50 = 47, \\ 3^3 \bmod 50 = 27, & 3^{13} \bmod 50 = 23, \\ 3^7 \bmod 50 = 37, & 3^{17} \bmod 50 = 13, \\ 3^9 \bmod 50 = 33, & 3^{19} \bmod 50 = 17. \end{array}$$

Admittedly, we had to do some arithmetic here, but it certainly entailed much less work than finding all the generators by simply determining the order of each element of  $U(50)$  one by one.

The reader should keep in mind that Theorem 4.2 and its corollaries apply only to elements of finite order.

## Classification of Subgroups of Cyclic Groups

The next theorem tells us how many subgroups a finite cyclic group has and how to find them.

### ■ Theorem 4.3 Fundamental Theorem of Cyclic Groups

*Every subgroup of a cyclic group is cyclic. Moreover, if  $|\langle a \rangle| = n$ , then the order of any subgroup of  $\langle a \rangle$  is a divisor of  $n$ ; and, for each positive divisor  $k$  of  $n$ , the group  $\langle a \rangle$  has exactly one subgroup of order  $k$ —namely,  $\langle a^{n/k} \rangle$ .*

Before we prove this theorem, let's see what it means. Understanding what a theorem means is a prerequisite to understanding its proof. Suppose  $G = \langle a \rangle$  and  $G$  has order 30. The first and second parts of the theorem say that if  $H$  is any subgroup of  $G$ , then  $H$  has the form  $\langle a^{30/k} \rangle$  for some  $k$  that is a divisor of 30. The third part of the theorem says that  $G$  has one subgroup of each of the orders 1, 2, 3, 5, 6, 10, 15, and 30—and no others. The proof will also show how to find these subgroups.

**PROOF** Let  $G = \langle a \rangle$  and suppose that  $H$  is a subgroup of  $G$ . We must show that  $H$  is cyclic. If it consists of the identity alone, then clearly  $H$  is cyclic. So we may assume that  $H \neq \{e\}$ . We now claim that  $H$  contains an element of the form  $a^t$ , where  $t$  is positive. Since  $G = \langle a \rangle$ , every element of  $H$  has the form  $a^t$ ; and when  $a^t$  belongs to  $H$  with  $t < 0$ , then  $a^{-t}$  belongs to  $H$  also and  $-t$  is positive. Thus, our claim is verified. Now let  $m$  be the least positive integer such that  $a^m \in H$ . By closure,  $\langle a^m \rangle \subseteq H$ . We next claim that  $H = \langle a^m \rangle$ . To prove this claim, it suffices to let  $b$  be an arbitrary member of  $H$  and show that  $b$  is in  $\langle a^m \rangle$ . Since  $b \in G = \langle a \rangle$ , we have  $b = a^k$  for some  $k$ . Now, apply the division algorithm to  $k$  and  $m$  to obtain integers  $q$  and  $r$  such that  $k = mq + r$  where  $0 \leq r < m$ . Then  $a^k = a^{mq+r} = a^{mq}a^r$ , so that  $a^r = a^{-mq}a^k$ . Since  $a^k = b \in H$  and  $a^{-mq} = (a^m)^{-q}$  is in  $H$  also,  $a^r \in H$ . But,  $m$  is the *least* positive integer such that  $a^m \in H$ , and  $0 \leq r < m$ , so  $r$  must be 0. Therefore,  $b = a^k = a^{mq} = (a^m)^q \in \langle a^m \rangle$ . This proves the assertion of the theorem that every subgroup of a cyclic group is cyclic.

To prove the next portion of the theorem, suppose that  $|\langle a \rangle| = n$  and  $H$  is any subgroup of  $\langle a \rangle$ . We have already shown that  $H = \langle a^m \rangle$ , where  $m$  is the least positive integer such that  $a^m \in H$ . Using  $e = b = a^n$  as in the preceding paragraph, we have  $n = mq$ .

Finally, let  $k$  be any positive divisor of  $n$ . We will show that  $\langle a^{n/k} \rangle$  is the one and only subgroup of  $\langle a \rangle$  of order  $k$ . From Theorem 4.2, we see that  $\langle a^{n/k} \rangle$  has order  $n/\gcd(n, n/k) = n/(n/k) = k$ . Now let  $H$  be any subgroup of  $\langle a \rangle$  of order  $k$ . We have already shown above that  $H = \langle a^m \rangle$ , where  $m$  is a divisor of  $n$ . Then  $m = \gcd(n, m)$  and  $k = |a^m| = |a^{\gcd(n, m)}| = n/\gcd(n, m) = n/m$ . Thus,  $m = n/k$  and  $H = \langle a^{n/k} \rangle$ . ■

Returning for a moment to our discussion of the cyclic group  $\langle a \rangle$ , where  $a$  has order 30, we may conclude from Theorem 4.3 that the subgroups of  $\langle a \rangle$  are precisely those of the form  $\langle a^m \rangle$ , where  $m$  is a divisor of 30. Moreover, if  $k$  is a divisor of 30, the subgroup of order  $k$  is  $\langle a^{30/k} \rangle$ . So the list of subgroups of  $\langle a \rangle$  is:

|                                                                    |           |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| $\langle a \rangle = \{e, a, a^2, \dots, a^{29}\}$                 | order 30, |
| $\langle a^2 \rangle = \{e, a^2, a^4, \dots, a^{28}\}$             | order 15, |
| $\langle a^3 \rangle = \{e, a^3, a^6, \dots, a^{27}\}$             | order 10, |
| $\langle a^5 \rangle = \{e, a^5, a^{10}, a^{15}, a^{20}, a^{25}\}$ | order 6,  |
| $\langle a^6 \rangle = \{e, a^6, a^{12}, a^{18}, a^{24}\}$         | order 5,  |
| $\langle a^{10} \rangle = \{e, a^{10}, a^{20}\}$                   | order 3,  |
| $\langle a^{15} \rangle = \{e, a^{15}\}$                           | order 2,  |
| $\langle a^{30} \rangle = \{e\}$                                   | order 1.  |

In general, if  $\langle a \rangle$  has order  $n$  and  $k$  divides  $n$ , then  $\langle a^{n/k} \rangle$  is the unique subgroup of order  $k$ .

Taking the group in Theorem 4.3 to be  $Z_n$  and  $a$  to be 1, we obtain the following important special case.

### ■ Corollary Subgroups of $Z_n$

*For each positive divisor  $k$  of  $n$ , the set  $\langle n/k \rangle$  is the unique subgroup of  $Z_n$  of order  $k$ ; moreover, these are the only subgroups of  $Z_n$ .*

■ **EXAMPLE 7** The list of subgroups of  $Z_{30}$  is

|                                                |           |
|------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| $\langle 1 \rangle = \{0, 1, 2, \dots, 29\}$   | order 30, |
| $\langle 2 \rangle = \{0, 2, 4, \dots, 28\}$   | order 15, |
| $\langle 3 \rangle = \{0, 3, 6, \dots, 27\}$   | order 10, |
| $\langle 5 \rangle = \{0, 5, 10, 15, 20, 25\}$ | order 6,  |
| $\langle 6 \rangle = \{0, 6, 12, 18, 24\}$     | order 5,  |
| $\langle 10 \rangle = \{0, 10, 20\}$           | order 3,  |
| $\langle 15 \rangle = \{0, 15\}$               | order 2,  |
| $\langle 30 \rangle = \{0\}$                   | order 1.  |

■

Theorems 4.2 and 4.3 provide a simple way to find all the generators of the subgroups of a finite cyclic group.

■ **EXAMPLE 8** To find the generators of the subgroup of order 9 in  $Z_{36}$ , we observe that  $36/9 = 4$  is one generator. To find the others, we have from Corollary 3 of Theorem 4.2 that they are all elements of  $Z_{36}$  of the form  $4j$ , where  $\gcd(9, j) = 1$ . Thus,

$$\langle 4 \cdot 1 \rangle = \langle 4 \cdot 2 \rangle = \langle 4 \cdot 4 \rangle = \langle 4 \cdot 5 \rangle = \langle 4 \cdot 7 \rangle = \langle 4 \cdot 8 \rangle.$$

In the generic case, to find all the subgroups of  $\langle a \rangle$  of order 9 where  $|a| = 36$ , we have

$$\langle (a^4)^1 \rangle = \langle (a^4)^2 \rangle = \langle (a^4)^4 \rangle = \langle (a^4)^5 \rangle = \langle (a^4)^7 \rangle = \langle (a^4)^8 \rangle.$$

In particular, note that once you have the generator  $a^{n/d}$  for the subgroup of order  $d$  where  $d$  is a divisor of  $|a| = n$ , all the generators of  $\langle a^d \rangle$  have the form  $(a^d)^j$  where  $j \in U(d)$ . ■

By combining Theorems 4.2 and 4.3, we can easily count the number of elements of each order in a finite cyclic group. For convenience, we introduce an important number-theoretic function called the *Euler phi function*. Let  $\phi(1) = 1$ , and for any integer  $n > 1$ , let  $\phi(n)$  denote the number of positive integers less than  $n$  and relatively prime to  $n$ . Notice that by definition of the group  $U(n)$ ,  $|U(n)| = \phi(n)$ . The first 12 values of  $\phi(n)$  are given in Table 4.1.

**Table 4.1** Values of  $\phi(n)$

| $n$       | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 | 6 | 7 | 8 | 9 | 10 | 11 | 12 |
|-----------|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|----|----|----|
| $\phi(n)$ | 1 | 1 | 2 | 2 | 4 | 2 | 6 | 4 | 6 | 4  | 10 | 4  |

#### ■ Theorem 4.4 Number of Elements of Each Order in a Cyclic Group

*If  $d$  is a positive divisor of  $n$ , the number of elements of order  $d$  in a cyclic group of order  $n$  is  $\phi(d)$ .*

**PROOF** By Theorem 4.3, the group has exactly one subgroup of order  $d$ —call it  $\langle a \rangle$ . Then every element of order  $d$  also generates the subgroup  $\langle a \rangle$  and, by Corollary 3 of Theorem 4.2, an element  $a^k$  generates  $\langle a \rangle$  if and only if  $\gcd(k, d) = 1$ . The number of such elements is precisely  $\phi(d)$ . ■

Notice that for a finite cyclic group of order  $n$ , the number of elements of order  $d$  for any divisor  $d$  of  $n$  depends only on  $d$ . Thus,  $Z_8$ ,  $Z_{640}$ , and  $Z_{80000}$  each have  $\phi(8) = 4$  elements of order 8.

Although there is no formula for the number of elements of each order for arbitrary finite groups, we still can say something important in this regard.

### ■ Corollary Number of Elements of Order $d$ in a Finite Group

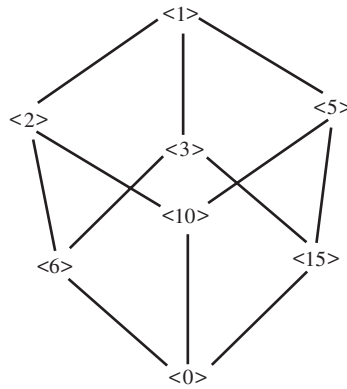
*In a finite group, the number of elements of order  $d$  is a multiple of  $\phi(d)$ .*

**PROOF** If a finite group has no elements of order  $d$ , the statement is true, since  $\phi(d)$  divides 0. Now suppose that  $a \in G$  and  $|a| = d$ . By Theorem 4.4, we know that  $\langle a \rangle$  has  $\phi(d)$  elements of order  $d$ . If all elements of order  $d$  in  $G$  are in  $\langle a \rangle$ , we are done. So, suppose that there is an element  $b$  in  $G$  of order  $d$  that is not in  $\langle a \rangle$ . Then,  $\langle b \rangle$  also has  $\phi(d)$  elements of order  $d$ . This means that we have found  $2\phi(d)$  elements of order  $d$  in  $G$  provided that  $\langle a \rangle$  and  $\langle b \rangle$  have no elements of order  $d$  in common. If there is an element  $c$  of order  $d$  that belongs to both  $\langle a \rangle$  and  $\langle b \rangle$ , then we have  $\langle a \rangle = \langle c \rangle = \langle b \rangle$ , so that  $b \in \langle a \rangle$ , which is a contradiction. Continuing in this fashion, we see that the number of elements of order  $d$  in a finite group is a multiple of  $\phi(d)$ . ■

On its face, the value of Theorem 4.4 and its corollary seem limited for large values of  $n$ , because it is tedious to determine the number of positive integers less than or equal to  $n$  and relatively prime to  $n$  by examining them one by one. However, the following properties of the  $\phi$  function make computing  $\phi(n)$  simple: For any prime  $p$ ,  $\phi(p^n) = p^n - p^{n-1}$  (see Exercise 65) and for relatively prime  $m$  and  $n$ ,  $\phi(mn) = \phi(m)\phi(n)$ . Thus,  $\phi(40) = \phi(8)\phi(5) = 4 \cdot 4 = 16$ ;  $\phi(75) = \phi(5^2)\phi(3) = (25 - 5) \cdot 2 = 40$ .

The relationships among the various subgroups of a group can be illustrated with a *subgroup lattice* of the group. This is a diagram that includes all the subgroups of the group and connects a subgroup  $H$  at one level to a subgroup  $K$  at a higher level with a sequence of line segments if and only if  $H$  is a proper subgroup of  $K$ . Although there are many ways to draw such a diagram, the connections between the subgroups must be the same. Typically, one attempts to present the diagram in an eye-pleasing fashion. The lattice diagram for  $Z_{30}$  is shown in Figure 4.2. Notice that  $\langle 10 \rangle$  is a subgroup of both  $\langle 2 \rangle$  and  $\langle 5 \rangle$ , but  $\langle 6 \rangle$  is not a subgroup of  $\langle 10 \rangle$ .





**Figure 4.2** Subgroup lattice of  $Z_{30}$ .

The precision of Theorem 4.3 can be appreciated by comparing the ease with which we are able to identify the subgroups of  $Z_{30}$  with that of doing the same for, say,  $U(30)$  or  $D_{30}$ . And these groups have relatively simple structures among noncyclic groups.

We will prove in Chapter 7 that a certain portion of Theorem 4.3 extends to arbitrary finite groups; namely, the order of a subgroup divides the order of the group itself. We will also see, however, that a finite group need not have exactly one subgroup corresponding to each divisor of the order of the group. For some divisors, there may be none at all, whereas for other divisors, there may be many. Indeed,  $D_4$ , the dihedral group of order 8, has five subgroups of order 2 and three of order 4.

One final remark about the importance of cyclic groups is appropriate. Although cyclic groups constitute a very narrow class of finite groups, we will see in Chapter 11 that they play the role of building blocks for all finite Abelian groups in much the same way that primes are the building blocks for the integers and that chemical elements are the building blocks for the chemical compounds.

## Exercises

It is not unreasonable to use the hypothesis.

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1. Find all generators of  $Z_6$ ,  $Z_8$ , and  $Z_{20}$ .
2. Suppose that  $\langle a \rangle$ ,  $\langle b \rangle$ , and  $\langle c \rangle$  are cyclic groups of orders 6, 8, and 20, respectively. Find all generators of  $\langle a \rangle$ ,  $\langle b \rangle$ , and  $\langle c \rangle$ .

3. List the elements of the subgroups  $\langle 20 \rangle$  and  $\langle 10 \rangle$  in  $Z_{30}$ . Let  $a$  be a group element of order 30. List the elements of the subgroups  $\langle a^{20} \rangle$  and  $\langle a^{10} \rangle$ .
4. List the elements of the subgroups  $\langle 3 \rangle$  and  $\langle 15 \rangle$  in  $Z_{18}$ . Let  $a$  be a group element of order 18. List the elements of the subgroups  $\langle a^3 \rangle$  and  $\langle a^{15} \rangle$ .
5. List the elements of the subgroups  $\langle 3 \rangle$  and  $\langle 7 \rangle$  in  $U(20)$ .
6. What do Exercises 3, 4, and 5 have in common? Try to make a generalization that includes these three cases.
7. Find an example of a noncyclic group, all of whose proper subgroups are cyclic.
8. Let  $a$  be an element of a group and let  $|a| = 15$ . Compute the orders of the following elements of  $G$ .
  - a.  $a^3, a^6, a^9, a^{12}$
  - b.  $a^5, a^{10}$
  - c.  $a^2, a^4, a^8, a^{14}$
9. How many subgroups does  $Z_{20}$  have? List a generator for each of these subgroups. Suppose that  $G = \langle a \rangle$  and  $|a| = 20$ . How many subgroups does  $G$  have? List a generator for each of these subgroups.
10. In  $Z_{24}$ , list all generators for the subgroup of order 8. Let  $G = \langle a \rangle$  and let  $|a| = 24$ . List all generators for the subgroup of order 8.
11. Let  $G$  be a group and let  $a \in G$ . Prove that  $\langle a^{-1} \rangle = \langle a \rangle$ .
12. In  $Z$ , find all generators of the subgroup  $\langle 3 \rangle$ . If  $a$  has infinite order, find all generators of the subgroup  $\langle a^3 \rangle$ .
13. In  $Z_{24}$ , find a generator for  $\langle 21 \rangle \cap \langle 10 \rangle$ . Suppose that  $|a| = 24$ . Find a generator for  $\langle a^{21} \rangle \cap \langle a^{10} \rangle$ . In general, what is a generator for the subgroup  $\langle a^m \rangle \cap \langle a^n \rangle$ ?
14. Suppose that a cyclic group  $G$  has exactly three subgroups:  $G$  itself,  $\{e\}$ , and a subgroup of order 7. What is  $|G|$ ? What can you say if 7 is replaced with  $p$  where  $p$  is a prime?
15. Let  $G$  be an Abelian group and let  $H = \{g \in G \mid |g| \text{ divides } 12\}$ . Prove that  $H$  is a subgroup of  $G$ . Is there anything special about 12 here? Would your proof be valid if 12 were replaced by some other positive integer? State the general result.
16. Complete the statement:  $|a| = |a^2|$  if and only if  $|a| \dots$
17. Complete the statement:  $|a^2| = |a^{12}|$  if and only if  $\dots$
18. Let  $a$  be a group element and  $|a| = \infty$ . Complete the following statement:  $|a^i| = |a^j|$  if and only if  $\dots$

19. If a cyclic group has an element of infinite order, how many elements of finite order does it have?
20. Suppose that  $G$  is an Abelian group of order 35 and every element of  $G$  satisfies the equation  $x^{35} = e$ . Prove that  $G$  is cyclic. Does your argument work if 35 is replaced with 33?
21. Let  $G$  be a group and let  $a$  be an element of  $G$ .
  - a. If  $a^{12} = e$ , what can we say about the order of  $a$ ?
  - b. If  $a^m = e$ , what can we say about the order of  $a$ ?
  - c. Suppose that  $|G| = 24$  and that  $G$  is cyclic. If  $a^8 \neq e$  and  $a^{12} \neq e$ , show that  $\langle a \rangle = G$ .
22. Prove that a group of order 3 must be cyclic.
23. Let  $Z$  denote the group of integers under addition. Is every subgroup of  $Z$  cyclic? Why? Describe all the subgroups of  $Z$ . Let  $a$  be a group element with infinite order. Describe all subgroups of  $\langle a \rangle$ .
24. For any element  $a$  in any group  $G$ , prove that  $\langle a \rangle$  is a subgroup of  $C(a)$  (the centralizer of  $a$ ).
25. If  $d$  is a positive integer,  $d \neq 2$ , and  $d$  divides  $n$ , show that the number of elements of order  $d$  in  $D_n$  is  $\phi(d)$ . How many elements of order 2 does  $D_n$  have?
26. Find all generators of  $Z$ . Let  $a$  be a group element that has infinite order. Find all generators of  $\langle a \rangle$ .
27. Prove that  $C^*$ , the group of nonzero complex numbers under multiplication, has a cyclic subgroup of order  $n$  for every positive integer  $n$ .
28. Let  $a$  be a group element that has infinite order. Prove that  $\langle a^i \rangle = \langle a^j \rangle$  if and only if  $i = \pm j$ .
29. List all the elements of order 8 in  $Z_{8000000}$ . How do you know your list is complete? Let  $a$  be a group element such that  $|a| = 8000000$ . List all elements of order 8 in  $\langle a \rangle$ . How do you know your list is complete?
30. Suppose that  $G$  is a group with more than one element. If the only subgroups of  $G$  are  $\{e\}$  and  $G$ , prove that  $G$  is cyclic and has prime order.
31. Let  $G$  be a finite group. Show that there exists a fixed positive integer  $n$  such that  $a^n = e$  for all  $a$  in  $G$ . (Note that  $n$  is independent of  $a$ .)
32. Determine the subgroup lattice for  $Z_{12}$ . Generalize to  $Z_{p^2q}$ , where  $p$  and  $q$  are distinct primes.
33. Determine the subgroup lattice for  $Z_8$ . Generalize to  $Z_{p^n}$ , where  $p$  is a prime and  $n$  is some positive integer.
34. Prove that a finite group is the union of proper subgroups if and only if the group is not cyclic.

35. Show that the group of positive rational numbers under multiplication is not cyclic. Why does this prove that the group of nonzero rationals under multiplication is not cyclic?
36. Consider the set  $\{4, 8, 12, 16\}$ . Show that this set is a group under multiplication modulo 20 by constructing its Cayley table. What is the identity element? Is the group cyclic? If so, find all of its generators.
37. Give an example of a group that has exactly 6 subgroups (including the trivial subgroup and the group itself). Generalize to exactly  $n$  subgroups for any positive integer  $n$ .
38. Let  $m$  and  $n$  be elements of the group  $Z$ . Find a generator for the group  $\langle m \rangle \cap \langle n \rangle$ .
39. Suppose that  $a$  and  $b$  are group elements that commute. If  $|a|$  is finite and  $|b|$  infinite, prove that  $|ab|$  has infinite order.
40. Suppose that  $a$  and  $b$  belong to a group  $G$ ,  $a$  and  $b$  commute, and  $|a|$  and  $|b|$  are finite. What are the possibilities for  $|ab|$ ?
41. Let  $a$  belong to a group and  $|a| = 100$ . Find  $|a^{98}|$  and  $|a^{70}|$ .
42. Let  $F$  and  $F'$  be distinct reflections in  $D_{21}$ . What are the possibilities for  $|FF'|$ ?
43. Suppose that  $H$  is a subgroup of a group  $G$  and  $|H| = 10$ . If  $a$  belongs to  $G$  and  $a^6$  belongs to  $H$ , what are the possibilities for  $|a|$ ?
44. Which of the following numbers could be the exact number of elements of order 21 in a group: 21600, 21602, 21604?
45. If  $G$  is an infinite group, what can you say about the number of elements of order 8 in the group? Generalize.
46. If  $G$  is a cyclic group of order  $n$ , prove that for every element  $a$  in  $G$ ,  $a^n = e$ .
47. For each positive integer  $n$ , prove that  $C^*$ , the group of nonzero complex numbers under multiplication, has exactly  $\phi(n)$  elements of order  $n$ .
48. Prove or disprove that  $H = \{n \in Z \mid n \text{ is divisible by both 8 and 10}\}$  is a subgroup of  $Z$ . What happens if “divisible by both 8 and 10” is changed to “divisible by 8 or 10”?
49. Suppose that  $G$  is a finite group with the property that every non-identity element has prime order (for example,  $D_3$  and  $D_5$ ). If  $Z(G)$  is not trivial, prove that every nonidentity element of  $G$  has the same order.
50. Prove that an infinite group must have an infinite number of subgroups.
51. Let  $p$  be a prime. If a group has more than  $p - 1$  elements of order  $p$ , why can't the group be cyclic?

52. Suppose that  $G$  is a cyclic group and that 6 divides  $|G|$ . How many elements of order 6 does  $G$  have? If 8 divides  $|G|$ , how many elements of order 8 does  $G$  have? If  $a$  is one element of order 8, list the other elements of order 8.
53. List all the elements of  $Z_{40}$  that have order 10. Let  $|x| = 40$ . List all the elements of  $\langle x \rangle$  that have order 10.
54. Reformulate the corollary of Theorem 4.4 to include the case when the group has infinite order.
55. Determine the orders of the elements of  $D_{33}$  and how many there are of each.
56. When checking to see if  $\langle 2 \rangle = U(25)$  explain why it is sufficient to check that  $2^{10} \neq 1$  and  $2^4 \neq 1$ .
57. If  $G$  is an Abelian group and contains cyclic subgroups of orders 4 and 5, what other sizes of cyclic subgroups must  $G$  contain? Generalize.
58. If  $G$  is an Abelian group and contains cyclic subgroups of orders 4 and 6, what other sizes of cyclic subgroups must  $G$  contain? Generalize.
59. Prove that no group can have exactly two elements of order 2.
60. Given the fact that  $U(49)$  is cyclic and has 42 elements, deduce the number of generators that  $U(49)$  has without actually finding any of the generators.
61. Let  $a$  and  $b$  be elements of a group. If  $|a| = 10$  and  $|b| = 21$ , show that  $\langle a \rangle \cap \langle b \rangle = \{e\}$ .
62. Let  $a$  and  $b$  belong to a group. If  $|a|$  and  $|b|$  are relatively prime, show that  $\langle a \rangle \cap \langle b \rangle = \{e\}$ .
63. Let  $a$  and  $b$  belong to a group. If  $|a| = 24$  and  $|b| = 10$ , what are the possibilities for  $|\langle a \rangle \cap \langle b \rangle|$ ?
64. Prove that  $U(2^n)$  ( $n \geq 3$ ) is not cyclic.
65. Prove that for any prime  $p$  and positive integer  $n$ ,  $\phi(p^n) = p^n - p^{n-1}$ .
66. Prove that  $Z_n$  has an even number of generators if  $n > 2$ . What does this tell you about  $\phi(n)$ ?
67. If  $|a^5| = 12$ , what are the possibilities for  $|a|$ ? If  $|a^4| = 12$ , what are the possibilities for  $|a|$ ?
68. Suppose that  $|x| = n$ . Find a necessary and sufficient condition on  $r$  and  $s$  such that  $\langle x^r \rangle \subseteq \langle x^s \rangle$ .
69. Let  $a$  be a group element such that  $|a| = 48$ . For each part, find a divisor  $k$  of 48 such that
  - a.  $\langle a^{21} \rangle = \langle a^k \rangle$ ;
  - b.  $\langle a^{14} \rangle = \langle a^k \rangle$ ;
  - c.  $\langle a^{18} \rangle = \langle a^k \rangle$ .

70. Prove that  $H = \left\{ \begin{bmatrix} 1 & n \\ 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \mid n \in \mathbb{Z} \right\}$  is a cyclic subgroup of  $GL(2, \mathbb{R})$ .
71. Suppose that  $|a|$  and  $|b|$  are elements of a group and  $a$  and  $b$  commute. If  $|a| = 5$  and  $|b| = 16$ , prove that  $|ab| = 80$ .
72. Let  $a$  and  $b$  belong to a group. If  $|a| = 12$ ,  $|b| = 22$ , and  $\langle a \rangle \cap \langle b \rangle \neq \{e\}$ , prove that  $a^6 = b^{11}$ .
73. Determine  $\phi(81)$ ,  $\phi(60)$  and  $\phi(105)$  where  $\phi$  is the Euler phi function.
74. If  $n$  is an even integer prove that  $\phi(2n) = 2\phi(n)$ .
75. Let  $a$  and  $b$  belong to some group. Suppose that  $|a| = m$ ,  $|b| = n$ , and  $m$  and  $n$  are relatively prime. If  $a^k = b^k$  for some integer  $k$ , prove that  $mn$  divides  $k$ . Give an example to show that the condition that  $m$  and  $n$  are relatively prime is necessary.
76. For every integer  $n$  greater than 2, prove that the group  $U(n^2 - 1)$  is not cyclic.
77. (2008 GRE Practice Exam) If  $x$  is an element of a cyclic group of order 15 and exactly two of  $x^3$ ,  $x^5$ , and  $x^9$  are equal, determine  $|x^{13}|$ .

## Computer Exercises

Computer exercises for this chapter are available at the website:

<http://www.d.umn.edu/~jgallian>

## Suggested Reading

Deborah L. Massari, "The Probability of Generating a Cyclic Group," *Pi Mu Epsilon Journal* 7 (1979): 3–6.

In this easy-to-read paper, it is shown that the probability of a randomly chosen element from a cyclic group being a generator of the group depends only on the set of prime divisors of the order of the group, and not on the order itself. This article, written by an undergraduate student, received first prize in a Pi Mu Epsilon paper contest.

# James Joseph Sylvester

I really love my subject.

J. J. SYLVESTER

JAMES JOSEPH SYLVESTER was the most influential mathematician in America in the 19th century. Sylvester was born on September 3, 1814, in London and showed his mathematical genius early. At the age of 14, he studied under De Morgan and won several prizes for his mathematics, and at the unusually young age of 25, he was elected a fellow of the Royal Society.

After receiving B.A. and M.A. degrees from Trinity College in Dublin in 1841, Sylvester began a professional life that was to include academics, law, and actuarial careers. In 1876, at the age of 62, he was appointed to a prestigious position at the newly founded Johns Hopkins University. During his seven years at Johns Hopkins, Sylvester pursued research in pure mathematics with tremendous vigor and enthusiasm. He also founded the *American Journal of Mathematics*, the first journal in America devoted to mathematical research. Sylvester returned to England in 1884 to a professorship at Oxford, a position he held until his death on March 15, 1897.

Sylvester's major contributions to mathematics were in the theory of equations, matrix theory, determinant theory, and invariant theory (which he founded with Cayley). His writings and lectures—flowery and eloquent, pervaded with poetic flights, emotional expressions, bizarre utterances, and paradoxes—reflected the personality of this sensitive, excitable, and enthusiastic man. We quote three of his students.<sup>†</sup> E. W. Davis commented on Sylvester's teaching methods.



Stock Montage

Sylvester's methods! He had none. "Three lectures will be delivered on a New Universal Algebra," he would say; then, "The course must be extended to twelve." It did last all the rest of that year. The following year the course was to be *Substitutions-Theorie*, by Netto. We all got the text. He lectured about three times, following the text closely and stopping sharp at the end of the hour. Then he began to think about matrices again. "I must give one lecture a week on those," he said. He could not confine himself to the hour, nor to the one lecture a week. Two weeks were passed, and Netto was forgotten entirely and never mentioned again. Statements like the following were not infrequent in his lectures: "I haven't proved this, but I am as sure as I can be of anything that it must be so. From this it will follow, etc." At the next lecture it turned out that what he was so sure of was false. Never mind, he kept on forever guessing and trying, and presently a wonderful discovery followed, then another and another. Afterward he would go back and work it all over again, and surprise us with all sorts of side lights. He then made another leap in the dark, more treasures were discovered, and so on forever.

<sup>†</sup>F. Cajori, *Teaching and History of Mathematics in the United States*, Washington: Government Printing Office, 1890, 265–266.

Sylvester's enthusiasm for teaching and his influence on his students are captured in the following passage written by Sylvester's first student at Johns Hopkins, G. B. Halsted.

A short, broad man of tremendous vitality, . . . Sylvester's capacious head was ever lost in the highest cloud-lands of pure mathematics. Often in the dead of night he would get his favorite pupil, that he might communicate the very last product of his creative thought. Everything he saw suggested to him something new in the higher algebra. This transmutation of everything into new mathematics was a revelation to those who knew him intimately. They began to do it themselves.

Another characteristic of Sylvester, which is very unusual among mathematicians, was his apparent inability to remember mathematics! W. P. Durfee had the following to say.

Sylvester had one remarkable peculiarity. He seldom remembered theorems, propositions, etc., but had always to deduce them when he wished to use them. In this he was the very antithesis of Cayley, who was thoroughly conversant with everything that had been done in every branch of mathematics.

I remember once submitting to Sylvester some investigations that I had been engaged on, and he immediately denied my first statement, saying that such a proposition had never been heard of, let alone proved. To his astonishment, I showed him a paper of his own in which he had proved the proposition; in fact, I believe the object of his paper had been the very proof which was so strange to him.

For more information about Sylvester, visit:

**[http://www-groups.dcs.st-and  
.ac.uk/~history/](http://www-groups.dcs.st-and.ac.uk/~history/)**



# 5

## Permutation Groups

Wigner's discovery about the electron permutation group was just the beginning. He and others found many similar applications and nowadays group theoretical methods—especially those involving characters and representations—pervade all branches of quantum mechanics.

George Mackey, *Proceedings of the American Philosophical Society*

Symmetry has been the scientists' pillar of fire, leading toward relativity and the standard model.

Mario Livio, *The Equation That Could Not Be Solved*

### Definition and Notation

In this chapter, we study certain groups of functions, called permutation groups, from a set  $A$  to itself. In the early and mid-19th century, groups of permutations were the only groups investigated by mathematicians. It was not until around 1850 that the notion of an abstract group was introduced by Cayley, and it took another quarter century before the idea firmly took hold.

#### **Definitions** Permutation of $A$ , Permutation Group of $A$

A *permutation* of a set  $A$  is a function from  $A$  to  $A$  that is both one-to-one and onto. A *permutation group* of a set  $A$  is a set of permutations of  $A$  that forms a group under function composition.

Although groups of permutations of any nonempty set  $A$  of objects exist, we will focus on the case where  $A$  is finite. Furthermore, it is customary, as well as convenient, to take  $A$  to be a set of the form  $\{1, 2, 3, \dots, n\}$  for some positive integer  $n$ . Unlike in calculus, where most functions are defined on infinite sets and are given by formulas, in algebra, permutations of finite sets are usually given by an explicit listing of each element of the domain and its corresponding functional value. For example, we define a permutation  $\alpha$  of the set  $\{1, 2, 3, 4\}$  by specifying

$$\alpha(1) = 2, \quad \alpha(2) = 3, \quad \alpha(3) = 1, \quad \alpha(4) = 4.$$

A more convenient way to express this correspondence is to write  $\alpha$  in array form as

$$\alpha = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 & 4 \\ 2 & 3 & 1 & 4 \end{bmatrix}.$$

Here  $\alpha(j)$  is placed directly below  $j$  for each  $j$ . Similarly, the permutation  $\beta$  of the set  $\{1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6\}$  given by

$$\beta(1) = 5, \quad \beta(2) = 3, \quad \beta(3) = 1, \quad \beta(4) = 6, \quad \beta(5) = 2, \quad \beta(6) = 4$$

is expressed in array form as

$$\beta = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 & 4 & 5 & 6 \\ 5 & 3 & 1 & 6 & 2 & 4 \end{bmatrix}.$$

Composition of permutations expressed in array notation is carried out from right to left by going from top to bottom, then again from top to bottom. For example, let

$$\sigma = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 & 4 & 5 \\ 2 & 4 & 3 & 5 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

and

$$\gamma = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 & 4 & 5 \\ 5 & 4 & 1 & 2 & 3 \end{bmatrix};$$

then

$$\gamma\sigma = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 & 4 & 5 \\ 5 & 4 & 1 & 2 & 3 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 & 4 & 5 \\ 2 & 4 & 3 & 5 & 1 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 & 4 & 5 \\ 4 & 2 & 1 & 3 & 5 \end{bmatrix}$$

On the right we have 4 under 1, since  $(\gamma\sigma)(1) = \gamma(\sigma(1)) = \gamma(2) = 4$ , so  $\gamma\sigma$  sends 1 to 4. The remainder of the bottom row  $\gamma\sigma$  is obtained in a similar fashion.

We are now ready to give some examples of permutation groups.

**EXAMPLE 1 Symmetric Group  $S_3$**  Let  $S_3$  denote the set of all one-to-one functions from  $\{1, 2, 3\}$  to itself. Then  $S_3$ , under function composition, is a group with six elements. The six elements are

$$\varepsilon = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 \\ 1 & 2 & 3 \end{bmatrix}, \quad \alpha = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 \\ 2 & 3 & 1 \end{bmatrix}, \quad \alpha^2 = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 \\ 3 & 1 & 2 \end{bmatrix},$$

$$\beta = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 \\ 1 & 3 & 2 \end{bmatrix}, \quad \alpha\beta = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 \\ 2 & 1 & 3 \end{bmatrix}, \quad \alpha^2\beta = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 \\ 3 & 2 & 1 \end{bmatrix}.$$

Note that  $\beta\alpha = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 \\ 3 & 2 & 1 \end{bmatrix} = \alpha^2\beta \neq \alpha\beta$ , so that  $S_3$  is non-Abelian. ■

The relation  $\beta\alpha = \alpha^2\beta$  can be used to compute other products in  $S_3$  without resorting to the arrays. For example,  $\beta\alpha^2 = (\beta\alpha)\alpha = (\alpha^2\beta)\alpha = \alpha^2(\beta\alpha) = \alpha^2(\alpha^2\beta) = \alpha^4\beta = \alpha\beta$ .

Example 1 can be generalized as follows.

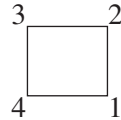
■ **EXAMPLE 2 Symmetric Group  $S_n$**  Let  $A = \{1, 2, \dots, n\}$ . The set of all permutations of  $A$  is called the *symmetric group of degree  $n$*  and is denoted by  $S_n$ . Elements of  $S_n$  have the form

$$\alpha = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 & \dots & n \\ \alpha(1) & \alpha(2) & \dots & \alpha(n) \end{bmatrix}.$$

It is easy to compute the order of  $S_n$ . There are  $n$  choices of  $\alpha(1)$ . Once  $\alpha(1)$  has been determined, there are  $n - 1$  possibilities for  $\alpha(2)$  [since  $\alpha$  is one-to-one, we must have  $\alpha(1) \neq \alpha(2)$ ]. After choosing  $\alpha(2)$ , there are exactly  $n - 2$  possibilities for  $\alpha(3)$ . Continuing along in this fashion, we see that  $S_n$  has  $n(n - 1) \cdots 3 \cdot 2 \cdot 1 = n!$  elements. We leave it to the reader to prove that  $S_n$  is non-Abelian when  $n \geq 3$  (Exercise 43). ■

The symmetric groups are rich in subgroups. The group  $S_4$  has 30 subgroups, and  $S_5$  has well over 100 subgroups.

■ **EXAMPLE 3 Symmetries of a Square** As a third example, we associate each motion in  $D_4$  with the permutation of the locations of each of the four corners of a square. For example, if we label the four corner positions as in the figure below and keep these labels fixed for reference, we may describe a  $90^\circ$  counterclockwise rotation by the permutation



$$\rho = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 & 4 \\ 2 & 3 & 4 & 1 \end{bmatrix},$$

whereas a reflection across a horizontal axis yields

$$\phi = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 & 4 \\ 2 & 1 & 4 & 3 \end{bmatrix}.$$

These two elements generate the entire group (that is, every element is some combination of the  $\rho$ 's and  $\phi$ 's).

When  $D_4$  is represented in this way, we see that it is a subgroup of  $S_4$ . ■

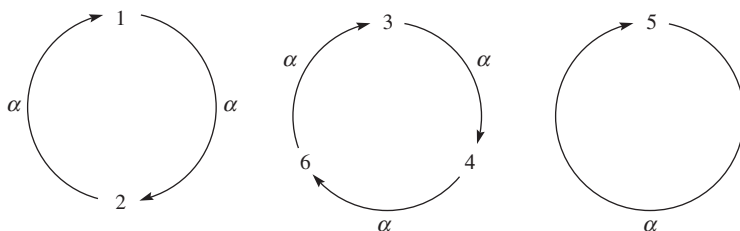
## Cycle Notation

There is another notation commonly used to specify permutations. It is called *cycle notation* and was first introduced by the great French mathematician Cauchy in 1815. Cycle notation has theoretical advantages in that certain important properties of the permutation can be readily determined when cycle notation is used.

As an illustration of cycle notation, let us consider the permutation

$$\alpha = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 & 4 & 5 & 6 \\ 2 & 1 & 4 & 6 & 5 & 3 \end{bmatrix}.$$

This assignment of values could be presented schematically as follows.



Although mathematically satisfactory, such diagrams are cumbersome. Instead, we leave out the arrows and simply write  $\alpha = (1, 2)(3, 4, 6)(5)$ . As a second example, consider

$$\beta = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 & 4 & 5 & 6 \\ 5 & 3 & 1 & 6 & 2 & 4 \end{bmatrix}.$$

In cycle notation,  $\beta$  can be written  $(2, 3, 1, 5)(6, 4)$  or  $(4, 6)(3, 1, 5, 2)$ , since both of these unambiguously specify the function  $\beta$ . An expression of the form  $(a_1, a_2, \dots, a_m)$  is called a *cycle of length  $m$*  or an  *$m$ -cycle*.

A multiplication of cycles can be introduced by thinking of a cycle as a permutation that fixes any symbol not appearing in the

cycle. Thus, the cycle (4, 6) can be thought of as representing the permutation  $\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 & 4 & 5 & 6 \\ 1 & 2 & 3 & 6 & 5 & 4 \end{bmatrix}$ . In this way, we can multiply cycles by thinking of them as permutations given in array form. Consider the following example from  $S_8$ . Let  $\alpha = (13)(27)(456)(8)$  and  $\beta = (1237)(648)(5)$ . (When the domain consists of single-digit integers, it is common practice to omit the commas between the digits.) What is the cycle form of  $\alpha\beta$ ? Of course, one could say that  $\alpha\beta = (13)(27)(456)(8)(1237)(648)(5)$ , but it is usually more desirable to express a permutation in a *disjoint* cycle form (that is, the various cycles have no number in common). Well, keeping in mind that function composition is done from right to left and that each cycle that does not contain a symbol fixes the symbol, we observe that (5) fixes 1; (648) fixes 1; (1237) sends 1 to 2; (8) fixes 2; (456) fixes 2; (27) sends 2 to 7; and (13) fixes 7. So the net effect of  $\alpha\beta$  is to send 1 to 7. Thus, we begin  $\alpha\beta = (17 \cdots) \cdots$ . Now, repeating the entire process beginning with 7, we have, cycle by cycle, right to left,

$$7 \rightarrow 7 \rightarrow 7 \rightarrow 1 \rightarrow 1 \rightarrow 1 \rightarrow 1 \rightarrow 3,$$

so that  $\alpha\beta = (173 \cdots) \cdots$ . Ultimately, we have  $\alpha\beta = (1732)(48)(56)$ . The important thing to bear in mind when multiplying cycles is to “keep moving” from one cycle to the next from right to left. (*Warning:* Some authors compose cycles from left to right. When reading another text, be sure to determine which convention is being used.)

To be sure you understand how to switch from one notation to the other and how to multiply permutations, we will do one more example of each.

If array notations for  $\alpha$  and  $\beta$ , respectively, are

$$\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 & 4 & 5 \\ 2 & 1 & 3 & 5 & 4 \end{bmatrix} \quad \text{and} \quad \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 & 4 & 5 \\ 5 & 4 & 1 & 2 & 3 \end{bmatrix},$$

then, in cycle notation,  $\alpha = (12)(3)(45)$ ,  $\beta = (153)(24)$ , and  $\alpha\beta = (12)(3)(45)(153)(24)$ .

To put  $\alpha\beta$  in disjoint cycle form, observe that (24) fixes 1; (153) sends 1 to 5; (45) sends 5 to 4; and (3) and (12) both fix 4. So,  $\alpha\beta$  sends 1 to 4. Continuing in this way we obtain  $\alpha\beta = (14)(253)$ .

One can convert  $\alpha\beta$  back to array form without converting each cycle of  $\alpha\beta$  into array form by simply observing that (14) means 1 goes to 4 and 4 goes to 1; (253) means  $2 \rightarrow 5$ ,  $5 \rightarrow 3$ ,  $3 \rightarrow 2$ .

One final remark about cycle notation: Mathematicians prefer not to write cycles that have only one entry. In this case, it is understood that any

missing element is mapped to itself. With this convention, the permutation  $\alpha$  above can be written as  $(12)(45)$ . Similarly,

$$\alpha = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 & 4 & 5 \\ 3 & 2 & 4 & 1 & 5 \end{bmatrix}$$

can be written  $\alpha = (134)$ . Of course, the identity permutation consists only of cycles with one entry, so we cannot omit all of these! In this case, one usually writes just one cycle. For example,

$$\varepsilon = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 & 4 & 5 \\ 1 & 2 & 3 & 4 & 5 \end{bmatrix}$$

can be written as  $\varepsilon = (5)$  or  $\varepsilon = (1)$ . Just remember that missing elements are mapped to themselves.

## Properties of Permutations

We are now ready to state several theorems about permutations and cycles. The proof of the first theorem is implicit in our discussion of writing permutations in cycle form.

### ■ Theorem 5.1 Products of Disjoint Cycles

*Every permutation of a finite set can be written as a cycle or as a product of disjoint cycles.*

**PROOF** Let  $\alpha$  be a permutation on  $A = \{1, 2, \dots, n\}$ . To write  $\alpha$  in disjoint cycle form, we start by choosing any member of  $A$ , say  $a_1$ , and let

$$a_2 = \alpha(a_1), \quad a_3 = \alpha(\alpha(a_1)) = \alpha^2(a_1),$$

and so on, until we arrive at  $a_1 = \alpha^m(a_1)$  for some  $m$ . We know that such an  $m$  exists because the sequence  $a_1, \alpha(a_1), \alpha^2(a_1), \dots$  must be finite; so there must eventually be a repetition, say  $\alpha^i(a_1) = \alpha^j(a_1)$  for some  $i$  and  $j$  with  $i < j$ . Then  $a_1 = \alpha^m(a_1)$ , where  $m = j - i$ . We express this relationship among  $a_1, a_2, \dots, a_m$  as

$$\alpha = (a_1, a_2, \dots, a_m) \cdots$$

The three dots at the end indicate the possibility that we may not have exhausted the set  $A$  in this process. In such a case, we merely choose any element  $b_1$  of  $A$  not appearing in the first cycle and proceed to create a new cycle as before. That is, we let  $b_2 = \alpha(b_1)$ ,  $b_3 = \alpha^2(b_1)$ , and so on, until we reach  $b_1 = \alpha^k(b_1)$  for some  $k$ . This new cycle will have no elements in

common with the previously constructed cycle. For, if so, then  $\alpha^i(a_1) = \alpha^j(b_1)$  for some  $i$  and  $j$ . But then  $\alpha^{i-j}(a_1) = b_1$ , and therefore  $b_1 = a_t$  for some  $t$ . This contradicts the way  $b_1$  was chosen. Continuing this process until we run out of elements of  $A$ , our permutation will appear as

$$\alpha = (a_1, a_2, \dots, a_m)(b_1, b_2, \dots, b_k) \cdots (c_1, c_2, \dots, c_s).$$

In this way, we see that every permutation can be written as a product of disjoint cycles. ■

## ■ Theorem 5.2 Disjoint Cycles Commute

*If the pair of cycles  $\alpha = (a_1, a_2, \dots, a_m)$  and  $\beta = (b_1, b_2, \dots, b_n)$  have no entries in common, then  $\alpha\beta = \beta\alpha$ .*

**PROOF** For definiteness, let us say that  $\alpha$  and  $\beta$  are permutations of the set

$$S = \{a_1, a_2, \dots, a_m, b_1, b_2, \dots, b_n, c_1, c_2, \dots, c_k\},$$

where the  $c$ 's are the members of  $S$  left fixed by both  $\alpha$  and  $\beta$  (there may not be any  $c$ 's). To prove that  $\alpha\beta = \beta\alpha$ , we must show that  $(\alpha\beta)(x) = (\beta\alpha)(x)$  for all  $x$  in  $S$ . If  $x$  is one of the  $a$  elements, say  $a_i$ , then

$$(\alpha\beta)(a_i) = \alpha(\beta(a_i)) = \alpha(a_i) = a_{i+1},$$

since  $\beta$  fixes all  $a$  elements. (We interpret  $a_{i+1}$  as  $a_1$  if  $i = m$ .) For the same reason,

$$(\beta\alpha)(a_i) = \beta(\alpha(a_i)) = \beta(a_{i+1}) = a_{i+1}.$$

Hence, the functions of  $\alpha\beta$  and  $\beta\alpha$  agree on the  $a$  elements. A similar argument shows that  $\alpha\beta$  and  $\beta\alpha$  agree on the  $b$  elements as well. Finally, suppose that  $x$  is a  $c$  element, say  $c_i$ . Then, since both  $\alpha$  and  $\beta$  fix  $c$  elements, we have

$$(\alpha\beta)(c_i) = \alpha(\beta(c_i)) = \alpha(c_i) = c_i$$

and

$$(\beta\alpha)(c_i) = \beta(\alpha(c_i)) = \beta(c_i) = c_i.$$

This completes the proof. ■

In demonstrating how to multiply cycles, we showed that the product  $(13)(27)(456)(8)(1237)(648)(5)$  can be written in disjoint cycle form as  $(1732)(48)(56)$ . Is economy in expression the only advantage to writing a permutation in disjoint cycle form? No. The next theorem shows that the disjoint cycle form has the enormous advantage of allowing us to “eyeball” the order of the permutation.

### ■ Theorem 5.3 Order of a Permutation (Ruffini, 1799)

*The order of a permutation of a finite set written in disjoint cycle form is the least common multiple of the lengths of the cycles.*

**PROOF** First, observe that a cycle of length  $n$  has order  $n$ . (Verify this yourself.) Next, suppose that  $\alpha$  and  $\beta$  are disjoint cycles of lengths  $m$  and  $n$ , and let  $k$  be the least common multiple of  $m$  and  $n$ . It follows from Theorem 4.1 that both  $\alpha^k$  and  $\beta^k$  are the identity permutation  $\varepsilon$  and, since  $\alpha$  and  $\beta$  commute,  $(\alpha\beta)^k = \alpha^k\beta^k$  is also the identity. Thus, we know by Corollary 2 to Theorem 4.1 ( $a^k = e$  implies that  $|a|$  divides  $k$ ) that the order of  $\alpha\beta$ —let us call it  $t$ —must divide  $k$ . But then  $(\alpha\beta)^t = \alpha^t\beta^t = \varepsilon$ , so that  $\alpha^t = \beta^{-t}$ . However, it is clear that if  $\alpha$  and  $\beta$  have no common symbol, the same is true for  $\alpha^t$  and  $\beta^{-t}$ , since raising a cycle to a power does not introduce new symbols. But, if  $\alpha^t$  and  $\beta^{-t}$  are equal and have no common symbol, they must both be the identity, because every symbol in  $\alpha^t$  is fixed by  $\beta^{-t}$  and vice versa (remember that a symbol not appearing in a permutation is fixed by the permutation). It follows, then, that both  $m$  and  $n$  must divide  $t$ . This means that  $k$ , the least common multiple of  $m$  and  $n$ , divides  $t$  also. This shows that  $k = t$ .

Thus far, we have proved that the theorem is true in the cases where the permutation is a single cycle or a product of two disjoint cycles. The general case involving more than two cycles can be handled in an analogous way. ■

Theorem 5.3 is an powerful tool for calculating the orders of permutations and the number of permutations of a particular order. We demonstrate this in the next four examples.

#### ■ EXAMPLE 4

$$|(132)(45)| = 6$$

$$|(1432)(56)| = 4$$

$$|(123)(456)(78)| = 6$$

$$|(123)(145)| = |14532| = 5$$

Arranging all possible disjoint cycle structures of elements of  $S_n$  according to the longest cycle lengths listed from left to right provides a systematic way of counting the number of elements in  $S_n$  of any particular order. There are two cases: permutations where the lengths of the disjoint cycles (ignoring 1-cycles) are distinct and permutations where there are at least two disjoint cycles (ignoring 1-cycles) of the same length. The two cases are illustrated in Examples 5, 6, and 7.



■ **EXAMPLE 5** To determine the orders of the  $7! = 5040$  elements of  $S_7$ , we need only consider the possible disjoint cycle structures of the elements of  $S_7$ . For convenience, we denote an  $n$ -cycle by  $(\underline{n})$ . Then, arranging all possible disjoint cycle structures of elements of  $S_7$  according to longest cycle lengths left to right, we have

$(\underline{7})$   
 $(\underline{6})(\underline{1})$   
 $(\underline{5})(\underline{2})$   
 $(\underline{5})(\underline{1})(\underline{1})$   
 $(\underline{4})(\underline{3})$   
 $(\underline{4})(\underline{2})(\underline{1})$   
 $(\underline{4})(\underline{1})(\underline{1})(\underline{1})$   
 $(\underline{3})(\underline{3})(\underline{1})$   
 $(\underline{3})(\underline{2})(\underline{2})$   
 $(\underline{3})(\underline{2})(\underline{1})(\underline{1})$   
 $(\underline{3})(\underline{1})(\underline{1})(\underline{1})(\underline{1})$   
 $(\underline{2})(\underline{2})(\underline{2})(\underline{1})$   
 $(\underline{2})(\underline{2})(\underline{1})(\underline{1})(\underline{1})$   
 $(\underline{2})(\underline{1})(\underline{1})(\underline{1})(\underline{1})(\underline{1})$   
 $(\underline{1})(\underline{1})(\underline{1})(\underline{1})(\underline{1})(\underline{1})(\underline{1})$ .

Now, from Theorem 5.3 we see that the orders of the elements of  $S_7$  are 7, 6, 10, 5, 12, 4, 3, 2, and 1. To do the same for the  $10! = 3628800$  elements of  $S_{10}$  would be nearly as simple. ■

■ **EXAMPLE 6** We determine the number of elements in  $S_7$  of order 12. By Theorems 5.2 and 5.3, we need only count the number of permutations with disjoint cycle form  $(a_1a_2a_3a_4)(a_5a_6a_7)$ . First consider the cycle  $(a_1a_2a_3a_4)$ . Although the number of ways to fill these slots is  $7 \cdot 6 \cdot 5 \cdot 4$ , this product counts the cycle  $(a_1a_2a_3a_4)$  four times. For example, the 4-cycle  $(2741)$  can also be written as  $(7412)$ ,  $(4127)$ ,  $(1274)$  whereas the product  $7 \cdot 6 \cdot 5 \cdot 4$  counts them as distinct. Likewise, the  $3 \cdot 2 \cdot 1$  expressions for  $(a_5a_6a_7)$  counts the cycles  $(a_5a_6a_7)$ ,  $(a_6a_7a_5)$  and  $(a_7a_5a_6)$  as distinct even though they are equal in  $S_7$ . Adjusting for these multiple countings, we have that there are  $(7 \cdot 6 \cdot 5 \cdot 4)(3 \cdot 2 \cdot 1)/(4 \cdot 3) = 420$  elements of order 12 in  $S_7$ . ■

■ **EXAMPLE 7** We determine the number of elements in  $S_7$  of order 3. By Theorem 5.3, we need only count the number of permutations of the form  $(a_1a_2a_3)$  and  $(a_1a_2a_3)(a_4a_5a_6)$ . As in Example 6, there are  $(7 \cdot 6 \cdot 5)/3 = 70$  elements of the form  $(a_1a_2a_3)$ . For elements of  $S_7$  of the form  $(a_1a_2a_3)(a_4a_5a_6)$  there are  $(7 \cdot 6 \cdot 5)/3$  ways to create the first cycle and  $(4 \cdot 3 \cdot 2)/3$  to create the second cycle but the product of  $(7 \cdot 6 \cdot 5)/3$  and  $(4 \cdot$

$3 \cdot 2)/3$ ) counts  $(a_1a_2a_3)$   $(a_4a_5a_6)$  and  $(a_4a_5a_6)(a_3a_2a_1)$  as distinct when they are equal group elements. Thus, the number of elements in  $S_7$  of the form  $(a_1a_2a_3)(a_4a_5a_6)$  is  $(7 \cdot 6 \cdot 5)(4 \cdot 3 \cdot 2)/(3 \cdot 3 \cdot 2) = 280$ . This gives us 350 elements of order 3 in  $S_7$ .

To count the number of elements in  $S_7$  of the form say  $(a_1a_2)(a_3a_4)(a_5a_6)$ , we proceed as before to obtain  $(7 \cdot 6)(5 \cdot 4)(3 \cdot 2)/(2 \cdot 2 \cdot 2 \cdot 3!) = 105$ . The  $3!$  term in the denominator appears because there are  $3!$  ways the product of three 2-cycles can be written and each represents the same group element. ■

As we will soon see, it is often greatly advantageous to write a permutation as a product of cycles of length 2—that is, as permutations of the form  $(ab)$  where  $a \neq b$ . Many authors call these permutations *transpositions*, since the effect of  $(ab)$  is to interchange or transpose  $a$  and  $b$ .

Example 8 and Theorem 5.4 show how this can always be done.

### ■ EXAMPLE 8

$$\begin{aligned}(12345) &= (15)(14)(13)(12) \\ (1632)(457) &= (12)(13)(16)(47)(45)\end{aligned}$$

■

### ■ Theorem 5.4 Product of 2-Cycles

*Every permutation in  $S_n$ ,  $n > 1$ , is a product of 2-cycles.*

**PROOF** First, note that the identity can be expressed as  $(12)(12)$ , and so it is a product of 2-cycles. By Theorem 5.1, we know that every permutation can be written in the form

$$(a_1a_2 \cdots a_k)(b_1b_2 \cdots b_t) \cdots (c_1c_2 \cdots c_s).$$

A direct computation shows that this is the same as

$$\begin{aligned}(a_1a_k)(a_1a_{k-1}) \cdots (a_1a_2)(b_1b_t)(b_1b_{t-1}) \cdots (b_1b_2) \\ \cdots (c_1c_s)(c_1c_{s-1}) \cdots (c_1c_2).\end{aligned}$$

This completes the proof. ■

The decomposition of a permutation into a product of 2-cycles given in Example 8 and in the proof of Theorem 5.4 is not the only way a permutation can be written as a product of 2-cycles. Although the next example shows that even the *number* of 2-cycles may vary from one decomposition to another, we will prove in Theorem 5.5 (first proved by Cauchy) that there is one aspect of a decomposition that never varies.

■ **EXAMPLE 9**

$$\begin{aligned}(12345) &= (54)(53)(52)(51) \\ (12345) &= (54)(52)(21)(25)(23)(13)\end{aligned}$$

We isolate a special case of Theorem 5.5 as a lemma.

■ **Lemma**

*If  $\varepsilon = \beta_1\beta_2 \cdots \beta_r$ , where the  $\beta$ 's are 2-cycles, then  $r$  is even.*

**PROOF** Clearly,  $r \neq 1$ , since a 2-cycle is not the identity. If  $r = 2$ , we are done. So, we suppose that  $r > 2$ , and we proceed by induction. Suppose that the rightmost 2-cycle is  $(ab)$ . Then, since  $(ij) = (ji)$ , the product  $\beta_{r-1}\beta_r$  can be expressed in one of the following forms shown on the right:

$$\begin{aligned}\varepsilon &= (ab)(ab), \\ (ab)(bc) &= (ac)(ab), \\ (ac)(cb) &= (bc)(ab), \\ (ab)(cd) &= (cd)(ab).\end{aligned}$$

If the first case occurs, we may delete  $\beta_{r-1}\beta_r$  from the original product to obtain  $\varepsilon = \beta_1\beta_2 \cdots \beta_{r-2}$ , and therefore, by the Second Principle of Mathematical Induction,  $r - 2$  is even. In the other three cases, we replace the form of  $\beta_{r-1}\beta_r$  on the right by its counterpart on the left to obtain a new product of  $r$  2-cycles that is still the identity, but where the rightmost occurrence of the integer  $a$  is in the second-from-the-rightmost 2-cycle of the product instead of the rightmost 2-cycle. We now repeat the procedure just described with  $\beta_{r-2}\beta_{r-1}$ , and, as before, we obtain a product of  $(r - 2)$  2-cycles equal to the identity or a new product of  $r$  2-cycles, where the rightmost occurrence of  $a$  is in the third 2-cycle from the right. Continuing this process, we must obtain a product of  $(r - 2)$  2-cycles equal to the identity, because otherwise we have a product equal to the identity in which the only occurrence of the integer  $a$  is in the leftmost 2-cycle, and such a product does not fix  $a$ , whereas the identity does. Hence, by the Second Principle of Mathematical Induction,  $r - 2$  is even, and  $r$  is even as well. ■

■ **Theorem 5.5** Always Even or Always Odd

*If a permutation  $\alpha$  can be expressed as a product of an even (odd) number of 2-cycles, then every decomposition of  $\alpha$  into a product of 2-cycles must have an even (odd) number of 2-cycles. In symbols, if*

$$\alpha = \beta_1\beta_2 \cdots \beta_r \quad \text{and} \quad \alpha = \gamma_1\gamma_2 \cdots \gamma_s,$$

*where the  $\beta$ 's and the  $\gamma$ 's are 2-cycles, then  $r$  and  $s$  are both even or both odd.*

**PROOF** Observe that  $\beta_1\beta_2 \cdots \beta_r = \gamma_1\gamma_2 \cdots \gamma_s$  implies

$$\begin{aligned}\varepsilon &= \gamma_1\gamma_2 \cdots \gamma_s\beta_r^{-1} \cdots \beta_2^{-1}\beta_1^{-1} \\ &= \gamma_1\gamma_2 \cdots \gamma_s\beta_r \cdots \beta_2\beta_1,\end{aligned}$$

since a 2-cycle is its own inverse. Thus, the lemma on page 103 guarantees that  $s + r$  is even. It follows that  $r$  and  $s$  are both even or both odd. ■

### Definition Even and Odd Permutations

A permutation that can be expressed as a product of an even number of 2-cycles is called an *even* permutation. A permutation that can be expressed as a product of an odd number of 2-cycles is called an *odd* permutation.

Theorems 5.4 and 5.5 together show that every permutation can be unambiguously classified as either even or odd. The significance of this observation is given in Theorem 5.6.

## ■ Theorem 5.6 Even Permutations Form a Group

*The set of even permutations in  $S_n$  forms a subgroup of  $S_n$ .*

**PROOF** This proof is left to the reader (Exercise 17). ■

The subgroup of even permutations in  $S_n$  arises so often that we give it a special name and notation.

### Definition Alternating Group of Degree $n$

The group of even permutations of  $n$  symbols is denoted by  $A_n$  and is called the *alternating group of degree  $n$* .

The next result shows that exactly half of the elements of  $S_n$  ( $n > 1$ ) are even permutations.

## ■ Theorem 5.7

*For  $n > 1$ ,  $A_n$  has order  $n!/2$ .*

**PROOF** For each odd permutation  $\alpha$ , the permutation  $(12)\alpha$  is even and, by the cancellation property in groups,  $(12)\alpha \neq (12)\beta$  when  $\alpha \neq \beta$ . Thus, there are at least as many even permutations as there are odd ones. On the other hand, for each even permutation  $\alpha$ , the permutation  $(12)\alpha$  is odd and  $(12)\alpha \neq (12)\beta$  when  $\alpha \neq \beta$ . Thus, there are at least as many odd permutations as there are even ones. It follows that there are

equal numbers of even and odd permutations. Since  $|S_n| = n!$ , we have  $|A_n| = n!/2$ . ■

The names for the symmetric group and the alternating group of degree  $n$  come from the study of polynomials over  $n$  variables. A *symmetric* polynomial in the variables  $x_1, x_2, \dots, x_n$  is one that is unchanged under any transposition of two of the variables. An *alternating* polynomial is one that changes signs under any transposition of two of the variables. For example, the polynomial  $x_1x_2x_3$  is unchanged by any transposition of two of the three variables, whereas the polynomial  $(x_1 - x_2)(x_1 - x_3)(x_2 - x_3)$  changes signs when any two of the variables are transposed. Since every member of the symmetric group is the product of transpositions, the symmetric polynomials are those that are unchanged by members of the symmetric group. Likewise, since any member of the alternating group is the product of an even number of transpositions, the alternating polynomials are those that are unchanged by members of the alternating group.

The alternating groups are among the most important examples of groups. The groups  $A_4$  and  $A_5$  will arise on several occasions in later chapters. In particular,  $A_5$  has great historical significance.

A geometric interpretation of  $A_4$  is given in Example 10, and a multiplication table for  $A_4$  is given as Table 5.1.

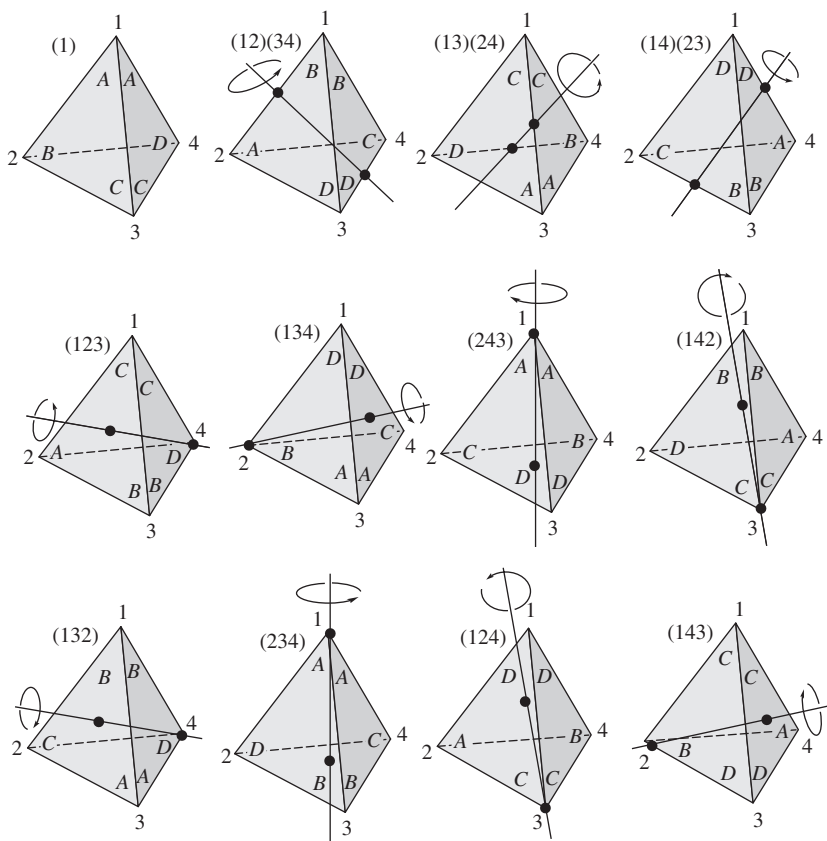
### ■ EXAMPLE 10 Rotations of a Tetrahedron

The 12 rotations of a regular tetrahedron can be conveniently described with the elements of  $A_4$ . The top row of Figure 5.1 illustrates the identity and three  $180^\circ$  “edge” rotations about axes joining midpoints of two

**Table 5.1** The Alternating Group  $A_4$  of Even Permutations of  $\{1, 2, 3, 4\}$

(In this table, the permutations of  $A_4$  are designated as  $\alpha_1, \alpha_2, \dots, \alpha_{12}$  and an entry  $k$  inside the table represents  $\alpha_k$ . For example,  $\alpha_3 \alpha_8 = \alpha_6$ .)

|                       | $\alpha_1$ | $\alpha_2$ | $\alpha_3$ | $\alpha_4$ | $\alpha_5$ | $\alpha_6$ | $\alpha_7$ | $\alpha_8$ | $\alpha_9$ | $\alpha_{10}$ | $\alpha_{11}$ | $\alpha_{12}$ |
|-----------------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|---------------|---------------|---------------|
| $(1) = \alpha_1$      | 1          | 2          | 3          | 4          | 5          | 6          | 7          | 8          | 9          | 10            | 11            | 12            |
| $(12)(34) = \alpha_2$ | 2          | 1          | 4          | 3          | 6          | 5          | 8          | 7          | 10         | 9             | 12            | 11            |
| $(13)(24) = \alpha_3$ | 3          | 4          | 1          | 2          | 7          | 8          | 5          | 6          | 11         | 12            | 9             | 10            |
| $(14)(23) = \alpha_4$ | 4          | 3          | 2          | 1          | 8          | 7          | 6          | 5          | 12         | 11            | 10            | 9             |
| $(123) = \alpha_5$    | 5          | 8          | 6          | 7          | 9          | 12         | 10         | 11         | 1          | 4             | 2             | 3             |
| $(243) = \alpha_6$    | 6          | 7          | 5          | 8          | 10         | 11         | 9          | 12         | 2          | 3             | 1             | 4             |
| $(142) = \alpha_7$    | 7          | 6          | 8          | 5          | 11         | 10         | 12         | 9          | 3          | 2             | 4             | 1             |
| $(134) = \alpha_8$    | 8          | 5          | 7          | 6          | 12         | 9          | 11         | 10         | 4          | 1             | 3             | 2             |
| $(132) = \alpha_9$    | 9          | 11         | 12         | 10         | 1          | 3          | 4          | 2          | 5          | 7             | 8             | 6             |
| $(143) = \alpha_{10}$ | 10         | 12         | 11         | 9          | 2          | 4          | 3          | 1          | 6          | 8             | 7             | 5             |
| $(234) = \alpha_{11}$ | 11         | 9          | 10         | 12         | 3          | 1          | 2          | 4          | 7          | 5             | 6             | 8             |
| $(124) = \alpha_{12}$ | 12         | 10         | 9          | 11         | 4          | 2          | 1          | 3          | 8          | 6             | 5             | 7             |



**Figure 5.1** Rotations of a regular tetrahedron.

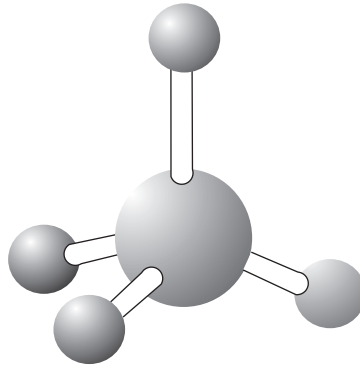
edges. The second row consists of  $120^\circ$  “face” rotations about axes joining a vertex to the center of the opposite face. The third row consists of  $-120^\circ$  (or  $240^\circ$ ) “face” rotations. Notice that the four rotations in the second row can be obtained from those in the first row by left-multiplying the four in the first row by the rotation  $(123)$ , whereas those in the third row can be obtained from those in the first row by left-multiplying the ones in the first row by  $(132)$ . ■

Many molecules with chemical formulas of the form  $AB_4$ , such as methane ( $\text{CH}_4$ ) and carbon tetrachloride ( $\text{CCl}_4$ ), have  $A_4$  as their symmetry group. Figure 5.2 shows the form of one such molecule.

Many games and puzzles can be analyzed using permutations.

### ■ EXAMPLE 11 Encryption Using a Permutation

An interesting application of permutations is cryptography. Cryptography is the study of methods to make and break secret codes. The process of



**Figure 5.2** A tetrahedral  $AB_4$  molecule.

coding information to prevent unauthorized use is called encryption. Historically, encryption was used primarily for military and diplomatic transmissions. Today, encryption is essential for securing electronic transactions of all kinds. Cryptography is what allows you to have a Web site safely receive your credit card number. Cryptographic schemes prevent hackers from charging calls to your cell phone account.

Among the first known cryptosystems is the Caesar cipher, used by Julius Caesar to send messages to his troops. Caesar encrypted a message by replacing each letter with the letter three positions further in the alphabet with x, y and z wrapping around to a, b and c. Identifying the 26 letters of the alphabet with 0, 1, ..., 25 in order, the Caesar method replaces letter  $i$  with letter  $(i + 3) \bmod 26$ . For example, the message ATTACK AT DAWN is encrypted as DWWDFN DW GDZQ. To decrypt the message one replaces letter  $i$  with letter  $(i - 3) \bmod 26$ .

Any permutation can be used as a cipher. To use the permutation  $\alpha = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 & 4 \\ 3 & 4 & 2 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$  to encrypt the message ATTACK AT DAWN we first break the message up into blocks of four letters each ignoring the spaces between the words to obtain the plaintext ATTA CKAT DAWN. (This has the added advantage of disguising the lengths of each word, which makes breaking the code more difficult.) We then reorder the four letters in each block in the same way  $\alpha$  reordered the integers 1, 2, 3, and 4. That is, the first letter is put in the third position, the second letter is put in the fourth position, the third letter is put in the second position, and the fourth letter is put in the first position. Doing this for each block we have ATAT TACK NWDA. Of course one decrypts a message encrypted by using  $\alpha$  by using  $\alpha^{-1}$ .

To enhance security one would use a permutation of long length  $n$  and blocks of length other than  $n$  so that anyone not authorized to receive

the encrypted message would not know the permutation length. In cases where the number of message characters is not divisible by the block length the sender simply fills out the last block with nonsense letters. For example, for the message RETREAT AT DUSK with block length 4 we could use RETR EATA TDUS KIUE. The recipient of the message will recognize the nonsense letters as padding needed to complete the last block.

Enigma machines were cipher devices used by the Germans in World War II (1939–1945). An Enigma machine had three to five wheels that would scramble the letters of a message. The machines were easy to use and offered a high degree of security when used properly. Although messages encoded with Enigma machines were difficult to break operator negligence and the capture of a number of Enigma machines and the tables of wheel settings by the Allied forces allowed Polish and British cryptologists to break the code. ■

■ Rubik's Cube

The Rubik's Cube made from 48 cubes called "facets" is the quintessential example of a group theory puzzle. It was invented in 1974 by the Hungarian Ernő Rubik. By 2009 more than 350 million Rubik's Cubes had been sold. The current record time for solving it is under 7 seconds; under 31 seconds blindfolded. Although it was proved in 1995 that there was a starting configuration that required at least 20 moves to solve, it was not until 2010 that it was determined that every cube could be solved in at most 20 moves. This computer calculation utilized about 35 CPU-years donated by Google to complete. In early discussions about the minimum number of moves to solve the cube in the worst possible case, someone called it "God's number," and the name stuck. A history of the quest to find God's number is given at the website at <http://www.cube20.org/>.

The set of all configuration of the Rubik's Cube form a group of permutations of order 43,252,003,274,489,856,00. This order can be computed using GAP by labeling the faces of the cube as shown here.

|    |      |    |    |        |    |    |       |    |    |      |    |
|----|------|----|----|--------|----|----|-------|----|----|------|----|
|    |      |    | 1  | 2      | 3  |    |       |    |    |      |    |
|    |      |    | 4  | top    | 5  |    |       |    |    |      |    |
|    |      |    | 6  | 7      | 8  |    |       |    |    |      |    |
| 9  | 10   | 11 | 17 | 18     | 19 | 25 | 26    | 27 | 33 | 34   | 35 |
| 12 | left | 13 | 20 | front  | 21 | 28 | right | 29 | 36 | rear | 37 |
| 14 | 15   | 16 | 22 | 23     | 24 | 30 | 31    | 32 | 38 | 39   | 40 |
|    |      |    | 41 | 42     | 43 |    |       |    |    |      |    |
|    |      |    | 44 | bottom | 45 |    |       |    |    |      |    |
|    |      |    | 46 | 47     | 48 |    |       |    |    |      |    |



The group of permutations of the cube is generated by the following rotations of the six layers.

top = (1,3,8,6)(2,5,7,4)(9,33,25,17)(10,34,26,18)(11,35,27,19)  
 left = (9,11,16,14)(10,13,15,12)(1,17,41,40)(4,20,44,37)(6,22,46,35)  
 front = (17,19,24,22)(18,21,23,20)(6,25,43,16)(7,28,42,13)(8,30,41,11)  
 right = (25,27,32,30)(26,29,31,28)(3,38,43,19)(5,36,45,21)(8,33,48,24)  
 rear = (33,35,40,38)(34,37,39,36)(3,9,46,32)(2,12,47,29)(1,14,48,27)  
 bottom = (41,43,48,46)(42,45,47,44)(14,22,30,38)(15,23,31,39)  
 (16,24,32,40)

## A Check-Digit Scheme Based on $D_5$

In Chapter 0, we presented several schemes for appending a check digit to an identification number. Among these schemes, only the International Standard Book Number method was capable of detecting all single-digit errors and all transposition errors involving adjacent digits. However, recall that this success was achieved by introducing the alphabetical character X to handle the case where 10 was required to make the dot product 0 modulo 11.

In contrast, in 1969, J. Verhoeff [2] devised a method utilizing the dihedral group of order 10 that detects all single-digit errors and all transposition errors involving adjacent digits without the necessity of avoiding certain numbers or introducing a new character. To describe this method, consider the permutation  $\sigma = (01589427)(36)$  and the dihedral group of order 10 as represented in Table 5.2. (Here we use 0 through 4 for the rotations, 5 through 9 for the reflections, and \* for the operation of  $D_5$ .)

**Table 5.2** Multiplication for  $D_5$

| * | 0 | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 | 6 | 7 | 8 | 9 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 0 | 0 | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 | 6 | 7 | 8 | 9 |
| 1 | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 0 | 6 | 7 | 8 | 9 | 5 |
| 2 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 0 | 1 | 7 | 8 | 9 | 5 | 6 |
| 3 | 3 | 4 | 0 | 1 | 2 | 8 | 9 | 5 | 6 | 7 |
| 4 | 4 | 0 | 1 | 2 | 3 | 9 | 5 | 6 | 7 | 8 |
| 5 | 5 | 9 | 8 | 7 | 6 | 0 | 4 | 3 | 2 | 1 |
| 6 | 6 | 5 | 9 | 8 | 7 | 1 | 0 | 4 | 3 | 2 |
| 7 | 7 | 6 | 5 | 9 | 8 | 2 | 1 | 0 | 4 | 3 |
| 8 | 8 | 7 | 6 | 5 | 9 | 3 | 2 | 1 | 0 | 4 |
| 9 | 9 | 8 | 7 | 6 | 5 | 4 | 3 | 2 | 1 | 0 |

Verhoeff's idea was to view the digits 0 through 9 as the elements of the group  $D_5$  and to replace ordinary addition with calculations done in  $D_5$ . In particular, to any string of digits  $a_1a_2 \dots a_{n-1}$ , we append the check digit  $a_n$  so that  $\sigma(a_1) * \sigma^2(a_2) * \dots * \sigma^{n-2}(a_{n-2}) * \sigma^{n-1}(a_{n-1}) * \sigma^n(a_n) = 0$ . [Here  $\sigma^2(x) = \sigma(\sigma(x))$ ,  $\sigma^3(x) = \sigma(\sigma^2(x))$ , and so on.] Since  $\sigma$  has the property that  $\sigma^i(a) \neq \sigma^i(b)$  if  $a \neq b$ , all single-digit errors are detected. Also, because

$$a * \sigma(b) \neq b * \sigma(a) \quad \text{if } a \neq b, \tag{1}$$

as can be checked on a case-by-case basis (see Exercise 59), it follows that all transposition errors involving adjacent digits are detected [since Equation (1) implies that  $\sigma^i(a) * \sigma^{i+1}(b) \neq \sigma^i(b) * \sigma^{i+1}(a)$  if  $a \neq b$ ].

From 1990 until 2002, the German government used a minor modification of Verhoeff's check-digit scheme to append a check digit to the serial numbers on German banknotes. Table 5.3 gives the values of the functions  $\sigma, \sigma^2, \dots, \sigma^{10}$  needed for the computations. [The functional value  $\sigma^i(j)$  appears in the row labeled with  $\sigma^i$  and the column labeled  $j$ .] Since the serial numbers on the banknotes use 10 letters of the alphabet in addition to the 10 decimal digits, it is necessary to assign numerical values to the letters to compute the check digit. This assignment is shown in Table 5.4.

**Table 5.3** Powers of  $\sigma$

|               | 0 | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 | 6 | 7 | 8 | 9 |
|---------------|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| $\sigma$      | 1 | 5 | 7 | 6 | 2 | 8 | 3 | 0 | 9 | 4 |
| $\sigma^2$    | 5 | 8 | 0 | 3 | 7 | 9 | 6 | 1 | 4 | 2 |
| $\sigma^3$    | 8 | 9 | 1 | 6 | 0 | 4 | 3 | 5 | 2 | 7 |
| $\sigma^4$    | 9 | 4 | 5 | 3 | 1 | 2 | 6 | 8 | 7 | 0 |
| $\sigma^5$    | 4 | 2 | 8 | 6 | 5 | 7 | 3 | 9 | 0 | 1 |
| $\sigma^6$    | 2 | 7 | 9 | 3 | 8 | 0 | 6 | 4 | 1 | 5 |
| $\sigma^7$    | 7 | 0 | 4 | 6 | 9 | 1 | 3 | 2 | 5 | 8 |
| $\sigma^8$    | 0 | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 | 6 | 7 | 8 | 9 |
| $\sigma^9$    | 1 | 5 | 7 | 6 | 2 | 8 | 3 | 0 | 9 | 4 |
| $\sigma^{10}$ | 5 | 8 | 0 | 3 | 7 | 9 | 6 | 1 | 4 | 2 |

**Table 5.4** Letter Values

| A | D | G | K | L | N | S | U | Y | Z |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 0 | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 | 6 | 7 | 8 | 9 |

To any string of digits  $a_1 a_2 \dots a_{10}$  corresponding to a banknote serial number, the check digit  $a_{11}$  is chosen such that  $\sigma(a_1) * \sigma^2(a_2) * \dots * \sigma^9(a_9) * \sigma^{10}(a_{10}) * a_{11} = 0$  [instead of  $\sigma(a_1) * \sigma^2(a_2) * \dots * \sigma^{10}(a_{10}) * \sigma^{11}(a_{11}) = 0$  as in the Verhoeff scheme].

To trace through a specific example, consider the banknote (featuring the mathematician Gauss) shown in Figure 5.3 with the number AG8536827U7. To verify that 7 is the appropriate check digit, we observe that  $\sigma(0) * \sigma^2(2) * \sigma^3(8) * \sigma^4(5) * \sigma^5(3) * \sigma^6(6) * \sigma^7(8) * \sigma^8(2) * \sigma^9(7) * \sigma^{10}(7) * 7 = 1 * 0 * 2 * 2 * 6 * 6 * 5 * 2 * 0 * 1 * 7 = 0$ , as it should be. [To illustrate how to use the multiplication table for  $D_5$ , we compute  $1 * 0 * 2 * 2 = (1 * 0) * 2 * 2 = 1 * 2 * 2 = (1 * 2) * 2 = 3 * 2 = 0$ .]



**Figure 5.3** German banknote with serial number AG8536827U and check digit 7.

One shortcoming of the German banknote scheme is that it does not distinguish between a letter and its assigned numerical value. Thus, a substitution of 7 for U (or vice versa) and the transposition of 7 and U are not detected by the check digit. Moreover, the banknote scheme does not detect all transpositions of adjacent characters involving the check digit itself. For example, the transposition of D and 8 in positions 10 and 11 is not detected. Both of these defects can be avoided by using the Verhoeff method with  $D_{18}$ , the dihedral group of order 36, to assign every letter and digit a distinct value together with an appropriate function  $\sigma$  [1]. Using this method to append a check character, all single-position errors and all transposition errors involving adjacent digits will be detected.

## Exercises

My mind rebels at stagnation. Give me problems, give me work, give me the most obtuse cryptogram, or the most intricate analysis, and I am in my own proper atmosphere.

Sherlock Holmes, *The Sign of Four*

1. Let

$$\alpha = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 & 4 & 5 & 6 \\ 2 & 1 & 3 & 5 & 4 & 6 \end{bmatrix} \quad \text{and} \quad \beta = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 & 4 & 5 & 6 \\ 6 & 1 & 2 & 4 & 3 & 5 \end{bmatrix}.$$

Compute each of the following.

- a.  $\alpha^{-1}$
- b.  $\beta\alpha$
- c.  $\alpha\beta$

2. Let

$$\alpha = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 & 4 & 5 & 6 & 7 & 8 \\ 2 & 3 & 4 & 5 & 1 & 7 & 8 & 6 \end{bmatrix} \quad \text{and} \quad \beta = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 & 4 & 5 & 6 & 7 & 8 \\ 1 & 3 & 8 & 7 & 6 & 5 & 2 & 4 \end{bmatrix}.$$

Write  $\alpha$ ,  $\beta$ , and  $\alpha\beta$  as

- a. products of disjoint cycles;
  - b. products of 2-cycles.
3. Write each of the following permutations as a product of disjoint cycles.
- a.  $(1235)(413)$
  - b.  $(13256)(23)(46512)$
  - c.  $(12)(13)(23)(142)$
4. Find the order of each of the following permutations.
- a.  $(14)$
  - b.  $(147)$
  - c.  $(14762)$
  - d.  $(a_1 a_2 \cdots a_k)$
5. What is the order of each of the following permutations?
- a.  $(124)(357)$
  - b.  $(124)(3567)$
  - c.  $(124)(35)$
  - d.  $(124)(357869)$
  - e.  $(1235)(24567)$
  - f.  $(345)(245)$

6. What is the order of each of the following permutations?
  - a.  $\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 & 4 & 5 & 6 \\ 2 & 1 & 5 & 4 & 6 & 3 \end{bmatrix}$
  - b.  $\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 & 4 & 5 & 6 & 7 \\ 7 & 6 & 1 & 2 & 3 & 4 & 5 \end{bmatrix}$
7. What is the order of the product of a pair of disjoint cycles of lengths 4 and 6?
8. Determine whether the following permutations are even or odd.
  - a. (135)
  - b. (1356)
  - c. (13567)
  - d. (12)(134)(152)
  - e. (1243)(3521)
9. What are the possible orders for the elements of  $S_6$  and  $A_6$ ? What about  $A_7$ ? (This exercise is referred to in Chapter 25.)
10. Show that  $A_8$  contains an element of order 15.
11. Find an element in  $A_{12}$  of order 30.
12. Show that a function from a finite set  $S$  to itself is one-to-one if and only if it is onto. Is this true when  $S$  is infinite? (This exercise is referred to in Chapter 6.)
13. Suppose that  $\alpha$  is a mapping from a set  $S$  to itself and  $\alpha(\alpha(x)) = x$  for all  $x$  in  $S$ . Prove that  $\alpha$  is one-to-one and onto.
14. Suppose that  $\alpha$  is a 6-cycle and  $\beta$  is a 5-cycle. Determine whether  $\alpha^5\beta^4\alpha^{-1}\beta^{-3}\alpha^5$  is even or odd. Show your reasoning.
15. Let  $n$  be a positive integer. If  $n$  is odd, is an  $n$ -cycle an odd or an even permutation? If  $n$  is even, is an  $n$ -cycle an odd or an even permutation?
16. If  $\alpha$  is even, prove that  $\alpha^{-1}$  is even. If  $\alpha$  is odd, prove that  $\alpha^{-1}$  is odd.
17. Prove Theorem 5.6.
18. In  $S_n$ , let  $\alpha$  be an  $r$ -cycle,  $\beta$  an  $s$ -cycle, and  $\gamma$  a  $t$ -cycle. Complete the following statements:  $\alpha\beta$  is even if and only if  $r + s$  is  $\dots$ ;  $\alpha\beta\gamma$  is even if and only if  $r + s + t$  is  $\dots$ .
19. Let  $\alpha$  and  $\beta$  belong to  $S_n$ . Prove that  $\alpha\beta$  is even if and only if  $\alpha$  and  $\beta$  are both even or both odd.
20. Associate an even permutation with the number  $+1$  and an odd permutation with the number  $-1$ . Draw an analogy between the result of multiplying two permutations and the result of multiplying their corresponding numbers  $+1$  or  $-1$ .

21. Complete the following statement: A product of disjoint cycles is even if and only if \_\_\_\_\_.
22. What cycle is  $(a_1 a_2 \cdots a_n)^{-1}$ ?
23. Show that if  $H$  is a subgroup of  $S_n$ , then either every member of  $H$  is an even permutation or exactly half of the members are even. (This exercise is referred to in Chapter 25.)
24. Suppose that  $H$  is a subgroup of  $S_n$  of odd order. Prove that  $H$  is a subgroup of  $A_n$ .
25. Give two reasons why the set of odd permutations in  $S_n$  is not a subgroup.
26. Let  $\alpha$  and  $\beta$  belong to  $S_n$ . Prove that  $\alpha^{-1}\beta^{-1}\alpha\beta$  is an even permutation.
27. How many elements are there of order 2 in  $A_8$  that have the disjoint cycle form  $(a_1 a_2)(a_3 a_4)(a_5 a_6)(a_7 a_8)$ ?
28. How many elements of order 5 are in  $S_7$ ?
29. How many elements of order 4 does  $S_6$  have? How many elements of order 2 does  $S_6$  have?
30. Prove that  $(1234)$  is not the product of 3-cycles. Generalize.
31. Let  $\beta \in S_7$  and suppose  $\beta^4 = (2143567)$ . Find  $\beta$ . What are the possibilities for  $\beta$  if  $\beta \in S_9$ ?
32. Let  $\beta = (123)(145)$ . Write  $\beta^{99}$  in disjoint cycle form.
33. Let  $(a_1 a_2 a_3 a_4)$  and  $(a_5 a_6)$  be disjoint cycles in  $S_{10}$ . Show that there is no element  $x$  in  $S_{10}$  such that  $x^2 = (a_1 a_2 a_3 a_4)(a_5 a_6)$ .
34. If  $\alpha$  and  $\beta$  are distinct 2-cycles, what are the possibilities for  $|\alpha\beta|$ ?
35. Let  $G$  be a group of permutations on a set  $X$ . Let  $a \in X$  and define  $\text{stab}(a) = \{\alpha \in G \mid \alpha(a) = a\}$ . We call  $\text{stab}(a)$  the *stabilizer of  $a$  in  $G$*  (since it consists of all members of  $G$  that leave  $a$  fixed). Prove that  $\text{stab}(a)$  is a subgroup of  $G$ . (This subgroup was introduced by Galois in 1832.) This exercise is referred to in Chapter 7.
36. Let  $\beta = (1,3,5,7,9,8,6)(2,4,10)$ . What is the smallest positive integer  $n$  for which  $\beta^n = \beta^{-5}$ ?
37. Let  $\alpha = (1,3,5,7,9)(2,4,6)(8,10)$ . If  $\alpha^m$  is a 5-cycle, what can you say about  $m$ ?
38. Let  $H = \{\beta \in S_5 \mid \beta(1) = 1 \text{ and } \beta(3) = 3\}$ . Prove that  $H$  is a subgroup of  $S_5$ . How many elements are in  $H$ ? Is your argument valid when  $S_5$  is replaced by  $S_n$  for  $n \geq 3$ ? How many elements are in  $H$  when  $S_5$  is replaced by  $A_n$  for  $n \geq 4$ ?
39. In  $S_4$ , find a cyclic subgroup of order 4 and a noncyclic subgroup of order 4.
40. In  $S_3$ , find elements  $\alpha$  and  $\beta$  such that  $|\alpha| = 2$ ,  $|\beta| = 2$ , and  $|\alpha\beta| = 3$ .

41. Find group elements  $\alpha$  and  $\beta$  in  $S_5$  such that  $|\alpha| = 3$ ,  $|\beta| = 3$ , and  $|\alpha\beta| = 5$ .
42. Represent the symmetry group of an equilateral triangle as a group of permutations of its vertices (see Example 3).
43. Prove that  $S_n$  is non-Abelian for all  $n \geq 3$ .
44. Prove that  $A_n$  is non-Abelian for all  $n \geq 4$ .
45. For  $n \geq 3$ , let  $H = \{\beta \in S_n \mid \beta(1) = 1 \text{ or } 2 \text{ and } \beta(2) = 1 \text{ or } 2\}$ . Prove that  $H$  is a subgroup of  $S_n$ . Determine  $|H|$ .
46. Show that in  $S_7$ , the equation  $x^2 = (1234)$  has no solutions but the equation  $x^3 = (1234)$  has at least two.
47. If  $(ab)$  and  $(cd)$  are distinct 2-cycles in  $S_n$ , prove that  $(ab)$  and  $(cd)$  commute if and only if they are disjoint.
48. Let  $\alpha$  and  $\beta$  belong to  $S_n$ . Prove that  $\beta\alpha\beta^{-1}$  and  $\alpha$  are both even or both odd.
49. Viewing the members of  $D_4$  as a group of permutations of a square labeled 1, 2, 3, 4 as described in Example 3, which geometric symmetries correspond to even permutations?
50. Viewing the members of  $D_5$  as a group of permutations of a regular pentagon with consecutive vertices labeled 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, what geometric symmetry corresponds to the permutation (14253)? Which symmetry corresponds to the permutation (25)(34)?
51. Let  $n$  be an odd integer greater than 1. Viewing  $D_n$  as a group of permutations of a regular  $n$ -gon with consecutive vertices labeled 1, 2,  $\dots$ ,  $n$ , explain why the rotation subgroup of  $D_n$  is a subgroup of  $A_n$ .
52. Let  $\alpha_1, \alpha_2$  and  $\alpha_3$  be 2-cycles. Prove that  $\alpha_1\alpha_2\alpha_3 \neq \epsilon$ . Generalize.
53. Show that  $A_5$  has 24 elements of order 5, 20 elements of order 3, and 15 elements of order 2. (This exercise is referred to in Chapter 25.)
54. Find a cyclic subgroup of  $A_8$  that has order 4. Find a noncyclic subgroup of  $A_8$  that has order 4.
55. Show that a permutation with odd order must be an even permutation.
56. Compute the order of each member of  $A_4$ . What arithmetic relationship do these orders have with the order of  $A_4$ ?
57. Show that every element in  $A_n$  for  $n \geq 3$  can be expressed as a 3-cycle or a product of 3-cycles.
58. Show that for  $n \geq 3$ ,  $Z(S_n) = \{\epsilon\}$ .
59. Verify the statement made in the discussion of the Verhoeff check digit scheme based on  $D_5$  that  $a * \sigma(b) \neq b * \sigma(a)$  for distinct  $a$  and  $b$ . Use this to prove that  $\sigma^i(a) * \sigma^{i+1}(b) \neq \sigma^i(b) * \sigma^{i+1}(a)$  for all  $i$ . Prove that this implies that all transposition errors involving adjacent digits are detected.

60. Use the Verhoeff check-digit scheme based on  $D_5$  to append a check digit to 45723.
61. Prove that every element of  $S_n$  ( $n > 1$ ) can be written as a product of elements of the form  $(1k)$ .
62. (Indiana College Mathematics Competition) A card-shuffling machine always rearranges cards in the same way relative to the order in which they were given to it. All of the hearts arranged in order from ace to king were put into the machine, and then the shuffled cards were put into the machine again to be shuffled. If the cards emerged in the order 10, 9, Q, 8, K, 3, 4, A, 5, J, 6, 2, 7, in what order were the cards after the first shuffle?
63. Determine integers  $n$  for which  $H = \{\alpha \in A_n \mid \alpha^2 = \varepsilon\}$  is a subgroup of  $A_n$ .
64. Find five subgroups of  $S_5$  of order 24.
65. Why does the fact that the orders of the elements of  $A_4$  are 1, 2, and 3 imply that  $|Z(A_4)| = 1$ ?
66. Let  $\alpha$  belong to  $S_n$ . Prove that  $|\alpha|$  divides  $n!$
67. Encrypt the message ATTACK POSTPONED using the permutation  $\alpha = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 & 4 & 5 \\ 2 & 1 & 5 & 3 & 4 \end{bmatrix}$ .
68. The message VAADENWCNHRDEYA was encrypted using the permutation  $\alpha = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 & 4 \\ 2 & 4 & 1 & 3 \end{bmatrix}$ . Decrypt it.

## Computer Exercises

Computer exercises for this chapter are available at the website:

<http://www.d.umn.edu/~jgallian>

## References

1. J. A. Gallian, "The Mathematics of Identification Numbers," *The College Mathematics Journal* 22 (1991): 194–202.
2. J. Verhoeff, *Error Detecting Decimal Codes*, Amsterdam: Mathematisch Centrum, 1969.



## Suggested Readings

Douglas E. Ensley, “Invariants Under Actions to Amaze Your Friends,” *Mathematics Magazine*, Dec. 1999: 383–387.

This article explains some card tricks that are based on permutation groups.

J. A. Gallian, “Error Detection Methods,” *ACM Computing Surveys* 28 (1996): 504–517.

This article gives a comprehensive survey of error-detection methods that use check digits. This article can be downloaded at <http://www.d.umn.edu/~jgallian/detection.pdf>

I. N. Herstein and I. Kaplansky, *Matters Mathematical*, New York: Chelsea, 1978.

Chapter 3 of this book discusses several interesting applications of permutations to games.

Douglas Hofstadter, “The Magic Cube’s Cubies Are Twiddled by Cubists and Solved by Cubemeisters,” *Scientific American* 244 (1981): 20–39.

This article, written by a Pulitzer Prize recipient, discusses the group theory involved in the solution of the Magic (Rubik’s) Cube. In particular, permutation groups, subgroups, conjugates (elements of the form  $xyx^{-1}$ ), commutators (elements of the form  $xyx^{-1}y^{-1}$ ), and the “always even or always odd” theorem (Theorem 5.5) are prominently mentioned. At one point, Hofstadter says, “It is this kind of marvelously concrete illustration of an abstract notion of group theory that makes the Magic Cube one of the most amazing things ever invented for teaching mathematical ideas.”

## Augustin Cauchy

You see that little young man? Well! He will supplant all of us in so far as we are mathematicians.

*Spoken by Lagrange  
to Laplace about the  
11-year-old Cauchy*



Stock Montage

AUGUSTIN LOUIS CAUCHY was born on August 21, 1789, in Paris. By the time he was 11, both Laplace and Lagrange had recognized Cauchy's extraordinary talent for mathematics. In school he won prizes for Greek, Latin, and the humanities. At the age of 21, he was given a commission in Napoleon's army as a civil engineer. For the next few years, Cauchy attended to his engineering duties while carrying out brilliant mathematical research on the side.

In 1815, at the age of 26, Cauchy was made Professor of Mathematics at the École Polytechnique and was recognized as the leading mathematician in France. Cauchy and his contemporary Gauss were among the last mathematicians to know the whole of mathematics as known at their time, and

both made important contributions to nearly every branch, both pure and applied, as well as to physics and astronomy.

Cauchy introduced a new level of rigor into mathematical analysis. We owe our contemporary notions of limit and continuity to him. He gave the first proof of the Fundamental Theorem of Calculus. Cauchy was the founder of complex function theory and a pioneer in the theory of permutation groups and determinants. His total written output of mathematics fills 24 large volumes. He wrote more than 500 research papers after the age of 50. Cauchy died at the age of 67 on May 23, 1857.

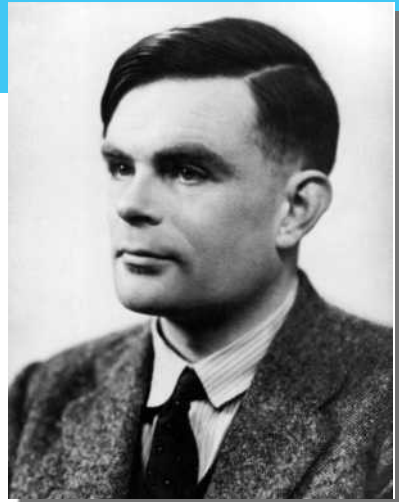
For more information about Cauchy, visit:

**[http://www-groups.dcs.st-and  
.ac.uk/~history/](http://www-groups.dcs.st-and.ac.uk/~history/)**

# Alan Turing

Every time you use a phone, or a computer, you use the ideas that Alan Turing invented. Alan discovered intelligence in computers, and today he surrounds us. A true hero of mankind.

ERIC E. SCHMIDT, *Executive Chairman, Google*



Pictures From History/The Image Works

On Time magazine's list of the 100 most influential people of the twentieth century was Alan Turing, a mathematician born in London on June 23, 1912. While a college student Turing developed ideas that would lay the foundation for theoretical computer science and artificial intelligence. After graduating from college Turing became a crucial member of a team of cryptologists working for the British government who successfully broke the Enigma codes.

Turing's life took a tragic turn in 1952 when he admitted that he had engaged in homosexual acts in his home, which was a felony in Britain at that time. As punishment, he was chemically castrated and subjected to estrogen treatments. Despondent by this treatment, he committed suicide two years later by eating an apple laced with cyanide at the age of 41.

Today Turing is widely honored for his fundamental contributions to computer science and his role in the defeat of Germany in World War II. Many rooms, lecture halls, and buildings at universities around the world have been named in honor of Turing. The annual award for contributions to the computing community, which is widely considered to be the equivalent to a Nobel Prize, is called the "Turing Award."

In 2013, Queen Elizabeth II granted Turing a pardon and issued a statement saying Turing's treatment was unjust and "Turing was an exceptional man with a brilliant mind who deserves to be remembered and recognized for his fantastic contribution to the war effort and his legacy to science."

# 6 Isomorphisms

Mathematics is the art of giving the same name to different things.

Henri Poincaré (1854–1912)

The basis for poetry and scientific discovery is the ability to comprehend the unlike in the like and the like in the unlike.

Jacob Bronowski

## Motivation

Suppose an American and a German are asked to count a handful of objects. The American says, “One, two, three, four, five, . . .,” whereas the German says, “Eins, zwei, drei, vier, fünf, . . .” Are the two doing different things? No. They are both counting the objects, but they are using different terminology to do so. Similarly, when one person says, “Two plus three is five” and another says, “Zwei und drei ist fünf,” the two are in agreement on the *concept* they are describing, but they are using different terminology to describe the concept. An analogous situation often occurs with groups; the same group is described with different terminology. We have seen two examples of this so far. In Chapter 1, we described the symmetries of a square in geometric terms (e.g.,  $R_{90}$ ), whereas in Chapter 5 we described the *same* group by way of permutations of the corners. In both cases, the underlying group was the symmetries of a square. In Chapter 4, we observed that when we have a cyclic group of order  $n$  generated by  $a$ , the operation turns out to be essentially that of addition modulo  $n$ , since  $a^r a^s = a^k$ , where  $k = (r + s) \bmod n$ . For example, each of  $U(43)$  and  $U(49)$  is cyclic of order 42. So, each has the form  $\langle a \rangle$ , where  $a^r a^s = a^{(r+s) \bmod 42}$ .

## Definition and Examples

In this chapter, we give a formal method for determining whether two groups defined in different terms are really the same. When this is the case, we say that there is an isomorphism between the two groups. This notion was first introduced by Galois about 180 years ago. The term *isomorphism* is derived from the Greek words **isos**, meaning “same” or “equal,” and

*morphe*, meaning “form.” R. Allenby has colorfully defined an algebraist as “a person who can’t tell the difference between isomorphic systems.”

**Definition Group Isomorphism**

An *isomorphism*  $\phi$  from a group  $G$  to a group  $\bar{G}$  is a one-to-one mapping (or function) from  $G$  onto  $\bar{G}$  that preserves the group operation. That is,

$$\phi(ab) = \phi(a)\phi(b) \quad \text{for all } a, b \text{ in } G.$$

If there is an isomorphism from  $G$  onto  $\bar{G}$ , we say that  $G$  and  $\bar{G}$  are *isomorphic* and write  $G \approx \bar{G}$ .

The definition of isomorphism ensures that if  $\phi$  is an isomorphism from  $G$  to  $\bar{G}$  then the operation table for  $\bar{G}$  can be obtained from the operation table for  $G$  by replacing each entry in the table for  $G$  by  $\phi(x)$ . See Figure 6.1. Thus the groups differ in notation only.

|           |   |   |   |            |   |   |
|-----------|---|---|---|------------|---|---|
| $G$       | — | — | — | $b$        | — | — |
| —         | — | — | — | —          | — | — |
| —         | — | — | — | —          | — | — |
| $a$       | — | — | — | $ab$       | — | — |
| —         | — | — | — | —          | — | — |
| $\bar{G}$ | — | — | — | $\phi(b)$  | — | — |
| —         | — | — | — | —          | — | — |
| —         | — | — | — | —          | — | — |
| $\phi(a)$ | — | — | — | $\phi(ab)$ | — | — |
| —         | — | — | — | —          | — | — |

Figure 6.1

It is implicit in the definition of isomorphism that isomorphic groups have the same order. It is also implicit in the definition of isomorphism that the operation on the left side of the equal sign is that of  $G$ , whereas the operation on the right side is that of  $\bar{G}$ . The four cases involving  $\cdot$  and  $+$  are shown in Table 6.1.

Table 6.1

| $G$ Operation | $\bar{G}$ Operation | Operation Preservation                    |
|---------------|---------------------|-------------------------------------------|
| $\cdot$       | $\cdot$             | $\phi(a \cdot b) = \phi(a) \cdot \phi(b)$ |
| $\cdot$       | $+$                 | $\phi(a \cdot b) = \phi(a) + \phi(b)$     |
| $+$           | $\cdot$             | $\phi(a + b) = \phi(a) \cdot \phi(b)$     |
| $+$           | $+$                 | $\phi(a + b) = \phi(a) + \phi(b)$         |

There are four separate steps involved in proving that a group  $G$  is isomorphic to a group  $\bar{G}$ .

**Step 1** “Mapping.” Define a candidate for the isomorphism; that is, define a function  $\phi$  from  $G$  to  $\bar{G}$ .

**Step 2** “1–1.” Prove that  $\phi$  is one-to-one; that is, assume that  $\phi(a) = \phi(b)$  and prove that  $a = b$ .

**Step 3** “Onto.” Prove that  $\phi$  is onto; that is, for any element  $\bar{g}$  in  $\bar{G}$ , find an element  $g$  in  $G$  such that  $\phi(g) = \bar{g}$ .

**Step 4** “O.P.” Prove that  $\phi$  is operation-preserving; that is, show that  $\phi(ab) = \phi(a)\phi(b)$  for all  $a$  and  $b$  in  $G$ .

None of these steps is unfamiliar to you. The only one that may appear novel is the fourth one. It requires that one be able to obtain the same result by combining two elements and then mapping, or by mapping two elements and then combining them. Roughly speaking, this says that the two processes—operating and mapping—can be done in either order without affecting the result. This same concept arises in calculus when we say

$$\lim_{x \rightarrow a} (f(x) \cdot g(x)) = \lim_{x \rightarrow a} f(x) \lim_{x \rightarrow a} g(x)$$

or

$$\int_a^b (f + g) dx = \int_a^b f dx + \int_a^b g dx.$$

In linear algebra an invertible linear transformation from a vector space  $V$  to a vector space  $W$  is a group isomorphism from  $V$  to  $W$ . (Every vector space is an Abelian group under vector addition).

Before going any further, let's consider some examples.

■ **EXAMPLE 1** Let  $G$  be the real numbers under addition and let  $\bar{G}$  be the positive real numbers under multiplication. Then  $G$  and  $\bar{G}$  are isomorphic under the mapping  $\phi(x) = 2^x$ . Certainly,  $\phi$  is a function from  $G$  to  $\bar{G}$ . To prove that it is one-to-one, suppose that  $2^x = 2^y$ . Then  $\log_2 2^x = \log_2 2^y$ , and therefore  $x = y$ . For “onto,” we must find for any positive real number  $y$  some real number  $x$  such that  $\phi(x) = y$ ; that is,  $2^x = y$ . Well, solving for  $x$  gives  $\log_2 y$ . Finally,

$$\phi(x + y) = 2^{x+y} = 2^x \cdot 2^y = \phi(x)\phi(y)$$

for all  $x$  and  $y$  in  $G$ , so that  $\phi$  is operation-preserving as well. ■

■ **EXAMPLE 2** Any infinite cyclic group is isomorphic to  $\mathbb{Z}$ . Indeed, if  $a$  is a generator of the cyclic group, the mapping  $a^k \rightarrow k$  is an isomorphism. Any finite cyclic group  $\langle a \rangle$  of order  $n$  is isomorphic to  $\mathbb{Z}_n$  under the mapping  $a^k \rightarrow k \bmod n$ . That these correspondences are functions and are one-to-one is the essence of Theorem 4.1. Obviously, the mappings are onto. That the mappings are operation-preserving follows from Exercise 9 in Chapter 0 in the finite case and from the definitions in the infinite case. ■

■ **EXAMPLE 3** The mapping from  $\mathbf{R}$  under addition to itself given by  $\phi(x) = x^3$  is *not* an isomorphism. Although  $\phi$  is one-to-one and onto, it is not operation-preserving, since it is not true that  $(x + y)^3 = x^3 + y^3$  for all  $x$  and  $y$ . ■

■ **EXAMPLE 4**  $U(10) \approx Z_4$  and  $U(5) \approx Z_4$ . To verify this, one need only observe that both  $U(10)$  and  $U(5)$  are cyclic of order 4. Then appeal to Example 2. ■

■ **EXAMPLE 5** There is no isomorphism from  $Q$ , the group of rational numbers under addition, to  $Q^*$ , the group of nonzero rational numbers under multiplication. If  $\phi$  were such a mapping, there would be a rational number  $a$  such that  $\phi(a) = -1$ . But then

$$-1 = \phi(a) = \phi(\tfrac{1}{2}a + \tfrac{1}{2}a) = \phi(\tfrac{1}{2}a)\phi(\tfrac{1}{2}a) = [\phi(\tfrac{1}{2}a)]^2.$$

However, no rational number squared is  $-1$ . ■

■ **EXAMPLE 6** Let  $G = SL(2, \mathbf{R})$ , the group of  $2 \times 2$  real matrices with determinant 1. Let  $M$  be any  $2 \times 2$  real matrix with determinant 1. Then we can define a mapping from  $G$  to  $G$  itself by  $\phi_M(A) = MAM^{-1}$  for all  $A$  in  $G$ . To verify that  $\phi_M$  is an isomorphism, we carry out the four steps.

**Step 1**  $\phi_M$  is a function from  $G$  to  $G$ . Here, we must show that  $\phi_M(A)$  is indeed an element of  $G$  whenever  $A$  is. This follows from properties of determinants:

$$\det(MAM^{-1}) = (\det M)(\det A)(\det M)^{-1} = 1 \cdot 1 \cdot 1^{-1} = 1.$$

Thus,  $MAM^{-1}$  is in  $G$ .

**Step 2**  $\phi_M$  is one-to-one. Suppose that  $\phi_M(A) = \phi_M(B)$ . Then  $MAM^{-1} = MBM^{-1}$  and, by left and right cancellation,  $A = B$ .

**Step 3**  $\phi_M$  is onto. Let  $B$  belong to  $G$ . We must find a matrix  $A$  in  $G$  such that  $\phi_M(A) = B$ . How shall we do this? If such a matrix  $A$  is to exist, it must have the property that  $MAM^{-1} = B$ . But this tells us exactly what  $A$  must be! For we can solve for  $A$  to obtain  $A = M^{-1}BM$  and verify that  $\phi_M(A) = MAM^{-1} = M(M^{-1}BM)M^{-1} = B$ .

**Step 4**  $\phi_M$  is operation-preserving. Let  $A$  and  $B$  belong to  $G$ . Then,

$$\begin{aligned}\phi_M(AB) &= M(AB)M^{-1} = MA(M^{-1}B)M^{-1} \\ &= (MAM^{-1})(MBM^{-1}) = \phi_M(A)\phi_M(B).\end{aligned}$$

The mapping  $\phi_M$  is called *conjugation* by  $M$ . ■

## Cayley's Theorem

Our first theorem is a classic result of Cayley. An important generalization of it will be given in Chapter 25.

### ■ Theorem 6.1 Cayley's Theorem (1854)

*Every group is isomorphic to a group of permutations.*

**PROOF** To prove this, let  $G$  be any group. We must find a group  $\overline{G}$  of permutations that we believe is isomorphic to  $G$ . Since  $G$  is all we have to work with, we will have to use it to construct  $\overline{G}$ . For any  $g$  in  $G$ , define a function  $T_g$  from  $G$  to  $G$  by

$$T_g(x) = gx \quad \text{for all } x \text{ in } G.$$

(In words,  $T_g$  is just multiplication by  $g$  on the left.) We leave it as an exercise (Exercise 35) to prove that  $T_g$  is a permutation on the set of elements of  $G$ . Now, let  $\overline{G} = \{T_g \mid g \in G\}$ . Then,  $\overline{G}$  is a group under the operation of function composition. To verify this, we first observe that for any  $g$  and  $h$  in  $G$  we have  $T_g T_h(x) = T_g(T_h(x)) = T_g(hx) = g(hx) = (gh)x = T_{gh}(x)$ , so that  $T_g T_h = T_{gh}$ . From this it follows that  $T_e$  is the identity and  $(T_g)^{-1} = T_{g^{-1}}$  (see Exercise 9). Since function composition is associative, we have verified all the conditions for  $\overline{G}$  to be a group.

The isomorphism  $\phi$  between  $G$  and  $\overline{G}$  is now ready-made. For every  $g$  in  $G$ , define  $\phi(g) = T_g$ . If  $T_g = T_h$ , then  $T_g(e) = T_h(e)$  or  $ge = he$ . Thus,  $g = h$  and  $\phi$  is one-to-one. By the way  $\overline{G}$  was constructed, we see that  $\phi$  is onto. The only condition that remains to be checked is that  $\phi$  is operation-preserving. To this end, let  $a$  and  $b$  belong to  $G$ . Then

$$\phi(ab) = T_{ab} = T_a T_b = \phi(a)\phi(b). \quad \blacksquare$$

The group  $\overline{G}$  constructed previously is called the *left regular representation* of  $G$ .

■ **EXAMPLE 7** For concreteness, let us calculate the left regular representation  $\overline{U(12)}$  for  $U(12) = \{1, 5, 7, 11\}$ . Writing the permutations of  $U(12)$  in array form, we have (remember,  $T_x$  is just multiplication by  $x$ )

$$\begin{aligned} T_1 &= \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 5 & 7 & 11 \\ 1 & 5 & 7 & 11 \end{bmatrix}, & T_5 &= \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 5 & 7 & 11 \\ 5 & 1 & 11 & 7 \end{bmatrix}, \\ T_7 &= \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 5 & 7 & 11 \\ 7 & 11 & 1 & 5 \end{bmatrix}, & T_{11} &= \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 5 & 7 & 11 \\ 11 & 7 & 5 & 1 \end{bmatrix}. \end{aligned}$$



It is instructive to compare the Cayley tables for  $U(12)$  and its left regular representation  $\overline{U(12)}$ .

| $U(12)$ | 1  | 5  | 7  | 11 | $\overline{U(12)}$ | $T_1$    | $T_5$    | $T_7$    | $T_{11}$ |
|---------|----|----|----|----|--------------------|----------|----------|----------|----------|
| 1       | 1  | 5  | 7  | 11 | $T_1$              | $T_1$    | $T_5$    | $T_7$    | $T_{11}$ |
| 5       | 5  | 1  | 11 | 7  | $T_5$              | $T_5$    | $T_1$    | $T_{11}$ | $T_7$    |
| 7       | 7  | 11 | 1  | 5  | $T_7$              | $T_7$    | $T_{11}$ | $T_1$    | $T_5$    |
| 11      | 11 | 7  | 5  | 1  | $T_{11}$           | $T_{11}$ | $T_7$    | $T_5$    | $T_1$    |

It should be abundantly clear from these tables that  $U(12)$  and  $\overline{U(12)}$  are only notationally different. ■

■ **EXAMPLE 8** Writing the left regular representations for the permutations  $T_{R_{270}}$  and  $T_H$  from  $D_4$  in disjoint cycle form we have (see the Cayley table in Chapter 1)

$$\begin{aligned} T_{R_{270}} &= (R_0 R_{270})(R_{90} R_0)(HD)(VD') \\ T_H &= (R_0 H)(R_{90} D)(R_{180} V)(R_{270} D') \end{aligned}$$

Cayley's Theorem is important for two contrasting reasons. One is that it allows us to represent an abstract group in a concrete way. A second is that it shows that the present-day set of axioms we have adopted for a group is the correct abstraction of its much earlier predecessor—a group of permutations. Indeed, Cayley's Theorem tells us that abstract groups are not different from permutation groups. Rather, it is the viewpoint that is different. It is this difference of viewpoint that has stimulated the tremendous progress in group theory and many other branches of mathematics in the past 100 years.

It is sometimes very difficult to prove or disprove, whichever the case may be, that two particular groups are isomorphic. For example, it requires somewhat sophisticated techniques to prove the surprising fact that the group of real numbers under addition is isomorphic to the group of complex numbers under addition. Likewise, it is not easy to prove the fact that the group of nonzero complex numbers under multiplication is isomorphic to the group of complex numbers with absolute value of 1 under multiplication. In geometric terms, this says that, as groups, the punctured plane and the unit circle are isomorphic [1]. ■

## Properties of Isomorphisms

Our next two theorems give a catalog of properties of isomorphisms and isomorphic groups.

## ■ Theorem 6.2 Properties of Isomorphisms Acting on Elements

*Suppose that  $\phi$  is an isomorphism from a group  $G$  onto a group  $\overline{G}$ . Then*

1.  $\phi$  carries the identity of  $G$  to the identity of  $\overline{G}$ .
2. For every integer  $n$  and for every group element  $a$  in  $G$ ,  $\phi(a^n) = [\phi(a)]^n$ .
3. For any elements  $a$  and  $b$  in  $G$ ,  $a$  and  $b$  commute if and only if  $\phi(a)$  and  $\phi(b)$  commute.
4.  $G = \langle a \rangle$  if and only if  $\overline{G} = \langle \phi(a) \rangle$ .
5.  $|a| = |\phi(a)|$  for all  $a$  in  $G$  (isomorphisms preserve orders).
6. For a fixed integer  $k$  and a fixed group element  $b$  in  $G$ , the equation  $x^k = b$  has the same number of solutions in  $G$  as does the equation  $x^k = \phi(b)$  in  $\overline{G}$ .
7. If  $G$  is finite, then  $G$  and  $\overline{G}$  have exactly the same number of elements of every order.

**PROOF** We will restrict ourselves to proving only properties 1, 2, and 4, but observe that property 5 follows from properties 1 and 2, property 6 follows from property 2, and property 7 follows from property 5. For convenience, let us denote the identity in  $G$  by  $e$  and the identity in  $\overline{G}$  by  $\bar{e}$ . Then, since  $e = ee$ , we have

$$\phi(e) = \phi(ee) = \phi(e)\phi(e).$$

Also, because  $\phi(e) \in \overline{G}$ , we have  $\phi(e) = \bar{e}\phi(e)$ , as well. Thus, by cancellation,  $\bar{e} = \phi(e)$ . This proves property 1.

For positive integers, property 2 follows from the definition of an isomorphism and mathematical induction. If  $n$  is negative, then  $-n$  is positive, and we have from property 1 and the observation about the positive integer case that  $e = \phi(e) = \phi(g^n g^{-n}) = \phi(g^n)\phi(g^{-n}) = \phi(g^n)(\phi(g))^{-n}$ . Thus, multiplying both sides on the right by  $(\phi(g))^n$ , we have  $(\phi(g))^n = \phi(g^n)$ . Property 1 takes care of the case  $n = 0$ .

To prove property 4, let  $G = \langle a \rangle$  and note that, by closure,  $\langle \phi(a) \rangle \subseteq \overline{G}$ . Because  $\phi$  is onto, for any element  $b$  in  $\overline{G}$ , there is an element  $a^k$  in  $G$  such that  $\phi(a^k) = b$ . Thus,  $b = (\phi(a))^k$  and so  $b \in \langle \phi(a) \rangle$ . This proves that  $\overline{G} = \langle \phi(a) \rangle$ .

Now suppose that  $\overline{G} = \langle \phi(a) \rangle$ . Clearly,  $\langle a \rangle \subseteq G$ . For any element  $b$  in  $G$ , we have  $\phi(b) \in \langle \phi(a) \rangle$ . So, for some integer  $k$  we have  $\phi(b) = (\phi(a))^k = \phi(a^k)$ . Because  $\phi$  is one-to-one,  $b = a^k$ . This proves that  $\langle a \rangle = G$ . ■

When the group operation is addition, property 2 of Theorem 6.2 is  $\phi(na) = n\phi(a)$ ; property 4 says that an isomorphism between two cyclic groups takes a generator to a generator.

### ■ Theorem 6.3 Properties of Isomorphisms Acting on Groups

*Suppose that  $\phi$  is an isomorphism from a group  $G$  onto a group  $\bar{G}$ . Then*

1.  $\phi^{-1}$  is an isomorphism from  $\bar{G}$  onto  $G$ .
2.  $G$  is Abelian if and only if  $\bar{G}$  is Abelian.
3.  $G$  is cyclic if and only if  $\bar{G}$  is cyclic.
4. If  $K$  is a subgroup of  $G$ , then  $\phi(K) = \{\phi(k) \mid k \in K\}$  is a subgroup of  $\bar{G}$ .
5. If  $\bar{K}$  is a subgroup of  $\bar{G}$ , then  $\phi^{-1}(\bar{K}) = \{g \in G \mid \phi(g) \in \bar{K}\}$  is a subgroup of  $G$ .
6.  $\phi(Z(G)) = Z(\bar{G})$ .

**PROOF** Properties 1 and 4 are left as exercises (Exercises 33 and 34). Properties 2 and 6 are a direct consequence of property 3 of Theorem 6.2. Property 3 follows from property 4 of Theorem 6.2 and property 1 of Theorem 6.3. Property 5 follows from properties 1 and 4. ■

Theorems 6.2 and 6.3 provide several convenient ways to prove that groups  $G$  and  $\bar{G}$  are not isomorphic.

1. Observe that  $|G| \neq |\bar{G}|$ .
2. Observe that  $G$  or  $\bar{G}$  is cyclic and the other is not.
3. Observe that  $G$  or  $\bar{G}$  is Abelian and the other is not.
4. Show that largest order of any element in  $G$  is not the same as the largest order of any element in  $\bar{G}$ .
5. Show that the number of elements of some specific order in  $G$  (the smallest order greater than 1 is often the good choice) is not the same as the number of elements of that order in  $\bar{G}$ .

■ **EXAMPLE 9** Consider these three groups of order 12:  $Z_{12}$ ,  $D_6$  and  $A_4$ . A quick check shows that the largest order of any element in the three are 12, 6 and 3, respectively. So no two are isomorphic. Alternatively, the number of elements of order 2 in each is 1, 7, and 3. ■

■ **EXAMPLE 10** The group  $Q$  of rational numbers under addition is not isomorphic to the group  $Q^*$  of nonzero rational numbers under multiplication because every non-identity element of  $Q$  has infinite order (because  $nx = 0$  if and only if  $n = 0$ ) or  $x = 0$  whereas in  $Q^*$ ,  $|-1| = 2$ . ■

Theorems 6.2 and 6.3 show that isomorphic groups have many properties in common. Actually, the definition is precisely formulated so that isomorphic groups have *all* group theoretic properties in common.

By this we mean that if two groups are isomorphic, then any property that can be expressed in the language of group theory is true for one if and only if it is true for the other. This is why algebraists speak of isomorphic groups as “equal” or “the same.” Admittedly, calling such groups equivalent, rather than the same, might be more appropriate, but we bow to long-standing tradition.

## Automorphisms

Certain kinds of isomorphisms are referred to so often that they have been given special names.

### Definition Automorphism

An isomorphism from a group  $G$  onto itself is called an *automorphism* of  $G$ .

The isomorphism in Example 6 is an automorphism of  $SL(2, \mathbf{R})$ . Two more examples follow.

■ **EXAMPLE 11** The function  $\phi$  from  $\mathbf{C}$  to  $\mathbf{C}$  given by  $\phi(a + bi) = a - bi$  is an automorphism of the group of complex numbers under addition. The restriction of  $\phi$  to  $\mathbf{C}^*$  is also an automorphism of the group of nonzero complex numbers under multiplication. (See Exercise 37.) ■

■ **EXAMPLE 12** Let  $\mathbf{R}^2 = \{(a, b) \mid a, b \in \mathbf{R}\}$ . Then  $\phi(a, b) = (b, a)$  is an automorphism of the group  $\mathbf{R}^2$  under componentwise addition. Geometrically,  $\phi$  reflects each point in the plane across the line  $y = x$ . More generally, any reflection across a line passing through the origin or any rotation of the plane about the origin is an automorphism of  $\mathbf{R}^2$ . ■

The isomorphism in Example 6 is a particular instance of an automorphism that arises often enough to warrant a name and notation of its own.

### Definition Inner Automorphism Induced by $a$

Let  $G$  be a group, and let  $a \in G$ . The function  $\phi_a$  defined by  $\phi_a(x) = axa^{-1}$  for all  $x$  in  $G$  is called the *inner automorphism of  $G$  induced by  $a$* .

We leave it for the reader to show that  $\phi_a$  is actually an automorphism of  $G$ . (Use Example 6 as a model.)

■ **EXAMPLE 13** The action of the inner automorphism of  $D_4$  induced by  $R_{90}$  is given in the following table.

$$\begin{array}{lcl}
x & \xrightarrow{\phi_{R_{90}}} & R_{90} x R_{90}^{-1} \\
\hline
R_0 & \rightarrow & R_{90} R_0 R_{90}^{-1} = R_0 \\
R_{90} & \rightarrow & R_{90} R_{90} R_{90}^{-1} = R_{90} \\
R_{180} & \rightarrow & R_{90} R_{180} R_{90}^{-1} = R_{180} \\
R_{270} & \rightarrow & R_{90} R_{270} R_{90}^{-1} = R_{270} \\
H & \rightarrow & R_{90} H R_{90}^{-1} = V \\
V & \rightarrow & R_{90} V R_{90}^{-1} = H \\
D & \rightarrow & R_{90} D R_{90}^{-1} = D' \\
D' & \rightarrow & R_{90} D' R_{90}^{-1} = D
\end{array}$$

When  $G$  is a group, we use  $\text{Aut}(G)$  to denote the set of all automorphisms of  $G$  and  $\text{Inn}(G)$  to denote the set of all inner automorphisms of  $G$ . The reason these sets are noteworthy is demonstrated by the next theorem.

#### ■ Theorem 6.4 $\text{Aut}(G)$ and $\text{Inn}(G)$ Are Groups<sup>†</sup>

*The set of automorphisms of a group and the set of inner automorphisms of a group are both groups under the operation of function composition.*

**PROOF** The proof of Theorem 6.4 is left as an exercise (Exercise 17).

The determination of  $\text{Inn}(G)$  is routine. If  $G = \{e, a, b, c, \dots\}$ , then  $\text{Inn}(G) = \{\phi_e, \phi_a, \phi_b, \phi_c, \dots\}$ . This latter list may have duplications, however, since  $\phi_a$  may be equal to  $\phi_b$  even though  $a \neq b$  (see Exercise 45). Thus, the only work involved in determining  $\text{Inn}(G)$  is deciding which distinct elements give the distinct automorphisms. On the other hand, the determination of  $\text{Aut}(G)$  is, in general, quite involved.

#### ■ EXAMPLE 14 $\text{Inn}(D_4)$

To determine  $\text{Inn}(D_4)$ , we first observe that the complete list of inner automorphisms is  $\phi_{R_0}, \phi_{R_{90}}, \phi_{R_{180}}, \phi_{R_{270}}, \phi_H, \phi_V, \phi_D$ , and  $\phi_{D'}$ . Our job is to determine the repetitions in this list. Since  $R_{180} \in Z(D_4)$ , we have  $\phi_{R_{180}}(x) = R_{180} x R_{180}^{-1} = x$ , so that  $\phi_{R_{180}} = \phi_{R_0}$ . Also,  $\phi_{R_{270}}(x) = R_{270} x R_{270}^{-1} = R_{90} R_{180} x R_{180}^{-1} R_{90}^{-1} = R_{90} x R_{90}^{-1} = \phi_{R_{90}}(x)$ . Similarly, since  $H = R_{180} V$  and  $D' = R_{180} D$ , we have  $\phi_H = \phi_V$  and  $\phi_D = \phi_{D'}$ . This proves that the

<sup>†</sup>The group  $\text{Aut}(G)$  was first studied by O. Hölder in 1893 and, independently, by E. H. Moore in 1894.

previous list can be pared down to  $\phi_{R_0}$ ,  $\phi_{R_{90}}$ ,  $\phi_H$ , and  $\phi_D$ . We leave it to the reader to show that these are distinct (Exercise 15). ■

### ■ EXAMPLE 15 $\text{Aut}(Z_{10})$

To compute  $\text{Aut}(Z_{10})$ , we try to discover enough information about an element  $\alpha$  of  $\text{Aut}(Z_{10})$  to determine how  $\alpha$  must be defined. Because  $Z_{10}$  is so simple, this is not difficult to do. To begin with, observe that once we know  $\alpha(1)$ , we know  $\alpha(k)$  for any  $k$ , because

$$\begin{aligned}\alpha(k) &= \underbrace{\alpha(1 + 1 + \cdots + 1)}_{k \text{ terms}} \\ &= \underbrace{\alpha(1) + \alpha(1) + \cdots + \alpha(1)}_{k \text{ terms}} = k\alpha(1).\end{aligned}$$

So, we need only determine the choices for  $\alpha(1)$  that make  $\alpha$  an automorphism of  $Z_{10}$ . Since property 5 of Theorem 6.2 tells us that  $|\alpha(1)| = 10$ , there are four candidates for  $\alpha(1)$ :

$$\alpha(1) = 1, \quad \alpha(1) = 3, \quad \alpha(1) = 7, \quad \alpha(1) = 9.$$

To distinguish among the four possibilities, we refine our notation by denoting the mapping that sends 1 to 1 by  $\alpha_1$ , 1 to 3 by  $\alpha_3$ , 1 to 7 by  $\alpha_7$ , and 1 to 9 by  $\alpha_9$ . So the only possibilities for  $\text{Aut}(Z_{10})$  are  $\alpha_1$ ,  $\alpha_3$ ,  $\alpha_7$ , and  $\alpha_9$ . But are all these automorphisms? Clearly,  $\alpha_1$  is the identity. Let us check  $\alpha_3$ . Since  $x \bmod 10 = y \bmod 10$  implies  $3x \bmod 10 = 3y \bmod 10$ ,  $\alpha_3$  is well defined. Moreover, because  $\alpha_3(1) = 3$  is a generator of  $Z_{10}$ , it follows that  $\alpha_3$  is onto (and, by Exercise 12 in Chapter 5, it is also one-to-one). Finally, since  $\alpha_3(a + b) = 3(a + b) = 3a + 3b = \alpha_3(a) + \alpha_3(b)$ , we see that  $\alpha_3$  is operation-preserving as well. Thus,  $\alpha_3 \in \text{Aut}(Z_{10})$ . The same argument shows that  $\alpha_7$  and  $\alpha_9$  are also automorphisms.

This gives us the elements of  $\text{Aut}(Z_{10})$  but not the structure. For instance, what is  $\alpha_3\alpha_3$ ? Well,  $(\alpha_3\alpha_3)(1) = \alpha_3(3) = 3 \cdot 3 = 9 = \alpha_9(1)$ , so  $\alpha_3\alpha_3 = \alpha_9$ . Similar calculations show that  $\alpha_3^3 = \alpha_7$  and  $\alpha_3^4 = \alpha_1$ , so that  $|\alpha_3| = 4$ . Thus,  $\text{Aut}(Z_{10})$  is cyclic. Actually, the following Cayley tables reveal that  $\text{Aut}(Z_{10})$  is isomorphic to  $U(10)$ .

| $U(10)$ | 1 | 3 | 7 | 9 | $\text{Aut}(Z_{10})$ | $\alpha_1$ | $\alpha_3$ | $\alpha_7$ | $\alpha_9$ |
|---------|---|---|---|---|----------------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|
| 1       | 1 | 3 | 7 | 9 | $\alpha_1$           | $\alpha_1$ | $\alpha_3$ | $\alpha_7$ | $\alpha_9$ |
| 3       | 3 | 9 | 1 | 7 | $\alpha_3$           | $\alpha_3$ | $\alpha_9$ | $\alpha_1$ | $\alpha_7$ |
| 7       | 7 | 1 | 9 | 3 | $\alpha_7$           | $\alpha_7$ | $\alpha_1$ | $\alpha_9$ | $\alpha_3$ |
| 9       | 9 | 7 | 3 | 1 | $\alpha_9$           | $\alpha_9$ | $\alpha_7$ | $\alpha_3$ | $\alpha_1$ |

■

With Example 15 as a guide, we are now ready to tackle the group  $\text{Aut}(Z_n)$ . The result is particularly nice, since it relates the two kinds of groups we have most frequently encountered thus far—the cyclic groups  $Z_n$  and the  $U$ -groups  $U(n)$ .

■ **Theorem 6.5**  $\text{Aut}(Z_n) \approx U(n)$

*For every positive integer  $n$ ,  $\text{Aut}(Z_n)$  is isomorphic to  $U(n)$ .*

**PROOF** As in Example 15, any automorphism  $\alpha$  is determined by the value of  $\alpha(1)$ , and  $\alpha(1) \in U(n)$ . Now consider the correspondence from  $\text{Aut}(Z_n)$  to  $U(n)$  given by  $T: \alpha \rightarrow \alpha(1)$ . The fact that  $\alpha(k) = k\alpha(1)$  (see Example 13) implies that  $T$  is a one-to-one mapping. For if  $\alpha$  and  $\beta$  belong to  $\text{Aut}(Z_n)$  and  $\alpha(1) = \beta(1)$ , then  $\alpha(k) = k\alpha(1) = k\beta(1) = \beta(k)$  for all  $k$  in  $Z_n$ , and therefore  $\alpha = \beta$ .

To prove that  $T$  is onto, let  $r \in U(n)$  and consider the mapping  $\alpha$  from  $Z_n$  to  $Z_n$  defined by  $\alpha(s) = sr \pmod{n}$  for all  $s$  in  $Z_n$ . We leave it as an exercise to verify that  $\alpha$  is an automorphism of  $Z_n$  (see Exercise 29). Then, since  $T(\alpha) = \alpha(1) = r$ ,  $T$  is onto  $U(n)$ .

Finally, we establish the fact that  $T$  is operation-preserving. Let  $\alpha, \beta \in \text{Aut}(Z_n)$ . We then have

$$\begin{aligned} T(\alpha\beta) &= (\alpha\beta)(1) = \alpha(\beta(1)) = \alpha(\underbrace{1 + 1 + \cdots + 1}_{\beta(1)}) \\ &= \underbrace{\alpha(1) + \alpha(1) + \cdots + \alpha(1)}_{\beta(1)} = \alpha(1)\beta(1) \\ &= T(\alpha)T(\beta). \end{aligned}$$

This completes the proof. ■

The next example shows how inner automorphisms of a group provide a convenient way to create multiple isomorphic subgroups of the group.

■ **EXAMPLE 16** Given the subgroup of  $S_4$

$$H = \{(1), (1234), (13)(24), (1432), (12)(34), (24), (14)(23), (13)\}$$

we have the subgroups

$$(12)H(21) = \{(1), (1342), (14)(23), (1234), (12)(34), (14), (13)(24), (23)\}$$

and

$$(123)H(321) = \{(1), (1423), (12)(34), (1324), (14)(23), (34), (13)(24), (12)\}$$

of  $S_4$  that are isomorphic to  $H$ . ■

## Exercises

Being a mathematician is a bit like being a manic depressive: you spend your life alternating between giddy elation and black despair.

Steven G. Krantz, *A Primer of Mathematical Writing*

1. Find an isomorphism from the group of integers under addition to the group of even integers under addition.
2. Find  $\text{Aut}(\mathbf{Z})$ .
3. Let  $\mathbf{R}^+$  be the group of positive real numbers under multiplication. Show that the mapping  $\phi(x) = \sqrt{x}$  is an automorphism of  $\mathbf{R}^+$ .
4. Show that  $U(8)$  is not isomorphic to  $U(10)$ .
5. Show that  $U(8)$  is isomorphic to  $U(12)$ .
6. Prove that isomorphism is an equivalence relation. That is, for any groups  $G$ ,  $H$ , and  $K$ 

$$G \approx G;$$

$$G \approx H \text{ implies } H \approx G$$

$$G \approx H \text{ and } H \approx K \text{ implies } G \approx K.$$
7. Prove that  $S_4$  is not isomorphic to  $D_{12}$ .
8. Show that the mapping  $a \rightarrow \log_{10} a$  is an isomorphism from  $\mathbf{R}^+$  under multiplication to  $\mathbf{R}$  under addition.
9. In the notation of Theorem 6.1, prove that  $T_e$  is the identity and that  $(T_g)^{-1} = T_{g^{-1}}$ .
10. Given that  $\phi$  is a isomorphism from a group  $G$  under addition to a group  $\bar{G}$  under addition, convert property 2 of Theorem 6.2 to additive notation.
11. Let  $G$  be a group under multiplication,  $\bar{G}$  be a group under addition and  $\phi$  be an isomorphism from  $G$  to  $\bar{G}$ . If  $\phi(a) = \bar{a}$  and  $\phi(b) = \bar{b}$ , find an expression for  $\phi(a^3b^{-2})$  in terms of  $\bar{a}$  and  $\bar{b}$ .
12. Let  $G$  be a group. Prove that the mapping  $\alpha(g) = g^{-1}$  for all  $g$  in  $G$  is an automorphism if and only if  $G$  is Abelian.
13. If  $g$  and  $h$  are elements from a group, prove that  $\phi_g\phi_h = \phi_{gh}$ .



14. Find two groups  $G$  and  $H$  such that  $G \neq H$ , but  $\text{Aut}(G) \approx \text{Aut}(H)$ .
15. Prove the assertion in Example 14 that the inner automorphisms  $\phi_{R_0}$ ,  $\phi_{R_{90}}$ ,  $\phi_H$ , and  $\phi_D$  of  $D_4$  are distinct.
16. Find  $\text{Aut}(Z_6)$ .
17. If  $G$  is a group, prove that  $\text{Aut}(G)$  and  $\text{Inn}(G)$  are groups. (This exercise is referred to in this chapter.)
18. If a group  $G$  is isomorphic to  $H$ , prove that  $\text{Aut}(G)$  is isomorphic to  $\text{Aut}(H)$ .
19. Suppose  $\phi$  belongs to  $\text{Aut}(Z_n)$  and  $a$  is relatively prime to  $n$ . If  $\phi(a) = b$ , determine a formula for  $\phi(x)$ .
20. Let  $H$  be the subgroup of all rotations in  $D_n$  and let  $\phi$  be an automorphism of  $D_n$ . Prove that  $\phi(H) = H$ . (In words, an automorphism of  $D_n$  carries rotations to rotations.)
21. Let  $H = \{\beta \in S_5 \mid \beta(1) = 1\}$  and  $K = \{\beta \in S_5 \mid \beta(2) = 2\}$ . Prove that  $H$  is isomorphic to  $K$ . Is the same true if  $S_5$  is replaced by  $S_n$ , where  $n \geq 3$ ?
22. Show that  $Z$  has infinitely many subgroups isomorphic to  $Z$ .
23. Let  $n$  be an even integer greater than 2 and let  $\phi$  be an automorphism of  $D_n$ . Determine  $\phi(R_{180})$ .
24. Let  $\phi$  be an automorphism of a group  $G$ . Prove that  $H = \{x \in G \mid \phi(x) = x\}$  is a subgroup of  $G$ .
25. Give an example of a cyclic group of smallest order that contains both a subgroup isomorphic to  $Z_{12}$  and a subgroup isomorphic to  $Z_{20}$ . No need to prove anything, but explain your reasoning.
26. Suppose that  $\phi: Z_{20} \rightarrow Z_{20}$  is an automorphism and  $\phi(5) = 5$ . What are the possibilities for  $\phi(x)$ ?
27. Identify a group  $G$  that has subgroups isomorphic to  $Z_n$  for all positive integers  $n$ .
28. Prove that the mapping from  $U(16)$  to itself given by  $x \rightarrow x^3$  is an automorphism.
29. Let  $r \in U(n)$ . Prove that the mapping  $\alpha: Z_n \rightarrow Z_n$  defined by  $\alpha(s) = sr \bmod n$  for all  $s$  in  $Z_n$  is an automorphism of  $Z_n$ . (This exercise is referred to in this chapter.)
30. The group  $\left\{ \begin{bmatrix} 1 & a \\ 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \mid a \in Z \right\}$  is isomorphic to what familiar group?  
What if  $Z$  is replaced by  $\mathbf{R}$ ?
31. If  $\phi$  and  $\gamma$  are isomorphisms from the cyclic group  $\langle a \rangle$  to some group and  $\phi(a) = \gamma(a)$ , prove that  $\phi = \gamma$ .
32. Suppose that  $\phi: Z_{50} \rightarrow Z_{50}$  is an automorphism with  $\phi(7) = 13$ . Determine a formula for  $\phi(x)$ .

33. Prove property 1 of Theorem 6.3.
34. Prove property 4 of Theorem 6.3.
35. Referring to Theorem 6.1, prove that  $T_g$  is indeed a permutation on the set  $G$ .
36. Prove or disprove that  $U(20)$  and  $U(24)$  are isomorphic.
37. Show that the mapping  $\phi(a + bi) = a - bi$  is an automorphism of the group of complex numbers under addition. Show that  $\phi$  preserves complex multiplication as well—that is,  $\phi(xy) = \phi(x)\phi(y)$  for all  $x$  and  $y$  in  $\mathbf{C}$ . (This exercise is referred to in Chapter 15.)
38. Let

$$G = \{a + b\sqrt{2} \mid a, b \text{ are rational}\}$$

and

$$H = \left\{ \begin{bmatrix} a & 2b \\ b & a \end{bmatrix} \mid a, b \text{ are rational} \right\}.$$

Show that  $G$  and  $H$  are isomorphic under addition. Prove that  $G$  and  $H$  are closed under multiplication. Does your isomorphism preserve multiplication as well as addition? ( $G$  and  $H$  are examples of rings—a topic we will take up in Part 3.)

39. Prove that  $Z$  under addition is not isomorphic to  $Q$  under addition.
40. Explain why  $S_8$  contains subgroups isomorphic to  $Z_{15}$ ,  $U(16)$ , and  $D_8$ .
41. Let  $\mathbf{C}$  be the complex numbers and

$$M = \left\{ \begin{bmatrix} a & -b \\ b & a \end{bmatrix} \mid a, b \in \mathbf{R} \right\}.$$

Prove that  $\mathbf{C}$  and  $M$  are isomorphic under addition and that  $\mathbf{C}^*$  and  $M^*$ , the nonzero elements of  $M$ , are isomorphic under multiplication.

42. Let  $\mathbf{R}^n = \{(a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n) \mid a_i \in \mathbf{R}\}$ . Show that the mapping  $\phi: (a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n) \rightarrow (-a_1, -a_2, \dots, -a_n)$  is an automorphism of the group  $\mathbf{R}^n$  under componentwise addition. This automorphism is called *inversion*. Describe the action of  $\phi$  geometrically.
43. Consider the following statement: The order of a subgroup divides the order of the group. Suppose you could prove this for finite permutation groups. Would the statement then be true for all finite groups? Explain.
44. Suppose that  $G$  is a finite Abelian group and  $G$  has no element of order 2. Show that the mapping  $g \rightarrow g^2$  is an automorphism of  $G$ . Show, by example, that there is an infinite Abelian group for which the mapping  $g \rightarrow g^2$  is one-to-one and operation-preserving but not an automorphism.

45. Let  $G$  be a group and let  $g \in G$ . If  $z \in Z(G)$ , show that the inner automorphism induced by  $g$  is the same as the inner automorphism induced by  $zg$  (that is, that the mappings  $\phi_g$  and  $\phi_{zg}$  are equal).
46. Prove that  $\mathbf{R}$  under addition is not isomorphic to  $\mathbf{R}^*$  under multiplication.
47. Suppose that  $g$  and  $h$  induce the same inner automorphism of a group  $G$ . Prove that  $h^{-1}g \in Z(G)$ .
48. Combine the results of Exercises 45 and 47 into a single “if and only if” theorem.
49. If  $\alpha$  and  $\beta$  are elements in  $S_n$  ( $n \geq 3$ ), prove that  $\phi_\alpha = \phi_\beta$  implies that  $\alpha = \beta$ . (Here,  $\phi_\alpha$  is the inner automorphism of  $S_n$  induced by  $\alpha$ .)
50. Prove or disprove that the mapping  $\phi$  from  $Q^+$ , the positive rational numbers under multiplication, to itself given by  $\phi(x) = x^2$  is an automorphism.
51. Suppose the  $\phi$  and  $\gamma$  are isomorphisms of some group  $G$  to the same group. Prove that  $H = \{g \in G \mid \phi(g) = \gamma(g)\}$  is a subgroup of  $G$ .
52. Let  $G$  be a group. Complete the following statement:  $|\text{Inn}(G)| = 1$  if and only if \_\_\_\_\_.
53. Suppose that  $G$  is an Abelian group and  $\phi$  is an automorphism of  $G$ . Prove that  $H = \{x \in G \mid \phi(x) = x^{-1}\}$  is a subgroup of  $G$ .
54. Let  $\phi$  be an automorphism of  $D_8$ . What are the possibilities for  $\phi(R_{45})$ ?
55. Let  $\phi$  be an automorphism of  $\mathbf{C}^*$ , the group of nonzero complex numbers under multiplication. Determine  $\phi(-1)$ . Determine the possibilities for  $\phi(i)$ .
56. Let  $G = \{0, \pm 2, \pm 4, \pm 6, \dots\}$  and  $H = \{0, \pm 3, \pm 6, \pm 9, \dots\}$ . Prove that  $G$  and  $H$  are isomorphic groups under addition by defining a mapping that has the required properties. Does your isomorphism preserve multiplication? Generalize to the case when  $G = \langle m \rangle$  and  $H = \langle n \rangle$ , where  $m$  and  $n$  are integers.
57. Give three examples of groups of order 120, no two of which are isomorphic. Explain why they are not isomorphic.
58. Let  $\phi$  be an automorphism of  $D_4$  such that  $\phi(H) = D$ . Find  $\phi(V)$ .
59. Suppose that  $\phi$  is an automorphism of  $D_4$  such that  $\phi(R_{90}) = R_{270}$  and  $\phi(V) = V$ . Determine  $\phi(D)$  and  $\phi(H)$ .
60. In  $\text{Aut}(Z_9)$ , let  $\alpha_i$  denote the automorphism that sends 1 to  $i$  where  $\gcd(i, 9) = 1$ . Write  $\alpha_5$  and  $\alpha_8$  as permutations of  $\{0, 1, \dots, 8\}$  in disjoint cycle form. [For example,  $\alpha_2 = (0)(124875)(36)$ .]
61. Write the permutation corresponding to  $R_{90}$  in the left regular representation of  $D_4$  in cycle form.

62. Show that every automorphism  $\phi$  of the rational numbers  $\mathcal{Q}$  under addition to itself has the form  $\phi(x) = x\phi(1)$ .
63. Prove that  $\mathcal{Q}^+$ , the group of positive rational numbers under multiplication, is isomorphic to a proper subgroup of itself.
64. Prove that  $\mathcal{Q}$ , the group of rational numbers under addition, is not isomorphic to a proper subgroup of itself.
65. Prove that every automorphism of  $\mathbf{R}^*$ , the group of nonzero real numbers under multiplication, maps positive numbers to positive numbers and negative numbers to negative numbers.
66. Prove that  $\mathcal{Q}^*$ , the group of nonzero rational numbers under multiplication, is not isomorphic to  $\mathcal{Q}$ , the group of rational numbers under addition.
67. Give a group theoretic proof that  $\mathcal{Q}$  under addition is not isomorphic to  $\mathbf{R}^+$  under multiplication.

## Reference

1. J. R. Clay, "The Punctured Plane Is Isomorphic to the Unit Circle," *Journal of Number Theory* 1 (1969): 500–501.

## Computer Exercises

Software for the computer exercise in this chapter is available at the website:

**<http://www.d.umn.edu/~jgallian>**

## Arthur Cayley

Cayley is forging the weapons for future generations of physicists.

PETER TAIT



The Granger Collection, New York

ARTHUR CAYLEY was born on August 16, 1821, in England. His genius showed itself at an early age. He published his first research paper while an undergraduate of 20, and in the next year he published eight papers. While still in his early 20s, he originated the concept of  $n$ -dimensional geometry.

After graduating from Trinity College, Cambridge, Cayley stayed on for three years as a tutor. At the age of 25, he began a 14-year career as a lawyer. During this period, he published approximately 200 mathematical papers, many of which are now classics.

In 1863, Cayley accepted the newly established Sadlerian professorship of mathematics at Cambridge University. He spent the rest of his life in that position. One of his notable accomplishments was his role in the

successful effort to have women admitted to Cambridge.

Among Cayley's many innovations in mathematics were the notions of an abstract group and a group algebra, and the matrix concept. He made major contributions to geometry and linear algebra. Cayley and his lifelong friend and collaborator J. J. Sylvester were the founders of the theory of invariants, which was later to play an important role in the theory of relativity.

Cayley's collected works comprise 13 volumes, each about 600 pages in length. He died on January 26, 1895.

To find more information about Cayley, visit:

**[http://www-groups.dcs  
.st-and.ac.uk/~history/](http://www-groups.dcs.st-and.ac.uk/~history/)**

# 7

## Cosets and Lagrange's Theorem

It might be difficult, at this point, for students to see the extreme importance of this result [Lagrange's Theorem]. As we penetrate the subject more deeply they will become more and more aware of its basic character.

I. N. Herstein, *Topics in Algebra*

Lagrange's theorem is extremely important and justly famous in group theory.

Norman J. Block, *Abstract Algebra with Applications*

### Properties of Cosets

In this chapter, we will prove the single most important theorem in finite group theory—Lagrange's Theorem. In his book on abstract algebra, I. N. Herstein likened it to the ABC's for finite groups. But first we introduce a new and powerful tool for analyzing a group—the notion of a coset. This notion was invented by Galois in 1830, although the term was coined by G. A. Miller in 1910.

#### Definition Coset of $H$ in $G$

Let  $G$  be a group and let  $H$  be a nonempty subset of  $G$ . For any  $a \in G$ , the set  $\{ah \mid h \in H\}$  is denoted by  $aH$ . Analogously,  $Ha = \{ha \mid h \in H\}$  and  $aHa^{-1} = \{aha^{-1} \mid h \in H\}$ . When  $H$  is a subgroup of  $G$ , the set  $aH$  is called the *left coset of  $H$  in  $G$  containing  $a$* , whereas  $Ha$  is called the *right coset of  $H$  in  $G$  containing  $a$* . In this case, the element  $a$  is called the *coset representative of  $aH$  (or  $Ha$ )*. We use  $|aH|$  to denote the number of elements in the set  $aH$ , and  $|Ha|$  to denote the number of elements in  $Ha$ .

■ **EXAMPLE 1** Let  $G = S_3$  and  $H = \{(1), (13)\}$ . Then the left cosets of  $H$  in  $G$  are

$$\begin{aligned}(1)H &= H, \\ (12)H &= \{(12), (12)(13)\} = \{(12), (132)\} = (132)H, \\ (13)H &= \{(13), (1)\} = H, \\ (23)H &= \{(23), (23)(13)\} = \{(23), (123)\} = (123)H.\end{aligned}$$

■ **EXAMPLE 2** Let  $\mathcal{H} = \{R_0, R_{180}\}$  in  $D_4$ , the dihedral group of order 8. Then,

$$\begin{aligned} R_0\mathcal{H} &= \mathcal{H}, \\ R_{90}\mathcal{H} &= \{R_{90}, R_{270}\} = R_{270}\mathcal{H}, \\ R_{180}\mathcal{H} &= \{R_{180}, R_0\} = \mathcal{H}, \\ V\mathcal{H} &= \{V, H\} = H\mathcal{H}, \\ D\mathcal{H} &= \{D, D'\} = D'\mathcal{H}. \end{aligned}$$

■ **EXAMPLE 3** Let  $H = \{0, 3, 6\}$  in  $Z_9$  under addition. In the case that the group operation is addition, we use the notation  $a + H$  instead of  $aH$ . Then the cosets of  $H$  in  $Z_9$  are

$$\begin{aligned} 0 + H &= \{0, 3, 6\} = 3 + H = 6 + H, \\ 1 + H &= \{1, 4, 7\} = 4 + H = 7 + H, \\ 2 + H &= \{2, 5, 8\} = 5 + H = 8 + H. \end{aligned}$$

The three preceding examples illustrate a few facts about cosets that are worthy of our attention. First, cosets are usually not subgroups. Second,  $aH$  may be the same as  $bH$ , even though  $a$  is not the same as  $b$ . Third, since in Example 1  $(12)H = \{(12), (132)\}$  whereas  $H(12) = \{(12), (123)\}$ ,  $aH$  need not be the same as  $Ha$ .

These examples and observations raise many questions. When does  $aH = bH$ ? Do  $aH$  and  $bH$  have any elements in common? When does  $aH = Ha$ ? Which cosets are subgroups? Why are cosets important? The next lemma and theorem answer these questions. (Analogous results hold for right cosets.)

### ■ Lemma *Properties of Cosets*

*Let  $H$  be a subgroup of  $G$ , and let  $a$  and  $b$  belong to  $G$ . Then,*

1.  $a \in aH$ .
2.  $aH = H$  if and only if  $a \in H$ .
3.  $(ab)H = a(bH)$  and  $H(ab) = (Ha)b$ .
4.  $aH = bH$  if and only if  $a \in bH$ .
5.  $aH = bH$  or  $aH \cap bH = \emptyset$ .
6.  $aH = bH$  if and only if  $a^{-1}b \in H$ .
7.  $|aH| = |bH|$ .
8.  $aH = Ha$  if and only if  $H = aHa^{-1}$ .
9.  $aH$  is a subgroup of  $G$  if and only if  $a \in H$ .

### PROOF

1.  $a = ae \in aH$ .
2. To verify property 2, we first suppose that  $aH = H$ . Then  $a = ae \in aH = H$ . Next, we assume that  $a \in H$  and show that  $aH \subseteq H$

and  $H \subseteq aH$ . The first inclusion follows directly from the closure of  $H$ . To show that  $H \subseteq aH$ , let  $h \in H$ . Then, since  $a \in H$  and  $h \in H$ , we know that  $a^{-1}h \in H$ . Thus,  $h = eh = (aa^{-1})h = a(a^{-1}h) \in aH$ .

3. This follows directly from  $(ab)h = a(bh)$  and  $h(ab) = (ha)b$ .
4. If  $aH = bH$ , then  $a = ae \in aH = bH$ . Conversely, if  $a \in bH$  we have  $a = bh$  where  $h \in H$ , and therefore  $aH = (bh)H = b(hH) = bH$ .
5. Property 5 follows directly from property 4, for if there is an element  $c$  in  $aH \cap bH$ , then  $cH = aH$  and  $cH = bH$ .
6. Observe that  $aH = bH$  if and only if  $H = a^{-1}bH$ . The result now follows from property 2.
7. To prove that  $|aH| = |bH|$ , it suffices to define a one-to-one mapping from  $aH$  onto  $bH$ . Obviously, the correspondence  $ah \rightarrow bh$  maps  $aH$  onto  $bH$ . That it is one-to-one follows directly from the cancellation property.
8. Note that  $aH = Ha$  if and only if  $(aH)a^{-1} = (Ha)a^{-1} = H(aa^{-1}) = H$ —that is, if and only if  $aHa^{-1} = H$ .
9. If  $aH$  is a subgroup, then it contains the identity  $e$ . Thus,  $aH \cap eH \neq \emptyset$ ; and, by property 5, we have  $aH = eH = H$ . Thus, from property 2, we have  $a \in H$ . Conversely, if  $a \in H$ , then, again by property 2,  $aH = H$ . ■

Although most mathematical theorems are written in symbolic form, one should also know what they say *in words*. In the preceding lemma, property 1 says simply that the left coset of  $H$  containing  $a$  does contain  $a$ . Property 2 says that the  $H$  “absorbs” an element if and only if the element belongs to  $H$ . Property 3 says that the left coset of  $H$  created by multiplying  $H$  on the left by  $ab$  is the same as the one created by multiplying  $H$  on the left by  $b$  then multiplying the resulting coset  $bH$  on the left by  $a$  (and analogously for multiplication on the right by  $ab$ ). Property 4 shows that a left coset of  $H$  is uniquely determined by any one of its elements. In particular, any element of a left coset can be used to represent the coset. Property 5 says—and this is very important—that two left cosets of  $H$  are either identical or disjoint. Thus, a left coset of  $H$  is uniquely determined by any one of its elements. In particular, any element of a left coset can be used to represent the coset. Property 6 shows how we may transfer a question about equality of left cosets of  $H$  to a question about  $H$  itself and vice versa. Property 7 says that all left cosets of  $H$  have the same size. Property 8 is analogous to property 6 in that it shows how a question about the equality of the left and right cosets of  $H$  containing  $a$  is equivalent to a question about the equality of two subgroups of  $G$ . The last property of the lemma says that  $H$  itself is the only coset of  $H$  that is a subgroup of  $G$ .



Note that properties 1, 5, and 7 of the lemma guarantee that the left cosets of a subgroup  $H$  of  $G$  partition  $G$  into blocks of equal size. Indeed, we may view the cosets of  $H$  as a partitioning of  $G$  into equivalence classes under the equivalence relation defined by  $a \sim b$  if  $aH = bH$  (see Theorem 0.7).

In practice, the subgroup  $H$  is often chosen so that the cosets partition the group in some highly desirable fashion. For example, if  $G$  is 3-space  $\mathbf{R}^3$  and  $H$  is a plane through the origin, then the coset  $(a, b, c) + H$  (addition is done componentwise) is the plane passing through the point  $(a, b, c)$  and parallel to  $H$ . Thus, the cosets of  $H$  constitute a partition of 3-space into planes parallel to  $H$ . If  $G = GL(2, \mathbf{R})$  and  $H = SL(2, \mathbf{R})$ , then for any matrix  $A$  in  $G$ , the coset  $AH$  is the set of all  $2 \times 2$  matrices with the same determinant as  $A$ . Thus,

$$\begin{bmatrix} 2 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix} H \text{ is the set of all } 2 \times 2 \text{ matrices of determinant 2}$$

and

$$\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 \\ 2 & 1 \end{bmatrix} H \text{ is the set of all } 2 \times 2 \text{ matrices of determinant } -3.$$

Similarly, it follows from Example 15 of Chapter 2 and Property 7 of complex numbers in Chapter 0 that if  $a + bi = \sqrt{a^2 + b^2}(\cos \theta + i \sin \theta)$  the set of  $n$   $n^{\text{th}}$ -roots of  $a + bi$  is the coset of  $\langle \cos \frac{360^\circ}{n} + i \sin \frac{360^\circ}{n} \rangle$  that contains  $\sqrt[n]{a^2 + b^2}(\cos \frac{\theta}{n} + i \sin \frac{\theta}{n})$ .

Property 5 of the lemma is useful for actually finding the distinct cosets of a subgroup. We illustrate this in the next example.

**EXAMPLE 4** To find the cosets of  $H = \{1, 15\}$  in  $G = U(32) = \{1, 3, 5, 7, 9, 11, 13, 15, 17, 19, 21, 23, 25, 27, 29, 31\}$ , we begin with  $H = \{1, 15\}$ . We can find a second coset by choosing any element not in  $H$ , say 3, as a coset representative. This gives the coset  $3H = \{3, 13\}$ . We find our next coset by choosing a representative not already appearing in the two previously chosen cosets, say 5. This gives us the coset  $5H = \{5, 11\}$ . We continue to form cosets by picking elements from  $U(32)$  that have not yet appeared in the previous cosets as representatives of the cosets until we have accounted for every element of  $U(32)$ . We then have the complete list of all distinct cosets of  $H$ . ■

## Lagrange's Theorem and Consequences

We are now ready to prove a theorem that has been around for more than 200 years—longer than group theory itself! (This theorem was not originally stated in group theoretic terms.) At this stage, it should come as no surprise.

### ■ Theorem 7.1 Lagrange's Theorem<sup>†</sup>: $|H|$ Divides $|G|$

*If  $G$  is a finite group and  $H$  is a subgroup of  $G$ , then  $|H|$  divides  $|G|$ .  
Moreover, the number of distinct left (right) cosets of  $H$  in  $G$  is  $|G|/|H|$ .*

**PROOF** Let  $a_1H, a_2H, \dots, a_rH$  denote the distinct left cosets of  $H$  in  $G$ . Then, for each  $a$  in  $G$ , we have  $aH = a_iH$  for some  $i$ . Also, by property 1 of the lemma,  $a \in aH$ . Thus, each member of  $G$  belongs to one of the cosets  $a_iH$ . In symbols,

$$G = a_1H \cup \dots \cup a_rH.$$

Now, property 5 of the lemma shows that this union is disjoint, so that

$$|G| = |a_1H| + |a_2H| + \dots + |a_rH|.$$

Finally, since  $|a_iH| = |H|$  for each  $i$ , we have  $|G| = r|H|$ . ■

We pause to emphasize that Lagrange's Theorem is a subgroup candidate criterion; that is, it provides a list of candidates for the orders of the subgroups of a group. Thus, a group of order 12 may have subgroups of order 12, 6, 4, 3, 2, 1, but no others. *Warning!* The converse of Lagrange's Theorem is false. For example, a group of order 12 need not have a subgroup of order 6. We prove this in Example 5.

A special name and notation have been adopted for the number of left (or right) cosets of a subgroup in a group. The *index* of a subgroup  $H$  in  $G$  is the number of distinct left cosets of  $H$  in  $G$ . This number is denoted by  $|G:H|$ . As an immediate consequence of the proof of Lagrange's Theorem, we have the following useful formula for the number of distinct left (or right) cosets of  $H$  in  $G$ .

<sup>†</sup>Lagrange stated his version of this theorem in 1770, but the first complete proof was given by Pietro Abbati some 30 years later.

### ■ Corollary 1 $|G:H| = |G|/|H|$

*If  $G$  is a finite group and  $H$  is a subgroup of  $G$ , then  $|G:H| = |G|/|H|$ .*

### ■ Corollary 2 $|a|$ Divides $|G|$

*In a finite group, the order of each element of the group divides the order of the group.*

**PROOF** Recall that the order of an element is the order of the subgroup generated by that element. ■

### ■ Corollary 3 Groups of Prime Order Are Cyclic

*A group of prime order is cyclic.*

**PROOF** Suppose that  $G$  has prime order. Let  $a \in G$  and  $a \neq e$ . Then,  $|\langle a \rangle|$  divides  $|G|$  and  $|\langle a \rangle| \neq 1$ . Thus,  $|\langle a \rangle| = |G|$  and the corollary follows. ■

### ■ Corollary 4 $a^{|G|} = e$

*Let  $G$  be a finite group, and let  $a \in G$ . Then,  $a^{|G|} = e$ .*

**PROOF** By Corollary 2,  $|G| = |a|k$  for some positive integer  $k$ . Thus,  $a^{|G|} = a^{|a|k} = e^k = e$ . ■

### ■ Corollary 5 Fermat's Little Theorem

*For every integer  $a$  and every prime  $p$ ,  $a^p \bmod p = a \bmod p$ .*

**PROOF** By the division algorithm,  $a = pm + r$ , where  $0 \leq r < p$ . Thus,  $a \bmod p = r$ , and it suffices to prove that  $r^p \bmod p = r$ . If  $r = 0$ , the result is trivial, so we may assume that  $r \in U(p)$ . [Recall that  $U(p) = \{1, 2, \dots, p-1\}$  under multiplication modulo  $p$ .] Then, by the preceding corollary,  $r^{p-1} \bmod p = 1$  and, therefore,  $r^p \bmod p = r$ . ■

Fermat's Little Theorem has been used in conjunction with computers to test for primality of certain numbers. One case concerned the number  $p = 2^{257} - 1$ . If  $p$  is prime, then we know from Fermat's Little Theorem that  $10^p \bmod p = 10 \bmod p$  and, therefore,  $10^{p+1} \bmod p = 100 \bmod p$ .

Using multiple precision and a simple loop, a computer was able to calculate  $10^{p+1} \bmod p = 10^{2257} \bmod p$  in a few seconds. The result was not 100, and so  $p$  is not prime.

■ **EXAMPLE 5 The Converse of Lagrange's Theorem Is False.**<sup>†</sup> The group  $A_4$  of order 12 has no subgroups of order 6. To verify this, recall that  $A_4$  has eight elements of order 3 ( $\alpha_5$  through  $\alpha_{12}$ , in the notation of Table 5.1) and suppose that  $H$  is a subgroup of order 6. Let  $a$  be any element of order 3 in  $A_4$ . If  $a$  is not in  $H$ , then  $A_4 = H \cup aH$ . But then  $a^2$  is in  $H$  or  $a^2$  is in  $aH$ . If  $a^2$  is in  $H$  then so is  $(a^2)^2 = a^4 = a$ , so this case is ruled out. If  $a^2$  is in  $aH$ , then  $a^2 = ah$  for some  $h$  in  $H$ , but this also implies that  $a$  is in  $H$ . This argument shows that any subgroup of  $A_4$  of order 6 must contain all eight elements of  $A_4$  of order 3, which is absurd. ■

Lagrange's Theorem demonstrates that the finiteness of a group imposes severe restrictions on the possible orders of subgroups. The next theorem is a counting technique that also places severe limits on the existence of certain subgroups in finite groups.

■ **Theorem 7.2**  $|HK| = |H||K|/|H \cap K|$

*For two finite subgroups  $H$  and  $K$  of a group, define the set  $HK = \{hk \mid h \in H, k \in K\}$ . Then  $|HK| = |H||K|/|H \cap K|$ .*

**PROOF** Although the set  $HK$  has  $|H||K|$  products, not all of these products need represent distinct group elements. That is, we may have  $hk = h'k'$  where  $h \neq h'$  and  $k \neq k'$ . To determine  $|HK|$ , we must find the extent to which this happens. For every  $t$  in  $H \cap K$ , the product  $hk = (ht)(t^{-1}k)$ , so each group element in  $HK$  is represented by at least  $|H \cap K|$  products in  $HK$ . But  $hk = h'k'$  implies  $t = h^{-1}h' = kk'^{-1} \in H \cap K$ , so that  $h' = ht$  and  $k' = t^{-1}k$ . Thus, each element in  $HK$  is represented by exactly  $|H \cap K|$  products. So,  $|HK| = |H||K|/|H \cap K|$ . ■

■ **EXAMPLE 6** A group of order 75 can have at most one subgroup of order 25. (It is shown in Chapter 24 that every group of order 75 has a subgroup of order 25). To see that a group of order 75 cannot have two subgroups of order 25, suppose  $H$  and  $K$  are two such subgroups. Since  $|H \cap K|$  divides  $|H| = 25$  and  $|H \cap K| = 1$  or 5 results in  $|HK| = |H||K|/|H \cap K| = 25 \cdot 25/|H \cap K| = 625$  or 125 elements, we have that  $|H \cap K| = 25$  and therefore  $H = K$ . ■

<sup>†</sup>The first counterexample to the converse of Lagrange's Theorem was given by Paolo Ruffini in 1799.

For any prime  $p > 2$ , we know that  $Z_{2p}$  and  $D_p$  are nonisomorphic groups of order  $2p$ . This naturally raises the question of whether there could be other possible groups of these orders. Remarkably, with just the simple machinery available to us at this point, we can answer this question.

### ■ Theorem 7.3 Classification of Groups of Order $2p$

*Let  $G$  be a group of order  $2p$ , where  $p$  is a prime greater than 2. Then  $G$  is isomorphic to  $Z_{2p}$  or  $D_p$ .*

**PROOF** We assume that  $G$  does not have an element of order  $2p$  and show that  $G \approx D_p$ . We begin by first showing that  $G$  must have an element of order  $p$ . By our assumption and Lagrange's Theorem, any nonidentity element of  $G$  must have order 2 or  $p$ . Thus, to verify our assertion, we may assume that every nonidentity element of  $G$  has order 2. In this case, we have for all  $a$  and  $b$  in the group  $ab = (ab)^{-1} = b^{-1}a^{-1} = ba$ , so that  $G$  is Abelian. Then, for any nonidentity elements  $a, b \in G$  with  $a \neq b$ , the set  $\{e, a, b, ab\}$  is closed and therefore is a subgroup of  $G$  of order 4. Since this contradicts Lagrange's Theorem, we have proved that  $G$  must have an element of order  $p$ ; call it  $a$ .

Now let  $b$  be any element not in  $\langle a \rangle$ . Then by Lagrange's Theorem and our assumption that  $G$  does not have an element of order  $2p$ , we have that  $|b| = 2$  or  $p$ . Because  $|\langle a \rangle \cap \langle b \rangle|$  divides  $|\langle a \rangle| = p$  and  $\langle a \rangle \neq \langle b \rangle$  we have that  $|\langle a \rangle \cap \langle b \rangle| = 1$ . But then  $|b| = 2$ , for otherwise, by Theorem 7.2  $|\langle a \rangle \langle b \rangle| = |\langle a \rangle||\langle b \rangle| = p^2 > 2p = |G|$ , which is impossible. So, any element of  $G$  not in  $\langle a \rangle$  has order 2.

Next consider  $ab$ . Since  $ab \notin \langle a \rangle$ , our argument above shows that  $|ab| = 2$ . Then  $ab = (ab)^{-1} = b^{-1}a^{-1} = ba^{-1}$ . Moreover, this relation completely determines the multiplication table for  $G$ . [For example,  $a^3(ba^4) = a^2(ab)a^4 = a^2(ba^{-1})a^4 = a(ab)a^3 = a(ba^{-1})a^3 = (ab)a^2 = (ba^{-1})a^2 = ba$ .] Since the multiplication table for all noncyclic groups of order  $2p$  is uniquely determined by the relation  $ab = ba^{-1}$ , all noncyclic groups of order  $2p$  must be isomorphic to each other. But of course,  $D_p$ , the dihedral group of order  $2p$ , is one such group. ■

As an immediate corollary, we have that the non-Abelian groups  $S_3$ , the symmetric group of degree 3, and  $\text{GL}(2, Z_2)$ , the group of  $2 \times 2$  matrices with nonzero determinants with entries from  $Z_2$  (see Example 18 and Exercise 49 in Chapter 2) are isomorphic to  $D_3$ .

## An Application of Cosets to Permutation Groups

Lagrange's Theorem and its corollaries dramatically demonstrate the fruitfulness of the coset concept. We next consider an application of cosets to permutation groups.

### Definition Stabilizer of a Point

Let  $G$  be a group of permutations of a set  $S$ . For each  $i$  in  $S$ , let  $\text{stab}_G(i) = \{\phi \in G \mid \phi(i) = i\}$ . We call  $\text{stab}_G(i)$  the *stabilizer of  $i$  in  $G$* .

The student should verify that  $\text{stab}_G(i)$  is a subgroup of  $G$ . (See Exercise 35 in Chapter 5.)

### Definition Orbit of a Point

Let  $G$  be a group of permutations of a set  $S$ . For each  $i$  in  $S$ , let  $\text{orb}_G(i) = \{\phi(i) \mid \phi \in G\}$ . The set  $\text{orb}_G(i)$  is a subset of  $S$  called the *orbit of  $i$  under  $G$* . We use  $|\text{orb}_G(i)|$  to denote the number of elements in  $\text{orb}_G(i)$ .

Example 7 should clarify these two definitions.

■ **EXAMPLE 7** Let  $G$  be the following subgroup of  $S_8$

$$\{(1), (132)(465)(78), (132)(465), (123)(456), (123)(456)(78), (78)\}.$$

Then,

$$\begin{aligned} \text{orb}_G(1) &= \{1, 3, 2\}, & \text{stab}_G(1) &= \{(1), (78)\}, \\ \text{orb}_G(2) &= \{2, 1, 3\}, & \text{stab}_G(2) &= \{(1), (78)\}, \\ \text{orb}_G(4) &= \{4, 6, 5\}, & \text{stab}_G(4) &= \{(1), (78)\}, \\ \text{orb}_G(7) &= \{7, 8\}, & \text{stab}_G(7) &= \{(1), (132)(465), (123)(456)\}. \end{aligned} \quad \blacksquare$$

■ **EXAMPLE 8** We may view  $D_4$  as a group of permutations of a square region. Figure 7.1(a) illustrates the orbit of the point  $p$  under  $D_4$ , and Figure 7.1(b) illustrates the orbit of the point  $q$  under  $D_4$ . Observe that  $\text{stab}_{D_4}(p) = \{R_0, D\}$ , whereas  $\text{stab}_{D_4}(q) = \{R_0\}$ . ■

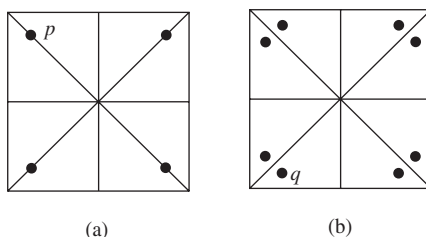


Figure 7.1

The preceding two examples also illustrate the following theorem.

## ■ Theorem 7.4 Orbit-Stabilizer Theorem

*Let  $G$  be a finite group of permutations of a set  $S$ . Then, for any  $i$  from  $S$ ,  $|G| = |\text{orb}_G(i)| |\text{stab}_G(i)|$ .*

**PROOF** By Lagrange's Theorem,  $|G|/|\text{stab}_G(i)|$  is the number of distinct left cosets of  $\text{stab}_G(i)$  in  $G$ . Thus, it suffices to establish a one-to-one correspondence between the left cosets of  $\text{stab}_G(i)$  and the elements in the orbit of  $i$ . To do this, we define a correspondence  $T$  by mapping the coset  $\phi\text{stab}_G(i)$  to  $\phi(i)$  under  $T$ . To show that  $T$  is a well-defined function, we must show that  $\alpha\text{stab}_G(i) = \beta\text{stab}_G(i)$  implies  $\alpha(i) = \beta(i)$ . But  $\alpha\text{stab}_G(i) = \beta\text{stab}_G(i)$  implies  $\alpha^{-1}\beta \in \text{stab}_G(i)$ , so that  $(\alpha^{-1}\beta)(i) = i$  and, therefore,  $\beta(i) = \alpha(i)$ . Reversing the argument from the last step to the first step shows that  $T$  is also one-to-one. We conclude the proof by showing that  $T$  is onto  $\text{orb}_G(i)$ . Let  $j \in \text{orb}_G(i)$ . Then  $\alpha(i) = j$  for some  $\alpha \in G$  and clearly  $T(\alpha\text{stab}_G(i)) = \alpha(i) = j$ , so that  $T$  is onto. ■

We leave as an exercise the proof of the important fact that the orbits of the elements of a set  $S$  under a group partition  $S$  (Exercise 43).

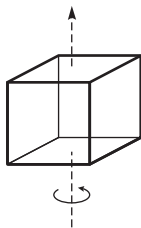
## The Rotation Group of a Cube and a Soccer Ball

It cannot be overemphasized that Theorem 7.4 and Lagrange's Theorem (Theorem 7.1) are *counting* theorems.<sup>†</sup> They enable us to determine the numbers of elements in various sets. To see how Theorem 7.4 works, we will determine the order of the rotation group of a cube and a soccer ball. That is, we wish to find the number of essentially different ways in which we can take a cube or a soccer ball in a certain location in space, physically rotate it, and then have it still occupy its original location.

■ **EXAMPLE 9** Let  $G$  be the rotation group of a cube. Label the six faces of the cube 1 through 6. Since any rotation of the cube must carry each face of the cube to exactly one other face of the cube and different rotations induce different permutations of the faces,  $G$  can be viewed as a group of permutations on the set  $\{1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6\}$ . Clearly, there is some rotation about a central horizontal or vertical axis that carries face number 1 to any other face, so that  $|\text{orb}_G(1)| = 6$ . Next, we consider  $\text{stab}_G(1)$ . Here, we are asking for all rotations of a cube that leave face number 1

<sup>†</sup>“People who don't count won't count” (Anatole France).

where it is. Surely, there are only four such motions—rotations of  $0^\circ$ ,  $90^\circ$ ,  $180^\circ$ , and  $270^\circ$ —about the line perpendicular to the face and passing through its center (see Figure 7.2). Thus, by Theorem 7.4,  $|G| = |\text{orb}_G(1)| |\text{stab}_G(1)| = 6 \cdot 4 = 24$ . ■



**Figure 7.2** Axis of rotation of a cube.

Now that we know how many rotations a cube has, it is simple to determine the actual structure of the rotation group of a cube. Recall that  $S_4$  is the symmetric group of degree 4.

### ■ Theorem 7.5 The Rotation Group of a Cube

*The group of rotations of a cube is isomorphic to  $S_4$ .*

**PROOF** Since the group of rotations of a cube has the same order as  $S_4$ , we need only prove that the group of rotations is isomorphic to a subgroup of  $S_4$ . To this end, observe that a cube has four diagonals and that the rotation group induces a group of permutations on the four diagonals. But we must be careful not to assume that different rotations correspond to different permutations. To see that this is so, all we need do is show that all 24 permutations of the diagonals arise from rotations. Labeling the consecutive diagonals 1, 2, 3, and 4, it is obvious that there is a  $90^\circ$  rotation that yields the permutation  $\alpha = (1234)$ ; another  $90^\circ$  rotation about an axis perpendicular to our first axis yields the permutation  $\beta = (1423)$ . See Figure 7.3. So, the group of permutations induced by the rotations contains the eight-element subgroup  $\{\varepsilon, \alpha, \alpha^2, \alpha^3, \beta^2, \beta^2\alpha, \beta^2\alpha^2, \beta^2\alpha^3\}$  (see Exercise 63) and  $\alpha\beta$ , which has order 3. Clearly, then, the rotations yield all 24 permutations, since the order of the rotation group must be divisible by both 8 and 3. ■

■ **EXAMPLE 10** A traditional soccer ball has 20 faces that are regular hexagons and 12 faces that are regular pentagons. (The technical term for this solid is *truncated icosahedron*.) To determine the number of rotational symmetries of a soccer ball using Theorem 7.4, we may choose our set  $S$  to be the 20 hexagons or the 12 pentagons. Let us say that  $S$  is the set of 12 pentagons. Since any pentagon can be carried to any other



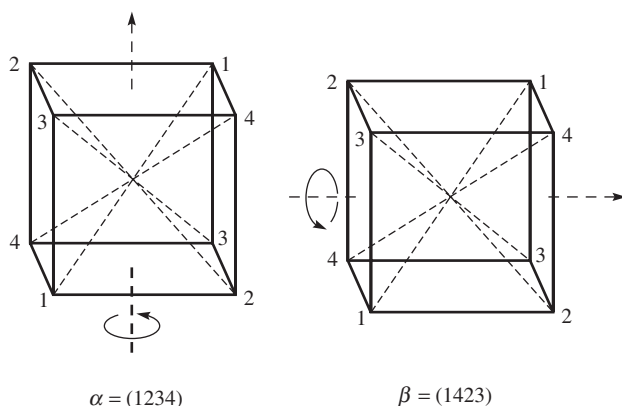


Figure 7.3

pentagon by some rotation, the orbit of any pentagon is  $S$ . Also, there are five rotations that fix (stabilize) any particular pentagon. Thus, by the Orbit-Stabilizer Theorem, there are  $12 \cdot 5 = 60$  rotational symmetries. (In case you are interested, the rotation group of a soccer ball is isomorphic to  $A_5$ .) ■



In 1985, chemists Robert Curl, Richard Smalley, and Harold Kroto caused tremendous excitement in the scientific community when they created a new form of carbon by using a laser beam to vaporize graphite. The structure of the new molecule was composed of 60 carbon atoms arranged in the shape of a soccer ball! Because the shape of the new molecule reminded them of the dome structures built by the architect R. Buckminster Fuller, Curl, Smalley, and Kroto named their discovery “buckyballs.” Buckyballs are the roundest, most symmetric large molecules known. Group theory has been particularly useful in illuminating the properties of buckyballs, since the absorption spectrum of a molecule depends on its symmetries and chemists classify various molecular states according to their symmetry properties. The buckyball discovery spurred a revolution in carbon chemistry. In 1996, Curl, Smalley, and Kroto received the Nobel Prize in chemistry for their discovery.

## An Application of Cosets to the Rubik's Cube

Recall from Chapter 5 that in 2010 it was proved via a computer computation, which took 35 CPU-years to complete, that every Rubik's cube could be solved in at most 20 moves. To carry out this effort, the research team of Morley Davidson, John Dethridge, Herbert Kociemba, and Tomas Rokicki applied a program of Rokicki, which built on early work of Kociemba, that checked the elements of the cosets of a subgroup  $H$  of order  $(8! \cdot 8! \cdot 4!)/2 = 19,508,428,800$  to see if each cube in a position corresponding to the elements in a coset could be solved within 20 moves. In the rare cases where Rokicki's program did not work, an alternate method was employed. Using symmetry considerations, they were able to reduce the approximately 2 billion cosets of  $H$  to about 56 million cosets for testing. Cosets played a role in this effort because Rokicki's program could handle the 19.5+ billion elements in the same coset in about 20 seconds.

### Exercises

I don't know, Marge. Trying is the first step towards failure.

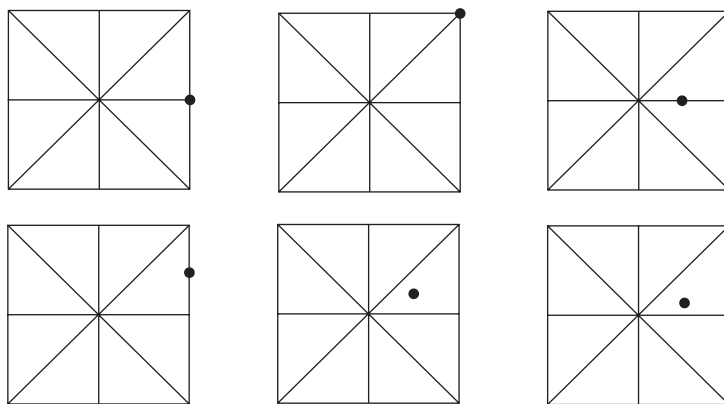
Homer Simpson

1. Let  $H = \{0, \pm 3, \pm 6, \pm 9, \dots\}$ . Find all the left cosets of  $H$  in  $\mathbb{Z}$ .
2. Rewrite the condition  $a^{-1}b \in H$  given in property 6 of the lemma on page 139 in additive notation. Assume that the group is Abelian.
3. Let  $H$  be as in Exercise 1. Use Exercise 2 to decide whether or not the following cosets of  $H$  are the same.
  - a.  $11 + H$  and  $17 + H$
  - b.  $-1 + H$  and  $5 + H$
  - c.  $7 + H$  and  $23 + H$
4. Let  $n$  be a positive integer. Let  $H = \{0, \pm n, \pm 2n, \pm 3n, \dots\}$ . Find all left cosets of  $H$  in  $\mathbb{Z}$ . How many are there?
5. Find all of the left cosets of  $\{1, 11\}$  in  $U(30)$ .
6. Suppose that  $a$  has order 15. Find all of the left cosets of  $\langle a^5 \rangle$  in  $\langle a \rangle$ .
7. Let  $|a| = 30$ . How many left cosets of  $\langle a^4 \rangle$  in  $\langle a \rangle$  are there? List them.
8. Give an example of a group  $G$  and subgroups  $H$  and  $K$  such that  $HK = \{h \in H, k \in K\}$  is not a subgroup of  $G$ .
9. Let  $H = \{(1), (12)(34), (13)(24), (14)(23)\}$ . Find the left cosets of  $H$  in  $A_4$  (see Table 5.1 on page 105). How many left cosets of  $H$  in  $S_4$  are there? (Determine this without listing them.)

10. Let  $a$  and  $b$  be elements of a group  $G$  and  $H$  and  $K$  be subgroups of  $G$ . If  $aH = bK$ , prove that  $H = K$ .
11. If  $H$  and  $K$  are subgroups of  $G$  and  $g$  belongs to  $G$ , show that  $g(H \cap K) = gH \cap gK$ .
12. Let  $a$  and  $b$  be nonidentity elements of different orders in a group  $G$  of order 155. Prove that the only subgroup of  $G$  that contains  $a$  and  $b$  is  $G$  itself.
13. Let  $H$  be a subgroup of  $\mathbf{R}^*$ , the group of nonzero real numbers under multiplication. If  $\mathbf{R}^+ \subseteq H \subseteq \mathbf{R}^*$ , prove that  $H = \mathbf{R}^+$  or  $H = \mathbf{R}^*$ .
14. Let  $\mathbf{C}^*$  be the group of nonzero complex numbers under multiplication and let  $H = \{a + bi \in \mathbf{C}^* \mid a^2 + b^2 = 1\}$ . Give a geometric description of the coset  $(3 + 4i)H$ . Give a geometric description of the coset  $(c + di)H$ .
15. Let  $G$  be a group of order 60. What are the possible orders for the subgroups of  $G$ ?
16. Suppose that  $K$  is a proper subgroup of  $H$  and  $H$  is a proper subgroup of  $G$ . If  $|K| = 42$  and  $|G| = 420$ , what are the possible orders of  $H$ ?
17. Let  $G$  be a group with  $|G| = pq$ , where  $p$  and  $q$  are prime. Prove that every proper subgroup of  $G$  is cyclic.
18. Recall that, for any integer  $n$  greater than 1,  $\phi(n)$  denotes the number of positive integers less than  $n$  and relatively prime to  $n$ . Prove that if  $a$  is any integer relatively prime to  $n$ , then  $a^{\phi(n)} \bmod n = 1$ .
19. Compute  $5^{15} \bmod 7$  and  $7^{13} \bmod 11$ .
20. Use Corollary 2 of Lagrange's Theorem (Theorem 7.1) to prove that the order of  $U(n)$  is even when  $n > 2$ .
21. Suppose  $G$  is a finite group of order  $n$  and  $m$  is relatively prime to  $n$ . If  $g \in G$  and  $g^m = e$ , prove that  $g = e$ .
22. Suppose  $H$  and  $K$  are subgroups of a group  $G$ . If  $|H| = 12$  and  $|K| = 35$ , find  $|H \cap K|$ . Generalize.
23. For any integer  $n \geq 3$ , prove that  $D_n$  has a subgroup of order 4 if and only if  $n$  is even.
24. Let  $p$  be a prime and  $k$  a positive integer such that  $a^k \bmod p = a \bmod p$  for all integers  $a$ . Prove that  $p - 1$  divides  $k - 1$ .
25. Suppose that  $G$  is an Abelian group with an odd number of elements. Show that the product of all of the elements of  $G$  is the identity.
26. Suppose that  $G$  is a group with more than one element and  $G$  has no proper, nontrivial subgroups. Prove that  $|G|$  is prime. (Do not assume at the outset that  $G$  is finite.)

27. Let  $|G| = 15$ . If  $G$  has only one subgroup of order 3 and only one of order 5, prove that  $G$  is cyclic. Generalize to  $|G| = pq$ , where  $p$  and  $q$  are prime.
28. Let  $G$  be a group of order 25. Prove that  $G$  is cyclic or  $g^5 = e$  for all  $g$  in  $G$ . Generalize to any group of order  $p^2$  where  $p$  is prime. Does your proof work for this generalization?
29. Let  $|G| = 33$ . What are the possible orders for the elements of  $G$ ? Show that  $G$  must have an element of order 3.
30. Let  $|G| = 8$ . Show that  $G$  must have an element of order 2.
31. Can a group of order 55 have exactly 20 elements of order 11? Give a reason for your answer.
32. Determine all finite subgroups of  $\mathbf{C}^*$ , the group of nonzero complex numbers under multiplication.
33. Let  $H$  and  $K$  be subgroups of a finite group  $G$  with  $H \subseteq K \subseteq G$ . Prove that  $|G:H| = |G:K| |K:H|$ .
34. Suppose that a group contains elements of orders 1 through 10. What is the minimum possible order of the group?
35. Give an example of the dihedral group of smallest order that contains a subgroup isomorphic to  $Z_{12}$  and a subgroup isomorphic to  $Z_{20}$ . No need to prove anything, but explain your reasoning.
36. Let  $G$  be a group and  $|G| = 21$ . If  $g \in G$  and  $g^{14} = e$ , what are the possibilities for  $|g|$ ?
37. Suppose that a finite Abelian group  $G$  has at least three elements of order 3. Prove that 9 divides  $|G|$ .
38. Prove that if  $G$  is a finite group, the index of  $Z(G)$  cannot be prime.
39. Suppose that  $H$  and  $K$  are subgroups of a group with  $|H| = 24$ ,  $|K| = 20$ . Prove that  $H \cap K$  is Abelian.
40. Prove that a group of order 63 must have an element of order 3.
41. Let  $G$  be a group of order 100 that has a subgroup  $H$  of order 25. Prove that every element of  $G$  of order 5 is in  $H$ .
42. Let  $G$  be a group of order  $n$  and  $k$  be any integer relatively prime to  $n$ . Show that the mapping from  $G$  to  $G$  given by  $g \rightarrow g^k$  is one-to-one. If  $G$  is also Abelian, show that the mapping given by  $g \rightarrow g^k$  is an automorphism of  $G$ .
43. Let  $G$  be a group of permutations of a set  $S$ . Prove that the orbits of the members of  $S$  constitute a partition of  $S$ . (This exercise is referred to in this chapter and in Chapter 29.)
44. Prove that every subgroup of  $D_n$  of odd order is cyclic.

45. Let  $G = \{(1), (12)(34), (1234)(56), (13)(24), (1432)(56), (56)(13), (14)(23), (24)(56)\}$ .
  - a. Find the stabilizer of 1 and the orbit of 1.
  - b. Find the stabilizer of 3 and the orbit of 3.
  - c. Find the stabilizer of 5 and the orbit of 5.
46. Prove that a group of order 12 must have an element of order 2.
47. Show that in a group  $G$  of odd order, the equation  $x^2 = a$  has a unique solution for all  $a$  in  $G$ .
48. Let  $G$  be a group of order  $pqr$ , where  $p, q$ , and  $r$  are distinct primes. If  $H$  and  $K$  are subgroups of  $G$  with  $|H| = pq$  and  $|K| = qr$ , prove that  $|H \cap K| = q$ .
49. Prove that a group that has more than one subgroup of order 5 must have order at least 25.
50. Prove that  $A_5$  has a subgroup of order 12.
51. Prove that  $A_5$  has no subgroup of order 30.
52. Prove that  $A_5$  has no subgroup of order 15 to 20.
53. Suppose that  $\alpha$  is an element from a permutation group  $G$  and one of its cycles in disjoint cycle form is  $(a_1 a_2 \cdots a_k)$ . Show that  $\{a_1, a_2, \dots, a_k\} \subseteq \text{orb}_G(a_i)$  for  $i = 1, 2, \dots, k$ .
54. Suppose that  $G$  is a group of order 105 with the property that  $G$  has exactly one subgroup for each divisor of 105. Prove that  $G$  is cyclic.
55. Prove that  $A_5$  is the only subgroup of  $S_5$  of order 60.
56. Why does the fact that  $A_4$  has no subgroup of order 6 imply that  $|Z(A_4)| = 1$ ?
57. Let  $G = GL(2, \mathbf{R})$  and  $H = SL(2, \mathbf{R})$ . Let  $A \in G$  and suppose that  $\det A = 2$ . Prove that  $AH$  is the set of all  $2 \times 2$  matrices in  $G$  that have determinant 2.
58. Let  $G$  be the group of rotations of a plane about a point  $P$  in the plane. Thinking of  $G$  as a group of permutations of the plane, describe the orbit of a point  $Q$  in the plane. (This is the motivation for the name “orbit.”)
59. Let  $G$  be the rotation group of a cube. Label the faces of the cube 1 through 6, and let  $H$  be the subgroup of elements of  $G$  that carry face 1 to itself. If  $\sigma$  is a rotation that carries face 2 to face 1, give a physical description of the coset  $H\sigma$ .
60. The group  $D_4$  acts as a group of permutations of the square regions shown below. (The axes of symmetry are drawn for reference purposes.) For each square region, locate the points in the orbit of the indicated point under  $D_4$ . In each case, determine the stabilizer of the indicated point.



61. Let  $G = GL(2, \mathbf{R})$ , the group of  $2 \times 2$  matrices over  $\mathbf{R}$  with nonzero determinant. Let  $H$  be the subgroup of matrices of determinant  $\pm 1$ . If  $a, b \in G$  and  $aH = bH$ , what can be said about  $\det(a)$  and  $\det(b)$ ? Prove or disprove the converse. [Determinants have the property that  $\det(xy) = \det(x)\det(y)$ .]
62. Calculate the orders of the following (refer to Figure 27.5 for illustrations).
  - a. The group of rotations of a regular tetrahedron (a solid with four congruent equilateral triangles as faces)
  - b. The group of rotations of a regular octahedron (a solid with eight congruent equilateral triangles as faces)
  - c. The group of rotations of a regular dodecahedron (a solid with 12 congruent regular pentagons as faces)
  - d. The group of rotations of a regular icosahedron (a solid with 20 congruent equilateral triangles as faces)
63. Prove that the eight-element set in the proof of Theorem 7.5 is a group.
64. A soccer ball has 20 faces that are regular hexagons and 12 faces that are regular pentagons. Use Theorem 7.4 to explain why a soccer ball cannot have a  $60^\circ$  rotational symmetry about a line through the centers of two opposite hexagonal faces.
65. If  $G$  is a finite group with fewer than 100 elements and  $G$  has subgroups of orders 10 and 25, what is the order of  $G$ ?

## Computer Exercises

A computer exercise for this chapter is available at the website:

<http://www.d.umn.edu/~jgallian>

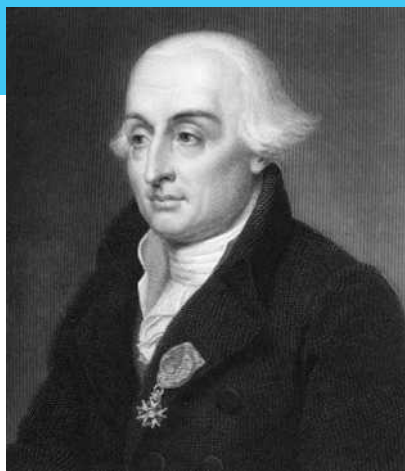
# Joseph Lagrange

Lagrange is the Lofty Pyramid of the Mathematical Sciences.

NAPOLEON BONAPARTE

JOSEPH LOUIS LAGRANGE was born in Italy of French ancestry on January 25, 1736. He became captivated by mathematics at an early age when he read an essay by Halley on Newton's calculus. At the age of 19, he became a professor of mathematics at the Royal Artillery School in Turin. Lagrange made significant contributions to many branches of mathematics and physics, among them the theory of numbers, the theory of equations, ordinary and partial differential equations, the calculus of variations, analytic geometry, fluid dynamics, and celestial mechanics. His methods for solving third- and fourth-degree polynomial equations by radicals laid the groundwork for the group theoretic approach to solving polynomials taken by Galois. Lagrange was a very careful writer with a clear and elegant style.

At the age of 40, Lagrange was appointed head of the Berlin Academy, succeeding



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Euler. In offering this appointment, Frederick the Great proclaimed that the “greatest king in Europe” ought to have the “greatest mathematician in Europe” at his court. In 1787, Lagrange was invited to Paris by Louis XVI and became a good friend of the king and his wife, Marie Antoinette. In 1793, Lagrange headed a commission, which included Laplace and Lavoisier, to devise a new system of weights and measures. Out of this came the metric system. Late in his life he was made a count by Napoleon. Lagrange died on April 10, 1813.

To find more information about Lagrange, visit:

**[http://www-groups.dcs  
.st-and.ac.uk/~history/](http://www-groups.dcs.st-and.ac.uk/~history/)**

# 8

## External Direct Products

The universe is an enormous direct product of representations of symmetry groups.

Steven Weinberg<sup>†</sup>

In many areas of mathematics, there are ways of “building things up” and “breaking things down”

Norman J. Block, *Abstract Algebra with Applications*

### Definition and Examples

In this chapter, we show how to piece together groups to make larger groups. In Chapter 9, we will show that we can often start with one large group and decompose it into a product of smaller groups in much the same way as a composite positive integer can be broken down into a product of primes. These methods will later be used to give us a simple way to construct all finite Abelian groups.

#### Definition External Direct Product

Let  $G_1, G_2, \dots, G_n$  be a finite collection of groups. The *external direct product* of  $G_1, G_2, \dots, G_n$ , written as  $G_1 \oplus G_2 \oplus \dots \oplus G_n$ , is the set of all  $n$ -tuples for which the  $i$ th component is an element of  $G_i$  and the operation is componentwise.

In symbols,

$$G_1 \oplus G_2 \oplus \dots \oplus G_n = \{(g_1, g_2, \dots, g_n) \mid g_i \in G_i\},$$

where  $(g_1, g_2, \dots, g_n)(g'_1, g'_2, \dots, g'_n)$  is defined to be  $(g_1g'_1, g_2g'_2, \dots, g_ng'_n)$ . It is understood that each product  $g_i g'_i$  is performed with the operation of  $G_i$ . Note that in the case that each  $G_i$  is finite, we have by properties of sets that  $|G_1 \oplus G_2 \oplus \dots \oplus G_n| = |G_1| |G_2| \dots |G_n|$ . We leave it to the reader to show that the external direct product of groups is itself a group (Exercise 1).

<sup>†</sup>Weinberg received the 1979 Nobel Prize in physics with Sheldon Glashow and Abdus Salam for their construction of a single theory incorporating weak and electromagnetic interactions.



This construction is not new to students who have had linear algebra or physics. Indeed,  $\mathbf{R}^2 = \mathbf{R} \oplus \mathbf{R}$  and  $\mathbf{R}^3 = \mathbf{R} \oplus \mathbf{R} \oplus \mathbf{R}$ —the operation being componentwise addition. Of course, there is also scalar multiplication, but we ignore this for the time being, since we are interested only in the group structure at this point.

### ■ EXAMPLE 1

$$\begin{aligned} U(8) \oplus U(10) = \{ & (1, 1), (1, 3), (1, 7), (1, 9), (3, 1), (3, 3), \\ & (3, 7), (3, 9), (5, 1), (5, 3), (5, 7), (5, 9), \\ & (7, 1), (7, 3), (7, 7), (7, 9) \}. \end{aligned}$$

The product  $(3, 7)(7, 9) = (5, 3)$ , since the first components are combined by multiplication modulo 8, whereas the second components are combined by multiplication modulo 10. ■

### ■ EXAMPLE 2

$$Z_2 \oplus Z_3 = \{(0, 0), (0, 1), (0, 2), (1, 0), (1, 1), (1, 2)\}.$$

Clearly, this is an Abelian group of order 6. Is this group related to another Abelian group of order 6 that we know, namely,  $Z_6$ ? Consider the subgroup of  $Z_2 \oplus Z_3$  generated by  $(1, 1)$ . Since the operation in each component is addition, we have  $(1, 1) = (1, 1)$ ,  $2(1, 1) = (0, 2)$ ,  $3(1, 1) = (1, 0)$ ,  $4(1, 1) = (0, 1)$ ,  $5(1, 1) = (1, 2)$ , and  $6(1, 1) = (0, 0)$ . Hence  $Z_2 \oplus Z_3$  is cyclic. It follows that  $Z_2 \oplus Z_3$  is isomorphic to  $Z_6$ . ■

In Theorem 7.3 we classified the groups of order  $2p$  where  $p$  is an odd prime. Now that we have defined  $Z_2 \oplus Z_2$ , it is easy to classify the groups of order 4.

### ■ EXAMPLE 3 Classification of Groups of Order 4

A group of order 4 is isomorphic to  $Z_4$  or  $Z_2 \oplus Z_2$ . To verify this it suffices to show that for any non-cyclic group  $G$  of order 4 there is only one way to create an operation table for  $G$ . By Lagrange's Theorem the elements of  $G$  have order 1 or 2. Let  $a$  and  $b$  be distinct non-identity elements of  $G$ . By cancellation,  $ab \neq a$  and  $ab \neq b$ . Moreover,  $ab \neq e$ , for otherwise  $a = b^{-1} = b$ . Thus  $G = \{e, a, b, ab\}$ . That the operation table is uniquely determined follows from the observation that  $ab = (ab)^{-1} = b^{-1}a^{-1} = ba$ . ■

We see from Examples 2 and 3 that in some cases  $Z_m \oplus Z_n$  is isomorphic to  $Z_{mn}$  and in some cases it is not. Theorem 8.2 provides a simple characterization for when the isomorphism holds.

## Properties of External Direct Products

Our first theorem gives a simple method for computing the order of an element in a direct product in terms of the orders of the component pieces.

### ■ Theorem 8.1 Order of an Element in a Direct Product

*The order of an element in a direct product of a finite number of finite groups is the least common multiple of the orders of the components of the element. In symbols,*

$$|(g_1, g_2, \dots, g_n)| = \text{lcm}(|g_1|, |g_2|, \dots, |g_n|).$$

**PROOF** Denote the identity of  $G_i$  by  $e_i$ . Let  $s = \text{lcm}(|g_1|, |g_2|, \dots, |g_n|)$  and  $t = |(g_1, g_2, \dots, g_n)|$ . Because the fact that  $s$  is a multiple of each  $|g_i|$  implies that  $(g_1, g_2, \dots, g_n)^s = (g_1^s, g_2^s, \dots, g_n^s) = (e_1, e_2, \dots, e_n)$ , we know that  $t \leq s$ . On the other hand, from  $(g_1^t, g_2^t, \dots, g_n^t) = (g_1, g_2, \dots, g_n)^t = (e_1, e_2, \dots, e_n)$  we see that  $t$  is a common multiple of  $|g_1|, |g_2|, \dots, |g_n|$ . Thus,  $s \leq t$ . ■

The next three examples are applications of Theorem 8.1.

■ **EXAMPLE 4** Examples of groups of order 100 include  $Z_{100}$ ;  $Z_{25} \oplus Z_2 \oplus Z_2$ ;  $Z_5 \oplus Z_5 \oplus Z_4$ ;  $Z_5 \oplus Z_5 \oplus Z_2 \oplus Z_2$ ;  $D_{50}$ ;  $D_{10} \oplus Z_5$ ;  $D_5 \oplus Z_{10}$ ; and  $D_5 \oplus D_5$ . That these are not isomorphic is an easy consequence of Theorem 8.1.

■ **EXAMPLE 5** We determine the number of elements of order 5 in  $Z_{25} \oplus Z_5$ . By Theorem 8.1, we may count the number of elements  $(a, b)$  in  $Z_{25} \oplus Z_5$  with the property that  $5 = |(a, b)| = \text{lcm}(|a|, |b|)$ . Clearly this requires that either  $|a| = 5$  and  $|b| = 1$  or  $5$ , or  $|b| = 5$  and  $|a| = 1$  or  $5$ . We consider two mutually exclusive cases.

**Case 1**  $|a| = 5$  and  $|b| = 1$  or  $5$ . Here there are four choices for  $a$  (namely, 5, 10, 15, and 20) and five choices for  $b$ . This gives 20 elements of order 5.

**Case 2**  $|a| = 1$  and  $|b| = 5$ . This time there is one choice for  $a$  and four choices for  $b$ , so we obtain four more elements of order 5.

Thus,  $Z_{25} \oplus Z_5$  has 24 elements of order 5. ■

■ **EXAMPLE 6** We determine the number of cyclic subgroups of order 10 in  $Z_{100} \oplus Z_{25}$ . We begin by counting the number of elements  $(a, b)$  of order 10.

**Case 1**  $|a| = 10$  and  $|b| = 1$  or  $5$ . Since  $Z_{100}$  has a unique cyclic subgroup of order 10 and any cyclic group of order 10 has four generators

(Theorem 4.4), there are four choices for  $a$ . Similarly, there are five choices for  $b$ . This gives 20 possibilities for  $(a, b)$ .

**Case 2**  $|a| = 2$  and  $|b| = 5$ . Since any finite cyclic group of even order has a unique subgroup of order 2 (Theorem 4.4), there is only one choice for  $a$ . Obviously, there are four choices for  $b$ . So, this case yields four more possibilities for  $(a, b)$ .

Thus,  $Z_{100} \oplus Z_{25}$  has 24 elements of order 10. Because each cyclic subgroup of order 10 has four elements of order 10 and no two of the cyclic subgroups can have an element of order 10 in common, there must be  $24/4 = 6$  cyclic subgroups of order 10. (This method is analogous to determining the number of sheep in a flock by counting legs and dividing by 4.) ■

The direct product notation is convenient for specifying certain subgroups of a direct product.

■ **EXAMPLE 7** For each divisor  $r$  of  $m$  and  $s$  of  $n$ , the group  $Z_m \oplus Z_n$  has a subgroup isomorphic to  $Z_r \oplus Z_s$  (see Exercise 19). To find a subgroup of, say,  $Z_{30} \oplus Z_{12}$  isomorphic to  $Z_6 \oplus Z_4$ , we observe that  $\langle 5 \rangle$  is a subgroup of  $Z_{30}$  of order 6 and  $\langle 3 \rangle$  is a subgroup of  $Z_{12}$  of order 4, so  $\langle 5 \rangle \oplus \langle 3 \rangle$  is the desired subgroup. ■

The next theorem and its first corollary characterize those direct products of cyclic groups that are themselves cyclic.

## ■ Theorem 8.2 Criterion for $G \oplus H$ to be Cyclic

*Let  $G$  and  $H$  be finite cyclic groups. Then  $G \oplus H$  is cyclic if and only if  $|G|$  and  $|H|$  are relatively prime.*

**PROOF** Let  $|G| = m$  and  $|H| = n$ , so that  $|G \oplus H| = mn$ . To prove the first half of the theorem, we assume  $G \oplus H$  is cyclic and show that  $m$  and  $n$  are relatively prime. Suppose that  $\gcd(m, n) = d$  and  $(g, h)$  is a generator of  $G \oplus H$ . Since  $(g, h)^{mn/d} = ((g^m)^{n/d}, (h^n)^{m/d}) = (e, e)$ , we have  $mn = |(g, h)| \leq mn/d$ . Thus,  $d = 1$ .

To prove the other half of the theorem, let  $G = \langle g \rangle$  and  $H = \langle h \rangle$  and suppose  $\gcd(m, n) = 1$ . Then,  $|(g, h)| = \text{lcm}(m, n) = mn = |G \oplus H|$ , so that  $(g, h)$  is a generator of  $G \oplus H$ . ■

As a consequence of Theorem 8.2 and an induction argument, we obtain the following extension of Theorem 8.2.

### ■ Corollary 1 Criterion for $G_1 \oplus G_2 \oplus \cdots \oplus G_n$ to Be Cyclic

*An external direct product  $G_1 \oplus G_2 \oplus \cdots \oplus G_n$  of a finite number of finite cyclic groups is cyclic if and only if  $|G_i|$  and  $|G_j|$  are relatively prime when  $i \neq j$ .*

### ■ Corollary 2 Criterion for $Z_{n_1 n_2 \cdots n_k} \approx Z_{n_1} \oplus Z_{n_2} \oplus \cdots \oplus Z_{n_k}$

*Let  $m = n_1 n_2 \cdots n_k$ . Then  $Z_m$  is isomorphic to  $Z_{n_1} \oplus Z_{n_2} \oplus \cdots \oplus Z_{n_k}$  if and only if  $n_i$  and  $n_j$  are relatively prime when  $i \neq j$ .*

By using the results above in an iterative fashion, one can express the same group (up to isomorphism) in many different forms. For example, we have

$$Z_2 \oplus Z_2 \oplus Z_3 \oplus Z_5 \approx Z_2 \oplus Z_6 \oplus Z_5 \approx Z_2 \oplus Z_{30}.$$

Similarly,

$$\begin{aligned} Z_2 \oplus Z_2 \oplus Z_3 \oplus Z_5 &\approx Z_2 \oplus Z_6 \oplus Z_5 \\ &\approx Z_2 \oplus Z_3 \oplus Z_2 \oplus Z_5 \approx Z_6 \oplus Z_{10}. \end{aligned}$$

Thus,  $Z_2 \oplus Z_{30} \approx Z_6 \oplus Z_{10}$ . Note, however, that  $Z_2 \oplus Z_{30} \not\approx Z_{60}$ .

## The Group of Units Modulo $n$ as an External Direct Product

The  $U$ -groups provide a convenient way to illustrate the preceding ideas. We first introduce some notation. If  $k$  is a divisor of  $n$ , let

$$U_k(n) = \{x \in U(n) \mid x \bmod k = 1\}.$$

For example,  $U_7(105) = \{1, 8, 22, 29, 43, 64, 71, 92\}$ . It can be readily shown that  $U_k(n)$  is indeed a subgroup of  $U(n)$ . (See Exercise 17 in Chapter 3.)

### ■ Theorem 8.3 $U(n)$ as an External Direct Product

*Suppose  $s$  and  $t$  are relatively prime. Then  $U(st)$  is isomorphic to the external direct product of  $U(s)$  and  $U(t)$ . In short,*

$$U(st) \approx U(s) \oplus U(t).$$

*Moreover,  $U_s(st)$  is isomorphic to  $U(t)$  and  $U_t(st)$  is isomorphic to  $U(s)$ .*

**PROOF** An isomorphism from  $U(st)$  to  $U(s) \oplus U(t)$  is  $x \rightarrow (x \bmod s, x \bmod t)$ ; an isomorphism from  $U_s(st)$  to  $U(t)$  is  $x \rightarrow x \bmod t$ ; an isomorphism from  $U_t(st)$  to  $U(s)$  is  $x \rightarrow x \bmod s$ . We leave the verification that these mappings are operation-preserving, one-to-one, and onto to the reader. (See Exercises 9, 17, and 19 in Chapter 0; see also [1].) ■

As a consequence of Theorem 8.3, we have the following result.

### Corollary

*Let  $m = n_1 n_2 \cdots n_k$ , where  $\gcd(n_i, n_j) = 1$  for  $i \neq j$ . Then,*

$$U(m) \approx U(n_1) \oplus U(n_2) \oplus \cdots \oplus U(n_k).$$

To see how these results work, let's apply them to  $U(105)$ . We obtain

$$\begin{aligned} U(105) &\approx U(7) \oplus U(15), \\ U(105) &\approx U(21) \oplus U(5), \\ U(105) &\approx U(3) \oplus U(5) \oplus U(7). \end{aligned}$$

Moreover,

$$\begin{aligned} U(7) &\approx U_{15}(105) = \{1, 16, 31, 46, 61, 76\}, \\ U(15) &\approx U_7(105) = \{1, 8, 22, 29, 43, 64, 71, 92\}, \\ U(21) &\approx U_5(105) = \{1, 11, 16, 26, 31, 41, 46, 61, 71, 76, 86, 101\}, \\ U(5) &\approx U_{21}(105) = \{1, 22, 43, 64\}, \\ U(3) &\approx U_{35}(105) = \{1, 71\}. \end{aligned}$$

Since  $|U(20)| = 8$  and  $|U(10) \oplus U(2)| = 4$  we see that the condition that  $\gcd(s, t) = 1$  in Theorem 8.3 is necessary.

Among all groups, surely the cyclic groups  $Z_n$  have the simplest structures and, at the same time, are the easiest groups with which to compute. Direct products of groups of the form  $Z_n$  are only slightly more complicated in structure and computability. Because of this, algebraists endeavor to describe a finite Abelian group as such a direct product. Indeed, we shall soon see that every finite Abelian group can be so represented. With this goal in mind, let us reexamine the  $U$ -groups. Using the corollary to Theorem 8.3 and the facts (see [2, p. 93]), first proved by Carl Gauss in 1801, that

$$U(2) \approx \{0\}, \quad U(4) \approx Z_2, \quad U(2^n) \approx Z_{2^{n-2}} \oplus Z_2 \quad \text{for } n \geq 3,$$

and

$$U(p^n) \approx Z_{p^{n-1}} \quad \text{for } p \text{ an odd prime,}$$

we now can write any  $U$ -group as an external direct product of cyclic groups. For example,

$$\begin{aligned} U(105) &= U(3 \cdot 5 \cdot 7) \approx U(3) \oplus U(5) \oplus U(7) \\ &\approx Z_2 \oplus Z_4 \oplus Z_6 \end{aligned}$$

and

$$\begin{aligned} U(144) &= U(16) \oplus U(9) \\ &\approx Z_4 \oplus Z_2 \oplus Z_6. \end{aligned}$$

What is the advantage of expressing the group  $U(n)$  as an external direct product of groups of the form  $Z_m$ ? Well, for one thing, we immediately see that  $|U(105)| = 2 \cdot 4 \cdot 6 = 48$  and that  $U(105)$  and  $U(144)$  are isomorphic. Another is that from Theorem 8.1 we know that the orders of the elements in  $U(105)$  are 1, 2, 3, 4, 6 and 12. Moreover, arguing as in Examples 5 and 6, we can determine that  $U(105)$  has exactly 16 elements of order 12, say.

These calculations tell us more. Since  $\text{Aut}(Z_{105})$  is isomorphic to  $U(105)$ , we also know that there are 16 automorphisms of  $Z_{105}$  of order 12. Imagine trying to deduce this information directly from  $U(105)$  or, worse yet, from  $\text{Aut}(Z_{105})$ ! These results beautifully illustrate the advantage of being able to represent a finite Abelian group as a direct product of cyclic groups. They also show the value of our theorems about  $\text{Aut}(Z_n)$  and  $U(n)$ . After all, theorems are laborsaving devices. If you want to convince yourself of this, try to prove directly from the definitions that  $\text{Aut}(Z_{105})$  has exactly 16 elements of order 12.

## Applications

We conclude this chapter with five applications of the material presented here—three to cryptography, the science of sending and deciphering secret messages, one to genetics, and one to electric circuits.

### Data Security

Because computers are built from two-state electronic components, it is natural to represent information as strings of 0s and 1s called *binary strings*. A binary string of length  $n$  can naturally be thought of as an element of  $Z_2 \oplus Z_2 \oplus \cdots \oplus Z_2$  ( $n$  copies) where the parentheses and the commas have been deleted. Thus the binary string 11000110 corresponds to the element  $(1, 1, 0, 0, 0, 1, 1, 0)$  in  $Z_2 \oplus Z_2 \oplus Z_2 \oplus Z_2 \oplus Z_2 \oplus Z_2 \oplus Z_2 \oplus Z_2$ . Similarly, two binary strings  $a_1 a_2 \cdots a_n$  and  $b_1 b_2 \cdots b_n$

are added componentwise modulo 2 just as their corresponding elements in  $Z_2 \oplus Z_2 \oplus \cdots \oplus Z_2$  are. For example,

$$11000111 + 01110110 = 10110001$$

and

$$10011100 + 10011100 = 00000000.$$

The fact that the sum of two binary sequences  $a_1a_2 \cdots a_n + b_1b_2 \cdots b_n = 00 \cdots 0$  if and only if the sequences are identical is the basis for a data security system used to protect Internet transactions.

Suppose that you want to purchase a compact disc from <http://www.amazon.com>. Need you be concerned that a hacker will intercept your credit-card number during the transaction? As you might expect, your credit-card number is sent to Amazon in a way that protects the data. We explain one way to send credit-card numbers over the Web securely. When you place an order with Amazon, the company sends your computer a randomly generated string of 0's and 1's called a *key*. This key has the same length as the binary string corresponding to your credit-card number and the two strings are added (think of this process as “locking” the data). The resulting sum is then transmitted to Amazon. Amazon in turn adds the same key to the received string, which then produces the original string corresponding to your credit-card number (adding the key a second time “unlocks” the data).

To illustrate the idea, say you want to send an eight-digit binary string such as  $s = 10101100$  to Amazon (actual credit-card numbers have very long strings) and Amazon sends your computer the key  $k = 00111101$ . Your computer returns the string  $s + k = 10101100 + 00111101 = 10010001$  to Amazon, and Amazon adds  $k$  to this string to get  $10010001 + 00111101 = 10101100$ , which is the string representing your credit-card number. If someone intercepts the number  $s + k = 10010001$  during transmission it is no value without knowing  $k$ .

The method is secure because the key sent by Amazon is randomly generated and used only one time.

## Public Key Cryptography

Unlike auctions such as those on eBay, where each bid is known by everyone, a silent auction is one in which each bid is secret. Suppose that you wanted to use your Twitter account to run a silent auction. How could a scheme be devised so that users could post their bids in such a way that the amounts are intelligible only to the account holder? In the mid-1970s, Ronald Rivest, Adi Shamir, and Leonard Adleman

devised an ingenious method that permits each person who is to receive a secret message to tell publicly how to scramble messages sent to him or her. And even though the method used to scramble the message is known publicly, only the person for whom it is intended will be able to unscramble the message. The idea is based on the fact that there exist efficient methods for finding very large prime numbers (say about 100 digits long) and for multiplying large numbers, but no one knows an efficient algorithm for factoring large integers (say about 200 digits long). The person who is to receive the message chooses a pair of large primes  $p$  and  $q$  and chooses an integer  $e$  (called the *encryption exponent*) with  $1 < e < m$ , where  $m = \text{lcm}(p - 1, q - 1)$ , such that  $e$  is relatively prime to  $m$  (any such  $e$  will do). This person calculates  $n = pq$  ( $n$  is called the *key*) and announces that a message  $M$  is to be sent to him or her publicly as  $M^e \bmod n$ . Although  $e$ ,  $n$ , and  $M^e$  are available to everyone, only the person who knows how to factor  $n$  as  $pq$  will be able to decipher the message.

To present a simple example that nevertheless illustrates the principal features of the method, say we wish to send the messages “YES.” We convert the message into a string of digits by replacing A by 01, B by 02, . . . , Z by 26, and a blank by 00. So, the message YES becomes 250519. To keep the numbers involved from becoming too unwieldy, we send the message in blocks of four digits and fill in with blanks when needed. Thus, the messages YES is represented by the two blocks 2505 and 1900. The person to whom the message is to be sent has picked two primes  $p$  and  $q$ , say  $p = 37$  and  $q = 73$ , and a number  $e$  that has no prime divisors in common with  $\text{lcm}(p - 1, q - 1) = 72$ , say  $e = 5$ , and has published  $n = 37 \cdot 73 = 2701$  and  $e = 5$  in a public forum. We will send the “scrambled” numbers  $(2505)^5 \bmod 2701$  and  $(1900)^5 \bmod 2701$  rather than 2505 and 1900, and the receiver will unscramble them. We show the work involved for us and the receiver only for the block 2505. We determine  $(2505)^5 \bmod 2701 = 2415$  by using a modular arithmetic calculator such as the one at <http://users.wpi.edu/~martin/mod.html>.<sup>†</sup>

Thus, the number 2415 is sent to the receiver. Now the receiver must take this number and convert it back to 2505. To do so, the receiver takes the two factors of 2701,  $p = 37$  and  $q = 73$ , and calculates the least common multiple of  $p - 1 = 36$  and  $q - 1 = 72$ , which is 72. (This is where the knowledge of  $p$  and  $q$  is necessary.) Next, the receiver must find

<sup>†</sup>Provided that the numbers are not too large, the Google search engine at <http://www.google.com> will do modular arithmetic. For example, entering  $2505^2 \bmod 2701$  in the search box yields 602. Be careful, however: Entering  $2505^5 \bmod 2701$  does not return a value, because  $2505^5$  is too large. Instead, we can use Google to compute smaller powers such as  $2505^2 \bmod 2701$  and  $2505^3 \bmod 2701$  (which yields 852) and then enter  $(852 \times 602) \bmod 2701$ .



$e^{-1} = d$  (called the *decryption exponent*) in  $U(72)$ —that is, solve the equation  $5 \cdot d = 1 \pmod{72}$ . This number is 29. See <http://www.d.umn.edu/~jgallian/msproject06/chap8.html#chap8ex5> or use a Google search box to compute  $5^k$  for each divisor  $k$  of  $|U(72)| = \phi(9) \cdot \phi(8) = 24$  starting with 2 until we reach  $5^k \pmod{72} = 1$ . Doing so, we obtain  $5^6 \pmod{72} = 1$ , which implies that  $5^5 \pmod{72} = 29$  is  $5^{-1}$  in  $U(72)$ .

Then the receiver takes the number received, 2415, and calculates  $(2415)^{29} \pmod{2701} = 2505$ , the encoded number. Thus, the receiver correctly determines the code for “YE.” On the other hand, without knowing how  $pq$  factors, one cannot find the modulus (in our case, 72) that is needed to determine the decryption exponent  $d$ .

The procedure just described is called the *RSA public key encryption scheme* in honor of the three people (Rivest, Shamir, and Adleman) who discovered the method. It is widely used in conjunction with web servers and browsers, e-mail programs, remote login sessions, and electronic financial transactions. The algorithm is summarized below.

### Receiver

1. Pick very large primes  $p$  and  $q$  and compute  $n = pq$ .
2. Compute the least common multiple of  $p - 1$  and  $q - 1$ ; let us call it  $m$ .
3. Pick  $e$  relatively prime to  $m$ .
4. Find  $d$  such that  $ed \pmod{m} = 1$ .
5. Publicly announce  $n$  and  $e$ .

### Sender

1. Convert the message to a string of digits.
2. Break up the message into uniform blocks of digits; call them  $M_1, M_2, \dots, M_k$ . (The integer value of each  $M_i$  must be less than  $n$ . In practice,  $n$  is so large that this is not a concern).
3. Check to see that the greatest common divisor of each  $M_i$  and  $n$  is 1. If not,  $n$  can be factored and our code is broken. (In practice, the primes  $p$  and  $q$  are so large that they exceed all  $M_i$ , so this step may be omitted.)
4. Calculate and send  $R_i = M_i^e \pmod{n}$ .

### Receiver

1. For each received message  $R_i$ , calculate  $R_i^d \pmod{n}$ .
2. Convert the string of digits back to a string of characters.

Why does this method work? Well, we know that  $U(n) \approx U(p) \oplus U(q) \approx Z_{p-1} \oplus Z_{q-1}$ . Thus, an element of the form  $x^m$  in  $U(n)$  corresponds under an isomorphism to one of the form  $(mx_1, mx_2)$  in  $Z_{p-1} \oplus Z_{q-1}$ . Since  $m$  is the least common multiple of  $p - 1$  and  $q - 1$ , we may write  $m = s(p - 1)$  and  $m = t(q - 1)$  for some integers  $s$  and  $t$ . Then

$(mx_1, mx_2) = (s(p-1)x_1, t(q-1)x_2) = (0, 0)$  in  $Z_{p-1} \oplus Z_{q-1}$ , and it follows that  $x^m = 1$  for all  $x$  in  $U(n)$ . So, because each message  $M_i$  is an element of  $U(n)$  and  $e$  was chosen so that  $ed = 1 + km$  for some  $k$ , we have, modulo  $n$ ,

$$R_i^d = (M_i^e)^d = M_i^{ed} = M_i^{1+km} = M_i(M_i^m)^k = M_i 1^k = M_i.$$

In 2002, Ronald Rivest, Adi Shamir, and Leonard Adleman received the Association for Computing Machinery A. M. Turing Award, which is considered the “Nobel Prize of computing,” for their contribution to public key cryptography.

An RSA calculator that does all the calculations is provided at <http://www.d.umn.edu/~jgallian/msproject06/chap8.html#chap8ex5>. A list of primes can be found by searching the Web for “list of primes.”

## Digital Signatures

With so many financial transactions now taking place electronically, the problem of authenticity is paramount. How is a stockbroker to know that an electronic message she receives that tells her to sell one stock and buy another actually came from her client? The technique used in public key cryptography allows for digital signatures as well. Let us say that person  $A$  wants to send a secret message to person  $B$  in such a way that only  $B$  can decode the message and  $B$  will know that only  $A$  could have sent it. Abstractly, let  $E_A$  and  $D_A$  denote the algorithms that  $A$  uses for encryption and decryption, respectively, and let  $E_B$  and  $D_B$  denote the algorithms that  $B$  uses for encryption and decryption, respectively. Here we assume that  $E_A$  and  $E_B$  are available to the public, whereas  $D_A$  is known only to  $A$  and  $D_B$  is known only to  $B$ , and that  $D_B E_B$  and  $E_A D_A$  applied to any message leaves the message unchanged. Then  $A$  sends a message  $M$  to  $B$  as  $E_B(D_A(M))$  and  $B$  decodes the received message by applying the function  $E_A D_B$  to it to obtain

$$(E_A D_B)(E_B(D_A(M))) = E_A(D_B E_B)(D_A(M)) = E_A(D_A(M)) = M.$$

Notice that only  $A$  can execute the first step (i.e., create  $D_A(M)$ ) and only  $B$  can implement the last step (i.e., apply  $E_A D_B$  to the received message).

Transactions using digital signatures became legally binding in the United States in October 2000.

## Genetics<sup>†</sup>

The genetic code can be conveniently modeled using elements of  $Z_4 \oplus Z_4 \oplus \cdots \oplus Z_4$ , where we omit the parentheses and the commas and

<sup>†</sup>This discussion is adapted from [3].

just use strings of 0's, 1's, 2's, and 3's and add componentwise modulo 4. A DNA molecule is composed of two long strands in the form of a double helix. Each strand is made up of strings of the four nitrogen bases adenine (A), thymine (T), guanine (G), and cytosine (C). Each base on one strand binds to a complementary base on the other strand. Adenine always is bound to thymine, and guanine always is bound to cytosine. To model this process, we identify A with 0, T with 2, G with 1, and C with 3. Thus, the DNA segment ACGTAACAGGA and its complement segment TGCATTGTCCT are denoted by 03120030110 and 21302212332. Noting that in  $Z_4$ ,  $0 + 2 = 2$ ,  $2 + 2 = 0$ ,  $1 + 2 = 3$ , and  $3 + 2 = 1$ , we see that adding 2 to elements of  $Z_4$  interchanges 0 and 2 and 1 and 3. So, for any DNA segment  $a_1a_2 \cdots a_n$  represented by elements of  $Z_4 \oplus Z_4 \oplus \cdots \oplus Z_4$ , we see that its complementary segment is represented by  $a_1a_2 \cdots a_n + 22 \cdots 2$ .

## Electric Circuits

Many homes have light fixtures that are operated by a pair of switches. They are wired so that when either switch is thrown, the light changes its status (from on to off or vice versa). Suppose the wiring is done so that the light is on when both switches are in the up position. We can conveniently think of the states of the two switches as being matched with the elements of  $Z_2 \oplus Z_2$ , with the two switches in the up position corresponding to  $(0, 0)$  and the two switches in the down position corresponding to  $(1, 1)$ . Each time a switch is thrown, we add 1 to the corresponding component in the group  $Z_2 \oplus Z_2$ . We then see that the lights are on when the switches correspond to the elements of the subgroup  $\langle(1, 1)\rangle$  and are off when the switches correspond to the elements in the coset  $(1, 0) + \langle(1, 1)\rangle$ . A similar analysis applies in the case of three switches, with the subgroup  $\{(0, 0, 0), (1, 1, 0), (0, 1, 1), (1, 0, 1)\}$  corresponding to the lights-on situation.

## Exercises

What's the most difficult aspect of your life as a mathematician, Diane MacLagan, an assistant professor at Rutgers, was asked. "Trying to prove theorems," she said. And the most fun? "Trying to prove theorems."

1. Prove that the external direct product of any finite number of groups is a group. (This exercise is referred to in this chapter.)
2. Prove that  $(1, 1)$  is an element of largest order in  $Z_{n_1} \oplus Z_{n_2}$ . State the general case.

3. Let  $G$  be a group with identity  $e_G$  and let  $H$  be a group with identity  $e_H$ . Prove that  $G$  is isomorphic to  $G \oplus \{e_H\}$  and that  $H$  is isomorphic to  $\{e_G\} \oplus H$ .
4. Show that  $G \oplus H$  is Abelian if and only if  $G$  and  $H$  are Abelian. State the general case.
5. Prove that  $Z \oplus Z$  is not cyclic. Does your proof work for  $Z \oplus G$  where  $G$  is any group with more than one element?
6. Prove, by comparing orders of elements, that  $Z_8 \oplus Z_2$  is not isomorphic to  $Z_4 \oplus Z_4$ .
7. Prove that  $G_1 \oplus G_2$  is isomorphic to  $G_2 \oplus G_1$ . State the general case.
8. Is  $Z_3 \oplus Z_9$  isomorphic to  $Z_{27}$ ? Why?
9. Give an example of a group of order 12 that has more than one subgroup of order 6.
10. How many elements of order 9 does  $Z_3 \oplus Z_9$  have? (Do not do this exercise by brute force.)
11. How many elements of order 4 does  $Z_4 \oplus Z_4$  have? (Do not do this by examining each element.) Explain why  $Z_4 \oplus Z_4$  has the same number of elements of order 4 as does  $Z_{8000000} \oplus Z_{400000}$ . Generalize to the case  $Z_m \oplus Z_n$ .
12. Give examples of four groups of order 12, no two of which are isomorphic. Give reasons why no two are isomorphic.
13. For each integer  $n > 1$ , give examples of two nonisomorphic groups of order  $n^2$ .
14. The dihedral group  $D_n$  of order  $2n$  ( $n \geq 3$ ) has a subgroup of  $n$  rotations and a subgroup of order 2. Explain why  $D_n$  cannot be isomorphic to the external direct product of two such groups.
15. Prove that the group of complex numbers under addition is isomorphic to  $\mathbf{R} \oplus \mathbf{R}$ .
16. Suppose that  $G_1 \approx G_2$  and  $H_1 \approx H_2$ . Prove that  $G_1 \oplus H_1 \approx G_2 \oplus H_2$ . State the general case.
17. If  $G \oplus H$  is cyclic, prove that  $G$  and  $H$  are cyclic. State the general case.
18. Find a cyclic subgroup of  $Z_{40} \oplus Z_{30}$  of order 12 and a non-cyclic subgroup of  $Z_{40} \oplus Z_{30}$  of order 12.
19. If  $r$  is a divisor of  $m$  and  $s$  is a divisor of  $n$ , find a subgroup of  $Z_m \oplus Z_n$  that is isomorphic to  $Z_r \oplus Z_s$ .
20. Find a subgroup of  $Z_{12} \oplus Z_{18}$  that is isomorphic to  $Z_9 \oplus Z_4$ .
21. Let  $G$  and  $H$  be finite groups and  $(g, h) \in G \oplus H$ . State a necessary and sufficient condition for  $\langle (g, h) \rangle = \langle g \rangle \oplus \langle h \rangle$ .
22. Determine the number of elements of order 15 and the number of cyclic subgroups of order 15 in  $Z_{30} \oplus Z_{20}$ .

23. How many subgroups of order 3 are there in  $Z_3 \oplus Z_3$ ? What about  $Z_3 \oplus Z_3 \oplus Z_3$ ? What about  $Z_3 \oplus Z_3 \oplus \cdots \oplus Z_3$  ( $n$  copies)?
24. Let  $m > 2$  be an even integer and let  $n > 2$  be an odd integer. Find a formula for the number of elements of order 2 in  $D_m \oplus D_n$ .
25. Let  $M$  be the group of all real  $2 \times 2$  matrices under addition. Let  $N = \mathbf{R} \oplus \mathbf{R} \oplus \mathbf{R} \oplus \mathbf{R}$  under componentwise addition. Prove that  $M$  and  $N$  are isomorphic. What is the corresponding theorem for the group of  $m \times n$  matrices under addition?
26. The group  $S_3 \oplus Z_2$  is isomorphic to one of the following groups:  $Z_{12}, Z_6 \oplus Z_2, A_4, D_6$ . Determine which one by elimination.
27. Let  $G$  be a group, and let  $H = \{(g, g) \mid g \in G\}$ . Show that  $H$  is a subgroup of  $G \oplus G$ . (This subgroup is called the *diagonal* of  $G \oplus G$ .) When  $G$  is the set of real numbers under addition, describe  $G \oplus G$  and  $H$  geometrically.
28. List six examples of non-Abelian groups of order 24.
29. Find all subgroups of order 3 in  $Z_9 \oplus Z_3$ .
30. Find all subgroups of order 4 in  $Z_4 \oplus Z_4$ .
31. What is the order of the largest cyclic subgroup of  $Z_6 \oplus Z_{10} \oplus Z_{15}$ ? What is the order of the largest cyclic subgroup of  $Z_{n_1} \oplus Z_{n_2} \oplus \cdots \oplus Z_{n_k}$ ?
32. How many elements of order 2 are in  $Z_{2000000} \oplus Z_{4000000}$ ? Generalize.
33. Find a subgroup of  $Z_{800} \oplus Z_{200}$  that is isomorphic to  $Z_2 \oplus Z_4$ .
34. Find a subgroup of  $Z_{12} \oplus Z_4 \oplus Z_{15}$  that has order 9.
35. Prove that  $\mathbf{R}^* \oplus \mathbf{R}^*$  is not isomorphic to  $\mathbf{C}^*$ . (Compare this with Exercise 15.)
36. Let

$$H = \left\{ \left[ \begin{array}{ccc} 1 & a & b \\ 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{array} \right] \mid a, b \in Z_3 \right\}.$$

(See Exercise 46 in Chapter 2 for the definition of multiplication.) Show that  $H$  is an Abelian group of order 9. Is  $H$  isomorphic to  $Z_9$  or to  $Z_3 \oplus Z_3$ ?

37. Let  $G = \{3^m 6^n \mid m, n \in \mathbf{Z}\}$  under multiplication. Prove that  $G$  is isomorphic to  $\mathbf{Z} \oplus \mathbf{Z}$ . Does your proof remain valid if  $G = \{3^m 9^n \mid m, n \in \mathbf{Z}\}$ ?
38. Let  $(a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n) \in G_1 \oplus G_2 \oplus \cdots \oplus G_n$ . Give a necessary and sufficient condition for  $|(a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n)| = \infty$ .
39. Compare the number of elements of each order in  $D_6$  with the number for each order in  $D_3 \oplus Z_2$ .
40. Determine the number of cyclic subgroups of order 15 in  $Z_{90} \oplus Z_{36}$ . Provide a generator for each of the subgroups of order 15.

41. List the elements in the groups  $U_5(35)$  and  $U_7(35)$ .
42. Prove or disprove that  $U(40) \oplus Z_6$  is isomorphic to  $U(72) \oplus Z_4$ .
43. Prove or disprove that  $\mathbf{C}^*$  has a subgroup isomorphic to  $Z_2 \oplus Z_2$ .
44. Let  $G$  be a group isomorphic to  $Z_{n_1} \oplus Z_{n_2} \oplus \cdots \oplus Z_{n_k}$ . Let  $x$  be the product of all elements in  $G$ . Describe all possibilities for  $x$ .
45. If a group has exactly 24 elements of order 6, how many cyclic subgroups of order 6 does it have?
46. Give an example of an infinite group that has both a subgroup isomorphic to  $D_4$  and a subgroup isomorphic to  $A_4$ .
47. Express  $\text{Aut}(U(25))$  in the form  $Z_m \oplus Z_n$ .
48. Determine  $\text{Aut}(Z_2 \oplus Z_2)$ .
49. Suppose that  $n_1, n_2, \dots, n_k$  are positive even integers. How many elements of order 2 does  $Z_{n_1} \oplus Z_{n_2} \oplus \cdots \oplus Z_{n_k}$  have? How many are there if we drop the requirement that  $n_1, n_2, \dots, n_k$  must be even?
50. Is  $Z_{10} \oplus Z_{12} \oplus Z_6 \approx Z_{60} \oplus Z_6 \oplus Z_2$ ? Is  $Z_{10} \oplus Z_{12} \oplus Z_6 \approx Z_{15} \oplus Z_4 \oplus Z_{12}$ ?
51. a. How many isomorphisms are there from  $Z_{18}$  to  $Z_2 \oplus Z_9$ ?  
b. How many isomorphisms are there from  $Z_{18}$  to  $Z_2 \oplus Z_3 \oplus Z_3$ ?
52. Suppose that  $\phi$  is an isomorphism from  $Z_3 \oplus Z_5$  to  $Z_{15}$  and  $\phi(2, 3) = 2$ . Find the element in  $Z_3 \oplus Z_5$  that maps to 1.
53. If  $\phi$  is an isomorphism from  $Z_4 \oplus Z_3$  to  $Z_{12}$ , what is  $\phi(2, 0)$ ? What are the possibilities for  $\phi(1, 0)$ ? Give reasons for your answer.
54. Find a subgroup of  $U(140)$  isomorphic to  $Z_4 \oplus Z_6$ .
55. Let  $(a, b)$  belong to  $Z_m \oplus Z_n$ . Prove that  $\text{lcm}(a, b)$  divides  $\text{lcm}(m, n)$ .
56. Let  $G = \{ax^2 + bx + c \mid a, b, c \in Z_3\}$ . Add elements of  $G$  as you would polynomials with integer coefficients, except use modulo 3 addition. Prove that  $G$  is isomorphic to  $Z_3 \oplus Z_3 \oplus Z_3$ . Generalize.
57. Determine all cyclic groups that have exactly two generators.
58. Explain a way that a string of length  $n$  of the four nitrogen bases A, T, G, and C could be modeled with the external direct product of  $n$  copies of  $Z_2 \oplus Z_2$ .
59. Let  $p$  be a prime. Prove that  $Z_p \oplus Z_p$  has exactly  $p + 1$  subgroups of order  $p$ .
60. Give an example of an infinite non-Abelian group that has exactly six elements of finite order.
61. Give an example to show that there exists a group with elements  $a$  and  $b$  such that  $|a| = \infty$ ,  $|b| = \infty$ , and  $|ab| = 2$ .
62. Express  $U(165)$  as an external direct product of cyclic groups of the form  $Z_n$ .

63. Express  $U(165)$  as an external direct product of  $U$ -groups in four different ways.
64. If  $n$  is an integer at least 3, determine the number of elements of order 2 in  $U(2^n)$ .
65. Without doing any calculations in  $\text{Aut}(Z_{105})$ , determine how many elements of  $\text{Aut}(Z_{105})$  have order 6.
66. Without doing any calculations in  $U(27)$ , decide how many subgroups  $U(27)$  has.
67. What is the largest order of any element in  $U(900)$ ?
68. Let  $p$  and  $q$  be odd primes and let  $m$  and  $n$  be positive integers. Explain why  $U(p^m) \oplus U(q^n)$  is not cyclic.
69. Use the results presented in this chapter to prove that  $U(55)$  is isomorphic to  $U(75)$ .
70. Use the results presented in this chapter to prove that  $U(144)$  is isomorphic to  $U(140)$ .
71. Find a subgroup of order 4 in  $U(1000)$ .
72. Find an integer  $n$  such that  $U(n)$  is isomorphic to  $Z_2 \oplus Z_4 \oplus Z_9$ .
73. What is the smallest positive integer  $k$  such that  $x^k = e$  for all  $x$  in  $U(7 \cdot 17)$ ? Generalize to  $U(pq)$  where  $p$  and  $q$  are distinct primes.
74. Prove that  $U_{50}(200)$  is not isomorphic to  $U(4)$ . Why does this not contradict Theorem 8.3?
75. Prove or disprove:  $U(200) \approx U(50) \oplus U(4)$ .
76. Find the smallest positive integer  $n$  such that  $x^n = 1$  for all  $x$  in  $U(100)$ . Show your reasoning.
77. Which of the following groups are cyclic?
  - a.  $U(35)$
  - b.  $U_5(40)$
  - c.  $U_8(40)$
78. Let  $p_1, p_2, \dots, p_k$  be distinct odd primes and  $n_1, n_2, \dots, n_k$  be positive integers. Determine the number of elements of order 2 in  $U(p_1^{n_1} p_2^{n_2} \dots p_k^{n_k})$ . How many are there in  $U(2^n p_1^{n_1} p_2^{n_2} \dots p_k^{n_k})$  where  $n$  is at least 3?
79. Using the RSA scheme with  $p = 37$ ,  $q = 73$ ,  $e = 5$ , and replacing the letters A, B, ..., Z by 01, 02, ..., 26, what number would be sent for the message "RL"?
80. Assuming that a message has been sent via the RSA scheme with  $p = 37$ ,  $q = 73$ , and  $e = 5$ , decode the received message "34."
81. Explain why the message YES cannot be sent using RSA scheme with  $p = 31$  and  $q = 73$  using blocks of length 4.

## Computer Exercises

Computer exercises in this chapter are available at the website:

<http://www.d.umn.edu/~jgallian>

## References

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3. S. Washburn, T. Marlowe, and C. Ryan, *Discrete Mathematics*, Reading, MA: Addison-Wesley, 1999.

## Suggested Readings

Y. Cheng, "Decompositions of  $U$ -Groups," *Mathematics Magazine* 62 (1989): 271–273.

This article explores the decomposition of  $U(st)$ , where  $s$  and  $t$  are relatively prime, in greater detail than we have provided.

David J. Devries, "The Group of Units in  $Z_m$ ," *Mathematics Magazine* 62 (1989): 340–342.

This article provides a simple proof that  $U(n)$  is not cyclic when  $n$  is not of the form 1, 2, 4,  $p^k$ , or  $2p^k$ , where  $p$  is an odd prime.

David R. Guichard, "When Is  $U(n)$  Cyclic? An Algebraic Approach," *Mathematics Magazine* 72 (1999): 139–142.

The author provides a group theoretic proof of the fact that  $U(n)$  is cyclic if and only if  $n$  is 1, 2, 4,  $p^k$ , or  $2p^k$ , where  $p$  is an odd prime.

Markku Niemenmaa, "A Check Digit System for Hexadecimal Numbers," *Applicable Algebra in Engineering, Communication, and Computing* 22 (2011): 109–112.

This article provides a new check-digit system for hexadecimal numbers that is based on the use of a suitable automorphism of the group  $Z_2 \oplus Z_2 \oplus Z_2 \oplus Z_2$ . It is able to detect all single errors, adjacent transpositions, twin errors, jump transpositions, and jump twin errors.



# Leonard Adleman

“For their ingenious contribution for making public-key cryptography useful in practice.”

*Citation for the ACM A. M. Turing Award*

LEONARD ADLEMAN was born on December 31, 1945 in San Francisco, California. He received a B.A. degree in mathematics in 1968 and a Ph.D. degree in computer science in 1976 from the University of California, Berkeley. He spent 1976–1980 as professor of mathematics at the Massachusetts Institute of Technology where he met Ronald Rivest and Adi Shamir. Rivest and Shamir were attempting to devise a secure public key cryptosystem and asked Adleman if he could break their codes. Eventually, they invented what is now known as the RSA code that was simple to implement yet secure.

In 1983, Adleman, Shamir, and Rivest formed the RSA Data Security company to license their algorithm. Their algorithm has become the primary cryptosystem used for security on the World Wide Web. They sold their company for \$200 million in 1996.

In the early 1990s, Adleman became interested in trying to find out a way to use DNA as a computer. His pioneering work on this problem led to the field now called “DNA computing.”

Among his many honors are: the Association for Computing Machinery



Photograph of Leonard Adleman

A. M. Turing Award, the Kanallakis Award for Theory and Practice, and election to the National Academy of Engineering, the American Academy of Arts and Sciences, and the National Academy of Sciences.

Adleman’s current position is the Henry Salvatori Distinguished Chair in Computer Science and Professor of Computer Science and Biological Sciences at the University of Southern California, where he has been since 1980.

For more information on Adleman, visit:

**<http://www.wikipedia.com>**

and

**<http://www.nytimes.com/1994/12/13/science/scientist-at-work-leonard-adleman-hitting-the-high-spots-of-computer-theory.html>**

# 9

## Normal Subgroups and Factor Groups

It is tribute to the genius of Galois that he recognized that those subgroups for which the left and right cosets coincide are distinguished ones. Very often in mathematics the crucial problem is to recognize and to discover what are the relevant concepts; once this is accomplished the job may be more than half done.

I. N. Herstein, *Topics in Algebra*

[On the concept of 'group':] ... what a wealth, what a grandeur of thought may spring from what slight beginnings.

H. F. Baker

### Normal Subgroups

As we saw in Chapter 7, if  $G$  is a group and  $H$  is a subgroup of  $G$ , it is not always true that  $aH = Ha$  for all  $a$  in  $G$ . There are certain situations where this does hold, however, and these cases turn out to be of critical importance in the theory of groups. It was Galois, about 185 years ago, who first recognized that such subgroups were worthy of special attention.

#### **Definition** Normal Subgroup

A subgroup  $H$  of a group  $G$  is called a *normal* subgroup of  $G$  if  $aH = Ha$  for all  $a$  in  $G$ . We denote this by  $H \triangleleft G$ .

You should think of a normal subgroup in this way: You can switch the order of a product of an element  $a$  from the group and an element  $h$  from the normal subgroup  $H$ , but you must “fudge” a bit on the element from the normal subgroup  $H$  by using some  $h'$  from  $H$  rather than  $h$ . That is, there is an element  $h'$  in  $H$  such that  $ah = h'a$ . Likewise, there is some  $h''$  in  $H$  such that  $ha = ah''$ . (It is possible that  $h' = h$  or  $h'' = h$ , but we may not assume this.)

There are several equivalent formulations of the definition of normality. We have chosen the one that is the easiest to use in applications. However, to *verify* that a subgroup is normal, it is usually better to use Theorem 9.1, which is a weaker version of property 8 of the lemma in Chapter 7. It allows us to substitute a condition about two subgroups of  $G$  for a condition about two cosets of  $G$ .

### ■ Theorem 9.1 Normal Subgroup Test

*A subgroup  $H$  of  $G$  is **normal** in  $G$  if and only if  $xHx^{-1} \subseteq H$  for all  $x$  in  $G$ .*

**PROOF** If  $H$  is normal in  $G$ , then for any  $x \in G$  and  $h \in H$  there is an  $h'$  in  $H$  such that  $xh = h'x$ . Thus,  $xhx^{-1} = h'$ , and therefore  $xHx^{-1} \subseteq H$ .

Conversely, if  $xHx^{-1} \subseteq H$  for all  $x$ , then, letting  $x = a$ , we have  $aHa^{-1} \subseteq H$  or  $aH \subseteq Ha$ . On the other hand, letting  $x = a^{-1}$ , we have  $a^{-1}H(a^{-1})^{-1} = a^{-1}Ha \subseteq H$  or  $Ha \subseteq aH$ . ■

■ **EXAMPLE 1** Every subgroup of an Abelian group is normal. (In this case,  $ah = ha$  for  $a$  in the group and  $h$  in the subgroup.) ■

■ **EXAMPLE 2** The center  $Z(G)$  of a group is always normal. [Again,  $ah = ha$  for any  $a \in G$  and any  $h \in Z(G)$ .] ■

■ **EXAMPLE 3** The alternating group  $A_n$  of even permutations is a normal subgroup of  $S_n$ . [Note, for example, that for  $(12) \in S_n$  and  $(123) \in A_n$ , we have  $(12)(123) \neq (123)(12)$  but  $(12)(123) = (132)(12)$  and  $(132) \in A_n$ .] ■

■ **EXAMPLE 4** Every subgroup of  $D_n$  consisting solely of rotations is normal in  $D_n$ . (For any rotation  $R$  and any reflection  $F$ , we have  $FR = R^{-1}F$  and any two rotations commute.) ■

The next example illustrates a way to use a normal subgroup to create new subgroups from existing ones.

■ **EXAMPLE 5** Let  $H$  be a normal subgroup of a group  $G$  and  $K$  be any subgroup of  $G$ . Then  $HK = \{hk \mid h \in H, k \in K\}$  is a subgroup of  $G$ . To verify this, note that  $e = ee$  is in  $HK$ . Then for any  $a = h_1k_1$  and  $b = h_2k_2$ , where  $h_1, h_2$  are in  $H$  and  $k_1, k_2$  are in  $K$ , there is an element  $h'$  in  $H$  such that  $ab^{-1} = h_1k_1k_2^{-1}h_2^{-1} = h_1(k_1k_2^{-1})h_2^{-1} = (h_1h')(k_1k_2^{-1})$ . So,  $ab^{-1}$  is in  $HK$ . ■

Be careful not to assume that for any subgroups  $H$  and  $K$  of a group  $G$ , the set  $HK$  is a subgroup of  $G$ . See Exercise 57.

Combining Examples 4 and 5, we form a non-Abelian subgroup of  $D_8$  of order 8.

■ **EXAMPLE 6** In  $D_8$ , let  $H = \{R_0, R_{90}, R_{180}, R_{270}\}$  and  $K = \{R_0, F\}$ , where  $F$  is any reflection. Then  $HK = \{R_0, R_{90}, R_{180}, R_{270}, R_0F, R_{90}F, R_{180}F, R_{270}F\}$  is a subgroup of  $D_8$ . ■

■ **EXAMPLE 7** If a group  $G$  has a unique subgroup  $H$  of some finite order, then  $H$  is normal in  $G$ . To see that this is so, observe that for any  $g \in G$ ,  $gHg^{-1}$  is a subgroup of  $G$  and  $|gHg^{-1}| = |H|$ . ■

■ **EXAMPLE 8** The group  $SL(2, \mathbf{R})$  of  $2 \times 2$  matrices with determinant 1 is a normal subgroup of  $GL(2, \mathbf{R})$ , the group of  $2 \times 2$  matrices with nonzero determinant. To verify this, we use the Normal Subgroup Test given in Theorem 9.1. Let  $x \in GL(2, \mathbf{R}) = G$ ,  $h \in SL(2, \mathbf{R}) = H$ , and note that  $\det xhx^{-1} = (\det x)(\det h)(\det x)^{-1} = (\det x)(\det x)^{-1} = 1$ . So,  $xhx^{-1} \in H$ , and, therefore,  $xHx^{-1} \subseteq H$ . ■

■ **EXAMPLE 9** Referring to the group table for  $A_4$  given in Table 5.1 on page 105, we may observe that  $H = \{\alpha_1, \alpha_2, \alpha_3, \alpha_4\}$  is a normal subgroup of  $A_4$ , whereas  $K = \{\alpha_1, \alpha_5, \alpha_9\}$  is *not* a normal subgroup of  $A_4$ . To see that  $H$  is normal, simply note that for any  $\beta$  in  $A_4$ ,  $\beta H \beta^{-1}$  is a subgroup of order 4 and  $H$  is the only subgroup of  $A_4$  of order 4 (see Table 5.1). Thus,  $\beta H \beta^{-1} = H$ . In contrast,  $\alpha_2 \alpha_5 \alpha_2^{-1} = \alpha_7$ , so that  $\alpha_2 K \alpha_2^{-1} \not\subseteq K$ . ■

## Factor Groups

We have yet to explain why normal subgroups are of special significance. The reason is simple. When the subgroup  $H$  of  $G$  is normal, then the set of left (or right) cosets of  $H$  in  $G$  is itself a group—called the **factor group of  $G$  by  $H$**  (or the **quotient group of  $G$  by  $H$** ). Quite often, one can obtain information about a group by studying one of its factor groups. This method will be illustrated in the next section of this chapter.

### ■ Theorem 9.2 Factor Groups (O. Hölder, 1889)

*Let  $G$  be a group and let  $H$  be a normal subgroup of  $G$ . The set  $G/H = \{aH \mid a \in G\}$  is a group under the operation  $(aH)(bH) = abH$ .<sup>†</sup>*

<sup>†</sup>The notation  $G/H$  was first used by C. Jordan.

**PROOF** Our first task is to show that the operation is well-defined; that is, we must show that the correspondence defined above from  $G/H \times G/H$  into  $G/H$  is actually a function. To do this, we assume that for some elements  $a, a', b$ , and  $b'$  from  $G$ , we have  $aH = a'H$  and  $bH = b'H$ , and verify that  $aHbH = a'Hb'H$ . That is, verify that  $abH = a'b'H$ . (This shows that the definition of multiplication depends on only the cosets and not on the coset representatives.) From  $aH = a'H$  and  $bH = b'H$ , we have  $a' = ah_1$  and  $b' = bh_2$  for some  $h_1, h_2$  in  $H$ , and therefore  $a'b'H = ah_1bh_2H = ah_1bH = ah_1Hb = aHb = abH$ . Here we have made multiple use of associativity, property 2 of the lemma in Chapter 7, and the fact that  $H \triangleleft G$ . The rest is easy:  $eH = H$  is the identity;  $a^{-1}H$  is the inverse of  $aH$ ; and  $(aHbH)cH = (ab)HcH = (ab)cH = a(bc)H = aH(bc)H = aH(bHcH)$ . This proves that  $G/H$  is a group. ■

Notice that the normality of  $H$  in  $G$  assures that the product of two left cosets  $aH$  and  $bH$  is a left coset of  $H$  in  $G$ , and since  $aHbH$  contains  $ab$ , the product is  $abH$ .

Although it is merely a curiosity, we point out that the converse of Theorem 9.2 is also true; that is, if the correspondence  $aHbH = abH$  defines a group operation on the set of left cosets of  $H$  in  $G$ , then  $H$  is normal in  $G$ . See Exercises 39 and 40.

The next few examples illustrate the factor group concept.

■ **EXAMPLE 10** Let  $4\mathbb{Z} = \{0, \pm 4, \pm 8, \dots\}$ . To construct  $\mathbb{Z}/4\mathbb{Z}$ , we first must determine the left cosets of  $4\mathbb{Z}$  in  $\mathbb{Z}$ . Consider the following four cosets:

$$\begin{aligned} 0 + 4\mathbb{Z} &= 4\mathbb{Z} = \{0, \pm 4, \pm 8, \dots\}, \\ 1 + 4\mathbb{Z} &= \{1, 5, 9, \dots; -3, -7, -11, \dots\}, \\ 2 + 4\mathbb{Z} &= \{2, 6, 10, \dots; -2, -6, -10, \dots\}, \\ 3 + 4\mathbb{Z} &= \{3, 7, 11, \dots; -1, -5, -9, \dots\}. \end{aligned}$$

We claim that there are no others. For if  $k \in \mathbb{Z}$ , then  $k = 4q + r$ , where  $0 \leq r < 4$ ; and, therefore,  $k + 4\mathbb{Z} = r + 4q + 4\mathbb{Z} = r + 4\mathbb{Z}$ . Now that we know the elements of the factor group, our next job is to determine the structure of  $\mathbb{Z}/4\mathbb{Z}$ . Its Cayley table is

|                   | $0 + 4\mathbb{Z}$ | $1 + 4\mathbb{Z}$ | $2 + 4\mathbb{Z}$ | $3 + 4\mathbb{Z}$ |
|-------------------|-------------------|-------------------|-------------------|-------------------|
| $0 + 4\mathbb{Z}$ | $0 + 4\mathbb{Z}$ | $1 + 4\mathbb{Z}$ | $2 + 4\mathbb{Z}$ | $3 + 4\mathbb{Z}$ |
| $1 + 4\mathbb{Z}$ | $1 + 4\mathbb{Z}$ | $2 + 4\mathbb{Z}$ | $3 + 4\mathbb{Z}$ | $0 + 4\mathbb{Z}$ |
| $2 + 4\mathbb{Z}$ | $2 + 4\mathbb{Z}$ | $3 + 4\mathbb{Z}$ | $0 + 4\mathbb{Z}$ | $1 + 4\mathbb{Z}$ |
| $3 + 4\mathbb{Z}$ | $3 + 4\mathbb{Z}$ | $0 + 4\mathbb{Z}$ | $1 + 4\mathbb{Z}$ | $2 + 4\mathbb{Z}$ |

Clearly, then,  $\mathbb{Z}/4\mathbb{Z} \approx \mathbb{Z}_4$ . More generally, if for any  $n > 0$  we let  $n\mathbb{Z} = \{0, \pm n, \pm 2n, \pm 3n, \dots\}$ , then  $\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z}$  is isomorphic to  $\mathbb{Z}_n$ . ■

■ **EXAMPLE 11** Let  $G = Z_{18}$  and let  $H = \langle 6 \rangle = \{0, 6, 12\}$ . Then  $G/H = \{0 + H, 1 + H, 2 + H, 3 + H, 4 + H, 5 + H\}$ . To illustrate how the group elements are combined, consider  $(5 + H) + (4 + H)$ . This should be one of the six elements listed in the set  $G/H$ . Well,  $(5 + H) + (4 + H) = 5 + 4 + H = 9 + H = 3 + 6 + H = 3 + H$ , since  $H$  absorbs all multiples of 6. ■

A few words of caution about notation are warranted here. When  $H$  is a normal subgroup of  $G$ , the expression  $|aH|$  has two possible interpretations. One could be thinking of  $aH$  as a *set* of elements and  $|aH|$  as the size of the set; or, as is more often the case, one could be thinking of  $aH$  as a group element of the factor group  $G/H$  and  $|aH|$  as the order of the *element*  $aH$  in  $G/H$ . In Example 11, for instance, the *set*  $3 + H$  has size 3, since  $3 + H = \{3, 9, 15\}$ . But the *group element*  $3 + H$  has order 2, since  $(3 + H) + (3 + H) = 6 + H = 0 + H$ . As is usually the case when one notation has more than one meaning, the appropriate interpretation will be clear from the context.

■ **EXAMPLE 12** Let  $\mathcal{K} = \{R_0, R_{180}\}$ , and consider the factor group of the dihedral group  $D_4$  (see the back inside cover for the multiplication table for  $D_4$ )

$$D_4/\mathcal{K} = \{\mathcal{K}, R_{90}\mathcal{K}, H\mathcal{K}, D\mathcal{K}\}.$$

The multiplication table for  $D_4/\mathcal{K}$  is given in Table 9.1. (Notice that even though  $R_{90}H = D'$ , we have used  $D\mathcal{K}$  in Table 9.1 for  $R_{90}\mathcal{K}H\mathcal{K}$  because  $D'\mathcal{K} = D\mathcal{K}$ .)

**Table 9.1**

|                     | $\mathcal{K}$       | $R_{90}\mathcal{K}$ | $H\mathcal{K}$      | $D\mathcal{K}$      |
|---------------------|---------------------|---------------------|---------------------|---------------------|
| $\mathcal{K}$       | $\mathcal{K}$       | $R_{90}\mathcal{K}$ | $H\mathcal{K}$      | $D\mathcal{K}$      |
| $R_{90}\mathcal{K}$ | $R_{90}\mathcal{K}$ | $\mathcal{K}$       | $D\mathcal{K}$      | $H\mathcal{K}$      |
| $H\mathcal{K}$      | $H\mathcal{K}$      | $D\mathcal{K}$      | $\mathcal{K}$       | $R_{90}\mathcal{K}$ |
| $D\mathcal{K}$      | $D\mathcal{K}$      | $H\mathcal{K}$      | $R_{90}\mathcal{K}$ | $\mathcal{K}$       |

$D_4/\mathcal{K}$  provides a good opportunity to demonstrate how a factor group of  $G$  is related to  $G$  itself. Suppose we arrange the heading of the Cayley table for  $D_4$  in such a way that elements from the same coset of  $\mathcal{K}$  are in adjacent columns (Table 9.2). Then, the multiplication table for  $D_4$  can be blocked off into boxes that are cosets of  $\mathcal{K}$ , and the substitution that replaces a box containing the element  $x$  with the coset  $x\mathcal{K}$  yields the Cayley table for  $D_4/\mathcal{K}$ .

For example, when we pass from  $D_4$  to  $D_4/\mathcal{H}$ , the box

$$\begin{array}{|c|c|} \hline H & V \\ \hline V & H \\ \hline \end{array}$$

in Table 9.2 becomes the element  $H\mathcal{H}$  in Table 9.1. Similarly, the box

$$\begin{array}{|c|c|} \hline D & D' \\ \hline D' & D \\ \hline \end{array}$$

becomes the element  $D\mathcal{H}$ , and so on.

**Table 9.2**

|           | $R_0$     | $R_{180}$ | $R_{90}$  | $R_{270}$ | $H$       | $V$       | $D$       | $D'$      |
|-----------|-----------|-----------|-----------|-----------|-----------|-----------|-----------|-----------|
| $R_0$     | $R_0$     | $R_{180}$ | $R_{90}$  | $R_{270}$ | $H$       | $V$       | $D$       | $D'$      |
| $R_{180}$ | $R_{180}$ | $R_0$     | $R_{270}$ | $R_{90}$  | $V$       | $H$       | $D'$      | $D$       |
| $R_{90}$  | $R_{90}$  | $R_{270}$ | $R_{180}$ | $R_0$     | $D'$      | $D$       | $H$       | $V$       |
| $R_{270}$ | $R_{270}$ | $R_{90}$  | $R_0$     | $R_{180}$ | $D$       | $D'$      | $V$       | $H$       |
| $H$       | $H$       | $V$       | $D$       | $D'$      | $R_0$     | $R_{180}$ | $R_{90}$  | $R_{270}$ |
| $V$       | $V$       | $H$       | $D'$      | $D$       | $R_{180}$ | $R_0$     | $R_{270}$ | $R_{90}$  |
| $D$       | $D$       | $D'$      | $V$       | $H$       | $R_{270}$ | $R_{90}$  | $R_0$     | $R_{180}$ |
| $D'$      | $D'$      | $D$       | $H$       | $V$       | $R_{90}$  | $R_{270}$ | $R_{180}$ | $R_0$     |

■

In this way, one can see that the formation of a factor group  $G/H$  causes a systematic collapse of the elements of  $G$ . In particular, all the elements in the coset of  $H$  containing  $a$  collapse to the single group element  $aH$  in  $G/H$ .

In Chapter 11, we will prove that every finite Abelian group is isomorphic to a direct product of cyclic groups. In particular, an Abelian group of order 8 is isomorphic to one of  $Z_8$ ,  $Z_4 \oplus Z_2$ , or  $Z_2 \oplus Z_2 \oplus Z_2$ . In the next two examples, we examine Abelian factor groups of order 8 and determine the isomorphism type of each.

■ **EXAMPLE 13** Let  $G = U(32) = \{1, 3, 5, 7, 9, 11, 13, 15, 17, 19, 21, 23, 25, 27, 29, 31\}$  and  $H = U_{16}(32) = \{1, 17\}$ . Then  $G/H$  is an Abelian group of order  $16/2 = 8$ . Which of the three Abelian groups of order 8 is it— $Z_8$ ,  $Z_4 \oplus Z_2$ , or  $Z_2 \oplus Z_2 \oplus Z_2$ ? To answer this question, we need only determine the elements of  $G/H$  and their orders. Observe that the eight cosets

$$\begin{aligned} 1H &= \{1, 17\}, & 3H &= \{3, 19\}, & 5H &= \{5, 21\}, & 7H &= \{7, 23\}, \\ 9H &= \{9, 25\}, & 11H &= \{11, 27\}, & 13H &= \{13, 29\}, & 15H &= \{15, 31\} \end{aligned}$$

are all distinct, so that they form the factor group  $G/H$ . Clearly,  $(3H)^2 = 9H \neq H$ , and so  $3H$  has order at least 4. Thus,  $G/H$  is not  $Z_2 \oplus Z_2 \oplus Z_2$ . On the other hand, direct computations show that both  $7H$  and  $9H$  have order 2, so that  $G/H$  cannot be  $Z_8$  either, since a cyclic group of even order has exactly one element of order 2 (Theorem 4.4). This proves that  $U(32)/U_{16}(32) \approx Z_4 \oplus Z_2$ , which (not so incidentally!) is isomorphic to  $U(16)$ . ■

■ **EXAMPLE 14** Let  $G = Z_8 \oplus Z_4$  and let  $H = \langle (2, 2) \rangle$  of  $G$ . Given that  $G/H$  is isomorphic to one of  $Z_8, Z_4 \oplus Z_2, Z_2 \oplus Z_2 \oplus Z_2$ , we can determine which one by elimination. First note that  $H = \{(0, 0), (2, 2)(4, 0), (6, 2)\}$ . Thus for any  $(a, b) + H$  we have  $((a, b) + H)^4 = (4a, 4b) + H = (4, 0) + H$  if  $a$  is odd and  $(0, 0) + H$  if  $a$  is even. Since  $H$  contains both  $(0, 0)$  and  $(4, 0)$  we have that  $((a, b) + H)^4 = (4a, 4b) + H = H$ . Thus the maximum order of any element in  $G/H$  is 4. Since  $((1, 0) + H)^2 = (2, 0) + H \neq H$  we know that  $|(1, 0) + H| = 4$ . Thus we have eliminated both  $Z_8$  and  $Z_2 \oplus Z_2 \oplus Z_2$ . ■

It is crucial to understand that when we factor out by a normal subgroup  $H$ , what we are essentially doing is defining every element in  $H$  to be the *identity*. Thus, in Example 12, we are making  $R_{180}\mathcal{K} = \mathcal{K}$  the identity. Likewise,  $R_{270}\mathcal{K} = R_{90}R_{180}\mathcal{K} = R_{90}\mathcal{K}$ . Similarly, in Example 10, we are declaring any multiple of 4 to be 0 in the factor group  $Z/4Z$ . This is why  $5 + 4Z = 1 + 4 + 4Z = 1 + 4Z$ , and so on. In Example 13, we have  $3H = 19H$ , since  $19 = 3 \cdot 17$  in  $U(32)$  and going to the factor group makes 17 the identity. Algebraists often refer to the process of creating the factor group  $G/H$  as “killing”  $H$ .

## Applications of Factor Groups

The next three theorems illustrate how knowledge of a factor group of  $G$  reveals information about  $G$  itself.

A natural consequence of the fact that the operation for a factor group  $G/H$  is inherited from the operation in  $G$  is that many properties of  $G$  are inherited by  $G/H$  and many properties of  $G$  can be deduced from properties of  $G/H$ . The importance of factor groups is that the structure of  $G/H$  is usually less complicated than that of  $G$  and yet  $G/H$  simulates  $G$  in many ways. Indeed, we may think of  $G/H$  as a less complicated approximation of  $G$  (similar to using the rational number 3.14 as an approximation of the irrational number  $\pi$ .) A number of the relationships between a group and its factor groups are given in the exercises.



### ■ Theorem 9.3 $G/Z$ Theorem

*Let  $G$  be a group and let  $Z(G)$  be the center of  $G$ . If  $G/Z(G)$  is cyclic, then  $G$  is Abelian.*

**PROOF** Since  $G$  is Abelian is equivalent to  $Z(G) = G$ , it suffices to show that the only element of  $G/Z(G)$  is the identity coset  $Z(G)$ . To this end, let  $G/Z(G) = \langle gZ(G) \rangle$  and let  $a \in G$ . Then there exists an integer  $i$  such that  $aZ(G) = (gZ(G))^i = g^iZ(G)$ . Thus,  $a = g^iz$  for some  $z$  in  $Z(G)$ . Since both  $g^i$  and  $z$  belong to  $C(g)$ , so does  $a$ . Because  $a$  is an arbitrary element of  $G$  this means that every element of  $G$  commutes with  $g$  so  $g \in Z(G)$ . Thus,  $gZ(G) = Z(G)$  is the only element of  $G/Z(G)$ . ■

A few remarks about Theorem 9.3 are in order. First, our proof shows that a better result is possible: If  $G/H$  is cyclic, where  $H$  is a subgroup of  $Z(G)$ , then  $G$  is Abelian. Second, in practice, it is the contrapositive of the theorem that is most often used—that is, if  $G$  is non-Abelian, then  $G/Z(G)$  is not cyclic. For example, it follows immediately from this statement and Lagrange's Theorem that a non-Abelian group of order  $pq$ , where  $p$  and  $q$  are primes, must have a trivial center. Third, if  $G/Z(G)$  is cyclic, it must be trivial.

The next example demonstrates how one can find a subgroup of a group  $G$  by “pulling back” a subgroup of a factor group of  $G$ .

■ **EXAMPLE 15** Let  $H$  be a normal subgroup of a group  $G$  and let  $\bar{K}$  be a subgroup of the factor group  $G/H$ . Then the set  $K$  consisting of the union of all elements in the cosets of  $H$  in  $\bar{K}$  is a subgroup of  $G$ . To verify that  $K$  is a subgroup of  $G$  let  $a$  and  $b$  belong to  $K$  ( $K$  is nonempty because it contains  $H$ ). Since  $a$  and  $b$  are in  $K$  the cosets  $aH$  and  $bH$  are in  $\bar{K}$  and  $aH(bH)^{-1} = aHb^{-1}H = ab^{-1}H$  is also a coset in  $\bar{K}$ . Thus,  $ab^{-1}$  belongs to  $K$ . Note that when  $G$  is finite  $|K| = |\bar{K}| |H|$ . ■

### ■ Theorem 9.4 $G/Z(G) \approx \text{Inn}(G)$

*For any group  $G$ ,  $G/Z(G)$  is isomorphic to  $\text{Inn}(G)$ .*

**PROOF** Consider the correspondence from  $G/Z(G)$  to  $\text{Inn}(G)$  given by  $T: gZ(G) \rightarrow \phi_g$  [where, recall,  $\phi_g(x) = gxg^{-1}$  for all  $x$  in  $G$ ]. First, we show that  $T$  is well defined. To do this, we assume that  $gZ(G) = hZ(G)$  and verify that  $\phi_g = \phi_h$ . (This shows that the image of a coset of  $Z(G)$  depends only on the coset itself and not on the element

representing the coset.) From  $gZ(G) = hZ(G)$ , we have that  $h^{-1}g$  belongs to  $Z(G)$ . Then, for all  $x$  in  $G$ ,  $h^{-1}gx = xh^{-1}g$ . Thus,  $gxg^{-1} = h x h^{-1}$  for all  $x$  in  $G$ , and, therefore,  $\phi_g = \phi_h$ . Reversing this argument shows that  $T$  is one-to-one, as well. Clearly,  $T$  is onto.

That  $T$  is operation-preserving follows directly from the fact that  $\phi_g \phi_h = \phi_{gh}$  for all  $g$  and  $h$  in  $G$ . ■

As an application of Theorems 9.3 and 9.4, we may easily determine  $\text{Inn}(D_6)$  without looking at  $\text{Inn}(D_6)$ !

■ **EXAMPLE 16** We know from Example 14 in Chapter 3 that  $|Z(D_6)| = 2$ . Thus,  $|D_6/Z(D_6)| = 6$ . So, by our classification of groups of order 6 (Theorem 7.3), we know that  $\text{Inn}(D_6)$  is isomorphic to  $D_3$  or  $Z_6$ . Now, if  $\text{Inn}(D_6)$  were cyclic, then, by Theorem 9.4,  $D_6/Z(D_6)$  would be also. But then, Theorem 9.3 would tell us that  $D_6$  is Abelian. So,  $\text{Inn}(D_6)$  is isomorphic to  $D_3$ . ■

The next theorem demonstrates one of the most powerful proof techniques available in the theory of finite groups—the combined use of factor groups and induction.

### ■ Theorem 9.5 Cauchy's Theorem for Abelian Groups

*Let  $G$  be a finite Abelian group and let  $p$  be a prime that divides the order of  $G$ . Then  $G$  has an element of order  $p$ .*

**PROOF** Clearly, this statement is true for the case in which  $G$  has order 2. We prove the theorem by using the Second Principle of Mathematical Induction on  $|G|$ . That is, we assume that the statement is true for all Abelian groups with fewer elements than  $G$  and use this assumption to show that the statement is true for  $G$  as well. Certainly,  $G$  has elements of prime order, for if  $|x| = m$  and  $m = qn$ , where  $q$  is prime, then  $|x^n| = q$ . So let  $x$  be an element of  $G$  of some prime order  $q$ , say. If  $q = p$ , we are finished; so assume that  $q \neq p$ . Since every subgroup of an Abelian group is normal, we may construct the factor group  $\overline{G} = G/\langle x \rangle$ . Then  $\overline{G}$  is Abelian and  $p$  divides  $|\overline{G}|$ , since  $|\overline{G}| = |G|/q$ . By induction, then,  $\overline{G}$  has an element—call it  $y\langle x \rangle$ —of order  $p$ .

Then,  $(y\langle x \rangle)^p = y^p\langle x \rangle = \langle x \rangle$  and therefore  $y^p \in \langle x \rangle$ . If  $y^p = e$ , we are done. If not, then  $y^p$  has order  $q$  and  $y^q$  has order  $p$ . ■

## Internal Direct Products

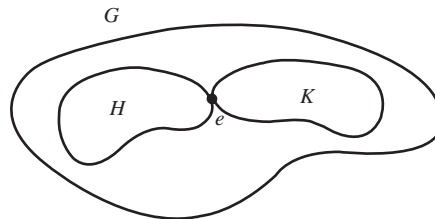
As we have seen, the external direct product provides a method of putting groups together to get a larger group in such a way that we can determine many properties of the larger group from the properties of the component pieces. For example: If  $G = H \oplus K$ , then  $|G| = |H||K|$ ; every element of  $G$  has the form  $(h, k)$  where  $h \in H$  and  $k \in K$ ; if  $|h|$  and  $|k|$  are finite, then  $|(h, k)| = \text{lcm}(|h|, |k|)$ ; if  $H$  and  $K$  are Abelian, then  $G$  is Abelian; if  $H$  and  $K$  are cyclic and  $|H|$  and  $|K|$  are relatively prime, then  $H \oplus K$  is cyclic. It would be quite useful to be able to reverse this process—that is, to be able to start with a large group  $G$  and break it down into a product of subgroups in such a way that we could glean many properties of  $G$  from properties of the component pieces. It is occasionally possible to do this.

### Definition Internal Direct Product of $H$ and $K$

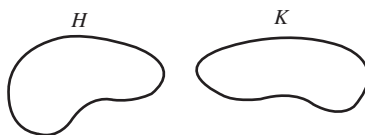
We say that  $G$  is the *internal direct product* of  $H$  and  $K$  and write  $G = H \times K$  if  $H$  and  $K$  are normal subgroups of  $G$  and

$$G = HK \quad \text{and} \quad H \cap K = \{e\}.$$

The wording of the phrase “internal direct product” is easy to justify. We want to call  $G$  the internal direct product of  $H$  and  $K$  if  $H$  and  $K$  are subgroups of  $G$ , and if  $G$  is naturally isomorphic to the external direct product of  $H$  and  $K$ . One forms the internal direct product by *starting* with a group  $G$  and then proceeding to find two subgroups  $H$  and  $K$  within  $G$  such that  $G$  is *isomorphic* to the external direct product of  $H$  and  $K$ . (The definition ensures that this is the case—see Theorem 9.6.) On the other hand, one forms an external direct product by *starting* with any two groups  $H$  and  $K$ , related or not, and proceeding to produce the larger group  $H \oplus K$ . The difference between the two products is that the internal direct product can be formed within  $G$  itself, using subgroups of  $G$  and the operation of  $G$ , whereas the external direct product can be formed with totally unrelated groups by creating a new set and a new operation. (See Figures 9.1 and 9.2.)



**Figure 9.1** For the internal direct product,  $H$  and  $K$  must be subgroups of the same group.



**Figure 9.2** For the external direct product,  $H$  and  $K$  can be any groups.

Perhaps the following analogy with integers will be useful in clarifying the distinction between the two products of groups discussed in the preceding paragraph. Just as we may take any (finite) collection of integers and form their product, we may also take any collection of groups and form their external direct product. Conversely, just as we may start with a particular integer and express it as a product of certain of its divisors, we may be able to start with a particular group and factor it as an internal direct product of certain of its subgroups.

The next example recasts Theorem 8.3.

■ **EXAMPLE 17** If  $s$  and  $t$  are relatively prime positive integers then  $U(st) = U_s(st) \times U_t(st)$ . ■

■ **EXAMPLE 18** In  $D_6$ , the dihedral group of order 12, let  $F$  denote some reflection and let  $R_k$  denote a rotation of  $k$  degrees. Then,

$$D_6 = \{R_0, R_{120}, R_{240}, F, R_{120}F, R_{240}F\} \times \{R_0, R_{180}\}. \quad \blacksquare$$

Students should be cautioned about the necessity of having all conditions of the definition of internal direct product satisfied to ensure that  $HK \approx H \oplus K$ . For example, if we take

$$G = S_3, \quad H = \langle (123) \rangle, \quad \text{and} \quad K = \langle (12) \rangle,$$

then  $G = HK$ , and  $H \cap K = \{(1)\}$ . But  $G$  is *not* isomorphic to  $H \oplus K$ , since, by Theorem 8.2,  $H \oplus K$  is cyclic, whereas  $S_3$  is not. Note that  $K$  is not normal.

A group  $G$  can also be the internal direct product of a collection of subgroups.

**Definition Internal Direct Product  $H_1 \times H_2 \times \cdots \times H_n$**

Let  $H_1, H_2, \dots, H_n$  be a finite collection of normal subgroups of  $G$ . We say that  $G$  is the *internal direct product* of  $H_1, H_2, \dots, H_n$  and write  $G = H_1 \times H_2 \times \cdots \times H_n$ , if

1.  $G = H_1 H_2 \cdots H_n = \{h_1 h_2 \cdots h_n \mid h_i \in H_i\}$ ,
2.  $(H_1 H_2 \cdots H_i) \cap H_{i+1} = \{e\}$  for  $i = 1, 2, \dots, n-1$ .

This definition is somewhat more complicated than the one given for two subgroups. The student may wonder about the motivation for it—that is, why should we want the subgroups to be normal and why is it desirable for each subgroup to be disjoint from the product of all previous ones? The reason is quite simple. We want the internal direct product to be isomorphic to the external direct product. As the next theorem shows, the conditions in the definition of internal direct product were chosen to ensure that the two products are isomorphic.

■ **Theorem 9.6**  $H_1 \times H_2 \times \cdots \times H_n \approx H_1 \oplus H_2 \oplus \cdots \oplus H_n$

*If a group  $G$  is the internal direct product of a finite number of subgroups  $H_1, H_2, \dots, H_n$ , then  $G$  is isomorphic to the external direct product of  $H_1, H_2, \dots, H_n$ .*

**PROOF** We first show that the normality of the  $H$ 's together with the second condition of the definition guarantees that  $h$ 's from different  $H_i$ 's commute. For if  $h_i \in H_i$  and  $h_j \in H_j$  with  $i \neq j$ , then

$$(h_i h_j h_i^{-1}) h_j^{-1} \in H_j h_j^{-1} = H_j$$

and

$$h_i (h_j h_i^{-1} h_j^{-1}) \in h_i H_i = H_i.$$

Thus,  $h_i h_j h_i^{-1} h_j^{-1} \in H_i \cap H_j = \{e\}$  (see Exercise 5), and, therefore,  $h_i h_j = h_j h_i$ . We next claim that each member of  $G$  can be expressed uniquely in the form  $h_1 h_2 \cdots h_n$ , where  $h_i \in H_i$ . That there is at least one such representation is the content of condition 1 of the definition. To prove uniqueness, suppose that  $g = h_1 h_2 \cdots h_n$  and  $g = h'_1 h'_2 \cdots h'_n$ , where  $h_i$  and  $h'_i$  belong to  $H_i$  for  $i = 1, \dots, n$ . Then, using the fact that the  $h$ 's from different  $H_i$ 's commute, we can solve the equation

$$h_1 h_2 \cdots h_n = h'_1 h'_2 \cdots h'_n \quad (1)$$

for  $h'_n h_n^{-1}$  to obtain

$$h'_n h_n^{-1} = (h'_1)^{-1} h_1 (h'_2)^{-1} h_2 \cdots (h'_{n-1})^{-1} h_{n-1}.$$

But then

$$h'_n h_n^{-1} \in H_1 H_2 \cdots H_{n-1} \cap H_n = \{e\},$$

so that  $h'_n h_n^{-1} = e$  and, therefore,  $h'_n = h_n$ . At this point, we can cancel  $h_n$  and  $h'_n$  from opposite sides of the equal sign in Equation (1) and repeat the preceding argument to obtain  $h'_{n-1} = h_{n-1}$ . Continuing in this fashion, we eventually have  $h_i = h'_i$  for  $i = 1, \dots, n$ . With our claim established, we may now define a function  $\phi$  from  $G$  to  $H_1 \oplus H_2 \oplus \dots \oplus H_n$  by  $\phi(h_1 h_2 \dots h_n) = (h_1, h_2, \dots, h_n)$ . We leave to the reader the easy verification that  $\phi$  is an isomorphism. ■

When we have a group  $G = H \times K$  the essence of Theorem 9.6 is that in  $H \oplus K$  the product  $(h_1, k_1)(h_2, k_2) = (h_1 h_2, k_1 k_2)$  is the same as  $h_1 h_2 k_1 k_2$  in  $H \times K$ . So, the operation in  $H \oplus K$  can be done inside  $HK$  by ignoring the parentheses and commas to separate the members of  $H$  and  $K$ .

The next theorem provides an important application of Theorem 9.6.

### ■ Theorem 9.7 Classification of Groups of Order $p^2$

*Every group of order  $p^2$ , where  $p$  is a prime, is isomorphic to  $Z_{p^2}$  or  $Z_p \oplus Z_p$ .*

**PROOF** Let  $G$  be a group of order  $p^2$ , where  $p$  is a prime. If  $G$  has an element of order  $p^2$ , then  $G$  is isomorphic to  $Z_{p^2}$ . So, by Corollary 2 of Lagrange's Theorem, we may assume that every nonidentity element of  $G$  has order  $p$ . First we show that for any element  $a$ , the subgroup  $\langle a \rangle$  is normal in  $G$ . If this is not the case, then there is an element  $b$  in  $G$  such that  $bab^{-1}$  is not in  $\langle a \rangle$ . Then  $\langle a \rangle$  and  $\langle bab^{-1} \rangle$  are distinct subgroups of order  $p$ . Since  $\langle a \rangle \cap \langle bab^{-1} \rangle$  is a subgroup of both  $\langle a \rangle$  and  $\langle bab^{-1} \rangle$ , we have that  $\langle a \rangle \cap \langle bab^{-1} \rangle = \{e\}$ . From this it follows that the distinct left cosets of  $\langle bab^{-1} \rangle$  are  $\langle bab^{-1} \rangle$ ,  $a\langle bab^{-1} \rangle$ ,  $a^2\langle bab^{-1} \rangle$ ,  $\dots$ ,  $a^{p-1}\langle bab^{-1} \rangle$ . Since  $b^{-1}$  must lie in one of these cosets, we may write  $b^{-1}$  in the form  $b^{-1} = a^i(bab^{-1})^j = a^i b a^j b^{-1}$  for some  $i$  and  $j$ . Canceling the  $b^{-1}$  terms, we obtain  $e = a^i b a^j$  and therefore  $b = a^{-i-j} \in \langle a \rangle$ . This contradiction verifies our assertion that every subgroup of the form  $\langle a \rangle$  is normal in  $G$ . To complete the proof, let  $x$  be any nonidentity element in  $G$  and  $y$  be any element of  $G$  not in  $\langle x \rangle$ . Then, by comparing orders and using Theorem 9.6, we see that  $G = \langle x \rangle \times \langle y \rangle \approx Z_p \oplus Z_p$ . ■

As an immediate corollary of Theorem 9.7, we have the following important fact.

## Corollary

*If  $G$  is a group of order  $p^2$ , where  $p$  is a prime, then  $G$  is Abelian.*

We mention in passing that if  $G = H_1 \oplus H_2 \oplus \cdots \oplus H_n$ , then  $G$  can be expressed as the internal direct product of subgroups isomorphic to  $H_1, H_2, \dots, H_n$ . For example, if  $G = H_1 \oplus H_2$ , then  $G = \overline{H}_1 \times \overline{H}_2$ , where  $\overline{H}_1 = H_1 \oplus \{e\}$  and  $\overline{H}_2 = \{e\} \oplus H_2$ .

The topic of direct products is one in which notation and terminology vary widely. Many authors use  $H \times K$  to denote both the internal direct product and the external direct product of  $H$  and  $K$ , making no notational distinction between the two products. A few authors define only the external direct product. Many people reserve the notation  $H \oplus K$  for the situation where  $H$  and  $K$  are Abelian groups under addition and call it the *direct sum* of  $H$  and  $K$ . In fact, we will adopt this terminology in the section on rings (Part 3), since rings are always Abelian groups under addition.

The  $U$ -groups provide a convenient way to illustrate the preceding ideas and to clarify the distinction between internal and external direct products. It follows directly from Theorem 8.3, its corollary, and Theorem 9.6 that if  $m = n_1 n_2 \cdots n_k$ , where  $\gcd(n_i, n_j) = 1$  for  $i \neq j$ , then

$$\begin{aligned} U(m) &= U_{m/n_1}(m) \times U_{m/n_2}(m) \times \cdots \times U_{m/n_k}(m) \\ &\approx U(n_1) \oplus U(n_2) \oplus \cdots \oplus U(n_k). \end{aligned}$$

Let us return to the examples given following Theorem 8.3.

$$\begin{aligned} U(105) &= U(15 \cdot 7) = U_{15}(105) \times U_7(105) \\ &= \{1, 16, 31, 46, 61, 76\} \times \{1, 8, 22, 29, 43, 64, 71, 92\} \\ &\approx U(7) \oplus U(15), \end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned} U(105) &= U(5 \cdot 21) = U_5(105) \times U_{21}(105) \\ &= \{1, 11, 16, 26, 31, 41, 46, 61, 71, 76, 86, 101\} \\ &\quad \times \{1, 22, 43, 64\} \approx U(21) \oplus U(5), \end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned} U(105) &= U(3 \cdot 5 \cdot 7) = U_{35}(105) \times U_{21}(105) \times U_{15}(105) \\ &= \{1, 71\} \times \{1, 22, 43, 64\} \times \{1, 16, 31, 46, 61, 76\} \\ &\approx U(3) \oplus U(5) \oplus U(7). \end{aligned}$$

## Exercises

The heart of mathematics is its problems.

Paul Halmos

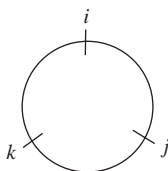
1. Let  $H = \{(1), (12)\}$ . Is  $H$  normal in  $S_3$ ?
2. Prove that  $A_n$  is normal in  $S_n$ .

3. In  $D_4$ , let  $K = \{R_0, R_{90}, R_{180}, R_{270}\}$ . Write  $HR_{90}$  in the form  $xH$ , where  $x \in K$ . Write  $DR_{270}$  in the form  $xD$ , where  $x \in K$ . Write  $R_{90}V$  in the form  $Vx$ , where  $x \in K$ .
4. Write  $(12)(13)(14)$  in the form  $\alpha(12)$ , where  $\alpha \in A_4$ . Write  $(1234)(12)(23)$ , in the form  $\alpha(1234)$ , where  $\alpha \in A_4$ .
5. Show that if  $G$  is the internal direct product of  $H_1, H_2, \dots, H_n$  and  $i \neq j$  with  $1 \leq i \leq n, 1 \leq j \leq n$ , then  $H_i \cap H_j = \{e\}$ . (This exercise is referred to in this chapter.)
6. Let  $H = \left\{ \begin{bmatrix} a & b \\ 0 & d \end{bmatrix} \mid a, b, d \in \mathbf{R}, ad \neq 0 \right\}$ . Is  $H$  a normal subgroup of  $GL(2, \mathbf{R})$ ?
7. Let  $G = GL(2, \mathbf{R})$  and let  $K$  be a subgroup of  $\mathbf{R}^*$ . Prove that  $H = \{A \in G \mid \det A \in K\}$  is a normal subgroup of  $G$ .
8. Viewing  $\langle 3 \rangle$  and  $\langle 12 \rangle$  as subgroups of  $Z$ , prove that  $\langle 3 \rangle / \langle 12 \rangle$  is isomorphic to  $Z_4$ . Similarly, prove that  $\langle 8 \rangle / \langle 48 \rangle$  is isomorphic to  $Z_6$ . Generalize to arbitrary integers  $k$  and  $n$ .
9. Prove that if  $H$  has index 2 in  $G$ , then  $H$  is normal in  $G$ . (This exercise is referred to in Chapters 24 and 25 and this chapter.)
10. Let  $H = \{(1), (12)(34)\}$  in  $A_4$ .
  - a. Show that  $H$  is not normal in  $A_4$ .
  - b. Referring to the multiplication table for  $A_4$  in Table 5.1 on page 105, show that, although  $\alpha_6 H = \alpha_7 H$  and  $\alpha_9 H = \alpha_{11} H$ , it is not true that  $\alpha_6 \alpha_9 H = \alpha_7 \alpha_{11} H$ . Explain why this proves that the left cosets of  $H$  do not form a group under coset multiplication.
11. Prove that a factor group of a cyclic group is cyclic.
12. Prove that a factor group of an Abelian group is Abelian.
13. Let  $H$  be a normal subgroup of a finite group  $G$  and let  $a$  be an element of  $G$ . Complete the following statement: The order of the element  $aH$  in the factor group  $G/H$  is the smallest positive integer  $n$  such that  $a^n$  is \_\_\_\_\_.
14. What is the order of the element  $14 + \langle 8 \rangle$  in the factor group  $Z_{24} / \langle 8 \rangle$ ?
15. What is the order of the element  $4U_5(105)$  in the factor group  $U(105) / U_5(105)$ ?
16. Recall that  $Z(D_6) = \{R_0, R_{180}\}$ . What is the order of the element  $R_{60}Z(D_6)$  in the factor group  $D_6 / Z(D_6)$ ?
17. Let  $G = Z / \langle 20 \rangle$  and  $H = \langle 4 \rangle / \langle 20 \rangle$ . List the elements of  $H$  and  $G/H$ .
18. What is the order of the factor group  $Z_{60} / \langle 15 \rangle$ ?
19. Determine all normal subgroups of  $D_n$  of order 2.
20. List the elements of  $U(20) / U_5(20)$ .
21. Prove that an Abelian group of order 33 is cyclic. Does your proof hold when 33 is replaced by  $pq$  where  $p$  and  $q$  are distinct primes?
22. Determine the order of  $(Z \oplus Z) / \langle (2, 2) \rangle$ . Is the group cyclic?



23. Let  $G_1$  and  $G_2$  be finite groups. If  $H_1$  is a normal subgroup of  $G_1$  and  $H_2$  is a normal subgroup of  $G_2$  give a formula for  $|G_1/H_1 \oplus G_2/H_2|$  in terms of  $|G_1|$ ,  $|G_2|$ ,  $|H_1|$  and  $|H_2|$ .
24. The group  $(Z_4 \oplus Z_{12})/\langle(2, 2)\rangle$  is isomorphic to one of  $Z_8$ ,  $Z_4 \oplus Z_2$ , or  $Z_2 \oplus Z_2 \oplus Z_2$ . Determine which one by elimination.
25. Let  $G = U(32)$  and  $H = \{1, 15\}$ . The group  $G/H$  is isomorphic to one of  $Z_8$ ,  $Z_4 \oplus Z_2$ , or  $Z_2 \oplus Z_2 \oplus Z_2$ . Determine which one by elimination.
26. Let  $H = \{1, 17, 41, 49, 73, 89, 97, 113\}$  under multiplication modulo 120. Write  $H$  as a external direct product of groups of the form  $Z_{2^k}$ . Write  $H$  as an internal direct product of nontrivial subgroups.
27. Let  $G = U(16)$ ,  $H = \{1, 15\}$ , and  $K = \{1, 9\}$ . Are  $H$  and  $K$  isomorphic? Are  $G/H$  and  $G/K$  isomorphic?
28. Let  $G = Z_4 \oplus Z_4$ ,  $H = \{(0, 0), (2, 0), (0, 2), (2, 2)\}$ , and  $K = \langle(1, 2)\rangle$ . Is  $G/H$  isomorphic to  $Z_4$  or  $Z_2 \oplus Z_2$ ? Is  $G/K$  isomorphic to  $Z_4$  or  $Z_2 \oplus Z_2$ ?
29. Explain why a non-Abelian group of order 8 cannot be the internal direct product of proper subgroups.
30. Express  $U(165)$  as an internal direct product of proper subgroups in four different ways.
31. Let  $\mathbf{R}^*$  denote the group of all nonzero real numbers under multiplication. Let  $\mathbf{R}^+$  denote the group of positive real numbers under multiplication. Prove that  $\mathbf{R}^*$  is the internal direct product of  $\mathbf{R}^+$  and the subgroup  $\{1, -1\}$ .
32. If  $N$  is a normal subgroup of  $G$  and  $|G/N| = m$ , show that  $x^m \in N$  for all  $x$  in  $G$ .
33. Let  $H$  and  $K$  be subgroups of a group  $G$ . If  $G = HK$  and  $g = hk$ , where  $h \in H$  and  $k \in K$ , is there any relationship among  $|g|$ ,  $|h|$ , and  $|k|$ ? What if  $G = H \times K$ ?
34. In  $Z$ , let  $H = \langle 5 \rangle$  and  $K = \langle 7 \rangle$ . Prove that  $Z = HK$ . Does  $Z = H \times K$ ?
35. Let  $G = \{3^a 6^b 10^c \mid a, b, c \in Z\}$  under multiplication and  $H = \{3^a 6^b 12^c \mid a, b, c \in Z\}$  under multiplication. Prove that  $G = \langle 3 \rangle \times \langle 6 \rangle \times \langle 10 \rangle$ , whereas  $H \neq \langle 3 \rangle \times \langle 6 \rangle \times \langle 12 \rangle$ .
36. Determine all subgroups of  $\mathbf{R}^*$  (nonzero reals under multiplication) of index 2.
37. Let  $G$  be a finite group and let  $H$  be a normal subgroup of  $G$ . Prove that the order of the element  $gH$  in  $G/H$  must divide the order of  $g$  in  $G$ .
38. Prove that for every positive integer  $n$ ,  $Q/Z$  has an element of order  $n$ .
39. Let  $H$  be a subgroup of a group  $G$  with the property that for all  $a$  and  $b$  in  $G$ ,  $aHbH = abH$ . Prove that  $H$  is a normal subgroup of  $G$ .

40. Let in  $S_3$  let  $H = \{(1), (12)\}$ . Show that  $(13)H(23)H \neq (13)(23)H$ . (This proves that when  $H$  is not a normal subgroup of a group  $G$ , the product of two left cosets of  $H$  in  $G$  need not be a left coset of  $H$  in  $G$ .)
41. Show that  $\mathbb{Q}$ , the group of rational numbers under addition, has no proper subgroup of finite index.
42. An element is called a *square* if it can be expressed in the form  $b^2$  for some  $b$ . Suppose that  $G$  is an Abelian group and  $H$  is a subgroup of  $G$ . If every element of  $H$  is a square and every element of  $G/H$  is a square, prove that every element of  $G$  is a square. Does your proof remain valid when “square” is replaced by “ $n$ th power,” where  $n$  is any integer?
43. Show, by example, that in a factor group  $G/H$  it can happen that  $aH = bH$  but  $|a| \neq |b|$ .
44. Verify that the mapping defined at the end of the proof of Theorem 9.6 is an isomorphism.
45. Let  $p$  be a prime. Show that if  $H$  is a subgroup of a group of order  $2p$  that is not normal, then  $H$  has order 2.
46. Show that  $D_{13}$  is isomorphic to  $\text{Inn}(D_{13})$ .
47. Let  $H$  and  $K$  be subgroups of a group  $G$ . If  $|H| = 63$  and  $|K| = 45$ , prove that  $H \cap K$  is Abelian.
48. If  $G$  is a group and  $|G:Z(G)| = 4$ , prove that  $G/Z(G) \approx Z_2 \oplus Z_2$ .
49. Suppose that  $G$  is a non-Abelian group of order  $p^3$ , where  $p$  is a prime, and  $Z(G) \neq \{e\}$ . Prove that  $|Z(G)| = p$ .
50. If  $|G| = pq$ , where  $p$  and  $q$  are primes that are not necessarily distinct, prove that  $|Z(G)| = 1$  or  $pq$ .
51. Let  $H$  be a normal subgroup of  $G$  and  $K$  a subgroup of  $G$  that contains  $H$ . Prove that  $K$  is normal in  $G$  if and only if  $K/H$  is normal in  $G/H$ .
52. Let  $G$  be an Abelian group and let  $H$  be the subgroup consisting of all elements of  $G$  that have finite order. Prove that every nonidentity element in  $G/H$  has infinite order.
53. Determine all subgroups of  $\mathbf{R}^*$  that have finite index.
54. Let  $G = \{\pm 1, \pm i, \pm j, \pm k\}$ , where  $i^2 = j^2 = k^2 = -1$ ,  $-i = (-1)i$ ,  $i^2 = (-1)^2 = 1$ ,  $ij = -ji = k$ ,  $jk = -kj = i$ , and  $ki = -ik = j$ .
- Show that  $H = \{1, -1\} \triangleleft G$ .
  - Construct the Cayley table for  $G/H$ . Is  $G/H$  isomorphic to  $Z_4$  or  $Z_2 \oplus Z_2$ ?
- (The rules involving  $i, j$ , and  $k$  can be remembered by using the circle below.



Going clockwise, the product of two consecutive elements is the third one. The same is true for going counterclockwise, except that we obtain the negative of the third element. This group is called the *quaternions*. It was invented by William Hamilton in 1843. The quaternions are used to describe rotations in three-dimensional space, and they are used in physics. The quaternions can be used to extend the complex numbers in a natural way).

55. In  $D_4$ , let  $K = \{R_0, D\}$  and let  $L = \{R_0, D, D', R_{180}\}$ . Show that  $K \triangleleft L \triangleleft D_4$ , but that  $K$  is not normal in  $D_4$ . (Normality is not transitive.)
56. Show that the intersection of two normal subgroups of  $G$  is a normal subgroup of  $G$ . Generalize.
57. Give an example of subgroups  $H$  and  $K$  of a group  $G$  such that  $HK$  is not a subgroup of  $G$ .
58. If  $N$  and  $M$  are normal subgroups of  $G$ , prove that  $NM$  is also a normal subgroup of  $G$ .
59. Let  $N$  be a normal subgroup of a group  $G$ . If  $N$  is cyclic, prove that every subgroup of  $N$  is also normal in  $G$ . (This exercise is referred to in Chapter 24.)
60. Without looking at inner automorphisms of  $D_n$ , determine the number of such automorphisms.
61. Let  $H$  be a normal subgroup of a finite group  $G$  and let  $x \in G$ . If  $\gcd(|x|, |G/H|) = 1$ , show that  $x \in H$ . (This exercise is referred to in Chapter 25.)
62. Let  $G$  be a group and let  $G'$  be the subgroup of  $G$  generated by the set  $S = \{x^{-1}y^{-1}xy \mid x, y \in G\}$ .
  - a. Prove that  $G'$  is normal in  $G$ .
  - b. Prove that  $G/G'$  is Abelian.
  - c. If  $G/N$  is Abelian, prove that  $G' \leq N$ .
  - d. Prove that if  $H$  is a subgroup of  $G$  and  $G' \leq H$ , then  $H$  is normal in  $G$ .
63. Prove that the group  $\mathbf{C}^*/\mathbf{R}^*$  has infinite order.
64. Suppose that a group  $G$  has a subgroup of order  $n$ . Prove that the intersection of all subgroups of  $G$  of order  $n$  is a normal subgroup of  $G$ .
65. If  $G$  is non-Abelian, show that  $\text{Aut}(G)$  is not cyclic.
66. Let  $|G| = p^n m$ , where  $p$  is prime and  $\gcd(p, m) = 1$ . Suppose that  $H$  is a normal subgroup of  $G$  of order  $p^n$ . If  $K$  is a subgroup of  $G$  of order  $p^k$ , show that  $K \subseteq H$ .
67. Suppose that  $H$  is a normal subgroup of a finite group  $G$ . If  $G/H$  has an element of order  $n$ , show that  $G$  has an element of order  $n$ . Show, by example, that the assumption that  $G$  is finite is necessary.
68. Prove that  $A_4$  is the only subgroup of  $S_4$  of order 12.

- 69.** If  $|G| = 30$  and  $|Z(G)| = 5$ , what is the structure of  $G/Z(G)$ ?  
What is the structure of  $G/Z(G)$  if  $|Z(G)| = 3$ ? Generalize to the case that  $|G| = 2pq$  where  $p$  and  $q$  are distinct odd primes.
- 70.** If  $H$  is a normal subgroup of  $G$  and  $|H| = 2$ , prove that  $H$  is contained in the center of  $G$ .
- 71.** Prove that  $A_5$  cannot have a normal subgroup of order 2.
- 72.** Let  $G$  be a group and  $H$  an odd-order subgroup of  $G$  of index 2. Show that  $H$  contains every element of  $G$  of odd order.

## Suggested Readings

Tony Rothman, “Genius and Biographers: The Fictionalization of Évariste Galois,” *The American Mathematical Monthly* 89 (1982): 84–106.

The author argues that many popular accounts of Galois’s life have been greatly embroidered.

Paul F. Zweifel, “Generalized Diatonic and Pentatonic Scales: A Group-theoretic Approach,” *Perspectives of New Music* 34 (1996): 140–161.

The author discusses how group theoretic notions such as subgroups, cosets, factor groups, and isomorphisms of  $Z_{12}$  and  $Z_{20}$  relate to musical scales, tuning, temperament, and structure.

# Évariste Galois

Galois at seventeen was making discoveries of epochal significance in the theory of equations, discoveries whose consequences are not yet exhausted after more than a century.

E. T. BELL, *Men of Mathematics*



The Granger Collection, NYC

ÉVARISTE GALOIS (pronounced gal-WAH) was born on October 25, 1811, near Paris. Although he had mastered the works of Legendre and Lagrange at age 15, Galois twice failed his entrance examination to the École Polytechnique. He did not know some basic mathematics, and he did mathematics almost entirely in his head, to the annoyance of the examiner.

At 18, Galois wrote his important research on the theory of equations and submitted it to the French Academy of Sciences for publication. The paper was given to Cauchy for refereeing. Cauchy, impressed by the paper, agreed to present it to the academy, but he never did. At the age of 19, Galois entered a paper of the highest quality in the competition for the Grand Prize in Mathematics, given by the French Academy of Sciences. The paper was given to Fourier, who died shortly thereafter. Galois's paper was never seen again.

Galois spent most of the last year and a half of his life in prison for revolutionary political offenses. While in prison, he attempted

suicide and prophesied that he would die in a duel. On May 30, 1832, Galois was shot in a duel; he died the next day at the age of 20.

Among the many concepts introduced by Galois are normal subgroups, isomorphisms, simple groups, finite fields, and Galois theory. His work provided a method for disposing of several famous constructability problems, such as trisecting an arbitrary angle and doubling a cube. In his book *Love and Math* Edward Frenkel wrote "His [Galois's] brilliant insight has forever changed the way people think about numbers and equations." Galois's entire works fill only 60 pages.

To find more information about Galois, visit:

**[http://www-groups.dcs  
.st-and.ac.uk/~history/](http://www-groups.dcs.st-and.ac.uk/~history/)**

# 10 Group Homomorphisms

When it comes to laws, there is absolutely no doubt that symmetry and group theory are extremely *useful* concepts. Without the introduction of symmetry and the language of groups into particle physics the description of the elementary particles and their interactions would have been an intricate nightmare. Groups truly flesh out order and identify patterns like no other mathematical machinery.

Mario Livio, *The Equation That Couldn't be Solved*

In a certain sense the subject of group theory is built up out of three basic concepts: that of a homomorphism, that of a normal subgroup, and that of the factor group of a group by a normal subgroup.

I. N. Herstein, *Abstract Algebra*, 3rd ed.

## Definition and Examples

In this chapter, we consider one of the most fundamental ideas of algebra—homomorphisms. The term *homomorphism* comes from the Greek words *homo*, “like,” and *morphe*, “form.” We will see that a homomorphism is a natural generalization of an isomorphism and that there is an intimate connection between factor groups of a group and homomorphisms of a group. The concept of group homomorphisms was introduced by Camille Jordan in 1870, in his influential book *Traité des substitutions*.

### Definition Group Homomorphism

A *homomorphism*  $\phi$  from a group  $G$  to a group  $\bar{G}$  is a mapping from  $G$  into  $\bar{G}$  that preserves the group operation; that is,  $\phi(ab) = \phi(a)\phi(b)$  for all  $a, b$  in  $G$ .

Before giving examples and stating numerous properties of homomorphisms, it is convenient to introduce an important subgroup that is intimately related to the image of a homomorphism. (See property 4 of Theorem 10.1.)

### Definition Kernel of a Homomorphism

The *kernel* of a homomorphism  $\phi$  from a group  $G$  to a group with identity  $e$  is the set  $\{x \in G \mid \phi(x) = e\}$ . The kernel of  $\phi$  is denoted by  $\text{Ker } \phi$ .

■ **EXAMPLE 1** Any isomorphism is a homomorphism that is also onto and one-to-one. The kernel of an isomorphism is the trivial subgroup. ■

■ **EXAMPLE 2** Let  $\mathbf{R}^*$  be the group of nonzero real numbers under multiplication. Then the determinant mapping  $A \rightarrow \det A$  is a homomorphism from  $GL(2, \mathbf{R})$  to  $\mathbf{R}^*$ . The kernel of the determinant mapping is  $SL(2, \mathbf{R})$ . ■

■ **EXAMPLE 3** The mapping  $\phi$  from  $\mathbf{R}^*$  to  $\mathbf{R}^*$ , defined by  $\phi(x) = |x|$ , is a homomorphism with  $\text{Ker } \phi = \{1, -1\}$ . ■

■ **EXAMPLE 4** Let  $\mathbf{R}[x]$  denote the group of all polynomials with real coefficients under addition. For any  $f$  in  $\mathbf{R}[x]$ , let  $f'$  denote the derivative of  $f$ . Then the mapping  $f \rightarrow f'$  is a homomorphism from  $\mathbf{R}[x]$  to itself. The kernel of the derivative mapping is the set of all constant polynomials. ■

■ **EXAMPLE 5** The mapping  $\phi$  from  $Z$  to  $Z_n$ , defined by  $\phi(m) = m \bmod n$ , is a homomorphism (see Exercise 9 in Chapter 0). The kernel of this mapping is  $\langle n \rangle$ . ■

■ **EXAMPLE 6** The mapping  $\phi(x) = x^2$  from  $\mathbf{R}^*$ , the nonzero real numbers under multiplication, to itself is a homomorphism, since  $\phi(ab) = (ab)^2 = a^2b^2 = \phi(a)\phi(b)$  for all  $a$  and  $b$  in  $\mathbf{R}^*$ . (See Exercise 5.) The kernel is  $\{1, -1\}$ . ■

■ **EXAMPLE 7** The mapping  $\phi(x) = x^2$  from  $\mathbf{R}$ , the real numbers under addition, to itself is not a homomorphism, since  $\phi(a + b) = (a + b)^2 = a^2 + 2ab + b^2$ , whereas  $\phi(a) + \phi(b) = a^2 + b^2$ . ■

When defining a homomorphism from a group in which there are several ways to represent the elements, caution must be exercised to ensure that the correspondence is a function. (The term *well-defined* is often used in this context.) For example, since  $3(x + y) = 3x + 3y$  in  $Z_6$ , one might believe that the correspondence  $x + \langle 3 \rangle \rightarrow 3x$  from  $Z/\langle 3 \rangle$  to  $Z_6$  is a homomorphism. But it is not a function, since  $0 + \langle 3 \rangle = 3 + \langle 3 \rangle$  in  $Z/\langle 3 \rangle$  but  $3 \cdot 0 \neq 3 \cdot 3$  in  $Z_6$ .

For students who have had linear algebra, we remark that every linear transformation is a group homomorphism and the null-space is the same as the kernel. An invertible linear transformation is a group isomorphism.

## Properties of Homomorphisms

### ■ Theorem 10.1 Properties of Elements Under Homomorphisms

*Let  $\phi$  be a homomorphism from a group  $G$  to a group  $\overline{G}$  and let  $g$  be an element of  $G$ . Then*

1.  $\phi$  carries the identity of  $G$  to the identity of  $\overline{G}$ .
2.  $\phi(g^n) = (\phi(g))^n$  for all  $n$  in  $\mathbb{Z}$ .
3. If  $|g|$  is finite, then  $|\phi(g)|$  divides  $|g|$ .
4.  $\text{Ker } \phi$  is a subgroup of  $G$ .
5.  $\phi(a) = \phi(b)$  if and only if  $a\text{Ker } \phi = b\text{Ker } \phi$ .
6. If  $\phi(g) = g'$ , then  $\phi^{-1}(g') = \{x \in G \mid \phi(x) = g'\} = g\text{Ker } \phi$ .

**PROOF** The proofs of properties 1 and 2 are identical to the proofs of properties 1 and 2 of isomorphisms in Theorem 6.2. To prove property 3, notice that properties 1 and 2 together with  $g^n = e$  imply that  $e = \phi(e) = \phi(g^n) = (\phi(g))^n$ . So, by Corollary 2 to Theorem 4.1, we have  $|\phi(g)|$  divides  $n$ .

By property 1 we know that  $\text{Ker } \phi$  is not empty. So, to prove property 4, we assume that  $a, b \in \text{Ker } \phi$  and show that  $ab^{-1} \in \text{Ker } \phi$ . Since  $\phi(a) = e$  and  $\phi(b) = e$ , we have  $\phi(ab^{-1}) = \phi(a)\phi(b^{-1}) = \phi(a)(\phi(b))^{-1} = ee^{-1} = e$ . So,  $ab^{-1} \in \text{Ker } \phi$ .

To prove property 5, first assume that  $\phi(a) = \phi(b)$ . Then  $e = (\phi(b))^{-1}\phi(a) = \phi(b^{-1})\phi(a) = \phi(b^{-1}a)$ , so that  $b^{-1}a \in \text{Ker } \phi$ . It now follows from property 6 of the lemma in Chapter 7 that  $b\text{Ker } \phi = a\text{Ker } \phi$ . Reversing this argument completes the proof.

To prove property 6, we must show that  $\phi^{-1}(g') \subseteq g\text{Ker } \phi$  and that  $g\text{Ker } \phi \subseteq \phi^{-1}(g')$ . For the first inclusion, let  $x \in \phi^{-1}(g')$ , so that  $\phi(x) = g'$ . Then  $\phi(g) = \phi(x)$  and by property 5 we have  $g\text{Ker } \phi = x\text{Ker } \phi$  and therefore  $x \in g\text{Ker } \phi$ . This completes the proof that  $\phi^{-1}(g') \subseteq g\text{Ker } \phi$ . To prove that  $g\text{Ker } \phi \subseteq \phi^{-1}(g')$ , suppose that  $k \in \text{Ker } \phi$ . Then  $\phi(gk) = \phi(g)\phi(k) = g'e = g'$ . Thus, by definition,  $gk \in \phi^{-1}(g')$ . ■

Since homomorphisms preserve the group operation, it should not be a surprise that they preserve many group properties.



## ■ Theorem 10.2 Properties of Subgroups Under Homomorphisms

Let  $\phi$  be a homomorphism from a group  $G$  to a group  $\bar{G}$  and let  $H$  be a subgroup of  $G$ . Then

1.  $\phi(H) = \{\phi(h) \mid h \in H\}$  is a subgroup of  $\bar{G}$ .
2. If  $H$  is cyclic, then  $\phi(H)$  is cyclic.
3. If  $H$  is Abelian, then  $\phi(H)$  is Abelian.
4. If  $H$  is normal in  $G$ , then  $\phi(H)$  is normal in  $\phi(G)$ .
5. If  $|\text{Ker } \phi| = n$ , then  $\phi$  is an  $n$ -to-1 mapping from  $G$  onto  $\phi(G)$ .
6. If  $|H| = n$ , then  $|\phi(H)|$  divides  $n$ .
7. If  $\bar{K}$  is a subgroup of  $\bar{G}$ , then  $\phi^{-1}(\bar{K}) = \{k \in G \mid \phi(k) \in \bar{K}\}$  is a subgroup of  $G$ .
8. If  $\bar{K}$  is a normal subgroup of  $\bar{G}$ , then  $\phi^{-1}(\bar{K}) = \{k \in G \mid \phi(k) \in \bar{K}\}$  is a normal subgroup of  $G$ .
9. If  $\phi$  is onto and  $\text{Ker } \phi = \{e\}$ , then  $\phi$  is an isomorphism from  $G$  to  $\bar{G}$ .

**PROOF** First note that the proofs of properties 1, 2, and 3 are identical to the proofs of properties 4, 3, and 2, respectively, of Theorem 6.3, since those proofs use only the fact that an isomorphism is an operation-preserving mapping.

To prove property 4, let  $\phi(h) \in \phi(H)$  and  $\phi(g) \in \phi(G)$ . Then  $\phi(g)\phi(h)\phi(g)^{-1} = \phi(ghg^{-1}) \in \phi(H)$ , since  $H$  is normal in  $G$ .

Property 5 follows directly from property 6 of Theorem 10.1 and the fact that all cosets of  $\text{Ker } \phi = \phi^{-1}(e)$  have the same number of elements.

To prove property 6, let  $\phi_H$  denote the restriction of  $\phi$  to the elements of  $H$ . Then  $\phi_H$  is a homomorphism from  $H$  onto  $\phi(H)$ . Suppose  $|\text{Ker } \phi_H| = t$ . Then, by property 5,  $\phi_H$  is a  $t$ -to-1 mapping. So,  $|\phi(H)|t = |H|$ .

To prove property 7, we use the One-Step Subgroup Test. Clearly,  $e \in \phi^{-1}(\bar{K})$ , so that  $\phi^{-1}(\bar{K})$  is not empty. Let  $k_1, k_2 \in \phi^{-1}(\bar{K})$ . Then, by the definition of  $\phi^{-1}(\bar{K})$ , we know that  $\phi(k_1), \phi(k_2) \in \bar{K}$ . Thus,  $\phi(k_2)^{-1} \in \bar{K}$  as well and  $\phi(k_1 k_2^{-1}) = \phi(k_1)\phi(k_2)^{-1} \in \bar{K}$ . So, by the definition of  $\phi^{-1}(\bar{K})$ , we have  $k_1 k_2^{-1} \in \phi^{-1}(\bar{K})$ .

To prove property 8, we use the normality test given in Theorem 9.1. Note that every element in  $x\phi^{-1}(\bar{K})x^{-1}$  has the form  $xkx^{-1}$ , where  $\phi(k) \in \bar{K}$ . Thus, since  $\bar{K}$  is normal in  $\bar{G}$ ,  $\phi(xkx^{-1}) = \phi(x)\phi(k)(\phi(x))^{-1} \in \bar{K}$ , and, therefore,  $xkx^{-1} \in \phi^{-1}(\bar{K})$ .

Finally, property 9 follows directly from property 5. ■

A few remarks about Theorems 10.1 and 10.2 are in order. Students should remember the various properties of these theorems in words. For example, properties 2 and 3 of Theorem 10.2 say that the homomorphic image of a cyclic group is cyclic and the homomorphic image of an Abelian group is Abelian. Property 4 of Theorem 10.2 says that the homomorphic image of a normal subgroup of  $G$  is normal in the image of  $G$ . Property 5 of Theorem 10.2 says that if  $\phi$  is a homomorphism from  $G$  to  $\bar{G}$ , then every element of  $\bar{G}$  that gets “hit” by  $\phi$  gets hit the same number of times as does the identity. The set  $\phi^{-1}(g')$  defined in property 6 of Theorem 10.1 is called the *inverse image of  $g'$*  (or the *pullback of  $g'$* ). Note that the inverse image of an element is a coset of the kernel and that every element in that coset has the same image. Similarly, the set  $\phi^{-1}(\bar{K})$  defined in property 7 of Theorem 10.2 is called the *inverse image of  $\bar{K}$*  (or the *pullback of  $\bar{K}$* ).

Property 6 of Theorem 10.1 is reminiscent of something from linear algebra and differential equations. Recall that if  $x$  is a particular solution to a system of linear equations and  $S$  is the entire solution set of the corresponding homogeneous system of linear equations, then  $x + S$  is the entire solution set of the nonhomogeneous system. In reality, this statement is just a special case of property 6. Properties 1 and 6 of Theorem 10.1 and property 5 of Theorem 10.2 are pictorially represented in Figure 10.1.

The special case of property 8 of Theorem 10.2, where  $\bar{K} = \{e\}$ , is of such importance that we single it out.

### ■ Corollary Kernels Are Normal

*Let  $\phi$  be a group homomorphism from  $G$  to  $\bar{G}$ . Then  $\text{Ker } \phi$  is a normal subgroup of  $G$ .*

The next two examples illustrate several properties of Theorems 10.1 and 10.2.

**■ EXAMPLE 8** Consider the mapping  $\phi$  from  $\mathbf{C}^*$  to  $\mathbf{C}^*$  given by  $\phi(x) = x^4$ . Since  $(xy)^4 = x^4y^4$ ,  $\phi$  is a homomorphism. Clearly,  $\text{Ker } \phi = \{x \mid x^4 = 1\} = \{1, -1, i, -i\}$ . So, by property 5 of Theorem 10.2, we know that  $\phi$  is a 4-to-1 mapping. Now let's find all elements that map to, say, 2. Certainly,  $\phi(\sqrt[4]{2}) = 2$ . Then, by property 6 of Theorem 10.1, the set of all elements that map to 2 is  $\sqrt[4]{2} \text{Ker } \phi = \{\sqrt[4]{2}, -\sqrt[4]{2}, \sqrt[4]{2}i, -\sqrt[4]{2}i\}$ .

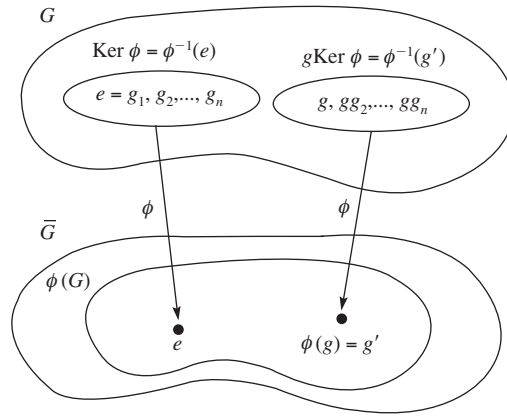


Figure 10.1

Finally, we verify a specific instance of property 3 of Theorem 10.1 and of properties 2 and 6 of Theorem 10.2. Let  $H = \langle \cos 30^\circ + i \sin 30^\circ \rangle$ . It follows from DeMoivre's Theorem (Example 12 in Chapter 0) that  $|H| = 12$ ,  $\phi(H) = \langle \cos 120^\circ + i \sin 120^\circ \rangle$ , and  $|\phi(H)| = 3$ . ■

■ **EXAMPLE 9** Define  $\phi: Z_{12} \rightarrow Z_{12}$  by  $\phi(x) = 3x$ . To verify that  $\phi$  is a homomorphism, we observe that in  $Z_{12}$ ,  $3(a + b) = 3a + 3b$  (since the group operation is addition modulo 12). Direct calculations show that  $\text{Ker } \phi = \{0, 4, 8\}$ . Thus, we know from property 5 of Theorem 10.2 that  $\phi$  is a 3-to-1 mapping. Since  $\phi(2) = 6$ , we have by property 6 of Theorem 10.1 that  $\phi^{-1}(6) = 2 + \text{Ker } \phi = \{2, 6, 10\}$ . Notice also that  $\langle 2 \rangle$  is cyclic and  $\phi(\langle 2 \rangle) = \{0, 6\}$  is cyclic. Moreover,  $|2| = 6$  and  $|\phi(2)| = |6| = 2$ , so  $|\phi(2)|$  divides  $|2|$  in agreement with property 3 of Theorem 10.1. Letting  $\bar{K} = \{0, 6\}$ , we see that the subgroup  $\phi^{-1}(\bar{K}) = \{0, 2, 4, 6, 8, 10\}$ . This verifies property 7 of Theorem 10.2 in this particular case. ■

The next example illustrates how one can easily determine all homomorphisms from a cyclic group to a cyclic group.

■ **EXAMPLE 10** We determine all homomorphisms from  $Z_{12}$  to  $Z_{30}$ . By property 2 of Theorem 10.1, such a homomorphism is completely specified by the image of 1. That is, if 1 maps to  $a$ , then  $x$  maps to  $xa$ . Lagrange's Theorem and property 3 of Theorem 10.1 require that  $|a|$  divide both 12 and 30. So,  $|a| = 1, 2, 3$ , or 6. Thus,  $a = 0, 15, 10, 20, 5$ , or 25. This gives us a list of candidates for the homomorphisms. That each of these six possibilities yields an operation-preserving, well-defined function can now be verified by direct calculations. [Note that  $\gcd(12, 30) = 6$ . This is not a coincidence!] ■

■ **EXAMPLE 11** The mapping from  $S_n$  to  $Z_2$  that takes an even permutation to 0 and an odd permutation to 1 is a homomorphism. Figure 10.2 illustrates the telescoping nature of the mapping.

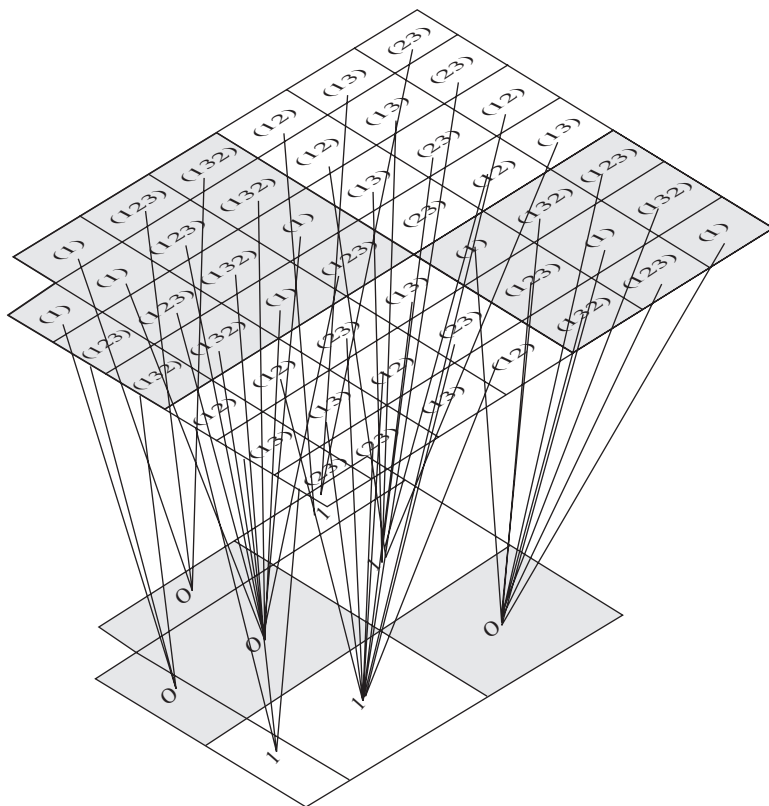


Figure 10.2 Homomorphism from  $S_3$  to  $Z_2$ .

## The First Isomorphism Theorem

In Chapter 9, we showed that for a group  $G$  and a normal subgroup  $H$ , we could arrange the Cayley table of  $G$  into boxes that represented the cosets of  $H$  in  $G$ , and that these boxes then became a Cayley table for  $G/H$ . The next theorem shows that for any homomorphism  $\phi$  of  $G$  and the normal subgroup  $\text{Ker } \phi$ , the same process produces a Cayley table isomorphic to the homomorphic image of  $G$ . Thus, homomorphisms, like factor groups, cause a *systematic* collapse of a group to a simpler but closely related group. This can be likened to viewing a group through the reverse end of a telescope—the general features of the group are present, but the apparent size is diminished. The important relationship between homomorphisms and factor groups given below is often called the Fundamental Theorem of Group Homomorphisms.

### ■ Theorem 10.3 First Isomorphism Theorem (Jordan, 1870)

*Let  $\phi$  be a group homomorphism from  $G$  to  $\overline{G}$ . Then the mapping from  $G/\text{Ker } \phi$  to  $\phi(G)$ , given by  $g\text{Ker } \phi \rightarrow \phi(g)$ , is an isomorphism. In symbols,  $G/\text{Ker } \phi \approx \phi(G)$ .*

**PROOF** Let us use  $\psi$  to denote the correspondence  $g\text{Ker } \phi \rightarrow \phi(g)$ . That  $\psi$  is well-defined (that is, the correspondence is independent of the particular coset representative chosen) and one-to-one follows directly from property 5 of Theorem 10.1. To show that  $\psi$  is operation-preserving, observe that  $\psi(x\text{Ker } \phi \ y\text{Ker } \phi) = \psi(xy\text{Ker } \phi) = \phi(xy) = \phi(x)\phi(y) = \psi(x\text{Ker } \phi)\psi(y\text{Ker } \phi)$ . ■

The next example demonstrates how Theorem 10.3 is often used to prove that a factor group  $G/H$  is isomorphic to some particular group  $\overline{G}$  by instead showing the less cumbersome problem of proving that there is a homomorphism from  $G$  onto  $\overline{G}$ .

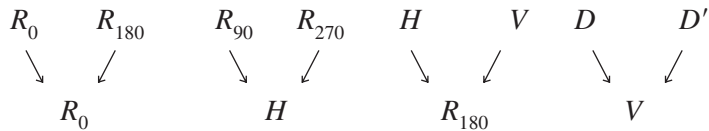
■ **EXAMPLE 12** Recall that  $SL(2, \mathbf{R}) = \{A \in GL(2, \mathbf{R}) \mid \det A = 1\}$  and let  $H = \{A \in GL(2, \mathbf{R}) \mid \det A = \pm 1\}$ . Then the mapping  $\phi(A) = \det A$  from  $GL(2, \mathbf{R})$  onto  $\mathbf{R}^*$  shows that  $GL(2, \mathbf{R})/SL(2, \mathbf{R}) \approx \mathbf{R}^*$  and the mapping  $\phi(A) = (\det A)^2$  from  $GL(2, \mathbf{R})$  onto  $\mathbf{R}^+$  shows that  $GL(2, \mathbf{R})/H \approx \mathbf{R}^+$ . ■

The next corollary follows directly from Theorem 10.3, property 1 of Theorem 10.2, and Lagrange's Theorem.

### ■ Corollary

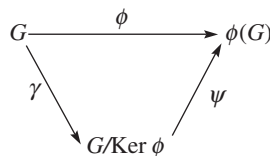
*If  $\phi$  is a homomorphism from a finite group  $G$  to  $\overline{G}$ , then  $|\phi(G)|$  divides  $|G|$  and  $|\overline{G}|$ .*

■ **EXAMPLE 13** To illustrate Theorem 10.3 and its proof, consider the homomorphism  $\phi$  from  $D_4$  to itself given by the following.



Then  $\text{Ker } \phi = \{R_0, R_{180}\}$ , and the mapping  $\psi$  in Theorem 10.3 is  $R_0\text{Ker } \phi \rightarrow R_0$ ,  $R_{90}\text{Ker } \phi \rightarrow H$ ,  $H\text{Ker } \phi \rightarrow R_{180}$ ,  $D\text{Ker } \phi \rightarrow V$ . It is straightforward to verify that the mapping  $\psi$  is an isomorphism. ■

Mathematicians often give a pictorial representation of Theorem 10.3, as follows:



where  $\gamma: G \rightarrow G/\text{Ker } \phi$  is defined as  $\gamma(g) = g\text{Ker } \phi$ . The mapping  $\gamma$  is called the *natural mapping* from  $G$  to  $G/\text{Ker } \phi$ . Our proof of Theorem 10.3 shows that  $\psi\gamma = \phi$ . In this case, one says that the preceding diagram is *commutative*.

As a consequence of Theorem 10.3, we see that all homomorphic images of  $G$  can be determined using  $G$ . We may simply consider the various factor groups of  $G$ . For example, we know that the homomorphic image of an Abelian group is Abelian because the factor group of an Abelian group is Abelian. We know that the number of homomorphic images of a cyclic group  $G$  of order  $n$  is the number of divisors of  $n$ , since there is exactly one subgroup of  $G$  (and therefore one factor group of  $G$ ) for each divisor of  $n$ . (Be careful: The number of homomorphisms of a cyclic group of order  $n$  need not be the same as the number of divisors of  $n$ , since different homomorphisms can have the same image.)

An appreciation for Theorem 10.3 can be gained by looking at a few examples.

#### ■ EXAMPLE 14 $\mathbb{Z}/\langle n \rangle \approx \mathbb{Z}_n$

Consider the mapping from  $\mathbb{Z}$  to  $\mathbb{Z}_n$  defined in Example 5. Clearly, its kernel is  $\langle n \rangle$ . So, by Theorem 10.3,  $\mathbb{Z}/\langle n \rangle \approx \mathbb{Z}_n$ . ■

#### ■ EXAMPLE 15 Wrapping Function

Recall the wrapping function  $W$  from trigonometry. The real number line is wrapped around a unit circle in the plane centered at  $(0, 0)$  with the number 0 on the number line at the point  $(1, 0)$ , the positive reals in the counterclockwise direction and the negative reals in the clockwise direction (see Figure 10.3). The function  $W$  assigns to each real number  $a$  the point  $a$  radians from  $(1, 0)$  on the circle. This mapping is a homomorphism from the group  $\mathbf{R}$  under addition onto the circle group (the group of complex numbers of magnitude 1 under multiplication). Indeed, it follows from elementary facts of trigonometry that  $W(x) = \cos x + i \sin x$  and  $W(x + y) = W(x)W(y)$ . Since  $W$  is periodic of period  $2\pi$ ,  $\text{Ker } W = \langle 2\pi \rangle$ . So, from the First Isomorphism Theorem, we see that  $\mathbf{R}/\langle 2\pi \rangle$  is isomorphic to the circle group. ■

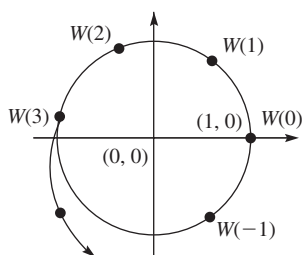


Figure 10.3

Our next example is a theorem that is used repeatedly in Chapters 24 and 25.

■ **EXAMPLE 16 *N/C*Theorem**

Let  $H$  be a subgroup of a group  $G$ . Recall that the normalizer of  $H$  in  $G$  is  $N(H) = \{x \in G \mid xHx^{-1} = H\}$  and the centralizer of  $H$  in  $G$  is  $C(H) = \{x \in G \mid xhx^{-1} = h \text{ for all } h \text{ in } H\}$ . Consider the mapping from  $N(H)$  to  $\text{Aut}(H)$  given by  $g \rightarrow \phi_g$ , where  $\phi_g$  is the inner automorphism of  $H$  induced by  $g$  [that is,  $\phi_g(h) = ghg^{-1}$  for all  $h$  in  $H$ ]. This mapping is a homomorphism with kernel  $C(H)$ . So, by Theorem 10.3,  $N(H)/C(H)$  is isomorphic to a subgroup of  $\text{Aut}(H)$ . ■

As an application of the *N/C* Theorem, we will show that every group of order 35 is cyclic.

■ **EXAMPLE 17** Let  $G$  be a group of order 35. By Lagrange's Theorem, every nonidentity element of  $G$  has order 5, 7, or 35. If some element has order 35,  $G$  is cyclic. So we may assume that all nonidentity elements have order 5 or 7. However, not all such elements can have order 5, since elements of order 5 come 4 at a time (if  $|x| = 5$ , then  $|x^2| = |x^3| = |x^4| = 5$ ) and 4 does not divide 34. Similarly, since 6 does not divide 34, not all nonidentity elements can have order 7. So,  $G$  has elements of order 7 and order 5. Since  $G$  has an element of order 7, it has a subgroup of order 7. Let us call it  $H$ . In fact,  $H$  is the only subgroup of  $G$  of order 7, for if  $K$  is another subgroup of  $G$  of order 7, we have by Theorem 7.2 that  $|HK| = |H||K|/|H \cap K| = 7 \cdot 7/1 = 49$ . But, of course, this is impossible in a group of order 35. Since for every  $a$  in  $G$ ,  $aHa^{-1}$  is also a subgroup of  $G$  of order 7, we must have  $aHa^{-1} = H$ . So,  $N(H) = G$ . Since  $H$  has prime order, it is cyclic and therefore Abelian. In particular,  $C(H)$  contains  $H$ . So, 7 divides  $|C(H)|$  and  $|C(H)|$  divides 35. It follows, then, that  $C(H) = G$  or  $C(H) = H$ . If  $C(H) = G$ , then we may obtain an element  $x$  of order 35 by letting  $x = hk$ , where  $h$  is a nonidentity element of  $H$  and  $k$  has order 5. On the other hand, if  $C(H) = H$ , then  $|C(H)| = 7$  and  $|N(H)/C(H)| = 35/7 = 5$ . However, 5 does not divide  $|\text{Aut}(H)| = |\text{Aut}(Z_7)| = 6$ . This contradiction shows that  $G$  is cyclic. ■

The corollary of Theorem 10.2 says that the kernel of every homomorphism of a group is a normal subgroup of the group. We conclude this chapter by verifying that the converse of this statement is also true.

## ■ Theorem 10.4 Normal Subgroups Are Kernels

*Every normal subgroup of a group  $G$  is the kernel of a homomorphism of  $G$ . In particular, a normal subgroup  $N$  is the kernel of the mapping  $g \rightarrow gN$  from  $G$  to  $G/N$ .*

**PROOF** Define  $\gamma: G \rightarrow G/N$  by  $\gamma(g) = gN$ . (This mapping is called the *natural homomorphism* from  $G$  to  $G/N$ .) Then,  $\gamma(xy) = (xy)N = xNyN = \gamma(x)\gamma(y)$ . Moreover,  $g \in \text{Ker } \gamma$  if and only if  $gN = \gamma(g) = N$ , which is true if and only if  $g \in N$  (see property 2 of the lemma in Chapter 7). ■

Examples 12, 13, 14, and 15 illustrate the utility of the First Isomorphism Theorem. But what about homomorphisms in general? Why would one care to study a homomorphism of a group? The answer is that, just as was the case with factor groups of a group, homomorphic images of a group tell us *some* of the properties of the original group. One measure of the likeness of a group and its homomorphic image is the size of the kernel. If the kernel of the homomorphism of group  $G$  is the identity, then the image of  $G$  tells us everything (group theoretically) about  $G$  (the two being isomorphic). On the other hand, if the kernel of the homomorphism is  $G$  itself, then the image tells us nothing about  $G$ . Between these two extremes, some information about  $G$  is preserved and some is lost. The utility of a particular homomorphism lies in its ability to preserve the group properties we want, while losing some inessential ones. In this way, we have replaced  $G$  by a group less complicated (and therefore easier to study) than  $G$ ; but, in the process, we have saved enough information to answer questions that we have about  $G$  itself. For example, if  $G$  is a group of order 60 and  $G$  has a homomorphic image of order 12 that is cyclic, then we know from properties 5, 7, and 8 of Theorem 10.2 that  $G$  has normal subgroups of orders 5, 10, 15, 20, 30, and 60.

The next example illustrates how one can use a homomorphism to simplify a problem.

■ **EXAMPLE 18** Suppose we are asked to find an infinite group that is the union of three proper subgroups. Instead of attempting to do this directly, we first make the problem easier by finding a finite group that is the union of three proper subgroups. Since no cyclic group can be the union of proper subgroups the smallest candidate is a noncyclic group of order 4 group such as  $U(8)$ . Observing that  $U(8)$  is the union of  $H = \{1, 3\}$ ,  $K = \{1, 5\}$ , and  $L = \{1, 7\}$  we have found our finite group. Now all we need do is think of an infinite group that has  $U(8)$  as a homomorphic image and pull back  $H$ ,  $K$ , and  $L$ , and our original



problem is solved. Clearly, the mapping from  $U(8) \oplus Z$  onto  $U(8)$  given by  $\phi(a, b) = a$  is such a mapping, and therefore  $U(8) \oplus Z$  is the union of the proper subgroups  $\phi^{-1}(H)$ ,  $\phi^{-1}(K)$  and  $\phi^{-1}(L)$ . ■

Although an isomorphism is a special case of a homomorphism, the two concepts have entirely different roles. Whereas isomorphisms allow us to look at a group in an alternative way, homomorphisms act as investigative tools. The following analogy between homomorphisms and photography may be instructive.<sup>†</sup> A photograph of a person cannot tell us the person's exact height, weight, or age. Nevertheless, we *may* be able to decide from a photograph whether the person is tall or short, heavy or thin, old or young, male or female. In the same way, a homomorphic image of a group gives us *some* information about the group.

In certain branches of group theory, and especially in physics and chemistry, one often wants to know all homomorphic images of a group that are matrix groups over the complex numbers (these are called *group representations*). Here, we may carry our analogy with photography one step further by saying that this is like wanting photographs of a person from many different angles (front view, profile, head-to-toe view, close-up, etc.), as well as x-rays! Just as this composite information from the photographs reveals much about the person, several homomorphic images of a group reveal much about the group.

## Exercises

The greater the difficulty, the more glory in surmounting it. Skillful pilots gain their reputation from storms and tempests.

Epicurus

1. Prove that the mapping given in Example 2 is a homomorphism.
2. Prove that the mapping given in Example 3 is a homomorphism.
3. Prove that the mapping given in Example 4 is a homomorphism.
4. Prove that the mapping given in Example 11 is a homomorphism.
5. Let  $\mathbf{R}^*$  be the group of nonzero real numbers under multiplication, and let  $r$  be a positive integer. Show that the mapping that takes  $x$  to  $x^r$  is a homomorphism from  $\mathbf{R}^*$  to  $\mathbf{R}^*$  and determine the kernel. Which values of  $r$  yield an isomorphism?

<sup>†</sup>“All perception of truth is the detection of an analogy.” Henry David Thoreau, *Journal*.

6. Let  $G$  be the group of all polynomials with real coefficients under addition. For each  $f$  in  $G$ , let  $\int f$  denote the antiderivative of  $f$  that passes through the point  $(0, 0)$ . Show that the mapping  $f \rightarrow \int f$  from  $G$  to  $G$  is a homomorphism. What is the kernel of this mapping? Is this mapping a homomorphism if  $\int f$  denotes the antiderivative of  $f$  that passes through  $(0, 1)$ ?
7. If  $\phi$  is a homomorphism from  $G$  to  $H$  and  $\sigma$  is a homomorphism from  $H$  to  $K$ , show that  $\sigma\phi$  is a homomorphism from  $G$  to  $K$ . How are  $\text{Ker } \phi$  and  $\text{Ker } \sigma\phi$  related? If  $\phi$  and  $\sigma$  are onto and  $G$  is finite, describe  $[\text{Ker } \sigma\phi : \text{Ker } \phi]$  in terms of  $|H|$  and  $|K|$ .
8. Let  $G$  be a group of permutations. For each  $\sigma$  in  $G$ , define

$$\text{sgn}(\sigma) = \begin{cases} +1 & \text{if } \sigma \text{ is an even permutation,} \\ -1 & \text{if } \sigma \text{ is an odd permutation.} \end{cases}$$

Prove that  $\text{sgn}$  is a homomorphism from  $G$  to the multiplicative group  $\{+1, -1\}$ . What is the kernel? Why does this homomorphism allow you to conclude that  $A_n$  is a normal subgroup of  $S_n$  of index 2? Why does this prove Exercise 23 of Chapter 5?

9. Prove that the mapping from  $G \oplus H$  to  $G$  given by  $(g, h) \rightarrow g$  is a homomorphism. What is the kernel? This mapping is called the *projection* of  $G \oplus H$  onto  $G$ .
10. Let  $G$  be a subgroup of some dihedral group. For each  $x$  in  $G$ , define

$$\phi(x) = \begin{cases} +1 & \text{if } x \text{ is a rotation,} \\ -1 & \text{if } x \text{ is a reflection.} \end{cases}$$

Prove that  $\phi$  is a homomorphism from  $G$  to the multiplicative group  $\{+1, -1\}$ . What is the kernel? Why does this prove Exercise 26 of Chapter 3?

11. Prove that  $(Z \oplus Z)/(\langle(a, 0)\rangle \times \langle(0, b)\rangle)$  is isomorphic to  $Z_a \oplus Z_b$ .
12. Suppose that  $k$  is a divisor of  $n$ . Prove that  $Z_n/\langle k \rangle \approx Z_k$ .
13. Prove that  $(A \oplus B)/(A \oplus \{e\}) \approx B$ .
14. Explain why the correspondence  $x \rightarrow 3x$  from  $Z_{12}$  to  $Z_{10}$  is not a homomorphism.
15. Suppose that  $\phi$  is a homomorphism from  $Z_{30}$  to  $Z_{30}$  and  $\text{Ker } \phi = \{0, 10, 20\}$ . If  $\phi(23) = 9$ , determine all elements that map to 9.
16. Prove that there is no homomorphism from  $Z_8 \oplus Z_2$  onto  $Z_4 \oplus Z_4$ .
17. Prove that there is no homomorphism from  $Z_{16} \oplus Z_2$  onto  $Z_4 \oplus Z_4$ .
18. Can there be a homomorphism from  $Z_4 \oplus Z_4$  onto  $Z_8$ ? Can there be a homomorphism from  $Z_{16}$  onto  $Z_2 \oplus Z_2$ ? Explain your answers.
19. Suppose that there is a homomorphism  $\phi$  from  $Z_{17}$  to some group and that  $\phi$  is not one-to-one. Determine  $\phi$ .

20. How many homomorphisms are there from  $Z_{20}$  onto  $Z_8$ ? How many are there to  $Z_8$ ?
21. If  $\phi$  is a homomorphism from  $Z_{30}$  onto a group of order 5, determine the kernel of  $\phi$ .
22. Suppose that  $\phi$  is a homomorphism from a finite group  $G$  onto  $\overline{G}$  and that  $\overline{G}$  has an element of order 8. Prove that  $G$  has an element of order 8. Generalize.
23. Let  $\phi$  be a homomorphism from a finite group  $G$  to  $\overline{G}$ . If  $H$  is a subgroup of  $\overline{G}$  give a formula for  $|\phi^{-1}(H)|$  in terms of  $|H|$  and  $\phi$ .
24. Suppose that  $\phi: Z_{50} \rightarrow Z_{15}$  is a group homomorphism with  $\phi(7) = 6$ .
  - a. Determine  $\phi(x)$ .
  - b. Determine the image of  $\phi$ .
  - c. Determine the kernel of  $\phi$ .
  - d. Determine  $\phi^{-1}(3)$ . That is, determine the set of all elements that map to 3.
25. How many homomorphisms are there from  $Z_{20}$  onto  $Z_{10}$ ? How many are there to  $Z_{10}$ ?
26. Determine all homomorphisms from  $Z_4$  to  $Z_2 \oplus Z_2$ .
27. Determine all homomorphisms from  $Z_n$  to itself.
28. Suppose that  $\phi$  is a homomorphism from  $S_4$  onto  $Z_2$ . Determine  $\text{Ker } \phi$ . Determine all homomorphisms from  $S_4$  to  $Z_2$ .
29. Suppose that there is a homomorphism from a finite group  $G$  onto  $Z_{10}$ . Prove that  $G$  has normal subgroups of indexes 2 and 5.
30. Suppose that  $\phi$  is a homomorphism from a group  $G$  onto  $Z_6 \oplus Z_2$  and that the kernel of  $\phi$  has order 5. Explain why  $G$  must have normal subgroups of orders 5, 10, 15, 20, 30, and 60.
31. Suppose that  $\phi$  is a homomorphism from  $U(30)$  to  $U(30)$  and that  $\text{Ker } \phi = \{1, 11\}$ . If  $\phi(7) = 7$ , find all elements of  $U(30)$  that map to 7.
32. Find a homomorphism  $\phi$  from  $U(30)$  to  $U(30)$  with kernel  $\{1, 11\}$  and  $\phi(7) = 7$ .
33. Suppose that  $\phi$  is a homomorphism from  $U(40)$  to  $U(40)$  and that  $\text{Ker } \phi = \{1, 9, 17, 33\}$ . If  $\phi(11) = 11$ , find all elements of  $U(40)$  that map to 11.
34. Prove that there is no homomorphism from  $A_4$  onto  $Z_2$ .
35. Prove that the mapping  $\phi: Z \oplus Z \rightarrow Z$  given by  $(a, b) \rightarrow a - b$  is a homomorphism. What is the kernel of  $\phi$ ? Describe the set  $\phi^{-1}(3)$  (that is, all elements that map to 3).

36. Suppose that there is a homomorphism  $\phi$  from  $Z \oplus Z$  to a group  $G$  such that  $\phi((3, 2)) = a$  and  $\phi((2, 1)) = b$ . Determine  $\phi((4, 4))$  in terms of  $a$  and  $b$ . Assume that the operation of  $G$  is addition.
37. Let  $H = \{z \in \mathbf{C}^* \mid |z| = 1\}$ . Prove that  $\mathbf{C}^*/H$  is isomorphic to  $\mathbf{R}^+$ , the group of positive real numbers under multiplication.  
(Recall  $|a + bi| = \sqrt{a^2 + b^2}$ .)
38. Let  $\alpha$  be a homomorphism from  $G_1$  to  $H_1$  and  $\beta$  be a homomorphism from  $G_2$  to  $H_2$ . Determine the kernel of the homomorphism  $\gamma$  from  $G_1 \oplus G_2$  to  $H_1 \oplus H_2$  defined by  $\gamma(g_1, g_2) = (\alpha(g_1), \beta(g_2))$ .
39. Prove that the mapping  $x \rightarrow x^6$  from  $\mathbf{C}^*$  to  $\mathbf{C}^*$  is a homomorphism. What is the kernel?
40. For each pair of positive integers  $m$  and  $n$ , we can define a homomorphism from  $Z$  to  $Z_m \oplus Z_n$  by  $x \rightarrow (x \bmod m, x \bmod n)$ . What is the kernel when  $(m, n) = (3, 4)$ ? What is the kernel when  $(m, n) = (6, 4)$ ? Generalize.
41. (Second Isomorphism Theorem) If  $K$  is a subgroup of  $G$  and  $N$  is a normal subgroup of  $G$ , prove that  $K/(K \cap N)$  is isomorphic to  $KN/N$ .
42. (Third Isomorphism Theorem) If  $M$  and  $N$  are normal subgroups of  $G$  and  $N \leq M$ , prove that  $(G/N)/(M/N) \approx G/M$ . Think of this as a form of “cancelling out” the  $N$  in the numerator and denominator.
43. Prove that the only homomorphism from  $A_4$  to a finite group with order not divisible by 3 is the trivial mapping that takes every element to the identity.
44. Let  $k$  be a divisor of  $n$ . Consider the homomorphism from  $U(n)$  to  $U(k)$  given by  $x \rightarrow x \bmod k$ . What is the relationship between this homomorphism and the subgroup  $U_k(n)$  of  $U(n)$ ?
45. Determine all homomorphic images of  $D_4$  (up to isomorphism).
46. Let  $N$  be a normal subgroup of a finite group  $G$ . Use the theorems of this chapter to prove that the order of the group element  $gN$  in  $G/N$  divides the order of  $g$ .
47. Suppose that  $G$  is a finite group and that  $Z_{10}$  is a homomorphic image of  $G$ . What can we say about  $|G|$ ? Generalize.
48. Suppose that  $Z_{10}$  and  $Z_{15}$  are both homomorphic images of a finite group  $G$ . What can be said about  $|G|$ ? Generalize.
49. Suppose that for each prime  $p$ ,  $Z_p$  is the homomorphic image of a group  $G$ . What can we say about  $|G|$ ? Give an example of such a group.

50. (For students who have had linear algebra.) Suppose that  $x$  is a particular solution to a system of linear equations and that  $S$  is the entire solution set of the corresponding homogeneous system of linear equations. Explain why property 6 of Theorem 10.1 guarantees that  $x + S$  is the entire solution set of the nonhomogeneous system. In particular, describe the relevant groups and the homomorphism between them.
51. Let  $N$  be a normal subgroup of a group  $G$ . Use property 7 of Theorem 10.2 to prove that every subgroup of  $G/N$  has the form  $H/N$ , where  $H$  is a subgroup of  $G$ . (This exercise is referred to in Chapter 11 and Chapter 24.)
52. Show that a homomorphism defined on a cyclic group is completely determined by its action on a generator of the group.
53. Use the First Isomorphism Theorem to prove Theorem 9.4.
54. Determine all homomorphisms from  $D_5$  onto  $Z_2 \oplus Z_2$ . Determine all homomorphisms from  $D_5$  to  $Z_2 \oplus Z_2$ .
55. Let  $Z[x]$  be the group of polynomials in  $x$  with integer coefficients under addition. Prove that the mapping from  $Z[x]$  into  $Z$  given by  $f(x) \rightarrow f(3)$  is a homomorphism. Give a geometric description of the kernel of this homomorphism. Generalize.
56. Prove that the mapping from  $\mathbf{R}$  under addition to  $SL(2, \mathbf{R})$  that takes  $x$  to

$$\begin{bmatrix} \cos x & \sin x \\ -\sin x & \cos x \end{bmatrix}$$

is a group homomorphism. What is the kernel of the homomorphism?

57. Suppose there is a homomorphism  $\phi$  from  $G$  onto  $Z_2 \oplus Z_2$ . Prove that  $G$  is the union of three proper normal subgroups.
58. If  $H$  and  $K$  are normal subgroups of  $G$  and  $H \cap K = \{e\}$ , prove that  $G$  is isomorphic to a subgroup of  $G/H \oplus G/K$ .
59. If  $\phi$  is a homomorphism from  $G$  onto  $H$ , prove that  $\phi(Z(G)) \subseteq Z(H)$ .
60. Suppose that  $\phi$  is a homomorphism from  $D_{12}$  onto  $D_3$ . What is  $\phi(R_{180})$ ?
61. Prove that every group of order 77 is cyclic.
62. Determine all homomorphisms from  $Z$  onto  $S_3$ . Determine all homomorphisms from  $Z$  to  $S_3$ .
63. Let  $G$  be an Abelian group. Determine all homomorphisms from  $S_3$  to  $G$ .
64. If  $m$  and  $n$  are positive integers prove that the mapping from  $Z_m$  to  $Z_n$  given by  $\phi(x) = x \bmod n$  is a homomorphism if and only if  $n$  divides  $m$ .

65. Prove that the mapping from  $\mathbf{C}^*$  to  $\mathbf{C}^*$  given by  $\phi(x) = x^2$  is a homomorphism and that  $\mathbf{C}^*/\{1, -1\}$  is isomorphic to  $\mathbf{C}^*$ . What happens if  $\mathbf{C}^*$  is replaced by  $\mathbf{R}^*$ ?
66. Let  $p$  be a prime. Determine the number of homomorphisms from  $Z_p \oplus Z_p$  into  $Z_p$ .

## Computer Exercise

A computer exercise for this chapter is available at the website:

<http://www.d.umn.edu/~jgallian>

## Suggested Readings

A. Crans, T. Fiore, and R. Satyendra, “Musical Actions of Dihedral Groups,” *The American Mathematical Monthly* 116 (2009):479-495.  
Available at <http://arxiv.org/abs/0711.1873>

In this award winning article the authors illustrate how music theorists have modeled works of music as diverse as Hindemith and the Beatles using the dihedral group of order 24.

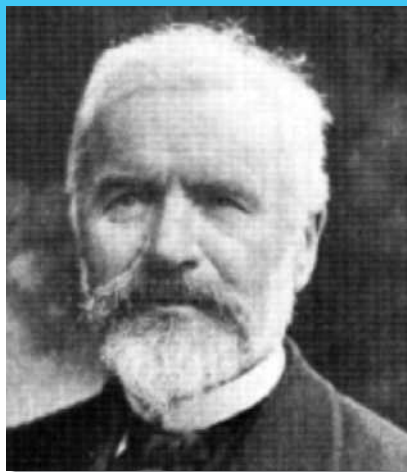
Jeremiah W. Johnson, “The Number of Group Homomorphisms from  $D_m$  into  $D_n$ ,” *The College Mathematics Journal* 44(2013): 190–192.  
Available at <http://arxiv.org/pdf/1201.2363>

In this article the author gives a formula for the number of group homomorphisms between any two dihedral groups using elementary group theory only.

## Camille Jordan

Although these contributions [to analysis and topology] would have been enough to rank Jordan very high among his mathematical contemporaries, it is chiefly as an algebraist that he reached celebrity when he was barely thirty; and during the next forty years he was universally regarded as the undisputed master of group theory.

J. DIEUDONNÉ, *Dictionary of Scientific Biography*



The Granger Collection, NYC

CAMILLE JORDAN was born into a well-to-do family on January 5, 1838, in Lyons, France. Like his father, he graduated from the École Polytechnique and became an engineer. Nearly all of his 120 research papers in mathematics were written before his retirement from engineering in 1885. From 1873 until 1912, Jordan taught simultaneously at the École Polytechnique and at the College of France.

In the great French tradition, Jordan was a universal mathematician who published in nearly every branch of mathematics. Among the concepts named after him are the Jordan canonical form in matrix theory, the Jordan curve theorem from topology, and the Jordan–Hölder Theorem from group theory. His classic book *Traité des substitutions*,

published in 1870, was the first to be devoted solely to group theory and its applications to other branches of mathematics.

Another book that had great influence and set a new standard for rigor was his *Cours d'analyse*. This book gave the first clear definitions of the notions of volume and multiple integral. Nearly 100 years after this book appeared, the distinguished mathematician and mathematical historian B. L. van der Waerden wrote, “For me, every single chapter of the *Cours d'analyse* is a pleasure to read.” Jordan died in Paris on January 22, 1922.

To find more information about Jordan, visit:

[http://www-groups.dcs  
.st-and.ac.uk/~history/](http://www-groups.dcs.st-and.ac.uk/~history/)

# 11

## Fundamental Theorem of Finite Abelian Groups

By a small sample we may judge of the whole piece.

Miguel De Cervantes, *Don Quixote*

Mathematical truths are inevitable.

Edward Frenkel, *Love and Math*

### The Fundamental Theorem

In this chapter, we present a theorem that describes to an algebraist's eye (that is, up to isomorphism) all finite Abelian groups in a standardized way. Before giving the proof, which is long and difficult, we discuss some consequences of the theorem and its proof. The first proof of the theorem was given by Leopold Kronecker in 1858.

#### ■ Theorem 11.1 Fundamental Theorem of Finite Abelian Groups

*Every finite Abelian group is a direct product of cyclic groups of prime-power order. Moreover, the number of terms in the product and the orders of the cyclic groups are uniquely determined by the group.*

Theorem 11.1 reduces questions about finite abelian groups to questions about cyclic groups, which when combined with the results of Chapter 4, usually yields complete answers to the questions.

Since a cyclic group of order  $n$  is isomorphic to  $Z_n$ , Theorem 11.1 shows that every finite Abelian group  $G$  is isomorphic to a group of the form

$$Z_{p_1^{n_1}} \oplus Z_{p_2^{n_2}} \oplus \cdots \oplus Z_{p_k^{n_k}},$$

where the  $p_i$ 's are not necessarily distinct primes and the prime powers  $p_1^{n_1}, p_2^{n_2}, \dots, p_k^{n_k}$  are uniquely determined by  $G$ . Writing a group in this form is called *determining the isomorphism class of  $G$* .



## The Isomorphism Classes of Abelian Groups

The Fundamental Theorem is extremely powerful. As an application, we can use it as an algorithm for constructing all Abelian groups of any order. Let's look at groups whose orders have the form  $p^k$ , where  $p$  is prime and  $k \leq 4$ . In general, there is one group of order  $p^k$  for each set of positive integers whose sum is  $k$  (such a set is called a *partition* of  $k$ ); that is, if  $k$  can be written as

$$k = n_1 + n_2 + \cdots + n_r,$$

where each  $n_i$  is a positive integer, then

$$Z_{p^{n_1}} \oplus Z_{p^{n_2}} \oplus \cdots \oplus Z_{p^{n_r}}$$

is an Abelian group of order  $p^k$ .

| Order of $G$ | Partitions of $k$ | Possible direct products for $G$       |
|--------------|-------------------|----------------------------------------|
| $p$          | 1                 | $Z_p$                                  |
| $p^2$        | 2                 | $Z_{p^2}$                              |
|              | 1 + 1             | $Z_p \oplus Z_p$                       |
| $p^3$        | 3                 | $Z_{p^3}$                              |
|              | 2 + 1             | $Z_{p^2} \oplus Z_p$                   |
|              | 1 + 1 + 1         | $Z_p \oplus Z_p \oplus Z_p$            |
| $p^4$        | 4                 | $Z_{p^4}$                              |
|              | 3 + 1             | $Z_{p^3} \oplus Z_p$                   |
|              | 2 + 2             | $Z_{p^2} \oplus Z_{p^2}$               |
|              | 2 + 1 + 1         | $Z_{p^2} \oplus Z_p \oplus Z_p$        |
|              | 1 + 1 + 1 + 1     | $Z_p \oplus Z_p \oplus Z_p \oplus Z_p$ |

Furthermore, the uniqueness portion of the Fundamental Theorem guarantees that distinct partitions of  $k$  yield distinct isomorphism classes. Thus, for example,  $Z_9 \oplus Z_3$  is not isomorphic to  $Z_3 \oplus Z_3 \oplus Z_3$ . A reliable mnemonic for comparing external direct products is the cancellation property: If  $A$  is *finite*, then

$$A \oplus B \approx A \oplus C \quad \text{if and only if} \quad B \approx C \quad (\text{see [1]}).$$

Thus,  $Z_4 \oplus Z_4$  is not isomorphic to  $Z_4 \oplus Z_2 \oplus Z_2$ , because  $Z_4$  is not isomorphic to  $Z_2 \oplus Z_2$ .

To appreciate fully the potency of the Fundamental Theorem, contrast the ease with which the Abelian groups of order  $p^k$ ,  $k \leq 4$ , were

determined with the corresponding problem for non-Abelian groups. Even a description of the two non-Abelian groups of order 8 is a challenge (see Theorem 26.4), and a description of the nine non-Abelian groups of order 16 is well beyond the scope of this text.

Now that we know how to construct all the Abelian groups of prime-power order, we move to the problem of constructing all Abelian groups of a certain order  $n$ , where  $n$  has two or more distinct prime divisors. We begin by writing  $n$  in prime-power decomposition form  $n = p_1^{n_1} p_2^{n_2} \cdots p_k^{n_k}$ . Next, we individually form all Abelian groups of order  $p_1^{n_1}$ , then  $p_2^{n_2}$ , and so on, as described earlier. Finally, we form all possible external direct products of these groups. For example, let  $n = 1176 = 2^3 \cdot 3 \cdot 7^2$ . Then, the complete list of the distinct isomorphism classes of Abelian groups of order 1176 is

$$\begin{aligned} &Z_8 \oplus Z_3 \oplus Z_{49}, \\ &Z_4 \oplus Z_2 \oplus Z_3 \oplus Z_{49}, \\ &Z_2 \oplus Z_2 \oplus Z_2 \oplus Z_3 \oplus Z_{49}, \\ &Z_8 \oplus Z_3 \oplus Z_7 \oplus Z_7, \\ &Z_4 \oplus Z_2 \oplus Z_3 \oplus Z_7 \oplus Z_7, \\ &Z_2 \oplus Z_2 \oplus Z_2 \oplus Z_3 \oplus Z_7 \oplus Z_7. \end{aligned}$$

If we are given any particular Abelian group  $G$  of order 1176, the question we want to answer about  $G$  is: Which of the preceding six isomorphism classes represents the structure of  $G$ ? We can answer this question by comparing the orders of the elements of  $G$  with the orders of the elements in the six direct products, since it can be shown that two finite Abelian groups are isomorphic if and only if they have the same number of elements of each order. For instance, we could determine whether  $G$  has any elements of order 8. If so, then  $G$  must be isomorphic to the first or fourth group above, since these are the only ones with elements of order 8. To narrow  $G$  down to a single choice, we now need only check whether or not  $G$  has an element of order 49, since the first product above has such an element, whereas the fourth one does not.

What if we have some specific Abelian group  $G$  of order  $p_1^{n_1} p_2^{n_2} \cdots p_k^{n_k}$ , where the  $p_i$ 's are distinct primes? How can  $G$  be expressed as an *internal* direct product of cyclic groups of prime-power order? For simplicity, let us say that the group has  $2^n$  elements. First, we must compute the orders of the elements. After this is done, pick an element of maximum order  $2^r$ , call it  $a_1$ . Then  $\langle a_1 \rangle$  is one of the factors in the desired internal direct product. If  $G \neq \langle a_1 \rangle$ , choose an element  $a_2$  of maximum order  $2^s$  such that  $s \leq n - r$  and none of  $a_2, a_2^2, a_2^4, \dots, a_2^{2^{s-1}}$  is in  $\langle a_1 \rangle$ . Then  $\langle a_2 \rangle$  is a second direct factor. If  $n \neq r + s$ , select an element  $a_3$  of

maximum order  $2^t$  such that  $t \leq n - r - s$  and none of  $a_3, a_3^2, a_3^4, \dots, a_3^{2^{t-1}}$  is in  $\langle a_1 \rangle \times \langle a_2 \rangle = \{a_1^i a_2^j \mid 0 \leq i < 2^r, 0 \leq j < 2^s\}$ . Then  $\langle a_3 \rangle$  is another direct factor. We continue in this fashion until our direct product has the same order as  $G$ .

A formal presentation of this algorithm for any Abelian group  $G$  of prime-power order  $p^n$  is as follows.

### Greedy Algorithm for an Abelian Group of Order $p^n$

1. Compute the orders of the elements of the group  $G$ .
2. Select an element  $a_1$  of maximum order and define  $G_1 = \langle a_1 \rangle$ .  
Set  $i = 1$ .
3. If  $|G| = |G_i|$ , stop. Otherwise, replace  $i$  by  $i + 1$ .
4. Select an element  $a_i$  of maximum order  $p^k$  such that  $p^k \leq |G|/|G_{i-1}|$  and none of  $a_i, a_i^p, a_i^{p^2}, \dots, a_i^{p^{k-1}}$  is in  $G_{i-1}$ , and define  $G_i = G_{i-1} \times \langle a_i \rangle$ .
5. Return to step 3.

In the general case where  $|G| = p_1^{n_1} p_2^{n_2} \cdots p_k^{n_k}$ , we simply use the algorithm to build up a direct product of order  $p_1^{n_1}$ , then another of order  $p_2^{n_2}$ , and so on. The direct product of all of these pieces is the desired factorization of  $G$ . The following example is small enough that we can compute the appropriate internal and external direct products by hand.

■ **EXAMPLE 1** Let  $G = \{1, 8, 12, 14, 18, 21, 27, 31, 34, 38, 44, 47, 51, 53, 57, 64\}$  under multiplication modulo 65. Since  $G$  has order 16, we know it is isomorphic to one of

$$\begin{array}{c} Z_{16}, \\ Z_8 \oplus Z_2, \\ Z_4 \oplus Z_4, \\ Z_4 \oplus Z_2 \oplus Z_2, \\ Z_2 \oplus Z_2 \oplus Z_2 \oplus Z_2. \end{array}$$

To decide which one, we dirty our hands to calculate the orders of the elements of  $G$ .

| Element | 1 | 8 | 12 | 14 | 18 | 21 | 27 | 31 | 34 | 38 | 44 | 47 | 51 | 53 | 57 | 64 |
|---------|---|---|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|
| Order   | 1 | 4 | 4  | 2  | 4  | 4  | 4  | 4  | 4  | 4  | 4  | 4  | 2  | 4  | 4  | 2  |

From the table of orders, we can instantly rule out all but  $Z_4 \oplus Z_4$  and  $Z_4 \oplus Z_2 \oplus Z_2$  as possibilities. Finally, we observe that since this latter group has a subgroup isomorphic to  $Z_2 \oplus Z_2 \oplus Z_2$ , it has more than three elements of order 2, and therefore we must have  $G \approx Z_4 \oplus Z_4$ .

Expressing  $G$  as an internal direct product is even easier. Pick an element of maximum order, say the element 8. Then  $\langle 8 \rangle$  is a factor in the product. Next, choose a second element, say  $a$ , so that  $a$  has order 4 and  $a$  and  $a^2$  are not in  $\langle 8 \rangle = \{1, 8, 64, 57\}$ . Since 12 has this property, we have  $G = \langle 8 \rangle \times \langle 12 \rangle$ . ■

Example 1 illustrates how quickly and easily one can write an Abelian group as a direct product given the orders of the elements of the group. But calculating all those orders is certainly not an appealing prospect! The good news is that, in practice, a combination of theory and calculation of the orders of a few elements will usually suffice.

■ **EXAMPLE 2** Let  $G = \{1, 8, 17, 19, 26, 28, 37, 44, 46, 53, 62, 64, 71, 73, 82, 89, 91, 98, 107, 109, 116, 118, 127, 134\}$  under multiplication modulo 135. Since  $G$  has order 24, it is isomorphic to one of

$$\begin{aligned} Z_8 \oplus Z_3 &\approx Z_{24}, \\ Z_4 \oplus Z_2 \oplus Z_3 &\approx Z_{12} \oplus Z_2, \\ Z_2 \oplus Z_2 \oplus Z_2 \oplus Z_3 &\approx Z_6 \oplus Z_2 \oplus Z_2. \end{aligned}$$

Consider the element 8. Direct calculations show that  $8^6 = 109$  and  $8^{12} = 1$ . (Be sure to mod as you go. For example,  $8^3 \bmod 135 = 512 \bmod 135 = 107$ , so compute  $8^4$  as  $8 \cdot 107$  rather than  $8 \cdot 512$ .) But now we know  $G$ . Why? Clearly,  $|8| = 12$  rules out the third group in the list. At the same time,  $|109| = 2 = |134|$  (remember,  $134 = -1 \bmod 135$ ) implies that  $G$  is not  $Z_{24}$  (see Theorem 4.4). Thus,  $G \approx Z_{12} \oplus Z_2$ , and  $G = \langle 8 \rangle \times \langle 134 \rangle$ . ■

Rather than express an Abelian group as a direct product of cyclic groups of prime-power orders, it is often more convenient to combine the cyclic factors of relatively prime order, as we did in Example 2, to obtain a direct product of the form  $Z_{n_1} \oplus Z_{n_2} \oplus \cdots \oplus Z_{n_k}$ , where  $n_i$  divides  $n_{i-1}$ . For example,  $Z_4 \oplus Z_4 \oplus Z_2 \oplus Z_9 \oplus Z_3 \oplus Z_5$  would be written as  $Z_{180} \oplus Z_{12} \oplus Z_2$  (see Exercise 11). The algorithm above is easily adapted to accomplish this by replacing step 4 by 4': Select an element  $a_i$  of maximum order  $m$  such that  $m \leq |G|/|G_{i-1}|$  and none of  $a_i, a_i^2, \dots, a_i^{m-1}$  is in  $G_{i-1}$ , and define  $G_i = G_{i-1} \times \langle a_i \rangle$ .

As a consequence of the Fundamental Theorem of Finite Abelian Groups, we have the following corollary, which shows that the converse of Lagrange's Theorem is true for finite Abelian groups.

## ■ Corollary Existence of Subgroups of Abelian Groups

*If  $m$  divides the order of a finite Abelian group  $G$ , then  $G$  has a subgroup of order  $m$ .*

**PROOF** Suppose that  $G$  is an Abelian group of order  $n$  and  $m$  divides  $n$ . We induct on the order of  $G$ . The case where  $n$  or  $m$  is 1 is trivial. Let  $p$  be a prime that divides  $m$ . It follows from Theorem 11.1 and properties of cyclic groups that  $G$  has a subgroup  $K$  of order  $p$ . Then  $G/K$  is an Abelian group of order  $n/p$  and  $m/p$  divides  $|G/K|$ . By the Second Principle of Mathematical Induction  $G/K$  has a subgroup of the form  $H/K$  where  $H$  is a subgroup of  $G$  and  $|H/K| = m/p$  (see Exercise 51 of Chapter 10). Then  $|H| = (|H/K|)|K| = (m/p)p = m$ . ■

It is instructive to verify this corollary for a specific case. Let us say that  $G$  is an Abelian group of order 72 and we wish to produce a subgroup of order 12. According to the Fundamental Theorem,  $G$  is isomorphic to one of the following six groups:

$$\begin{array}{ll} Z_8 \oplus Z_9, & Z_8 \oplus Z_3 \oplus Z_3, \\ Z_4 \oplus Z_2 \oplus Z_9, & Z_4 \oplus Z_2 \oplus Z_3 \oplus Z_3, \\ Z_2 \oplus Z_2 \oplus Z_2 \oplus Z_9, & Z_2 \oplus Z_2 \oplus Z_2 \oplus Z_3 \oplus Z_3. \end{array}$$

Obviously,  $Z_8 \oplus Z_9 \approx Z_{72}$  and  $Z_4 \oplus Z_2 \oplus Z_3 \oplus Z_3 \approx Z_{12} \oplus Z_6$  both have a subgroup of order 12. To construct a subgroup of order 12 in  $Z_4 \oplus Z_2 \oplus Z_9$ , we simply piece together all of  $Z_4$  and the subgroup of order 3 in  $Z_9$ ; that is,  $\{(a, 0, b) \mid a \in Z_4, b \in \{0, 3, 6\}\}$ . A subgroup of order 12 in  $Z_8 \oplus Z_3 \oplus Z_3$  is given by  $\{(a, b, 0) \mid a \in \{0, 2, 4, 6\}, b \in Z_3\}$ . An analogous procedure applies to the remaining cases and indeed to any finite Abelian group.

## Proof of the Fundamental Theorem

Because of the length and complexity of the proof of the Fundamental Theorem of Finite Abelian Groups, we will break it up into a series of lemmas.

### ■ Lemma 1

*Let  $G$  be a finite Abelian group of order  $p^a m$ , where  $p$  is a prime that does not divide  $m$ . Then  $G = H \times K$ , where  $H = \{x \in G \mid x^{p^a} = e\}$  and  $K = \{x \in G \mid x^m = e\}$ . Moreover,  $|H| = p^a$ .*

**PROOF** It is an easy exercise to prove that  $H$  and  $K$  are subgroups of  $G$  (see Exercise 47 in Chapter 3). Because  $G$  is Abelian, to prove that  $G = H \times K$  we need only prove that  $G = HK$  and  $H \cap K = \{e\}$ . Since we have  $\gcd(m, p^n) = 1$ , there are integers  $s$  and  $t$  such that  $1 = sm + tp^n$ . For any  $x$  in  $G$ , we have  $x = x^1 = x^{sm+tp^n} = x^{sm}x^{tp^n}$  and, by Corollary 4 of Lagrange's Theorem (Theorem 7.1),  $x^{sm} \in H$  and  $x^{tp^n} \in K$ . Thus,  $G = HK$ . Now suppose that some  $x \in H \cap K$ . Then  $x^{p^n} = e = x^m$  and, by Corollary 2 of Theorem 4.1,  $|x|$  divides both  $p^n$  and  $m$ . Since  $p$  does not divide  $m$ , we have  $|x| = 1$  and, therefore,  $x = e$ .

To prove the second assertion of the lemma, note that  $p^n m = |HK| = |H||K|/|H \cap K| = |H||K|$  (Theorem 7.2). It follows from Theorem 9.5 and Corollary 2 to Theorem 4.1 that  $p$  does not divide  $|K|$  and therefore  $|H| = p^n$ . ■

Given an Abelian group  $G$  with  $|G| = p_1^{n_1} p_2^{n_2} \cdots p_k^{n_k}$ , where the  $p$ 's are distinct primes, we let  $G(p_i)$  denote the set  $\{x \in G \mid x^{p_i^{n_i}} = e\}$ . It then follows immediately from Lemma 1 and induction that  $G = G(p_1) \times G(p_2) \times \cdots \times G(p_k)$  and  $|G(p_i)| = p_i^{n_i}$ . Hence, we turn our attention to groups of prime-power order.

## ■ Lemma 2

*Let  $G$  be an Abelian group of prime-power order and let  $a$  be an element of maximum order in  $G$ . Then  $G$  can be written in the form  $\langle a \rangle \times K$ .*

**PROOF** We denote  $|G|$  by  $p^n$  and induct on  $n$ . If  $n = 1$ , then  $G = \langle a \rangle \times \langle e \rangle$ . Now assume that the statement is true for all Abelian groups of order  $p^k$ , where  $k < n$ . Among all the elements of  $G$ , choose  $a$  of maximum order  $p^m$ . Then  $x^{p^m} = e$  for all  $x$  in  $G$ . We may assume that  $G \neq \langle a \rangle$ , for otherwise there is nothing to prove. Now, among all the elements of  $G$ , choose  $b$  of smallest order such that  $b \notin \langle a \rangle$ . We claim that  $\langle a \rangle \cap \langle b \rangle = \{e\}$ . Since  $|b^p| = |b|/p$ , we know that  $b^p \in \langle a \rangle$  by the manner in which  $b$  was chosen. Say  $b^p = a^i$ . Notice that  $e = b^{p^m} = (b^p)^{p^{m-1}} = (a^i)^{p^{m-1}}$ , so  $|a^i| \leq p^{m-1}$ . Thus,  $a^i$  is not a generator of  $\langle a \rangle$  and, therefore, by Corollary 3 to Theorem 4.2,  $\gcd(p^m, i) \neq 1$ . This proves that  $p$  divides  $i$ , so that we can write  $i = pj$ . Then  $b^p = a^i = a^{pj}$ . Consider the element  $c = a^{-j}b$ . Certainly,  $c$  is not in  $\langle a \rangle$ , for if it were,  $b$  would be, too. Also,  $c^p = a^{-jp}b^p = a^{-i}b^p = b^{-p}b^p = e$ . Thus, we have found an element  $c$  of order  $p$  such that  $c \notin \langle a \rangle$ . Since  $b$  was chosen to have smallest order such that  $b \notin \langle a \rangle$ , we conclude that  $b$  also has order  $p$ . It now follows that  $\langle a \rangle \cap \langle b \rangle = \{e\}$ , because any nonidentity element of the intersection would generate  $\langle b \rangle$  and thus contradict  $b \notin \langle a \rangle$ .

Now consider the factor group  $\overline{G} = G/\langle b \rangle$ . To simplify the notation, we let  $\bar{x}$  denote the coset  $x\langle b \rangle$  in  $\overline{G}$ . If  $|\bar{a}| < |a| = p^m$ , then  $\bar{a}^{p^{m-1}} = \bar{e}$ . This means that  $(a\langle b \rangle)^{p^{m-1}} = a^{p^{m-1}}\langle b \rangle = \langle b \rangle$ , so that  $a^{p^{m-1}} \in \langle a \rangle \cap \langle b \rangle = \{e\}$ , contradicting the fact that  $|a| = p^m$ . Thus,  $|\bar{a}| = |a| = p^m$ , and therefore  $\bar{a}$  is an element of maximum order in  $\overline{G}$ . By induction, we know that  $\overline{G}$  can be written in the form  $\langle \bar{a} \rangle \times \overline{K}$  for some subgroup  $\overline{K}$  of  $\overline{G}$ . Let  $K$  be the pullback of  $\overline{K}$  under the natural homomorphism from  $G$  to  $\overline{G}$  (that is,  $K = \{x \in G \mid \bar{x} \in \overline{K}\}$ ). We claim that  $\langle a \rangle \cap K = \{e\}$ . For if  $x \in \langle a \rangle \cap K$ , then  $\bar{x} \in \langle \bar{a} \rangle \cap \overline{K} = \{\bar{e}\} = \langle \bar{b} \rangle$  and  $x \in \langle a \rangle \cap \langle b \rangle = \{e\}$ . It now follows from an order argument (see Exercise 35) that  $G = \langle a \rangle K$ , and therefore  $G = \langle a \rangle \times K$ . ■

Lemma 2 and induction on the order of the group now give the following.

### ■ Lemma 3

*A finite Abelian group of prime-power order is an internal direct product of cyclic groups.*

Let us pause to determine where we are in our effort to prove the Fundamental Theorem of Finite Abelian Groups. The remark following Lemma 1 shows that  $G = G(p_1) \times G(p_2) \times \cdots \times G(p_n)$ , where each  $G(p_i)$  is a group of prime-power order, and Lemma 3 shows that each of these factors is an internal direct product of cyclic groups. Thus, we have proved that  $G$  is an internal direct product of cyclic groups of prime-power order. All that remains to be proved is the uniqueness of the factors. Certainly the groups  $G(p_i)$  are uniquely determined by  $G$ , since they comprise the elements of  $G$  whose orders are powers of  $p_i$ . So we must prove that there is only one way (up to isomorphism and rearrangement of factors) to write each  $G(p_i)$  as an internal direct product of cyclic groups.

### ■ Lemma 4

*Suppose that  $G$  is a finite Abelian group of prime-power order. If  $G = H_1 \times H_2 \times \cdots \times H_m$  and  $G = K_1 \times K_2 \times \cdots \times K_n$ , where the  $H$ 's and  $K$ 's are nontrivial cyclic subgroups with  $|H_1| \geq |H_2| \geq \cdots \geq |H_m|$  and  $|K_1| \geq |K_2| \geq \cdots \geq |K_n|$ , then  $m = n$  and  $|H_i| = |K_i|$  for all  $i$ .*

**PROOF** We proceed by induction on  $|G|$ . Clearly, the case where  $|G| = p$  is true. Now suppose that the statement is true for all Abelian groups of

order less than  $|G|$ . For any Abelian group  $L$ , the set  $L^p = \{x^p \mid x \in L\}$  is a subgroup of  $L$  (see Example 5 of Chapter 3) and, by Theorem 9.5, is a proper subgroup if  $p$  divides  $|L|$ . It follows that  $G^p = H_1^p \times H_2^p \times \cdots \times H_{m'}^p$ , and  $G^p = K_1^p \times K_2^p \times \cdots \times K_{n'}^p$ , where  $m'$  is the largest integer  $i$  such that  $|H_i| > p$ , and  $n'$  is the largest integer  $j$  such that  $|K_j| > p$ . (This ensures that our two direct products for  $G^p$  do not have trivial factors.) Since  $|G^p| < |G|$ , we have, by induction,  $m' = n'$  and  $|H_i^p| = |K_i^p|$  for  $i = 1, \dots, m'$ . Since  $|H_i| = p|H_i^p|$ , this proves that  $|H_i| = |K_i|$  for all  $i = 1, \dots, m'$ . All that remains to be proved is that the number of  $H_i$  of order  $p$  equals the number of  $K_i$  of order  $p$ ; that is, we must prove that  $m - m' = n - n'$  (since  $n' = m'$ ). This follows directly from the facts that  $|H_1||H_2| \cdots |H_{m'}|p^{m-m'} = |G| = |K_1||K_2| \cdots |K_{n'}|p^{n-n'}$ ,  $|H_i| = |K_i|$ , and  $m' = n'$ . ■

## Exercises

One problem after another presents itself and in the solving of them we can find our greatest pleasure.

Karl Menninger

1. What is the smallest positive integer  $n$  such that there are two non-isomorphic groups of order  $n$ ? Name the two groups.
2. What is the smallest positive integer  $n$  such that there are three non-isomorphic Abelian groups of order  $n$ ? Name the three groups.
3. What is the smallest positive integer  $n$  such that there are exactly four nonisomorphic Abelian groups of order  $n$ ? Name the four groups.
4. Calculate the number of elements of order 2 in each of  $Z_{16}$ ,  $Z_8 \oplus Z_2$ ,  $Z_4 \oplus Z_4$ , and  $Z_4 \oplus Z_2 \oplus Z_2$ . Do the same for the elements of order 4.
5. Prove that any Abelian group of order 45 has an element of order 15. Does every Abelian group of order 45 have an element of order 9?
6. Show that there are two Abelian groups of order 108 that have exactly one subgroup of order 3.
7. Show that there are two Abelian groups of order 108 that have exactly four subgroups of order 3.
8. Show that there are two Abelian groups of order 108 that have exactly 13 subgroups of order 3.
9. Suppose that  $G$  is an Abelian group of order 120 and that  $G$  has exactly three elements of order 2. Determine the isomorphism class of  $G$ .
10. Find all Abelian groups (up to isomorphism) of order 360.



11. Prove that every finite Abelian group can be expressed as the (external) direct product of cyclic groups of orders  $n_1, n_2, \dots, n_t$ , where  $n_{i+1}$  divides  $n_i$  for  $i = 1, 2, \dots, t - 1$ . (This exercise is referred to in this chapter.)
12. Suppose that the order of some finite Abelian group is divisible by 10. Prove that the group has a cyclic subgroup of order 10.
13. Show, by example, that if the order of a finite Abelian group is divisible by 4, the group need not have a cyclic subgroup of order 4.
14. On the basis of Exercises 12 and 13, draw a general conclusion about the existence of cyclic subgroups of a finite Abelian group.
15. How many Abelian groups (up to isomorphism) are there
  - a. of order 6?
  - b. of order 15?
  - c. of order 42?
  - d. of order  $pq$ , where  $p$  and  $q$  are distinct primes?
  - e. of order  $pqr$ , where  $p, q$ , and  $r$  are distinct primes?
  - f. Generalize parts d and e.
16. How does the number (up to isomorphism) of Abelian groups of order  $n$  compare with the number (up to isomorphism) of Abelian groups of order  $m$  where
  - a.  $n = 3^2$  and  $m = 5^2$ ?
  - b.  $n = 2^4$  and  $m = 5^4$ ?
  - c.  $n = p^r$  and  $m = q^r$ , where  $p$  and  $q$  are prime?
  - d.  $n = p^r$  and  $m = p^r q$ , where  $p$  and  $q$  are distinct primes?
  - e.  $n = p^r$  and  $m = p^r q^2$ , where  $p$  and  $q$  are distinct primes?
17. Up to isomorphism, how many additive Abelian groups of order 16 have the property that  $x + x + x + x = 0$  for all  $x$  in the group?
18. Let  $p_1, p_2, \dots, p_n$  be distinct primes. Up to isomorphism, how many Abelian groups are there of order  $p_1^4 p_2^4 \dots p_n^4$ ?
19. The symmetry group of a nonsquare rectangle is an Abelian group of order 4. Is it isomorphic to  $Z_4$  or  $Z_2 \oplus Z_2$ ?
20. Verify the corollary to the Fundamental Theorem of Finite Abelian Groups in the case that the group has order 1080 and the divisor is 180.
21. The set  $\{1, 9, 16, 22, 29, 53, 74, 79, 81\}$  is a group under multiplication modulo 91. Determine the isomorphism class of this group.
22. Suppose that  $G$  is a finite Abelian group that has exactly one subgroup for each divisor of  $|G|$ . Show that  $G$  is cyclic.
23. Characterize those integers  $n$  such that the only Abelian groups of order  $n$  are cyclic.

24. Characterize those integers  $n$  such that any Abelian group of order  $n$  belongs to one of exactly four isomorphism classes.
25. Refer to Example 1 in this chapter and explain why it is unnecessary to compute the orders of the last five elements listed to determine the isomorphism class of  $G$ .
26. Let  $G = \{1, 7, 17, 23, 49, 55, 65, 71\}$  under multiplication modulo 96. Express  $G$  as an external and an internal direct product of cyclic groups.
27. Let  $G = \{1, 7, 43, 49, 51, 57, 93, 99, 101, 107, 143, 149, 151, 157, 193, 199\}$  under multiplication modulo 200. Express  $G$  as an external and an internal direct product of cyclic groups.
28. The set  $G = \{1, 4, 11, 14, 16, 19, 26, 29, 31, 34, 41, 44\}$  is a group under multiplication modulo 45. Write  $G$  as an external and an internal direct product of cyclic groups of prime-power order.
29. Suppose that  $G$  is an Abelian group of order 9. What is the maximum number of elements (excluding the identity) of which one needs to compute the order to determine the isomorphism class of  $G$ ? What if  $G$  has order 18? What about 16?
30. Suppose that  $G$  is an Abelian group of order 16, and in computing the orders of its elements, you come across an element of order 8 and two elements of order 2. Explain why no further computations are needed to determine the isomorphism class of  $G$ .
31. Let  $G$  be an Abelian group of order 16. Suppose that there are elements  $a$  and  $b$  in  $G$  such that  $|a| = |b| = 4$  and  $a^2 \neq b^2$ . Determine the isomorphism class of  $G$ .
32. Prove that an Abelian group of order  $2^n$  ( $n \geq 1$ ) must have an odd number of elements of order 2.
33. Without using Lagrange's Theorem, show that an Abelian group of odd order cannot have an element of even order.
34. Let  $G$  be the group of all  $n \times n$  diagonal matrices with  $\pm 1$  diagonal entries. What is the isomorphism class of  $G$ ?
35. Prove the assertion made in the proof of Lemma 2 that  $G = \langle a \rangle K$ .
36. Suppose that  $G$  is a finite Abelian group. Prove that  $G$  has order  $p^n$ , where  $p$  is prime, if and only if the order of every element of  $G$  is a power of  $p$ .
37. Dirichlet's Theorem says that, for every pair of relatively prime integers  $a$  and  $b$ , there are infinitely many primes of the form  $at + b$ . Use Dirichlet's Theorem to prove that every finite Abelian group is isomorphic to a subgroup of a  $U$ -group.
38. Determine the isomorphism class of  $\text{Aut}(Z_2 \oplus Z_3 \oplus Z_5)$ .
39. Give an example to show that Lemma 2 is false if  $G$  is non-Abelian.

## Computer Exercises

Computer exercises for this chapter are available at the website:

**<http://www.d.umn.edu/~jgallian>**

## Reference

1. R. Hirshon, “On Cancellation in Groups,” *American Mathematical Monthly* 76 (1969): 1037–1039.

## Suggested Readings

J. A. Gallian, “Computers in Group Theory,” *Mathematics Magazine* 49 (1976): 69–73.

This paper discusses several computer-related projects in group theory done by undergraduate students.

J. Kane, “Distribution of Orders of Abelian Groups,” *Mathematics Magazine* 49 (1976): 132–135.

In this article, the author determines the percentages of integers  $k$  between 1 and  $n$ , for sufficiently large  $n$ , that have exactly one isomorphism class of Abelian groups of order  $k$ , exactly two isomorphism classes of Abelian groups of order  $k$ , and so on, up to 13 isomorphism classes.

G. Mackiw, “Computing in Abstract Algebra,” *The College Mathematics Journal* 27 (1996): 136–142.

This article explains how one can use computer software to implement the algorithm given in this chapter for expressing an Abelian group as an internal direct product.

## Suggested Website

To find more information about the development of group theory, visit:

**<http://www-groups.dcs.st-and.ac.uk/~history/>**



PART  
3

# Rings



For online student resources, visit this textbook's website at  
[www.CengageBrain.com](http://www.CengageBrain.com)



# 12 Introduction to Rings

Example is the school of mankind, and they will learn at no other.

Edmund Burke, *On a Regicide Peace*

... the source of all great mathematics is the special case, the concrete example. It is frequent in mathematics that every instance of a concept of seemingly great generality is in essence the same as a small and concrete special case.

Paul R. Halmos, *I Want to be a Mathematician*

## Motivation and Definition

Many sets are naturally endowed with two binary operations: addition and multiplication. Examples that quickly come to mind are the integers, the integers modulo  $n$ , the real numbers, matrices, and polynomials. When considering these sets as groups, we simply used addition and ignored multiplication. In many instances, however, one wishes to take into account both addition and multiplication. One abstract concept that does this is the concept of a ring.<sup>†</sup> This notion was originated in the mid-19th century by Richard Dedekind, although its first formal abstract definition was not given until Abraham Fraenkel presented it in 1914.

### Definition Ring

A *ring*  $R$  is a set with two binary operations, addition (denoted by  $a + b$ ) and multiplication (denoted by  $ab$ ), such that for all  $a, b, c$  in  $R$ :

1.  $a + b = b + a$ .
2.  $(a + b) + c = a + (b + c)$ .
3. There is an additive identity 0. That is, there is an element 0 in  $R$  such that  $a + 0 = a$  for all  $a$  in  $R$ .
4. There is an element  $-a$  in  $R$  such that  $a + (-a) = 0$ .
5.  $a(bc) = (ab)c$ .
6.  $a(b + c) = ab + ac$  and  $(b + c)a = ba + ca$ .

<sup>†</sup>The term *ring* was first applied in 1897 by the German mathematician David Hilbert (1862–1943).

So, a ring is an Abelian group under addition, also having an associative multiplication that is left and right distributive over addition. Note that multiplication need not be commutative. When it is, we say that the ring is *commutative*. Also, a ring need not have an identity under multiplication. A *unity* (or *identity*) in a ring is a nonzero element that is an identity under multiplication. A nonzero element of a commutative ring with unity need not have a multiplicative inverse. When it does, we say that it is a *unit* of the ring. Thus,  $a$  is a unit if  $a^{-1}$  exists.

The following terminology and notation are convenient. If  $a$  and  $b$  belong to a commutative ring  $R$  and  $a$  is nonzero, we say that  $a$  *divides*  $b$  (or that  $a$  is a *factor* of  $b$ ) and write  $a \mid b$ , if there exists an element  $c$  in  $R$  such that  $b = ac$ . If  $a$  does not divide  $b$ , we write  $a \nmid b$ .

Recall that if  $a$  is an element from a group under the operation of addition and  $n$  is a positive integer,  $na$  means  $a + a + \cdots + a$ , where there are  $n$  summands. When dealing with rings, this notation can cause confusion, since we also use juxtaposition for the ring multiplication. When there is the potential for confusion, we will use  $n \cdot a$  to mean  $a + a + \cdots + a$  ( $n$  summands).

For an abstraction to be worthy of study, it must have many diverse concrete realizations. The following list of examples shows that the ring concept is pervasive.

## Examples of Rings

■ **EXAMPLE 1** The set  $Z$  of integers under ordinary addition and multiplication is a commutative ring with unity 1. The units of  $Z$  are 1 and  $-1$ . ■

■ **EXAMPLE 2** The set  $Z_n = \{0, 1, \dots, n-1\}$  under addition and multiplication modulo  $n$  is a commutative ring with unity 1. The set of units is  $U(n)$ . ■

■ **EXAMPLE 3** The set  $Z[x]$  of all polynomials in the variable  $x$  with integer coefficients under ordinary addition and multiplication is a commutative ring with unity  $f(x) = 1$ . ■

■ **EXAMPLE 4** The set  $M_2(Z)$  of  $2 \times 2$  matrices with integer entries is a noncommutative ring with unity  $\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$ . ■

■ **EXAMPLE 5** The set  $2Z$  of even integers under ordinary addition and multiplication is a commutative ring without unity. ■



■ **EXAMPLE 6** The set of all continuous real-valued functions of a real variable whose graphs pass through the point  $(1, 0)$  is a commutative ring without unity under the operations of pointwise addition and multiplication [that is, the operations  $(f + g)(a) = f(a) + g(a)$  and  $(fg)(a) = f(a)g(a)$ ]. ■

■ **EXAMPLE 7** Let  $R_1, R_2, \dots, R_n$  be rings. We can use these to construct a new ring as follows. Let

$$R_1 \oplus R_2 \oplus \cdots \oplus R_n = \{(a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n) \mid a_i \in R_i\}$$

and perform componentwise addition and multiplication; that is, define

$$(a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n) + (b_1, b_2, \dots, b_n) = (a_1 + b_1, a_2 + b_2, \dots, a_n + b_n)$$

and

$$(a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n)(b_1, b_2, \dots, b_n) = (a_1b_1, a_2b_2, \dots, a_nb_n).$$

This ring is called the *direct sum* of  $R_1, R_2, \dots, R_n$ . ■

## Properties of Rings

Our first theorem shows how the operations of addition and multiplication intertwine. We use  $b - c$  to denote  $b + (-c)$ .

### ■ Theorem 12.1 Rules of Multiplication

**Let  $a, b$ , and  $c$  belong to a ring  $R$ . Then**

1.  $a0 = 0a = 0$ .
2.  $a(-b) = (-a)b = -(ab)$ .
3.  $(-a)(-b) = ab$ .
4.  $a(b - c) = ab - ac$  and  $(b - c)a = ba - ca$ .

**Furthermore, if  $R$  has a unity element  $1$ , then**

5.  $(-1)a = -a$ .
6.  $(-1)(-1) = 1$ .

**PROOF** We will prove rules 1 and 2 and leave the rest as easy exercises (see Exercise 11). To prove statements such as those in Theorem 12.1, we need only “play off” the distributive property against the fact that  $R$  is a group under addition with additive identity  $0$ . Consider rule 1. Clearly,

$$0 + a0 = a0 = a(0 + 0) = a0 + a0.$$

So, by cancellation,  $0 = a0$ . Similarly,  $0a = 0$ .

To prove rule 2, we observe that  $a(-b) + ab = a(-b + b) = a0 = 0$ . So, adding  $-(ab)$  to both sides yields  $a(-b) = -(ab)$ . The remainder of rule 2 is done analogously. ■

Recall that in the case of groups, the identity and inverses are unique. The same is true for rings, provided that these elements exist. The proofs are identical to the ones given for groups and therefore are omitted.

## ■ Theorem 12.2 Uniqueness of the Unity and Inverses

*If a ring has a unity, it is unique. If a ring element has a multiplicative inverse, it is unique.*

Many students have the mistaken tendency to treat a ring as if it were a group under *multiplication*. It is not. The two most common errors are the assumptions that *ring elements have multiplicative inverses—they need not*—and that *a ring has a multiplicative identity—it need not*. For example, if  $a$ ,  $b$ , and  $c$  belong to a ring,  $a \neq 0$  and  $ab = ac$ , we *cannot* conclude that  $b = c$ . Similarly, if  $a^2 = a$ , we *cannot* conclude that  $a = 0$  or  $1$  (as is the case with real numbers). In the first place, the ring need not have multiplicative cancellation, and in the second place, the ring need not have a multiplicative identity. There is an important class of rings that contains  $\mathbb{Z}$  and  $\mathbb{Z}[x]$  wherein multiplicative identities exist and for which multiplicative cancellation holds. This class is taken up in the next chapter.

## Subrings

In our study of groups, subgroups played a crucial role. Subrings, the analogous structures in ring theory, play a much less prominent role than their counterparts in group theory. Nevertheless, subrings are important.

### Definition Subring

A subset  $S$  of a ring  $R$  is a *subring of  $R$*  if  $S$  is itself a ring with the operations of  $R$ .

Just as was the case for subgroups, there is a simple test for subrings.

## ■ Theorem 12.3 Subring Test

*A nonempty subset  $S$  of a ring  $R$  is a subring if  $S$  is closed under subtraction and multiplication—that is, if  $a - b$  and  $ab$  are in  $S$  whenever  $a$  and  $b$  are in  $S$ .*

**PROOF** Since addition in  $R$  is commutative and  $S$  is closed under subtraction, we know by the One-Step Subgroup Test (Theorem 3.1) that  $S$  is an Abelian group under addition. Also, since multiplication in  $R$  is associative as well as distributive over addition, the same is true for multiplication in  $S$ . Thus, the only condition remaining to be checked is that multiplication is a binary operation on  $S$ . But this is exactly what closure means. ■

We leave it to the student to confirm that each of the following examples is a subring.

■ **EXAMPLE 8**  $\{0\}$  and  $R$  are subrings of any ring  $R$ .  $\{0\}$  is called the *trivial* subring of  $R$ . ■

■ **EXAMPLE 9**  $\{0, 2, 4\}$  is a subring of the ring  $Z_6$ , the integers modulo 6. Note that although 1 is the unity in  $Z_6$ , 4 is the unity in  $\{0, 2, 4\}$ . ■

■ **EXAMPLE 10** For each positive integer  $n$ , the set

$$nZ = \{0, \pm n, \pm 2n, \pm 3n, \dots\}$$

is a subring of the integers  $Z$ . ■

■ **EXAMPLE 11** The set of Gaussian integers

$$Z[i] = \{a + bi \mid a, b \in Z\}$$

is a subring of the complex numbers  $C$ . ■

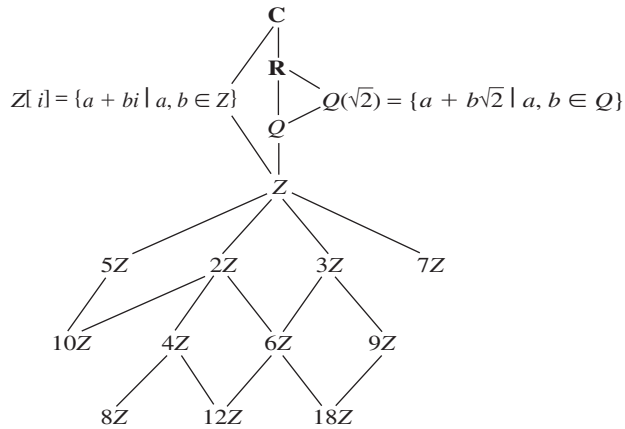
■ **EXAMPLE 12** Let  $R$  be the ring of all real-valued functions of a single real variable under pointwise addition and multiplication. The subset  $S$  of  $R$  of functions whose graphs pass through the origin forms a subring of  $R$ . ■

■ **EXAMPLE 13** The set

$$\left\{ \begin{bmatrix} a & 0 \\ 0 & b \end{bmatrix} \mid a, b \in Z \right\}$$

of diagonal matrices is a subring of the ring of all  $2 \times 2$  matrices over  $Z$ . ■

We can picture the relationship between a ring and its various subrings by way of a subring lattice diagram. In such a diagram, any ring is a subring of all the rings that it is connected to by one or more upward lines. Figure 12.1 shows the relationships among some of the rings we have already discussed.



**Figure 12.1** Partial subring lattice diagram of  $\mathbb{C}$ .

In the next several chapters, we will see that many of the fundamental concepts of group theory can be naturally extended to rings. In particular, we will introduce ring homomorphisms and factor rings.

## Exercises

There is no substitute for hard work.

Thomas Alva Edison, *Life*

1. Give an example of a finite noncommutative ring. Give an example of an infinite noncommutative ring that does not have a unity.
2. The ring  $\{0, 2, 4, 6, 8\}$  under addition and multiplication modulo 10 has a unity. Find it.
3. Give an example of a subset of a ring that is a subgroup under addition but not a subring.
4. Show, by example, that for fixed nonzero elements  $a$  and  $b$  in a ring, the equation  $ax = b$  can have more than one solution. How does this compare with groups?
5. Prove Theorem 12.2.
6. Find an integer  $n$  that shows that the rings  $Z_n$  need not have the following properties that the ring of integers has.
  - a.  $a^2 = a$  implies  $a = 0$  or  $a = 1$ .
  - b.  $ab = 0$  implies  $a = 0$  or  $b = 0$ .
  - c.  $ab = ac$  and  $a \neq 0$  imply  $b = c$ .
 Is the  $n$  you found prime?
7. Show that the three properties listed in Exercise 6 are valid for  $Z_p$ , where  $p$  is prime.

8. Show that a ring is commutative if it has the property that  $ab = ca$  implies  $b = c$  when  $a \neq 0$ .
9. Prove that the intersection of any collection of subrings of a ring  $R$  is a subring of  $R$ .
10. Verify that Examples 8 through 13 in this chapter are as stated.
11. Prove rules 3 through 6 of Theorem 12.1.
12. Let  $a, b$ , and  $c$  be elements of a commutative ring, and suppose that  $a$  is a unit. Prove that  $b$  divides  $c$  if and only if  $ab$  divides  $c$ .
13. Describe all the subrings of the ring of integers.
14. Let  $a$  and  $b$  belong to a ring  $R$  and let  $m$  be an integer. Prove that  $m \cdot (ab) = (m \cdot a)b = a(m \cdot b)$ .
15. Show that if  $m$  and  $n$  are integers and  $a$  and  $b$  are elements from a ring, then  $(m \cdot a)(n \cdot b) = (mn) \cdot (ab)$ . (This exercise is referred to in Chapters 13 and 15.)
16. Show that if  $n$  is an integer and  $a$  is an element from a ring, then  $n \cdot (-a) = -(n \cdot a)$ .
17. Show that a ring that is cyclic under addition is commutative.
18. Let  $a$  belong to a ring  $R$ . Let  $S = \{x \in R \mid ax = 0\}$ . Show that  $S$  is a subring of  $R$ .
19. Let  $R$  be a ring. The *center of  $R$*  is the set  $\{x \in R \mid ax = xa \text{ for all } a \text{ in } R\}$ . Prove that the center of a ring is a subring.
20. Describe the elements of  $M_2(\mathbb{Z})$  (see Example 4) that have multiplicative inverses.
21. Suppose that  $R_1, R_2, \dots, R_n$  are rings that contain nonzero elements. Show that  $R_1 \oplus R_2 \oplus \dots \oplus R_n$  has a unity if and only if each  $R_i$  has a unity.
22. Let  $R$  be a commutative ring with unity and let  $U(R)$  denote the set of units of  $R$ . Prove that  $U(R)$  is a group under the multiplication of  $R$ . (This group is called the *group of units of  $R$* .)
23. Determine  $U(\mathbb{Z}[i])$  (see Example 11).
24. If  $R_1, R_2, \dots, R_n$  are commutative rings with unity, show that  $U(R_1 \oplus R_2 \oplus \dots \oplus R_n) = U(R_1) \oplus U(R_2) \oplus \dots \oplus U(R_n)$ .
25. Determine  $U(\mathbb{Z}[x])$ . (This exercise is referred to in Chapter 17.)
26. Determine  $U(\mathbb{R}[x])$ .
27. Show that a unit of a ring divides every element of the ring.
28. In  $\mathbb{Z}_6$ , show that  $4 \mid 2$ ; in  $\mathbb{Z}_8$ , show that  $3 \mid 7$ ; in  $\mathbb{Z}_{15}$ , show that  $9 \mid 12$ .
29. Suppose that  $a$  and  $b$  belong to a commutative ring  $R$  with unity. If  $a$  is a unit of  $R$  and  $b^2 = 0$ , show that  $a + b$  is a unit of  $R$ .
30. Suppose that there is an integer  $n > 1$  such that  $x^n = x$  for all elements  $x$  of some ring. If  $m$  is a positive integer and  $a^m = 0$  for some  $a$ , show that  $a = 0$ .

31. Give an example of ring elements  $a$  and  $b$  with the properties that  $ab = 0$  but  $ba \neq 0$ .
32. Let  $n$  be an integer greater than 1. In a ring in which  $x^n = x$  for all  $x$ , show that  $ab = 0$  implies  $ba = 0$ .
33. Suppose that  $R$  is a ring such that  $x^3 = x$  for all  $x$  in  $R$ . Prove that  $6x = 0$  for all  $x$  in  $R$ .
34. Suppose that  $a$  belongs to a ring and  $a^4 = a^2$ . Prove that  $a^{2n} = a^2$  for all  $n \geq 1$ .
35. Find an integer  $n > 1$  such that  $a^n = a$  for all  $a$  in  $Z_6$ . Do the same for  $Z_{10}$ . Show that no such  $n$  exists for  $Z_m$  when  $m$  is divisible by the square of some prime.
36. Let  $m$  and  $n$  be positive integers and let  $k$  be the least common multiple of  $m$  and  $n$ . Show that  $mZ \cap nZ = kZ$ .
37. Explain why every subgroup of  $Z_n$  under addition is also a subring of  $Z_n$ .
38. Is  $Z_6$  a subring of  $Z_{12}$ ?
39. Suppose that  $R$  is a ring with unity 1 and  $a$  is an element of  $R$  such that  $a^2 = 1$ . Let  $S = \{ara \mid r \in R\}$ . Prove that  $S$  is a subring of  $R$ . Does  $S$  contain 1?
40. Let  $M_2(Z)$  be the ring of all  $2 \times 2$  matrices over the integers and let  $R = \left\{ \begin{bmatrix} a & a+b \\ a+b & b \end{bmatrix} \mid a, b \in Z \right\}$ . Prove or disprove that  $R$  is a subring of  $M_2(Z)$ .
41. Let  $M_2(Z)$  be the ring of all  $2 \times 2$  matrices over the integers and let  $R = \left\{ \begin{bmatrix} a & a-b \\ a-b & b \end{bmatrix} \mid a, b \in Z \right\}$ . Prove or disprove that  $R$  is a subring of  $M_2(Z)$ .
42. Let  $R = \left\{ \begin{bmatrix} a & a \\ b & b \end{bmatrix} \mid a, b \in Z \right\}$ . Prove or disprove that  $R$  is a subring of  $M_2(Z)$ .
43. Let  $R = Z \oplus Z \oplus Z$  and  $S = \{(a, b, c) \in R \mid a + b = c\}$ . Prove or disprove that  $S$  is a subring of  $R$ .
44. Suppose that there is a positive even integer  $n$  such that  $a^n = a$  for all elements  $a$  of some ring. Show that  $-a = a$  for all  $a$  in the ring.
45. Let  $R$  be a ring with unity 1. Show that  $S = \{n \cdot 1 \mid n \in Z\}$  is a subring of  $R$ .
46. Show that  $2Z \cup 3Z$  is not a subring of  $Z$ .
47. Determine the smallest subring of  $Q$  that contains  $1/2$ . (That is, find the subring  $S$  with the property that  $S$  contains  $1/2$  and, if  $T$  is any subring containing  $1/2$ , then  $T$  contains  $S$ .)

48. Determine the smallest subring of  $Q$  that contains  $2/3$ .
49. Let  $R$  be a ring. Prove that  $a^2 - b^2 = (a + b)(a - b)$  for all  $a, b$  in  $R$  if and only if  $R$  is commutative.
50. Suppose that  $R$  is a ring and that  $a^2 = a$  for all  $a$  in  $R$ . Show that  $R$  is commutative. [A ring in which  $a^2 = a$  for all  $a$  is called a *Boolean* ring, in honor of the English mathematician George Boole (1815–1864).]
51. Give an example of a Boolean ring with four elements. Give an example of an infinite Boolean ring.
52. If  $a, b$ , and  $c$  are elements of a ring, does the equation  $ax + b = c$  always have a solution  $x$ ? If it does, must the solution be unique? Answer the same questions given that  $a$  is a unit.
53. Let  $R$  and  $S$  be commutative rings. Prove that  $(a, b)$  is a zero-divisor in  $R \oplus S$  if and only if  $a$  or  $b$  is a zero-divisor or exactly one of  $a$  or  $b$  is 0.
54. Show that  $4x^2 + 6x + 3$  is a unit in  $\mathbb{Z}_8[x]$ .
55. Let  $R$  be a commutative ring with more than one element. Prove that if for every nonzero element  $a$  of  $R$  we have  $aR = R$ , then  $R$  has a unity and every nonzero element has an inverse.
56. Find an example of a commutative ring  $R$  with unity such that  $a, b \in R, a \neq b, a^n = b^n$ , and  $a^m = b^m$ , where  $n$  and  $m$  are positive integers that are relatively prime. (Compare with Exercise 39, part b, in Chapter 13.)
57. Suppose that  $R$  is a ring with no zero-divisors and that  $R$  contains a nonzero element  $b$  such that  $b^2 = b$ . Show that  $b$  is the unity for  $R$ .

## Computer Exercises

Software for the computer exercises in this chapter is available at the website:

<http://www.d.umn.edu/~jgallian>

## Suggested Reading

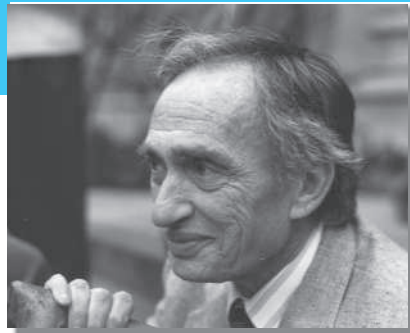
D. B. Erickson, “Orders for Finite Noncommutative Rings,” *American Mathematical Monthly* 73 (1966): 376–377.

In this elementary paper, it is shown that there exists a noncommutative ring of order  $m > 1$  if and only if  $m$  is divisible by the square of a prime.

## I. N. Herstein

A whole generation of textbooks and an entire generation of mathematicians, myself included, have been profoundly influenced by that text [Herstein's *Topics in Algebra*].

GEORGIA BENKART



Author: George M. Bergman,  
Source: Archives of the Mathematisches  
Forschungsinstitut Oberwolfach

I. N. HERSTEIN was born on March 28, 1923, in Poland. His family moved to Canada when he was seven. He grew up in a poor and tough environment, on which he commented that in his neighborhood you became either a gangster or a college professor. During his school years he played football, hockey, golf, tennis, and pool. During this time he worked as a steeplejack and as a barber at a fair. Herstein received a B.S. degree from the University of Manitoba, an M.A. from the University of Toronto, and, in 1948, a Ph.D. degree from Indiana University under the supervision of Max Zorn. Before permanently settling at the University of Chicago in 1962, he held positions at the University of Kansas, the Ohio State University, the University of Pennsylvania, and Cornell University.

Herstein wrote more than 100 research papers and a dozen books. Although his

principal interest was noncommutative ring theory, he also wrote papers on finite groups, linear algebra, and mathematical economics. His textbook *Topics in Algebra*, first published in 1964, dominated the field for 20 years and has become a classic. Herstein had great influence through his teaching and his collaboration with colleagues. He had 30 Ph.D. students, and traveled and lectured widely. His nonmathematical interests included languages and art. He spoke Italian, Hebrew, Polish, and Portuguese. Herstein died on February 9, 1988, after a long battle with cancer.

To find more information about Herstein, visit:

**[http://www-groups.dcs  
.st-and.ac.uk/~history/](http://www-groups.dcs.st-and.ac.uk/~history/)**



# 13 Integral Domains

Don't just read it! Ask your own questions, look for your own examples, discover your own proofs. Is the hypothesis necessary? Is the converse true? What happens in the classical special case? Where does the proof use the hypothesis?

Paul Halmos

I was mesmerized by the beauty of these mathematical abstractions.

Edward Frenkel, *Love and Math*

## Definition and Examples

To a certain degree, the notion of a ring was invented in an attempt to put the algebraic properties of the integers into an abstract setting. A ring is not the appropriate abstraction of the integers, however, for too much is lost in the process. Besides the two obvious properties of commutativity and existence of a unity, there is one other essential feature of the integers that rings in general do not enjoy—the cancellation property. In this chapter, we introduce integral domains—a particular class of rings that have all three of these properties. Integral domains play a prominent role in number theory and algebraic geometry.

### Definition Zero-Divisors

A *zero-divisor* is a nonzero element  $a$  of a commutative ring  $R$  such that there is a nonzero element  $b \in R$  with  $ab = 0$ .

### Definition Integral Domain

An *integral domain* is a commutative ring with unity and no zero-divisors.

Thus, in an integral domain, a product is 0 only when one of the factors is 0; that is,  $ab = 0$  only when  $a = 0$  or  $b = 0$ . The following examples show that many familiar rings are integral domains and some familiar rings are not. For each example, the student should verify the assertion made.

■ **EXAMPLE 1** The ring of integers is an integral domain. ■

■ **EXAMPLE 2** The ring of Gaussian integers  $Z[i] = \{a + bi \mid a, b \in Z\}$  is an integral domain. ■

■ **EXAMPLE 3** The ring  $Z[x]$  of polynomials with integer coefficients is an integral domain. ■

■ **EXAMPLE 4** The ring  $Z[\sqrt{2}] = \{a + b\sqrt{2} \mid a, b \in Z\}$  is an integral domain. ■

■ **EXAMPLE 5** The ring  $Z_p$  of integers modulo a prime  $p$  is an integral domain. ■

■ **EXAMPLE 6** The ring  $Z_n$  of integers modulo  $n$  is *not* an integral domain when  $n$  is not prime. ■

■ **EXAMPLE 7** The ring  $M_2(Z)$  of  $2 \times 2$  matrices over the integers is *not* an integral domain. ■

■ **EXAMPLE 8**  $Z \oplus Z$  is *not* an integral domain. ■

What makes integral domains particularly appealing is that they have an important multiplicative group theoretic property, in spite of the fact that the nonzero elements need not form a group under multiplication. This property is cancellation.

### ■ Theorem 13.1 Cancellation

*Let  $a, b$ , and  $c$  belong to an integral domain. If  $a \neq 0$  and  $ab = ac$ , then  $b = c$ .*

**PROOF** From  $ab = ac$ , we have  $a(b - c) = 0$ . Since  $a \neq 0$ , we must have  $b - c = 0$ . ■

Many authors prefer to define integral domains by the cancellation property—that is, as commutative rings with unity in which the cancellation property holds. This definition is equivalent to ours.

## Fields

In many applications, a particular kind of integral domain called a *field* is necessary.

**Definition Field**

A *field* is a commutative ring with unity in which every nonzero element is a unit.

To verify that every field is an integral domain, observe that if  $a$  and  $b$  belong to a field with  $a \neq 0$  and  $ab = 0$ , we can multiply both sides of the last expression by  $a^{-1}$  to obtain  $b = 0$ .

It is often helpful to think of  $ab^{-1}$  as  $a$  divided by  $b$ . With this in mind, a field can be thought of as simply an algebraic system that is closed under addition, subtraction, multiplication, and division (except by 0). We have had numerous examples of fields: the complex numbers, the real numbers, the rational numbers. The abstract theory of fields was initiated by Heinrich Weber in 1893. Groups, rings, and fields are the three main branches of abstract algebra. Theorem 13.2 says that, in the finite case, fields and integral domains are the same.

### ■ Theorem 13.2 Finite Integral Domains Are Fields

*A finite integral domain is a field.*

**PROOF** Let  $D$  be a finite integral domain with unity 1. Let  $a$  be any nonzero element of  $D$ . We must show that  $a$  is a unit. If  $a = 1$ ,  $a$  is its own inverse, so we may assume that  $a \neq 1$ . Now consider the following sequence of elements of  $D$ :  $a, a^2, a^3, \dots$ . Since  $D$  is finite, there must be two positive integers  $i$  and  $j$  such that  $i > j$  and  $a^i = a^j$ . Then, by cancellation,  $a^{i-j} = 1$ . Since  $a \neq 1$ , we know that  $i - j > 1$ , and we have shown that  $a^{i-j-1}$  is the inverse of  $a$ . ■

### ■ Corollary $Z_p$ Is a Field

*For every prime  $p$ ,  $Z_p$ , the ring of integers modulo  $p$  is a field.*

**PROOF** According to Theorem 13.2, we need only prove that  $Z_p$  has no zero-divisors. So, suppose that  $a, b \in Z_p$  and  $ab = 0$ . Then  $ab = pk$  for some integer  $k$ . But then, by Euclid's Lemma (see Chapter 0),  $p$  divides  $a$  or  $p$  divides  $b$ . Thus, in  $Z_p$ ,  $a = 0$  or  $b = 0$ . ■

Putting the preceding corollary together with Example 6, we see that  $Z_n$  is a field if and only if  $n$  is prime. In Chapter 22, we will describe how all finite fields can be constructed. For now, we give one example of a finite field that is not of the form  $Z_p$ .

■ **EXAMPLE 9 FIELD WITH NINE ELEMENTS**

Let  $Z_3[i] = \{a + bi \mid a, b \in Z_3\}$   
 $= \{0, 1, 2, i, 1 + i, 2 + i, 2i, 1 + 2i, 2 + 2i\},$

where  $i^2 = -1$ . This is the ring of Gaussian integers modulo 3. Elements are added and multiplied as in the complex numbers, except that the coefficients are reduced modulo 3. In particular,  $-1 = 2$ . Table 13.1 is the multiplication table for the nonzero elements of  $Z_3[i]$ . ■

**Table 13.1** Multiplication Table for  $Z_3[i]^*$

|          | 1        | 2        | $i$      | $1 + i$  | $2 + i$  | $2i$     | $1 + 2i$ | $2 + 2i$ |
|----------|----------|----------|----------|----------|----------|----------|----------|----------|
| 1        | 1        | 2        | $i$      | $1 + i$  | $2 + i$  | $2i$     | $1 + 2i$ | $2 + 2i$ |
| 2        | 2        | 1        | $2i$     | $2 + 2i$ | $1 + 2i$ | $i$      | $2 + i$  | $1 + i$  |
| $i$      | $i$      | $2i$     | 2        | $2 + i$  | $2 + 2i$ | 1        | $1 + i$  | $1 + 2i$ |
| $1 + i$  | $1 + i$  | $2 + 2i$ | $2 + i$  | $2i$     | 1        | $1 + 2i$ | 2        | $i$      |
| $2 + i$  | $2 + i$  | $1 + 2i$ | $2 + 2i$ | 1        | $i$      | $1 + i$  | $2i$     | 2        |
| $2i$     | $2i$     | $i$      | 1        | $1 + 2i$ | $1 + i$  | 2        | $2 + 2i$ | $2 + i$  |
| $1 + 2i$ | $1 + 2i$ | $2 + i$  | $1 + i$  | 2        | $2i$     | $2 + 2i$ | $i$      | 1        |
| $2 + 2i$ | $2 + 2i$ | $1 + i$  | $1 + 2i$ | $i$      | 2        | $2 + i$  | 1        | $2i$     |

■ **EXAMPLE 10** Let  $Q[\sqrt{2}] = \{a + b\sqrt{2} \mid a, b \in Q\}$ . It is easy to see that  $Q[\sqrt{2}]$  is a ring. Viewed as an element of  $\mathbf{R}$ , the multiplicative inverse of any nonzero element of the form  $a + b\sqrt{2}$  is simply  $1/(a + b\sqrt{2})$ . To verify that  $Q[\sqrt{2}]$  is a field, we must show that  $1/(a + b\sqrt{2})$  can be written in the form  $c + d\sqrt{2}$ . In high school algebra, this process is called “rationalizing the denominator.” Specifically,

$$\frac{1}{a + b\sqrt{2}} = \frac{1}{a + b\sqrt{2}} \frac{a - b\sqrt{2}}{a - b\sqrt{2}} = \frac{a}{a^2 - 2b^2} - \frac{b}{a^2 - 2b^2} \sqrt{2}.$$

(Note that  $a + b\sqrt{2} \neq 0$  guarantees that  $a - b\sqrt{2} \neq 0$ .) ■

## Characteristic of a Ring

Note that for any element  $x$  in  $Z_3[i]$ , we have  $3x = x + x + x = 0$ , since addition is done modulo 3. Similarly, in the subring  $\{0, 3, 6, 9\}$  of  $Z_{12}$ , we have  $4x = x + x + x + x = 0$  for all  $x$ . This observation motivates the following definition.

**Definition Characteristic of a Ring**

The *characteristic* of a ring  $R$  is the least positive integer  $n$  such that  $nx = 0$  for all  $x$  in  $R$ . If no such integer exists, we say that  $R$  has characteristic 0. The characteristic of  $R$  is denoted by  $\text{char } R$ .

Thus, the ring of integers has characteristic 0, and  $Z_n$  has characteristic  $n$ . An infinite ring can have a nonzero characteristic. Indeed, the ring  $Z_2[x]$  of all polynomials with coefficients in  $Z_2$  has characteristic 2. (Addition and multiplication are done as for polynomials with ordinary integer coefficients except that the coefficients are reduced modulo 2.) When a ring has a unity, the task of determining the characteristic is simplified by Theorem 13.3.

### ■ Theorem 13.3 Characteristic of a Ring with Unity

*Let  $R$  be a ring with unity 1. If 1 has infinite order under addition, then the characteristic of  $R$  is 0. If 1 has order  $n$  under addition, then the characteristic of  $R$  is  $n$ .*

**PROOF** If 1 has infinite order, then there is no positive integer  $n$  such that  $n \cdot 1 = 0$ , so  $R$  has characteristic 0. Now suppose that 1 has additive order  $n$ . Then  $n \cdot 1 = 0$ , and  $n$  is the least positive integer with this property. So, for any  $x$  in  $R$ , we have

$$\begin{aligned} n \cdot x &= x + x + \cdots + x \text{ (} n \text{ summands)} \\ &= 1x + 1x + \cdots + 1x \text{ (} n \text{ summands)} \\ &= (1 + 1 + \cdots + 1)x \text{ (} n \text{ summands)} \\ &= (n \cdot 1)x = 0x = 0. \end{aligned}$$

Thus,  $R$  has characteristic  $n$ . ■

In the case of an integral domain, the possibilities for the characteristic are severely limited.

### ■ Theorem 13.4 Characteristic of an Integral Domain

*The characteristic of an integral domain is 0 or prime.*

**PROOF** By Theorem 13.3, it suffices to show that if the additive order of 1 is finite, it must be prime. Suppose that 1 has order  $n$  and that  $n = st$ , where  $1 \leq s, t \leq n$ . Then, by Exercise 15 in Chapter 12,

$$0 = n \cdot 1 = (st) \cdot 1 = (s \cdot 1)(t \cdot 1).$$

So,  $s \cdot 1 = 0$  or  $t \cdot 1 = 0$ . Since  $n$  is the least positive integer with the property that  $n \cdot 1 = 0$ , we must have  $s = n$  or  $t = n$ . Thus,  $n$  is prime. ■

We conclude this chapter with a brief discussion of polynomials with coefficients from a ring—a topic we will consider in detail in later chapters. The existence of zero-divisors in a ring causes unusual results when one is finding zeros of polynomials with coefficients in the ring. Consider, for example, the equation  $x^2 - 4x + 3 = 0$ . In the integers, we could find all solutions by factoring

$$x^2 - 4x + 3 = (x - 3)(x - 1) = 0$$

and setting each factor equal to 0. But notice that when we say we can find *all* solutions in this manner, we are using the fact that the only way for a product to equal 0 is for one of the factors to be 0—that is, we are using the fact that  $Z$  is an integral domain. In  $Z_{12}$ , there are many pairs of nonzero elements whose products are 0:  $2 \cdot 6 = 0$ ,  $3 \cdot 4 = 0$ ,  $4 \cdot 6 = 0$ ,  $6 \cdot 8 = 0$ , and so on. So, how do we find *all* solutions of  $x^2 - 4x + 3 = 0$  in  $Z_{12}$ ? The easiest way is simply to try every element! Upon doing so, we find four solutions:  $x = 1$ ,  $x = 3$ ,  $x = 7$ , and  $x = 9$ . Observe that we can find all solutions of  $x^2 - 4x + 3 = 0$  over  $Z_{11}$  or  $Z_{13}$ , say, by setting the two factors  $x - 3$  and  $x - 1$  equal to 0. Of course, the reason this works for these rings is that they are integral domains. Perhaps this will convince you that integral domains are particularly advantageous rings. Table 13.2 gives a summary of some of the rings we have introduced and their properties.

**Table 13.2** Summary of Rings and Their Properties

| Ring                  | Form of Element                                    | Unity                                          | Commutative | Integral Domain | Field | Characteristic |
|-----------------------|----------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|-------------|-----------------|-------|----------------|
| $Z$                   | $k$                                                | 1                                              | Yes         | Yes             | No    | 0              |
| $Z_n$ , $n$ composite | $k$                                                | 1                                              | Yes         | No              | No    | $n$            |
| $Z_p$ , $p$ prime     | $k$                                                | 1                                              | Yes         | Yes             | Yes   | $p$            |
| $Z[x]$                | $a_n x^n + \cdots + a_1 x + a_0$                   | $f(x) = 1$                                     | Yes         | Yes             | No    | 0              |
| $nZ$ , $n > 1$        | $nk$                                               | None                                           | Yes         | No              | No    | 0              |
| $M_2(Z)$              | $\begin{bmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{bmatrix}$     | $\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$ | No          | No              | No    | 0              |
| $M_2(2Z)$             | $\begin{bmatrix} 2a & 2b \\ 2c & 2d \end{bmatrix}$ | None                                           | No          | No              | No    | 0              |
| $Z[i]$                | $a + bi$                                           | 1                                              | Yes         | Yes             | No    | 0              |
| $Z_3[i]$              | $a + bi$ ; $a, b \in Z_3$                          | 1                                              | Yes         | Yes             | Yes   | 3              |
| $Z[\sqrt{2}]$         | $a + b\sqrt{2}$ ; $a, b \in Z$                     | 1                                              | Yes         | Yes             | No    | 0              |
| $Q[\sqrt{2}]$         | $a + b\sqrt{2}$ ; $a, b \in Q$                     | 1                                              | Yes         | Yes             | Yes   | 0              |
| $Z \oplus Z$          | $(a, b)$                                           | $(1, 1)$                                       | Yes         | No              | No    | 0              |

## Exercises

It looked absolutely impossible. But it so happens that you go on worrying away at a problem in science and it seems to get tired, and lies down and lets you catch it.

William Lawrence Bragg<sup>†</sup>

1. Verify that Examples 1 through 8 are as claimed.
2. Which of Examples 1 through 5 are fields?
3. Show that a commutative ring with the cancellation property (under multiplication) has no zero-divisors.
4. List all zero-divisors in  $Z_{20}$ . Can you see a relationship between the zero-divisors of  $Z_{20}$  and the units of  $Z_{20}$ ?
5. Show that every nonzero element of  $Z_n$  is a unit or a zero-divisor.
6. Find a nonzero element in a ring that is neither a zero-divisor nor a unit.
7. Let  $R$  be a finite commutative ring with unity. Prove that every non-zero element of  $R$  is either a zero-divisor or a unit. What happens if we drop the “finite” condition on  $R$ ?
8. Let  $a \neq 0$  belong to a commutative ring. Prove that  $a$  is a zero-divisor if and only if  $a^2b = 0$  for some  $b \neq 0$ .
9. Find elements  $a, b$ , and  $c$  in the ring  $Z \oplus Z \oplus Z$  such that  $ab, ac$ , and  $bc$  are zero-divisors but  $abc$  is not a zero-divisor.
10. Describe all zero-divisors and units of  $Z \oplus Q \oplus Z$ .
11. Let  $d$  be an integer. Prove that  $Z[\sqrt{d}] = \{a + b\sqrt{d} \mid a, b \in Z\}$  is an integral domain. (This exercise is referred to in Chapter 18.)
12. In  $Z_7$ , give a reasonable interpretation for the expressions  $1/2$ ,  $-2/3$ ,  $\sqrt{-3}$ , and  $-1/6$ .
13. Give an example of a commutative ring without zero-divisors that is not an integral domain.
14. Find two elements  $a$  and  $b$  in a ring such that both  $a$  and  $b$  are zero-divisors,  $a + b \neq 0$ , and  $a + b$  is not a zero-divisor.
15. Let  $a$  belong to a ring  $R$  with unity and suppose that  $a^n = 0$  for some positive integer  $n$ . (Such an element is called *nilpotent*.) Prove that  $1 - a$  has a multiplicative inverse in  $R$ . [Hint: Consider  $(1 - a)(1 + a + a^2 + \cdots + a^{n-1})$ .]
16. Show that the nilpotent elements of a commutative ring form a subring.

<sup>†</sup>Bragg, at age 24, won the Nobel Prize for the invention of x-ray crystallography. He remains the youngest person ever to receive the Nobel Prize.

17. Show that 0 is the only nilpotent element in an integral domain.
18. A ring element  $a$  is called an *idempotent* if  $a^2 = a$ . Prove that the only idempotents in an integral domain are 0 and 1.
19. Let  $a$  and  $b$  be idempotents in a commutative ring. Show that each of the following is also an idempotent:  $ab$ ,  $a - ab$ ,  $a + b - ab$ ,  $a + b - 2ab$ .
20. Show that  $Z_n$  has a nonzero nilpotent element if and only if  $n$  is divisible by the square of some prime.
21. Let  $R$  be the ring of real-valued continuous functions on  $[-1, 1]$ . Show that  $R$  has zero-divisors.
22. Prove that if  $a$  is a ring idempotent, then  $a^n = a$  for all positive integers  $n$ .
23. Determine all ring elements that are both nilpotent elements and idempotents.
24. Find a zero-divisor in  $Z_5[i] = \{a + bi \mid a, b \in Z_5\}$ .
25. Find an idempotent in  $Z_5[i] = \{a + bi \mid a, b \in Z_5\}$ .
26. Find all units, zero-divisors, idempotents, and nilpotent elements in  $Z_3 \oplus Z_6$ .
27. Determine all elements of a ring that are both units and idempotents.
28. Let  $R$  be the set of all real-valued functions defined for all real numbers under function addition and multiplication.
  - a. Determine all zero-divisors of  $R$ .
  - b. Determine all nilpotent elements of  $R$ .
  - c. Show that every nonzero element is a zero-divisor or a unit.
29. (Subfield Test) Let  $F$  be a field and let  $K$  be a subset of  $F$  with at least two elements. Prove that  $K$  is a subfield of  $F$  if, for any  $a, b$  ( $b \neq 0$ ) in  $K$ ,  $a - b$  and  $ab^{-1}$  belong to  $K$ .
30. Let  $d$  be a positive integer. Prove that  $Q[\sqrt{d}] = \{a + b\sqrt{d} \mid a, b \in Q\}$  is a field.
31. Let  $R$  be a ring with unity 1. If the product of any pair of nonzero elements of  $R$  is nonzero, prove that  $ab = 1$  implies  $ba = 1$ .
32. Let  $R = \{0, 2, 4, 6, 8\}$  under addition and multiplication modulo 10. Prove that  $R$  is a field.
33. Formulate the appropriate definition of a subdomain (that is, a “sub” integral domain). Let  $D$  be an integral domain with unity 1. Show that  $P = \{n \cdot 1 \mid n \in Z\}$  (that is, all integral multiples of 1) is a subdomain of  $D$ . Show that  $P$  is contained in every subdomain of  $D$ . What can we say about the order of  $P$ ?
34. Prove that there is no integral domain with exactly six elements. Can your argument be adapted to show that there is no integral domain



with exactly four elements? What about 15 elements? Use these observations to guess a general result about the number of elements in a finite integral domain.

35. Let  $F$  be a field of order  $2^n$ . Prove that  $\text{char } F = 2$ .
36. Determine all elements of an integral domain that are their own inverses under multiplication.
37. Characterize those integral domains for which 1 is the only element that is its own multiplicative inverse.
38. Determine all integers  $n > 1$  for which  $(n - 1)!$  is a zero-divisor in  $Z_n$ .
39. Suppose that  $a$  and  $b$  belong to an integral domain.
  - a. If  $a^5 = b^5$  and  $a^3 = b^3$ , prove that  $a = b$ .
  - b. If  $a^m = b^m$  and  $a^n = b^n$ , where  $m$  and  $n$  are positive integers that are relatively prime, prove that  $a = b$ .
40. Find an example of an integral domain and distinct positive integers  $m$  and  $n$  such that  $a^m = b^m$  and  $a^n = b^n$ , but  $a \neq b$ .
41. If  $a$  is an idempotent in a commutative ring, show that  $1 - a$  is also an idempotent.
42. Construct a multiplication table for  $Z_2[i]$ , the ring of Gaussian integers modulo 2. Is this ring a field? Is it an integral domain?
43. The nonzero elements of  $Z_3[i]$  form an Abelian group of order 8 under multiplication. Is it isomorphic to  $Z_8$ ,  $Z_4 \oplus Z_2$ , or  $Z_2 \oplus Z_2 \oplus Z_2$ ?
44. Show that  $Z_7[\sqrt{3}] = \{a + b\sqrt{3} \mid a, b \in Z_7\}$  is a field. For any positive integer  $k$  and any prime  $p$ , determine a necessary and sufficient condition for  $Z_p[\sqrt{k}] = \{a + b\sqrt{k} \mid a, b \in Z_p\}$  to be a field.
45. Show that a finite commutative ring with no zero-divisors and at least two elements has a unity.
46. Suppose that  $a$  and  $b$  belong to a commutative ring and  $ab$  is a zero-divisor. Show that either  $a$  or  $b$  is a zero-divisor.
47. Suppose that  $R$  is a commutative ring without zero-divisors. Show that all the nonzero elements of  $R$  have the same additive order.
48. Suppose that  $R$  is a commutative ring without zero-divisors. Show that the characteristic of  $R$  is 0 or prime.
49. Let  $x$  and  $y$  belong to a commutative ring  $R$  with prime characteristic  $p$ .
  - a. Show that  $(x + y)^p = x^p + y^p$ .
  - b. Show that, for all positive integers  $n$ ,  $(x + y)^{p^n} = x^{p^n} + y^{p^n}$ .
  - c. Find elements  $x$  and  $y$  in a ring of characteristic 4 such that  $(x + y)^4 \neq x^4 + y^4$ . (This exercise is referred to in Chapter 20.)
50. Let  $R$  be a commutative ring with unity 1 and prime characteristic. If  $a \in R$  is nilpotent, prove that there is a positive integer  $k$  such that  $(1 + a)^k = 1$ .

51. Show that any finite field has order  $p^n$ , where  $p$  is a prime. *Hint:* Use facts about finite Abelian groups. (This exercise is referred to in Chapter 22.)
52. Give an example of an infinite integral domain that has characteristic 3.
53. Let  $R$  be a ring and let  $M_2(R)$  be the ring of  $2 \times 2$  matrices with entries from  $R$ . Explain why these two rings have the same characteristic.
54. Let  $R$  be a ring with  $m$  elements. Show that the characteristic of  $R$  divides  $m$ .
55. Explain why a finite ring must have a nonzero characteristic.
56. Find all solutions of  $x^2 - x + 2 = 0$  over  $\mathbb{Z}_3[i]$ . (See Example 9.)
57. Consider the equation  $x^2 - 5x + 6 = 0$ .
  - a. How many solutions does this equation have in  $\mathbb{Z}_7$ ?
  - b. Find all solutions of this equation in  $\mathbb{Z}_8$ .
  - c. Find all solutions of this equation in  $\mathbb{Z}_{12}$ .
  - d. Find all solutions of this equation in  $\mathbb{Z}_{14}$ .
58. Find the characteristic of  $\mathbb{Z}_4 \oplus 4\mathbb{Z}$ .
59. Suppose that  $R$  is an integral domain in which  $20 \cdot 1 = 0$  and  $12 \cdot 1 = 0$ . (Recall that  $n \cdot 1$  means the sum  $1 + 1 + \cdots + 1$  with  $n$  terms.) What is the characteristic of  $R$ ?
60. In a commutative ring of characteristic 2, prove that the idempotents form a subring.
61. Describe the smallest subfield of the field of real numbers that contains  $\sqrt{2}$ . (That is, describe the subfield  $K$  with the property that  $K$  contains  $\sqrt{2}$  and if  $F$  is any subfield containing  $\sqrt{2}$ , then  $F$  contains  $K$ .)
62. Let  $F$  be a finite field with  $n$  elements. Prove that  $x^{n-1} = 1$  for all nonzero  $x$  in  $F$ .
63. Let  $F$  be a field of prime characteristic  $p$ . Prove that  $K = \{x \in F \mid x^p = x\}$  is a subfield of  $F$ .
64. Suppose that  $a$  and  $b$  belong to a field of order 8 and that  $a^2 + ab + b^2 = 0$ . Prove that  $a = 0$  and  $b = 0$ . Do the same when the field has order  $2^n$  with  $n$  odd.
65. Let  $F$  be a field of characteristic 2 with more than two elements. Show that  $(x + y)^3 \neq x^3 + y^3$  for some  $x$  and  $y$  in  $F$ .
66. Suppose that  $F$  is a field with characteristic not 2, and that the nonzero elements of  $F$  form a cyclic group under multiplication. Prove that  $F$  is finite.
67. Suppose that  $D$  is an integral domain and that  $\phi$  is a nonconstant function from  $D$  to the nonnegative integers such that  $\phi(xy) = \phi(x)\phi(y)$ . If  $x$  is a unit in  $D$ , show that  $\phi(x) = 1$ .

68. Let  $F$  be a field of order 32. Show that the only subfields of  $F$  are  $F$  itself and  $\{0, 1\}$ .
69. Suppose that  $F$  is a field with 27 elements. Show that for every element  $a \in F$ ,  $5a = -a$ .

## Computer Exercises

Computer exercises for this chapter are available at the website:

**<http://www.d.umn.edu/~jgallian>**

## Suggested Readings

Eric Berg, “A Family of Fields,” *Pi Mu Epsilon* 9 (1990): 154–155.

In this article, the author uses properties of logarithms and exponents to define recursively an infinite family of fields starting with the real numbers.

N. A. Khan, “The Characteristic of a Ring,” *American Mathematical Monthly* 70 (1963): 736–738.

Here it is shown that a ring has nonzero characteristic  $n$  if and only if  $n$  is the maximum of the orders of the elements of  $R$ .

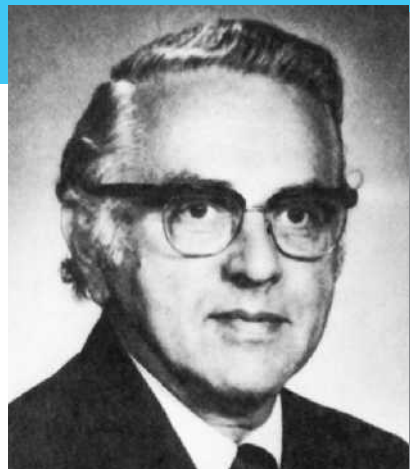
K. Robin McLean, “Groups in Modular Arithmetic,” *The Mathematical Gazette* 62 (1978): 94–104.

This article explores the interplay between various groups of integers under multiplication modulo  $n$  and the ring  $Z_n$ . It shows how to construct groups of integers in which the identity is not obvious; for example, 1977 is the identity of the group  $\{1977, 5931\}$  under multiplication modulo 7908.

# Nathan Jacobson

Few mathematicians have been as productive over such a long career or have had as much influence on the profession as has Professor Jacobson.

*Citation for the Steele Prize  
for Lifetime Achievement*



Courtesy of the American Mathematical Society ([www.ams.org](http://www.ams.org))

NATHAN JACOBSON was born on September 8, 1910, in Warsaw, Poland. After arriving in the United States in 1917, Jacobson grew up in Alabama, Mississippi, and Georgia, where his father owned small clothing stores. He received a B.A. degree from the University of Alabama in 1930 and a Ph.D. from Princeton in 1934. After brief periods as a professor at Bryn Mawr, the University of Chicago, the University of North Carolina, and Johns Hopkins, Jacobson accepted a position at Yale, where he remained until his retirement in 1981.

Jacobson's principal contributions to algebra were in the areas of rings, Lie algebras, and Jordan algebras. In particular, he developed structure theories for these systems. He was the author of nine books and

numerous articles, and he had 33 Ph.D. students.

Jacobson held visiting positions in France, India, Italy, Israel, China, Australia, and Switzerland. Among his many honors were the presidency of the American Mathematical Society, memberships in the National Academy of Sciences and the American Academy of Arts and Sciences, a Guggenheim Fellowship, and an honorary degree from the University of Chicago. Jacobson died on December 5, 1999, at the age of 89.

To find more information about Jacobson, visit:

**[http://www-groups.dcs  
.st-and.ac.uk/~history/](http://www-groups.dcs.st-and.ac.uk/~history/)**

# 14 Ideals and Factor Rings

Abstractness, sometimes hurled as a reproach at mathematics, is its chief glory and its surest title to practical usefulness. It is also the source of such beauty as may spring from mathematics.

E. T. Bell

The secret of science is to ask the right questions, and it is the choice of problem more than anything else that marks the man of genius in the scientific world.

Sir Henry Tizard In C. P. Snow,  
*A postscript to Science and Government*

## Ideals

Normal subgroups play a special role in group theory—they permit us to construct factor groups. In this chapter, we introduce the analogous concepts for rings—ideals and factor rings.

### Definition Ideal

A subring  $A$  of a ring  $R$  is called a (two-sided) *ideal* of  $R$  if for every  $r \in R$  and every  $a \in A$  both  $ra$  and  $ar$  are in  $A$ .

So, a subring  $A$  of a ring  $R$  is an ideal of  $R$  if  $A$  “absorbs” elements from  $R$ —that is, if  $rA = \{ra \mid a \in A\} \subseteq A$  and  $Ar = \{ar \mid a \in A\} \subseteq A$  for all  $r \in R$ .

An ideal  $A$  of  $R$  is called a *proper* ideal of  $R$  if  $A$  is a proper subset of  $R$ . In practice, one identifies ideals with the following test, which is an immediate consequence of the definition of ideal and the subring test given in Theorem 12.3.

### ■ Theorem 14.1 Ideal Test

A nonempty subset  $A$  of a ring  $R$  is an ideal of  $R$  if

1.  $a - b \in A$  whenever  $a, b \in A$ .
2.  $ra$  and  $ar$  are in  $A$  whenever  $a \in A$  and  $r \in R$ .

■ **EXAMPLE 1** For any ring  $R$ ,  $\{0\}$  and  $R$  are ideals of  $R$ . The ideal  $\{0\}$  is called the *trivial* ideal. ■

■ **EXAMPLE 2** For any positive integer  $n$ , the set  $n\mathbb{Z} = \{0, \pm n, \pm 2n, \dots\}$  is an ideal of  $\mathbb{Z}$ . ■

■ **EXAMPLE 3** Let  $R$  be a commutative ring with unity and let  $a \in R$ . The set  $\langle a \rangle = \{ra \mid r \in R\}$  is an ideal of  $R$  called the *principal ideal generated by  $a$* . (Notice that  $\langle a \rangle$  is also the notation we used for the cyclic subgroup generated by  $a$ . However, the intended meaning will always be clear from the context.) The assumption that  $R$  is commutative is necessary in this example. ■

■ **EXAMPLE 4** Let  $\mathbf{R}[x]$  denote the set of all polynomials with real coefficients and let  $A$  denote the subset of all polynomials with constant term 0. Then  $A$  is an ideal of  $\mathbf{R}[x]$  and  $A = \langle x \rangle$ . ■

■ **EXAMPLE 5** Let  $R$  be a commutative ring with unity and let  $a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n$  belong to  $R$ . Then  $I = \langle a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n \rangle = \{r_1a_1 + r_2a_2 + \dots + r_na_n \mid r_i \in R\}$  is an ideal of  $R$  called the *ideal generated by  $a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n$* . The verification that  $I$  is an ideal is left as an easy exercise (Exercise 3). ■

■ **EXAMPLE 6** Let  $\mathbb{Z}[x]$  denote the ring of all polynomials with integer coefficients and let  $I$  be the subset of  $\mathbb{Z}[x]$  of all polynomials with even constant terms. Then  $I$  is an ideal of  $\mathbb{Z}[x]$  and  $I = \langle x, 2 \rangle$  (see Exercise 39). ■

■ **EXAMPLE 7** Let  $R$  be the ring of all real-valued functions of a real variable. The subset  $S$  of all differentiable functions is a subring of  $R$  but not an ideal of  $R$ . ■

## Factor Rings

Let  $R$  be a ring and let  $A$  be an ideal of  $R$ . Since  $R$  is a group under addition and  $A$  is a normal subgroup of  $R$ , we may form the factor group  $R/A = \{r + A \mid r \in R\}$ . The natural question at this point is: How may we form a ring of this group of cosets? The addition is already taken care of, and, by analogy with groups of cosets, we define the product of two cosets of  $s + A$  and  $t + A$  as  $st + A$ . The next theorem shows that this definition works as long as  $A$  is an ideal, and not just a subring, of  $R$ .

## ■ Theorem 14.2 Existence of Factor Rings

*Let  $R$  be a ring and let  $A$  be a subring of  $R$ . The set of cosets  $\{r + A \mid r \in R\}$  is a ring under the operations  $(s + A) + (t + A) = s + t + A$  and  $(s + A)(t + A) = st + A$  if and only if  $A$  is an ideal of  $R$ .*

**PROOF** We know that the set of cosets forms a group under addition. Once we know that multiplication is indeed a binary operation on the cosets, it is trivial to check that the multiplication is associative and that multiplication is distributive over addition. Hence, the proof boils down to showing that multiplication is well-defined if and only if  $A$  is an ideal of  $R$ . To do this, let us suppose that  $A$  is an ideal and let  $s + A = s' + A$  and  $t + A = t' + A$ . Then we must show that  $st + A = s't' + A$ . Well, by definition,  $s = s' + a$  and  $t = t' + b$ , where  $a$  and  $b$  belong to  $A$ . Then

$$st = (s' + a)(t' + b) = s't' + at' + s'b + ab,$$

and so

$$st + A = s't' + at' + s'b + ab + A = s't' + A,$$

since  $A$  absorbs  $at' + s'b + ab$ . Thus, multiplication is well-defined when  $A$  is an ideal.

On the other hand, suppose that  $A$  is a subring of  $R$  that is not an ideal of  $R$ . Then there exist elements  $a \in A$  and  $r \in R$  such that  $ar \notin A$  or  $ra \notin A$ . For convenience, say  $ar \notin A$ . Consider the elements  $a + A = 0 + A$  and  $r + A$ . Clearly,  $(a + A)(r + A) = ar + A$  but  $(0 + A) \cdot (r + A) = 0 \cdot r + A = A$ . Since  $ar + A \neq A$ , the multiplication is not well-defined and the set of cosets is not a ring. ■

Let's look at a few factor rings.

■ **EXAMPLE 8**  $\mathbb{Z}/4\mathbb{Z} = \{0 + 4\mathbb{Z}, 1 + 4\mathbb{Z}, 2 + 4\mathbb{Z}, 3 + 4\mathbb{Z}\}$ . To see how to add and multiply, consider  $2 + 4\mathbb{Z}$  and  $3 + 4\mathbb{Z}$ .

$$\begin{aligned}(2 + 4\mathbb{Z}) + (3 + 4\mathbb{Z}) &= 5 + 4\mathbb{Z} = 1 + 4 + 4\mathbb{Z} = 1 + 4\mathbb{Z}, \\ (2 + 4\mathbb{Z})(3 + 4\mathbb{Z}) &= 6 + 4\mathbb{Z} = 2 + 4 + 4\mathbb{Z} = 2 + 4\mathbb{Z}.\end{aligned}$$

One can readily see that the two operations are essentially modulo 4 arithmetic. ■

■ **EXAMPLE 9**  $2\mathbb{Z}/6\mathbb{Z} = \{0 + 6\mathbb{Z}, 2 + 6\mathbb{Z}, 4 + 6\mathbb{Z}\}$ . Here the operations are essentially modulo 6 arithmetic. For example,  $(4 + 6\mathbb{Z}) + (4 + 6\mathbb{Z}) = 2 + 6\mathbb{Z}$  and  $(4 + 6\mathbb{Z})(4 + 6\mathbb{Z}) = 4 + 6\mathbb{Z}$ . ■

Here is a noncommutative example of an ideal and factor ring.

■ **EXAMPLE 10** Let  $R = \left\{ \begin{bmatrix} a_1 & a_2 \\ a_3 & a_4 \end{bmatrix} \mid a_i \in Z \right\}$  and let  $I$  be the subset of  $R$  consisting of matrices with even entries. It is easy to show that  $I$  is indeed an ideal of  $R$  (Exercise 21). Consider the factor ring  $R/I$ . The interesting question about this ring is: What is its size?

We claim  $R/I$  has 16 elements; in fact,  $R/I = \left\{ \begin{bmatrix} r_1 & r_2 \\ r_3 & r_4 \end{bmatrix} + I \mid r_i \in \{0, 1\} \right\}$ .

An example illustrates the typical situation. Which of the 16 elements

is  $\begin{bmatrix} 7 & 8 \\ 5 & -3 \end{bmatrix} + I$ ? Well, observe that  $\begin{bmatrix} 7 & 8 \\ 5 & -3 \end{bmatrix} + I = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix} +$

$\begin{bmatrix} 6 & 8 \\ 4 & -4 \end{bmatrix} + I = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix} + I$ , since an ideal absorbs its own elements.

The general case is left to the reader (Exercise 23). ■

■ **EXAMPLE 11** Consider the factor ring of the Gaussian integers  $R = Z[i]/\langle 2 - i \rangle$ . What does this ring look like? Of course, the elements of  $R$  have the form  $a + bi + \langle 2 - i \rangle$ , where  $a$  and  $b$  are integers, but the important question is: What do the *distinct* cosets look like? The fact that  $2 - i + \langle 2 - i \rangle = 0 + \langle 2 - i \rangle$  means that *when dealing with coset representatives*, we may treat  $2 - i$  as equivalent to 0, so that  $2 = i$ . For example, the coset  $3 + 4i + \langle 2 - i \rangle = 3 + 8 + \langle 2 - i \rangle = 11 + \langle 2 - i \rangle$ . Similarly, all the elements of  $R$  can be written in the form  $a + \langle 2 - i \rangle$ , where  $a$  is an integer. But we can further reduce the set of distinct coset representatives by observing that *when dealing with coset representatives*,  $2 = i$  implies (by squaring both sides) that  $4 = -1$  or  $5 = 0$ . Thus, the coset  $3 + 4i + \langle 2 - i \rangle = 11 + \langle 2 - i \rangle = 1 + 5 + 5 + \langle 2 - i \rangle = 1 + \langle 2 - i \rangle$ . In this way, we can show that every element of  $R$  is equal to one of the following cosets:  $0 + \langle 2 - i \rangle$ ,  $1 + \langle 2 - i \rangle$ ,  $2 + \langle 2 - i \rangle$ ,  $3 + \langle 2 - i \rangle$ ,  $4 + \langle 2 - i \rangle$ . Is any further reduction possible? To demonstrate that there is not, we will show that these five cosets are distinct. It suffices to show that  $1 + \langle 2 - i \rangle$  has additive order 5. Since  $5(1 + \langle 2 - i \rangle) = 5 + \langle 2 - i \rangle = 0 + \langle 2 - i \rangle$ ,  $1 + \langle 2 - i \rangle$  has order 1 or 5. If the order is actually 1, then  $1 + \langle 2 - i \rangle = 0 + \langle 2 - i \rangle$ , so  $1 \in \langle 2 - i \rangle$ . Thus,  $1 = (2 - i)(a + bi) = 2a + b + (-a + 2b)i$  for some integers  $a$  and  $b$ . But this equation implies that  $1 = 2a + b$  and  $0 = -a + 2b$ , and solving these simultaneously yields  $b = 1/5$ , which is a contradiction. It should be clear that the ring  $R$  is essentially the same as the field  $Z_5$ . ■

■ **EXAMPLE 12** Let  $\mathbf{R}[x]$  denote the ring of polynomials with real coefficients and let  $\langle x^2 + 1 \rangle$  denote the principal ideal generated by  $x^2 + 1$ ; that is,



$$\langle x^2 + 1 \rangle = \{f(x)(x^2 + 1) \mid f(x) \in \mathbf{R}[x]\}.$$

Then

$$\begin{aligned}\mathbf{R}[x]/\langle x^2 + 1 \rangle &= \{g(x) + \langle x^2 + 1 \rangle \mid g(x) \in \mathbf{R}[x]\} \\ &= \{ax + b + \langle x^2 + 1 \rangle \mid a, b \in \mathbf{R}\}.\end{aligned}$$

To see this last equality, note that if  $g(x)$  is any member of  $\mathbf{R}[x]$ , then we may write  $g(x)$  in the form  $q(x)(x^2 + 1) + r(x)$ , where  $q(x)$  is the quotient and  $r(x)$  is the remainder upon dividing  $g(x)$  by  $x^2 + 1$ . In particular,  $r(x) = 0$  or the degree of  $r(x)$  is less than 2, so that  $r(x) = ax + b$  for some  $a$  and  $b$  in  $\mathbf{R}$ . Thus,

$$\begin{aligned}g(x) + \langle x^2 + 1 \rangle &= q(x)(x^2 + 1) + r(x) + \langle x^2 + 1 \rangle \\ &= r(x) + \langle x^2 + 1 \rangle,\end{aligned}$$

since the ideal  $\langle x^2 + 1 \rangle$  absorbs the term  $q(x)(x^2 + 1)$ .

How is multiplication done? Since

$$x^2 + 1 + \langle x^2 + 1 \rangle = 0 + \langle x^2 + 1 \rangle,$$

one should think of  $x^2 + 1$  as 0 or, equivalently, as  $x^2 = -1$ . So, for example,

$$\begin{aligned}(x + 3 + \langle x^2 + 1 \rangle) \cdot (2x + 5 + \langle x^2 + 1 \rangle) \\ = 2x^2 + 11x + 15 + \langle x^2 + 1 \rangle = 11x + 13 + \langle x^2 + 1 \rangle.\end{aligned}$$

In view of the fact that the elements of this ring have the form  $ax + b + \langle x^2 + 1 \rangle$ , where  $x^2 + \langle x^2 + 1 \rangle = -1 + \langle x^2 + 1 \rangle$ , it is perhaps not surprising that this ring turns out to be algebraically the same ring as the ring of complex numbers. This observation was first made by Cauchy in 1847. ■

Examples 11 and 12 illustrate one of the most important applications of factor rings—the construction of rings with highly desirable properties. In particular, we shall show how one may use factor rings to construct integral domains and fields.

## Prime Ideals and Maximal Ideals

### Definition Prime Ideal, Maximal Ideal

A *prime ideal*  $A$  of a commutative ring  $R$  is a proper ideal of  $R$  such that  $a, b \in R$  and  $ab \in A$  imply  $a \in A$  or  $b \in A$ . A *maximal ideal* of a commutative ring  $R$  is a *proper ideal* of  $R$  such that, whenever  $B$  is an ideal of  $R$  and  $A \subseteq B \subseteq R$ , then  $B = A$  or  $B = R$ .

So, the only ideal that properly contains a maximal ideal is the entire ring. The motivation for the definition of a prime ideal comes from the integers.

■ **EXAMPLE 13** Let  $n$  be an integer greater than 1. Then, in the ring of integers, the ideal  $n\mathbb{Z}$  is prime if and only if  $n$  is prime (Exercise 9).  $\{0\}$  is also a prime ideal of  $\mathbb{Z}$ . ■

■ **EXAMPLE 14** The lattice of ideals of  $\mathbb{Z}_{36}$  (Figure 14.1) shows that only  $\langle 2 \rangle$  and  $\langle 3 \rangle$  are maximal ideals. ■

■ **EXAMPLE 15** The ideal  $\langle x^2 + 1 \rangle$  is maximal in  $\mathbb{R}[x]$ . To see this, assume that  $A$  is an ideal of  $\mathbb{R}[x]$  that properly contains  $\langle x^2 + 1 \rangle$ . We will prove that  $A = \mathbb{R}[x]$  by showing that  $A$  contains some nonzero real number  $c$ . [This is the constant polynomial  $h(x) = c$  for all  $x$ .] Then  $1 = (1/c)c \in A$  and therefore, by Exercise 15,  $A = \mathbb{R}[x]$ . To this end, let  $f(x) \in A$ , but  $f(x) \notin \langle x^2 + 1 \rangle$ . Then

$$f(x) = q(x)(x^2 + 1) + r(x),$$

where  $r(x) \neq 0$  and the degree of  $r(x)$  is less than 2. It follows that  $r(x) = ax + b$ , where  $a$  and  $b$  are not both 0, and

$$ax + b = r(x) = f(x) - q(x)(x^2 + 1) \in A.$$

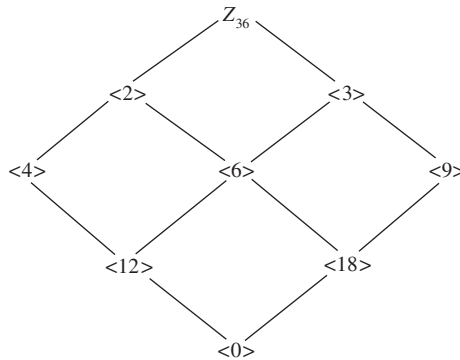


Figure 14.1

Thus,

$$a^2x^2 - b^2 = (ax + b)(ax - b) \in A \quad \text{and} \quad a^2(x^2 + 1) \in A.$$

So,

$$0 \neq a^2 + b^2 = (a^2x^2 + a^2) - (a^2x^2 - b^2) \in A. \quad \blacksquare$$

■ **EXAMPLE 16** The ideal  $\langle x^2 + 1 \rangle$  is not prime in  $\mathbb{Z}_2[x]$ , since it contains  $(x + 1)^2 = x^2 + 2x + 1 = x^2 + 1$  but does not contain  $x + 1$ . ■

The next two theorems are useful for determining whether a particular ideal is prime or maximal.

■ **Theorem 14.3**  *$R/A$  Is an Integral Domain If and Only If  $A$  Is Prime*

*Let  $R$  be a commutative ring with unity and let  $A$  be an ideal of  $R$ . Then  $R/A$  is an integral domain if and only if  $A$  is prime.*

**PROOF** Suppose that  $R/A$  is an integral domain and  $ab \in A$ . Then  $(a + A)(b + A) = ab + A = A$ , the zero element of the ring  $R/A$ . So, either  $a + A = A$  or  $b + A = A$ ; that is, either  $a \in A$  or  $b \in A$ . Hence,  $A$  is prime.

To prove the other half of the theorem, we first observe that  $R/A$  is a commutative ring with unity for any proper ideal  $A$ . Thus, our task is simply to show that when  $A$  is prime,  $R/A$  has no zero-divisors. So, suppose that  $A$  is prime and  $(a + A)(b + A) = 0 + A = A$ . Then  $ab \in A$  and, therefore,  $a \in A$  or  $b \in A$ . Thus, one of  $a + A$  or  $b + A$  is the zero coset in  $R/A$ . ■

For maximal ideals, we can do even better.

■ **Theorem 14.4**  *$R/A$  Is a Field If and Only If  $A$  Is Maximal*

*Let  $R$  be a commutative ring with unity and let  $A$  be an ideal of  $R$ . Then  $R/A$  is a field if and only if  $A$  is maximal.*

**PROOF** Suppose that  $R/A$  is a field and  $B$  is an ideal of  $R$  that properly contains  $A$ . Let  $b \in B$  but  $b \notin A$ . Then  $b + A$  is a nonzero element of  $R/A$  and, therefore, there exists an element  $c + A$  such that  $(b + A) \cdot (c + A) = 1 + A$ , the multiplicative identity of  $R/A$ . Since  $b \in B$ , we have  $bc \in B$ . Because

$$1 + A = (b + A)(c + A) = bc + A,$$

we have  $1 - bc \in A \subset B$ . So,  $1 = (1 - bc) + bc \in B$ . By Exercise 15,  $B = R$ . This proves that  $A$  is maximal.

Now suppose that  $A$  is maximal and let  $b \in R$  but  $b \notin A$ . It suffices to show that  $b + A$  has a multiplicative inverse. (All other properties for a field follow trivially.) Consider  $B = \{br + a \mid r \in R, a \in A\}$ . This is an ideal of  $R$  that properly contains  $A$  (Exercise 25). Since  $A$  is maximal, we must have  $B = R$ . Thus,  $1 \in B$ , say,  $1 = bc + a'$ , where  $a' \in A$ . Then

$$1 + A = bc + a' + A = bc + A = (b + A)(c + A). \quad \blacksquare$$

When a commutative ring has a unity, it follows from Theorems 14.3 and 14.4 that a maximal ideal is a prime ideal. The next example shows that a prime ideal need not be maximal.

**■ EXAMPLE 17** The ideal  $\langle x \rangle$  is a prime ideal in  $Z[x]$  but not a maximal ideal in  $Z[x]$ . To verify this, we begin with the observation that  $\langle x \rangle = \{f(x) \in Z[x] \mid f(0) = 0\}$  (see Exercise 31). Thus, if  $g(x)h(x) \in \langle x \rangle$ , then  $g(0)h(0) = 0$ . And since  $g(0)$  and  $h(0)$  are integers, we have  $g(0) = 0$  or  $h(0) = 0$ .

To see that  $\langle x \rangle$  is not maximal, we simply note that  $\langle x \rangle \subset \langle x, 2 \rangle \subset Z[x]$  (see Exercise 39). **■**

## Exercises

One Problem after another presents itself and in the solving of them we can find our greatest pleasure.

Karl Menninger

1. Verify that the set defined in Example 3 is an ideal.
2. Verify that the set  $A$  in Example 4 is an ideal and that  $A = \langle x \rangle$ .
3. Verify that the set  $I$  in Example 5 is an ideal and that if  $J$  is any ideal of  $R$  that contains  $a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n$ , then  $I \subseteq J$ . (Hence,  $\langle a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n \rangle$  is the smallest ideal of  $R$  that contains  $a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n$ .)
4. Find a subring of  $Z \oplus Z$  that is not an ideal of  $Z \oplus Z$ .
5. Let  $S = \{a + bi \mid a, b \in Z, b \text{ is even}\}$ . Show that  $S$  is a subring of  $Z[i]$ , but not an ideal of  $Z[i]$ .
6. Find all maximal ideals in
  - a.  $Z_8$ .
  - b.  $Z_{10}$ .
  - c.  $Z_{12}$ .
  - d.  $Z_n$ .
7. Let  $a$  belong to a commutative ring  $R$ . Show that  $aR = \{ar \mid r \in R\}$  is an ideal of  $R$ . If  $R$  is the ring of even integers, list the elements of  $4R$ .
8. Prove that the intersection of any set of ideals of a ring is an ideal.
9. If  $n$  is an integer greater than 1, show that  $\langle n \rangle = nZ$  is a prime ideal of  $Z$  if and only if  $n$  is prime. (This exercise is referred to in this chapter.)
10. If  $A$  and  $B$  are ideals of a ring, show that the *sum* of  $A$  and  $B$ ,  $A + B = \{a + b \mid a \in A, b \in B\}$ , is an ideal.
11. In the ring of integers, find a positive integer  $a$  such that
  - a.  $\langle a \rangle = \langle 2 \rangle + \langle 3 \rangle$ .
  - b.  $\langle a \rangle = \langle 6 \rangle + \langle 8 \rangle$ .
  - c.  $\langle a \rangle = \langle m \rangle + \langle n \rangle$ .

12. If  $A$  and  $B$  are ideals of a ring, show that the *product* of  $A$  and  $B$ ,  $AB = \{a_1b_1 + a_2b_2 + \cdots + a_nb_n \mid a_i \in A, b_i \in B, n \text{ a positive integer}\}$ , is an ideal.
13. Find a positive integer  $a$  such that
  - a.  $\langle a \rangle = \langle 3 \rangle \langle 4 \rangle$ .
  - b.  $\langle a \rangle = \langle 6 \rangle \langle 8 \rangle$ .
  - c.  $\langle a \rangle = \langle m \rangle \langle n \rangle$ .
14. Let  $A$  and  $B$  be ideals of a ring. Prove that  $AB \subseteq A \cap B$ .
15. If  $A$  is an ideal of a ring  $R$  and 1 belongs to  $A$ , prove that  $A = R$ . (This exercise is referred to in this chapter.)
16. If  $A$  and  $B$  are ideals of a commutative ring  $R$  with unity and  $A + B = R$ , show that  $A \cap B = AB$ .
17. If an ideal  $I$  of a ring  $R$  contains a unit, show that  $I = R$ .
18. If  $R$  is a finite commutative ring with unity, prove that every prime ideal of  $R$  is a maximal ideal of  $R$ .
19. Give an example of a ring that has exactly two maximal ideals.
20. Suppose that  $R$  is a commutative ring and  $|R| = 30$ . If  $I$  is an ideal of  $R$  and  $|I| = 10$ , prove that  $I$  is a maximal ideal.
21. Let  $R$  and  $I$  be as described in Example 10. Prove that  $I$  is an ideal of  $R$ .
22. Let  $I = \langle 2 \rangle$ . Prove that  $I[x]$  is not a maximal ideal of  $Z[x]$  even though  $I$  is a maximal ideal of  $Z$ .
23. Verify the claim made in Example 10 about the size of  $R/I$ .
24. Give an example of a commutative ring that has a maximal ideal that is not a prime ideal.
25. Show that the set  $B$  in the latter half of the proof of Theorem 14.4 is an ideal of  $R$ . (This exercise is referred to in this chapter.)
26. If  $R$  is a commutative ring with unity and  $A$  is a proper ideal of  $R$ , show that  $R/A$  is a commutative ring with unity.
27. Prove that the only ideals of a field  $F$  are  $\{0\}$  and  $F$  itself.
28. Let  $R$  be a commutative ring with unity. Suppose that the only ideals of  $R$  are  $\{0\}$  and  $R$ . Show that  $R$  is a field.
29. List the distinct elements in the ring  $Z[x]/\langle 3, x^2 + 1 \rangle$ . Show that this ring is a field.
30. Show that  $\mathbf{R}[x]/\langle x^2 + 1 \rangle$  is a field.
31. In  $Z[x]$ , the ring of polynomials with integer coefficients, let  $I = \{f(x) \in Z[x] \mid f(0) = 0\}$ . Prove that  $I = \langle x \rangle$ . (This exercise is referred to in this chapter and in Chapter 15.)
32. Show that  $A = \{(3x, y) \mid x, y \in Z\}$  is a maximal ideal of  $Z \oplus Z$ . Generalize. What happens if  $3x$  is replaced by  $4x$ ? Generalize.

33. Let  $R$  be the ring of continuous functions from  $\mathbf{R}$  to  $\mathbf{R}$ . Show that  $A = \{f \in R \mid f(0) = 0\}$  is a maximal ideal of  $R$ .
34. Let  $R = \mathbf{Z}_8 \oplus \mathbf{Z}_{30}$ . Find all maximal ideals of  $R$ , and for each maximal ideal  $I$ , identify the size of the field  $R/I$ .
35. How many elements are in  $\mathbf{Z}[i]/\langle 3 + i \rangle$ ? Give reasons for your answer.
36. In  $\mathbf{Z}[x]$ , the ring of polynomials with integer coefficients, let  $I = \{f(x) \in \mathbf{Z}[x] \mid f(0) = 0\}$ . Prove that  $I$  is not a maximal ideal.
37. In  $\mathbf{Z} \oplus \mathbf{Z}$ , let  $I = \{(a, 0) \mid a \in \mathbf{Z}\}$ . Show that  $I$  is a prime ideal but not a maximal ideal.
38. Let  $R$  be a ring and let  $I$  be an ideal of  $R$ . Prove that the factor ring  $R/I$  is commutative if and only if  $rs - sr \in I$  for all  $r$  and  $s$  in  $R$ .
39. In  $\mathbf{Z}[x]$ , let  $I = \{f(x) \in \mathbf{Z}[x] \mid f(0) \text{ is an even integer}\}$ . Prove that  $I = \langle x, 2 \rangle$ . Is  $I$  a prime ideal of  $\mathbf{Z}[x]$ ? Is  $I$  a maximal ideal? How many elements does  $\mathbf{Z}[x]/I$  have? (This exercise is referred to in this chapter.)
40. Prove that  $I = \langle 2 + 2i \rangle$  is not a prime ideal of  $\mathbf{Z}[i]$ . How many elements are in  $\mathbf{Z}[i]/I$ ? What is the characteristic of  $\mathbf{Z}[i]/I$ ?
41. In  $\mathbf{Z}_5[x]$ , let  $I = \langle x^2 + x + 2 \rangle$ . Find the multiplicative inverse of  $2x + 3 + I$  in  $\mathbf{Z}_5[x]/I$ .
42. Let  $R$  be a ring and let  $p$  be a fixed prime. Show that  $I_p = \{r \in R \mid \text{additive order of } r \text{ is a power of } p\}$  is an ideal of  $R$ .
43. An integral domain  $D$  is called a *principal ideal domain* if every ideal of  $D$  has the form  $\langle a \rangle = \{ad \mid d \in D\}$  for some  $a$  in  $D$ . Show that  $\mathbf{Z}$  is a principal ideal domain. (This exercise is referred to in Chapter 18.)
44. Let  $R = \left\{ \begin{bmatrix} a & b \\ 0 & d \end{bmatrix} \mid a, b, d \in \mathbf{Z} \right\}$  and  $S = \left\{ \begin{bmatrix} r & s \\ 0 & t \end{bmatrix} \mid r, s, t \in \mathbf{Z}, s \text{ is even} \right\}$ . If  $S$  is an ideal of  $R$ , what can you say about  $r$  and  $t$ ?
45. If  $R$  and  $S$  are principal ideal domains, prove that  $R \oplus S$  is a principal ideal ring. (See Exercise 41 for the definition.)
46. In a principal ideal domain, show that every nontrivial prime ideal is a maximal ideal.
47. Let  $R$  be a commutative ring and let  $A$  be any subset of  $R$ . Show that the *annihilator* of  $A$ ,  $\text{Ann}(A) = \{r \in R \mid ra = 0 \text{ for all } a \text{ in } A\}$ , is an ideal.
48. Let  $R$  be a commutative ring and let  $A$  be any ideal of  $R$ . Show that the *nil radical* of  $A$ ,  $N(A) = \{r \in R \mid r^n \in A \text{ for some positive integer } n \text{ (} n \text{ depends on } r)\}$ , is an ideal of  $R$ . [ $N(\langle 0 \rangle)$  is called the *nil radical* of  $R$ .]

49. Let  $R = Z_{27}$ . Find
  - a.  $N(\langle 0 \rangle)$ .
  - b.  $N(\langle 3 \rangle)$ .
  - c.  $N(\langle 9 \rangle)$ .
50. Let  $R = Z_{36}$ . Find
  - a.  $N(\langle 0 \rangle)$ .
  - b.  $N(\langle 4 \rangle)$ .
  - c.  $N(\langle 6 \rangle)$ .
51. Let  $R$  be a commutative ring. Show that  $R/N(\langle 0 \rangle)$  has no nonzero nilpotent elements.
52. Let  $A$  be an ideal of a commutative ring. Prove that  $N(N(A)) = N(A)$ .
53. Let  $Z_2[x]$  be the ring of all polynomials with coefficients in  $Z_2$  (that is, coefficients are 0 or 1, and addition and multiplication of coefficients are done modulo 2). Show that  $Z_2[x]/\langle x^2 + x + 1 \rangle$  is a field.
54. List the elements of the field given in Exercise 51, and make an addition and multiplication table for the field.
55. Show that  $Z_3[x]/\langle x^2 + x + 1 \rangle$  is not a field.
56. Let  $R$  be a commutative ring without unity, and let  $a \in R$ . Describe the smallest ideal  $I$  of  $R$  that contains  $a$  (that is, if  $J$  is any ideal that contains  $a$ , then  $I \subseteq J$ ).
57. Let  $R$  be the ring of continuous functions from  $\mathbf{R}$  to  $\mathbf{R}$ . Let  $A = \{f \in R \mid f(0) \text{ is an even integer}\}$ . Show that  $A$  is a subring of  $R$ , but not an ideal of  $R$ .
58. Show that  $Z[i]/\langle 1 - i \rangle$  is a field. How many elements does this field have?
59. If  $R$  is a principal ideal domain and  $I$  is an ideal of  $R$ , prove that every ideal of  $R/I$  is principal (see Exercise 43).
60. How many elements are in  $Z_5[i]/\langle 1 + i \rangle$ ?
61. Show, by example, that the intersection of two prime ideals need not be a prime ideal.
62. Let  $\mathbf{R}$  denote the ring of real numbers. Determine all ideals of  $\mathbf{R} \oplus \mathbf{R}$ . What happens if  $\mathbf{R}$  is replaced by any field  $F$ ?
63. Find the characteristic of  $Z[i]/\langle 2 + i \rangle$ .
64. Show that the characteristic of  $Z[i]/\langle a + bi \rangle$  divides  $a^2 + b^2$ .
65. Prove that the set of all polynomials whose coefficients are all even is a prime ideal in  $Z[x]$ .
66. Let  $R = Z[\sqrt{-5}]$  and let  $I = \{a + b\sqrt{-5} \mid a, b \in Z, a - b \text{ is even}\}$ . Show that  $I$  is a maximal ideal of  $R$ .
67. Let  $R$  be a commutative ring with unity that has the property that  $a^2 = a$  for all  $a$  in  $R$ . Let  $I$  be a prime ideal in  $R$ . Show that  $|R/I| = 2$ .
68. Let  $R$  be a commutative ring with unity, and let  $I$  be a proper ideal with the property that every element of  $R$  that is not in  $I$  is a unit of  $R$ . Prove that  $I$  is the unique maximal ideal of  $R$ .

69. Let  $I_0 = \{f(x) \in \mathbb{Z}[x] \mid f(0) = 0\}$ . For any positive integer  $n$ , show that there exists a sequence of strictly increasing ideals such that  $I_0 \subset I_1 \subset I_2 \subset \cdots \subset I_n \subset \mathbb{Z}[x]$ .
70. Let  $R = \{(a_1, a_2, a_3, \dots)\}$ , where each  $a_i \in \mathbb{Z}$ . Let  $I = \{(a_1, a_2, a_3, \dots)\}$ , where only a finite number of terms are nonzero. Prove that  $I$  is not a principal ideal of  $R$ .
71. Let  $R$  be a commutative ring with unity and let  $a, b \in R$ . Show that  $\langle a, b \rangle$ , the smallest ideal of  $R$  containing  $a$  and  $b$ , is  $I = \{ra + sb \mid r, s \in R\}$ . That is, show that  $I$  contains  $a$  and  $b$  and that any ideal that contains  $a$  and  $b$  also contains  $I$ .

## Computer Exercises

Computer exercises for this chapter are available at the website:

<http://www.d.umn.edu/~jgallian>

## Suggested Reading

Thomas Sonar, “Brunswick’s Second Mathematical Star: Richard Dedekind (1831–1916),” *The Mathematical Intelligencer* 34:2 (2012): 63–67.

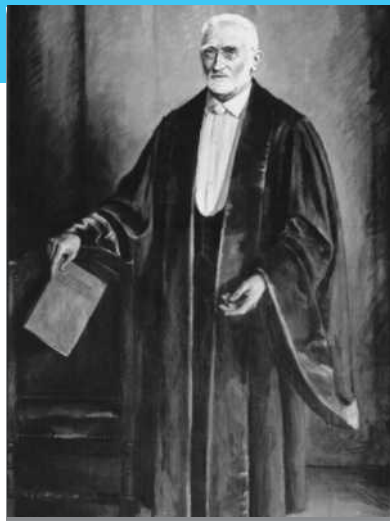
This beautifully illustrated short biographical sketch of Dedekind emphasizes the breadth of his talent and interests. Dedekind was the last doctoral student of Gauss, and a steadfast friend of Bernhard Riemann. He gave the first lectures on Galois theory in Germany, edited the collective works of Lejeune Dirichlet, and promoted the work of Georg Cantor. He was also an accomplished musician on the piano and the cello, and played chamber music with Brahms in the home of Dirichlet, whose wife Rebecka Mendelssohn was the sister of Felix Mendelssohn. As the first president of the Technical University of Brunswick, Dedekind supervised the construction of the new university. In his honor, the council of mathematics students at the university still call themselves the Dedekinder, the “children of Dedekind”.



# Richard Dedekind

Richard Dedekind was not only a mathematician, but one of the wholly great in the history of mathematics, now and in the past, the last hero of a great epoch, the last pupil of Gauss, for four decades himself a classic, from whose works not only we, but our teachers and the teachers of our teachers, have drawn.

EDMUND LANDAU,  
*Commemorative Address  
to the Royal Society of Göttingen*



akg-images/Newscom

RICHARD DEDEKIND was born on October 6, 1831, in Brunswick, Germany, the birthplace of Gauss. Dedekind was the youngest of four children of a law professor. His early interests were in chemistry and physics, but he obtained a doctor's degree in mathematics at the age of 21 under Gauss at the University of Göttingen. Dedekind continued his studies at Göttingen for a few years, and in 1854 he began to lecture there.

Dedekind spent the years 1858–1862 as a professor in Zürich. Then he accepted a position at an institute in Brunswick where he had once been a student. Although this school was less than university level, Dedekind remained there for the next 50 years. He died in Brunswick in 1916.

During his career, Dedekind made numerous fundamental contributions to mathematics. His treatment of irrational numbers, “Dedekind cuts,” put analysis on a firm, logical foundation. His work on unique factorization led to the modern theory of algebraic numbers. He was a pioneer in the theory of rings and fields. The notion of ideals as well as the term itself are attributed to Dedekind. Mathematics historian Morris Kline has called him “the effective founder of abstract algebra.”

To find more information about Dedekind, visit:

[http://www-groups.dcs  
.st-and.ac.uk/~history/](http://www-groups.dcs.st-and.ac.uk/~history/)

## Emmy Noether

... she discovered methods which have proved of enormous importance in the development of the present-day younger generation of mathematicians.

ALBERT EINSTEIN, *The New York Times*



The Granger Collection, NY

EMMY NOETHER was born on March 23, 1882, in Germany. When she entered the University of Erlangen, she was one of only two women among the 1000 students. Noether completed her doctorate in 1907.

In 1916, Noether went to Göttingen and, under the influence of David Hilbert and Felix Klein, became interested in general relativity. While there, she made a major contribution to physics with her theorem that whenever there is a symmetry in nature, there is also a conservation law, and vice versa. In a 2012 issue of the New York Times science writer Ranson Stephens said "You can make a strong case that her theorem is the backbone on which all of modern physics is built." Hilbert tried unsuccessfully to obtain a faculty appointment at Göttingen for Noether, saying, "I do not see that the sex of the candidate is an argument against her admission as Privatdozent. After all, we are a university and not a bathing establishment."

It was not until she was 38 that Noether's true genius revealed itself. Over the next 13 years, she used an axiomatic method to develop a general theory of ideals and non-commutative algebras. With this abstract theory, Noether was able to weld together many important concepts. Her approach was even more important than the individual results. Hermann Weyl said of Noether, "She originated above all a new and epoch-making style of thinking in algebra."

With the rise of Hitler in 1933, Noether, a Jew, fled to the United States and took a position at Bryn Mawr College. She died suddenly on April 14, 1935, following an operation.

To find more information about Noether, visit:

<http://www-groups.dcs.st-and.ac.uk/~history/>

# 15 Ring Homomorphisms

If there is one central idea which is common to all aspects of modern algebra it is the notion of homomorphism.

I. N. Herstein, *Topics in Algebra*

In mathematics, functions are used, among other purposes, (1) to carry out a *matching up* of elements of one system with those of another; and (2) to transform a given system (or problem) into a simpler one.

Norman J. Block, *Abstract Algebra with Applications*

## Definition and Examples

In our work with groups, we saw that one way to discover information about a group is to examine its interaction with other groups by way of homomorphisms. It should not be surprising to learn that this concept extends to rings with equally profitable results.

Just as a group homomorphism preserves the group operation, a ring homomorphism preserves the ring operations.

### **Definitions** Ring Homomorphism, Ring Isomorphism

A *ring homomorphism*  $\phi$  from a ring  $R$  to a ring  $S$  is a mapping from  $R$  to  $S$  that preserves the two ring operations; that is, for all  $a, b$  in  $R$ ,

$$\phi(a + b) = \phi(a) + \phi(b) \quad \text{and} \quad \phi(ab) = \phi(a)\phi(b).$$

A ring homomorphism that is both one-to-one and onto is called a *ring isomorphism*.

As is the case for groups, in the preceding definition the operations on the left of the equal signs are those of  $R$ , whereas the operations on the right of the equal signs are those of  $S$ .

Again as with group theory, the roles of isomorphisms and homomorphisms are entirely distinct. An isomorphism is used to show that two rings are algebraically identical; a homomorphism is used to simplify a ring while retaining certain of its features.

A schematic representation of a ring homomorphism is given in Figure 15.1. The dashed arrows indicate the results of performing the ring operations.

The following examples illustrate ring homomorphisms. The reader should supply the missing details.

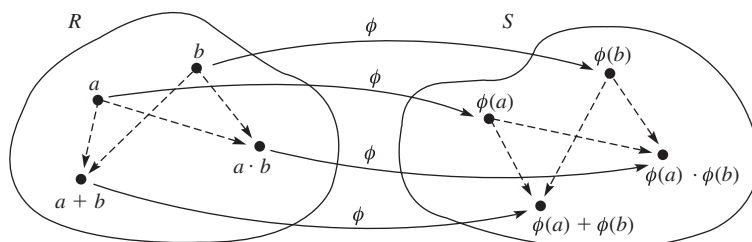


Figure 15.1

■ **EXAMPLE 1** For any positive integer  $n$ , the mapping  $k \rightarrow k \bmod n$  is a ring homomorphism from  $\mathbb{Z}$  onto  $\mathbb{Z}_n$  (see Exercise 9 in Chapter 0). This mapping is called the *natural homomorphism* from  $\mathbb{Z}$  to  $\mathbb{Z}_n$ . ■

■ **EXAMPLE 2** The mapping  $a + bi \rightarrow a - bi$  is a ring isomorphism from the complex numbers onto the complex numbers (see Exercise 37 in Chapter 6). ■

■ **EXAMPLE 3** Let  $\mathbf{R}[x]$  denote the ring of all polynomials with real coefficients. The mapping  $f(x) \rightarrow f(1)$  is a ring homomorphism from  $\mathbf{R}[x]$  onto  $\mathbf{R}$ . ■

■ **EXAMPLE 4** The correspondence  $\phi: x \rightarrow 5x$  from  $\mathbb{Z}_4$  to  $\mathbb{Z}_{10}$  is a ring homomorphism. Although showing that  $\phi(x + y) = \phi(x) + \phi(y)$  appears to be accomplished by the simple statement that  $5(x + y) = 5x + 5y$ , we must bear in mind that the addition on the left is done modulo 4, whereas the addition on the right and the multiplication on both sides are done modulo 10. An analogous difficulty arises in showing that  $\phi$  preserves multiplication. So, to verify that  $\phi$  preserves both operations, we write  $x + y = 4q_1 + r_1$  and  $xy = 4q_2 + r_2$ , where  $0 \leq r_1 < 4$  and  $0 \leq r_2 < 4$ . Then  $\phi(x + y) = \phi(r_1) = 5r_1 = 5(x + y - 4q_1) = 5x + 5y - 20q_1 = 5x + 5y = \phi(x) + \phi(y)$  in  $\mathbb{Z}_{10}$ . Similarly, using the fact that  $5 \cdot 5 = 5$  in  $\mathbb{Z}_{10}$ , we have  $\phi(xy) = \phi(r_2) = 5r_2 = 5(xy - 4q_2) = 5xy - 20q_2 = (5 \cdot 5)xy = 5x5y = \phi(x)\phi(y)$  in  $\mathbb{Z}_{10}$ . ■

■ **EXAMPLE 5** We determine all ring homomorphisms from  $\mathbb{Z}_{12}$  to  $\mathbb{Z}_{30}$ . By Example 10 in Chapter 10, the only group homomorphisms from  $\mathbb{Z}_{12}$  to  $\mathbb{Z}_{30}$  are  $x \rightarrow ax$ , where  $a = 0, 15, 10, 20, 5$ , or  $25$ . But, since  $1 \cdot 1 = 1$  in  $\mathbb{Z}_{12}$ , we must have  $a \cdot a = a$  in  $\mathbb{Z}_{30}$ . This requirement rules out 20 and 5 as

possibilities for  $a$ . Finally, simple calculations show that each of the remaining four choices does yield a ring homomorphism. ■

■ **EXAMPLE 6** Let  $R$  be a commutative ring of characteristic 2. Then the mapping  $a \rightarrow a^2$  is a ring homomorphism from  $R$  to  $R$ . ■

■ **EXAMPLE 7** Although  $2\mathbb{Z}$ , the group of even integers under addition, is group-isomorphic to the group  $\mathbb{Z}$  under addition, the ring  $2\mathbb{Z}$  is not ring-isomorphic to the ring  $\mathbb{Z}$ . (Quick! What does  $\mathbb{Z}$  have that  $2\mathbb{Z}$  doesn't?) ■

Our next two examples are applications to number theory of the natural homomorphism given in Example 1.

### ■ EXAMPLE 8 Test for Divisibility by 9

An integer  $n$  with decimal representation  $a_k a_{k-1} \cdots a_0$  is divisible by 9 if and only if  $a_k + a_{k-1} + \cdots + a_0$  is divisible by 9. To verify this, observe that  $n = a_k 10^k + a_{k-1} 10^{k-1} + \cdots + a_0$ . Then, letting  $\alpha$  denote the natural homomorphism from  $\mathbb{Z}$  to  $\mathbb{Z}_9$  [in particular,  $\alpha(10) = 1$ ], we note that  $n$  is divisible by 9 if and only if

$$\begin{aligned} 0 &= \alpha(n) = \alpha(a_k)(\alpha(10))^k + \alpha(a_{k-1})(\alpha(10))^{k-1} + \cdots + \alpha(a_0) \\ &= \alpha(a_k) + \alpha(a_{k-1}) + \cdots + \alpha(a_0) \\ &= \alpha(a_k + a_{k-1} + \cdots + a_0). \end{aligned}$$

But  $\alpha(a_k + a_{k-1} + \cdots + a_0) = 0$  is equivalent to  $a_k + a_{k-1} + \cdots + a_0$  being divisible by 9. ■

The next example illustrates the value of the natural homomorphism given in Example 1.

### ■ EXAMPLE 9 Theorem of Gersonides

In 1844 Eugène Charles Catalan conjectured that  $2^3$  and  $3^2$  is the only instance of two consecutive powers greater than 1 of natural numbers. That is, they are the only solution in the natural numbers of  $x^m - y^n = 1$  where  $m, n, x, y > 1$ . This conjecture was proved in 2002 by Preda Mihăilescu. The special case where  $x$  and  $y$  are restricted to 2 and 3 was first proved by the Rabbi Gersonides in the fourteenth century who proved for  $m, n > 1$  the only case when  $2^m = 3^n \pm 1$  is for  $(m, n) = (3, 2)$ . To verify this is so for  $2^m = 3^n + 1$ , observe that for all  $n$  we have  $3^n \bmod 8 = 3$  or  $1$ . Thus,  $3^n + 1 \bmod 8 = 4$  or  $2$ . On the other hand, for  $m > 2$ , we have  $2^m \bmod 8 = 0$ . To handle the case where  $2^m = 3^n - 1$ , we first note that for all  $n$ ,  $3^n \bmod 16 = 3, 9, 11$ , or  $1$ , depending on the value of  $n \bmod 4$ . Thus,  $(3^n - 1) \bmod 16 = 2, 8, 10$ , or  $0$ . Since  $2^m \bmod 16 = 0$  for  $m \geq 4$ , we have ruled out the cases where  $n \bmod 4 = 1, 2$ , or  $3$ . Because  $3^{4k} \bmod 5 = (3^4)^k \bmod 5 = 1^k \bmod 5 = 1$ , we know that  $(3^{4k} - 1) \bmod 5 = 0$ . But the only values for  $2^m \bmod 5$  are 2, 4, 3, and 1. This contradiction completes the proof. ■

## Properties of Ring Homomorphisms

### ■ Theorem 15.1 Properties of Ring Homomorphisms

*Let  $\phi$  be a ring homomorphism from a ring  $R$  to a ring  $S$ . Let  $A$  be a subring of  $R$  and let  $B$  be an ideal of  $S$ .*

1. *For any  $r \in R$  and any positive integer  $n$ ,  $\phi(nr) = n\phi(r)$  and  $\phi(r^n) = (\phi(r))^n$ .*
2.  *$\phi(A) = \{\phi(a) \mid a \in A\}$  is a subring of  $S$ .*
3. *If  $A$  is an ideal and  $\phi$  is onto  $S$ , then  $\phi(A)$  is an ideal.*
4.  *$\phi^{-1}(B) = \{r \in R \mid \phi(r) \in B\}$  is an ideal of  $R$ .*
5. *If  $R$  is commutative, then  $\phi(R)$  is commutative.*
6. *If  $R$  has a unity  $1$ ,  $S \neq \{0\}$ , and  $\phi$  is onto, then  $\phi(1)$  is the unity of  $S$ .*
7.  *$\phi$  is an isomorphism if and only if  $\phi$  is onto and  $\text{Ker } \phi = \{r \in R \mid \phi(r) = 0\} = \{0\}$ .*
8. *If  $\phi$  is an isomorphism from  $R$  onto  $S$ , then  $\phi^{-1}$  is an isomorphism from  $S$  onto  $R$ .*

**PROOF** The proofs of these properties are similar to those given in Theorems 10.1 and 10.2 and are left as exercises (Exercise 1). ■

The student should learn the various properties of Theorem 15.1 in words in addition to the symbols. Property 2 says that the homomorphic image of a subring is a subring. Property 4 says that the pullback of an ideal is an ideal, and so on.

The next three theorems parallel results we had for groups. The proofs are nearly identical to their group theory counterparts and are left as exercises (Exercises 2, 3, and 4).

### ■ Theorem 15.2 Kernels Are Ideals

*Let  $\phi$  be a ring homomorphism from a ring  $R$  to a ring  $S$ . Then  $\text{Ker } \phi = \{r \in R \mid \phi(r) = 0\}$  is an ideal of  $R$ .*

### ■ Theorem 15.3 First Isomorphism Theorem for Rings

*Let  $\phi$  be a ring homomorphism from  $R$  to  $S$ . Then the mapping from  $R/\text{Ker } \phi$  to  $\phi(R)$ , given by  $r + \text{Ker } \phi \rightarrow \phi(r)$ , is an isomorphism. In symbols,  $R/\text{Ker } \phi \approx \phi(R)$ .*

### ■ Theorem 15.4 Ideals Are Kernels

*Every ideal of a ring  $R$  is the kernel of a ring homomorphism of  $R$ . In particular, an ideal  $A$  is the kernel of the mapping  $r \rightarrow r + A$  from  $R$  to  $R/A$ .*

The homomorphism from  $R$  to  $R/A$  given in Theorem 15.4 is called the *natural homomorphism* from  $R$  to  $R/A$ . Theorem 15.3 is often referred to as the Fundamental Theorem of Ring Homomorphisms.

In Example 17 in Chapter 14 we gave a direct proof that  $\langle x \rangle$  is a prime ideal of  $Z[x]$  but not a maximal ideal. In the following example we illustrate a better way to do this kind of problem.

■ **EXAMPLE 10** Since the mapping  $\phi$  from  $Z[x]$  onto  $Z$  given by  $\phi(f(x)) = f(0)$  is a ring homomorphism with  $\text{Ker } \phi = \langle x \rangle$  (see Exercise 31 in Chapter 14), we have, by Theorem 15.3,  $Z[x]/\langle x \rangle \approx Z$ . And because  $Z$  is an integral domain but not a field, we know by Theorems 14.3 and 14.4 that the ideal  $\langle x \rangle$  is prime but not maximal in  $Z[x]$ . ■

### ■ Theorem 15.5 Homomorphism from $Z$ to a Ring with Unity

*Let  $R$  be a ring with unity 1. The mapping  $\phi: Z \rightarrow R$  given by  $n \rightarrow n \cdot 1$  is a ring homomorphism.*

**PROOF** Since the multiplicative group property  $a^{m+n} = a^m a^n$  translates to  $(m+n)a = ma + na$  when the operation is addition, we have  $\phi(m+n) = (m+n) \cdot 1 = m \cdot 1 + n \cdot 1$ . So,  $\phi$  preserves addition.

That  $\phi$  also preserves multiplication follows from Exercise 15 in Chapter 12, which says that  $(m \cdot a)(n \cdot b) = (mn) \cdot (ab)$  for all integers  $m$  and  $n$ . Thus,  $\phi(mn) = (mn) \cdot 1 = (mn) \cdot ((1)(1)) = (m \cdot 1)(n \cdot 1) = \phi(m)\phi(n)$ . So,  $\phi$  preserves multiplication as well. ■

### ■ Corollary 1 A Ring with Unity Contains $Z_n$ or $Z$

*If  $R$  is a ring with unity and the characteristic of  $R$  is  $n > 0$ , then  $R$  contains a subring isomorphic to  $Z_n$ . If the characteristic of  $R$  is 0, then  $R$  contains a subring isomorphic to  $Z$ .*

**PROOF** Let 1 be the unity of  $R$  and let  $S = \{k \cdot 1 \mid k \in Z\}$ . Theorem 15.5 shows that the mapping  $\phi$  from  $Z$  to  $S$  given by  $\phi(k) = k \cdot 1$  is a homomorphism, and by the First Isomorphism Theorem for rings, we have  $Z/\text{Ker } \phi \approx S$ . But, clearly,  $\text{Ker } \phi = \langle n \rangle$ , where  $n$  is the additive order of 1

and, by Theorem 13.3,  $n$  is also the characteristic of  $R$ . So, when  $R$  has characteristic  $n$ ,  $S \approx \mathbb{Z}/\langle n \rangle \approx \mathbb{Z}_n$ . When  $R$  has characteristic 0,  $S \approx \mathbb{Z}/\langle 0 \rangle \approx \mathbb{Z}$ . ■

### ■ Corollary 2 $\mathbb{Z}_m$ Is a Homomorphic Image of $\mathbb{Z}$

*For any positive integer  $m$ , the mapping of  $\phi: \mathbb{Z} \rightarrow \mathbb{Z}_m$  given by  $x \rightarrow x \bmod m$  is a ring homomorphism.*

**PROOF** This follows directly from the statement of Theorem 15.5, since in the ring  $\mathbb{Z}_m$ , the integer  $x \bmod m$  is  $x \cdot 1$ . (For example, in  $\mathbb{Z}_3$ , if  $x = 5$ , we have  $5 \cdot 1 = 1 + 1 + 1 + 1 + 1 = 2$ .) ■

### ■ Corollary 3 A Field Contains $\mathbb{Z}_p$ or $\mathbb{Q}$ (Steinitz, 1910)

*If  $F$  is a field of characteristic  $p$ , then  $F$  contains a subfield isomorphic to  $\mathbb{Z}_p$ . If  $F$  is a field of characteristic 0, then  $F$  contains a subfield isomorphic to the rational numbers.*

**PROOF** By Corollary 1,  $F$  contains a subring isomorphic to  $\mathbb{Z}_p$  if  $F$  has characteristic  $p$ , and  $F$  has a subring  $S$  isomorphic to  $\mathbb{Z}$  if  $F$  has characteristic 0. In the latter case, let

$$T = \{ab^{-1} \mid a, b \in S, b \neq 0\}.$$

Then  $T$  is isomorphic to the rationals (Exercise 63). ■

Since the intersection of all subfields of a field is itself a subfield (Exercise 11), every field has a smallest subfield (that is, a subfield that is contained in every subfield). This subfield is called the *prime subfield* of the field. It follows from Corollary 3 that the prime subfield of a field of characteristic  $p$  is isomorphic to  $\mathbb{Z}_p$ , whereas the prime subfield of a field of characteristic 0 is isomorphic to  $\mathbb{Q}$ . (See Exercise 67.)

## The Field of Quotients

Although the integral domain  $\mathbb{Z}$  is not a field, it is at least contained in a field—the field of rational numbers. And notice that the field of rational numbers is nothing more than quotients of integers. Can we mimic the construction of the rationals from the integers for other integral domains? Yes. The field constructed in Theorem 15.6 is called the *field of quotients of  $D$* . Throughout the proof of Theorem 15.6, you should keep in mind that we are using the construction of the rationals from the integers as a model for our construction of the field of quotients of  $D$ .



### Theorem 15.6 Field of Quotients

*Let  $D$  be an integral domain. Then there exists a field  $F$  (called the field of quotients of  $D$ ) that contains a subring isomorphic to  $D$ .*

**PROOF** Let  $S = \{(a, b) \mid a, b \in D, b \neq 0\}$ . We define an equivalence relation on  $S$  by  $(a, b) \equiv (c, d)$  if  $ad = bc$ . Now, let  $F$  be the set of equivalence classes of  $S$  under the relation  $\equiv$  and denote the equivalence class that contains  $(x, y)$  by  $x/y$ . We define addition and multiplication on  $F$  by

$$a/b + c/d = (ad + bc)/(bd) \quad \text{and} \quad a/b \cdot c/d = (ac)/(bd).$$

(Notice that here we need the fact that  $D$  is an integral domain to ensure that multiplication is closed; that is,  $bd \neq 0$  whenever  $b \neq 0$  and  $d \neq 0$ .)

Since there are many representations of any particular element of  $F$  (just as in the rationals, we have  $1/2 = 3/6 = 4/8$ ), we must show that these two operations are well-defined. To do this, suppose that  $a/b = a'/b'$  and  $c/d = c'/d'$ , so that  $ab' = a'b$  and  $cd' = c'd$ . It then follows that

$$\begin{aligned} (ad + bc)b'd' &= adb'd' + bcb'd' = (ab')dd' + (cd')bb' \\ &= (a'b)dd' + (c'd)bb' = a'd'bd + b'c'bd \\ &= (a'd' + b'c')bd. \end{aligned}$$

Thus, by definition, we have

$$(ad + bc)/(bd) = (a'd' + b'c')/(b'd'),$$

and, therefore, addition is well-defined. We leave the verification that multiplication is well-defined as an exercise (Exercise 55). That  $F$  is a field is straightforward. Let 1 denote the unity of  $D$ . Then  $0/1$  is the additive identity of  $F$ . The additive inverse of  $a/b$  is  $-a/b$ ; the multiplicative inverse of a nonzero element  $a/b$  is  $b/a$ . The remaining field properties can be checked easily.

Finally, the mapping  $\phi: D \rightarrow F$  given by  $x \rightarrow x/1$  is a ring isomorphism from  $D$  to  $\phi(D)$  (see Exercise 7). ■

■ **EXAMPLE 11** Let  $D = Z[x]$ . Then the field of quotients of  $D$  is  $\{f(x)/g(x) \mid f(x), g(x) \in D, \text{ where } g(x) \text{ is not the zero polynomial}\}$ . ■

When  $F$  is a field, the field of quotients of  $F[x]$  is traditionally denoted by  $F(x)$ .

■ **EXAMPLE 12** Let  $p$  be a prime. Then  $Z_p(x) = \{f(x)/g(x) \mid f(x), g(x) \in Z_p[x], g(x) \neq 0\}$  is an infinite field of characteristic  $p$ . ■

## Exercises

We can work it out.

John Lennon and Paul McCartney,  
"We Can Work It Out," single\*

1. Prove Theorem 15.1.
2. Prove Theorem 15.2.
3. Prove Theorem 15.3.
4. Prove Theorem 15.4.
5. Show that the correspondence  $x \rightarrow 5x$  from  $Z_5$  to  $Z_{10}$  does not pre-serve addition.
6. Show that the correspondence  $x \rightarrow 3x$  from  $Z_4$  to  $Z_{12}$  does not pre-serve multiplication.
7. Show that the mapping  $\phi: D \rightarrow F$  in the proof of Theorem 15.6 is a ring homomorphism.
8. Prove that every ring homomorphism  $\phi$  from  $Z_n$  to itself has the form  $\phi(x) = ax$ , where  $a^2 = a$ .
9. Suppose that  $\phi$  is a ring homomorphism from  $Z_m$  to  $Z_n$ . Prove that if  $\phi(1) = a$ , then  $a^2 = a$ . Give an example to show that the converse is false.
10. a. Is the ring  $2Z$  isomorphic to the ring  $3Z$ ?  
b. Is the ring  $2Z$  isomorphic to the ring  $4Z$ ?
11. Prove that the intersection of any collection of subfields of a field  $F$  is a subfield of  $F$ . (This exercise is referred to in this chapter.)
12. Let  $Z_3[i] = \{a + bi \mid a, b \in Z_3\}$  (see Example 9 in Chapter 13). Show that the field  $Z_3[i]$  is ring-isomorphic to the field  $Z_3[x]/\langle x^2 + 1 \rangle$ .
13. Let

$$S = \left\{ \begin{bmatrix} a & b \\ -b & a \end{bmatrix} \mid a, b \in \mathbf{R} \right\}.$$

Show that  $\phi: \mathbf{C} \rightarrow S$  given by

$$\phi(a + bi) = \begin{bmatrix} a & b \\ -b & a \end{bmatrix}$$

is a ring isomorphism.

14. Let  $Z[\sqrt{2}] = \{a + b\sqrt{2} \mid a, b \in Z\}$  and

$$H = \left\{ \begin{bmatrix} a & 2b \\ b & a \end{bmatrix} \mid a, b \in Z \right\}.$$

Show that  $Z[\sqrt{2}]$  and  $H$  are isomorphic as rings.

15. Consider the mapping from  $M_2(\mathbb{Z})$  into  $\mathbb{Z}$  given by  $\begin{bmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{bmatrix} \rightarrow a$ . Prove or disprove that this is a ring homomorphism.
16. Let  $R = \left\{ \begin{bmatrix} a & b \\ 0 & c \end{bmatrix} \mid a, b, c \in \mathbb{Z} \right\}$ . Prove or disprove that the mapping  $\begin{bmatrix} a & b \\ 0 & c \end{bmatrix} \rightarrow a$  is a ring homomorphism.
17. Is the mapping from  $\mathbb{Z}_5$  to  $\mathbb{Z}_{30}$  given by  $x \rightarrow 6x$  a ring homomorphism? Note that the image of the unity is the unity of the image but not the unity of  $\mathbb{Z}_{30}$ .
18. Is the mapping from  $\mathbb{Z}_{10}$  to  $\mathbb{Z}_{10}$  given by  $x \rightarrow 2x$  a ring homomorphism?
19. Describe the kernel of the homomorphism given in Example 3.
20. Recall that a ring element  $a$  is called an idempotent if  $a^2 = a$ . Prove that a ring homomorphism carries an idempotent to an idempotent.
21. Determine all ring homomorphisms from  $\mathbb{Z}_6$  to  $\mathbb{Z}_6$ . Determine all ring homomorphisms from  $\mathbb{Z}_{20}$  to  $\mathbb{Z}_{30}$ .
22. Determine all ring isomorphisms from  $\mathbb{Z}_n$  to itself.
23. Determine all ring homomorphisms from  $\mathbb{Z}$  to  $\mathbb{Z}$ .
24. Suppose  $\phi$  is a ring homomorphism from  $\mathbb{Z} \oplus \mathbb{Z}$  into  $\mathbb{Z} \oplus \mathbb{Z}$ . What are the possibilities for  $\phi((1, 0))$ ?
25. Determine all ring homomorphisms from  $\mathbb{Z} \oplus \mathbb{Z}$  into  $\mathbb{Z} \oplus \mathbb{Z}$ .
26. In  $\mathbb{Z}$ , let  $A = \langle 2 \rangle$  and  $B = \langle 8 \rangle$ . Show that the group  $A/B$  is isomorphic to the group  $\mathbb{Z}_4$  but that the ring  $A/B$  is not ring-isomorphic to the ring  $\mathbb{Z}_4$ .
27. Let  $R$  be a ring with unity and let  $\phi$  be a ring homomorphism from  $R$  onto  $S$  where  $S$  has more than one element. Prove that  $S$  has a unity.
28. Show that  $(\mathbb{Z} \oplus \mathbb{Z})/(\langle a \rangle \oplus \langle b \rangle)$  is ring-isomorphic to  $\mathbb{Z}_a \oplus \mathbb{Z}_b$ .
29. Determine all ring homomorphisms from  $\mathbb{Z} \oplus \mathbb{Z}$  to  $\mathbb{Z}$ .
30. Prove that the sum of the squares of three consecutive integers cannot be a square.
31. Let  $m$  be a positive integer and let  $n$  be an integer obtained from  $m$  by rearranging the digits of  $m$  in some way. (For example, 72345 is a rearrangement of 35274.) Show that  $m - n$  is divisible by 9.
32. (Test for Divisibility by 11) Let  $n$  be an integer with decimal representation  $a_k a_{k-1} \cdots a_1 a_0$ . Prove that  $n$  is divisible by 11 if and only if  $a_0 - a_1 + a_2 - \cdots + (-1)^k a_k$  is divisible by 11.
33. Show that the number 7,176,825,942,116,027,211 is divisible by 9 but not divisible by 11.

34. If  $m$  and  $n$  are positive integers, prove that the mapping from  $Z_m$  to  $Z_n$  given by  $\phi(x) = x \bmod n$  is a ring homomorphism if and only if  $n$  divides  $m$ .
35. (Test for Divisibility by 3) Let  $n$  be an integer with decimal representation  $a_k a_{k-1} \cdots a_1 a_0$ . Prove that  $n$  is divisible by 3 if and only if  $a_k + a_{k-1} + \cdots + a_1 + a_0$  is divisible by 3.
36. (Test for Divisibility by 4) Let  $n$  be an integer with decimal representation  $a_k a_{k-1} \cdots a_1 a_0$ . Prove that  $n$  is divisible by 4 if and only if  $a_1 a_0$  is divisible by 4.
37. For any integer  $n > 1$ , prove that  $Z_n[x]/\langle x \rangle$  is isomorphic to  $Z_n$ .
38. For any integer  $n > 1$ , prove that  $\langle x \rangle$  is a maximal ideal of  $Z_n[x]$  if and only if  $n$  is prime.
39. Give an example of a ring homomorphism from a commutative ring  $R$  to a ring  $S$  that maps a zero-divisor in  $R$  to the unity of  $S$ .
40. Prove that any automorphism of a field  $F$  is the identity from the prime subfield to itself.
41. In your head, determine  $(2 \cdot 10^{75} + 2)^{100} \bmod 3$  and  $(10^{100} + 1)^{99} \bmod 3$ .
42. Determine all ring homomorphisms from  $Q$  to  $Q$ .
43. Let  $R$  and  $S$  be commutative rings with unity. If  $\phi$  is a homomorphism from  $R$  onto  $S$  and the characteristic of  $R$  is nonzero, prove that the characteristic of  $S$  divides the characteristic of  $R$ .
44. Let  $R$  be a commutative ring of prime characteristic  $p$ . Show that the Frobenius map  $x \rightarrow x^p$  is a ring homomorphism from  $R$  to  $R$ .
45. Is there a ring homomorphism from the reals to some ring whose kernel is the integers?
46. Show that a homomorphism from a field onto a ring with more than one element must be an isomorphism.
47. Suppose that  $R$  and  $S$  are commutative rings with unities. Let  $\phi$  be a ring homomorphism from  $R$  onto  $S$  and let  $A$  be an ideal of  $S$ .
  - a. If  $A$  is prime in  $S$ , show that  $\phi^{-1}(A) = \{x \in R \mid \phi(x) \in A\}$  is prime in  $R$ .
  - b. If  $A$  is maximal in  $S$ , show that  $\phi^{-1}(A)$  is maximal in  $R$ .
48. A *principal ideal ring* is a ring with the property that every ideal has the form  $\langle a \rangle$ . Show that the homomorphic image of a principal ideal ring is a principal ideal ring.
49. Let  $R$  and  $S$  be rings.
  - a. Show that the mapping from  $R \oplus S$  onto  $R$  given by  $(a, b) \rightarrow a$  is a ring homomorphism.
  - b. Show that the mapping from  $R$  to  $R \oplus S$  given by  $a \rightarrow (a, 0)$  is a one-to-one ring homomorphism.
  - c. Show that  $R \oplus S$  is ring-isomorphic to  $S \oplus R$ .

50. Show that if  $m$  and  $n$  are distinct positive integers, then  $m\mathbb{Z}$  is not ring-isomorphic to  $n\mathbb{Z}$ .
51. Prove or disprove that the field of real numbers is ring-isomorphic to the field of complex numbers.
52. Show that the only ring automorphism of the real numbers is the identity mapping.
53. Determine all ring homomorphisms from  $\mathbf{R}$  to  $\mathbf{R}$ .
54. Suppose that  $n$  divides  $m$  and that  $a$  is an idempotent of  $Z_n$  (that is,  $a^2 = a$ ). Show that the mapping  $x \rightarrow ax$  is a ring homomorphism from  $Z_m$  to  $Z_n$ . Show that the same correspondence need not yield a ring homomorphism if  $n$  does not divide  $m$ .
55. Show that the operation of multiplication defined in the proof of Theorem 15.6 is well-defined.
56. Let  $Q[\sqrt{2}] = \{a + b\sqrt{2} \mid a, b \in Q\}$  and  $Q[\sqrt{5}] = \{a + b\sqrt{5} \mid a, b \in Q\}$ . Show that these two rings are not ring-isomorphic.
57. Let  $Z[i] = \{a + bi \mid a, b \in Z\}$ . Show that the field of quotients of  $Z[i]$  is ring-isomorphic to  $Q[i] = \{r + si \mid r, s \in Q\}$ . (This exercise is referred to in Chapter 18.)
58. Let  $F$  be a field. Show that the field of quotients of  $F$  is ring-isomorphic to  $F$ .
59. Let  $D$  be an integral domain and let  $F$  be the field of quotients of  $D$ . Show that if  $E$  is any field that contains  $D$ , then  $E$  contains a subfield that is ring-isomorphic to  $F$ . (Thus, the field of quotients of an integral domain  $D$  is the smallest field containing  $D$ .)
60. Explain why a commutative ring with unity that is not an integral domain cannot be contained in a field. (Compare with Theorem 15.6.)
61. Show that the relation  $\equiv$  defined in the proof of Theorem 15.6 is an equivalence relation.
62. Give an example of a ring without unity that is contained in a field.
63. Prove that the set  $T$  in the proof of Corollary 3 to Theorem 15.5 is ring-isomorphic to the field of rational numbers.
64. Suppose that  $\phi: R \rightarrow S$  is a ring homomorphism and that the image of  $\phi$  is not  $\{0\}$ . If  $R$  has a unity and  $S$  is an integral domain, show that  $\phi$  carries the unity of  $R$  to the unity of  $S$ . Give an example to show that the preceding statement need not be true if  $S$  is not an integral domain.
65. Let  $f(x) \in \mathbf{R}[x]$ . If  $a + bi$  is a complex zero of  $f(x)$  (here  $i = \sqrt{-1}$ ), show that  $a - bi$  is a zero of  $f(x)$ . (This exercise is referred to in Chapter 32.)

66. Let  $R = \left\{ \begin{bmatrix} a & b \\ b & a \end{bmatrix} \mid a, b \in \mathbb{Z} \right\}$ , and let  $\phi$  be the mapping that takes  $\begin{bmatrix} a & b \\ b & a \end{bmatrix}$  to  $a - b$ .
- Show that  $\phi$  is a homomorphism.
  - Determine the kernel of  $\phi$ .
  - Show that  $R/\text{Ker } \phi$  is isomorphic to  $\mathbb{Z}$ .
  - Is  $\text{Ker } \phi$  a prime ideal?
  - Is  $\text{Ker } \phi$  a maximal ideal?
67. Show that the prime subfield of a field of characteristic  $p$  is ring-isomorphic to  $\mathbb{Z}_p$  and that the prime subfield of a field of characteristic 0 is ring-isomorphic to  $\mathbb{Q}$ . (This exercise is referred to in this chapter.)
68. Let  $n$  be a positive integer. Show that there is a ring isomorphism from  $\mathbb{Z}_2$  to a subring of  $\mathbb{Z}_{2n}$  if and only if  $n$  is odd.
69. Show that  $\mathbb{Z}_{mn}$  is ring-isomorphic to  $\mathbb{Z}_m \oplus \mathbb{Z}_n$  when  $m$  and  $n$  are relatively prime.

## Suggested Readings

J. A. Gallian and J. Van Buskirk, "The Number of Homomorphisms from  $\mathbb{Z}_m$  into  $\mathbb{Z}_n$ ," *American Mathematical Monthly* 91 (1984): 196–197.

In this article, formulas are given for the number of group homomorphisms from  $\mathbb{Z}_m$  into  $\mathbb{Z}_n$  and the number of ring homomorphisms from  $\mathbb{Z}_m$  into  $\mathbb{Z}_n$ .

Lillian Kinkade and Joyce Wagner, "When Polynomial Rings Are Principal Ideal Rings," *Journal of Undergraduate Mathematics* 23 (1991): 59–62.

In this article written by undergraduates, it is shown that  $R[x]$  is a principal ideal ring if and only if  $R \approx R_1 \oplus R_2 \oplus \cdots \oplus R_n$ , where each  $R_i$  is a field.

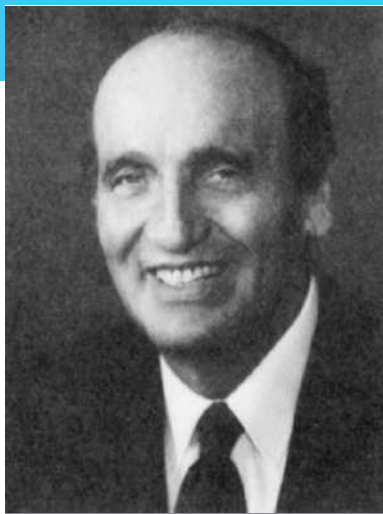
Mohammad Saleh and Hasan Yousef, "The Number of Ring Homomorphisms from  $\mathbb{Z}_{m_1} \oplus \cdots \oplus \mathbb{Z}_{m_r}$  into  $\mathbb{Z}_{k_1} \oplus \cdots \oplus \mathbb{Z}_{k_s}$ ," *American Mathematical Monthly* 105 (1998): 259–260.

This article gives a formula for the number described in the title.

# Irving Kaplansky

He got to the top of the heap  
by being a first-rate doer and  
expositor of algebra.

PAUL R. HALMOS, *I Have a  
Photographic Memory*



Courtesy of the American Mathematical Society ([www.ams.org](http://www.ams.org))

IRVING KAPLANSKY was born on March 22, 1917, in Toronto, Canada, a few years after his parents emigrated from Poland. Although his parents thought he would pursue a career in music, Kaplansky knew early on that mathematics was what he wanted to do. As an undergraduate at the University of Toronto, Kaplansky was a member of the winning team in the first William Lowell Putnam Competition, a mathematical contest for United States and Canadian college students. Kaplansky received a B.A. degree from Toronto in 1938 and an M.A. in 1939. In 1939, he entered Harvard University to earn his doctorate as the first recipient of a Putnam Fellowship. After receiving his Ph.D. from Harvard in 1941, Kaplansky stayed on as Benjamin Peirce Instructor until 1944. After one year at Columbia University, he went to the University of Chicago, where he remained until his retirement in 1984. He then became the director of the Mathematical Sciences Research Institute at the University of California, Berkeley.

Kaplansky's interests were broad, including areas such as ring theory, group theory, field theory, Galois theory, ergodic theory, algebras, metric spaces, number theory, statistics, and probability.

Among the many honors Kaplansky received are election to both the National Academy of Sciences and the American Academy of Arts and Sciences, election to the presidency of the American Mathematical Society, and the 1989 Steele Prize for cumulative influence from the American Mathematical Society. The Steele Prize citation says, in part, "... he has made striking changes in mathematics and has inspired generations of younger mathematicians." Kaplansky died on June 25, 2006, at the age of 89.

For more information about Kaplansky, visit:

[http://www-groups.dcs  
.st-and.ac.uk/~history/](http://www-groups.dcs.st-and.ac.uk/~history/)

# 16 Polynomial Rings

We lay down a fundamental principle of generalization by abstraction: The existence of analogies between central features of various theories implies the existence of a general theory which underlies the particular theories and unifies them with respect to those central features....

E. H. Moore, (1862–1932)

Wit lies in recognizing the resemblance among things which differ and the difference between things which are alike.

Madame De Staël

## Notation and Terminology

One of the mathematical concepts that students are most familiar with and most comfortable with is that of a polynomial. In high school, students study polynomials with integer coefficients, rational coefficients, real coefficients, and perhaps even complex coefficients. In earlier chapters of this book, we introduced something that was probably new—polynomials with coefficients from  $Z_n$ . Notice that all of these sets of polynomials are rings, and, in each case, the set of coefficients is also a ring. In this chapter, we abstract all of these examples into one.

### Definition Ring of Polynomials over $R$

Let  $R$  be a commutative ring. The set of formal symbols

$$R[x] = \{a_n x^n + a_{n-1} x^{n-1} + \cdots + a_1 x + a_0 \mid a_i \in R, \\ n \text{ is a nonnegative integer}\}$$

is called the *ring of polynomials over  $R$  in the indeterminate  $x$* .

Two elements

$$a_n x^n + a_{n-1} x^{n-1} + \cdots + a_1 x + a_0$$

and

$$b_m x^m + b_{m-1} x^{m-1} + \cdots + b_1 x + b_0$$

of  $R[x]$  are considered equal if and only if  $a_i = b_i$  for all nonnegative integers  $i$ . (Define  $a_i = 0$  when  $i > n$  and  $b_i = 0$  when  $i > m$ .)



In this definition, the symbols  $x, x^2, \dots, x^n$  do not represent “unknown” elements or variables from the ring  $R$ . Rather, their purpose is to serve as convenient placeholders that separate the ring elements  $a_n, a_{n-1}, \dots, a_0$ . We could have avoided the  $x$ ’s by defining a polynomial as an infinite sequence  $a_0, a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n, 0, 0, 0, \dots$ , but our method takes advantage of the student’s experience in manipulating polynomials where  $x$  does represent a variable. The disadvantage of our method is that one must be careful not to confuse a polynomial with the function determined by a polynomial. For example, in  $Z_3[x]$ , the polynomials  $f(x) = x$  and  $g(x) = x^3$  determine the same function from  $Z_3$  to  $Z_3$ , since  $f(a) = g(a)$  for all  $a$  in  $Z_3$ .<sup>†</sup> But  $f(x)$  and  $g(x)$  are different elements of  $Z_3[x]$ . Also, in the ring  $Z_n[x]$ , be careful to reduce only the coefficients and not the exponents modulo  $n$ . For example, in  $Z_3[x]$ ,  $5x = 2x$ , but  $x^5 \neq x^2$ .

To make  $R[x]$  into a ring, we define addition and multiplication in the usual way.

### Definition Addition and Multiplication in $R[x]$

Let  $R$  be a commutative ring and let

$$f(x) = a_n x^n + a_{n-1} x^{n-1} + \dots + a_1 x + a_0$$

and

$$g(x) = b_m x^m + b_{m-1} x^{m-1} + \dots + b_1 x + b_0$$

belong to  $R[x]$ . Then

$$\begin{aligned} f(x) + g(x) &= (a_s + b_s)x^s + (a_{s-1} + b_{s-1})x^{s-1} \\ &\quad + \dots + (a_1 + b_1)x + a_0 + b_0, \end{aligned}$$

where  $s$  is the maximum of  $m$  and  $n$ ,  $a_i = 0$  for  $i > n$ , and  $b_i = 0$  for  $i > m$ . Also,

$$f(x)g(x) = c_{m+n}x^{m+n} + c_{m+n-1}x^{m+n-1} + \dots + c_1x + c_0,$$

where

$$c_k = a_k b_0 + a_{k-1} b_1 + \dots + a_1 b_{k-1} + a_0 b_k$$

for  $k = 0, \dots, m+n$ .

Although the definition of multiplication might appear complicated, it is just a formalization of the familiar process of using the distributive property and collecting like terms. So, just multiply polynomials over a

<sup>†</sup>In general, given  $f(x)$  in  $R[x]$  and  $a$  in  $R$ ,  $f(a)$  means substitute  $a$  for  $x$  in the formula for  $f(x)$ . This substitution is a homomorphism from  $R[x]$  to  $R$ .

commutative ring  $R$  in the same way that polynomials are always multiplied. Here is an example.

Consider  $f(x) = 2x^3 + x^2 + 2x + 2$  and  $g(x) = 2x^2 + 2x + 1$  in  $Z_3[x]$ . Then, in our preceding notation,  $a_5 = 0, a_4 = 0, a_3 = 2, a_2 = 1, a_1 = 2, a_0 = 2$ , and  $b_5 = 0, b_4 = 0, b_3 = 0, b_2 = 2, b_1 = 2, b_0 = 1$ . Now, using the definitions and remembering that addition and multiplication of the coefficients are done modulo 3, we have

$$\begin{aligned} f(x) + g(x) &= (2 + 0)x^3 + (1 + 2)x^2 + (2 + 2)x + (2 + 1) \\ &= 2x^3 + 0x^2 + 1x + 0 \\ &= 2x^3 + x \end{aligned}$$

and

$$\begin{aligned} f(x) \cdot g(x) &= (0 \cdot 1 + 0 \cdot 2 + 2 \cdot 2 + 1 \cdot 0 + 2 \cdot 0 + 2 \cdot 0)x^5 \\ &\quad + (0 \cdot 1 + 2 \cdot 2 + 1 \cdot 2 + 2 \cdot 0 + 2 \cdot 0)x^4 \\ &\quad + (2 \cdot 1 + 1 \cdot 2 + 2 \cdot 2 + 2 \cdot 0)x^3 \\ &\quad + (1 \cdot 1 + 2 \cdot 2 + 2 \cdot 2)x^2 + (2 \cdot 1 + 2 \cdot 2)x + 2 \cdot 1 \\ &= x^5 + 0x^4 + 2x^3 + 0x^2 + 0x + 2 \\ &= x^5 + 2x^3 + 2. \end{aligned}$$

Our definitions for addition and multiplication of polynomials were formulated so that they are commutative and associative, and so that multiplication is distributive over addition. We leave the verification that  $R[x]$  is a ring to the reader.

It is time to introduce some terminology for polynomials. If

$$f(x) = a_n x^n + a_{n-1} x^{n-1} + \cdots + a_1 x + a_0,$$

where  $a_n \neq 0$ , we say that  $f(x)$  has *degree  $n$* ; the term  $a_n$  is called the *leading coefficient* of  $f(x)$ , and if the leading coefficient is the multiplicative identity element of  $R$ , we say that  $f(x)$  is a *monic polynomial*. The polynomial  $f(x) = 0$  has no degree. Polynomials of the form  $f(x) = a_0$  are called *constant*. We often write  $\deg f(x) = n$  to indicate that  $f(x)$  has degree  $n$ . As with polynomials with real coefficients, we may insert or delete terms of the form  $0x^k$ ;  $1x^k$  is the same as  $x^k$ ; and  $+(-a_k)x^k$  is the same as  $-a_k x^k$ .

Very often properties of  $R$  carry over to  $R[x]$ . Our first theorem is a case in point.

### ■ Theorem 16.1 $D$ an Integral Domain Implies $D[x]$ an Integral Domain

*If  $D$  is an integral domain, then  $D[x]$  is an integral domain.*

**PROOF** Since we already know that  $D[x]$  is a ring, all we need to show is that  $D[x]$  is commutative with a unity and has no zero-divisors. Clearly,  $D[x]$  is commutative whenever  $D$  is. If 1 is the unity element of  $D$ , it is obvious that  $f(x) = 1$  is the unity element of  $D[x]$ . Finally, suppose that

$$f(x) = a_n x^n + a_{n-1} x^{n-1} + \cdots + a_0$$

and

$$g(x) = b_m x^m + b_{m-1} x^{m-1} + \cdots + b_0,$$

where  $a_n \neq 0$  and  $b_m \neq 0$ . Then, by definition,  $f(x)g(x)$  has leading coefficient  $a_n b_m$  and, since  $D$  is an integral domain,  $a_n b_m \neq 0$ . ■

## The Division Algorithm and Consequences

One of the properties of integers that we have used repeatedly is the division algorithm: If  $a$  and  $b$  are integers and  $b \neq 0$ , then there exist unique integers  $q$  and  $r$  such that  $a = bq + r$ , where  $0 \leq r < |b|$ . The next theorem is the analogous statement for polynomials over a field.

### ■ Theorem 16.2 Division Algorithm for $F[x]$

*Let  $F$  be a field and let  $f(x), g(x) \in F[x]$  with  $g(x) \neq 0$ . Then there exist unique polynomials  $q(x)$  and  $r(x)$  in  $F[x]$  such that  $f(x) = g(x)q(x) + r(x)$  and either  $r(x) = 0$  or  $\deg r(x) < \deg g(x)$ .*

**PROOF** We begin by showing the existence of  $q(x)$  and  $r(x)$ . If  $f(x) = 0$  or  $\deg f(x) < \deg g(x)$ , we simply set  $q(x) = 0$  and  $r(x) = f(x)$ . So, we may assume that  $n = \deg f(x) \geq \deg g(x) = m$  and let  $f(x) = a_n x^n + \cdots + a_0$  and  $g(x) = b_m x^m + \cdots + b_0$ . The idea behind this proof is to begin just as if you were going to “long divide”  $g(x)$  into  $f(x)$ , then use the Second Principle of Mathematical Induction on  $\deg f(x)$  to finish up. Thus, resorting to long division, we let  $f_1(x) = f(x) - a_n b_m^{-1} x^{n-m} g(x)$ .<sup>†</sup> Then,  $f_1(x) = 0$  or  $\deg f_1(x) < \deg f(x)$ ; so, by our induction hypothesis, there exist  $q_1(x)$  and  $r_1(x)$  in  $F[x]$  such that  $f_1(x) = g(x)q_1(x) + r_1(x)$ , where  $r_1(x) = 0$  or  $\deg r_1(x) < \deg g(x)$ .

[Technically, we should get the induction started by proving the case in which  $\deg f(x) = 0$ , but this is trivial.] Thus,

$$\begin{aligned} f(x) &= a_n b_m^{-1} x^{n-m} g(x) + f_1(x) \\ &= a_n b_m^{-1} x^{n-m} g(x) + q_1(x) g(x) + r_1(x) \\ &= [a_n b_m^{-1} x^{n-m} + q_1(x)] g(x) + r_1(x). \end{aligned}$$

So, the polynomials  $q(x) = a_n b_m^{-1} x^{n-m} + q_1(x)$  and  $r(x) = r_1(x)$  have the desired properties.

To prove uniqueness, suppose that  $f(x) = g(x)q(x) + r(x)$  and  $f(x) = g(x)\bar{q}(x) + \bar{r}(x)$ , where  $r(x) = 0$  or  $\deg r(x) < \deg g(x)$  and  $\bar{r}(x) = 0$  or  $\deg \bar{r}(x) < \deg g(x)$ . Then, subtracting these two equations, we obtain

$$0 = g(x)[q(x) - \bar{q}(x)] + [r(x) - \bar{r}(x)]$$

or

$$\bar{r}(x) - r(x) = g(x)[q(x) - \bar{q}(x)].$$

Thus,  $\bar{r}(x) - r(x)$  is 0, or the degree of  $\bar{r}(x) - r(x)$  is at least that of  $g(x)$ . Since the latter is clearly impossible, we have  $\bar{r}(x) = r(x)$  and  $q(x) = \bar{q}(x)$  as well. ■

The polynomials  $q(x)$  and  $r(x)$  in the division algorithm are called the *quotient* and *remainder* in the division of  $f(x)$  by  $g(x)$ . When the ring of coefficients of a polynomial ring is a field, we can use the long division process to determine the quotient and remainder.

<sup>†</sup>For example,

$$\begin{array}{r} (3/2)x^2 \\ 2x^2 + 2 \overline{) 3x^4 \phantom{+ 3x^3 + 3x^2 + 3x + 1}} \\ \underline{3x^4 + 3x^2} \phantom{+ 3x + 1} \\ -3x^2 + x + 1 \end{array}$$

So,

$$-3x^2 + x + 1 = 3x^4 + x + 1 - (3/2)x^2(2x^2 + 2)$$

In general,

$$\begin{array}{r} a_n b_m^{-1} x^{n-m} \\ b_m x^m + \cdots \overline{) a_n x^n + \cdots} \\ \underline{a_n x^n + \cdots} \\ f_1(x) \end{array}$$

So,

$$f_1(x) = (a_n x^n + \cdots) - a_n b_m^{-1} x^{n-m} (b_m x^m + \cdots)$$

■ **EXAMPLE 1** To find the quotient and remainder upon dividing  $f(x) = 3x^4 + x^3 + 2x^2 + 1$  by  $g(x) = x^2 + 4x + 2$ , where  $f(x)$  and  $g(x)$  belong to  $Z_5[x]$ , we may proceed by long division, provided we keep in mind that addition and multiplication are done modulo 5. Thus,

$$\begin{array}{r}
 3x^2 + 4x \\
 x^2 + 4x + 2 \overline{) 3x^4 + x^3 + 2x^2 + 1} \\
 \underline{3x^4 + 2x^3 + x^2} \phantom{+ 1} \\
 4x^3 + x^2 + 1 \\
 \underline{4x^3 + x^2 + 3x} \\
 2x + 1
 \end{array}$$

So,  $3x^2 + 4x$  is the quotient and  $2x + 1$  is the remainder. Therefore,

$$3x^4 + x^3 + 2x^2 + 1 = (x^2 + 4x + 2)(3x^2 + 4x) + 2x + 1. \quad \blacksquare$$

Let  $D$  be an integral domain. If  $f(x)$  and  $g(x) \in D[x]$ , we say that  $g(x)$  *divides*  $f(x)$  in  $D[x]$  [and write  $g(x) \mid f(x)$ ] if there exists an  $h(x) \in D[x]$  such that  $f(x) = g(x)h(x)$ . In this case, we also call  $g(x)$  a *factor* of  $f(x)$ . An element  $a$  is a *zero* (or a *root*) of a polynomial  $f(x)$  if  $f(a) = 0$ . [Recall that  $f(a)$  means substitute  $a$  for  $x$  in the expression for  $f(x)$ .] When  $F$  is a field,  $a \in F$ , and  $f(x) \in F[x]$ , we say that  $a$  is a *zero of multiplicity*  $k$  ( $k \geq 1$ ) if  $(x - a)^k$  is a factor of  $f(x)$  but  $(x - a)^{k+1}$  is not a factor of  $f(x)$ . With these definitions, we may now give several important corollaries of the division algorithm. No doubt you have seen these for the special case where  $F$  is the field of real numbers.

### ■ Corollary 1 Remainder Theorem

*Let  $F$  be a field,  $a \in F$ , and  $f(x) \in F[x]$ . Then  $f(a)$  is the remainder in the division of  $f(x)$  by  $x - a$ .*

**PROOF** The proof of Corollary 1 is left as an exercise (Exercise 5). ■

### ■ Corollary 2 Factor Theorem

*Let  $F$  be a field,  $a \in F$ , and  $f(x) \in F[x]$ . Then  $a$  is a zero of  $f(x)$  if and only if  $x - a$  is a factor of  $f(x)$ .*

**PROOF** The proof of Corollary 2 is left as an exercise (Exercise 13). ■

### ■ Theorem 16.3 Polynomials of Degree $n$ Have at Most $n$ Zeros

*A polynomial of degree  $n$  over a field has at most  $n$  zeros, counting multiplicity.*

**PROOF** We proceed by induction on  $n$ . Clearly, a polynomial of degree 0 over a field has no zeros. Now suppose that  $f(x)$  is a polynomial of degree  $n$  over a field and  $a$  is a zero of  $f(x)$  of multiplicity  $k$ . Then,  $f(x) = (x - a)^k q(x)$  and  $q(a) \neq 0$ ; and, since  $n = \deg f(x) = \deg (x - a)^k q(x) = k + \deg q(x)$ , we have  $k \leq n$  (see Exercise 19). If  $f(x)$  has no zeros other than  $a$ , we are done. On the other hand, if  $b \neq a$  and  $b$  is a zero of  $f(x)$ , then  $0 = f(b) = (b - a)^k q(b)$ , so that  $b$  is also a zero of  $q(x)$  with the same multiplicity as it has for  $f(x)$  (see Exercise 21). By the Second Principle of Mathematical Induction, we know that  $q(x)$  has at most  $\deg q(x) = n - k$  zeros, counting multiplicity. Thus,  $f(x)$  has at most  $k + n - k = n$  zeros, counting multiplicity. ■

We remark that Theorem 16.4 is not true for arbitrary polynomial rings. For example, the polynomial  $x^2 + 7$  has 1, 3, 5 and 7 as zeros over  $\mathbb{Z}_8$ . Lagrange was the first to prove Theorem 16.4 for polynomials in  $\mathbb{Z}_p[x]$ .

#### ■ EXAMPLE 2 THE COMPLEX ZEROS OF $x^n - 1$

We find all complex zeros of  $x^n - 1$ . Let  $\omega = \cos(360^\circ/n) + i \sin(360^\circ/n)$ . It follows from DeMoivre's Theorem (see Example 12 in Chapter 0) that  $\omega^n = 1$  and  $\omega^k \neq 1$  for  $1 \leq k < n$ . Thus, each of 1,  $\omega, \omega^2, \dots, \omega^{n-1}$  is a zero of  $x^n - 1$  and, by Theorem 16.4, there are no others. ■

The complex number  $\omega$  in Example 2 is called a *primitive  $n$ th root of unity*.

We conclude this chapter with an important theoretical application of the division algorithm, but first an important definition.

#### **Definition** Principal Ideal Domain (PID)

A *principal ideal domain* is an integral domain  $R$  in which every ideal has the form  $\langle a \rangle = \{ra \mid r \in R\}$  for some  $a$  in  $R$ .

### ■ Theorem 16.4 $F[x]$ Is a PID

*Let  $F$  be a field. Then  $F[x]$  is a principal ideal domain.*

**PROOF** By Theorem 16.1, we know that  $F[x]$  is an integral domain. Now, let  $I$  be an ideal in  $F[x]$ . If  $I = \{0\}$ , then  $I = \langle 0 \rangle$ . If  $I \neq \{0\}$ , then among all the elements of  $I$ , let  $g(x)$  be one of minimum degree. We will show that  $I = \langle g(x) \rangle$ . Since  $g(x) \in I$ , we have  $\langle g(x) \rangle \subseteq I$ . Now let  $f(x) \in I$ . Then, by the division algorithm, we may write  $f(x) = g(x)q(x) + r(x)$ , where  $r(x) = 0$  or  $\deg r(x) < \deg g(x)$ . Since  $r(x) = f(x) - g(x)q(x) \in I$ , the minimality of  $\deg g(x)$  implies that the latter condition cannot hold. So,  $r(x) = 0$  and, therefore,  $f(x) \in \langle g(x) \rangle$ . This shows that  $I \subseteq \langle g(x) \rangle$ . ■

The proof of Theorem 16.3 also establishes the following.

■ **Theorem 16.5** Criterion for  $I = \langle g(x) \rangle$

*Let  $F$  be a field,  $I$  a nonzero ideal in  $F[x]$ , and  $g(x)$  an element of  $F[x]$ . Then,  $I = \langle g(x) \rangle$  if and only if  $g(x)$  is a nonzero polynomial of minimum degree in  $I$ .*

As an application of the First Isomorphism Theorem for Rings (Theorem 15.3) and Theorem 16.5, we verify the remark we made in Example 12 in Chapter 14 that the ring  $\mathbf{R}[x]/\langle x^2 + 1 \rangle$  is isomorphic to the ring of complex numbers.

■ **EXAMPLE 3** Consider the homomorphism  $\phi$  from  $\mathbf{R}[x]$  onto  $\mathbf{C}$  given by  $f(x) \rightarrow f(i)$  (that is, evaluate a polynomial in  $\mathbf{R}[x]$  at  $i$ ). Then  $x^2 + 1 \in \text{Ker } \phi$  and is clearly a polynomial of minimum degree in  $\text{Ker } \phi$ . Thus,  $\text{Ker } \phi = \langle x^2 + 1 \rangle$  and  $\mathbf{R}[x]/\langle x^2 + 1 \rangle$  is isomorphic to  $\mathbf{C}$ . ■

## Exercises

If I feel unhappy, I do mathematics to become happy. If I am happy, I do mathematics to keep happy.

Paul Turán

1. Let  $f(x) = 4x^3 + 2x^2 + x + 3$  and  $g(x) = 3x^4 + 3x^3 + 3x^2 + x + 4$ , where  $f(x), g(x) \in \mathbf{Z}_5[x]$ . Compute  $f(x) + g(x)$  and  $f(x) \cdot g(x)$ .
2. In  $\mathbf{Z}_3[x]$ , show that the distinct polynomials  $x^4 + x$  and  $x^2 + x$  determine the same function from  $\mathbf{Z}_3$  to  $\mathbf{Z}_3$ .
3. Show that  $x^2 + 3x + 2$  has four zeros in  $\mathbf{Z}_6$ .
4. If  $R$  is a commutative ring, show that the characteristic of  $R[x]$  is the same as the characteristic of  $R$ .

5. Prove Corollary 1 of Theorem 16.2.
6. List all the polynomials of degree 2 in  $Z_2[x]$ . Which of these are equal as functions from  $Z_2$  to  $Z_2$ ?
7. Find two distinct cubic polynomials over  $Z_2$  that determine the same function from  $Z_2$  to  $Z_2$ .
8. For any positive integer  $n$ , how many polynomials are there of degree  $n$  over  $Z_2$ ? How many distinct polynomial functions from  $Z_2$  to  $Z_2$  are there?
9. Let  $f(x) = 5x^4 + 3x^3 + 1$  and  $g(x) = 3x^2 + 2x + 1$  in  $Z_7[x]$ . Determine the quotient and remainder upon dividing  $f(x)$  by  $g(x)$ .
10. Let  $R$  be a commutative ring. Show that  $R[x]$  has a subring isomorphic to  $R$ .
11. If  $\phi: R \rightarrow S$  is a ring homomorphism, define  $\bar{\phi}: R[x] \rightarrow S[x]$  by  $(a_n x^n + \cdots + a_0) \rightarrow \phi(a_n)x^n + \cdots + \phi(a_0)$ . Show that  $\bar{\phi}$  is a ring homomorphism. (This exercise is referred to in Chapter 33.)
12. If the rings  $R$  and  $S$  are isomorphic, show that  $R[x]$  and  $S[x]$  are isomorphic. (The converse is not true—see [1].)
13. Prove Corollary 2 of Theorem 16.2.
14. Let  $f(x)$  and  $g(x)$  be cubic polynomials with integer coefficients such that  $f(a) = g(a)$  for four integer values of  $a$ . Prove that  $f(x) = g(x)$ . Generalize.
15. Show that the polynomial  $2x + 1$  in  $Z_4[x]$  has a multiplicative inverse in  $Z_4[x]$ .
16. Are there any nonconstant polynomials in  $Z[x]$  that have multiplicative inverses? Explain your answer.
17. Let  $p$  be a prime. Are there any nonconstant polynomials in  $Z_p[x]$  that have multiplicative inverses? Explain your answer.
18. Show that Theorem 16.4 is false for any commutative ring that has a zero divisor.
19. (Degree Rule) Let  $D$  be an integral domain and  $f(x), g(x) \in D[x]$ . Prove that  $\deg(f(x) \cdot g(x)) = \deg f(x) + \deg g(x)$ . Show, by example, that for commutative ring  $R$  it is possible that  $\deg f(x)g(x) < \deg f(x) + \deg g(x)$ , where  $f(x)$  and  $g(x)$  are nonzero elements in  $R[x]$ . (This exercise is referred to in this chapter, Chapter 17, and Chapter 18.)
20. Prove that the ideal  $\langle x \rangle$  in  $Q[x]$  is maximal.
21. Let  $f(x)$  belong to  $F[x]$ , where  $F$  is a field. Let  $a$  be a zero of  $f(x)$  of multiplicity  $n$ , and write  $f(x) = (x - a)^n q(x)$ . If  $b \neq a$  is a zero of  $q(x)$ , show that  $b$  has the same multiplicity as a zero of  $q(x)$  as it does for  $f(x)$ . (This exercise is referred to in this chapter.)



22. Prove that for any positive integer  $n$ , a field  $F$  can have at most a finite number of elements of multiplicative order at most  $n$ .
23. Let  $F$  be a field, and let  $f(x)$  and  $g(x)$  belong to  $F[x]$ . If there is no polynomial of positive degree in  $F[x]$  that divides both  $f(x)$  and  $g(x)$  [in this case,  $f(x)$  and  $g(x)$  are said to be *relatively prime*], prove that there exist polynomials  $h(x)$  and  $k(x)$  in  $F[x]$  with the property that  $f(x)h(x) + g(x)k(x) = 1$ . (This exercise is referred to in Chapter 20.)
24. Let  $F$  be an infinite field and let  $f(x), g(x) \in F[x]$ . If  $f(a) = g(a)$  for infinitely many elements  $a$  of  $F$ , show that  $f(x) = g(x)$ .
25. Let  $F$  be a field and let  $p(x) \in F[x]$ . If  $f(x), g(x) \in F[x]$  and  $\deg f(x) < \deg p(x)$  and  $\deg g(x) < \deg p(x)$ , show that  $f(x) + \langle p(x) \rangle = g(x) + \langle p(x) \rangle$  implies  $f(x) = g(x)$ . (This exercise is referred to in Chapter 20.)
26. Prove that  $Z[x]$  is not a principal ideal domain. (Compare this with Theorem 16.3.)
27. Find a polynomial with integer coefficients that has  $1/2$  and  $-1/3$  as zeros.
28. Let  $f(x) \in \mathbf{R}[x]$ . Suppose that  $f(a) = 0$  but  $f'(a) \neq 0$ , where  $f'(x)$  is the derivative of  $f(x)$ . Show that  $a$  is a zero of  $f(x)$  of multiplicity 1.
29. Show that Corollary 2 of Theorem 16.2 is true over any commutative ring with unity.
30. Show that Theorem 16.4 is true for polynomials over integral domains.
31. Let  $F$  be a field and let

$$I = \{a_n x^n + a_{n-1} x^{n-1} + \cdots + a_0 \mid a_n, a_{n-1}, \dots, a_0 \in F \text{ and } a_n + a_{n-1} + \cdots + a_0 = 0\}.$$

Show that  $I$  is an ideal of  $F[x]$  and find a generator for  $I$ .

32. Let  $F$  be a field and let  $f(x) = a_n x^n + a_{n-1} x^{n-1} + \cdots + a_0 \in F[x]$ . Prove that  $x - 1$  is a factor of  $f(x)$  if and only if  $a_n + a_{n-1} + \cdots + a_0 = 0$ .
  33. Let  $m$  be a fixed positive integer. For any integer  $a$ , let  $\bar{a}$  denote  $a \bmod m$ . Show that the mapping of  $\phi: Z[x] \rightarrow Z_m[x]$  given by
- $$\phi(a_n x^n + a_{n-1} x^{n-1} + \cdots + a_0) = \bar{a}_n x^n + \bar{a}_{n-1} x^{n-1} + \cdots + \bar{a}_0$$
- is a ring homomorphism. (This exercise is referred to in Chapters 17 and 33.)
34. Find infinitely many polynomials  $f(x)$  in  $Z_3[x]$  such that  $f(a) = 0$  for all  $a$  in  $Z_3$ .

35. For every prime  $p$ , show that

$$x^{p-1} - 1 = (x - 1)(x - 2) \cdots [x - (p - 1)]$$

in  $Z_p[x]$ .

36. Let  $\phi$  be the ring homomorphism from  $Z[x]$  to  $Z$  given by  $\phi(f(x)) = f(1)$ . Find a polynomial  $g(x)$  in  $Z[x]$  such that  $\text{Ker } \phi = \langle g(x) \rangle$ . Is there more than one possibility for  $g(x)$ ? To what familiar ring is  $Z[x]/\text{Ker } \phi$  isomorphic? Do this exercise with  $Z$  replaced by  $Q$ .
37. Give an example of a field that properly contains the field of complex numbers  $C$ .
38. (Wilson's Theorem) For every integer  $n > 1$ , prove that  $(n - 1)! \bmod n = n - 1$  if and only if  $n$  is prime.
39. For every prime  $p$ , show that  $(p - 2)! \bmod p = 1$ .
40. Find the remainder upon dividing  $98!$  by  $101$ .
41. Prove that  $(50!)^2 \bmod 101 = -1 \bmod 101$ .
42. If  $I$  is an ideal of a ring  $R$ , prove that  $I[x]$  is an ideal of  $R[x]$ .
43. Give an example of a commutative ring  $R$  with unity and a maximal ideal  $I$  of  $R$  such that  $I[x]$  is not a maximal ideal of  $R[x]$ .
44. Let  $R$  be a commutative ring with unity. If  $I$  is a prime ideal of  $R$ , prove that  $I[x]$  is a prime ideal of  $R[x]$ .
45. Let  $F$  be an infinite field and let  $f(x) \in F[x]$ . If  $f(a) = 0$  for infinitely many elements  $a$  of  $F$ , show that  $f(x) = 0$ .
46. Prove that  $Q[x]/\langle x^2 - 2 \rangle$  is ring-isomorphic to  $Q[\sqrt{2}] = \{a + b\sqrt{2} \mid a, b \in Q\}$ .
47. Let  $f(x) \in R[x]$ . If  $f(a) = 0$  and  $f'(a) = 0$  [ $f'(a)$  is the derivative of  $f(x)$  at  $a$ ], show that  $(x - a)^2$  divides  $f(x)$ .
48. Let  $F$  be a field and let  $I = \{f(x) \in F[x] \mid f(a) = 0 \text{ for all } a \text{ in } F\}$ . Prove that  $I$  is an ideal in  $F[x]$ . Prove that  $I$  is infinite when  $F$  is finite and  $I = \{0\}$  when  $F$  is infinite. When  $F$  is finite, find a monic polynomial  $g(x)$  such that  $I = \langle g(x) \rangle$ .
49. Let  $g(x)$  and  $h(x)$  belong to  $Z[x]$  and let  $h(x)$  be monic. If  $h(x)$  divides  $g(x)$  in  $Q[x]$ , show that  $h(x)$  divides  $g(x)$  in  $Z[x]$ . (This exercise is referred to in Chapter 33.)
50. Let  $R$  be a ring and  $x$  be an indeterminate. Prove that the rings  $R[x]$  and  $R[x^2]$  are ring-isomorphic.
51. Let  $f(x)$  be a nonconstant element of  $Z[x]$ . Prove that  $f(x)$  takes on infinitely many values in  $Z$ .
52. Let  $f(x)$  be a nonconstant element in  $Z[x]$ . Prove that  $\langle f(x) \rangle$  is not maximal in  $Z[x]$ .

53. Suppose that  $F$  is a field and there is a ring homomorphism from  $Z$  onto  $F$ . Show that  $F$  is isomorphic to  $Z_p$  for some prime  $p$ .
54. Let  $f(x)$  belong to  $Z_p[x]$ . Prove that if  $f(b) = 0$ , then  $f(b^p) = 0$ .
55. Suppose  $f(x)$  is a polynomial with odd integer coefficients and even degree. Prove that  $f(x)$  has no rational zeros.
56. Find the remainder when  $x^{51}$  is divided by  $x + 4$  in  $Z_7[x]$ .
57. Let  $F$  be a field. Show that there exist  $a, b \in F$  with the property that  $x^2 + x + 1$  divides  $x^{43} + ax + b$ .
58. Let  $f(x) = a_mx^m + a_{m-1}x^{m-1} + \cdots + a_0$  and  $g(x) = b_nx^n + b_{n-1}x^{n-1} + \cdots + b_0$  belong to  $Q[x]$  and suppose that  $f(x)g(x)$  belongs to  $Z[x]$ . Prove that  $a_ib_j$  is an integer for every  $i$  and  $j$ .
59. Let  $f(x)$  belong to  $Z[x]$ . If  $a \bmod m = b \bmod m$ , prove that  $f(a) \bmod m = f(b) \bmod m$ . Prove that if both  $f(0)$  and  $f(1)$  are odd, then  $f$  has no zero in  $Z$ .
60. For any field  $F$ , recall that  $F(x)$  denotes the field of quotients of the ring  $F[x]$ . Prove that there is no element in  $F(x)$  whose square is  $x$ .
61. Show that 1 is the only solution of  $x^{25} - 1 = 0$  in  $Z_{37}$ .

## Suggested Reading

M. Hochster, "Nonuniqueness of Coefficient Rings in a Polynomial Ring," *Proceedings of American Mathematical Society*, 34 (1972): 81–82.

The author gives an example of non-isomorphic commutative rings  $R$  and  $S$  with property that the ring  $R[x]$  and  $S[x]$  are isomorphic.

## Saunders Mac Lane

The 1986 Steele Prize for cumulative influence is awarded to Saunders Mac Lane for his many contributions to algebra and algebraic topology, and in particular for his pioneering work in homological and categorical algebra.

*Citation for the Steele Prize*



Courtesy Usa Mac Lane

SAUNDERS MAC LANE ranks among the most influential mathematicians in the 20th century. He was born on August 4, 1909, in Norwich, Connecticut. In 1933, at the height of the Depression, he was newly married; despite having degrees from Yale, the University of Chicago, and the University of Göttingen, he had no prospects for a position at a college or university. After applying for employment as a master at a private preparatory school for boys, Mac Lane received a two-year instructorship at Harvard in 1934. He then spent a year at Cornell and a year at the University of Chicago before returning to Harvard in 1938. In 1947, he went back to Chicago permanently.

Much of Mac Lane's work focuses on the interconnections among algebra, topology,

and geometry. His book *Survey of Modern Algebra*, coauthored with Garrett Birkhoff, influenced generations of mathematicians and is now a classic. Mac Lane served as president of the Mathematical Association of America and the American Mathematical Society. He was elected to the National Academy of Sciences, received the National Medal of Science and the American Mathematical Society's Steele Prize for Lifetime Achievement, and supervised 41 Ph.D. theses. Mac Lane died April 14, 2005, at age 95.

To find more information about Mac Lane, visit:

**[http://www-groups.dcs  
.st-and.ac.uk/~history/](http://www-groups.dcs.st-and.ac.uk/~history/)**

# 17 Factorization of Polynomials

Very early in our mathematical education—in fact in junior high school or early in high school itself—we are introduced to polynomials. For a seemingly endless amount of time we are drilled, to the point of utter boredom, in factoring them, multiplying them, dividing them, simplifying them. Facility in factoring a quadratic becomes confused with genuine mathematical talent.

I. N. Herstein, *Topics in Algebra*

The value of a principle is the number of things it will explain.

Ralph Waldo Emerson

## Reducibility Tests

In high school, students spend much time factoring polynomials and finding their zeros. In this chapter, we consider the same problems in a more abstract setting.

To discuss factorization of polynomials, we must first introduce the polynomial analog of a prime integer.

### **Definition Irreducible Polynomial, Reducible Polynomial**

Let  $D$  be an integral domain. A polynomial  $f(x)$  from  $D[x]$  that is neither the zero polynomial nor a unit in  $D[x]$  is said to be *irreducible over  $D$*  if, whenever  $f(x)$  is expressed as a product  $f(x) = g(x)h(x)$ , with  $g(x)$  and  $h(x)$  from  $D[x]$ , then  $g(x)$  or  $h(x)$  is a unit in  $D[x]$ . A nonzero, nonunit element of  $D[x]$  that is not irreducible over  $D$  is called *reducible over  $D$* .

In the case that an integral domain is a field  $F$ , it is equivalent and more convenient to define a nonconstant  $f(x) \in F[x]$  to be irreducible if  $f(x)$  cannot be expressed as a product of two polynomials of lower degree.

■ **EXAMPLE 1** The polynomial  $f(x) = 2x^2 + 4$  is irreducible over  $\mathcal{Q}$  but reducible over  $\mathbb{Z}$ , since  $2x^2 + 4 = 2(x^2 + 2)$  and neither 2 nor  $x^2 + 2$  is a unit in  $\mathbb{Z}[x]$ . ■

■ **EXAMPLE 2** The polynomial  $f(x) = 2x^2 + 4$  is irreducible over  $\mathbb{R}$  but reducible over  $\mathbb{C}$ . ■

■ **EXAMPLE 3** The polynomial  $x^2 - 2$  is irreducible over  $\mathcal{Q}$  but reducible over  $\mathbb{R}$ . ■

■ **EXAMPLE 4** The polynomial  $x^2 + 1$  is irreducible over  $\mathbb{Z}_3$  but reducible over  $\mathbb{Z}_5$ . ■

In general, it is a difficult problem to decide whether or not a particular polynomial is reducible over an integral domain, but there are special cases when it is easy. Our first theorem is a case in point. It applies to the four preceding examples.

### ■ Theorem 17.1 Reducibility Test for Degrees 2 and 3

*Let  $F$  be a field. If  $f(x) \in F[x]$  and  $\deg f(x)$  is 2 or 3, then  $f(x)$  is reducible over  $F$  if and only if  $f(x)$  has a zero in  $F$ .*

**PROOF** Suppose that  $f(x) = g(x)h(x)$ , where both  $g(x)$  and  $h(x)$  belong to  $F[x]$  and have degrees less than that of  $f(x)$ . Since  $\deg f(x) = \deg g(x) + \deg h(x)$  (Exercise 19 in Chapter 16) and  $\deg f(x)$  is 2 or 3, at least one of  $g(x)$  and  $h(x)$  has degree 1. Say  $g(x) = ax + b$ . Then, clearly,  $-a^{-1}b$  is a zero of  $g(x)$  and therefore a zero of  $f(x)$  as well.

Conversely, suppose that  $f(a) = 0$ , where  $a \in F$ . Then, by the Factor Theorem, we know that  $x - a$  is a factor of  $f(x)$  and, therefore,  $f(x)$  is reducible over  $F$ . ■

Theorem 17.1 is particularly easy to use when the field is  $\mathbb{Z}_p$ , because in this case we can check for reducibility of  $f(x)$  by simply testing to see if  $f(a) = 0$  for  $a = 0, 1, \dots, p - 1$ . For example, since 2 is a zero of  $x^2 + 1$  over  $\mathbb{Z}_5$ ,  $x^2 + 1$  is reducible over  $\mathbb{Z}_5$ . On the other hand, because neither 0, 1, nor 2 is a zero of  $x^2 + 1$  over  $\mathbb{Z}_3$ ,  $x^2 + 1$  is irreducible over  $\mathbb{Z}_3$ .

Note that polynomials of degree larger than 3 may be reducible over a field even though they do not have zeros in the field. For example, in  $\mathcal{Q}[x]$ , the polynomial  $x^4 + 2x^2 + 1$  is equal to  $(x^2 + 1)^2$ , but has no zeros in  $\mathcal{Q}$ .

Our next three tests deal with polynomials with integer coefficients. To simplify the proof of the first of these, we introduce some terminology and isolate a portion of the argument in the form of a lemma.

**Definition Content of a Polynomial, Primitive Polynomial**

The *content* of a nonzero polynomial  $a_n x^n + a_{n-1} x^{n-1} + \cdots + a_0$ , where the  $a$ 's are integers, is the greatest common divisor of the integers  $a_n, a_{n-1}, \dots, a_0$ . A *primitive polynomial* is an element of  $\mathbb{Z}[x]$  with content 1.

**■ Gauss's Lemma**

*The product of two primitive polynomials is primitive.*

**PROOF** Let  $f(x)$  and  $g(x)$  be primitive polynomials, and suppose that  $f(x)g(x)$  is not primitive. Let  $p$  be a prime divisor of the content of  $f(x)g(x)$ , and let  $\bar{f}(x)$ ,  $\bar{g}(x)$ , and  $\overline{f(x)g(x)}$  be the polynomials obtained from  $f(x)$ ,  $g(x)$ , and  $f(x)g(x)$  by reducing the coefficients modulo  $p$ . Then,  $\bar{f}(x)$  and  $\bar{g}(x)$  belong to the integral domain  $\mathbb{Z}_p[x]$  and  $\bar{f}(x)\bar{g}(x) = \overline{f(x)g(x)} = 0$ , the zero element of  $\mathbb{Z}_p[x]$  (see Exercise 33 in Chapter 16). Thus,  $\bar{f}(x) = 0$  or  $\bar{g}(x) = 0$ . This means that either  $p$  divides every coefficient of  $f(x)$  or  $p$  divides every coefficient of  $g(x)$ . Hence, either  $f(x)$  is not primitive or  $g(x)$  is not primitive. This contradiction completes the proof. ■

Remember that the question of reducibility depends on which ring of coefficients one permits. Thus,  $x^2 - 2$  is irreducible over  $\mathbb{Z}$  but reducible over  $\mathbb{Q}[\sqrt{2}]$ . In Chapter 20, we will prove that every polynomial of degree greater than 1 with coefficients from an integral domain is reducible over some field. Theorem 17.2 shows that in the case of polynomials irreducible over  $\mathbb{Z}$ , this field must be larger than the field of rational numbers.

**■ Theorem 17.2 Reducibility over  $\mathbb{Q}$  Implies Reducibility over  $\mathbb{Z}$** 

*Let  $f(x) \in \mathbb{Z}[x]$ . If  $f(x)$  is reducible over  $\mathbb{Q}$ , then it is reducible over  $\mathbb{Z}$ .*

**PROOF** Suppose that  $f(x) = g(x)h(x)$ , where  $g(x)$  and  $h(x) \in \mathbb{Q}[x]$ . Clearly, we may assume that  $f(x)$  is primitive because we can divide both  $f(x)$  and  $g(x)$  by the content of  $f(x)$ . Let  $a$  be the least common multiple of the denominators of the coefficients of  $g(x)$ , and  $b$  the least common multiple of the denominators of the coefficients of  $h(x)$ . Then  $abf(x) = ag(x) \cdot bh(x)$ , where  $ag(x)$  and  $bh(x) \in \mathbb{Z}[x]$ . Let  $c_1$  be the content of  $ag(x)$  and let  $c_2$  be the content of  $bh(x)$ . Then  $ag(x) = c_1 g_1(x)$  and  $bh(x) = c_2 h_1(x)$ , where both  $g_1(x)$  and  $h_1(x)$  are primitive, and  $abf(x) = c_1 c_2 g_1(x) h_1(x)$ . Since  $f(x)$  is primitive, the content of  $abf(x)$  is  $ab$ . Also, since the product of two primitive polynomials is primitive, it follows that the content of  $c_1 c_2 g_1(x) h_1(x)$

$h_1(x)$  is  $c_1c_2$ . Thus,  $ab = c_1c_2$  and  $f(x) = g_1(x)h_1(x)$ , where  $g_1(x)$  and  $h_1(x) \in \mathbb{Z}[x]$  and  $\deg g_1(x) = \deg g(x)$  and  $\deg h_1(x) = \deg h(x)$ . ■

■ **EXAMPLE 5** We illustrate the proof of Theorem 17.2 by tracing through it for the polynomial  $f(x) = 6x^2 + x - 2 = (3x - 3/2)(2x + 4/3) = g(x)h(x)$ . In this case we have  $a = 2$ ,  $b = 3$ ,  $c_1 = 3$ ,  $c_2 = 2$ ,  $g_1(x) = 2x - 1$ , and  $h_1(x) = 3x + 2$ , so that  $2 \cdot 3(6x^2 + x - 2) = 3 \cdot 2(2x - 1)(3x + 2)$  or  $6x^2 + x - 2 = (2x - 1)(3x + 2)$ . ■

## Irreducibility Tests

Theorem 17.1 reduces the question of irreducibility of a polynomial of degree 2 or 3 to one of finding a zero. The next theorem often allows us to simplify the problem even further.

### ■ Theorem 17.3 Mod $p$ Irreducibility Test

*Let  $p$  be a prime and suppose that  $f(x) \in \mathbb{Z}[x]$  with  $\deg f(x) \geq 1$ . Let  $\bar{f}(x)$  be the polynomial in  $\mathbb{Z}_p[x]$  obtained from  $f(x)$  by reducing all the coefficients of  $f(x)$  modulo  $p$ . If  $\bar{f}(x)$  is irreducible over  $\mathbb{Z}_p$  and  $\deg \bar{f}(x) = \deg f(x)$ , then  $f(x)$  is irreducible over  $\mathbb{Q}$ .*

**PROOF** It follows from the proof of Theorem 17.2 that if  $f(x)$  is reducible over  $\mathbb{Q}$ , then  $f(x) = g(x)h(x)$  with  $g(x), h(x) \in \mathbb{Z}[x]$ , and both  $g(x)$  and  $h(x)$  have degree less than that of  $f(x)$ . Let  $\bar{f}(x)$ ,  $\bar{g}(x)$ , and  $\bar{h}(x)$  be the polynomials obtained from  $f(x)$ ,  $g(x)$ , and  $h(x)$  by reducing all the coefficients modulo  $p$ . Since  $\deg f(x) = \deg \bar{f}(x)$ , we have  $\deg \bar{g}(x) \leq \deg g(x) < \deg \bar{f}(x)$  and  $\deg \bar{h}(x) \leq \deg h(x) < \deg \bar{f}(x)$ . But,  $\bar{f}(x) = \bar{g}(x)\bar{h}(x)$ , and this contradicts our assumption that  $\bar{f}(x)$  is irreducible over  $\mathbb{Z}_p$ . ■

■ **EXAMPLE 6** Let  $f(x) = 21x^3 - 3x^2 + 2x + 9$ . Then, over  $\mathbb{Z}_2$ , we have  $\bar{f}(x) = x^3 + x^2 + 1$  and, since  $\bar{f}(0) = 1$  and  $\bar{f}(1) = 1$ , we see that  $\bar{f}(x)$  is irreducible over  $\mathbb{Z}_2$ . Thus,  $f(x)$  is irreducible over  $\mathbb{Q}$ . Notice that, over  $\mathbb{Z}_3$ ,  $\bar{f}(x) = 2x$  is irreducible, but we may *not* apply Theorem 17.3 to conclude that  $f(x)$  is irreducible over  $\mathbb{Q}$ . ■

Be careful not to use the converse of Theorem 17.3. If  $f(x) \in \mathbb{Z}[x]$  and  $\bar{f}(x)$  is reducible over  $\mathbb{Z}_p$  for some  $p$ ,  $f(x)$  may still be irreducible over  $\mathbb{Q}$ . For example, consider  $f(x) = 21x^3 - 3x^2 + 2x + 8$ . Then, over  $\mathbb{Z}_2$ ,  $\bar{f}(x) = x^3 + x^2 = x^2(x + 1)$ . But over  $\mathbb{Z}_5$ ,  $\bar{f}(x)$  has no zeros and therefore is irreducible over  $\mathbb{Z}_5$ . So,  $f(x)$  is irreducible over  $\mathbb{Q}$ . Note that this example



shows that the Mod  $p$  Irreducibility Test may fail for some  $p$  and work for others. To conclude that a particular  $f(x)$  in  $Z[x]$  is irreducible over  $Q$ , all we need to do is find a single  $p$  for which the corresponding polynomial  $\bar{f}(x)$  in  $Z_p$  is irreducible. However, this is not always possible, since  $f(x) = x^4 + 1$  is irreducible over  $Q$  but reducible over  $Z_p$  for *every* prime  $p$ . (See Exercise 17.)

The Mod  $p$  Irreducibility Test can also be helpful in checking for irreducibility of polynomials of degree greater than 3 and polynomials with rational coefficients.

■ **EXAMPLE 7** Let  $f(x) = (3/7)x^4 - (2/7)x^2 + (9/35)x + 3/5$ . We will show that  $f(x)$  is irreducible over  $Q$ . First, let  $h(x) = 35f(x) = 15x^4 - 10x^2 + 9x + 21$ . Then  $f(x)$  is irreducible over  $Q$  if  $h(x)$  is irreducible over  $Z$ . Next, applying the Mod 2 Irreducibility Test to  $h(x)$ , we get  $\bar{h}(x) = x^4 + x + 1$ . Clearly,  $\bar{h}(x)$  has no zeros in  $Z_2$ . Furthermore,  $\bar{h}(x)$  has no quadratic factor in  $Z_2[x]$  either. [For if so, the factor would have to be either  $x^2 + x + 1$  or  $x^2 + 1$ . Long division shows that  $x^2 + x + 1$  is not a factor, and  $x^2 + 1$  cannot be a factor because it has a zero, whereas  $\bar{h}(x)$  does not.] Thus,  $\bar{h}(x)$  is irreducible over  $Z_2[x]$ . This guarantees that  $h(x)$  is irreducible over  $Q$ . ■

■ **EXAMPLE 8** Let  $f(x) = x^5 + 2x + 4$ . Obviously, neither Theorem 17.1 nor the Mod 2 Irreducibility Test helps here. Let's try mod 3. Substitution of 0, 1, and 2 into  $\bar{f}(x)$  does not yield 0, so there are no linear factors. But  $\bar{f}(x)$  may have a quadratic factor. If so, we may assume it has the form  $x^2 + ax + b$  (see Exercise 5). This gives nine possibilities to check. We can immediately rule out each of the nine that has a zero over  $Z_3$ , since  $\bar{f}(x)$  does not have one. This leaves only  $x^2 + 1$ ,  $x^2 + x + 2$ , and  $x^2 + 2x + 2$  to check. These are eliminated by long division. So, since  $\bar{f}(x)$  is irreducible over  $Z_3$ ,  $f(x)$  is irreducible over  $Q$ . (Why is it unnecessary to check for cubic or fourth-degree factors?) ■

Another important irreducibility test is the following one, credited to Ferdinand Eisenstein (1823–1852), a student of Gauss. The corollary was first proved by Gauss by a different method.

#### ■ Theorem 17.4 Eisenstein's Criterion (1850)

*Let*

$$f(x) = a_n x^n + a_{n-1} x^{n-1} + \cdots + a_0 \in Z[x].$$

*If there is a prime  $p$  such that  $p \nmid a_n$ ,  $p \mid a_{n-1}, \dots, p \mid a_0$  and  $p^2 \nmid a_0$ , then  $f(x)$  is irreducible over  $Q$ .*

**PROOF** If  $f(x)$  is reducible over  $Q$ , we know by Theorem 17.2 that there exist elements  $g(x)$  and  $h(x)$  in  $Z[x]$  such that  $f(x) = g(x)h(x)$ ,  $1 \leq \deg g(x)$ , and  $1 \leq \deg h(x) < n$ . Say  $g(x) = b_r x^r + \cdots + b_0$  and  $h(x) = c_s x^s + \cdots + c_0$ . Then, since  $p \mid a_0$ ,  $p^2 \nmid a_0$ , and  $a_0 = b_0 c_0$ , it follows that  $p$  divides one of  $b_0$  and  $c_0$  but not the other. Let us say  $p \mid b_0$  and  $p \nmid c_0$ . Also, since  $p \nmid a_n = b_r c_s$ , we know that  $p \nmid b_r$ . So, there is a least integer  $t$  such that  $p \nmid b_t$ . Now, consider  $a_t = b_t c_0 + b_{t-1} c_1 + \cdots + b_0 c_t$ . By assumption,  $p$  divides  $a_t$  and, by choice of  $t$ , every summand on the right after the first one is divisible by  $p$ . Clearly, this forces  $p$  to divide  $b_t c_0$  as well. This is impossible, however, since  $p$  is prime and  $p$  divides neither  $b_t$  nor  $c_0$ . ■

### ■ Corollary Irreducibility of $p$ th Cyclotomic Polynomial

For any prime  $p$ , the  $p$ th cyclotomic polynomial

$$\Phi_p(x) = \frac{x^p - 1}{x - 1} = x^{p-1} + x^{p-2} + \cdots + x + 1$$

is irreducible over  $Q$ .

**PROOF** Let

$$f(x) = \Phi_p(x + 1) = \frac{(x + 1)^p - 1}{(x + 1) - 1} = x^{p-1} + \binom{p}{1} x^{p-2} + \binom{p}{2} x^{p-3} + \cdots + \binom{p}{p-1}.$$

Then, since every coefficient except that of  $x^{p-1}$  is divisible by  $p$  and the constant term is not divisible by  $p^2$ , by Eisenstein's Criterion,  $f(x)$  is irreducible over  $Q$ . So, if  $\Phi_p(x) = g(x)h(x)$  were a nontrivial factorization of  $\Phi_p(x)$  over  $Q$ , then  $f(x) = \Phi_p(x + 1) = g(x + 1) \cdot h(x + 1)$  would be a nontrivial factorization of  $f(x)$  over  $Q$ . Since this is impossible, we conclude that  $\Phi_p(x)$  is irreducible over  $Q$ . ■

■ **EXAMPLE 9** The polynomial  $3x^5 + 15x^4 - 20x^3 + 10x + 20$  is irreducible over  $Q$  because  $5 \nmid 3$  and  $25 \nmid 20$  but 5 does divide 15,  $-20$ , 10, and 20. ■

The principal reason for our interest in irreducible polynomials stems from the fact that there is an intimate connection among them, maximal ideals, and fields. This connection is revealed in the next theorem and its first corollary.

### ■ Theorem 17.5 $\langle p(x) \rangle$ Is Maximal If and Only If $p(x)$ Is Irreducible

*Let  $F$  be a field and let  $p(x) \in F[x]$ . Then  $\langle p(x) \rangle$  is a maximal ideal in  $F[x]$  if and only if  $p(x)$  is irreducible over  $F$ .*

**PROOF** Suppose first that  $\langle p(x) \rangle$  is a maximal ideal in  $F[x]$ . Clearly,  $p(x)$  is neither the zero polynomial nor a unit in  $F[x]$ , because neither  $\{0\}$  nor  $F[x]$  is a maximal ideal in  $F[x]$ . If  $p(x) = g(x)h(x)$  is a factorization of  $p(x)$  over  $F$ , then  $\langle p(x) \rangle \subseteq \langle g(x) \rangle \subseteq F[x]$ . Thus,  $\langle p(x) \rangle = \langle g(x) \rangle$  or  $F[x] = \langle g(x) \rangle$ . In the first case, we must have  $\deg p(x) = \deg g(x)$ . In the second case, it follows that  $\deg g(x) = 0$  and, consequently,  $\deg h(x) = \deg p(x)$ . Thus,  $p(x)$  cannot be written as a product of two polynomials in  $F[x]$  of lower degree.

Now, suppose that  $p(x)$  is irreducible over  $F$ . Let  $I$  be any ideal of  $F[x]$  such that  $\langle p(x) \rangle \subseteq I \subseteq F[x]$ . Because  $F[x]$  is a principal ideal domain, we know that  $I = \langle g(x) \rangle$  for some  $g(x)$  in  $F[x]$ . So,  $p(x) \in \langle g(x) \rangle$  and, therefore,  $p(x) = g(x)h(x)$ , where  $h(x) \in F[x]$ . Since  $p(x)$  is irreducible over  $F$ , it follows that either  $g(x)$  is a constant or  $h(x)$  is a constant. In the first case, we have  $I = F[x]$ ; in the second case, we have  $\langle p(x) \rangle = \langle g(x) \rangle = I$ . So,  $\langle p(x) \rangle$  is maximal in  $F[x]$ . ■

### ■ Corollary 1 $F[x]/\langle p(x) \rangle$ Is a Field

*Let  $F$  be a field and  $p(x)$  be an irreducible polynomial over  $F$ . Then  $F[x]/\langle p(x) \rangle$  is a field.*

**PROOF** This follows directly from Theorems 17.5 and 14.4. ■

The next corollary is a polynomial analog of Euclid's Lemma for primes (see Chapter 0).

### ■ Corollary 2 $p(x) \mid a(x)b(x)$ Implies $p(x) \mid a(x)$ or $p(x) \mid b(x)$

*Let  $F$  be a field and let  $p(x), a(x), b(x) \in F[x]$ . If  $p(x)$  is irreducible over  $F$  and  $p(x) \mid a(x)b(x)$ , then  $p(x) \mid a(x)$  or  $p(x) \mid b(x)$ .*

**PROOF** Since  $p(x)$  is irreducible,  $F[x]/\langle p(x) \rangle$  is a field and, therefore, an integral domain. From Theorem 14.3, we know that  $\langle p(x) \rangle$  is a prime ideal, and since  $p(x)$  divides  $a(x)b(x)$ , we have  $a(x)b(x) \in \langle p(x) \rangle$ . Thus,  $a(x) \in \langle p(x) \rangle$  or  $b(x) \in \langle p(x) \rangle$ . This means that  $p(x) \mid a(x)$  or  $p(x) \mid b(x)$ . ■

The next two examples put the theory to work.

■ **EXAMPLE 10** We construct a field with eight elements. By Theorem 17.1 and Corollary 1 of Theorem 17.5, it suffices to find a cubic polynomial over  $Z_2$  that has no zero in  $Z_2$ . By inspection,  $x^3 + x + 1$  fills the bill. Thus,  $Z_2[x]/\langle x^3 + x + 1 \rangle = \{ax^2 + bx + c + \langle x^3 + x + 1 \rangle \mid a, b, c \in Z_2\}$  is a field with eight elements. For practice, let us do a few calculations in this field. Since the sum of two polynomials of the form  $ax^2 + bx + c$  is another one of the same form, addition is easy. For example,

$$\begin{aligned} (x^2 + x + 1 + \langle x^3 + x + 1 \rangle) + (x^2 + 1 + \langle x^3 + x + 1 \rangle) \\ = x + \langle x^3 + x + 1 \rangle. \end{aligned}$$

On the other hand, multiplication of two coset representatives need not yield one of the original eight coset representatives:

$$\begin{aligned} (x^2 + x + 1 + \langle x^3 + x + 1 \rangle) \cdot (x^2 + 1 + \langle x^3 + x + 1 \rangle) \\ = x^4 + x^3 + x + 1 + \langle x^3 + x + 1 \rangle = x^4 + \langle x^3 + x + 1 \rangle \end{aligned}$$

(since the ideal absorbs the last three terms). How do we express this in the form  $ax^2 + bx + c + \langle x^3 + x + 1 \rangle$ ? One way is to long divide  $x^4$  by  $x^3 + x + 1$  to obtain the remainder of  $x^2 + x$  (just as one reduces  $12 + \langle 5 \rangle$  to  $2 + \langle 5 \rangle$  by dividing 12 by 5 to obtain the remainder 2). Another way is to observe that  $x^3 + x + 1 + \langle x^3 + x + 1 \rangle = 0 + \langle x^3 + x + 1 \rangle$  implies  $x^3 + \langle x^3 + x + 1 \rangle = x + 1 + \langle x^3 + x + 1 \rangle$ . Thus, we may multiply both sides by  $x$  to obtain

$$x^4 + \langle x^3 + x + 1 \rangle = x^2 + x + \langle x^3 + x + 1 \rangle.$$

Similarly,

$$\begin{aligned} (x^2 + x + \langle x^3 + x + 1 \rangle) \cdot (x + \langle x^3 + x + 1 \rangle) \\ = x^3 + x^2 + \langle x^3 + x + 1 \rangle \\ = x^2 + x + 1 + \langle x^3 + x + 1 \rangle. \end{aligned}$$

A partial multiplication table for this field is given in Table 17.1. To simplify the notation, we indicate a coset by its representative only.

**Table 17.1** A Partial Multiplication Table for Example 10

|           | 1         | $x$       | $x + 1$       | $x^2$         | $x^2 + 1$     | $x^2 + x$     | $x^2 + x + 1$ |
|-----------|-----------|-----------|---------------|---------------|---------------|---------------|---------------|
| 1         | 1         | $x$       | $x + 1$       | $x^2$         | $x^2 + 1$     | $x^2 + x$     | $x^2 + x + 1$ |
| $x$       | $x$       | $x^2$     | $x^2 + x$     | $x + 1$       | 1             | $x^2 + x + 1$ | $x^2 + 1$     |
| $x + 1$   | $x + 1$   | $x^2 + x$ | $x^2 + 1$     | $x^2 + x + 1$ | $x^2$         | 1             | $x$           |
| $x^2$     | $x^2$     | $x + 1$   | $x^2 + x + 1$ | $x^2 + x$     | $x$           | $x^2 + 1$     | 1             |
| $x^2 + 1$ | $x^2 + 1$ | 1         | $x^2$         | $x$           | $x^2 + x + 1$ | $x + 1$       | $x^2 + x$     |

(Complete the table yourself. Keep in mind that  $x^3$  can be replaced by  $x + 1$  and  $x^4$  by  $x^2 + x$ .) ■

■ **EXAMPLE 11** Since  $x^2 + 1$  has no zero in  $Z_3$ , it is irreducible over  $Z_3$ . Thus,  $Z_3[x]/\langle x^2 + 1 \rangle$  is a field. Analogous to Example 12 in Chapter 14,  $Z_3[x]/\langle x^2 + 1 \rangle = \{ax + b + \langle x^2 + 1 \rangle \mid a, b \in Z_3\}$ . Thus, this field has nine elements. A multiplication table for this field can be obtained from Table 13.1 by replacing  $i$  by  $x$ . (Why does this work?) ■

## Unique Factorization in $Z[x]$

As a further application of the ideas presented in this chapter, we next prove that  $Z[x]$  has an important factorization property. In Chapter 18, we will study this property in greater depth. The first proof of Theorem 17.6 was given by Gauss. In reading this theorem and its proof, keep in mind that the units in  $Z[x]$  are precisely  $f(x) = 1$  and  $f(x) = -1$  (see Exercise 25 in Chapter 12), the irreducible polynomials of degree 0 over  $Z$  are precisely those of the form  $f(x) = p$  and  $f(x) = -p$  where  $p$  is a prime, and every nonconstant polynomial from  $Z[x]$  that is irreducible over  $Z$  is primitive (see Exercise 3).

### ■ Theorem 17.6 Unique Factorization in $Z[x]$

*Every polynomial in  $Z[x]$  that is not the zero polynomial or a unit in  $Z[x]$  can be written in the form  $b_1 b_2 \cdots b_s p_1(x) p_2(x) \cdots p_m(x)$ , where the  $b_i$ 's are irreducible polynomials of degree 0 and the  $p_i(x)$ 's are irreducible polynomials of positive degree. Furthermore, if*

$$b_1 b_2 \cdots b_s p_1(x) p_2(x) \cdots p_m(x) = c_1 c_2 \cdots c_t q_1(x) q_2(x) \cdots q_n(x),$$

*where the  $b_i$ 's and  $c_i$ 's are irreducible polynomials of degree 0 and the  $p_i(x)$ 's and  $q_i(x)$ 's are irreducible polynomials of positive degree, then  $s = t$ ,  $m = n$ , and, after renumbering the  $c$ 's and  $q(x)$ 's, we have  $b_i = \pm c_i$  for  $i = 1, \dots, s$  and  $p_i(x) = \pm q_i(x)$  for  $i = 1, \dots, m$ .*

**PROOF** Let  $f(x)$  be a nonzero, nonunit polynomial from  $Z[x]$ . If  $\deg f(x) = 0$ , then  $f(x)$  is constant and the result follows from the Fundamental Theorem of Arithmetic. If  $\deg f(x) > 0$ , let  $b$  denote the content of  $f(x)$ , and let  $b_1 b_2 \cdots b_s$  be the factorization of  $b$  as a product of primes. Then,  $f(x) = b_1 b_2 \cdots b_s f_1(x)$ , where  $f_1(x)$  belongs to  $Z[x]$ , is primitive and  $\deg f_1(x) = \deg f(x)$ . Thus, to prove the existence portion of the theorem, it suffices to show that a primitive polynomial  $f(x)$  of positive degree can be written as a product of irreducible polynomials of positive degree. We proceed by

induction on  $\deg f(x)$ . If  $\deg f(x) = 1$ , then  $f(x)$  is already irreducible and we are done. Now suppose that every primitive polynomial of degree less than  $\deg f(x)$  can be written as a product of irreducibles of positive degree. If  $f(x)$  is irreducible, there is nothing to prove. Otherwise,  $f(x) = g(x)h(x)$ , where both  $g(x)$  and  $h(x)$  are primitive and have degree less than that of  $f(x)$ . Thus, by induction, both  $g(x)$  and  $h(x)$  can be written as a product of irreducibles of positive degree. Clearly, then,  $f(x)$  is also such a product.

To prove the uniqueness portion of the theorem, suppose that  $f(x) = b_1 b_2 \cdots b_s p_1(x) p_2(x) \cdots p_m(x) = c_1 c_2 \cdots c_t q_1(x) q_2(x) \cdots q_n(x)$ , where the  $b_i$ 's and  $c_i$ 's are irreducible polynomials of degree 0 and the  $p_i(x)$ 's and  $q_i(x)$ 's are irreducible polynomials of positive degree. Let  $b = b_1 b_2 \cdots b_s$  and  $c = c_1 c_2 \cdots c_t$ . Since the  $p(x)$ 's and  $q(x)$ 's are primitive, it follows from Gauss's Lemma that  $p_1(x) p_2(x) \cdots p_m(x)$  and  $q_1(x) q_2(x) \cdots q_n(x)$  are primitive. Hence, both  $b$  and  $c$  must equal plus or minus the content of  $f(x)$  and, therefore, are equal in absolute value. It then follows from the Fundamental Theorem of Arithmetic that  $s = t$  and, after renumbering,  $b_i = \pm c_i$  for  $i = 1, 2, \dots, s$ . Thus, by canceling the constant terms in the two factorizations for  $f(x)$ , we have  $p_1(x) p_2(x) \cdots p_m(x) = \pm q_1(x) q_2(x) \cdots q_n(x)$ . Now, viewing the  $p(x)$ 's and  $q(x)$ 's as elements of  $\mathcal{Q}[x]$  and noting that  $p_1(x)$  divides  $q_1(x) \cdots q_n(x)$ , it follows from Corollary 2 of Theorem 17.5 and induction (see Exercise 32) that  $p_1(x) \mid q_i(x)$  for some  $i$ . By renumbering, we may assume  $i = 1$ . Then, since  $q_1(x)$  is irreducible, we have  $q_1(x) = (r/s)p_1(x)$ , where  $r, s \in \mathbb{Z}$ . However, because both  $q_1(x)$  and  $p_1(x)$  are primitive, we must have  $r/s = \pm 1$ . So,  $q_1(x) = \pm p_1(x)$ . Also, after canceling, we have  $p_2(x) \cdots p_m(x) = \pm q_2(x) \cdots q_n(x)$ . Now, we may repeat the argument above with  $p_2(x)$  in place of  $p_1(x)$ . If  $m < n$ , after  $m$  such steps we would have 1 on the left and a nonconstant polynomial on the right. Clearly, this is impossible. On the other hand, if  $m > n$ , after  $n$  steps we would have  $\pm 1$  on the right and a nonconstant polynomial on the left—another impossibility. So,  $m = n$  and  $p_i(x) = \pm q_i(x)$  after suitable renumbering of the  $q(x)$ 's. ■

## Weird Dice: An Application of Unique Factorization

■ **EXAMPLE 12** Consider an ordinary pair of dice whose faces are labeled 1 through 6. The probability of rolling a sum of 2 is  $1/36$ , the probability of rolling a sum of 3 is  $2/36$ , and so on. In a 1978 issue of *Scientific American* [1], Martin Gardner remarked that if one were to label the six faces of one cube with the integers 1, 2, 2, 3, 3, 4 and the six faces of another cube with the integers 1, 3, 4, 5, 6, 8, then the probability of obtaining any particular sum with these dice (called *Sicherman dice*)

would be the same as the probability of rolling that sum with ordinary dice (that is,  $1/36$  for a 2,  $2/36$  for a 3, and so on). See Figure 17.1. In this example, we show how the Sicherman labels can be derived, and that they are the only possible such labels besides 1 through 6. To do so, we utilize the fact that  $\mathbb{Z}[x]$  has the unique factorization property.

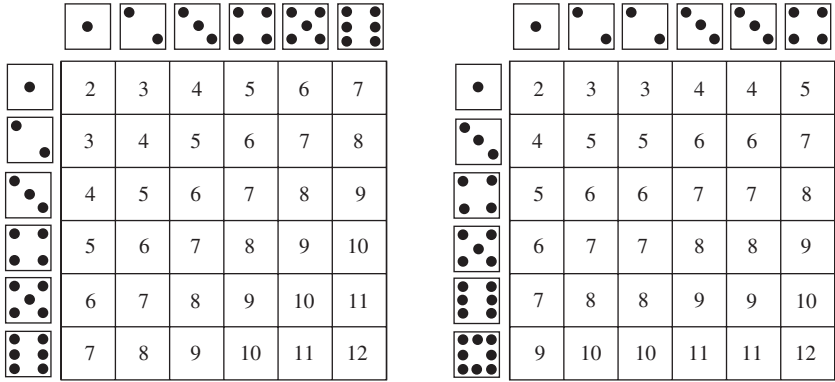


Figure 17.1

To begin, let us ask ourselves how we may obtain a sum of 6, say, with an ordinary pair of dice. Well, there are five possibilities for the two faces: (5, 1), (4, 2), (3, 3), (2, 4), and (1, 5). Next we consider the product of the two polynomials created by using the ordinary dice labels as exponents:

$$(x^6 + x^5 + x^4 + x^3 + x^2 + x)(x^6 + x^5 + x^4 + x^3 + x^2 + x).$$

Observe that we pick up the term  $x^6$  in this product in precisely the following ways:  $x^5 \cdot x^1$ ,  $x^4 \cdot x^2$ ,  $x^3 \cdot x^3$ ,  $x^2 \cdot x^4$ ,  $x^1 \cdot x^5$ . Notice the correspondence between pairs of labels whose sums are 6 and pairs of terms whose products are  $x^6$ . This correspondence is one-to-one, and it is valid for all sums and all dice—including the Sicherman dice and any other dice that yield the desired probabilities. So, let  $a_1, a_2, a_3, a_4, a_5, a_6$  and  $b_1, b_2, b_3, b_4, b_5, b_6$  be any two lists of positive integer labels for the faces of a pair of cubes with the property that the probability of rolling any particular sum with these dice (let us call them *weird dice*) is the same as the probability of rolling that sum with ordinary dice labeled 1 through 6. Using our observation about products of polynomials, this means that

$$\begin{aligned} & (x^6 + x^5 + x^4 + x^3 + x^2 + x)(x^6 + x^5 + x^4 + x^3 + x^2 + x) \\ &= (x^{a_1} + x^{a_2} + x^{a_3} + x^{a_4} + x^{a_5} + x^{a_6}) \cdot \\ & \quad (x^{b_1} + x^{b_2} + x^{b_3} + x^{b_4} + x^{b_5} + x^{b_6}). \end{aligned} \tag{1}$$

Now all we have to do is solve this equation for the  $a$ 's and  $b$ 's. Here is where unique factorization in  $\mathbb{Z}[x]$  comes in. The polynomial  $x^6 + x^5 + x^4 + x^3 + x^2 + x$  factors uniquely into irreducibles as

$$x(x+1)(x^2+x+1)(x^2-x+1)$$

so that the left-hand side of Equation (1) has the irreducible factorization

$$x^2(x+1)^2(x^2+x+1)^2(x^2-x+1)^2.$$

So, by Theorem 17.6, this means that these factors are the only possible irreducible factors of  $P(x) = x^{a_1} + x^{a_2} + x^{a_3} + x^{a_4} + x^{a_5} + x^{a_6}$ . Thus,  $P(x)$  has the form

$$x^q(x+1)^r(x^2+x+1)^t(x^2-x+1)^u,$$

where  $0 \leq q, r, t, u \leq 2$ .

To restrict further the possibilities for these four parameters, we evaluate  $P(1)$  in two ways.  $P(1) = 1^{a_1} + 1^{a_2} + \cdots + 1^{a_6} = 6$  and  $P(1) = 1^q 2^r 3^t 1^u$ . Clearly, this means that  $r = 1$  and  $t = 1$ . What about  $q$ ? Evaluating  $P(0)$  in two ways shows that  $q \neq 0$ . On the other hand, if  $q = 2$ , the smallest possible sum one could roll with the corresponding labels for dice would be 3. Since this violates our assumption, we have now reduced our list of possibilities for  $q, r, t$ , and  $u$  to  $q = 1, r = 1, t = 1$ , and  $u = 0, 1, 2$ . Let's consider each of these possibilities in turn.

When  $u = 0$ ,  $P(x) = x^4 + x^3 + x^3 + x^2 + x^2 + x$ , so the die labels are 4, 3, 3, 2, 2, 1—a Sicherman die.

When  $u = 1$ ,  $P(x) = x^6 + x^5 + x^4 + x^3 + x^2 + x$ , so the die labels are 6, 5, 4, 3, 2, 1—an ordinary die.

When  $u = 2$ ,  $P(x) = x^8 + x^6 + x^5 + x^4 + x^3 + x$ , so the die labels are 8, 6, 5, 4, 3, 1—the other Sicherman die.

This proves that the Sicherman dice do give the same probabilities as ordinary dice *and* that they are the *only* other pair of dice that have this property. ■

## Exercises

No matter how good you are at something, there's always about a million people better than you.

Homer Simpson

1. Verify the assertion made in Example 2.
2. Suppose that  $D$  is an integral domain and  $F$  is a field containing  $D$ . If  $f(x) \in D[x]$  and  $f(x)$  is irreducible over  $F$  but reducible over  $D$ , what can you say about the factorization of  $f(x)$  over  $D$ ?
3. Show that a nonconstant polynomial from  $Z[x]$  that is irreducible over  $Z$  is primitive. (This exercise is referred to in this chapter.)
4. Suppose that  $f(x) = x^n + a_{n-1}x^{n-1} + \cdots + a_0 \in Z[x]$ . If  $r$  is rational and  $x - r$  divides  $f(x)$ , show that  $r$  is an integer.



5. Let  $F$  be a field and let  $a$  be a nonzero element of  $F$ .
  - a. If  $af(x)$  is irreducible over  $F$ , prove that  $f(x)$  is irreducible over  $F$ .
  - b. If  $f(ax)$  is irreducible over  $F$ , prove that  $f(x)$  is irreducible over  $F$ .
  - c. If  $f(x + a)$  is irreducible over  $F$ , prove that  $f(x)$  is irreducible over  $F$ .
  - d. Use part c to prove that  $8x^3 - 6x + 1$  is irreducible over  $\mathbb{Q}$ . (This exercise is referred to in this chapter.)
6. Let  $F$  be a field and  $f(x) \in F[x]$ . Show that, as far as deciding upon the irreducibility of  $f(x)$  over  $F$  is concerned, we may assume that  $f(x)$  is monic. (This assumption is useful when one uses a computer to check for irreducibility.)
7. Suppose there is a real number  $r$  with the property that  $r + 1/r$  is an odd integer. Prove that  $r$  is irrational.
8. Show that the equation  $x^2 + y^2 = 2003$  has no solutions in the integers.
9. Explain how the Mod  $p$  Irreducibility Test (Theorem 17.3) can be used to test members of  $\mathbb{Q}[x]$  for irreducibility.
10. Suppose that  $f(x) \in \mathbb{Z}_p[x]$  and  $f(x)$  is irreducible over  $\mathbb{Z}_p$ , where  $p$  is a prime. If  $\deg f(x) = n$ , prove that  $\mathbb{Z}_p[x]/\langle f(x) \rangle$  is a field with  $p^n$  elements.
11. Construct a field of order 25.
12. Construct a field of order 27.
13. Show that  $x^3 + x^2 + x + 1$  is reducible over  $\mathbb{Q}$ . Does this fact contradict the corollary to Theorem 17.4?
14. Determine which of the polynomials below is (are) irreducible over  $\mathbb{Q}$ .
  - a.  $x^5 + 9x^4 + 12x^2 + 6$
  - b.  $x^4 + x + 1$
  - c.  $x^4 + 3x^2 + 3$
  - d.  $x^5 + 5x^2 + 1$
  - e.  $(5/2)x^5 + (9/2)x^4 + 15x^3 + (3/7)x^2 + 6x + 3/14$
15. Show that  $x^4 + 1$  is irreducible over  $\mathbb{Q}$  but reducible over  $\mathbb{R}$ . (This exercise is referred to in this chapter.)
16. Prove that  $x^4 + 15x^3 + 7$  is irreducible over  $\mathbb{Q}$ .
17. Show that  $x^4 + 1$  is reducible over  $\mathbb{Z}_p$  for every prime  $p$ . (This exercise is referred to in this chapter.)
18. Show that  $x^2 + x + 4$  is irreducible over  $\mathbb{Z}_{11}$ .
19. Let  $f(x) = x^3 + 6 \in \mathbb{Z}_7[x]$ . Write  $f(x)$  as a product of irreducible polynomials over  $\mathbb{Z}_7$ .
20. Let  $f(x) = x^3 + x^2 + x + 1 \in \mathbb{Z}_2[x]$ . Write  $f(x)$  as a product of irreducible polynomials over  $\mathbb{Z}_2$ .

21. Find all the zeros and their multiplicities of  $x^5 + 4x^4 + 4x^3 - x^2 - 4x + 1$  over  $Z_5$ .
22. Find all zeros of  $f(x) = 3x^2 + x + 4$  over  $Z_7$  by substitution. Find all zeros of  $f(x)$  by using the quadratic formula  $(-b \pm \sqrt{b^2 - 4ac}) \cdot (2a)^{-1}$  (all calculations are done in  $Z_7$ ). Do your answers agree? Should they? Find all zeros of  $g(x) = 2x^2 + x + 3$  over  $Z_5$  by substitution. Try the quadratic formula on  $g(x)$ . Do your answers agree? State necessary and sufficient conditions for the quadratic formula to yield the zeros of a quadratic from  $Z_p[x]$ , where  $p$  is a prime greater than 2.
23. Let  $p$  be a prime.
  - a. Show that the number of reducible polynomials over  $Z_p$  of the form  $x^2 + ax + b$  is  $p(p+1)/2$ .
  - b. Determine the number of reducible quadratic polynomials over  $Z_p$ .
24. Let  $p$  be a prime.
  - a. Determine the number of irreducible polynomials over  $Z_p$  of the form  $x^2 + ax + b$ .
  - b. Determine the number of irreducible quadratic polynomials over  $Z_p$ .
25. Show that for every prime  $p$  there exists a field of order  $p^2$ .
26. Prove that, for every positive integer  $n$ , there are infinitely many polynomials of degree  $n$  in  $Z[x]$  that are irreducible over  $Q$ .
27. Show that the field given in Example 11 in this chapter is isomorphic to the field given in Example 9 in Chapter 13.
28. Let  $f(x) \in Z_p[x]$ . Prove that if  $f(x)$  has no factor of the form  $x^2 + ax + b$ , then it has no quadratic factor over  $Z_p$ .
29. Find all monic irreducible polynomials of degree 2 over  $Z_3$ .
30. Given that  $\pi$  is not the zero of a nonzero polynomial with rational coefficients, prove that  $\pi^2$  cannot be written in the form  $a\pi + b$ , where  $a$  and  $b$  are rational.
31. (Rational Root Theorem) Let

$$f(x) = a_n x^n + a_{n-1} x^{n-1} + \cdots + a_0 \in Z[x]$$

and  $a_n \neq 0$ . Prove that if  $r$  and  $s$  are relatively prime integers and  $f(r/s) = 0$ , then  $r \mid a_0$  and  $s \mid a_n$ .

32. Let  $F$  be a field and let  $p(x), a_1(x), a_2(x), \dots, a_k(x) \in F[x]$ , where  $p(x)$  is irreducible over  $F$ . If  $p(x) \mid a_1(x)a_2(x) \cdots a_k(x)$ , show that  $p(x)$  divides some  $a_i(x)$ . (This exercise is referred to in the proof of Theorem 17.6.)
33. Let  $F$  be a field and  $p(x) \in F[x]$ . Use Theorem 14.4 to prove that if  $\langle p(x) \rangle$  is a maximal ideal in  $F[x]$ , then  $p(x)$  is irreducible over  $F$  (see Theorem 17.5).

34. If  $p$  is a prime, prove that  $x^{p-1} - x^{p-2} + x^{p-3} - \cdots - x + 1$  is irreducible over  $\mathbb{Q}$ .
35. Let  $F$  be a field and let  $p(x)$  be irreducible over  $F$ . If  $E$  is a field that contains  $F$  and there is an element  $a$  in  $E$  such that  $p(a) = 0$ , show that the mapping  $\phi: F[x] \rightarrow E$  given by  $f(x) \rightarrow f(a)$  is a ring homomorphism with kernel  $\langle p(x) \rangle$ . (This exercise is referred to in Chapter 20.)
36. Prove that the ideal  $\langle x^2 + 1 \rangle$  is prime in  $\mathbb{Z}[x]$  but not maximal in  $\mathbb{Z}[x]$ .
37. Let  $F$  be a field and let  $p(x)$  be irreducible over  $F$ . Show that  $\{a + \langle p(x) \rangle \mid a \in F\}$  is a subfield of  $F[x]/\langle p(x) \rangle$  isomorphic to  $F$ . (This exercise is referred to in Chapter 20.)
38. Let  $F$  be a field and let  $f(x)$  be a polynomial in  $F[x]$  that is reducible over  $F$ . Prove that  $\langle f(x) \rangle$  is not a prime ideal in  $F[x]$ .
39. Example 1 in this chapter shows the converse of Theorem 17.2 is not true. That is, a polynomial  $f(x)$  in  $\mathbb{Z}[x]$  can be reducible over  $\mathbb{Z}$  but irreducible over  $\mathbb{Q}$ . State a condition on  $f(x)$  that makes the converse true.
40. Carry out the analysis given in Example 12 for a pair of tetrahedrons instead of a pair of cubes. (Define ordinary tetrahedral dice as the ones labeled 1 through 4.)
41. Suppose in Example 12 that we begin with  $n$  ( $n > 2$ ) ordinary dice each labeled 1 through 6, instead of just two. Show that the only possible labels that produce the same probabilities as  $n$  ordinary dice are the labels 1 through 6 and the Sicherman labels.
42. Show that one two-sided die labeled with 1 and 4 and another 18-sided die labeled with 1, 2, 2, 3, 3, 3, 4, 4, 4, 5, 5, 5, 6, 6, 6, 7, 7, 8 yield the same probabilities as an ordinary pair of cubes labeled 1 through 6. Carry out an analysis similar to that given in Example 12 to derive these labels.
43. In the game of Monopoly, would the probabilities of landing on various properties be different if the game were played with Sicherman dice instead of ordinary dice? Why?

## Computer Exercises

Computer exercises for this chapter are available at the website:

<http://www.d.umn.edu/~jgallian>

## Reference

1. Martin Gardner, "Mathematical Games," *Scientific American* 238/2 (1978): 19–32.

## Suggested Readings

Duane Broline, "Renumbering the Faces of Dice," *Mathematics Magazine* 52 (1979): 312–315.

In this article, the author extends the analysis we carried out in Example 12 to dice in the shape of Platonic solids.

J. A. Gallian and D. J. Rusin, "Cyclotomic Polynomials and Nonstandard Dice," *Discrete Mathematics* 27 (1979): 245–259.

Here Example 12 is generalized to the case of  $n$  dice each with  $m$  labels for all  $n$  and  $m$  greater than 1.

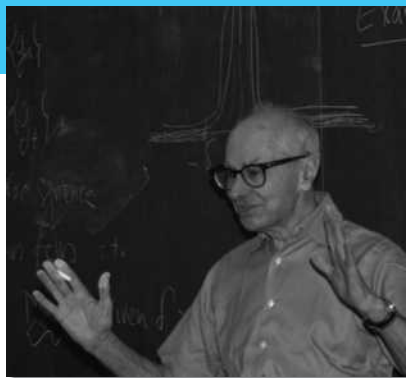
Randall Swift and Brian Fowler, "Relabeling Dice," *The College Mathematics Journal* 30 (1999): 204–208.

The authors use the method presented in this chapter to derive positive integer labels for a pair of dice that are not six-sided but give the same probabilities for the sum of the faces as a pair of cubes labeled 1 through 6.

# Serge Lang

Lang's *Algebra* changed the way graduate algebra is taught . . . It has affected all subsequent graduate-level algebra books.

*Citation for the Steele Prize*



Courtesy of Bogdan Oporowski

SERGE LANG was a prolific mathematician, inspiring teacher, and political activist. He was born near Paris on May 19, 1927. His family moved to Los Angeles when he was a teenager. Lang received a B.A. in physics from Caltech in 1946 and a Ph.D. in mathematics from Princeton in 1951 under Emil Artin (see the biography in Chapter 19). His first permanent position was at Columbia University in 1955, but in 1971 Lang resigned his position at Columbia as a protest against Columbia's handling of Vietnam anti-war protesters. He joined Yale University in 1972 and remained there until his retirement.

Lang made significant contributions to number theory, algebraic geometry, differential geometry, and analysis. He wrote more than 120 research articles and 60 books. His most famous and influential book was his graduate-level *Algebra*. Lang was a

prize-winning teacher known for his extraordinary devotion to students. Lang often got into heated discussions about mathematics, the arts, and politics. In one incident, he threatened to hit a fellow mathematician with a bronze bust for not conceding it was self-evident that the Beatles were greater musicians than Beethoven.

Among Lang's honors were the Steele Prize for Mathematical Exposition from the American Mathematical Society, the Cole Prize in Algebra (see Chapter 25), and election to the National Academy of Sciences. Lang died on September 25, 2005, at the age of 78.

For more information about Lang, visit:

**[http://wikipedia.org/wiki/  
Serge\\_Lang](http://wikipedia.org/wiki/Serge_Lang)**

# 18

## Divisibility in Integral Domains

Fundamental definitions do not arise at the start but at the end of the exploration, because in order to define a thing you must know what it is and what it is good for.

Hans Freudenthal, *Developments in Mathematical Education*

Give me a fruitful error anytime, full of seeds, bursting with its own corrections. You can keep your sterile truth for yourself.

Vilfredo Pareto

### Irreducibles, Primes

In the preceding two chapters, we focused on factoring polynomials over the integers or a field. Several of those results—unique factorization in  $\mathbb{Z}[x]$  and the division algorithm for  $F[x]$ , for instance—are natural counterparts to theorems about the integers. In this chapter and the next, we examine factoring in a more abstract setting.

#### **Definition Associates, Irreducibles, Primes**

Elements  $a$  and  $b$  of an integral domain  $D$  are called *associates* if  $a = ub$ , where  $u$  is a unit of  $D$ . A nonzero element  $a$  of an integral domain  $D$  is called an *irreducible* if  $a$  is not a unit and, whenever  $b, c \in D$  with  $a = bc$ , then  $b$  or  $c$  is a unit. A nonzero element  $a$  of an integral domain  $D$  is called a *prime* if  $a$  is not a unit and  $a \mid bc$  implies  $a \mid b$  or  $a \mid c$ .

Roughly speaking, an irreducible is an element that can be factored only in a trivial way. Notice that an element  $a$  is a prime if and only if  $\langle a \rangle$  is a prime ideal.

Relating the definitions above to the integers may seem a bit confusing, since in Chapter 0 we defined a positive integer to be a prime if it satisfies our definition of an irreducible, and we proved that a prime integer satisfies the definition of a prime in an integral domain (Euclid's Lemma). The source of the confusion is that in the case of the integers,

the concepts of irreducibles and primes are equivalent, but in general, as we will soon see, they are not.

The distinction between primes and irreducibles is best illustrated by integral domains of the form  $Z[\sqrt{d}] = \{a + b\sqrt{d} \mid a, b \in Z\}$ , where  $d$  is not 1 and is not divisible by the square of a prime. (These rings are of fundamental importance in number theory.) To analyze these rings, we need a convenient method of determining their units, irreducibles, and primes. To do this, we define a function  $N$ , called the *norm*, from  $Z[\sqrt{d}]$  into the nonnegative integers by  $N(a + b\sqrt{d}) = |a^2 - db^2|$ . We leave it to the reader (Exercise 1) to verify the following four properties:  $N(x) = 0$  if and only if  $x = 0$ ;  $N(xy) = N(x)N(y)$  for all  $x$  and  $y$ ;  $x$  is a unit if and only if  $N(x) = 1$ ; and, if  $N(x)$  is prime, then  $x$  is irreducible in  $Z[\sqrt{d}]$ .

■ **EXAMPLE 1** We exhibit an irreducible in  $Z[\sqrt{-3}]$  that is not prime. Here,  $N(a + b\sqrt{-3}) = a^2 + 3b^2$ . Consider  $1 + \sqrt{-3}$ . Suppose that we can factor this as  $xy$ , where neither  $x$  nor  $y$  is a unit. Then  $N(xy) = N(x)N(y) = N(1 + \sqrt{-3}) = 4$ , and it follows that  $N(x) = 2$ . But there are no integers  $a$  and  $b$  that satisfy  $a^2 + 3b^2 = 2$ . Thus,  $x$  or  $y$  is a unit and  $1 + \sqrt{-3}$  is an irreducible. To verify that it is not prime, we observe that  $(1 + \sqrt{-3})(1 - \sqrt{-3}) = 4 = 2 \cdot 2$ , so that  $1 + \sqrt{-3}$  divides  $2 \cdot 2$ . On the other hand, for integers  $a$  and  $b$  to exist so that  $2 = (1 + \sqrt{-3})(a + b\sqrt{-3}) = (a - 3b) + (a + b)\sqrt{-3}$ , we must have  $a - 3b = 2$  and  $a + b = 0$ , which is impossible. ■

Showing that an element of a ring of the form  $Z[\sqrt{d}]$  is irreducible is more difficult when  $d > 1$ . The next example illustrates one method of doing this. The example also shows that the converse of the fourth property above for the norm is not true. That is, it shows that  $x$  may be irreducible even if  $N(x)$  is not prime.

■ **EXAMPLE 2** The element 7 is irreducible in the ring  $Z[\sqrt{5}]$ . To verify this assertion, suppose that  $7 = xy$ , where neither  $x$  nor  $y$  is a unit. Then  $49 = N(7) = N(x)N(y)$ , and since  $x$  is not a unit, we cannot have  $N(x) = 1$ . This leaves only the case  $N(x) = 7$ . Let  $x = a + b\sqrt{5}$ . Then there are integers  $a$  and  $b$  satisfying  $|a^2 - 5b^2| = 7$ . This means that  $a^2 - 5b^2 = \pm 7$ . Viewing this equation modulo 5 and trying all possible cases for  $a$  reveals that there are no solutions. ■

Example 1 raises the question of whether or not there is an integral domain containing a prime that is not an irreducible. The answer: no.

### ■ Theorem 18.1 Prime Implies Irreducible

*In an integral domain, every prime is an irreducible.*

**PROOF** Suppose that  $a$  is a prime in an integral domain and  $a = bc$ . We must show that  $b$  or  $c$  is a unit. By the definition of prime, we know that  $a \mid b$  or  $a \mid c$ . Say  $at = b$ . Then  $1b = b = at = (bc)t = b(ct)$  and, by cancellation,  $1 = ct$ . Thus,  $c$  is a unit. ■

Recall that a principal ideal domain is an integral domain in which every ideal has the form  $\langle a \rangle$ . The next theorem reveals a circumstance in which primes and irreducibles are equivalent.

## ■ Theorem 18.2 PID Implies Irreducible Equals Prime

*In a principal ideal domain, an element is an irreducible if and only if it is a prime.*

**PROOF** Theorem 18.1 shows that primes are irreducibles. To prove the converse, let  $a$  be an irreducible element of a principal ideal domain  $D$  and suppose that  $a \mid bc$ . We must show that  $a \mid b$  or  $a \mid c$ . Consider the ideal  $I = \{ax + by \mid x, y \in D\}$  and let  $\langle d \rangle = I$ . Since  $a \in I$ , we can write  $a = dr$ , and because  $a$  is irreducible,  $d$  is a unit or  $r$  is a unit. If  $d$  is a unit, then  $I = D$  and we may write  $1 = ax + by$ . Then  $c = acx + bcy$ , and since  $a$  divides both terms on the right,  $a$  also divides  $c$ .

On the other hand, if  $r$  is a unit, then  $\langle a \rangle = \langle d \rangle = I$ , and, because  $b \in I$ , there is an element  $t$  in  $D$  such that  $at = b$ . Thus,  $a$  divides  $b$ . ■

It is an easy consequence of the respective division algorithms for  $Z$  and  $F[x]$ , where  $F$  is a field, that  $Z$  and  $F[x]$  are principal ideal domains (see Exercise 43 in Chapter 14 and Theorem 16.3). Our next example shows, however, that one of the most familiar rings is not a principal ideal domain.

**EXAMPLE 3** We show that  $Z[x]$  is not a principal ideal domain. Consider the ideal  $I = \langle 2, x \rangle$ . We claim that  $I$  is not of the form  $\langle h(x) \rangle$ . If this were so, there would be  $f(x)$  and  $g(x)$  in  $Z[x]$  such that  $2 = h(x)f(x)$  and  $x = h(x)g(x)$ , since both  $2$  and  $x$  belong to  $I$ . By the degree rule (Exercise 19 in Chapter 16),  $0 = \deg 2 = \deg h(x) + \deg f(x)$ , so that  $h(x)$  is a constant polynomial. To determine which constant, we observe that  $2 = h(1)f(1)$ . Thus,  $h(1) = \pm 1$  or  $\pm 2$ . Since  $1$  is not in  $I$ , we must have  $h(x) = \pm 2$ . But then  $x = \pm 2g(x)$ , which is nonsense. ■

We have previously proved that the integral domains  $Z$  and  $Z[x]$  have important factorization properties: Every integer greater than 1 can be uniquely factored as a product of irreducibles (that is, primes), and every nonzero, nonunit polynomial can be uniquely factored as a product of



irreducible polynomials. It is natural to ask whether all integral domains have this property. The question of unique factorization in integral domains first arose with the efforts to solve a famous problem in number theory that goes by the name Fermat's Last Theorem.

## Historical Discussion of Fermat's Last Theorem

There are infinitely many nonzero integers  $x, y, z$  that satisfy the equation  $x^2 + y^2 = z^2$ . But what about the equation  $x^3 + y^3 = z^3$  or, more generally,  $x^n + y^n = z^n$ , where  $n$  is an integer greater than 2 and  $x, y, z$  are nonzero integers? Well, no one has ever found a single solution of this equation, and for more than three centuries many have tried to prove that there is none. The tremendous effort put forth by the likes of Euler, Legendre, Abel, Gauss, Dirichlet, Cauchy, Kummer, Kronecker, and Hilbert to prove that there are no solutions to this equation has greatly influenced the development of ring theory.

About a thousand years ago, Arab mathematicians gave an incorrect proof that there were no solutions when  $n = 3$ . The problem lay dormant until 1637, when the French mathematician Pierre de Fermat (1601–1665) wrote in the margin of a book, “. . . it is impossible to separate a cube into two cubes, a fourth power into two fourth powers, or, generally, any power above the second into two powers of the same degree: I have discovered a truly marvelous demonstration [of this general theorem] which this margin is too narrow to contain.”

Because Fermat gave no proof, many mathematicians tried to prove the result. The case where  $n = 3$  was done by Euler in 1770, although his proof was incomplete. The case where  $n = 4$  is elementary and was done by Fermat himself. The case where  $n = 5$  was done in 1825 by Dirichlet, who had just turned 20, and by Legendre, who was past 70. Since the validity of the case for a particular integer implies the validity for all multiples of that integer, the next case of interest was  $n = 7$ . This case resisted the efforts of the best mathematicians until it was done by Gabriel Lamé in 1839. In 1847, Lamé stirred excitement by announcing that he had completely solved the problem. His approach was to factor the expression  $x^p + y^p$ , where  $p$  is an odd prime, into

$$(x + y)(x + \alpha y) \cdots (x + \alpha^{p-1}y),$$

where  $\alpha$  is the complex number  $\cos(2\pi/p) + i \sin(2\pi/p)$ . Thus, his factorization took place in the ring  $Z[\alpha] = \{a_0 + a_1\alpha + \cdots + a_{p-1}\alpha^{p-1} \mid a_i \in Z\}$ . But Lamé made the mistake of assuming that, in such a ring,

factorization into the product of irreducibles is unique. In fact, three years earlier, Ernst Eduard Kummer had proved that this is not always the case. Undaunted by the failure of unique factorization, Kummer began developing a theory to “save” factorization by creating a new type of number. Within a few weeks of Lamé’s announcement, Kummer had shown that Fermat’s Last Theorem is true for all primes of a special type. This proved that the theorem was true for all exponents less than 100, prime or not, except for 37, 59, 67, and 74. Kummer’s work has led to the theory of ideals as we know it today.

Over the centuries, many proposed proofs have not held up under scrutiny. The famous number theorist Edmund Landau received so many of these that he had a form printed with “On page \_\_\_\_\_, lines \_\_\_\_\_ to \_\_\_\_\_, you will find there is a mistake.” Martin Gardner, “Mathematical Games” columnist of *Scientific American*, had postcards printed to decline requests from readers asking him to examine their proofs.

Recent discoveries tying Fermat’s Last Theorem closely to modern mathematical theories gave hope that these theories might eventually lead to a proof. In March 1988, newspapers and scientific publications worldwide carried news of a proof by Yoichi Miyaoka (see Figure 18.1). Within weeks, however, Miyaoka’s proof was shown to be invalid. In June 1993, excitement spread through the mathematics community with the announcement that Andrew Wiles of Princeton University had proved Fermat’s Last Theorem (see Figure 18.2). The Princeton mathematics department chairperson was quoted as saying, “When we heard it, people starting walking on air.” But guess what. Yes, you guessed it. Once again a proof did not hold up under scrutiny. This story does have a happy ending. The mathematical community has agreed on the validity of the revised proof given by Wiles and Richard Taylor in September of 1994.

In view of the fact that so many eminent mathematicians were unable to prove Fermat’s Last Theorem, despite the availability of the vastly powerful theories, it seems highly improbable that Fermat had a correct proof. Most likely, he made the error that his successors made of assuming that the properties of integers, such as unique factorization, carry over to integral domains in general.



Figure 18.1

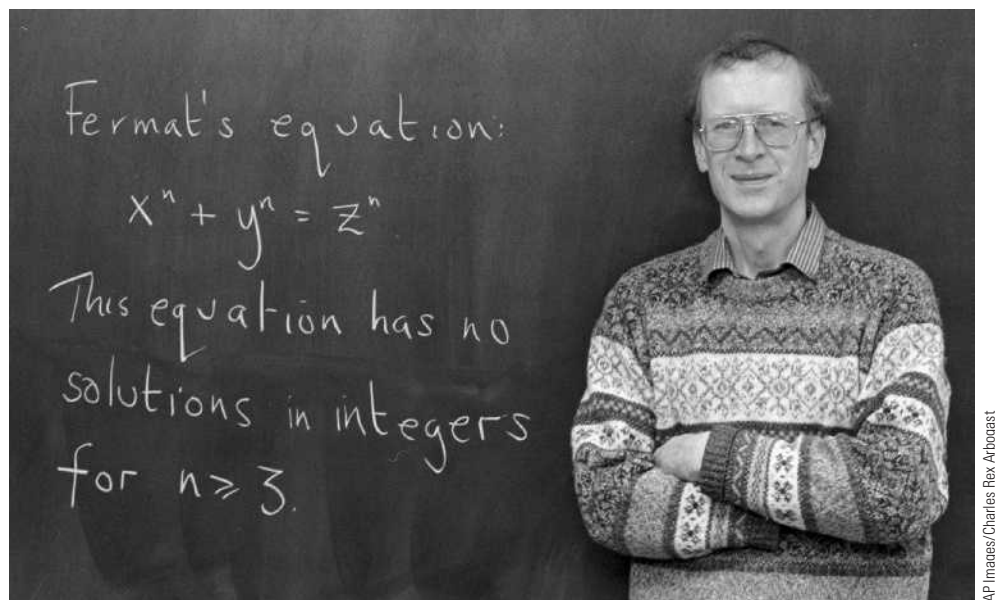


Figure 18.2 Andrew Wiles

## Unique Factorization Domains

We now have the necessary terminology to formalize the idea of unique factorization.

### Definition Unique Factorization Domain (UFD)

An integral domain  $D$  is a *unique factorization domain* if

1. every nonzero element of  $D$  that is not a unit can be written as a product of irreducibles of  $D$ ; and
2. the factorization into irreducibles is unique up to associates and the order in which the factors appear.

Another way to formulate part 2 of this definition is the following: If  $p_1^{n_1}p_2^{n_2} \cdots p_r^{n_r}$  and  $q_1^{m_1}q_2^{m_2} \cdots q_s^{m_s}$  are two factorizations of some element as a product of irreducibles, where no two of the  $p_i$ 's are associates and no two of the  $q_j$ 's are associates, then  $r = s$ , each  $p_i$  is an associate of one and only one  $q_j$ , and  $n_i = m_j$ .

Of course, the Fundamental Theorem of Arithmetic tells us that the ring of integers is a unique factorization domain, and Theorem 17.6 says that  $\mathbb{Z}[x]$  is a unique factorization domain. In fact, as we shall soon see, most of the integral domains we have encountered are unique factorization domains.

Before proving our next theorem, we need the ascending chain condition for ideals.

### ■ Lemma Ascending Chain Condition for a PID

*In a principal ideal domain, any strictly increasing chain of ideals  $I_1 \subset I_2 \subset \cdots$  must be finite in length.*

**PROOF** Let  $I_1 \subset I_2 \subset \cdots$  be a chain of strictly increasing ideals in an integral domain  $D$ , and let  $I$  be the union of all the ideals in this chain. We leave it as an exercise (Exercise 3) to verify that  $I$  is an ideal of  $D$ .

Then, since  $D$  is a principal ideal domain, there is an element  $a$  in  $D$  such that  $I = \langle a \rangle$ . Because  $a \in I$  and  $I = \bigcup I_k$ ,  $a$  belongs to some member of the chain, say  $a \in I_n$ . Clearly, then, for any member  $I_i$  of the chain, we have  $I_i \subseteq I = \langle a \rangle \subseteq I_n$ , so that  $I_n$  must be the last member of the chain. ■

### ■ Theorem 18.3 PID Implies UFD

*Every principal ideal domain is a unique factorization domain.*

**PROOF** Let  $D$  be a principal ideal domain and let  $a_0$  be any nonzero nonunit in  $D$ . We will show that  $a_0$  is a product of irreducibles (the product might consist of only one factor). We begin by showing that  $a_0$  has at least one irreducible factor. If  $a_0$  is irreducible, we are done. Thus, we may assume that  $a_0 = b_1 a_1$ , where neither  $b_1$  nor  $a_1$  is a unit and  $a_1$  is nonzero. If  $a_1$  is not irreducible, then we can write  $a_1 = b_2 a_2$ , where neither  $b_2$  nor  $a_2$  is a unit and  $a_2$  is nonzero. Continuing in this fashion, we obtain a sequence  $b_1, b_2, \dots$  of elements that are not units in  $D$  and a sequence  $a_0, a_1, a_2, \dots$  of nonzero elements of  $D$  with  $a_n = b_{n+1} a_{n+1}$  for each  $n$ . Hence,  $\langle a_0 \rangle \subset \langle a_1 \rangle \subset \cdots$  is a strictly increasing chain of ideals (see Exercise 5), which, by the preceding lemma, must be finite, say,  $\langle a_0 \rangle \subset \langle a_1 \rangle \subset \cdots \subset \langle a_r \rangle$ . In particular,  $a_r$  is an irreducible factor of  $a_0$ . This argument shows that every nonzero nonunit in  $D$  has at least one irreducible factor.

Now write  $a_0 = p_1 c_1$ , where  $p_1$  is irreducible and  $c_1$  is not a unit. If  $c_1$  is not irreducible, then we can write  $c_1 = p_2 c_2$ , where  $p_2$  is irreducible and  $c_2$  is not a unit. Continuing in this fashion, we obtain, as before, a strictly increasing sequence  $\langle a_0 \rangle \subset \langle c_1 \rangle \subset \langle c_2 \rangle \subset \cdots$ , which must end in a finite number of steps. Let us say that the sequence ends with  $\langle c_s \rangle$ . Then  $c_s$  is irreducible and  $a_0 = p_1 p_2 \cdots p_s c_s$ , where each  $p_i$  is also irreducible. This completes the proof that every nonzero nonunit of a principal ideal domain is a product of irreducibles.

It remains to be shown that the factorization is unique up to associates and the order in which the factors appear. To do this, suppose that some element  $a$  of  $D$  can be written

$$a = p_1 p_2 \cdots p_r = q_1 q_2 \cdots q_s,$$

where the  $p$ 's and  $q$ 's are irreducible and repetition is permitted. We use induction on  $r$ . If  $r = 1$ , then  $a$  is irreducible and, clearly,  $s = 1$  and  $p_1 = q_1$ . So we may assume that any element that can be expressed as a product of fewer than  $r$  irreducible factors can be so expressed in only one way (up to order and associates). Since  $D$  is a principal ideal domain, by Theorem 18.2, each irreducible  $p_i$  in the product  $p_1 p_2 \cdots p_r$  is prime. Then because  $p_1$  divides  $q_1 q_2 \cdots q_s$ ,  $p_1$  must divide some  $q_i$  (see Exercise 33), say  $p_1 \mid q_1$ . Then,  $q_1 = up_1$ , where  $u$  is a unit of  $D$ . Since

$$up_1 p_2 \cdots p_r = u q_1 q_2 \cdots q_s = q_1 (u q_2) \cdots q_s$$

and

$$up_1 = q_1,$$

we have, by cancellation,

$$p_2 \cdots p_r = (u q_2) \cdots q_s.$$

The induction hypothesis now tells us that these two factorizations are identical up to associates and the order in which the factors appear. Hence, the same is true about the two factorizations of  $a$ . ■

In the existence portion of the proof of Theorem 18.3, the only way we used the fact that the integral domain  $D$  is a principal ideal domain was to say that  $D$  has the property that there is no infinite, strictly increasing chain of ideals in  $D$ . An integral domain with this property is called a *Noetherian domain*, in honor of Emmy Noether, who inaugurated the use of chain conditions in algebra. Noetherian domains are of the utmost importance in algebraic geometry. One reason for this is that, for many important rings  $R$ , the polynomial ring  $R[x]$  is a Noetherian domain but not a principal ideal domain. One such example is  $\mathbb{Z}[x]$ . In particular,  $\mathbb{Z}[x]$  shows that a UFD need not be a PID (see Example 3).

As an immediate corollary of Theorem 18.3, we have the following fact.

### Corollary $F[x]$ Is a UFD

*Let  $F$  be a field. Then  $F[x]$  is a unique factorization domain.*

**PROOF** By Theorem 16.3,  $F[x]$  is a principal ideal domain. So,  $F[x]$  is a unique factorization domain, as well. ■

As an application of the preceding corollary, we give an elegant proof, due to Richard Singer, of Eisenstein's Criterion (Theorem 17.4).

■ **EXAMPLE 4** Let

$$f(x) = a_n x^n + a_{n-1} x^{n-1} + \cdots + a_0 \in Z[x],$$

and suppose that  $p$  is prime such that

$$p \nmid a_n, p \mid a_{n-1}, \dots, p \mid a_0 \quad \text{and} \quad p^2 \nmid a_0.$$

We will prove that  $f(x)$  is irreducible over  $Q$ . If  $f(x)$  is reducible over  $Q$ , we know by Theorem 17.2 that there exist elements  $g(x)$  and  $h(x)$  in  $Z[x]$  such that  $f(x) = g(x)h(x)$ ,  $1 \leq \deg g(x) < n$ , and  $1 \leq \deg h(x) < n$ . Let  $\bar{f}(x)$ ,  $\bar{g}(x)$ , and  $\bar{h}(x)$  be the polynomials in  $Z_p[x]$  obtained from  $f(x)$ ,  $g(x)$ , and  $h(x)$  by reducing all coefficients modulo  $p$ . Then, since  $p$  divides all the coefficients of  $f(x)$  except  $a_n$ , we have  $\bar{a}_n x^n = \bar{f}(x) = \bar{g}(x) \cdot \bar{h}(x)$ . Since  $Z_p$  is a field,  $Z_p[x]$  is a unique factorization domain. Thus,  $x \mid \bar{g}(x)$  and  $x \mid \bar{h}(x)$ . So,  $\bar{g}(0) = \bar{h}(0) = 0$  and, therefore,  $p \mid g(0)$  and  $p \mid h(0)$ . But then  $p^2 \mid g(0)h(0) = f(0) = a_0$ , which is a contradiction. ■

## Euclidean Domains

Another important kind of integral domain is a Euclidean domain.

### Definition Euclidean Domain (ED)

An integral domain  $D$  is called a *Euclidean domain* if there is a function  $d$  (called the *measure*) from the nonzero elements of  $D$  to the nonnegative integers such that

1.  $d(a) \leq d(ab)$  for all nonzero  $a, b$  in  $D$ ; and
2. if  $a, b \in D$ ,  $b \neq 0$ , then there exist elements  $q$  and  $r$  in  $D$  such that  $a = bq + r$ , where  $r = 0$  or  $d(r) < d(b)$ .

■ **EXAMPLE 5** The ring  $Z$  is a Euclidean domain with  $d(a) = |a|$  (the absolute value of  $a$ ). ■

■ **EXAMPLE 6** Let  $F$  be a field. Then  $F[x]$  is a Euclidean domain with  $d(f(x)) = \deg f(x)$  (see Theorem 16.2). ■

Examples 5 and 6 illustrate just one of many similarities between the rings  $Z$  and  $F[x]$ . Additional similarities are summarized in Table 18.1.

**Table 18.1** Similarities Between  $Z$  and  $F[x]$

| $Z$                                                                                                |                   | $F[x]$                                                                                                                                                          |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Euclidean domain:                                                                                  | $\leftrightarrow$ | Euclidean domain:                                                                                                                                               |
| $d(a) =  a $                                                                                       |                   | $d(f(x)) = \deg f(x)$                                                                                                                                           |
| Units:                                                                                             |                   | Units:                                                                                                                                                          |
| $a$ is a unit if and only if $ a  = 1$                                                             |                   | $f(x)$ is a unit if and only if $\deg f(x) = 0$                                                                                                                 |
| Division algorithm:                                                                                | $\leftrightarrow$ | Division algorithm:                                                                                                                                             |
| For $a, b \in Z$ , $b \neq 0$ , there exist $q, r \in Z$ such that $a = bq + r$ , $0 \leq r <  b $ |                   | For $f(x), g(x) \in F[x]$ , $g(x) \neq 0$ , there exist $q(x), r(x) \in F[x]$ such that $f(x) = g(x)q(x) + r(x)$ , $0 \leq \deg r(x) < \deg g(x)$ or $r(x) = 0$ |
| PID:                                                                                               | $\leftrightarrow$ | PID:                                                                                                                                                            |
| Every nonzero ideal $I = \langle a \rangle$ , where $a \neq 0$ and $ a $ is minimum                |                   | Every nonzero ideal $I = \langle f(x) \rangle$ , where $\deg f(x)$ is minimum                                                                                   |
| Prime:                                                                                             | $\leftrightarrow$ | Irreducible:                                                                                                                                                    |
| No nontrivial factors                                                                              |                   | No nontrivial factors                                                                                                                                           |
| UFD:                                                                                               | $\leftrightarrow$ | UFD:                                                                                                                                                            |
| Every element is a “unique” product of primes                                                      |                   | Every element is a “unique” product of irreducibles                                                                                                             |

■ **EXAMPLE 7** The ring of Gaussian integers

$$Z[i] = \{a + bi \mid a, b \in Z\}$$

is a Euclidean domain with  $d(a + bi) = a^2 + b^2$ . Unlike the previous two examples, in this example the function  $d$  does not obviously satisfy the necessary conditions. That  $d(x) \leq d(xy)$  for  $x, y \in Z[i]$  follows directly from the fact that  $d(xy) = d(x)d(y)$  (Exercise 7). To verify that condition 2 holds, observe that if  $x, y \in Z[i]$  and  $y \neq 0$ , then  $xy^{-1} \in Q[i]$ , the field of quotients of  $Z[i]$  (Exercise 57 in Chapter 15). Say  $xy^{-1} = s + ti$ , where  $s, t \in Q$ . Now let  $m$  be the integer nearest  $s$ , and let  $n$  be the integer nearest  $t$ . (These integers may not be uniquely determined, but that does not matter.) Thus,  $|m - s| \leq 1/2$  and  $|n - t| \leq 1/2$ . Then

$$\begin{aligned} xy^{-1} = s + ti &= (m - m + s) + (n - n + t)i \\ &= (m + ni) + [(s - m) + (t - n)i]. \end{aligned}$$

So,

$$x = (m + ni)y + [(s - m) + (t - n)i]y.$$

We claim that the division condition of the definition of a Euclidean domain is satisfied with  $q = m + ni$  and

$$r = [(s - m) + (t - n)i]y.$$



Clearly,  $q$  belongs to  $Z[i]$ , and since  $r = x - qy$ , so does  $r$ . Finally,

$$\begin{aligned} d(r) &= d[(s - m) + (t - n)i]d(y) \\ &= [(s - m)^2 + (t - n)^2]d(y) \\ &\leq \left(\frac{1}{4} + \frac{1}{4}\right)d(y) < d(y). \end{aligned}$$

■

### ■ Theorem 18.4 ED Implies PID

*Every Euclidean domain is a principal ideal domain.*

**PROOF** Let  $D$  be a Euclidean domain and  $I$  a nonzero ideal of  $D$ . Among all the nonzero elements of  $I$ , let  $a$  be such that  $d(a)$  is a minimum. Then  $I = \langle a \rangle$ . For, if  $b \in I$ , there are elements  $q$  and  $r$  such that  $b = aq + r$ , where  $r = 0$  or  $d(r) < d(a)$ . But  $r = b - aq \in I$ , so  $d(r)$  cannot be less than  $d(a)$ . Thus,  $r = 0$  and  $b \in \langle a \rangle$ . Finally, the zero ideal is  $\langle 0 \rangle$ . ■

Although it is not easy to verify, we remark that there are principal ideal domains that are not Euclidean domains. The first such example was given by T. Motzkin in 1949. A more accessible account of Motzkin's result can be found in [2].

As an immediate consequence of Theorems 18.3 and 18.4, we have the following important result.

### ■ Corollary ED Implies UFD

*Every Euclidean domain is a unique factorization domain.*

We may summarize our theorems and remarks as follows:

$$\begin{aligned} \text{ED} &\Rightarrow \text{PID} \Rightarrow \text{UFD}; \\ \text{UFD} &\not\Rightarrow \text{PID} \not\Rightarrow \text{ED}. \end{aligned}$$

(You can remember these implications by listing the types alphabetically.)

In Chapter 17, we proved that  $Z[x]$  is a unique factorization domain. Since  $Z$  is a unique factorization domain, the next theorem is a broad generalization of this fact. The proof is similar to that of the special case, and we therefore omit it.

### ■ Theorem 18.5 $D$ a UFD Implies $D[x]$ a UFD

*If  $D$  is a unique factorization domain, then  $D[x]$  is a unique factorization domain.*

We conclude this chapter with an example of an integral domain that is not a unique factorization domain.

■ **EXAMPLE 8** The ring  $Z[\sqrt{-5}] = \{a + b\sqrt{-5} \mid a, b \in Z\}$  is an integral domain but not a unique factorization domain. It is straightforward that  $Z[\sqrt{-5}]$  is an integral domain (see Exercise 11 in Chapter 13). To verify that unique factorization does not hold, we mimic the method used in Example 1 with  $N(a + b\sqrt{-5}) = a^2 + 5b^2$ . Since  $N(xy) = N(x)N(y)$  and  $N(x) = 1$  if and only if  $x$  is a unit (see Exercise 1), it follows that the only units of  $Z[\sqrt{-5}]$  are  $\pm 1$ .

Now consider the following factorizations:

$$\begin{aligned} 46 &= 2 \cdot 23, \\ 46 &= (1 + 3\sqrt{-5})(1 - 3\sqrt{-5}). \end{aligned}$$

We claim that each of these four factors is irreducible over  $Z[\sqrt{-5}]$ . Suppose that, say,  $2 = xy$ , where  $x, y \in Z[\sqrt{-5}]$  and neither is a unit. Then  $4 = N(2) = N(x)N(y)$  and, therefore,  $N(x) = N(y) = 2$ , which is impossible. Likewise, if  $23 = xy$  were a nontrivial factorization, then  $N(x) = 23$ . Thus, there would be integers  $a$  and  $b$  such that  $a^2 + 5b^2 = 23$ . Clearly, no such integers exist. The same argument applies to  $1 \pm 3\sqrt{-5}$ . ■

In light of Examples 7 and 8, one can't help but wonder for which  $d < 0$  is  $Z[\sqrt{d}]$  a unique factorization domain. The answer is only when  $d = -1$  or  $-2$  (see [1], p. 297). The case where  $d = -1$  was first proved, naturally enough, by Gauss.

## Exercises

I tell them that if they will occupy themselves with the study of mathematics they will find in it the best remedy against lust of the flesh.

Thomas Mann, *The Magic Mountain*

1. For the ring  $Z[\sqrt{d}] = \{a + b\sqrt{d} \mid a, b \in Z\}$ , where  $d \neq 1$  and  $d$  is not divisible by the square of a prime, prove that the norm  $N(a + b\sqrt{d}) = |a^2 - db^2|$  satisfies the four assertions made preceding Example 1. (This exercise is referred to in this chapter.)
2. In an integral domain, show that  $a$  and  $b$  are associates if and only if  $\langle a \rangle = \langle b \rangle$ .
3. Show that the union of a chain  $I_1 \subset I_2 \subset \cdots$  of ideals of a ring  $R$  is an ideal of  $R$ . (This exercise is referred to in this chapter.)

4. In an integral domain, show that the product of an irreducible and a unit is an irreducible.
5. Suppose that  $a$  and  $b$  belong to an integral domain and  $b \neq 0$ . Show that  $\langle ab \rangle$  is a proper subset of  $\langle b \rangle$  if and only if  $a$  is not a unit. This exercise is referred to in this chapter.
6. Let  $D$  be an integral domain. Define  $a \sim b$  if  $a$  and  $b$  are associates. Show that this defines an equivalence relation on  $D$ .
7. In the notation of Example 7, show that  $d(xy) = d(x)d(y)$ .
8. Let  $D$  be a Euclidean domain with measure  $d$ . Prove that  $u$  is a unit in  $D$  if and only if  $d(u) = d(1)$ .
9. Let  $D$  be a Euclidean domain with measure  $d$ . Show that if  $a$  and  $b$  are associates in  $D$ , then  $d(a) = d(b)$ .
10. Let  $D$  be a principal ideal domain and let  $p \in D$ . Prove that  $\langle p \rangle$  is a maximal ideal in  $D$  if and only if  $p$  is irreducible.
11. Trace through the argument given in Example 7 to find  $q$  and  $r$  in  $Z[i]$  such that  $3 - 4i = (2 + 5i)q + r$  and  $d(r) < d(2 + 5i)$ .
12. Let  $D$  be a principal ideal domain. Show that every proper ideal of  $D$  is contained in a maximal ideal of  $D$ .
13. In  $Z[\sqrt{-5}]$ , show that 21 does not factor uniquely as a product of irreducibles.
14. Show that  $1 - i$  is an irreducible in  $Z[i]$ .
15. Show that  $Z[\sqrt{-6}]$  is not a unique factorization domain. (*Hint:* Factor 10 in two ways.) Why does this show that  $Z[\sqrt{-6}]$  is not a principal ideal domain?
16. Give an example of a unique factorization domain with a subdomain that does not have a unique factorization.
17. In  $Z[i]$ , show that 3 is irreducible but 2 and 5 are not.
18. Prove that 7 is irreducible in  $Z[\sqrt{6}]$ , even though  $N(7)$  is not prime.
19. Prove that if  $p$  is a prime in  $Z$  that can be written in the form  $a^2 + b^2$ , then  $a + bi$  is irreducible in  $Z[i]$ . Find three primes that have this property and the corresponding irreducibles.
20. Prove that  $Z[\sqrt{-3}]$  is not a principal ideal domain.
21. In  $Z[\sqrt{-5}]$ , prove that  $1 + 3\sqrt{-5}$  is irreducible but not prime.
22. In  $Z[\sqrt{5}]$ , prove that both 2 and  $1 + \sqrt{5}$  are irreducible but not prime.
23. Prove that  $Z[\sqrt{5}]$  is not a unique factorization domain.
24. Let  $F$  be a field. Show that in  $F[x]$  a prime ideal is a maximal ideal.
25. Let  $d$  be an integer less than  $-1$  that is not divisible by the square of a prime. Prove that the only units of  $Z[\sqrt{d}]$  are  $+1$  and  $-1$ .

26. In  $Z[\sqrt{2}] = \{a + b\sqrt{2} \mid a, b \in Z\}$ , show that every element of the form  $(3 + 2\sqrt{2})^n$  is a unit, where  $n$  is a positive integer.
27. If  $a$  and  $b$  belong to  $Z[\sqrt{d}]$ , where  $d$  is not divisible by the square of a prime and  $ab$  is a unit, prove that  $a$  and  $b$  are units.
28. For a commutative ring with unity we may define associates, irreducibles, and primes exactly as we did for integral domains. With these definitions, show that both 2 and 3 are prime in  $Z_{12}$  but 2 is irreducible and 3 is not.
29. Let  $n$  be a positive integer and  $p$  a prime that divides  $n$ . Prove that  $p$  is prime in  $Z_n$ . (See Exercise 28).
30. Let  $p$  be a prime divisor of a positive integer  $n$ . Prove that  $p$  is irreducible in  $Z_n$  if and only if  $p^2$  divides  $n$ . (See Exercise 28).
31. Prove or disprove that if  $D$  is a principal ideal domain, then  $D[x]$  is a principal ideal domain.
32. Determine the units in  $Z[i]$ .
33. Let  $p$  be a prime in an integral domain. If  $p \mid a_1 a_2 \cdots a_n$ , prove that  $p$  divides some  $a_i$ . (This exercise is referred to in this chapter.)
34. Show that  $3x^2 + 4x + 3 \in Z_5[x]$  factors as  $(3x + 2)(x + 4)$  and  $(4x + 1)(2x + 3)$ . Explain why this does not contradict the corollary of Theorem 18.3.
35. Let  $D$  be a principal ideal domain and  $p$  an irreducible element of  $D$ . Prove that  $D/\langle p \rangle$  is a field.
36. Show that an integral domain with the property that every strictly decreasing chain of ideals  $I_1 \supset I_2 \supset \cdots$  must be finite in length is a field.
37. An ideal  $A$  of a commutative ring  $R$  with unity is said to be *finitely generated* if there exist elements  $a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n$  of  $A$  such that  $A = \langle a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n \rangle$ . An integral domain  $R$  is said to satisfy the *ascending chain condition* if every strictly increasing chain of ideals  $I_1 \subset I_2 \subset \cdots$  must be finite in length. Show that an integral domain  $R$  satisfies the ascending chain condition if and only if every ideal of  $R$  is finitely generated.
38. Prove or disprove that a subdomain of a Euclidean domain is a Euclidean domain.
39. Show that for any nontrivial ideal  $I$  of  $Z[i]$ ,  $Z[i]/I$  is finite.
40. Find the inverse of  $1 + \sqrt{2}$  in  $Z[\sqrt{2}]$ . What is the multiplicative order of  $1 + \sqrt{2}$ ?
41. In  $Z[\sqrt{-7}]$ , show that  $N(6 + 2\sqrt{-7}) = N(1 + 3\sqrt{-7})$  but  $6 + 2\sqrt{-7}$  and  $1 + 3\sqrt{-7}$  are not associates.

42. Let  $R = \mathbb{Z} \oplus \mathbb{Z} \oplus \cdots$  (the collection of all sequences of integers under componentwise addition and multiplication). Show that  $R$  has ideals  $I_1, I_2, I_3, \dots$  with the property that  $I_1 \subset I_2 \subset I_3 \subset \cdots$ . (Thus  $R$  does not have the ascending chain condition.)
43. Prove that in a unique factorization domain, an element is irreducible if and only if it is prime.
44. Let  $F$  be a field and let  $R$  be the integral domain in  $F[x]$  generated by  $x^2$  and  $x^3$ . (That is,  $R$  is contained in every integral domain in  $F[x]$  that contains  $x^2$  and  $x^3$ .) Show that  $R$  is not a unique factorization domain.
45. Prove that for every field  $F$ , there are infinitely many irreducible elements in  $F[x]$ .
46. Prove that  $\mathbb{Z}[\sqrt{-2}]$  and  $\mathbb{Z}[\sqrt{2}]$  are unique factorization domains. (*Hint*: Mimic Example 7 in Chapter 18.)
47. Express both 13 and  $5 + i$  as products of irreducibles from  $\mathbb{Z}[i]$ .
48. Find a mistake in the statement shown in Figure 18.2.

## Computer Exercise

Software for a computer exercise is available at the website:

<http://www.d.umn.edu/~jgallian>

## References

1. H. M. Stark, *An Introduction to Number Theory*, Chicago: Markham, 1970.
2. J. C. Wilson, "A Principal Ideal Ring That Is Not a Euclidean Ring," *Mathematics Magazine* 46 (1973): 34–38.

## Suggested Readings

Oscar Campoli, "A Principal Ideal Domain That Is Not a Euclidean Domain," *The American Mathematical Monthly* 95 (1988): 868–871.

The author shows that  $\{a + b\theta \mid a, b \in \mathbb{Z}, \theta = (1 + \sqrt{-19})/2\}$  is a PID that is not an ED.

Gina Kolata, "At Last, Shout of 'Eureka!' in Age-Old Math Mystery," *The New York Times*, June 24, 1993.

This front-page article reports on Andrew Wiles's announced proof of Fermat's Last Theorem.

C. Krauthhammer, “The Joy of Math, or Fermat’s Revenge,” *Time*, April 18, 1988: 92.

The demise of Miyaoka’s proof of Fermat’s Last Theorem is charmingly lamented.

Sahib Singh, “Non-Euclidean Domains: An Example,” *Mathematics Magazine* 49 (1976): 243.

This article gives a short proof that  $Z[\sqrt{-n}] = \{a + b\sqrt{-n} \mid a, b \in Z\}$  is an integral domain that is not Euclidean when  $n > 2$  and  $-n \bmod 4 = 2$  or  $-n \bmod 4 = 3$ .

Simon Singh and Kenneth Ribet, “Fermat’s Last Stand,” *Scientific American* 277 (1997): 68–73.

This article gives an accessible description of Andrew Wiles’s proof of Fermat’s Last Theorem.

## Suggested Video

*The Proof*, Nova, <http://www.pbs.org/wgbh/nova/proof>

This documentary film shown on PBS’s *Nova* program in 1997 chronicles the seven-year effort of Andrew Wiles to prove Fermat’s Last Theorem. It can be viewed in five segments at <http://www.youtube.com>.

## Suggested Websites

[http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Fermat's\\_Last\\_Theorem](http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Fermat's_Last_Theorem)

This website provides a concise history of the efforts to prove Fermat’s Last Theorem. It includes photographs, references, and links.

# Sophie Germain

One of the very few women to overcome the prejudice and discrimination that tended to exclude women from the pursuit of higher mathematics in her time was Sophie Germain.



Stock Montage

SOPHIE GERMAIN was born in Paris on April 1, 1776. She educated herself by reading the works of Newton and Euler in Latin and the lecture notes of Lagrange. In 1804, Germain wrote to Gauss about her work in number theory but used the pseudonym Monsieur LeBlanc because she feared that Gauss would not take seriously the efforts of a woman. Gauss gave Germain's results high praise and a few years later, upon learning her true identity, wrote to her:

But how to describe to you my admiration and astonishment at seeing my esteemed correspondent Mr. LeBlanc metamorphose himself into this illustrious personage who gives such a brilliant example of what I would find it difficult to believe. A taste for the abstract sciences in general and above all the mysteries of numbers is excessively rare: it is not a subject which strikes everyone; the enchanting charms of this sublime science reveal

themselves only to those who have the courage to go deeply into it. But when a person of the sex which, according to our customs and prejudices, must encounter infinitely more difficulties than men to familiarize herself with these thorny researches, succeeds nevertheless in surmounting these obstacles and penetrating the most obscure parts of them, then without doubt she must have the noblest courage, quite extraordinary talents, and a superior genius.\*

Germain is best known for her work on Fermat's Last Theorem. She died on June 27, 1831, in Paris.

For more information about Germain, visit:

**<http://www-groups.dcs.st-and.ac.uk/~history>**

\*Quote from *Math's Hidden Woman*, Nova Online, <http://www.pbs.org/wgbh/nova/proof/germain.html> (accessed Nov 5, 2008).

## Andrew Wiles

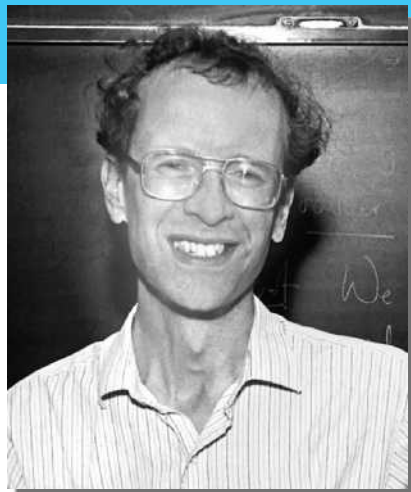
For spectacular contributions to number theory and related fields, for major advances on fundamental conjectures, and for settling Fermat's Last Theorem.

*Citation for the Wolf Prize*



Postage stamp issued by the Czech Republic in honor of Fermat's Last Theorem.

IN 1993, ANDREW WILES of Princeton electrified the mathematics community by announcing that he had proved Fermat's Last Theorem after seven years of effort. His proof, which ran 200 pages, relied heavily on ring theory and group theory. Because of Wiles's solid reputation and because his approach was based on deep results that had already shed much light on the problem, many experts in the field believed that Wiles had succeeded where so many others had failed. Wiles's achievement was reported in newspapers and magazines around the world. *The New York Times* ran a front-page story on it, and one TV network announced it on the evening news. Wiles even made *People* magazine's list of the 25 most intriguing people of 1993! In San Francisco a group of mathematicians rented a 1200-seat movie theater and sold tickets for \$5.00



Princeton University

each for public lectures on the proof. Scalpers received as much as \$25.00 a ticket for the sold-out event.

The bubble soon burst when experts had an opportunity to scrutinize Wiles's manuscript. By December, Wiles released a statement saying he was working to resolve a gap in the proof. In September of 1994, a paper by Wiles and Richard Taylor, a former student of his, circumvented the gap in the original proof. Since then, many experts have checked the proof and have found no errors. One mathematician was quoted as saying, "The exuberance is back." In 1997, Wiles's proof was the subject of a PBS *Nova* program.

Wiles was born in 1953 in Cambridge, England. He obtained his bachelor's degree at Oxford and his doctoral degree at Cambridge University in 1980. He was a professor at Oxford, where a building is named in his honor. Among his many prestigious awards is the Fermat prize for his research on Fermat's Last Theorem.

To find more information about Wiles, visit:

<http://www-groups.dcs.st-and.ac.uk/~history/>



# Pierre de Fermat

This theorem [Fermat's Little Theorem] is one of the great tools of modern number theory.

WILLIAM DUNHAM



Marzolino/Shutterstock.com

Pierre de Fermat (pronounced Fair-mah) was born in Beaumont-de-Lomagne, France in August of 1601 and died in 1665. Fermat obtained a Bachelor's degree in civil law from the University of Orleans in 1631. While earning his living practicing law he did mathematics as a hobby. Rather than proving and publishing theorems he sent the statements of his results and questions to leading mathematicians. One of his important observations is that any prime of the form  $4k + 1$  can be written as the sum of two squares in one and only one way, whereas a prime of the form  $4k - 1$  cannot be written as the sum of two squares in any manner whatever. Mathematics historian William Dunham asserts that Fermat's discovery of this dichotomy among primes ranks as one of the landmarks of number theory. Addressing Fermat's contributions to number theory André

Weil wrote that "... what we possess of his methods for dealing with curves of genus 1 is remarkably coherent; it is still the foundation for the modern theory of such curves." A Wikipedia article on Fermat concluded with the statement "Fermat essentially created the modern theory of numbers."

Beyond his contributions to number theory, Fermat found a law of optics and is considered as one of the founders of analytic geometry and probability theory. In 1989 the Institut de Mathématiques de Toulouse in France established the Fermat prize for research in fields in which Fermat made major contributions. Among the recipients are Andrew Wiles and Richard Taylor.

To find more information about Fermat, visit

**[https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Pierre\\_de\\_Fermat](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Pierre_de_Fermat)**



PART

4

Fields



# 19 Vector Spaces

Still round the corner there may wait  
A new road or a secret gate.

J. R. R. Tolkien, *The Fellowship of the Ring*

The art of doing mathematics consists in finding that special case  
which contains all the germs of generality.

David Hilbert (1862–1943)

## Definition and Examples

Abstract algebra has three basic components: groups, rings, and fields. Thus far we have covered groups and rings in some detail, and we have touched on the notion of a field. To explore fields more deeply, we need some rudiments of vector space theory that are covered in a linear algebra course. In this chapter, we provide a concise review of this material.

### Definition Vector Space

A set  $V$  is said to be a *vector space* over a field  $F$  if  $V$  is an Abelian group under addition (denoted by  $+$ ) and, if for each  $a \in F$  and  $v \in V$ , there is an element  $av$  in  $V$  such that the following conditions hold for all  $a, b$  in  $F$  and all  $u, v$  in  $V$ .

1.  $a(v + u) = av + au$
2.  $(a + b)v = av + bv$
3.  $a(bv) = (ab)v$
4.  $1v = v$

The members of a vector space are called *vectors*. The members of the field are called *scalars*. The operation that combines a scalar  $a$  and a vector  $v$  to form the vector  $av$  is called *scalar multiplication*. In general, we will denote vectors by letters from the end of the alphabet, such as  $u, v, w$ , and scalars by letters from the beginning of the alphabet, such as  $a, b, c$ .

■ **EXAMPLE 1** The set  $\mathbf{R}^n = \{(a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n) \mid a_i \in \mathbf{R}\}$  is a vector space over  $\mathbf{R}$ . Here the operations are the obvious ones:

$$(a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n) + (b_1, b_2, \dots, b_n) = (a_1 + b_1, a_2 + b_2, \dots, a_n + b_n)$$

and

$$b(a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n) = (ba_1, ba_2, \dots, ba_n). \quad \blacksquare$$

■ **EXAMPLE 2** The set  $M_2(Q)$  of  $2 \times 2$  matrices with entries from  $Q$  is a vector space over  $Q$ . The operations are

$$\begin{bmatrix} a_1 & a_2 \\ a_3 & a_4 \end{bmatrix} + \begin{bmatrix} b_1 & b_2 \\ b_3 & b_4 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} a_1 + b_1 & a_2 + b_2 \\ a_3 + b_3 & a_4 + b_4 \end{bmatrix}$$

and

$$b \begin{bmatrix} a_1 & a_2 \\ a_3 & a_4 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} ba_1 & ba_2 \\ ba_3 & ba_4 \end{bmatrix}. \quad \blacksquare$$

■ **EXAMPLE 3** The set  $Z_p[x]$  of polynomials with coefficients from  $Z_p$  is a vector space over  $Z_p$ , where  $p$  is a prime. ■

■ **EXAMPLE 4** The set of complex numbers  $\mathbf{C} = \{a + bi \mid a, b \in \mathbf{R}\}$  is a vector space over  $\mathbf{R}$ . The vector addition and scalar multiplication are the usual addition and multiplication of complex numbers. ■

The next example is a generalization of Example 4. Although it appears rather trivial, it is of the utmost importance in the theory of fields.

■ **EXAMPLE 5** Let  $E$  be a field and let  $F$  be a subfield of  $E$ . Then  $E$  is a vector space over  $F$ . The vector addition and scalar multiplication are the operations of  $E$ . ■

## Subspaces

Of course, there is a natural analog of subgroup and subring.

### Definition Subspace

Let  $V$  be a vector space over a field  $F$  and let  $U$  be a subset of  $V$ . We say that  $U$  is a *subspace* of  $V$  if  $U$  is also a vector space over  $F$  under the operations of  $V$ .

■ **EXAMPLE 6** The set  $\{a_2x^2 + a_1x + a_0 \mid a_0, a_1, a_2 \in \mathbf{R}\}$  is a subspace of the vector space of all polynomials with real coefficients over  $\mathbf{R}$ . ■

■ **EXAMPLE 7** Let  $V$  be a vector space over  $F$  and let  $v_1, v_2, \dots, v_n$  be (not necessarily distinct) elements of  $V$ . Then the subset

$$\langle v_1, v_2, \dots, v_n \rangle = \{a_1v_1 + a_2v_2 + \dots + a_nv_n \mid a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n \in F\}$$

is called the *subspace of  $V$  spanned by  $v_1, v_2, \dots, v_n$* . Any sum of the form  $a_1v_1 + a_2v_2 + \dots + a_nv_n$  is called a *linear combination of  $v_1, v_2, \dots, v_n$* . If  $\langle v_1, v_2, \dots, v_n \rangle = V$ , we say that  $\{v_1, v_2, \dots, v_n\}$  *spans  $V$* . ■

## Linear Independence

The next definition is the heart of the theory.

### Definition Linearly Dependent, Linearly Independent

A set  $S$  of vectors is said to be *linearly dependent* over the field  $F$  if there are vectors  $v_1, v_2, \dots, v_n$  from  $S$  and elements  $a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n$  from  $F$ , not all zero, such that  $a_1v_1 + a_2v_2 + \dots + a_nv_n = 0$ . A set of vectors that is not linearly dependent over  $F$  is called *linearly independent* over  $F$ .

In other words, a set of vectors is linearly dependent over  $F$  if there is a nontrivial linear combination of them over  $F$  equal to 0.

■ **EXAMPLE 8** In  $\mathbf{R}^3$  the vectors  $(1, 0, 0)$ ,  $(1, 0, 1)$ , and  $(1, 1, 1)$  are linearly independent over  $\mathbf{R}$ . To verify this, assume that there are real numbers  $a$ ,  $b$ , and  $c$  such that  $a(1, 0, 0) + b(1, 0, 1) + c(1, 1, 1) = (0, 0, 0)$ . Then  $(a + b + c, c, b + c) = (0, 0, 0)$ . From this we see that  $a = b = c = 0$ . ■

Certain kinds of linearly independent sets play a crucial role in the theory of vector spaces.

### Definition Basis

Let  $V$  be a vector space over  $F$ . A subset  $B$  of  $V$  is called a *basis* for  $V$  if  $B$  is linearly independent over  $F$  and every element of  $V$  is a linear combination of elements of  $B$ .

The motivation for this definition is twofold. First, if  $B$  is a basis for a vector space  $V$ , then every member of  $V$  is a unique linear combination of the elements of  $B$  (see Exercise 19). Second, with every vector space spanned by finitely many vectors, we can use the notion of basis to associate a unique integer that tells us much about the vector space. (In fact, this integer and the field completely determine the vector space up to isomorphism—see Exercise 31.)

■ **EXAMPLE 9** The set  $V = \left\{ \begin{bmatrix} a & a+b \\ a+b & b \end{bmatrix} \mid a, b \in \mathbf{R} \right\}$

is a vector space over  $\mathbf{R}$  (see Exercise 17). We claim that the set

$B = \left\{ \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 \end{bmatrix}, \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \right\}$  is a basis for  $V$  over  $\mathbf{R}$ . To prove that the set

$B$  is linearly independent, suppose that there are real numbers  $a$  and  $b$  such that

$$a \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 \end{bmatrix} + b \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 \end{bmatrix}.$$

This gives  $\begin{bmatrix} a & a+b \\ a+b & b \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 \end{bmatrix}$ , so that  $a = b = 0$ . On the other

hand, since every member of  $V$  has the form

$$\begin{bmatrix} a & a+b \\ a+b & b \end{bmatrix} = a \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 \end{bmatrix} + b \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix},$$

we see that  $B$  spans  $V$ . ■

We now come to the main result of this chapter.

### ■ Theorem 19.1 Invariance of Basis Size

*If  $\{u_1, u_2, \dots, u_m\}$  and  $\{w_1, w_2, \dots, w_n\}$  are both bases of a vector space  $V$  over a field  $F$ , then  $m = n$ .*

**PROOF** Suppose that  $m \neq n$ . To be specific, let us say that  $m < n$ . Consider the set  $\{w_1, u_1, u_2, \dots, u_m\}$ . Since the  $u$ 's span  $V$ , we know that  $w_1$  is a linear combination of the  $u$ 's, say,  $w_1 = a_1 u_1 + a_2 u_2 + \dots + a_m u_m$ , where the  $a$ 's belong to  $F$ . Clearly, not all the  $a$ 's are 0. For convenience, say  $a_1 \neq 0$ . Then  $\{w_1, u_2, \dots, u_m\}$  spans  $V$  (see Exercise 21). Next, consider the set  $\{w_1, w_2, u_2, \dots, u_m\}$ . This time,  $w_2$  is a linear combination of  $w_1, u_2, \dots, u_m$ , say,  $w_2 = b_1 w_1 + b_2 u_2 + \dots + b_m u_m$ , where the  $b$ 's belong to  $F$ . Then at least one of  $b_2, \dots, b_m$  is nonzero, for otherwise the  $w$ 's are not linearly independent. Let us say  $b_2 \neq 0$ . Then  $w_1, w_2, u_3, \dots, u_m$  span  $V$ . Continuing in this fashion, we see that  $\{w_1, w_2, \dots, w_m\}$  spans  $V$ . But then  $w_{m+1}$  is a linear combination of  $w_1, w_2, \dots, w_m$  and, therefore, the set  $\{w_1, \dots, w_n\}$  is not linearly independent. This contradiction finishes the proof. ■

Theorem 19.1 shows that any two finite bases for a vector space have the same size. Of course, not all vector spaces have finite bases. However,



there is no vector space that has a finite basis and an infinite basis (see Exercise 25).

### Definition Dimension

A vector space that has a basis consisting of  $n$  elements is said to have *dimension  $n$* . For completeness, the trivial vector space  $\{0\}$  is said to be spanned by the empty set and to have dimension 0.

Although it requires a bit of set theory that is beyond the scope of this text, it can be shown that every vector space has a basis. A vector space that has a finite basis is called *finite dimensional*; otherwise, it is called *infinite dimensional*.

## Exercises

Somebody who thinks logically is a nice contrast to the real world.

The Law of Thumb

1. Verify that each of the sets in Examples 1–4 satisfies the axioms for a vector space. Find a basis for each of the vector spaces in Examples 1–4.
2. (Subspace Test) Prove that a nonempty subset  $U$  of a vector space  $V$  over a field  $F$  is a subspace of  $V$  if, for every  $u$  and  $u' \in U$  and every  $a$  in  $F$ ,  $u + u' \in U$  and  $au \in U$ . (In words, a nonempty set  $U$  is a subspace of  $V$  if it is closed under the two operations of  $V$ .)
3. Verify that the set in Example 6 is a subspace. Find a basis for this subspace. Is  $\{x^2 + x + 1, x + 5, 3\}$  a basis?
4. Verify that the set  $\langle v_1, v_2, \dots, v_n \rangle$  defined in Example 7 is a subspace.
5. Determine whether or not the set  $\{(2, -1, 0), (1, 2, 5), (7, -1, 5)\}$  is linearly independent over  $\mathbf{R}$ .
6. Determine whether or not the set

$$\left\{ \begin{bmatrix} 2 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 \end{bmatrix}, \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ 1 & 2 \end{bmatrix}, \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \right\}$$

is linearly independent over  $Z_5$ .

7. If  $\{u, v, w\}$  is a linearly independent subset of a vector space, show that  $\{u, u + v, u + v + w\}$  is also linearly independent.
8. If  $\{v_1, v_2, \dots, v_n\}$  is a linearly dependent set of vectors, prove that one of these vectors is a linear combination of the other.
9. (Every spanning collection contains a basis.) If  $\{v_1, v_2, \dots, v_n\}$  spans a vector space  $V$ , prove that some subset of the  $v$ 's is a basis for  $V$ .

10. (Every independent set is contained in a basis.) Let  $V$  be a finite-dimensional vector space and let  $\{v_1, v_2, \dots, v_n\}$  be a linearly independent subset of  $V$ . Show that there are vectors  $w_1, w_2, \dots, w_m$  such that  $\{v_1, v_2, \dots, v_n, w_1, \dots, w_m\}$  is a basis for  $V$ .
11. If  $V$  is a vector space over  $F$  of dimension 5 and  $U$  and  $W$  are subspaces of  $V$  of dimension 3, prove that  $U \cap W \neq \{0\}$ . Generalize.
12. Show that the solution set to a system of equations of the form

$$\begin{array}{rcl} a_{11}x_1 + \cdots + a_{1n}x_n & = & 0 \\ a_{21}x_1 + \cdots + a_{2n}x_n & = & 0 \\ \cdot & & \cdot \\ \cdot & & \cdot \\ \cdot & & \cdot \\ a_{m1}x_1 + \cdots + a_{mn}x_n & = & 0, \end{array}$$

where the  $a$ 's are real, is a subspace of  $\mathbf{R}^n$ .

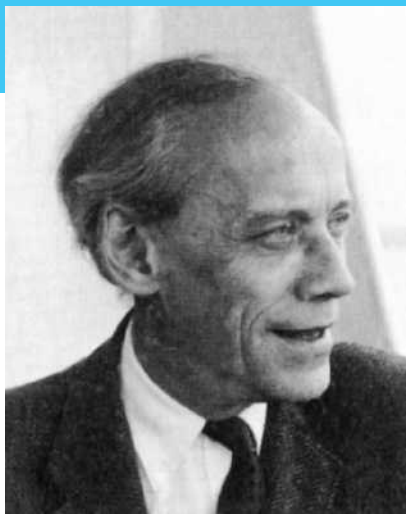
13. Let  $V$  be the set of all polynomials over  $Q$  of degree 2 together with the zero polynomial. Is  $V$  a vector space over  $Q$ ?
14. Let  $V = \mathbf{R}^3$  and  $W = \{(a, b, c) \in V \mid a^2 + b^2 = c^2\}$ . Is  $W$  a subspace of  $V$ ? If so, what is its dimension?
15. Let  $V = \mathbf{R}^3$  and  $W = \{(a, b, c) \in V \mid a + b = c\}$ . Is  $W$  a subspace of  $V$ ? If so, what is its dimension?
16. Let  $V = \left\{ \begin{bmatrix} a & b \\ b & c \end{bmatrix} \mid a, b, c \in Q \right\}$ . Prove that  $V$  is a vector space over  $Q$ , and find a basis for  $V$  over  $Q$ .
17. Verify that the set  $V$  in Example 9 is a vector space over  $\mathbf{R}$ .
18. Let  $P = \{(a, b, c) \mid a, b, c \in \mathbf{R}, a = 2b + 3c\}$ . Prove that  $P$  is a subspace of  $\mathbf{R}^3$ . Find a basis for  $P$ . Give a geometric description of  $P$ .
19. Let  $B$  be a subset of a vector space  $V$ . Show that  $B$  is a basis for  $V$  if and only if every member of  $V$  is a unique linear combination of the elements of  $B$ . (This exercise is referred to in this chapter and in Chapter 20.)
20. If  $U$  is a proper subspace of a finite-dimensional vector space  $V$ , show that the dimension of  $U$  is less than the dimension of  $V$ .
21. Referring to the proof of Theorem 19.1, prove that  $\{w_1, u_2, \dots, u_m\}$  spans  $V$ .
22. If  $V$  is a vector space of dimension  $n$  over the field  $Z_p$ , how many elements are in  $V$ ?
23. Let  $S = \{(a, b, c, d) \mid a, b, c, d \in \mathbf{R}, a = c, d = a + b\}$ . Find a basis for  $S$ .

24. Let  $U$  and  $W$  be subspaces of a vector space  $V$ . Show that  $U \cap W$  is a subspace of  $V$  and that  $U + W = \{u + w \mid u \in U, w \in W\}$  is a subspace of  $V$ .
25. If a vector space has one basis that contains infinitely many elements, prove that every basis contains infinitely many elements. (This exercise is referred to in this chapter.)
26. Let  $u = (2, 3, 1)$ ,  $v = (1, 3, 0)$ , and  $w = (2, -3, 3)$ . Since  $(1/2)u - (2/3)v - (1/6)w = (0, 0, 0)$ , can we conclude that the set  $\{u, v, w\}$  is linearly dependent over  $Z_7$ ?
27. Define the vector space analog of group homomorphism and ring homomorphism. Such a mapping is called a *linear transformation*. Define the vector space analog of group isomorphism and ring isomorphism.
28. Let  $T$  be a linear transformation from  $V$  to  $W$ . Prove that the image of  $V$  under  $T$  is a subspace of  $W$ .
29. Let  $T$  be a linear transformation of a vector space  $V$ . Prove that  $\{v \in V \mid T(v) = 0\}$ , the *kernel* of  $T$ , is a subspace of  $V$ .
30. Let  $T$  be a linear transformation of  $V$  onto  $W$ . If  $\{v_1, v_2, \dots, v_n\}$  spans  $V$ , show that  $\{T(v_1), T(v_2), \dots, T(v_n)\}$  spans  $W$ .
31. If  $V$  is a vector space over  $F$  of dimension  $n$ , prove that  $V$  is isomorphic as a vector space to  $F^n = \{(a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n) \mid a_i \in F\}$ . (This exercise is referred to in this chapter.)
32. Show that it is impossible to find a basis for the vector space of  $n \times n$  ( $n > 1$ ) matrices such that each pair of elements in the basis commutes under multiplication.
33. Let  $P_n = \{a_n x^n + a_{n-1} x^{n-1} + \dots + a_1 x + a_0 \mid \text{each } a_i \text{ is a real number}\}$ . Is it possible to have a basis for  $P_n$  such that every element of the basis has  $x$  as a factor?
34. Find a basis for the vector space  $\{f \in P_3 \mid f(0) = 0\}$ . (See Exercise 33 for notation.)
35. Given that  $f$  is a polynomial of degree  $n$  in  $P_n$ , show that  $\{f, f', f'', \dots, f^{(n)}\}$  is a basis for  $P_n$ . ( $f^{(k)}$  denotes the  $k$ th derivative of  $f$ .)
36. Prove that for a vector space  $V$  over a field that does not have characteristic 2, the hypothesis that  $V$  is commutative under addition is redundant.
37. Let  $V$  be a vector space over an infinite field. Prove that  $V$  is not the union of finitely many proper subspaces of  $V$ .

## Emil Artin

For Artin, to be a mathematician meant to participate in a great common effort, to continue work begun thousands of years ago, to shed new light on old discoveries, to seek new ways to prepare the developments of the future. Whatever standards we use, he was a great mathematician.

RICHARD BRAUER,  
*Bulletin of the American  
Mathematical Society*



Massachusetts Institute of Technology

EMIL ARTIN was one of the leading mathematicians of the 20th century and a major contributor to linear algebra and abstract algebra. Artin was born on March 3, 1898, in Vienna, Austria, and grew up in what was recently known as Czechoslovakia. He received a Ph.D. in 1921 from the University of Leipzig. Artin was a professor at the University of Hamburg from 1923 until he was barred from employment in Nazi Germany in 1937 because his wife had a Jewish grandparent. His family emigrated to the United States where he spent one year at Notre Dame then eight years at Indiana University. In 1946 he moved to Princeton, where he stayed until 1958. The last four years of his career were spent where it began, at Hamburg.

Artin's mathematics is both deep and broad. He made contributions to number theory, group theory, ring theory, field theory, Galois theory, geometric algebra, algebraic topology, and the theory of braids—a field he invented. Artin received the American

Mathematical Society's Cole Prize in number theory, and he solved one of the 23 famous problems posed by the eminent mathematician David Hilbert in 1900.

Eminent mathematician Hermann Weyl said of Artin "I look upon his early work in algebra and number theory as one of the few big mathematical events I have witnessed in my lifetime. A genius, aglow with the fire of ideas—that was the impression he gave in those years."

Artin was an outstanding teacher of mathematics at all levels, from freshman calculus to seminars for colleagues. Many of his Ph.D. students as well as his son Michael have become leading mathematicians. Through his research, teaching, and books, Artin exerted great influence among his contemporaries. He died of a heart attack, at the age of 64, in 1962.

For more information about Artin, visit:

[http://www-groups.dcs  
.st-and.ac.uk/~history/](http://www-groups.dcs.st-and.ac.uk/~history/)

## Olga Taussky-Todd

“Olga Taussky-Todd was a distinguished and prolific mathematician who wrote about 300 papers.”

EDITH LUCHINS AND MARY ANN McLOUGHLIN,  
*Notices of the American  
Mathematical Society, 1996*



Courtesy of Edith H. Luchins, Professor of Mathematics  
and Adjunct Professor of Cognitive Science Emerita

OLGA TAUSSKY-TODD was born on August 30, 1906, in Olmütz in the Austro-Hungarian Empire. Taussky-Todd received her doctoral degree in 1930 from the University of Vienna. In the early 1930s she was hired as an assistant at the University of Göttingen to edit books on the work of David Hilbert. She also edited lecture notes of Emil Artin and assisted Richard Courant. She spent 1934 and 1935 at Bryn Mawr and the next two years at Girton College in Cambridge, England. In 1937, she taught at the University of London. In 1947, she moved to the United States and took a job at the National Bureau of Standards' National Applied Mathematics Laboratory. In 1957, she became the first woman to teach at the California Institute of Technology as well as the first woman to receive tenure and a full professorship in mathematics, physics, or astronomy there. Thirteen Caltech Ph.D. students wrote their Ph.D. theses under her direction.

In addition to her influential contributions to linear algebra, Taussky-Todd did important work in number theory.

Taussky-Todd received many honors and awards. She was elected a Fellow of the American Association for the Advancement of Science and vice president of the American Mathematical Society. In 1990, Caltech established an instructorship named in her honor. Taussky-Todd died on October 7, 1995, at the age of 89.

For more information about Taussky-Todd, visit:

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.edu/lriddle/women/women.htm](http://www.agnesscott.edu/lriddle/women/women.htm)**

# 20

## Extension Fields

Viewed with perfect hindsight, there were many occasions during the history of algebra when new number systems had to be *created*, or *constructed*, in order to provide roots for certain polynomials.

Norman J. Block, *Abstract Algebra with Applications*

In many respects this [Kronecker's Theorem] is the fundamental theorem of algebra.

Richard A. Dean, *Elements of Abstract Algebra*

### The Fundamental Theorem of Field Theory

In our work on rings, we came across a number of fields, both finite and infinite. Indeed, we saw that  $Z_3[x]/\langle x^2 + 1 \rangle$  is a field of order 9, whereas  $\mathbf{R}[x]/\langle x^2 + 1 \rangle$  is a field isomorphic to the complex numbers. In the next three chapters, we take up, in a systematic way, the subject of fields.

#### Definition Extension Field

A field  $E$  is an *extension field* of a field  $F$  if  $F \subseteq E$  and the operations of  $F$  are those of  $E$  restricted to  $F$ .

Cauchy's observation in 1847 that  $\mathbf{R}[x]/\langle x^2 + 1 \rangle$  is a field that contains a zero of  $x^2 + 1$  prepared the way for the following sweeping generalization of that fact.

#### ■ Theorem 20.1 Fundamental Theorem of Field Theory (Kronecker's Theorem, 1887)

*Let  $F$  be a field and let  $f(x)$  be a nonconstant polynomial in  $F[x]$ . Then there is an extension field  $E$  of  $F$  in which  $f(x)$  has a zero.*

**PROOF** Since  $F[x]$  is a unique factorization domain,  $f(x)$  has an irreducible factor, say,  $p(x)$ . Clearly, it suffices to construct an extension field  $E$  of  $F$  in which  $p(x)$  has a zero. Our candidate for  $E$  is  $F[x]/\langle p(x) \rangle$ . We already know that this is a field from Corollary 1 of Theorem 17.5. Also, since the mapping of  $\phi: F \rightarrow E$  given by  $\phi(a) = a + \langle p(x) \rangle$  is one-to-one and preserves both operations,  $E$  has a subfield isomorphic to  $F$ . We may think of  $E$  as containing  $F$  if we simply identify the coset  $a + \langle p(x) \rangle$  with its unique coset representative  $a$  that belongs to  $F$  [that is, think of  $a + \langle p(x) \rangle$  as just  $a$  and vice versa; see Exercise 37 in Chapter 17].

Finally, to show that  $p(x)$  has a zero in  $E$ , write

$$p(x) = a_n x^n + a_{n-1} x^{n-1} + \cdots + a_0.$$

Then, in  $E$ ,  $x + \langle p(x) \rangle$  is a zero of  $p(x)$ , because

$$\begin{aligned} p(x + \langle p(x) \rangle) &= a_n (x + \langle p(x) \rangle)^n + a_{n-1} (x + \langle p(x) \rangle)^{n-1} + \cdots + a_0 \\ &= a_n (x^n + \langle p(x) \rangle) + a_{n-1} (x^{n-1} + \langle p(x) \rangle) + \cdots + a_0 \\ &= a_n x^n + a_{n-1} x^{n-1} + \cdots + a_0 + \langle p(x) \rangle \\ &= p(x) + \langle p(x) \rangle = 0 + \langle p(x) \rangle. \end{aligned}$$

■ **EXAMPLE 1** Let  $f(x) = x^2 + 1 \in Q[x]$ . Then, viewing  $f(x)$  as an element of  $E[x] = (Q[x]/\langle x^2 + 1 \rangle)[x]$ , we have

$$\begin{aligned} f(x + \langle x^2 + 1 \rangle) &= (x + \langle x^2 + 1 \rangle)^2 + 1 \\ &= x^2 + \langle x^2 + 1 \rangle + 1 \\ &= x^2 + 1 + \langle x^2 + 1 \rangle \\ &= 0 + \langle x^2 + 1 \rangle. \end{aligned}$$

Of course, the polynomial  $x^2 + 1$  has the complex number  $\sqrt{-1}$  as a zero, but the point we wish to emphasize here is that we have constructed a field that contains the rational numbers and a zero for the polynomial  $x^2 + 1$  by using only the rational numbers. No knowledge of complex numbers is necessary. Our method utilizes only the field we are given. ■

■ **EXAMPLE 2** Let  $f(x) = x^5 + 2x^2 + 2x + 2 \in Z_3[x]$ . Then, the irreducible factorization of  $f(x)$  over  $Z_3$  is  $(x^2 + 1)(x^3 + 2x + 2)$ . So, to find an extension  $E$  of  $Z_3$  in which  $f(x)$  has a zero, we may take  $E = Z_3[x]/\langle x^2 + 1 \rangle$ , a field with nine elements, or  $E = Z_3[x]/\langle x^3 + 2x + 2 \rangle$ , a field with 27 elements. ■

Since every integral domain is contained in its field of quotients (Theorem 15.6), we see that every nonconstant polynomial with coefficients from an integral domain always has a zero in some field containing the ring of coefficients. The next example shows that this is not true for commutative rings in general.

■ **EXAMPLE 3** Let  $f(x) = 2x + 1 \in Z_4[x]$ . Then  $f(x)$  has no zero in any ring containing  $Z_4$  as a subring, because if  $\beta$  were a zero in such a ring, then  $0 = 2\beta + 1$ , and therefore  $0 = 2(2\beta + 1) = 2(2\beta) + 2 = (2 \cdot 2)\beta + 2 = 0 \cdot \beta + 2 = 2$ . But  $0 \neq 2$  in  $Z_4$ . ■

## Splitting Fields

To motivate the next definition and theorem, let's return to Example 1 for a moment. For notational convenience, in  $Q[x]/\langle x^2 + 1 \rangle$ , let  $\alpha = x + \langle x^2 + 1 \rangle$ . Then, since  $\alpha$  and  $-\alpha$  are both zeros of  $x^2 + 1$  in  $(Q[x]/\langle x^2 + 1 \rangle)[x]$ , it should be the case that  $x^2 + 1 = (x - \alpha)(x + \alpha)$ . Let's check this out. First note that

$$(x - \alpha)(x + \alpha) = x^2 - \alpha^2 = x^2 - (x^2 + \langle x^2 + 1 \rangle).$$

At the same time,

$$x^2 + \langle x^2 + 1 \rangle = -1 + \langle x^2 + 1 \rangle$$

and we have agreed to identify  $-1$  and  $-1 + \langle x^2 + 1 \rangle$ , so

$$(x - \alpha)(x + \alpha) = x^2 - (-1) = x^2 + 1.$$

This shows that  $x^2 + 1$  can be written as a product of linear factors in some extension of  $Q$ . That was easy and you might argue coincidental. The polynomial given in Example 2 presents a greater challenge. Is there an extension of  $Z_3$  in which that polynomial factors as a product of linear factors? Yes, there is. But first some notation and a definition.

Let  $F$  be a field and let  $a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n$  be elements of some extension  $E$  of  $F$ . We use  $F(a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n)$  to denote the smallest subfield of  $E$  that contains  $F$  and the set  $\{a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n\}$ . We leave it as an exercise (Exercise 37) to show that  $F(a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n)$  is the intersection of all subfields of  $E$  that contain  $F$  and the set  $\{a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n\}$ .

### Definition Splitting Field

Let  $E$  be an extension field of  $F$  and let  $f(x) \in F[x]$  with degree at least

1. We say that  $f(x)$  *splits* in  $E$  if there are elements  $a \in F$  and  $a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n \in E$  such that

$$f(x) = a(x - a_1)(x - a_2) \cdots (x - a_n).$$

We call  $E$  a *splitting field* for  $f(x)$  over  $F$  if

$$E = F(a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n).$$

Note that a splitting field of a polynomial over a field depends not only on the polynomial but on the field as well. Indeed, a splitting field of  $f(x)$  over  $F$  is just a smallest extension field of  $F$  in which  $f(x)$  splits.



The next example illustrates how a splitting field of a polynomial  $f(x)$  over field  $F$  depends on  $F$ .

■ **EXAMPLE 4** Consider the polynomial  $f(x) = x^2 + 1 \in Q[x]$ . Since  $x^2 + 1 = (x + \sqrt{-1})(x - \sqrt{-1})$ , we see that  $f(x)$  splits in  $\mathbf{C}$ , but a splitting field over  $Q$  is  $Q(i) = \{r + si \mid r, s \in Q\}$ . A splitting field for  $x^2 + 1$  over  $\mathbf{R}$  is  $\mathbf{C}$ . Likewise,  $x^2 - 2 \in Q[x]$  splits in  $\mathbf{R}$ , but a splitting field over  $Q$  is  $Q(\sqrt{2}) = \{r + s\sqrt{2} \mid r, s \in Q\}$ . ■

There is a useful analogy between the definition of a splitting field and the definition of an irreducible polynomial. Just as it makes no sense to say “ $f(x)$  is irreducible,” it makes no sense to say “ $E$  is a splitting field for  $f(x)$ .” In each case, the underlying field must be specified; that is, one must say “ $f(x)$  is irreducible over  $F$ ” and “ $E$  is a splitting field for  $f(x)$  over  $F$ .”

Our notation in Example 4 appears to be inconsistent with the notation that we used in earlier chapters. For example, we denoted the set  $\{a + b\sqrt{2} \mid a, b \in Z\}$  by  $Z[\sqrt{2}]$  and the set  $\{a + b\sqrt{2} \mid a, b \in Q\}$  by  $Q(\sqrt{2})$ . The difference is that  $Z[\sqrt{2}]$  is merely a ring, whereas  $Q(\sqrt{2})$  is a field. In general, parentheses are used when one wishes to indicate that the set is a field, although no harm would be done by using, say,  $Q[\sqrt{2}]$  to denote  $\{a + b\sqrt{2} \mid a, b \in Q\}$  if we were concerned with its ring properties only. Using parentheses rather than brackets simply conveys a bit more information about the set.

## ■ Theorem 20.2 Existence of Splitting Fields

*Let  $F$  be a field and let  $f(x)$  be a nonconstant element of  $F[x]$ . Then there exists a splitting field  $E$  for  $f(x)$  over  $F$ .*

**PROOF** We proceed by induction on  $\deg f(x)$ . If  $\deg f(x) = 1$ , then  $f(x)$  is linear. Now suppose that the statement is true for all fields and all polynomials of degree less than that of  $f(x)$ . By Theorem 20.1, there is an extension  $E$  of  $F$  in which  $f(x)$  has a zero, say,  $a_1$ . Then we may write  $f(x) = (x - a_1)g(x)$ , where  $g(x) \in E[x]$ . Since  $\deg g(x) < \deg f(x)$ , by induction, there is a field  $K$  that contains  $E$  and all the zeros of  $g(x)$ , say,  $a_2, \dots, a_n$ . Clearly, then, a splitting field for  $f(x)$  over  $F$  is  $F(a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n)$ . ■

■ **EXAMPLE 5** Consider

$$f(x) = x^4 - x^2 - 2 = (x^2 - 2)(x^2 + 1)$$

over  $Q$ . Obviously, the zeros of  $f(x)$  in  $\mathbf{C}$  are  $\pm\sqrt{2}$  and  $\pm i$ . So a splitting field for  $f(x)$  over  $Q$  is

$$\begin{aligned} Q(\sqrt{2}, i) &= Q(\sqrt{2})(i) = \{\alpha + \beta i \mid \alpha, \beta \in Q(\sqrt{2})\} \\ &= \{(a + b\sqrt{2}) + (c + d\sqrt{2})i \mid a, b, c, d \in Q\}. \quad \blacksquare \end{aligned}$$

■ **EXAMPLE 6** Consider  $f(x) = x^2 + x + 2$  over  $Z_3$ . Then  $Z_3(i) = \{a + bi \mid a, b \in Z_3\}$  (see Example 9 in Chapter 13) is a splitting field for  $f(x)$  over  $Z_3$  because

$$f(x) = [x - (1 + i)][x - (1 - i)].$$

At the same time, we know by the proof of Kronecker's Theorem that the element  $x + \langle x^2 + x + 2 \rangle$  of

$$F = Z_3[x]/\langle x^2 + x + 2 \rangle$$

is a zero of  $f(x)$ . Since  $f(x)$  has degree 2, it follows from the Factor Theorem (Corollary 2 of Theorem 16.2) that the other zero of  $f(x)$  must also be in  $F$ . Thus,  $f(x)$  splits in  $F$ , and because  $F$  is a two-dimensional vector space over  $Z_3$ , we know that  $F$  is also a splitting field of  $f(x)$  over  $Z_3$ . But how do we factor  $f(x)$  in  $F$ ? Factoring  $f(x)$  in  $F$  is confusing because we are using the symbol  $x$  in two distinct ways: It is used as a placeholder to write the polynomial  $f(x)$ , and it is used to create the coset representatives of the elements of  $F$ . This confusion can be avoided by simply identifying the coset  $1 + \langle x^2 + x + 2 \rangle$  with the element 1 in  $Z_3$  and denoting the coset  $x + \langle x^2 + x + 2 \rangle$  by  $\beta$ . With this identification, the field  $Z_3[x]/\langle x^2 + x + 2 \rangle$  can be represented as  $\{0, 1, 2, \beta, 2\beta, \beta + 1, 2\beta + 1, \beta + 2, 2\beta + 2\}$ . These elements are added and multiplied just as polynomials are, except that we use the observation that  $x^2 + x + 2 + \langle x^2 + x + 2 \rangle = 0$  implies that  $\beta^2 + \beta + 2 = 0$ , so that  $\beta^2 = -\beta - 2 = 2\beta + 1$ . For example,  $(2\beta + 1)(\beta + 2) = 2\beta^2 + 5\beta + 2 = 2(2\beta + 1) + 5\beta + 2 = 9\beta + 4 = 1$ . To obtain the factorization of  $f(x)$  in  $F$ , we simply long divide, as follows:

$$\begin{array}{r} x + (\beta + 1) \\ x - \beta \overline{)x^2 + x + 2} \\ \underline{x^2 - \beta x} \phantom{+ 2} \\ (\beta + 1)x + 2 \\ (\beta + 1)x - (\beta + 1)\beta \\ \hline (\beta + 1)\beta + 2 = \beta^2 + \beta + 2 = 0. \end{array}$$

So,  $x^2 + x + 2 = (x - \beta)(x + \beta + 1)$ . Thus, we have found two splitting fields for  $x^2 + x + 2$  over  $Z_3$ , one of the form  $F(a)$  and one of the form  $F[x]/\langle p(x) \rangle$  [where  $F = Z_3$  and  $p(x) = x^2 + x + 2$ ]. ■

The next theorem shows how the fields  $F(a)$  and  $F[x]/\langle p(x) \rangle$  are related in the case where  $p(x)$  is irreducible over  $F$  and  $a$  is a zero of  $p(x)$  in some extension of  $F$ .

### ■ Theorem 20.3 $F(a) \approx F[x]/\langle p(x) \rangle$

*Let  $F$  be a field and let  $p(x) \in F[x]$  be irreducible over  $F$ . If  $a$  is a zero of  $p(x)$  in some extension  $E$  of  $F$ , then  $F(a)$  is isomorphic to  $F[x]/\langle p(x) \rangle$ . Furthermore, if  $\deg p(x) = n$ , then every member of  $F(a)$  can be uniquely expressed in the form*

$$c_{n-1}a^{n-1} + c_{n-2}a^{n-2} + \cdots + c_1a + c_0,$$

*where  $c_0, c_1, \dots, c_{n-1} \in F$ .*

**PROOF** Consider the function  $\phi$  from  $F[x]$  to  $F(a)$  given by  $\phi(f(x)) = f(a)$ . Clearly,  $\phi$  is a ring homomorphism. We claim that  $\text{Ker } \phi = \langle p(x) \rangle$ . (This is Exercise 35 in Chapter 17.) Since  $p(a) = 0$ , we have  $\langle p(x) \rangle \subseteq \text{Ker } \phi$ . On the other hand, we know by Theorem 17.5 that  $\langle p(x) \rangle$  is a maximal ideal in  $F[x]$ . So, because  $\text{Ker } \phi \neq F[x]$  [it does not contain the constant polynomial  $f(x) = 1$ ], we have  $\text{Ker } \phi = \langle p(x) \rangle$ . At this point it follows from the First Isomorphism Theorem for Rings and Corollary 1 of Theorem 17.5 that  $\phi(F[x])$  is a subfield of  $F(a)$ . Noting that  $\phi(F[x])$  contains both  $F$  and  $a$  and recalling that  $F(a)$  is the smallest such field, we have  $F[x]/\langle p(x) \rangle \approx \phi(F[x]) = F(a)$ .

The final assertion of the theorem follows from the fact that every element of  $F[x]/\langle p(x) \rangle$  can be expressed uniquely in the form

$$c_{n-1}x^{n-1} + \cdots + c_0 + \langle p(x) \rangle,$$

where  $c_0, \dots, c_{n-1} \in F$  (see Exercise 25 in Chapter 16), and the natural isomorphism from  $F[x]/\langle p(x) \rangle$  to  $F(a)$  carries  $c_kx^k + \langle p(x) \rangle$  to  $c_ka^k$ . ■

As an immediate corollary of Theorem 20.3, we have the following attractive result.

### ■ Corollary $F(a) \approx F(b)$

*Let  $F$  be a field and let  $p(x) \in F[x]$  be irreducible over  $F$ . If  $a$  is a zero of  $p(x)$  in some extension  $E$  of  $F$  and  $b$  is a zero of  $p(x)$  in some extension  $E'$  of  $F$ , then the fields  $F(a)$  and  $F(b)$  are isomorphic.*

**PROOF** From Theorem 20.3, we have

$$F(a) \approx F[x]/\langle p(x) \rangle \approx F(b). \quad \blacksquare$$

Recall that a basis for an  $n$ -dimensional vector space over a field  $F$  is a set of  $n$  vectors  $v_1, v_2, \dots, v_n$  with the property that every member of the vector space can be expressed uniquely in the form  $a_1v_1 + a_2v_2 + \dots + a_nv_n$ , where the  $a$ 's belong to  $F$  (Exercise 19 in Chapter 19). So, in the language of vector spaces, the latter portion of Theorem 20.3 says that if  $a$  is a zero of an irreducible polynomial over  $F$  of degree  $n$ , then the set  $\{1, a, \dots, a^{n-1}\}$  is a basis for  $F(a)$  over  $F$ .

Theorem 20.3 often provides a convenient way of describing the elements of a field.

**EXAMPLE 7** Consider the irreducible polynomial  $f(x) = x^6 - 2$  over  $\mathcal{Q}$ . Since  $\sqrt[6]{2}$  is a zero of  $f(x)$ , we know from Theorem 20.3 that the set  $\{1, 2^{1/6}, 2^{2/6}, 2^{3/6}, 2^{4/6}, 2^{5/6}\}$  is a basis for  $\mathcal{Q}(\sqrt[6]{2})$  over  $\mathcal{Q}$ . Thus,

$$\mathcal{Q}(\sqrt[6]{2}) = \{a_0 + a_1 2^{1/6} + a_2 2^{2/6} + a_3 2^{3/6} + a_4 2^{4/6} + a_5 2^{5/6} \mid a_i \in \mathcal{Q}\}.$$

This field is isomorphic to  $\mathcal{Q}[x]/\langle x^6 - 2 \rangle$ . ■

In 1882, Ferdinand von Lindemann (1852–1939) proved that  $\pi$  is not the zero of any polynomial in  $\mathcal{Q}[x]$ . Because of this important result, Theorem 20.3 does not apply to  $\mathcal{Q}(\pi)$  (see Exercise 11). Fields of the form  $F(a)$  where  $a$  is in some extension field of  $F$  but not the zero of an element of  $F(x)$  are discussed in the next chapter.

In Example 6, we produced two splitting fields for the polynomial  $x^2 + x + 2$  over  $\mathcal{Z}_3$ . Likewise, it is an easy exercise to show that both  $\mathcal{Q}[x]/\langle x^2 + 1 \rangle$  and  $\mathcal{Q}(i) = \{r + si \mid r, s \in \mathcal{Q}\}$  are splitting fields of the polynomial  $x^2 + 1$  over  $\mathcal{Q}$ . But are these different-looking splitting fields algebraically different? Not really. We conclude our discussion of splitting fields by proving that splitting fields are unique up to isomorphism. To make it easier to apply induction, we will prove a more general result.

We begin by observing first that any ring isomorphism  $\phi$  from  $F$  to  $F'$  has a natural extension from  $F[x]$  to  $F'[x]$  given by  $c_n x^n + c_{n-1} x^{n-1} + \dots + c_1 x + c_0 \rightarrow \phi(c_n) x^n + \phi(c_{n-1}) x^{n-1} + \dots + \phi(c_1) x + \phi(c_0)$ . Since this mapping agrees with  $\phi$  on  $F$ , it is convenient and natural to use  $\phi$  to denote this mapping as well.

## ■ Lemma

*Let  $F$  be a field, let  $p(x) \in F[x]$  be irreducible over  $F$ , and let  $a$  be a zero of  $p(x)$  in some extension of  $F$ . If  $\phi$  is a field isomorphism from  $F$  to  $F'$  and  $b$  is a zero of  $\phi(p(x))$  in some extension of  $F'$ , then there is an isomorphism from  $F(a)$  to  $F'(b)$  that agrees with  $\phi$  on  $F$  and carries  $a$  to  $b$ .*

**PROOF** First observe that since  $p(x)$  is irreducible over  $F$ ,  $\phi(p(x))$  is irreducible over  $F'$ . It is straightforward to check that the mapping from  $F[x]/\langle p(x) \rangle$  to  $F'[x]/\langle \phi(p(x)) \rangle$  given by

$$f(x) + \langle p(x) \rangle \rightarrow \phi(f(x)) + \langle \phi(p(x)) \rangle$$

is a field isomorphism. By a slight abuse of notation, we denote this mapping by  $\phi$  also. (If you object, put a bar over the  $\phi$ .) From the proof of Theorem 20.3, we know that there is an isomorphism  $\alpha$  from  $F(a)$  to  $F[x]/\langle p(x) \rangle$  that is the identity on  $F$  and carries  $a$  to  $x + \langle p(x) \rangle$ . Similarly, there is an isomorphism  $\beta$  from  $F'[x]/\langle \phi(p(x)) \rangle$  to  $F'(b)$  that is the identity on  $F'$  and carries  $x + \langle \phi(p(x)) \rangle$  to  $b$ . Thus,  $\beta\phi\alpha$  is the desired mapping from  $F(a)$  to  $F'(b)$ . See Figure 20.1. ■

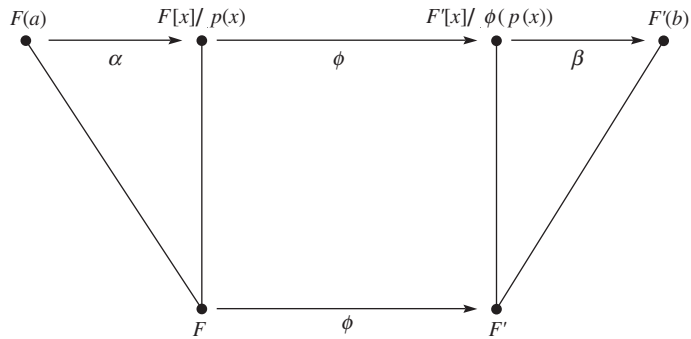


Figure 20.1

#### ■ Theorem 20.4 Extending $\phi: F \rightarrow F'$

*Let  $\phi$  be an isomorphism from a field  $F$  to a field  $F'$  and let  $f(x) \in F[x]$ . If  $E$  is a splitting field for  $f(x)$  over  $F$  and  $E'$  is a splitting field for  $\phi(f(x))$  over  $F'$ , then there is an isomorphism from  $E$  to  $E'$  that agrees with  $\phi$  on  $F$ .*

**PROOF** We use induction on  $\deg f(x)$ . If  $\deg f(x) = 1$ , then  $E = F$  and  $E' = F'$ , so that  $\phi$  itself is the desired mapping. If  $\deg f(x) > 1$ , let  $p(x)$  be an irreducible factor of  $f(x)$ , let  $a$  be a zero of  $p(x)$  in  $E$ , and let  $b$  be a zero of  $\phi(p(x))$  in  $E'$ . By the preceding lemma, there is an isomorphism  $\alpha$  from  $F(a)$  to  $F'(b)$  that agrees with  $\phi$  on  $F$  and carries  $a$  to  $b$ . Now write  $f(x) = (x - a)g(x)$ , where  $g(x) \in F(a)[x]$ . Then  $E$  is a splitting field for  $g(x)$  over  $F(a)$  and  $E'$  is a splitting field for  $\alpha(g(x))$  over  $F'(b)$ . Since  $\deg g(x) < \deg f(x)$ , there is an isomorphism from  $E$  to  $E'$  that agrees with  $\alpha$  on  $F(a)$  and therefore with  $\phi$  on  $F$ . ■

## ■ Corollary Splitting Fields Are Unique

*Let  $F$  be a field and let  $f(x) \in F[x]$ . Then any two splitting fields of  $f(x)$  over  $F$  are isomorphic.*

**PROOF** Suppose that  $E$  and  $E'$  are splitting fields of  $f(x)$  over  $F$ . The result follows immediately from Theorem 20.4 by letting  $\phi$  be the identity from  $F$  to  $F$ . ■

In light of the corollary above, we may refer to “the” splitting field of a polynomial over  $F$  without ambiguity.

Even though  $x^6 - 2$  has a zero in  $Q(\sqrt[6]{2})$ , it does not split in  $Q(\sqrt[6]{2})$ . The splitting field is easy to obtain, however.

### ■ EXAMPLE 8 The Splitting Field of $x^n - a$ over $Q$

Let  $a$  be a positive rational number and let  $\omega$  be a primitive  $n$ th root of unity (see Example 2 in Chapter 16). Then each of

$$a^{1/n}, \omega a^{1/n}, \omega^2 a^{1/n}, \dots, \omega^{n-1} a^{1/n}$$

is a zero of  $x^n - a$  in  $Q(\sqrt[n]{a}, \omega)$ . ■

## Zeros of an Irreducible Polynomial

Now that we know that every nonconstant polynomial over a field splits in some extension, we ask whether irreducible polynomials must split in some special way. Yes, they do. To discover how, we borrow something whose origins are in calculus.

### Definition Derivative

Let  $f(x) = a_n x^n + a_{n-1} x^{n-1} + \dots + a_1 x + a_0$  belong to  $F[x]$ . The *derivative* of  $f(x)$ , denoted by  $f'(x)$ , is the polynomial  $na_n x^{n-1} + (n-1)a_{n-1} x^{n-2} + \dots + a_1$  in  $F[x]$ .

Notice that our definition does not involve the notion of a limit. The standard rules for handling sums and products of functions in calculus carry over to arbitrary fields as well.

## ■ Lemma Properties of the Derivative

*Let  $f(x)$  and  $g(x) \in F[x]$  and let  $a \in F$ . Then*

1.  $(f(x) + g(x))' = f'(x) + g'(x)$ .
2.  $(af(x))' = af'(x)$ .
3.  $(f(x)g(x))' = f(x)g'(x) + g(x)f'(x)$ .

**PROOF** Properties 1 and 2 follow from straightforward applications of the definition. Using property 1 and induction on  $\deg f(x)$ , property 3 reduces to the special case in which  $f(x) = a_n x^n$ . This also follows directly from the definition. ■

Before addressing the question of the nature of the zeros of an irreducible polynomial, we establish a general result concerning zeros of multiplicity greater than 1. Such zeros are called *multiple* zeros.

### ■ Theorem 20.5 Criterion for Multiple Zeros

*A polynomial  $f(x)$  over a field  $F$  has a multiple zero in some extension  $E$  if and only if  $f(x)$  and  $f'(x)$  have a common factor of positive degree in  $F[x]$ .*

**PROOF** If  $a$  is a multiple zero of  $f(x)$  in some extension  $E$ , then there is a  $g(x)$  in  $E[x]$  such that  $f(x) = (x - a)^2 g(x)$ . Since  $f'(x) = (x - a)^2 g'(x) + 2(x - a)g(x)$ , we see that  $f'(a) = 0$ . Thus,  $x - a$  is a factor of both  $f(x)$  and  $f'(x)$  in the extension  $E$  of  $F$ . Now if  $f(x)$  and  $f'(x)$  have no common divisor of positive degree in  $F[x]$ , there are polynomials  $h(x)$  and  $k(x)$  in  $F[x]$  such that  $f(x)h(x) + f'(x)k(x) = 1$  (see Exercise 23 in Chapter 16). Viewing  $f(x)h(x) + f'(x)k(x)$  as an element of  $E[x]$ , we see also that  $x - a$  is a factor of 1. Since this is nonsense,  $f(x)$  and  $f'(x)$  must have a common divisor of positive degree in  $F[x]$ .

Conversely, suppose that  $f(x)$  and  $f'(x)$  have a common factor of positive degree. Let  $a$  be a zero of the common factor. Then  $a$  is a zero of  $f(x)$  and  $f'(x)$ . Since  $a$  is a zero of  $f(x)$ , there is a polynomial  $q(x)$  such that  $f(x) = (x - a)q(x)$ . Then  $f'(x) = (x - a)q'(x) + q(x)$  and  $0 = f'(a) = q(a)$ . Thus,  $x - a$  is a factor of  $q(x)$  and  $a$  is a multiple zero of  $f(x)$ . ■

### ■ Theorem 20.6 Zeros of an Irreducible

*Let  $f(x)$  be an irreducible polynomial over a field  $F$ . If  $F$  has characteristic 0, then  $f(x)$  has no multiple zeros. If  $F$  has characteristic  $p \neq 0$ , then  $f(x)$  has a multiple zero only if it is of the form  $f(x) = g(x^p)$  for some  $g(x)$  in  $F[x]$ .*

**PROOF** If  $f(x)$  has a multiple zero, then, by Theorem 20.5,  $f(x)$  and  $f'(x)$  have a common divisor of positive degree in  $F[x]$ . Since the only divisor of positive degree of  $f(x)$  in  $F[x]$  is  $f(x)$  itself (up to associates), we see that  $f(x)$  divides  $f'(x)$ . Because a polynomial over a field cannot divide a polynomial of smaller degree, we must have  $f'(x) = 0$ .

Now what does it mean to say that  $f'(x) = 0$ ? If we write  $f(x) = a_n x^n + a_{n-1} x^{n-1} + \cdots + a_1 x + a_0$ , then  $f'(x) = n a_n x^{n-1} + (n-1) a_{n-1} x^{n-2} + \cdots + a_1$ . Thus,  $f'(x) = 0$  only when  $k a_k = 0$  for  $k = 1, \dots, n$ .

So, when  $\text{char } F = 0$ , we have  $f(x) = a_0$ , which is not an irreducible polynomial. This contradicts the hypothesis that  $f(x)$  is irreducible over  $F$ . Thus,  $f(x)$  has no multiple zeros.

When  $\text{char } F = p \neq 0$ , we have  $a_k = 0$  when  $p$  does not divide  $k$ . Thus, the only powers of  $x$  that appear in the sum  $a_n x^n + \cdots + a_1 x + a_0$  are those of the form  $x^{pj} = (x^p)^j$ . It follows that  $f(x) = g(x^p)$  for some  $g(x) \in F[x]$ . [For example, if  $f(x) = x^{4p} + 3x^{2p} + x^p + 1$ , then  $g(x) = x^4 + 3x^2 + x + 1$ .] ■

Theorem 20.6 shows that an irreducible polynomial over a field of characteristic 0 cannot have multiple zeros. The desire to extend this result to a larger class of fields motivates the following definition.

### Definition Perfect Field

A field  $F$  is called *perfect* if  $F$  has characteristic 0 or if  $F$  has characteristic  $p$  and  $F^p = \{a^p \mid a \in F\} = F$ .

The most important family of perfect fields of characteristic  $p$  is the finite fields.

## ■ Theorem 20.7 Finite Fields Are Perfect

*Every finite field is perfect.*

**PROOF** Let  $F$  be a finite field of characteristic  $p$ . Consider the mapping  $\phi$  from  $F$  to  $F$  defined by  $\phi(x) = x^p$  for all  $x \in F$ . We claim that  $\phi$  is a field automorphism. Obviously,  $\phi(ab) = (ab)^p = a^p b^p =$

$\phi(a)\phi(b)$ . Moreover,  $\phi(a + b) = (a + b)^p = a^p + \binom{p}{1} a^{p-1} b +$

$\binom{p}{2} a^{p-2} b^2 + \cdots + \binom{p}{p-1} a b^{p-1} + b^p = a^p + b^p$ , since each

$\binom{p}{i}$  is divisible by  $p$ . Finally, since  $x^p \neq 0$  when  $x \neq 0$ ,  $\text{Ker } \phi = \{0\}$ .

Thus,  $\phi$  is one-to-one and, since  $F$  is finite,  $\phi$  is onto. This proves that  $F^p = F$ . ■



### ■ Theorem 20.8 Criterion for No Multiple Zeros

*If  $f(x)$  is an irreducible polynomial over a perfect field  $F$ , then  $f(x)$  has no multiple zeros.*

**PROOF** The case where  $F$  has characteristic 0 has been done. So let us assume that  $f(x) \in F[x]$  is irreducible over a perfect field  $F$  of characteristic  $p$  and that  $f(x)$  has multiple zeros. From Theorem 20.6 we know that  $f(x) = g(x^p)$  for some  $g(x) \in F[x]$ , say,  $g(x) = a_n x^n + a_{n-1} x^{n-1} + \cdots + a_1 x + a_0$ . Since  $F^p = F$ , each  $a_i$  in  $F$  can be written in the form  $b_i^p$  for some  $b_i$  in  $F$ . So, using Exercise 49a in Chapter 13, we have

$$\begin{aligned} f(x) &= g(x^p) = b_n^p x^{pn} + b_{n-1}^p x^{p(n-1)} + \cdots + b_1^p x^p + b_0^p \\ &= (b_n x^n + b_{n-1} x^{n-1} + \cdots + b_1 x + b_0)^p = (h(x))^p, \end{aligned}$$

where  $h(x) \in F[x]$ . But then  $f(x)$  is not irreducible. ■

The next theorem shows that when an irreducible polynomial does have multiple zeros, there is something striking about the multiplicities.

### ■ Theorem 20.9 Zeros of an Irreducible over a Splitting Field

*Let  $f(x)$  be an irreducible polynomial over a field  $F$  and let  $E$  be a splitting field of  $f(x)$  over  $F$ . Then all the zeros of  $f(x)$  in  $E$  have the same multiplicity.*

**PROOF** Let  $a$  and  $b$  be distinct zeros of  $f(x)$  in  $E$ . If  $a$  has multiplicity  $m$ , then in  $E[x]$  we may write  $f(x) = (x - a)^m g(x)$ . It follows from the lemma preceding Theorem 20.4 and from Theorem 20.4 that there is a field isomorphism  $\phi$  from  $E$  to itself that carries  $a$  to  $b$  and acts as the identity on  $F$ . Thus,

$$f(x) = \phi(f(x)) = (x - b)^m \phi(g(x)),$$

and we see that the multiplicity of  $b$  is greater than or equal to the multiplicity of  $a$ . By interchanging the roles of  $a$  and  $b$ , we observe that the multiplicity of  $a$  is greater than or equal to the multiplicity of  $b$ . So, we have proved that  $a$  and  $b$  have the same multiplicity. ■

As an immediate corollary of Theorem 20.9 we have the following appealing result.

## ■ Corollary Factorization of an Irreducible over a Splitting Field

*Let  $f(x)$  be an irreducible polynomial over a field  $F$  and let  $E$  be a splitting field of  $f(x)$ . Then  $f(x)$  has the form*

$$a(x - a_1)^n(x - a_2)^n \cdots (x - a_t)^n,$$

*where  $a_1, a_2, \dots, a_t$  are distinct elements of  $E$  and  $a \in F$ .*

We conclude this chapter by giving an example of an irreducible polynomial over a field that does have a multiple zero. In particular, notice that the field we use is not perfect.

**■ EXAMPLE 9** Let  $F = Z_2(t)$  be the field of quotients of the ring  $Z_2[t]$  of polynomials in the indeterminate  $t$  with coefficients from  $Z_2$ . (We must introduce a letter other than  $x$ , since the members of  $F$  are going to be our coefficients for the elements in  $F[x]$ .) Consider  $f(x) = x^2 - t \in F[x]$ . To see that  $f(x)$  is irreducible over  $F$ , it suffices to show that it has no zeros in  $F$ . Well, suppose that  $h(t)/k(t)$  is a zero of  $f(x)$ . Then  $(h(t)/k(t))^2 = t$ , and therefore  $(h(t))^2 = t(k(t))^2$ . Since  $h(t), k(t) \in Z_2[t]$ , we then have  $h(t^2) = tk(t^2)$  (see Exercise 49 in Chapter 13). But  $\deg h(t^2)$  is even, whereas  $\deg tk(t^2)$  is odd. So,  $f(x)$  is irreducible over  $F$ .

Finally, since  $t$  is a constant in  $F[x]$  and the characteristic of  $F$  is 2, we have  $f'(x) = 0$ , so that  $f'(x)$  and  $f(x)$  have  $f(x)$  as a common factor. So, by Theorem 20.5,  $f(x)$  has a multiple zero in some extension of  $F$ . (Indeed, it has a single zero of multiplicity 2 in  $K = F[x]/\langle x^2 - t \rangle$ .) ■

## Exercises

I have yet to see any problem, however complicated, which, when you looked at it in the right way, did not become still more complicated.

Paul Anderson, *New Scientist*

1. Describe the elements of  $Q(\sqrt[3]{5})$ .
2. Show that  $Q(\sqrt{2}, \sqrt{3}) = Q(\sqrt{2} + \sqrt{3})$ .
3. Find the splitting field of  $x^3 - 1$  over  $Q$ . Express your answer in the form  $Q(a)$ .
4. Find the splitting field of  $x^4 + 1$  over  $Q$ .
5. Find the splitting field of

$$x^4 + x^2 + 1 = (x^2 + x + 1)(x^2 - x + 1)$$

over  $Q$ .

6. Let  $a, b \in \mathbf{R}$  with  $b \neq 0$ . Show that  $\mathbf{R}(a + bi) = \mathbf{C}$ .
7. Let  $F$  be a field, and let  $a$  and  $b$  belong to  $F$  with  $a \neq 0$ . If  $c$  belongs to some extension of  $F$ , prove that  $F(c) = F(ac + b)$ . ( $F$  “absorbs” its own elements.)
8. Let  $F = \mathbf{Z}_2$  and let  $f(x) = x^3 + x + 1 \in F[x]$ . Suppose that  $a$  is a zero of  $f(x)$  in some extension of  $F$ . How many elements does  $F(a)$  have? Express each member of  $F(a)$  in terms of  $a$ . Write out a complete multiplication table for  $F(a)$ .
9. Let  $F(a)$  be the field described in Exercise 8. Express each of  $a^5$ ,  $a^{-2}$ , and  $a^{100}$  in the form  $c_2a^2 + c_1a + c_0$ .
10. Let  $F(a)$  be the field described in Exercise 8. Show that  $a^2$  and  $a^2 + a$  are zeros of  $x^3 + x + 1$ .
11. Describe the elements in  $Q(\pi)$ .
12. Let  $F = Q(\pi^3)$ . Find a basis for  $F(\pi)$  over  $F$ .
13. Write  $x^7 - x$  as a product of linear factors over  $\mathbf{Z}_3$ . Do the same for  $x^{10} - x$ .
14. Find all ring automorphisms of  $Q(\sqrt[3]{5})$ .
15. Let  $F$  be a field of characteristic  $p$  and let  $f(x) = x^p - a \in F[x]$ . Show that  $f(x)$  is irreducible over  $F$  or  $f(x)$  splits in  $F$ .
16. Suppose that  $\beta$  is a zero of  $f(x) = x^4 + x + 1$  in some extension field  $E$  of  $\mathbf{Z}_2$ . Write  $f(x)$  as a product of linear factors in  $E[x]$ .
17. Find  $a, b, c$  in  $Q$  such that

$$(1 + \sqrt[3]{4})/(2 - \sqrt[3]{2}) = a + b\sqrt[3]{2} + c\sqrt[3]{4}.$$

Note that such  $a, b, c$  exist, since

$$(1 + \sqrt[3]{4})/(2 - \sqrt[3]{2}) \in Q(\sqrt[3]{2}) = \{a + b\sqrt[3]{2} + c\sqrt[3]{4} \mid a, b, c \in Q\}.$$

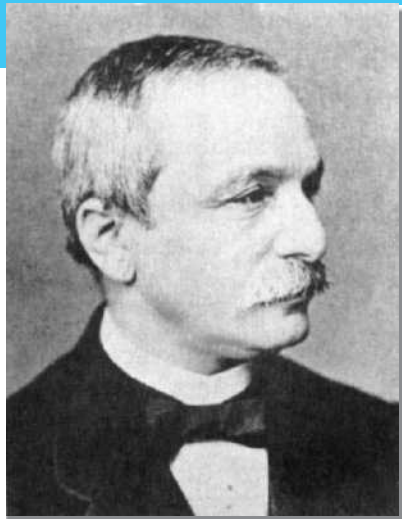
18. Express  $(3 + 4\sqrt{2})^{-1}$  in the form  $a + b\sqrt{2}$ , where  $a, b \in Q$ .
19. Show that  $Q(4 - i) = Q(1 + i)$ , where  $i = \sqrt{-1}$ .
20. Find a polynomial  $p(x)$  in  $Q[x]$  such that  $Q(\sqrt{1 + \sqrt{5}})$  is ring-isomorphic to  $Q[x]/\langle p(x) \rangle$ .
21. Let  $f(x) \in F[x]$  and let  $a \in F$ . Show that  $f(x)$  and  $f(x + a)$  have the same splitting field over  $F$ .
22. Recall that two polynomials  $f(x)$  and  $g(x)$  from  $F[x]$  are said to be relatively prime if there is no polynomial of positive degree in  $F[x]$  that divides both  $f(x)$  and  $g(x)$ . Show that if  $f(x)$  and  $g(x)$  are relatively prime in  $F[x]$ , they are relatively prime in  $K[x]$ , where  $K$  is any extension of  $F$ .
23. Determine all of the subfields of  $Q(\sqrt{2})$ .

24. Describe the elements of the extension  $Q(\sqrt[4]{2})$  over the field  $Q(\sqrt{2})$ .
25. What is the order of the splitting field of  $x^5 + x^4 + 1 = (x^2 + x + 1) \cdot (x^3 + x + 1)$  over  $Z_2$ ?
26. Let  $E$  be an extension of  $F$  and let  $a$  and  $b$  belong to  $E$ . Prove that  $F(a, b) = F(a)(b) = F(b)(a)$ .
27. Write  $x^3 + 2x + 1$  as a product of linear polynomials over some extension field of  $Z_3$ .
28. Express  $x^8 - x$  as a product of irreducibles over  $Z_2$ .
29. Prove or disprove that  $Q(\sqrt{3})$  and  $Q(\sqrt{-3})$  are ring-isomorphic.
30. For any prime  $p$ , find a field of characteristic  $p$  that is not perfect.
31. If  $\beta$  is a zero of  $x^2 + x + 2$  over  $Z_5$ , find the other zero.
32. Show that  $x^4 + x + 1$  over  $Z_2$  does not have any multiple zeros in any extension field of  $Z_2$ .
33. Show that  $x^{21} + 2x^8 + 1$  does not have multiple zeros in any extension of  $Z_3$ .
34. Show that  $x^{19} + x^8 + 1$  has multiple zeros in some extension of  $Z_3$ .
35. Let  $F$  be a field of characteristic  $p \neq 0$ . Show that the polynomial  $f(x) = x^{p^n} - x$  over  $F$  has distinct zeros.
36. Find the splitting field for  $f(x) = (x^2 + x + 2)(x^2 + 2x + 2)$  over  $Z_3[x]$ . Write  $f(x)$  as a product of linear factors.
37. Let  $F$  be a field and  $E$  an extension field of  $F$  that contains  $a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n$ . Prove that  $F(a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n)$  is the intersection of all subfields of  $E$  that contain  $F$  and the set  $\{a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n\}$ . (This exercise is referred to in this chapter.)
38. Find the splitting field  $x^4 - x^2 - 2$  over  $Z_3$ .
39. Suppose that  $f(x)$  is a fifth-degree polynomial that is irreducible over  $Z_2$ . Prove that every nonidentity element is a generator of the cyclic group  $(Z_2[x]/\langle f(x) \rangle)^*$ .
40. Show that  $Q(\sqrt{7}, i)$  is the splitting field for  $x^4 - 6x^2 - 7$ .
41. Suppose that  $p(x)$  is a quadratic polynomial with rational coefficients and is irreducible over  $Q$ . Show that  $p(x)$  has two zeros in  $Q[x]/\langle p(x) \rangle$ .
42. If  $p(x) \in F[x]$  and  $\deg p(x) = n$ , show that the splitting field for  $p(x)$  over  $F$  has degree at most  $n!$ .
43. Let  $p$  be a prime,  $F = Z_p(t)$  (the field of quotients of the ring  $Z_p[x]$ ) and  $f(x) = x^p - t$ . Prove that  $f(x)$  is irreducible over  $F$  and has a multiple zero in  $K = F[x]/\langle x^p - t \rangle$ .
44. Let  $f(x)$  be an irreducible polynomial over a field  $F$ . Prove that the number of distinct zeros of  $f(x)$  in a splitting field divides  $\deg f(x)$ .

# Leopold Kronecker

He [Kronecker] wove together the three strands of his greatest interests—the theory of numbers, the theory of equations and elliptic functions—into one beautiful pattern.

E. T. BELL



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LEOPOLD KRONECKER was born on December 7, 1823, in Liegnitz, Prussia. As a schoolboy, he received special instruction from the great algebraist Kummer. Kronecker entered the University of Berlin in 1841 and completed his Ph.D. dissertation in 1845 on the units in a certain ring.

Kronecker devoted the years 1845–1853 to business affairs, relegating mathematics to a hobby. Thereafter, being well-off financially, he spent most of his time doing research in algebra and number theory. Kronecker was one of the early advocates of the abstract approach to algebra. He innovatively applied rings and fields in his investigations of algebraic numbers, established the Fundamental Theorem of Finite Abelian Groups, and was the first mathematician to master Galois's theory of fields.

Kronecker advocated constructive methods for all proofs and definitions. He believed

that all mathematics should be based on relationships among integers. He went so far as to say to Lindemann, who proved that  $\pi$  is transcendental, that irrational numbers do not exist. His most famous remark on the matter was "God made the integers, all the rest is the work of man." Henri Poincaré once remarked that Kronecker was able to produce fine work in number theory and algebra only by temporarily forgetting his own philosophy.

Kronecker died on December 29, 1891, at the age of 68.

For more information about Kronecker, visit:

**[http://www-groups.dcs  
.st-and.ac.uk/~history/](http://www-groups.dcs.st-and.ac.uk/~history/)**

# 21 Algebraic Extensions

All things are difficult before they are easy.

Thomas Fuller

Banach once told me, “Good mathematicians see analogies between theorems or theories, the very best ones see analogies between analogies.”

S. M. Ulam, *Adventures of a Mathematician*

## Characterization of Extensions

In Chapter 20, we saw that every element in the field  $Q(\sqrt{2})$  has the particularly simple form  $a + b\sqrt{2}$ , where  $a$  and  $b$  are rational. On the other hand, the elements of  $Q(\pi)$  have the more complicated form

$$(a_n\pi^n + a_{n-1}\pi^{n-1} + \cdots + a_0)/(b_m\pi^m + b_{m-1}\pi^{m-1} + \cdots + b_0),$$

where the  $a$ 's and  $b$ 's are rational. The fields of the first type have a great deal of algebraic structure. This structure is the subject of this chapter.

### Definition Types of Extensions

Let  $E$  be an extension field of a field  $F$  and let  $a \in E$ . We call  $a$  *algebraic over  $F$*  if  $a$  is the zero of some nonzero polynomial in  $F[x]$ . If  $a$  is not algebraic over  $F$ , it is called *transcendental over  $F$* . An extension  $E$  of  $F$  is called an *algebraic extension of  $F$*  if every element of  $E$  is algebraic over  $F$ . If  $E$  is not an algebraic extension of  $F$ , it is called a *transcendental extension of  $F$* . An extension of  $F$  of the form  $F(a)$  is called a *simple extension of  $F$* .

Leonhard Euler used the term *transcendental* for numbers that are not algebraic because “they transcended the power of algebraic methods.” Although Euler made this distinction in 1744, it wasn’t until 1844 that the existence of transcendental numbers over  $Q$  was proved by Joseph Liouville. Charles Hermite proved that  $e$  is transcendental over  $Q$  in 1873, and Lindemann showed that  $\pi$  is transcendental over  $Q$  in 1882. To this day, it is not known whether  $\pi + e$  is transcendental over  $Q$ .

With a precise definition of “almost all,” it can be shown that almost all real numbers are transcendental over  $\mathbb{Q}$ .

Theorem 21.1 shows why we make the distinction between elements that are algebraic over a field and elements that are transcendental over a field. Recall that  $F(x)$  is the field of quotients of  $F[x]$ ; that is,

$$F(x) = \{f(x)/g(x) \mid f(x), g(x) \in F[x], g(x) \neq 0\}.$$

### ■ Theorem 21.1 Characterization of Extensions

*Let  $E$  be an extension field of the field  $F$  and let  $a \in E$ . If  $a$  is transcendental over  $F$ , then  $F(a) \approx F(x)$ . If  $a$  is algebraic over  $F$ , then  $F(a) \approx F[x]/\langle p(x) \rangle$ , where  $p(x)$  is a polynomial in  $F[x]$  of minimum degree such that  $p(a) = 0$ . Moreover,  $p(x)$  is irreducible over  $F$ .*

**PROOF** Consider the homomorphism  $\phi: F[x] \rightarrow F(a)$  given by  $f(x) \rightarrow f(a)$ . If  $a$  is transcendental over  $F$ , then  $\text{Ker } \phi = \{0\}$ , and so we may extend  $\phi$  to an isomorphism  $\bar{\phi}: F(x) \rightarrow F(a)$  by defining  $\bar{\phi}(f(x)/g(x)) = f(a)/g(a)$ .

If  $a$  is algebraic over  $F$ , then  $\text{Ker } \phi \neq \{0\}$ ; and, by Theorem 16.5, there is a polynomial  $p(x)$  in  $F[x]$  such that  $\text{Ker } \phi = \langle p(x) \rangle$  and  $p(x)$  has minimum degree among all nonzero elements of  $\text{Ker } \phi$ . Thus,  $p(a) = 0$  and, since  $p(x)$  is a polynomial of minimum degree with this property, it is irreducible over  $F$ . ■

The proof of Theorem 21.1 can readily be adapted to yield the next two results also. The details are left to the reader (see Exercise 1).

### ■ Theorem 21.2 Uniqueness Property

*If  $a$  is algebraic over a field  $F$ , then there is a unique monic irreducible polynomial  $p(x)$  in  $F[x]$  such that  $p(a) = 0$ .*

The polynomial with the property specified in Theorem 21.2 is called the *minimal polynomial for  $a$  over  $F$* .

### ■ Theorem 21.3 Divisibility Property

*Let  $a$  be algebraic over  $F$ , and let  $p(x)$  be the minimal polynomial for  $a$  over  $F$ . If  $f(x) \in F[x]$  and  $f(a) = 0$ , then  $p(x)$  divides  $f(x)$  in  $F[x]$ .*

If  $E$  is an extension field of  $F$ , we may view  $E$  as a vector space over  $F$  (that is, the elements of  $E$  are the vectors and the elements of  $F$  are the

scalars). We are then able to use such notions as dimension and basis in our discussion.

## Finite Extensions

### Definition Degree of an Extension

Let  $E$  be an extension field of a field  $F$ . We say that  $E$  has *degree  $n$  over  $F$*  and write  $[E:F] = n$  if  $E$  has dimension  $n$  as a vector space over  $F$ . If  $[E:F]$  is finite,  $E$  is called a *finite extension* of  $F$ ; otherwise, we say that  $E$  is an *infinite extension* of  $F$ .

Figure 21.1 illustrates a convenient method of depicting the degree of a field extension over a field.

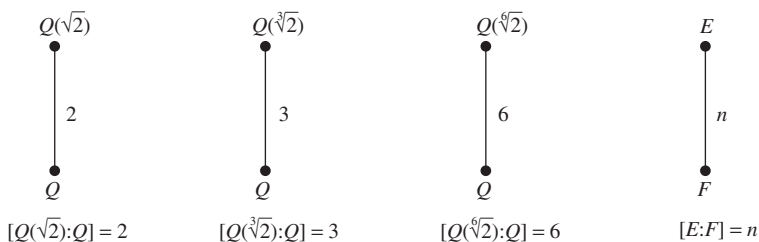


Figure 21.1

■ **EXAMPLE 1** The field of complex numbers has degree 2 over the reals, since  $\{1, i\}$  is a basis. The field of complex numbers is an infinite extension of the rationals. ■

■ **EXAMPLE 2** If  $a$  is algebraic over  $F$  and its minimal polynomial over  $F$  has degree  $n$ , then, by Theorem 20.3, we know that  $\{1, a, \dots, a^{n-1}\}$  is a basis for  $F(a)$  over  $F$ ; and, therefore,  $[F(a):F] = n$ . In this case, we say that  $a$  has *degree  $n$  over  $F$* . ■

### ■ Theorem 21.4 Finite Implies Algebraic

*If  $E$  is a finite extension of  $F$ , then  $E$  is an algebraic extension of  $F$ .*

**PROOF** Suppose that  $[E:F] = n$  and  $a \in E$ . Then the set  $\{1, a, \dots, a^n\}$  is linearly dependent over  $F$ ; that is, there are elements  $c_0, c_1, \dots, c_n$  in  $F$ , not all zero, such that

$$c_n a^n + c_{n-1} a^{n-1} + \cdots + c_1 a + c_0 = 0.$$

Clearly, then,  $a$  is a zero of the nonzero polynomial

$$f(x) = c_n x^n + c_{n-1} x^{n-1} + \cdots + c_1 x + c_0.$$



The converse of Theorem 21.4 is not true, for otherwise, the degrees of the elements of every algebraic extension of  $E$  over  $F$  would be bounded. But  $Q(\sqrt{2}, \sqrt[3]{2}, \sqrt[4]{2}, \dots)$  is an algebraic extension of  $Q$  that contains elements of every degree over  $Q$  (see Exercise 3).

The next theorem is the field theory counterpart of Lagrange's Theorem for finite groups. Like all counting theorems, it has far-reaching consequences.

■ **Theorem 21.5**  $[K:F] = [K:E][E:F]$

*Let  $K$  be a finite extension field of the field  $E$  and let  $E$  be a finite extension field of the field  $F$ . Then  $K$  is a finite extension field of  $F$  and  $[K:F] = [K:E][E:F]$ .*

**PROOF** Let  $X = \{x_1, x_2, \dots, x_n\}$  be a basis for  $K$  over  $E$ , and let  $Y = \{y_1, y_2, \dots, y_m\}$  be a basis for  $E$  over  $F$ . It suffices to prove that

$$YX = \{y_j x_i \mid 1 \leq j \leq m, 1 \leq i \leq n\}$$

is a basis for  $K$  over  $F$ . To do this, let  $a \in K$ . Then there are elements  $b_1, b_2, \dots, b_n \in E$  such that

$$a = b_1 x_1 + b_2 x_2 + \dots + b_n x_n$$

and, for each  $i = 1, \dots, n$ , there are elements  $c_{i1}, c_{i2}, \dots, c_{im} \in F$  such that

$$b_i = c_{i1} y_1 + c_{i2} y_2 + \dots + c_{im} y_m.$$

Thus,

$$a = \sum_{i=1}^n b_i x_i = \sum_{i=1}^n \left( \sum_{j=1}^m c_{ij} y_j \right) x_i = \sum_{i,j} c_{ij} (y_j x_i).$$

This proves that  $YX$  spans  $K$  over  $F$ .

Now suppose there are elements  $c_{ij}$  in  $F$  such that

$$0 = \sum_{i,j} c_{ij} (y_j x_i) = \sum_i \left( \sum_j (c_{ij} y_j) \right) x_i.$$

Then, since each  $\sum_j c_{ij} y_j \in E$  and  $X$  is a basis for  $K$  over  $E$ , we have

$$\sum_j c_{ij} y_j = 0$$

for each  $i$ . But each  $c_{ij} \in F$  and  $Y$  is a basis for  $E$  over  $F$ , so each  $c_{ij} = 0$ . This proves that the set  $YX$  is linearly independent over  $F$ . ■

Using the fact that for any field extension  $L$  of a field  $J$ ,  $[L:J] = n$  if and only if  $L$  is isomorphic to  $J^n$  as vector spaces (see Exercise 39),

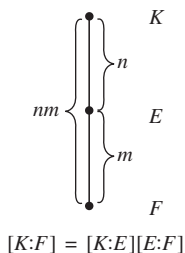


Figure 21.2

we may give a concise conceptual proof of Theorem 21.5, as follows. Let  $[K:E] = n$  and  $[E:F] = m$ . Then  $K \approx E^n$  and  $E \approx F^m$ , so that  $K \approx E^n \approx (F^m)^n \approx F^{mn}$ . Thus,  $[K:F] = mn$ .

The content of Theorem 21.5 can be pictured as in Figure 21.2. Examples 3, 4, and 5 show how Theorem 21.5 is often utilized.

■ **EXAMPLE 3** Since  $\{1, \sqrt{3}\}$  is a basis for  $Q(\sqrt{3}, \sqrt{5})$  over  $Q(\sqrt{5})$  (see Exercise 7) and  $\{1, \sqrt{5}\}$  is a basis for  $Q(\sqrt{5})$  over  $Q$ , the proof of Theorem 21.5 shows that  $\{1, \sqrt{3}, \sqrt{5}, \sqrt{15}\}$  is a basis for  $Q(\sqrt{3}, \sqrt{5})$  over  $Q$ . (See Figure 21.3.) ■

■ **EXAMPLE 4** Consider  $Q(\sqrt[3]{2}, \sqrt[4]{3})$ . Then  $[Q(\sqrt[3]{2}, \sqrt[4]{3}):Q] = 12$ . For, clearly,  $[Q(\sqrt[3]{2}, \sqrt[4]{3}):Q] = [Q(\sqrt[3]{2}, \sqrt[4]{3}):Q(\sqrt[3]{2})][Q(\sqrt[3]{2}):Q]$  and  $[Q(\sqrt[3]{2}, \sqrt[4]{3}):Q] = [Q(\sqrt[3]{2}, \sqrt[4]{3}):Q(\sqrt[4]{3})][Q(\sqrt[4]{3}):Q]$  show that both  $3 = [Q(\sqrt[3]{2}):Q]$  and  $4 = [Q(\sqrt[4]{3}):Q]$  divide  $[Q(\sqrt[3]{2}, \sqrt[4]{3}):Q]$ . Thus,  $[Q(\sqrt[3]{2}, \sqrt[4]{3}):Q] \geq 12$ . On the other hand,  $[Q(\sqrt[3]{2}, \sqrt[4]{3}):Q(\sqrt[3]{2})]$  is at most 4, since  $\sqrt[4]{3}$  is a zero of  $x^4 - 3 \in Q(\sqrt[3]{2})[x]$ . Therefore,  $[Q(\sqrt[3]{2}, \sqrt[4]{3}):Q] = [Q(\sqrt[3]{2}, \sqrt[4]{3}):Q(\sqrt[3]{2})][Q(\sqrt[3]{2}):Q] \leq 4 \cdot 3 = 12$ . (See Figure 21.4.) ■

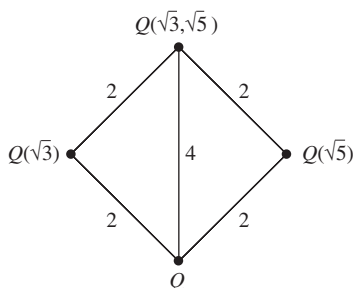


Figure 21.3

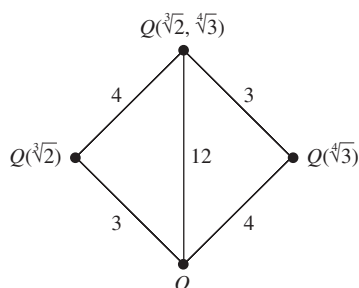


Figure 21.4

Theorem 21.5 can sometimes be used to show that a field does not contain a particular element.

■ **EXAMPLE 5** Recall from Example 7 in Chapter 17 that  $h(x) = 15x^4 - 10x^2 + 9x + 21$  is irreducible over  $Q$ . Let  $\beta$  be a zero of  $h(x)$  in some extension of  $Q$ . Then, even though we don't know what  $\beta$  is, we can still prove that  $\sqrt[3]{2}$  is not an element of  $Q(\beta)$ . For, if so, then  $Q \subset Q(\sqrt[3]{2}) \subseteq Q(\beta)$  and  $4 = [Q(\beta):Q] = [Q(\beta):Q(\sqrt[3]{2})][Q(\sqrt[3]{2}):Q]$  implies that 3 divides 4. Notice that this argument cannot be used to show that  $\sqrt{2}$  is not contained in  $Q(\beta)$ . ■

■ **EXAMPLE 6** Consider  $Q(\sqrt{3}, \sqrt{5})$ . We claim that  $Q(\sqrt{3}, \sqrt{5}) = Q(\sqrt{3} + \sqrt{5})$ . The inclusion  $Q(\sqrt{3} + \sqrt{5}) \subseteq Q(\sqrt{3}, \sqrt{5})$  is clear. Now note that since

$$(\sqrt{3} + \sqrt{5})^{-1} = \frac{1}{\sqrt{3} + \sqrt{5}} \cdot \frac{\sqrt{3} - \sqrt{5}}{\sqrt{3} - \sqrt{5}} = -\frac{1}{2}(\sqrt{3} - \sqrt{5}),$$

we know that  $\sqrt{3} - \sqrt{5}$  belongs to  $Q(\sqrt{3} + \sqrt{5})$ . It follows that  $[(\sqrt{3} + \sqrt{5}) + (\sqrt{3} - \sqrt{5})]/2 = \sqrt{3}$  and  $[(\sqrt{3} + \sqrt{5}) - (\sqrt{3} - \sqrt{5})]/2 = \sqrt{5}$  both belong to  $Q(\sqrt{3} + \sqrt{5})$ , and therefore  $Q(\sqrt{3}, \sqrt{5}) \subseteq Q(\sqrt{3} + \sqrt{5})$ . ■

■ **EXAMPLE 7** It follows from Example 6 and Theorem 20.3 that the minimal polynomial for  $\sqrt{3} + \sqrt{5}$  over  $Q$  has degree 4. How can we find this polynomial? We begin with  $x = \sqrt{3} + \sqrt{5}$ . Then  $x^2 = 3 + 2\sqrt{15} + 5$ . From this we obtain  $x^2 - 8 = 2\sqrt{15}$  and, by squaring both sides,  $x^4 - 16x + 64 = 60$ . Thus,  $\sqrt{3} + \sqrt{5}$  is a zero of  $x^4 - 16x + 4$ . We know that this is the minimal polynomial of  $\sqrt{3} + \sqrt{5}$  over  $Q$  since it is monic and has degree 4. ■

Example 6 shows that an extension obtained by adjoining two elements to a field can sometimes be obtained by adjoining a single element to the field. Our next theorem shows that, under certain conditions, this can always be done.

### ■ Theorem 21.6 Primitive Element Theorem (Steinitz, 1910)

*If  $F$  is a field of characteristic 0, and  $a$  and  $b$  are algebraic over  $F$ , then there is an element  $c$  in  $F(a, b)$  such that  $F(a, b) = F(c)$ .*

**PROOF** Let  $p(x)$  and  $q(x)$  be the minimal polynomials over  $F$  for  $a$  and  $b$ , respectively. In some extension  $K$  of  $F$ , let  $a_1, a_2, \dots, a_m$  and  $b_1, b_2, \dots, b_n$  be the distinct zeros of  $p(x)$  and  $q(x)$ , respectively, where  $a = a_1$  and  $b = b_1$ . Among the infinitely many elements of  $F$ , choose an element

$d$  not equal to  $(a_i - a)/(b - b_j)$  for all  $i \geq 1$  and all  $j > 1$ . In particular,  $a_i \neq a + d(b - b_j)$  for  $j > 1$ .

We shall show that  $c = a + db$  has the property that  $F(a, b) = F(c)$ . Certainly,  $F(c) \subseteq F(a, b)$ . To verify that  $F(a, b) \subseteq F(c)$ , it suffices to prove that  $b \in F(c)$ , for then  $b, c$ , and  $d$  belong to  $F(c)$  and  $a = c - bd$ . Consider the polynomials  $q(x)$  and  $r(x) = p(c - dx)$  [that is,  $r(x)$  is obtained by substituting  $c - dx$  for  $x$  in  $p(x)$ ] over  $F(c)$ . Since both  $q(b) = 0$  and  $r(b) = p(c - db) = p(a) = 0$ , both  $q(x)$  and  $r(x)$  are divisible by the minimal polynomial  $s(x)$  for  $b$  over  $F(c)$  (see Theorem 21.3). Because  $s(x) \in F(c)[x]$ , we may complete the proof by proving that  $s(x) = x - b$ . Since  $s(x)$  is a common divisor of  $q(x)$  and  $r(x)$ , the only possible zeros of  $s(x)$  in  $K$  are the zeros of  $q(x)$  that are also zeros of  $r(x)$ . But  $r(b_j) = p(c - db_j) = p(a + db - db_j) = p(a + d(b - b_j))$  and  $d$  was chosen such that  $a + d(b - b_j) \neq a_i$  for  $j > 1$ . It follows that  $b$  is the only zero of  $s(x)$  in  $K[x]$  and, therefore,  $s(x) = (x - b)^u$ . Since  $s(x)$  is irreducible and  $F$  has characteristic 0, Theorem 20.6 guarantees that  $u = 1$ . ■

In the terminology introduced earlier, it follows from Theorem 21.6 and induction that any finite extension of a field of characteristic 0 is a simple extension. An element  $a$  with the property that  $E = F(a)$  is called a *primitive element* of  $E$ .

## Properties of Algebraic Extensions

### ■ Theorem 21.7 Algebraic over Algebraic Is Algebraic

*If  $K$  is an algebraic extension of  $E$  and  $E$  is an algebraic extension of  $F$ , then  $K$  is an algebraic extension of  $F$ .*

**PROOF** Let  $a \in K$ . It suffices to show that  $a$  belongs to some finite extension of  $F$ . Since  $a$  is algebraic over  $E$ , we know that  $a$  is the zero of some irreducible polynomial in  $E[x]$ , say,  $p(x) = b_n x^n + \cdots + b_0$ . Now we construct a tower of extension fields of  $F$ , as follows:

$$\begin{aligned} F_0 &= F(b_0), \\ F_1 &= F_0(b_1), \dots, F_n = F_{n-1}(b_n). \end{aligned}$$

In particular,

$$F_n = F(b_0, b_1, \dots, b_n),$$

so that  $p(x) \in F_n[x]$ . Thus,  $[F_n(a):F_n] = n$ ; and, because each  $b_i$  is algebraic over  $F$ , we know that each  $[F_{i+1}:F_i]$  is finite. So,

$$[F_n(a):F] = [F_n(a):F_n][F_n:F_{n-1}] \cdots [F_1:F_0][F_0:F]$$

is finite. (See Figure 21.5.) ■

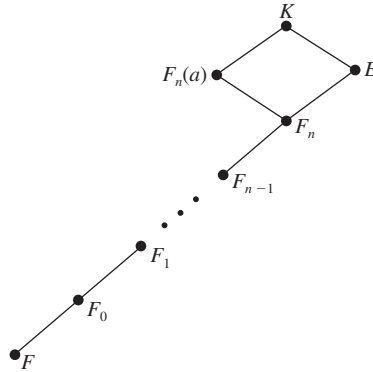


Figure 21.5

### ■ Corollary Subfield of Algebraic Elements

*Let  $E$  be an extension field of the field  $F$ . Then the set of all elements of  $E$  that are algebraic over  $F$  is a subfield of  $E$ .*

**PROOF** Suppose that  $a, b \in E$  are algebraic over  $F$  and  $b \neq 0$ . To show that  $a + b$ ,  $a - b$ ,  $ab$ , and  $a/b$  are algebraic over  $F$ , it suffices to show that  $[F(a, b):F]$  is finite, since each of these four elements belongs to  $F(a, b)$ . But note that

$$[F(a, b):F] = [F(a, b):F(b)][F(b):F].$$

Also, since  $a$  is algebraic over  $F$ , it is certainly algebraic over  $F(b)$ . Thus, both  $[F(a, b):F(b)]$  and  $[F(b):F]$  are finite. ■

For any extension  $E$  of a field  $F$ , the subfield of  $E$  of the elements that are algebraic over  $F$  is called the *algebraic closure of  $F$  in  $E$* .

One might wonder if there is such a thing as a maximal algebraic extension of a field  $F$ —that is, whether there is an algebraic extension  $E$  of  $F$  that has no proper algebraic extensions. For such an  $E$  to exist, it is necessary that every polynomial in  $E[x]$  splits in  $E$ . Otherwise, it follows from Kronecker's Theorem that  $E$  would have a proper algebraic extension. This condition is also sufficient. If every member of  $E[x]$  splits in  $E$ , and  $K$  is an algebraic extension of  $E$ , then every member of  $K$  is a zero of some element of  $E[x]$ . But the zeros of elements of  $E[x]$  are in  $E$ . A field that has no proper algebraic extension is called *algebraically closed*. In 1910, Ernst Steinitz proved that every field  $F$  has a unique (up to isomorphism) algebraic extension that is algebraically closed. This field is called the *algebraic closure of  $F$* . A proof of this result requires a sophisticated set theory background.

In 1799, Gauss, at the age of 22, proved that  $\mathbf{C}$  is algebraically closed. This fact was considered so important at the time that it was called the Fundamental Theorem of Algebra. Over a 50-year period, Gauss found three additional proofs of the Fundamental Theorem. Today more than 100 proofs exist. In view of the ascendancy of abstract algebra in the 20th century, a more appropriate phrase for Gauss's result would be the Fundamental Theorem of Classical Algebra.

## Exercises

It matters not what goal you seek  
 Its secret here reposes:  
 You've got to dig from week to week  
 To get Results or Roses.

Edgar Guest

1. Prove Theorem 21.2 and Theorem 21.3.
2. Let  $E$  be the algebraic closure of  $F$ . Show that every polynomial in  $F[x]$  splits in  $E$ .
3. Prove that  $Q(\sqrt{2}, \sqrt[3]{2}, \sqrt[4]{2}, \dots)$  is an algebraic extension of  $Q$  but not a finite extension of  $Q$ . (This exercise is referred to in this chapter.)
4. Let  $E$  be an algebraic extension of  $F$ . If every polynomial in  $F[x]$  splits in  $E$ , show that  $E$  is algebraically closed.
5. Suppose that  $F$  is a field and every irreducible polynomial in  $F[x]$  is linear. Show that  $F$  is algebraically closed.
6. Suppose that  $f(x)$  and  $g(x)$  are irreducible over  $F$  and that  $\deg f(x)$  and  $\deg g(x)$  are relatively prime. If  $a$  is a zero of  $f(x)$  in some extension of  $F$ , show that  $g(x)$  is irreducible over  $F(a)$ .
7. Let  $a$  and  $b$  belong to  $Q$  with  $b \neq 0$ . Show that  $Q(\sqrt{a}) = Q(\sqrt{b})$  if and only if there exists some  $c \in Q$  such that  $a = bc^2$ .
8. Find the degree and a basis for  $Q(\sqrt{3} + \sqrt{5})$  over  $Q(\sqrt{15})$ . Find the degree and a basis for  $Q(\sqrt{2}, \sqrt[3]{2}, \sqrt[4]{2})$  over  $Q$ .
9. Suppose that  $E$  is an extension of  $F$  of prime degree. Show that, for every  $a$  in  $E$ ,  $F(a) = F$  or  $F(a) = E$ .
10. If  $[F(a):F] = 5$ , find  $[F(a^3):F]$ . Does your argument apply equally well if  $a^3$  is replaced with  $a^2$  or  $a^4$ ?
11. Without using the Primitive Element Theorem, prove that if  $[K:F]$  is prime, then  $K$  has a primitive element.
12. Let  $a$  be a complex number that is algebraic over  $Q$ . Show that  $\sqrt{a}$  is algebraic over  $Q$ .

13. Let  $\beta$  be a zero of  $f(x) = x^5 + 2x + 4$  (see Example 8 in Chapter 17). Show that none of  $\sqrt{2}, \sqrt[3]{2}, \sqrt[4]{2}$  belongs to  $Q(\beta)$ .
14. Prove that  $Q(\sqrt{2}, \sqrt[3]{2}) = Q(\sqrt[6]{2})$ .
15. Let  $a$  and  $b$  be rational numbers. Show that  $Q(\sqrt{a}, \sqrt{b}) = Q(\sqrt{a} + \sqrt{b})$ .
16. Find the minimal polynomial for  $\sqrt[3]{2} + \sqrt[3]{4}$  over  $Q$ .
17. Let  $K$  be an extension of  $F$ . Suppose that  $E_1$  and  $E_2$  are contained in  $K$  and are extensions of  $F$ . If  $[E_1:F]$  and  $[E_2:F]$  are both prime, show that  $E_1 = E_2$  or  $E_1 \cap E_2 = F$ .
18. Let  $a$  be a nonzero algebraic element over  $F$  of degree  $n$ . Show that  $a^{-1}$  is also algebraic over  $F$  of degree  $n$ .
19. Suppose that  $a$  is algebraic over a field  $F$ . Show that  $a$  and  $1 + a^{-1}$  have the same degree over  $F$ .
20. If  $ab$  is algebraic over  $F$  and  $b \neq 0$ , prove that  $a$  is algebraic over  $F(b)$ .
21. Let  $E$  be an algebraic extension of a field  $F$ . If  $R$  is a ring and  $E \supseteq R \supseteq F$ , show that  $R$  must be a field.
22. Prove that  $\pi^2 - 1$  is algebraic over  $Q(\pi^3)$ .
23. If  $a$  is transcendental over  $F$ , show that every element of  $F(a)$  that is not in  $F$  is transcendental over  $F$ .
24. Suppose that  $E$  is an extension of  $F$  and  $a, b \in E$ . If  $a$  is algebraic over  $F$  of degree  $m$ , and  $b$  is algebraic over  $F$  of degree  $n$ , where  $m$  and  $n$  are relatively prime, show that  $[F(a, b):F] = mn$ .
25. Let  $K$  be a field extension of  $F$  and let  $a \in K$ . Show that  $[F(a):F(a^3)] \leq 3$ . Find examples to illustrate that  $[F(a):F(a^3)]$  can be 1, 2, or 3.
26. Find an example of a field  $F$  and elements  $a$  and  $b$  from some extension field such that  $F(a, b) \neq F(a)$ ,  $F(a, b) \neq F(b)$ , and  $[F(a, b):F] < [F(a):F][F(b):F]$ .
27. Let  $E$  be a finite extension of  $\mathbf{R}$ . Use the fact that  $\mathbf{C}$  is algebraically closed to prove that  $E = \mathbf{C}$  or  $E = \mathbf{R}$ .
28. Suppose that  $[E:Q] = 2$ . Show that there is an integer  $d$  such that  $E = Q(\sqrt{d})$  where  $d$  is not divisible by the square of any prime.
29. Suppose that  $p(x) \in F[x]$  and  $E$  is a finite extension of  $F$ . If  $p(x)$  is irreducible over  $F$ , and  $\deg p(x)$  and  $[E:F]$  are relatively prime, show that  $p(x)$  is irreducible over  $E$ .
30. Let  $E$  be an extension field of  $F$ . Show that  $[E:F]$  is finite if and only if  $E = F(a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n)$ , where  $a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n$  are algebraic over  $F$ .
31. If  $\alpha$  and  $\beta$  are real numbers and  $\alpha$  and  $\beta$  are transcendental over  $Q$ , show that either  $\alpha\beta$  or  $\alpha + \beta$  is also transcendental over  $Q$ .

32. Let  $f(x)$  be a nonconstant element of  $F[x]$ . If  $a$  belongs to some extension of  $F$  and  $f(a)$  is algebraic over  $F$ , prove that  $a$  is algebraic over  $F$ .
33. Let  $f(x) = ax^2 + bx + c \in Q[x]$ . Find a primitive element for the splitting field for  $f(x)$  over  $Q$ .
34. Let  $f(x)$  and  $g(x)$  be irreducible polynomials over a field  $F$  and let  $a$  and  $b$  belong to some extension  $E$  of  $F$ . If  $a$  is a zero of  $f(x)$  and  $b$  is a zero of  $g(x)$ , show that  $f(x)$  is irreducible over  $F(b)$  if and only if  $g(x)$  is irreducible over  $F(a)$ .
35. Let  $f(x) \in F[x]$ . If  $\deg f(x) = 2$  and  $a$  is a zero of  $f(x)$  in some extension of  $F$ , prove that  $F(a)$  is the splitting field for  $f(x)$  over  $F$ .
36. Let  $a$  be a complex zero of  $x^2 + x + 1$  over  $Q$ . Prove that  $Q(\sqrt{a}) = Q(a)$ .
37. If  $F$  is a field and the multiplicative group of nonzero elements of  $F$  is cyclic, prove that  $F$  is finite.
38. Let  $a$  be a complex number that is algebraic over  $Q$  and let  $r$  be a rational number. Show that  $a^r$  is algebraic over  $Q$ .
39. Prove that, if  $K$  is an extension field of  $F$ , then  $[K:F] = n$  if and only if  $K$  is isomorphic to  $F^n$  as vector spaces. (See Exercise 27 in Chapter 19 for the appropriate definition. This exercise is referred to in this chapter.)
40. Let  $a$  be a positive real number and let  $n$  be an integer greater than 1. Prove or disprove that  $[Q(a^{1/n}):Q] = n$ .
41. Let  $a$  and  $b$  belong to some extension field of  $F$  and let  $b$  be algebraic over  $F$ . Prove that  $[F(a, b):F(a)] \leq [F(a, b):F]$ .
42. Let  $F, K$ , and  $L$  be fields with  $F \subseteq K \subseteq L$ . If  $L$  is a finite extension of  $F$  and  $[L:F] = [L:K]$ , prove that  $F = K$ .
43. Let  $F$  be a field and  $K$  a splitting field for some nonconstant polynomial over  $F$ . Show that  $K$  is a finite extension of  $F$ .
44. Prove that  $\mathbf{C}$  is not the splitting field of any polynomial in  $Q[x]$ .
45. Prove that  $\sqrt{2}$  is not an element of  $Q(\pi)$ .
46. Let  $\alpha = \cos \frac{2\pi}{7} + i \sin \frac{2\pi}{7}$  and  $\beta = \cos \frac{2\pi}{5} + i \sin \frac{2\pi}{5}$ . Prove that  $\beta$  is not in  $Q(\alpha)$ .
47. Let  $m$  be a positive integer. If  $a$  is transcendental over a field  $F$ , prove that  $a^m$  is transcendental over  $F$ .
48. Suppose  $K$  is an extension of  $F$  of degree  $n$ . Prove that  $K$  can be written in the form  $F(x_1, x_2, \dots, x_n)$  for some  $x_1, x_2, \dots, x_n$  in  $K$ .
49. Prove that there are no positive integers  $m$  and  $n$  such that  $\sqrt{2^m} = \pi^n$ .



## Suggested Readings

R. L. Roth, “On Extensions of  $\mathbb{Q}$  by Square Roots,” *American Mathematical Monthly* 78 (1971): 392–393.

In this paper, it is proved that if  $p_1, p_2, \dots, p_n$  are distinct primes, then  $[\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{p_1}, \sqrt{p_2}, \dots, \sqrt{p_n}) : \mathbb{Q}] = 2^n$ .

Paul B. Yale, “Automorphisms of the Complex Numbers,” *Mathematics Magazine* 39 (1966): 135–141.

This award-winning expository paper is devoted to various results on automorphisms of the complex numbers.

## Ernst Steinitz

One cannot overestimate the importance of this paper [by Steinitz]. The appearance of this paper marks a turning point in the history of algebra of the 20th century.

BARTEL VAN DER WAERDEN



Author: George M. Bergman, Source: Archives of the Mathematisches Forschungsinstitut Oberwolfach

ERNST STEINITZ was born in Laurahütte, Silesia, Germany (now in Poland) on June 13, 1871. He received a Ph.D. at the University of Breslau in 1894. Steinitz's seminal work was a 1910 paper in which he was the first to give an abstract definition of the concept of a "field." Among the concepts he introduced there are: prime field, perfect fields, degree of an extension, and algebraic closure. In his classic textbook on Modern Algebra Van der Waerden wrote: "Almost all the notions and facts about fields which we teach our students in such a course, are contained in Steinitz's paper." Hulmut Hasse wrote in his textbook on "Higher Algebra": "Every algebraist should have read at least once this basic original paper on field theory." In their book on the

history of mathematics Bourbaki describe Steinitz's paper on fields as "a fundamental work which may be considered as the origin of today's concept of algebra."

In addition to field theory Steinitz made important contributions to theory of polyhedra, module theory, linear algebra, algebraic geometry and graph theory. Two of his famous theorems are the "Steinitz replacement theorem" for vector spaces and the "Primitive Element Theorem." He died on September 29, 1928 in Kiel, Germany.

To find more information about Steinitz, visit

**[www.rzuser.uni-heidelberg.de/~ci3/STEINITZ.pdf](http://www.rzuser.uni-heidelberg.de/~ci3/STEINITZ.pdf)**

## 22 Finite Fields

Even though these numerical systems [finite fields] look very different from the numerical systems we are used to, such as the rational numbers, they have the same salient properties.

Edward Frenkel, *Love and Math*

This theory [of finite fields] is of considerable interest in its own right and it provides a particularly beautiful example of how the general theory of the preceding chapters fits together to provide a rather detailed description of all finite fields.

Richard A. Dean, *Elements of Abstract Algebra*

### Classification of Finite Fields

In this, our final chapter on field theory, we take up one of the most beautiful and important areas of abstract algebra—finite fields. Finite fields were first introduced by Galois in 1830 in his proof of the unsolvability of the general quintic equation. When Cayley invented matrices a few decades later, it was natural to investigate groups of matrices over finite fields. To this day, matrix groups over finite fields are among the most important classes of groups. In the past 60 years, there have been important applications of finite fields in computer science, coding theory, information theory, and cryptography. But, besides the many uses of finite fields in pure and applied mathematics, there is yet another good reason for studying them. They are just plain fun!

The most striking fact about finite fields is the restricted nature of their order and structure. We have already seen that every finite field has prime-power order (Exercise 51 in Chapter 13). A converse of sorts is also true.

#### ■ Theorem 22.1 Classification of Finite Fields

*For each prime  $p$  and each positive integer  $n$ , there is, up to isomorphism, a unique finite field of order  $p^n$ .*

**PROOF** Consider the splitting field  $E$  of  $f(x) = x^{p^n} - x$  over  $Z_p$ . We will show that  $|E| = p^n$ . Since  $f(x)$  splits in  $E$ , we know that  $f(x)$  has exactly  $p^n$  zeros in  $E$ , counting multiplicity. Moreover, by Theorem 20.5, every zero of  $f(x)$  has multiplicity 1. Thus,  $f(x)$  has  $p^n$  distinct zeros in  $E$ . On the other hand, the set of zeros of  $f(x)$  in  $E$  is closed under addition, subtraction, multiplication, and division by nonzero elements (see Exercise 39), so that the set of zeros of  $f(x)$  is itself an extension field of  $Z_p$  in which  $f(x)$  splits. Thus, the set of zeros of  $f(x)$  is  $E$  and, therefore,  $|E| = p^n$ .

To show that there is a unique field for each prime-power, suppose that  $K$  is any field of order  $p^n$ . Then  $K$  has a subfield isomorphic to  $Z_p$  (generated by 1), and, because the nonzero elements of  $K$  form a multiplicative group of order  $p^n - 1$ , every element of  $K$  is a zero of  $f(x) = x^{p^n} - x$  (see Exercise 29). So,  $K$  must be a splitting field for  $f(x)$  over  $Z_p$ . By the corollary to Theorem 20.4, there is only one such field up to isomorphism. ■

The existence portion of Theorem 22.1 appeared in the works of Galois and Gauss in the first third of the 19th century. Rigorous proofs were given by Dedekind in 1857 and by Jordan in 1870 in his classic book on group theory. The uniqueness portion of the theorem was proved by E. H. Moore in an 1893 paper concerning finite groups. The mathematics historian E. T. Bell once said that this paper by Moore marked the beginning of abstract algebra in America.

Because there is only one field for each prime-power  $p^n$ , we may unambiguously denote it by  $\text{GF}(p^n)$ , in honor of Galois, and call it the *Galois field of order  $p^n$* .

## Structure of Finite Fields

The next theorem tells us the additive and multiplicative group structure of a field of order  $p^n$ .

### ■ Theorem 22.2 Structure of Finite Fields

*As a group under addition,  $\text{GF}(p^n)$  is isomorphic to*

$$\underbrace{Z_p \oplus Z_p \oplus \dots \oplus Z_p}_{n \text{ factors}}$$

*As a group under multiplication, the set of nonzero elements of  $\text{GF}(p^n)$  is isomorphic to  $Z_{p^n-1}$  (and is, therefore, cyclic).*

**PROOF** Since  $\text{GF}(p^n)$  has characteristic  $p$  (Theorem 13.3), every nonzero element of  $\text{GF}(p^n)$  has additive order  $p$ . Then by the Fundamental Theorem of Finite Abelian Groups,  $\text{GF}(p^n)$  under addition is isomorphic to a direct product of  $n$  copies of  $Z_p$ .

To see that the multiplicative group  $\text{GF}(p^n)^*$  of nonzero elements of  $\text{GF}(p^n)$  is cyclic, we first note that by the Fundamental Theorem of Finite Abelian Groups (Theorem 11.1),  $\text{GF}(p^n)^*$  is isomorphic to a direct product of the form  $Z_{n_1} \oplus Z_{n_2} \oplus \cdots \oplus Z_{n_m}$ . If the orders of these components are pairwise relatively prime, then it follows from Corollary 1 of Theorem 8.2 that  $\text{GF}(p^n)^*$  is cyclic. Hence we may assume that there is an integer  $d > 1$  that divides the orders of two of the components. From the Fundamental Theorem of Cyclic Groups (Theorem 4.3) we know that each of these components has a subgroup of order  $d$ . This means that  $\text{GF}(p^n)^*$  has two distinct subgroups of order  $d$ , call them  $H$  and  $K$ . But then every element of  $H$  and  $K$  is a zero of  $x^d - 1$ , which contradicts the fact that a polynomial of degree  $d$  over a field can have at most  $d$  zeros (Corollary 3 of Theorem 16.2). ■

Some students misinterpret Theorem 22.2 to mean that  $Z_p \oplus Z_p \oplus \cdots \oplus Z_p$  is a field of order  $p^n$ . Since any element of  $Z_p \oplus Z_p \oplus \cdots \oplus Z_p$  that has at least one coordinate equal to 0 cannot have an inverse, it is not a field.

Since  $Z_p \oplus Z_p \oplus \cdots \oplus Z_p$  is a vector space over  $Z_p$  with  $\{(1, 0, \dots, 0), (0, 1, 0, \dots, 0), \dots, (0, 0, \dots, 1)\}$  as a basis, we have the following useful and aesthetically appealing formula.

### ■ Corollary 1

$$[\text{GF}(p^n):\text{GF}(p)] = n$$

### ■ Corollary 2 $\text{GF}(p^n)$ Contains an Element of Degree $n$

*Let  $a$  be a generator of the group of nonzero elements of  $\text{GF}(p^n)$  under multiplication. Then  $a$  is algebraic over  $\text{GF}(p)$  of degree  $n$ .*

**PROOF** Observe that  $[\text{GF}(p)(a):\text{GF}(p)] = [\text{GF}(p^n):\text{GF}(p)] = n$ . ■

■ **EXAMPLE 1** Let's examine the field  $\text{GF}(16)$  in detail. Since  $x^4 + x + 1$  is irreducible over  $Z_2$ , we know that

$$\text{GF}(16) \approx \{ax^3 + bx^2 + cx + d + \langle x^4 + x + 1 \rangle \mid a, b, c, d \in Z_2\}.$$

Thus, we may think of  $\text{GF}(16)$  as the set

$$F = \{ax^3 + bx^2 + cx + d \mid a, b, c, d \in Z_2\},$$

where addition is done as in  $Z_2[x]$ , but multiplication is done modulo  $x^4 + x + 1$ . For example,

$$(x^3 + x^2 + x + 1)(x^3 + x) = x^3 + x^2,$$

since the remainder upon dividing

$$(x^3 + x^2 + x + 1)(x^3 + x) = x^6 + x^5 + x^2 + x$$

by  $x^4 + x + 1$  in  $Z_2[x]$  is  $x^3 + x^2$ . An easier way to perform the same calculation is to observe that in this context  $x^4 + x + 1$  is 0, so

$$\begin{aligned} x^4 &= -x - 1 = x + 1, \\ x^5 &= x^2 + x, \\ x^6 &= x^3 + x^2. \end{aligned}$$

Thus,

$$x^6 + x^5 + x^2 + x = (x^3 + x^2) + (x^2 + x) + x^2 + x = x^3 + x^2.$$

Another way to simplify the multiplication process is to make use of the fact that the nonzero elements of  $\text{GF}(16)$  form a cyclic group of order 15. To take advantage of this, we must first find a generator of this group. Since any element  $F^*$  must have a multiplicative order that divides 15, all we need to do is find an element  $\alpha$  in  $F^*$  such that  $\alpha^3 \neq 1$  and  $\alpha^5 \neq 1$ . Obviously,  $x$  has these properties. So, we may think of  $\text{GF}(16)$  as the set  $\{0, 1, x, x^2, \dots, x^{14}\}$ , where  $x^{15} = 1$ . This makes multiplication in  $F$  trivial, but, unfortunately, it makes addition more difficult. For example,  $x^{10} \cdot x^7 = x^{17} = x^2$ , but what is  $x^{10} + x^7$ ? So, we face a dilemma. If we write the elements of  $F^*$  in the additive form  $ax^3 + bx^2 + cx + d$ , then addition is easy and multiplication is hard. On the other hand, if we write the elements of  $F^*$  in the multiplicative form  $x^i$ , then multiplication is easy and addition is hard. Can we have the best of both? Yes, we can. All we need to do is use the relation  $x^4 = x + 1$  to make a two-way conversion table, as in Table 22.1.

So, we see from Table 22.1 that

$$\begin{aligned} x^{10} + x^7 &= (x^2 + x + 1) + (x^3 + x + 1) \\ &= x^3 + x^2 = x^6 \end{aligned}$$

and

$$\begin{aligned} (x^3 + x^2 + 1)(x^3 + x^2 + x + 1) &= x^{13} \cdot x^{12} \\ &= x^{25} = x^{10} = x^2 + x + 1. \quad \blacksquare \end{aligned}$$

Don't be misled by the preceding example into believing that the element  $x$  is always a generator for the cyclic multiplicative group of nonzero elements. It is not. (See Exercise 21.) Although any two

**Table 22.1** Conversion Table for Addition and Multiplication in GF(16)

| Multiplicative Form to Additive Form |                     | Additive Form to Multiplicative Form |          |
|--------------------------------------|---------------------|--------------------------------------|----------|
| 1                                    | 1                   | 1                                    | 1        |
| $x$                                  | $x$                 | $x$                                  | $x$      |
| $x^2$                                | $x^2$               | $x + 1$                              | $x^4$    |
| $x^3$                                | $x^3$               | $x^2$                                | $x^2$    |
| $x^4$                                | $x + 1$             | $x^2 + x$                            | $x^5$    |
| $x^5$                                | $x^2 + x$           | $x^2 + 1$                            | $x^8$    |
| $x^6$                                | $x^3 + x^2$         | $x^2 + x + 1$                        | $x^{10}$ |
| $x^7$                                | $x^3 + x + 1$       | $x^3$                                | $x^3$    |
| $x^8$                                | $x^2 + 1$           | $x^3 + x^2$                          | $x^6$    |
| $x^9$                                | $x^3 + x$           | $x^3 + x$                            | $x^9$    |
| $x^{10}$                             | $x^2 + x + 1$       | $x^3 + 1$                            | $x^{14}$ |
| $x^{11}$                             | $x^3 + x^2 + x$     | $x^3 + x^2 + x$                      | $x^{11}$ |
| $x^{12}$                             | $x^3 + x^2 + x + 1$ | $x^3 + x^2 + 1$                      | $x^{13}$ |
| $x^{13}$                             | $x^3 + x^2 + 1$     | $x^3 + x + 1$                        | $x^7$    |
| $x^{14}$                             | $x^3 + 1$           | $x^3 + x^2 + x + 1$                  | $x^{12}$ |

irreducible polynomials of the same degree over  $Z_p[x]$  yield isomorphic fields, some are better than others for computational purposes.

■ **EXAMPLE 2** Consider  $f(x) = x^3 + x^2 + 1$  over  $Z_2$ . We will show how to write  $f(x)$  as the product of linear factors. Let  $F = Z_2[x]/\langle f(x) \rangle$  and let  $a$  be a zero of  $f(x)$  in  $F$ . Then  $|F| = 8$  and  $|F^*| = 7$ . So, by Corollary 2 to Theorem 7.1, we know that  $|a| = 7$ . Thus, by Theorem 20.3,

$$\begin{aligned} F &= \{0, 1, a, a^2, a^3, a^4, a^5, a^6\} \\ &= \{0, 1, a, a + 1, a^2, a^2 + a + 1, a^2 + 1, a^2 + a\}. \end{aligned}$$

We know that  $a$  is one zero of  $f(x)$ , and we can test the other elements of  $F$  to see if they are zeros. We can simplify the calculations by using the fact that  $a^3 + a^2 + 1 = 0$  to make a conversion table for the two forms of writing the elements of  $F$ . Because  $\text{char } F = 2$ , we know that  $a^3 = a^2 + 1$ . Then,

$$\begin{aligned} a^4 &= a^3 + a = (a^2 + 1) + a = a^2 + a + 1, \\ a^5 &= a^3 + a^2 + a = (a^2 + 1) + a^2 + a = a + 1, \\ a^6 &= a^2 + a, \\ a^7 &= 1. \end{aligned}$$

Now let's see whether  $a^2$  is a zero of  $f(x)$ .

$$\begin{aligned} f(a^2) &= (a^2)^3 + (a^2)^2 + 1 = a^6 + a^4 + 1 \\ &= (a^2 + a) + (a^2 + a + 1) + 1 = 0. \end{aligned}$$

So, yes, it is. Next we try  $a^3$ .

$$\begin{aligned} f(a^3) &= (a^3)^3 + (a^3)^2 + 1 = a^9 + a^6 + 1 \\ &= a^2 + (a^2 + a) + 1 = a + 1 \neq 0. \end{aligned}$$

Now  $a^4$ .

$$\begin{aligned} f(a^4) &= (a^4)^3 + (a^4)^2 + 1 = a^{12} + a^8 + 1 \\ &= a^5 + a + 1 = (a + 1) + a + 1 = 0. \end{aligned}$$

So,  $a^4$  is our remaining zero. Thus,  $f(x) = (x - a)(x - a^2)(x - a^4) = (x + a)(x + a^2)(x + a^4)$ , since  $\text{char } F = 2$ .

We may check this factorization by expanding the product and using a conversion table to obtain  $f(x) = x^3 + x^2 + 1$ . ■

## Subfields of a Finite Field

Theorem 22.1 gives us a complete description of all finite fields. The following theorem gives us a complete description of all the subfields of a finite field. Notice the close analogy between this theorem and Theorem 4.3, which describes all the subgroups of a finite cyclic group.

### ■ Theorem 22.3 Subfields of a Finite Field

*For each divisor  $m$  of  $n$ ,  $\text{GF}(p^n)$  has a unique subfield of order  $p^m$ . Moreover, these are the only subfields of  $\text{GF}(p^n)$ .*

**PROOF** To show the existence portion of the theorem, suppose that  $m$  divides  $n$ . Then, since

$$p^n - 1 = (p^m - 1)(p^{n-m} + p^{n-2m} + \cdots + p^m + 1),$$

we see that  $p^m - 1$  divides  $p^n - 1$ . For simplicity, write  $p^n - 1 = (p^m - 1)t$ . Let  $K = \{x \in \text{GF}(p^n) \mid x^{p^m} = x\}$ . We leave it as an easy exercise for the reader to show that  $K$  is a subfield of  $\text{GF}(p^n)$  (Exercise 27). Since the polynomial  $x^{p^m} - x$  has at most  $p^m$  zeros in  $\text{GF}(p^n)$ , we have  $|K| \leq p^m$ . Let  $\langle a \rangle = \text{GF}(p^n)^*$ . Then  $|a^t| = p^m - 1$ , and since  $(a^t)^{p^m-1} = 1$ , it follows that  $a^t \in K$ . So,  $K$  is a subfield of  $\text{GF}(p^n)$  of order  $p^m$ .

The uniqueness portion of the theorem follows from the observation that if  $\text{GF}(p^n)$  had two distinct subfields of order  $p^m$ , then the polynomial  $x^{p^m} - x$  would have more than  $p^m$  zeros in  $\text{GF}(p^n)$ . This contradicts Corollary 3 of Theorem 16.2.



Finally, suppose that  $F$  is a subfield of  $\text{GF}(p^n)$ . Then  $F$  is isomorphic to  $\text{GF}(p^m)$  for some  $m$  and, by Theorem 21.5,

$$\begin{aligned} n &= [\text{GF}(p^n):\text{GF}(p)] \\ &= [\text{GF}(p^n):\text{GF}(p^m)][\text{GF}(p^m):\text{GF}(p)] \\ &= [\text{GF}(p^n):\text{GF}(p^m)]m. \end{aligned}$$

Thus,  $m$  divides  $n$ . ■

Theorems 22.2 and 22.3, together with Theorem 4.3, make the task of finding the subfields of a finite field a simple exercise in arithmetic.

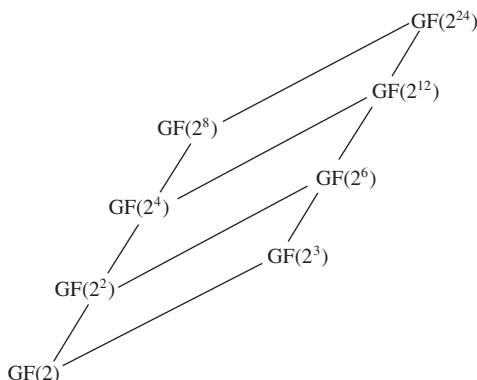
**EXAMPLE 3** Let  $F$  be the field of order 16 given in Example 1. Then there are exactly three subfields of  $F$ , and their orders are 2, 4, and 16. Obviously, the subfield of order 2 is  $\{0, 1\}$  and the subfield of order 16 is  $F$  itself. To find the subfield of order 4, we merely observe that the three nonzero elements of this subfield must be the cyclic subgroup of  $F^* = \langle x \rangle$  of order 3. So the subfield of order 4 is

$$\{0, 1, x^5, x^{10}\} = \{0, 1, x^2 + x, x^2 + x + 1\}. \quad \blacksquare$$

**EXAMPLE 4** If  $F$  is a field of order  $3^6 = 729$  and  $\alpha$  is a generator of  $F^*$ , then the subfields of  $F$  are

1.  $\text{GF}(3) = \{0\} \cup \langle \alpha^{364} \rangle = \{0, 1, 2\},$
  2.  $\text{GF}(9) = \{0\} \cup \langle \alpha^{91} \rangle,$
  3.  $\text{GF}(27) = \{0\} \cup \langle \alpha^{28} \rangle,$
  4.  $\text{GF}(729) = \{0\} \cup \langle \alpha \rangle.$
- 

**EXAMPLE 5** The subfield lattice of  $\text{GF}(2^{24})$  is the following.



## Exercises

No pressure, no diamonds.

Mary Case

1. Find  $[\text{GF}(729):\text{GF}(9)]$  and  $[\text{GF}(64):\text{GF}(8)]$ .
2. If  $m$  divides  $n$ , show that  $[\text{GF}(p^n):\text{GF}(p^m)] = n/m$ .
3. Draw the lattice of subfields of  $\text{GF}(64)$ .
4. Let  $\alpha$  be a zero of  $x^3 + x^2 + 1$  in some extension field of  $Z_2$ . Find the multiplicative inverse of  $\alpha + 1$  in  $Z_2[\alpha]$ .
5. Let  $\alpha$  be a zero of  $x^3 + x^2 + 1$  in some extension field of  $Z_2$ . Solve the equation  $(\alpha + 1)x + \alpha = \alpha^2 + 1$  for  $x$ .
6. Prove that every non-identity element in  $\text{GF}(32)^*$  is a generator of  $\text{GF}(32)^*$ .
7. Let  $\alpha$  be a zero of  $f(x) = x^2 + 2x + 2$  in some extension field of  $Z_3$ . Find the other zero of  $f(x)$  in  $Z_3[\alpha]$ .
8. Let  $\alpha$  be a zero of  $f(x) = x^3 + x + 1$  in some extension field of  $Z_2$ . Find the other zeros of  $f(x)$  in  $Z_2[\alpha]$ .
9. Let  $K$  be a finite extension field of a finite field  $F$ . Show that there is an element  $a$  in  $K$  such that  $K = F(a)$ .
10. How many elements of the cyclic group  $\text{GF}(81)^*$  are generators?
11. Let  $f(x)$  be a cubic irreducible over  $Z_2$ . Prove that the splitting field of  $f(x)$  over  $Z_2$  has order 8.
12. Prove that the rings  $Z_3[x]/\langle x^2 + x + 2 \rangle$  and  $Z_3[x]/\langle x^2 + 2x + 2 \rangle$  are isomorphic.
13. Show that the *Frobenius mapping*  $\phi: \text{GF}(p^n) \rightarrow \text{GF}(p^n)$ , given by  $a \rightarrow a^p$ , is a ring automorphism of order  $n$  (that is,  $\phi^n$  is the identity mapping). (This exercise is referred to in Chapter 32.)
14. Determine the possible finite fields whose largest proper subfield is  $\text{GF}(2^5)$ .
15. Prove that the degree of any irreducible factor of  $x^8 - x$  over  $Z_2$  is 1 or 3.
16. Find the smallest field that has exactly 6 subfields.
17. Find the smallest field of characteristic 2 that contains an element whose multiplicative order is 5 and the smallest field of characteristic 3 that contains an element whose multiplicative order is 5.
18. Verify that the factorization for  $f(x) = x^3 + x^2 + 1$  over  $Z_2$  given in Example 2 is correct by expanding.
19. Show that  $x$  is a generator of the cyclic group  $(Z_3[x]/\langle x^3 + 2x + 1 \rangle)^*$ .
20. Suppose that  $f(x)$  is a fifth-degree polynomial that is irreducible over  $Z_2$ . Prove that  $x$  is a generator of the cyclic group  $(Z_2[x]/\langle f(x) \rangle)^*$ .

21. Show that  $x$  is not a generator of the cyclic group  $(Z_3[x]/\langle x^3 + 2x + 2 \rangle)^*$ . Find one such generator.
22. If  $f(x)$  is a cubic irreducible polynomial over  $Z_3$ , prove that either  $x$  or  $2x$  is a generator for the cyclic group  $(Z_3[x]/\langle f(x) \rangle)^*$ .
23. Prove the uniqueness portion of Theorem 22.3 using a group theoretic argument.
24. Suppose that  $\alpha$  and  $\beta$  belong to  $\text{GF}(81)^*$ , with  $|\alpha| = 5$  and  $|\beta| = 16$ . Show that  $\alpha\beta$  is a generator of  $\text{GF}(81)^*$ .
25. Construct a field of order 9 and carry out the analysis as in Example 1, including the conversion table.
26. Show that any finite subgroup of the multiplicative group of a field is cyclic.
27. Show that the set  $K$  in the proof of Theorem 22.3 is a subfield.
28. If  $g(x)$  is irreducible over  $\text{GF}(p)$  and  $g(x)$  divides  $x^{p^n} - x$ , prove that  $\deg g(x)$  divides  $n$ .
29. Use a purely group theoretic argument to show that if  $F$  is a field of order  $p^n$ , then every element of  $F^*$  is a zero of  $x^{p^n} - x$ . (This exercise is referred to in the proof of Theorem 22.1.)
30. Draw the subfield lattices of  $\text{GF}(3^{18})$  and of  $\text{GF}(2^{30})$ .
31. How does the subfield lattice of  $\text{GF}(2^{30})$  compare with the subfield lattice of  $\text{GF}(3^{30})$ ?
32. If  $p(x)$  is a polynomial in  $Z_p[x]$  with no multiple zeros, show that  $p(x)$  divides  $x^{p^n} - x$  for some  $n$ .
33. Suppose that  $p$  is a prime and  $p \neq 2$ . Let  $a$  be a nonsquare in  $\text{GF}(p)$ —that is,  $a$  does not have the form  $b^2$  for any  $b$  in  $\text{GF}(p)$ . Show that  $a$  is a nonsquare in  $\text{GF}(p^n)$  if  $n$  is odd and that  $a$  is a square in  $\text{GF}(p^n)$  if  $n$  is even.
34. Let  $f(x)$  be a cubic irreducible over  $Z_p$ , where  $p$  is a prime. Prove that the splitting field of  $f(x)$  over  $Z_p$  has order  $p^3$  or  $p^6$ .
35. Show that every element of  $\text{GF}(p^n)$  can be written in the form  $a^p$  for some unique  $a$  in  $\text{GF}(p^n)$ .
36. Suppose that  $F$  is a field of order 1024 and  $F^* = \langle \alpha \rangle$ . List the elements of each subfield of  $F$ .
37. Suppose that  $F$  is a field of order 125 and  $F^* = \langle \alpha \rangle$ . Show that  $\alpha^{62} = -1$ .
38. Show that no finite field is algebraically closed.
39. Let  $E$  be the splitting field of  $f(x) = x^{p^n} - x$  over  $Z_p$ . Show that the set of zeros of  $f(x)$  in  $E$  is closed under addition, subtraction, multiplication, and division (by nonzero elements). (This exercise is referred to in the proof of Theorem 22.1.)

40. Suppose that  $L$  and  $K$  are subfields of  $\text{GF}(p^n)$ . If  $L$  has  $p^s$  elements and  $K$  has  $p^t$  elements, how many elements does  $L \cap K$  have?
41. Let  $a$  be a non-zero element of  $\text{GF}(p^n)$ . Prove that the number of solutions of  $x^{p-1} = a$  is 0 or  $p - 1$ .
42. Let  $\alpha$  be a zero of an irreducible quadratic polynomial over  $Z_5$ . Prove that there are elements  $a$  and  $b$  in  $Z_5[\alpha]$  such that  $(3\alpha + 2)(a\alpha + b) = 4\alpha + 1$ .
43. Show that a finite extension of a finite field is a simple extension.
44. Let  $F$  be a finite field of order  $q$  and let  $a$  be a nonzero element in  $F$ . If  $n$  divides  $q - 1$ , prove that the equation  $x^n = a$  has either no solutions in  $F$  or  $n$  distinct solutions in  $F$ .
45. Give an example to show that the mapping  $a \rightarrow a^p$  need not be an automorphism for arbitrary fields of prime characteristic  $p$ .
46. In the field  $\text{GF}(p^n)$ , show that for every positive divisor  $d$  of  $n$ ,  $x^{p^n} - x$  has an irreducible factor over  $\text{GF}(p)$  of degree  $d$ .
47. Let  $a$  be a primitive element for the field  $\text{GF}(p^n)$ , where  $p$  is an odd prime and  $n$  is a positive integer. Find the smallest positive integer  $k$  such that  $a^k = p - 1$ .
48. Let  $a$  be a primitive element for the field  $\text{GF}(5^n)$ , where  $n$  is a positive integer. Find the smallest positive integer  $k$  such that  $a^k = 2$ .
49. Let  $p$  be a prime such that  $p \bmod 4 = 1$ . How many elements of order 4 are in  $\text{GF}(p^n)^*$ ?
50. Let  $p$  be a prime such that  $p \bmod 4 = 3$ . How many elements of order 4 are in  $\text{GF}(p^n)^*$ ?

## Computer Exercises

Software for the computer exercises in this chapter is available at the website:

<http://www.d.umn.edu/~jgallian>

## Suggested Reading

Judy L. Smith and J. A. Gallian, "Factoring Finite Factor Rings," *Mathematics Magazine* 58 (1985): 93–95.

This paper gives an algorithm for finding the group of units of the ring  $F[x]/\langle g(x)^m \rangle$ .

## L.E. Dickson

One of the books [written by L. E. Dickson] is his major, three-volume *History of the Theory of Numbers* which would be a life's work by itself for a more ordinary man.

A. A. ALBERT,  
*Bulletin of the American  
Mathematical Society*



Courtesy of the American Mathematical Society (www.ams.org)

LEONARD EUGENE DICKSON was born in Independence, Iowa, on January 22, 1874. In 1896, he received the first Ph.D. to be awarded in mathematics at the University of Chicago. After spending a few years at the University of California and the University of Texas, he was appointed to the faculty at Chicago and remained there until his retirement in 1939.

Dickson was one of the most prolific mathematicians of the 20th century, writing 267 research papers and 18 books. His principal interests were matrix groups, finite fields, algebra, and number theory.

Dickson had a disdainful attitude toward applicable mathematics; he would often say, "Thank God that number theory is unsullied by any applications." He also had a sense of humor. Dickson would often mention his

honeymoon: "It was a great success," he said, "except that I only got two research papers written."

Dickson received many honors in his career. He was the first to be awarded the prize from the American Association for the Advancement of Science for the most notable contribution to the advancement of science, and the first to receive the Cole Prize in algebra from the American Mathematical Society. The University of Chicago has research instructorships named after him. Dickson died on January 17, 1954.

For more information about Dickson, visit:

**[http://www-groups.dcs  
.st-and.ac.uk/~history/](http://www-groups.dcs.st-and.ac.uk/~history/)**

# 23 Geometric Constructions

At the age of eleven, I began Euclid. . . . This was one of the great events of my life, as dazzling as first love.

Bertrand Russell

Meton: With the straight ruler I set to work to make the circle four-cornered.

Aristophanes (ca 444–380 BC)

## Historical Discussion of Geometric Constructions

The ancient Greeks were fond of geometric constructions. They were especially interested in constructions that could be achieved using only a straightedge without markings and a compass. They knew, for example, that any angle can be bisected, and they knew how to construct an equilateral triangle, a square, a regular pentagon, and a regular hexagon. But they did not know how to trisect every angle or how to construct a regular seven-sided polygon (heptagon). Another problem that they attempted was the duplication of the cube—that is, given any cube, they tried to construct a new cube having twice the volume of the given one using only an unmarked straightedge and a compass. Legend has it that the ancient Athenians were told by the oracle at Delos that a plague would end if they constructed a new altar to Apollo in the shape of a cube with double the volume of the old altar, which was also a cube. Besides “doubling the cube,” the Greeks also attempted to “square the circle”—to construct a square with area equal to that of a given circle. They knew how to solve all these problems using other means, such as a compass and a straightedge with two marks, or an unmarked straightedge and a spiral, but they could not achieve any of the constructions with a compass and an unmarked straightedge alone. These problems vexed mathematicians for over 2000 years. The resolution of these perplexities was made possible when they were transferred from questions of geometry to questions of algebra in the 19th century.

The first of the famous problems of antiquity to be solved was that of the construction of regular polygons. It had been known since Euclid that regular polygons with a number of sides of the form  $2^k$ ,  $2^k \cdot 3$ ,  $2^k \cdot 5$ , and  $2^k \cdot 3 \cdot 5$  could be constructed, and it was believed that no others were possible. In 1796, while still a teenager, Gauss proved that the 17-sided regular polygon is constructible. In 1801, Gauss asserted that a regular polygon of  $n$  sides is constructible if and only if  $n$  has the form  $2^k p_1 p_2 \cdots p_i$ , where the  $p$ 's are distinct primes of the form  $2^{2^s} + 1$ . We provide a proof of this statement in Theorem 33.5.

Thus, regular polygons with 3, 4, 5, 6, 8, 10, 12, 15, 16, 17, and 20 sides are possible to construct, whereas those with 7, 9, 11, 13, 14, 18, and 19 sides are not. How these constructions can be effected is another matter. One person spent 10 years trying to determine a way to construct the 65,537-sided polygon.

Gauss's result on the constructibility of regular  $n$ -gons eliminated another of the famous unsolved problems, because the ability to trisect a  $60^\circ$  angle enables one to construct a regular 9-gon. Thus, there is no method for trisecting a  $60^\circ$  angle with an unmarked straightedge and a compass. In 1837, Wantzel proved that it was not possible to double the cube. The problem of the squaring of a circle resisted all attempts until 1882, when Ferdinand Lindemann proved that  $\pi$  is transcendental, since, as we will show, all constructible numbers are algebraic.

## Constructible Numbers

With the field theory we now have, it is an easy matter to solve the following problem: Given an unmarked straightedge, a compass, and a unit length, what other lengths can be constructed? To begin, we call a real number  $\alpha$  *constructible* if, by means of an unmarked straightedge, a compass, and a line segment of length 1, we can construct a line segment of length  $|\alpha|$  in a finite number of steps. It follows from plane geometry that if  $\alpha$  and  $\beta$  ( $\beta \neq 0$ ) are constructible numbers, then so are  $\alpha + \beta$ ,  $\alpha - \beta$ ,  $\alpha \cdot \beta$ , and  $\alpha/\beta$ . (See the exercises for hints.) Thus, the set of constructible numbers contains  $\mathbb{Q}$  and is a subfield of the real numbers. What we desire is an algebraic characterization of this field. To derive such a characterization, let  $F$  be any subfield of the reals. Call the subset  $\{(x, y) \in \mathbb{R}^2 \mid x, y \in F\}$  of the real plane the *plane of  $F$* , call any line joining two points in the plane of  $F$  a *line in  $F$* , and call any circle whose center is in the plane of  $F$  and whose radius is in  $F$  a *circle in  $F$* . Then a line in  $F$  has an equation of the form

$$ax + by + c = 0, \quad \text{where } a, b, c \in F,$$

and a circle in  $F$  has an equation of the form

$$x^2 + y^2 + ax + by + c = 0, \quad \text{where } a, b, c \in F.$$

In particular, note that to find the point of intersection of a pair of lines in  $F$  or the points of intersection of a line in  $F$  and a circle in  $F$ , one need only solve a linear or quadratic equation in  $F$ . We now come to the crucial question. Starting with points in the plane of some field  $F$ , which points in the real plane can be obtained with an unmarked straightedge and a compass? Well, there are only three ways to construct points, starting with points in the plane of  $F$ .

1. Intersect two lines in  $F$ .
2. Intersect a circle in  $F$  and a line in  $F$ .
3. Intersect two circles in  $F$ .

In case 1, we do not obtain any new points, because two lines in  $F$  intersect in a point in the plane of  $F$ . In case 2, the point of intersection is the solution to either a linear equation in  $F$  or a quadratic equation in  $F$ . So, the point lies in the plane of  $F$  or in the plane of  $F(\sqrt{\alpha})$ , where  $\alpha \in F$  and  $\alpha$  is positive. In case 3, no new points are obtained, because, if the two circles are given by  $x^2 + y^2 + ax + by + c = 0$  and  $x^2 + y^2 + a'x + b'y + c' = 0$ , then we have  $(a - a')x + (b - b')y + (c - c') = 0$ , which is a line in  $F$ . So, the points of intersection are in  $F$ .

It follows, then, that the only points in the real plane that can be constructed from the plane of a field  $F$  are those whose coordinates lie in fields of the form  $F(\sqrt{\alpha})$ , where  $\alpha \in F$  and  $\alpha$  is positive. Of course, we can start over with  $F_1 = F(\sqrt{\alpha})$  and construct points whose coordinates lie in fields of the form  $F_2 = F_1(\sqrt{\beta})$ , where  $\beta \in F_1$  and  $\beta$  is positive. Continuing in this fashion, we see that a real number  $c$  is constructible if and only if there is a series of fields  $Q = F_1 \subseteq F_2 \subseteq \cdots \subseteq F_n \subseteq \mathbf{R}$  such that  $F_{i+1} = F_i(\sqrt{\alpha_i})$ , where  $\alpha_i \in F_i$  and  $c \in F_n$ . Since  $[F_{i+1}:F_i] = 1$  or  $2$ , we see by Theorem 21.5 that if  $c$  is constructible, then  $[Q(c):Q] = 2^k$  for some nonnegative integer  $k$ .

We now dispatch the problems that plagued the Greeks. Consider doubling the cube of volume 1. The enlarged cube would have an edge of length  $\sqrt[3]{2}$ . But  $[Q(\sqrt[3]{2}):Q] = 3$ , so such a cube cannot be constructed.

Next consider the possibility of trisecting a  $60^\circ$  angle. If it were possible to trisect an angle of  $60^\circ$ , then  $\cos 20^\circ$  would be constructible. (See Figure 23.1.) In particular,  $[Q(\cos 20^\circ):Q] = 2^k$  for some  $k$ . Now,

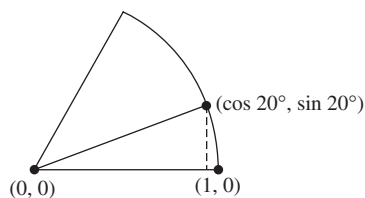


Figure 23.1



using the trigonometric identity  $\cos 3\theta = 4 \cos^3 \theta - 3 \cos \theta$ , with  $\theta = 20^\circ$ , we see that  $1/2 = 4 \cos^3 20^\circ - 3 \cos 20^\circ$ , so that  $\cos 20^\circ$  is a zero of  $8x^3 - 6x - 1$ . But, since  $8x^3 - 6x - 1$  is irreducible over  $\mathbb{Q}$  (see Exercise 13), we must also have  $[Q(\cos 20^\circ):Q] = 3$ . This contradiction shows that trisecting a  $60^\circ$  angle is impossible.

The remaining problems are relegated to the reader as Exercises 14, 15, and 17.

## Angle-Trisectors and Circle-Squarers

Down through the centuries, hundreds of people have claimed to have achieved one or more of the impossible constructions. In 1775, the Paris Academy, so overwhelmed with these claims, passed a resolution to no longer examine these claims or claims of machines purported to exhibit perpetual motion. Although it has been more than 100 years since the last of the constructions was shown to be impossible, there continues to be a steady parade of people who claim to have done one or more of them. Most of these people have heard that this is impossible but have refused to believe it. One person insisted that he could trisect any angle with a straightedge alone [2, p. 158]. Another found his trisection in 1973 after 12,000 hours of work [2, p. 80]. One got his from God [2, p. 73]. In 1971, a person with a Ph.D. in mathematics asserted that he had a valid trisection method [2, p. 127]. Many people have claimed the hat trick: trisecting the angle, doubling the cube, and squaring the circle. Two men who did this in 1961 succeeded in having their accomplishment noted in the *Congressional Record* [2, p. 110]. Occasionally, newspapers and magazines have run stories about “doing the impossible,” often giving the impression that the construction may be valid. Many angle-trisectors and circle-squarers have had their work published at their own expense and distributed to colleges and universities. One had his printed in four languages! There are two delightful books written by mathematicians about their encounters with these people. The books are full of wit, charm, and humor ([1] and [2]).

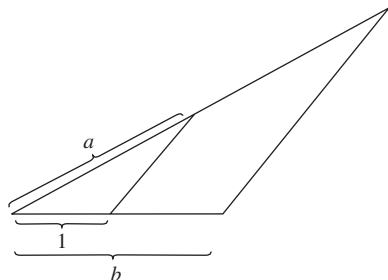
## Exercises

Only prove to me that it is impossible, and I will set about it this very evening.

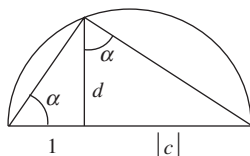
*Spoken by a member of the audience after De Morgan gave a lecture on the impossibility of squaring the circle.*

1. If  $a$  and  $b$  are constructible numbers and  $a \geq b > 0$ , give a geometric proof that  $a + b$  and  $a - b$  are constructible.

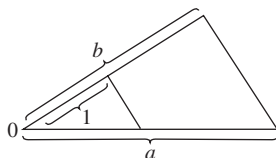
2. If  $a$  and  $b$  are constructible, give a geometric proof that  $ab$  is constructible. (*Hint*: Consider the following figure. Notice that all segments in the figure can be made with an unmarked straightedge and a compass.)



3. Prove that if  $c$  is a constructible number, then so is  $\sqrt{|c|}$ . (*Hint*: Consider the following semicircle with diameter  $1 + |c|$ .) (This exercise is referred to in Chapter 33.)



4. If  $a$  and  $b$  ( $b \neq 0$ ) are constructible numbers, give a geometric proof that  $a/b$  is constructible. (*Hint*: Consider the following figure.)



5. Prove that  $\sin \theta$  is constructible if and only if  $\cos \theta$  is constructible.
6. Prove that an angle  $\theta$  is constructible if and only if  $\sin \theta$  is constructible.
7. Prove that  $\cos 2\theta$  is constructible if and only if  $\cos \theta$  is constructible.
8. Prove that  $30^\circ$  is a constructible angle.
9. Prove that a  $45^\circ$  angle can be trisected with an unmarked straightedge and a compass.
10. Prove that a  $40^\circ$  angle is not constructible.
11. Show that the point of intersection of two lines in the plane of a field  $F$  lies in the plane of  $F$ .

12. Show that the points of intersection of a circle in the plane of a field  $F$  and a line in the plane of  $F$  are points in the plane of  $F$  or in the plane of  $F(\sqrt{\alpha})$ , where  $\alpha \in F$  and  $\alpha$  is positive. Give an example of a circle and a line in the plane of  $Q$  whose points of intersection are not in the plane of  $Q$ .
13. Prove that  $8x^3 - 6x - 1$  is irreducible over  $Q$ .
14. Use the fact that  $8 \cos^3(2\pi/7) + 4 \cos^2(2\pi/7) - 4 \cos(2\pi/7) - 1 = 0$  to prove that a regular seven-sided polygon is not constructible with an unmarked straightedge and a compass.
15. Show that a regular 9-gon cannot be constructed with an unmarked straightedge and a compass.
16. Show that if a regular  $n$ -gon is constructible, then so is a regular  $2n$ -gon.
17. (Squaring the Circle) Show that it is impossible to construct, with an unmarked straightedge and a compass, a square whose area equals that of a circle of radius 1. You may use the fact that  $\pi$  is transcendental over  $Q$ .
18. Use the fact that  $4 \cos^2(2\pi/5) + 2 \cos(2\pi/5) - 1 = 0$  to prove that a regular pentagon is constructible.
19. Can the cube be “tripled”?
20. Can the cube be “quadrupled”?
21. Can the circle be “cubed”?
22. If  $a$ ,  $b$ , and  $c$  are constructible, show that the real roots of  $ax^2 + bx + c$  are constructible.

## References

1. Augustus De Morgan, *A Budget of Paradoxes*, Dover Publications, 1954, books.google.com.
2. Underwood Dudley, *A Budget of Trisections*, New York: Springer-Verlag, 1987.

## Suggested Website

**[http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Squaring\\_the\\_circle](http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Squaring_the_circle)**

This website provides an excellent account of efforts to square the circle, and links for articles about trisecting the angle and doubling the cube.



PART  
5

Special  
Topics



# 24 Sylow Theorems

Generally these three results are implied by the expression “Sylow’s Theorem.” All of them are of fundamental importance. In fact, if the theorems of group theory were arranged in order of their importance Sylow’s Theorem might reasonably occupy the second place—coming next to Lagrange’s Theorem in such an arrangement.

G. A. Miller, *Theory and Application of Finite Groups*

It is impossible to overstate the importance of Sylow’s Theorem in the study of finite groups. Without it the subject would not get off the ground.

I. N. Herstein, *Abstract Algebra, 3rd ed.*

## Conjugacy Classes

In this chapter, we derive several important arithmetic relationships between a group and certain of its subgroups. Recall from Chapter 7 that Lagrange’s Theorem was proved by showing that cosets of a subgroup partition the group. Another fruitful method of partitioning the elements of a group is by way of conjugacy classes.

### Definition Conjugacy Class of $a$

Let  $a$  and  $b$  be elements of a group  $G$ . We say that  $a$  and  $b$  are *conjugate* in  $G$  (and call  $b$  a *conjugate* of  $a$ ) if  $xax^{-1} = b$  for some  $x$  in  $G$ . The *conjugacy class* of  $a$  is the set  $\text{cl}(a) = \{xax^{-1} \mid x \in G\}$ .

We leave it to the reader (Exercise 1) to prove that conjugacy is an equivalence relation on  $G$ , and that the conjugacy class of  $a$  is the equivalence class of  $a$  under conjugacy. Thus, we may partition any group into disjoint conjugacy classes. Let’s look at one example. In  $D_4$  we have

$$\text{cl}(H) = \{R_0HR_0^{-1}, R_{90}HR_{90}^{-1}, R_{180}HR_{180}^{-1}, R_{270}HR_{270}^{-1}, \\ HHH^{-1}, VHV^{-1}, DHD^{-1}, D'HD'^{-1}\} = \{H, V\}.$$

Similarly, one may verify that

$$\begin{aligned}\text{cl}(R_0) &= \{R_0\}, \\ \text{cl}(R_{90}) &= \{R_{90}, R_{270}\} = \text{cl}(R_{270}), \\ \text{cl}(R_{180}) &= \{R_{180}\}, \\ \text{cl}(V) &= \{V, H\} = \text{cl}(H), \\ \text{cl}(D) &= \{D, D'\} = \text{cl}(D').\end{aligned}$$

Theorem 24.1 gives an arithmetic relationship between the size of the conjugacy class of  $a$  and the size of  $C(a)$ , the centralizer of  $a$ .

### ■ Theorem 24.1 Number of Conjugates of $a$

*Let  $G$  be a finite group and let  $a$  be an element of  $G$ . Then,*  
 $|\text{cl}(a)| = |G:C(a)|.$

**PROOF** Consider the function  $T$  that sends the coset  $x C(a)$  to the conjugate  $x a x^{-1}$  of  $a$ . A routine calculation shows that  $T$  is well-defined, is one-to-one, and maps the set of left cosets onto the conjugacy class of  $a$ . Thus, the number of conjugates of  $a$  is the index of the centralizer of  $a$ . ■

### ■ Corollary 1 $|\text{cl}(a)|$ Divides $|G|$

*In a finite group,  $|\text{cl}(a)|$  divides  $|G|$ .*

## The Class Equation

Since the conjugacy classes partition a group, the following important counting principle is a corollary to Theorem 24.1.

### ■ Corollary 2 Class Equation

*For any finite group  $G$ ,*

$$|G| = \sum |G:C(a)|,$$

*where the sum runs over one element  $a$  from each conjugacy class of  $G$ .*

In finite group theory, counting principles such as this corollary are powerful tools.<sup>†</sup> Theorem 24.2 is the single most important fact about

<sup>†</sup>“Never underestimate a theorem that counts something.” John Fraleigh, *A First Course in Abstract Algebra*.



finite groups of prime-power order (a group of order  $p^n$ , where  $p$  is a prime, is called a  $p$ -group).

### ■ Theorem 24.2 $p$ -Groups Have Nontrivial Centers

*Let  $G$  be a nontrivial finite group whose order is a power of a prime  $p$ . Then  $Z(G)$  has more than one element.*

**PROOF** First observe that  $\text{cl}(a) = \{a\}$  if and only if  $a \in Z(G)$  (see Exercise 4). Thus, by culling out these elements, we may write the class equation in the form

$$|G| = |Z(G)| + \sum |G:C(a)|,$$

where the sum runs over representatives of all conjugacy classes with more than one element (this set may be empty). But  $|G:C(a)| = |G|/|C(a)|$ , so each term in  $\sum |G:C(a)|$  has the form  $p^k$  with  $k \geq 1$ . Hence,

$$|G| - \sum |G:C(a)| = |Z(G)|,$$

where each term on the left is divisible by  $p$ . It follows, then, that  $p$  also divides  $|Z(G)|$ , and hence  $|Z(G)| \neq 1$ . ■

### ■ Corollary Groups of Order $p^2$ Are Abelian

*If  $|G| = p^2$ , where  $p$  is prime, then  $G$  is Abelian.*

**PROOF** By Theorem 24.2 and Lagrange's Theorem,  $|Z(G)| = p$  or  $p^2$ . If  $|Z(G)| = p^2$ , then  $G = Z(G)$  and  $G$  is Abelian. If  $|Z(G)| = p$ , then  $|G/Z(G)| = p$ , so that  $G/Z(G)$  is cyclic. But, then, by Theorem 9.3,  $G$  is Abelian. ■

## The Sylow Theorems

Now to the Sylow theorems. Recall that the converse of Lagrange's Theorem is false; that is, if  $G$  is a group of order  $m$  and  $n$  divides  $m$ ,  $G$  need *not* have a subgroup of order  $n$ . Our next theorem is a partial converse of Lagrange's Theorem. It, as well as Theorem 24.2, was first proved by the Norwegian mathematician Ludwig Sylow (1832–1918). Sylow's Theorem and Lagrange's Theorem are the two most important results in finite group theory.<sup>†</sup> The first gives a sufficient condition for the existence of subgroups, and the second gives a necessary condition.

<sup>†</sup>My candidate for the third most important result is the Fundamental Theorem of Finite Abelian Groups.

### ■ Theorem 24.3 Existence of Subgroups of Prime-Power Order (Sylow's First Theorem, 1872)

*Let  $G$  be a finite group and let  $p$  be a prime. If  $p^k$  divides  $|G|$ , then  $G$  has at least one subgroup of order  $p^k$ .*

**PROOF** We proceed by induction on  $|G|$ . If  $|G| = 1$ , Theorem 24.3 is trivially true. Now assume that the statement is true for all groups of order less than  $|G|$ . If  $G$  has a proper subgroup  $H$  such that  $p^k$  divides  $|H|$ , then, by our inductive assumption,  $H$  has a subgroup of order  $p^k$  and we are done. Thus, we may henceforth assume that  $p^k$  does not divide the order of any proper subgroup of  $G$ . Next, consider the class equation for  $G$  in the form

$$|G| = |Z(G)| + \sum |G:C(a)|,$$

where we sum over a representative of each conjugacy class  $\text{cl}(a)$ , where  $a \notin Z(G)$ . Since  $p^k$  divides  $|G| = |G:C(a)||C(a)|$  and  $p^k$  does not divide  $|C(a)|$ , we know that  $p$  must divide  $|G:C(a)|$  for all  $a \notin Z(G)$ . It then follows from the class equation that  $p$  divides  $|Z(G)|$ . The Fundamental Theorem of Finite Abelian Groups (Theorem 11.1), or Theorem 9.5, then guarantees that  $Z(G)$  contains an element of order  $p$ , say  $x$ . Since  $x$  is in the center of  $G$ ,  $\langle x \rangle$  is a normal subgroup of  $G$ , and we may form the factor group  $G/\langle x \rangle$ . Now observe that  $p^{k-1}$  divides  $|G/\langle x \rangle|$ . Thus, by the induction hypothesis,  $G/\langle x \rangle$  has a subgroup of order  $p^{k-1}$  and, by Exercise 51 in Chapter 10, this subgroup has the form  $H/\langle x \rangle$ , where  $H$  is a subgroup of  $G$ . Finally, note that  $|H/\langle x \rangle| = p^{k-1}$  and  $|\langle x \rangle| = p$  imply that  $|H| = p^k$ . Thus, we have produced a subgroup of order  $p^k$ , which contradicts our assumption that no such subgroup exists. Therefore, we must have originally had a subgroup of order  $p^k$ , and we can apply the induction hypothesis to that subgroup. ■

Let's be sure we understand exactly what Sylow's First Theorem means. Say we have a group  $G$  of order  $2^3 \cdot 3^2 \cdot 5^4 \cdot 7$ . Then Sylow's First Theorem says that  $G$  must have at least one subgroup of each of the following orders: 2, 4, 8, 3, 9, 5, 25, 125, 625, and 7. On the other hand, Sylow's First Theorem tells us nothing about the possible existence of subgroups of order 6, 10, 15, 30, or any other divisor of  $|G|$  that has two or more distinct prime factors. Because certain subgroups guaranteed by Sylow's First Theorem play a central role in the theory of finite groups, they are given a special name.

**Definition Sylow  $p$ -Subgroup**

Let  $G$  be a finite group and let  $p$  be a prime. If  $p^k$  divides  $|G|$  and  $p^{k+1}$  does not divide  $|G|$ , then any subgroup of  $G$  of order  $p^k$  is called a *Sylow  $p$ -subgroup of  $G$* .<sup>†</sup>

So, returning to our group  $G$  of order  $2^3 \cdot 3^2 \cdot 5^4 \cdot 7$ , we call any subgroup of order 8 a Sylow 2-subgroup of  $G$ , any subgroup of order 625 a Sylow 5-subgroup of  $G$ , and so on. Notice that a Sylow  $p$ -subgroup of  $G$  is a subgroup whose order is the largest power of  $p$  consistent with Lagrange's Theorem.

Since any subgroup of order  $p$  is cyclic, we have the following generalization of Theorem 9.5, first proved by Cauchy in 1845. His proof ran nine pages!

**■ Corollary Cauchy's Theorem**

*Let  $G$  be a finite group and let  $p$  be a prime that divides the order of  $G$ . Then  $G$  has an element of order  $p$ .*

Sylow's First Theorem is so fundamental to finite group theory that many different proofs of it have been published over the years [our proof is essentially the one given by Georg Frobenius (1849–1917) in 1895]. Likewise, there are scores of generalizations of Sylow's Theorem.

Observe that the corollary to the Fundamental Theorem of Finite Abelian Groups and Sylow's First Theorem show that the converse of Lagrange's Theorem is true for all finite Abelian groups and all finite groups of prime-power order.

There are two more Sylow theorems that are extremely valuable tools in finite group theory. But first we introduce a new term.

**Definition Conjugate Subgroups**

Let  $H$  and  $K$  be subgroups of a group  $G$ . We say that  $H$  and  $K$  are *conjugate in  $G$*  if there is an element  $g$  in  $G$  such that  $H = gKg^{-1}$ .

Recall from Chapter 7 that if  $G$  is a finite group of permutations on a set  $S$  and  $i \in S$ , then  $\text{orb}_G(i) = \{\phi(i) \mid \phi \in G\}$  and  $|\text{orb}_G(i)|$  divides  $|G|$ .

<sup>†</sup>Note that it follows from Sylow's First Theorem and the definition that the trivial subgroup  $\{e\}$  is a Sylow  $p$ -subgroup of  $G$  if and only if  $p$  does not divide  $|G|$ .

### ■ Theorem 24.4 Sylow's Second Theorem

*If  $H$  is a subgroup of a finite group  $G$  and  $|H|$  is a power of a prime  $p$ , then  $H$  is contained in some Sylow  $p$ -subgroup of  $G$ .*

**PROOF** Let  $K$  be a Sylow  $p$ -subgroup of  $G$  and let  $C = \{K_1, K_2, \dots, K_n\}$  with  $K = K_1$  be the set of all conjugates of  $K$  in  $G$ . Since conjugation is an automorphism, each element of  $C$  is a Sylow  $p$ -subgroup of  $G$ . Let  $S_C$  denote the group of all permutations of  $C$ . For each  $g \in G$ , define  $\phi_g: C \rightarrow C$  by  $\phi_g(K_i) = gK_i g^{-1}$ . It is easy to show that each  $\phi_g \in S_C$ .

Now define a mapping  $T: G \rightarrow S_C$  by  $T(g) = \phi_g$ . Since  $\phi_{gh}(K_i) = (gh)K_i(gh)^{-1} = g(hK_i h^{-1})g^{-1} = g\phi_h(K_i)g^{-1} = \phi_g(\phi_h(K_i)) = (\phi_g \phi_h)(K_i)$ , we have  $\phi_{gh} = \phi_g \phi_h$ , and therefore  $T$  is a homomorphism from  $G$  to  $S_C$ .

Next consider  $T(H)$ , the image of  $H$  under  $T$ . Since  $|H|$  is a power of  $p$ , so is  $|T(H)|$  (see property 6 of Theorem 10.2). Thus, by the Orbit-Stabilizer Theorem (Theorem 7.3), for each  $i$ ,  $|\text{orb}_{T(H)}(K_i)|$  divides  $|T(H)|$ , so that  $|\text{orb}_{T(H)}(K_i)|$  is a power of  $p$ . Now we ask: Under what condition does  $|\text{orb}_{T(H)}(K_i)| = 1$ ? Well,  $|\text{orb}_{T(H)}(K_i)| = 1$  means that  $\phi_g(K_i) = gK_i g^{-1} = K_i$  for all  $g \in H$ ; that is,  $|\text{orb}_{T(H)}(K_i)| = 1$  if and only if  $H \leq N(K_i)$ . But the only elements of  $N(K_i)$  that have orders that are powers of  $p$  are those of  $K_i$  (see Exercise 17). Thus,  $|\text{orb}_{T(H)}(K_i)| = 1$  if and only if  $H \leq K_i$ .

So, to complete the proof, all we need to do is show that for some  $i$ ,  $|\text{orb}_{T(H)}(K_i)| = 1$ . Analogous to Theorem 24.1, we have  $|C| = |G:N(K)|$  (see Exercise 9). And since  $|G:K| = |G:N(K)||N(K):K|$  is not divisible by  $p$ , neither is  $|C|$ . Because the orbits partition  $C$ ,  $|C|$  is the sum of powers of  $p$ . If no orbit has size 1, then  $p$  divides each summand and, therefore,  $p$  divides  $|C|$ , which is a contradiction. Thus, there is an orbit of size 1, and the proof is complete. ■

### ■ Theorem 24.5 Sylow's Third Theorem

*Let  $p$  be a prime and let  $G$  be a group of order  $p^k m$ , where  $p$  does not divide  $m$ . Then the number  $n$  of Sylow  $p$ -subgroups of  $G$  is equal to 1 modulo  $p$  and divides  $m$ . Furthermore, any two Sylow  $p$ -subgroups of  $G$  are conjugate.*

**PROOF** Let  $K$  be any Sylow  $p$ -subgroup of  $G$  and let  $C = \{K_1, K_2, \dots, K_n\}$ , with  $K = K_1$ , be the set of all conjugates of  $K$  in  $G$ . We first prove that  $n \bmod p = 1$ .

Let  $S_C$  and  $T$  be as in the proof of Theorem 24.4. This time we consider  $T(K)$ , the image of  $K$  under  $T$ . As before, we have  $|\text{orb}_{T(K)}(K_i)|$  is a power of  $p$  for each  $i$  and  $|\text{orb}_{T(K)}(K_i)| = 1$  if and only if  $K \leq K_i$ . Thus,  $|\text{orb}_{T(K)}(K_1)| = 1$  and  $|\text{orb}_{T(K)}(K_i)|$  is a power of  $p$  greater than 1 for all  $i \neq 1$ . Since the orbits partition  $C$ , it follows that, modulo  $p$ ,  $n = |C| = 1$ .

Next we show that every Sylow  $p$ -subgroup of  $G$  belongs to  $C$ . To do this, suppose that  $H$  is a Sylow  $p$ -subgroup of  $G$  that is not in  $C$ . Let  $S_C$  and  $T$  be as in the proof of Theorem 24.4, and this time consider  $T(H)$ . As in the previous paragraph,  $|C|$  is the sum of the orbits' sizes under the action of  $T(H)$ . However, no orbit has size 1, since  $H$  is not in  $C$ . Thus,  $|C|$  is a sum of terms each divisible by  $p$ , so that, modulo  $p$ ,  $n = |C| = 0$ . This contradiction proves that  $H$  belongs to  $C$ , and that  $n$  is the number of Sylow  $p$ -subgroups of  $G$ .

Finally, that  $n$  divides  $m$  follows directly from the fact that  $n = |G:N(K)|$  (see Exercise 9) and  $n$  is relatively prime to  $p$ . ■

It is convenient to let  $n_p$  denote the number of Sylow  $p$ -subgroups of a group. Observe that the first portion of Sylow's Third Theorem is a counting principle.<sup>†</sup> As an important consequence of Sylow's Third Theorem, we have the following corollary.

### ■ Corollary A Unique Sylow $p$ -Subgroup Is Normal

*A Sylow  $p$ -subgroup of a finite group  $G$  is a normal subgroup of  $G$  if and only if it is the only Sylow  $p$ -subgroup of  $G$ .*

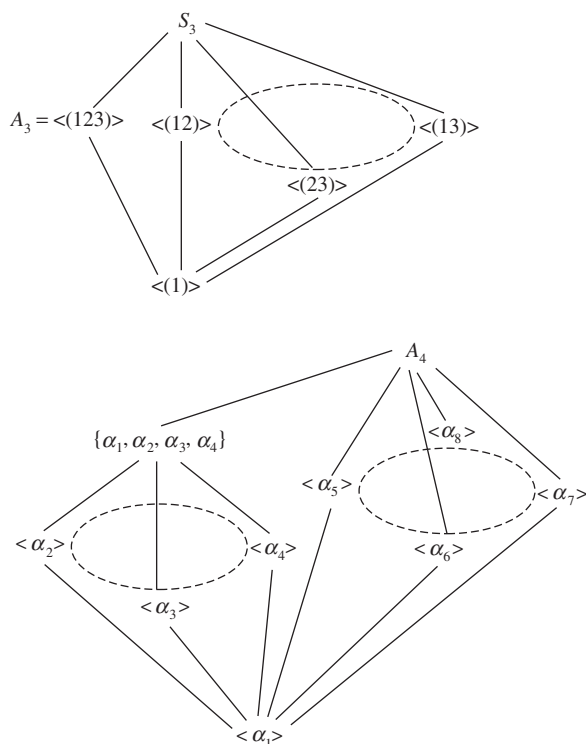
We illustrate Sylow's Third Theorem with two examples.

■ **EXAMPLE 1** Consider the Sylow 2-subgroups of  $S_3$ . They are  $\{(1), (12)\}$ ,  $\{(1), (23)\}$ , and  $\{(1), (13)\}$ . According to Sylow's Third Theorem, we should be able to obtain the latter two of these from the first by conjugation. Indeed,

$$\begin{aligned}(13)\{(1), (12)\}(13)^{-1} &= \{(1), (23)\}, \\ (23)\{(1), (12)\}(23)^{-1} &= \{(1), (13)\}.\end{aligned}$$

■

<sup>†</sup>“Whenever you can, count.” Sir Francis Galton (1822–1911), *The World of Mathematics*.



**Figure 24.1** Lattices of subgroups for  $S_3$  and  $A_4$ .

■ **EXAMPLE 2** Consider the Sylow 3-subgroups of  $A_4$ . They are  $\{\alpha_1, \alpha_5, \alpha_9\}$ ,  $\{\alpha_1, \alpha_6, \alpha_{11}\}$ ,  $\{\alpha_1, \alpha_7, \alpha_{12}\}$ , and  $\{\alpha_1, \alpha_8, \alpha_{10}\}$ . (See Table 5.1.) Then,

$$\begin{aligned}\alpha_2\{\alpha_1, \alpha_5, \alpha_9\}\alpha_2^{-1} &= \{\alpha_1, \alpha_7, \alpha_{12}\}, \\ \alpha_3\{\alpha_1, \alpha_5, \alpha_9\}\alpha_3^{-1} &= \{\alpha_1, \alpha_8, \alpha_{10}\}, \\ \alpha_4\{\alpha_1, \alpha_5, \alpha_9\}\alpha_4^{-1} &= \{\alpha_1, \alpha_6, \alpha_{11}\}.\end{aligned}$$

Thus, the number of Sylow 3-subgroups is 1 modulo 3, and the four Sylow 3-subgroups are conjugate. ■

Figure 24.1 shows the subgroup lattices for  $S_3$  and  $A_4$ . We have connected the Sylow  $p$ -groups with dashed circles to indicate that they belong to one orbit under conjugation. Notice that the three subgroups of order 2 in  $A_4$  are contained in a Sylow 2-group, as required by Sylow's Second Theorem. As it happens, these three subgroups also belong to one orbit under conjugation, but this is not a consequence of Sylow's Third Theorem.

In contrast to the two preceding examples, observe that the dihedral group of order 12 has seven subgroups of order 2, but that conjugating  $\{R_0, R_{180}\}$  does not yield any of the other six. (Why?)

## Applications of Sylow Theorems

A few numerical examples will make the Sylow theorems come to life.

■ **EXAMPLE 3** Say  $G$  is a group of order 40. What do the Sylow theorems tell us about  $G$ ? A great deal! Since 1 is the only divisor of 40 that is congruent to 1 modulo 5, we know that  $G$  has exactly one subgroup of order 5, and therefore it is normal. Similarly,  $G$  has either one or five subgroups of order 8. If there is only one subgroup of order 8, it is normal. If there are five subgroups of order 8, none is normal and all five can be obtained by starting with any particular one, say  $H$ , and computing  $xHx^{-1}$  for various  $x$ 's. Finally, if we let  $K$  denote the normal subgroup of order 5 and let  $H$  denote any subgroup of order 8, then  $G = HK$ . (See Example 5 in Chapter 9.) If  $H$  happens to be normal, we can say even more:  $G = H \times K$ . ■

■ **EXAMPLE 4** Consider a group of order 30. By Sylow's Third Theorem, it must have either one or six subgroups of order 5 and one or 10 subgroups of order 3. However,  $G$  cannot have both six subgroups of order 5 and 10 subgroups of order 3 (for then  $G$  would have more than 30 elements). Thus, the subgroup of order 3 is unique or the subgroup of order 5 is unique (or both are unique) and therefore is normal in  $G$ . It follows, then, that the product of a subgroup of order 3 and one of order 5 is a group of order 15 that is both cyclic (Exercise 35) and normal (Exercise 9 in Chapter 9) in  $G$ . [This, in turn, implies that *both* the subgroup of order 3 and the subgroup of order 5 are normal in  $G$  (Exercise 59 in Chapter 9).] So, if we let  $y$  be a generator of the cyclic subgroup of order 15 and let  $x$  be an element of order 2 (the existence of which is guaranteed by Cauchy's Theorem), we see that

$$G = \{x^i y^j \mid 0 \leq i \leq 1, 0 \leq j \leq 14\}. \quad \blacksquare$$

■ **EXAMPLE 5** We show that any group  $G$  of order 72 must have a proper, nontrivial normal subgroup. Our arguments are a preview of those in Chapter 25. By Sylow's Third Theorem, the number of Sylow 3-subgroups of  $G$  is equal to 1 mod 3 and divides 8. Thus, the number is 1 or 4. If there is only one, then it is normal by the corollary of Sylow's Third Theorem. Otherwise, let  $H$  and  $H'$  be two distinct Sylow 3-subgroups. By Theorem 7.2, we have that  $|HH'| = |H||H'|/|H \cap H'| = 81/|H \cap H'|$ . Since  $|G| = 72$  and  $|H \cap H'|$  is a subgroup of  $H$  and  $H'$ , we know that  $|H \cap H'| = 3$ . By the corollary to Theorem 24.2,  $N(H \cap H')$  contains both  $H$  and  $H'$ . Thus,  $|N(H \cap H')|$  divides 72, is divisible by 9, and has at least  $|HH'|' = 27$  elements. This leaves only 36 or 72 for  $|N(H \cap H')|$ . In the first case, we have from Exercise 9 of Chapter 9 that  $N(H \cap H')$  is

normal in  $G$ . In the second case, we have by definition that  $H \cap H'$  is normal in  $G$ . ■

Note that in these examples we were able to deduce all of this information from knowing only the order of the group—so many conclusions from one assumption! This is the beauty of finite group theory.

In Chapter 7 we saw that the only group (up to isomorphism) of prime order  $p$  is  $Z_p$ . As a further illustration of the power of the Sylow theorems, we next give a sufficient condition that guarantees that a group of order  $pq$ , where  $p$  and  $q$  are primes, must be  $Z_{pq}$ .

### ■ Theorem 24.6 Cyclic Groups of Order $pq$

*If  $G$  is a group of order  $pq$ , where  $p$  and  $q$  are primes,  $p < q$ , and  $p$  does not divide  $q - 1$ , then  $G$  is cyclic. In particular,  $G$  is isomorphic to  $Z_{pq}$ .*

**PROOF** Let  $H$  be a Sylow  $p$ -subgroup of  $G$  and let  $K$  be a Sylow  $q$ -subgroup of  $G$ . Sylow's Third Theorem states that the number of Sylow  $p$ -subgroups of  $G$  is of the form  $1 + kp$  and divides  $q$ . So  $1 + kp = 1$  or  $1 + kp = q$ . Since  $p$  does not divide  $q - 1$ , we have that  $k = 0$  and therefore  $H$  is the only Sylow  $p$ -subgroup of  $G$ .

Similarly, there is only one Sylow  $q$ -subgroup of  $G$  (see Exercise 25). Thus, by the corollary to Theorem 24.5,  $H$  and  $K$  are normal subgroups of  $G$ . This, together with  $G = HK$  and  $H \cap K = \langle e \rangle$ , means that  $G = H \times K$ . Finally, by Theorem 9.6 and Theorem 8.2,  $G \approx Z_p \oplus Z_p \approx Z_{pq}$ .

Theorem 24.6 demonstrates the power of the Sylow theorems in classifying the finite groups whose orders have small numbers of prime factors. Similar results exist for groups of orders  $p^2q$ ,  $p^2q^2$ ,  $p^3$ , and  $p^4$ , where  $p$  and  $q$  are prime.

For your amusement, Figure 24.2 lists the number of nonisomorphic groups with order at most 100. Note in particular the large number of groups of order 64. Also observe that, generally speaking, it is not the size of the group that gives rise to a large number of groups of that size but the number of prime factors involved. In all, there are 1047 nonisomorphic groups with 100 or fewer elements. Contrast this with the fact that there are 49,487,365,422 groups of order  $1024 = 2^{10}$ . The number of groups of any order less than 2048 is given at <http://oeis.org/A000001/b000001.txt>.

As a final application of the Sylow theorems, you might enjoy seeing a determination of the groups of order 99, 66, and 255. In fact, our arguments serve as a good review of much of our work in group theory.



|        |    |    |    |     |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |     |    |    |    |     |
|--------|----|----|----|-----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|-----|----|----|----|-----|
| Order  | 1  | 2  | 3  | 4   | 5  | 6  | 7  | 8  | 9  | 10 | 11 | 12 | 13 | 14 | 15 | 16  | 17 | 18 | 19 | 20  |
| Number | 1  | 1  | 1  | 2   | 1  | 2  | 1  | 5  | 2  | 2  | 1  | 5  | 1  | 2  | 1  | 14  | 1  | 5  | 1  | 5   |
| Order  | 21 | 22 | 23 | 24  | 25 | 26 | 27 | 28 | 29 | 30 | 31 | 32 | 33 | 34 | 35 | 36  | 37 | 38 | 39 | 40  |
| Number | 2  | 2  | 1  | 15  | 2  | 2  | 5  | 4  | 1  | 4  | 1  | 51 | 1  | 2  | 1  | 14  | 1  | 2  | 2  | 14  |
| Order  | 41 | 42 | 43 | 44  | 45 | 46 | 47 | 48 | 49 | 50 | 51 | 52 | 53 | 54 | 55 | 56  | 57 | 58 | 59 | 60  |
| Number | 1  | 6  | 1  | 4   | 2  | 2  | 1  | 52 | 2  | 5  | 1  | 5  | 1  | 15 | 2  | 13  | 2  | 2  | 1  | 13  |
| Order  | 61 | 62 | 63 | 64  | 65 | 66 | 67 | 68 | 69 | 70 | 71 | 72 | 73 | 74 | 75 | 76  | 77 | 78 | 79 | 80  |
| Number | 1  | 2  | 4  | 267 | 1  | 4  | 1  | 5  | 1  | 4  | 1  | 50 | 1  | 2  | 3  | 4   | 1  | 6  | 1  | 52  |
| Order  | 81 | 82 | 83 | 84  | 85 | 86 | 87 | 88 | 89 | 90 | 91 | 92 | 93 | 94 | 95 | 96  | 97 | 98 | 99 | 100 |
| Number | 15 | 2  | 1  | 15  | 1  | 2  | 1  | 12 | 1  | 10 | 1  | 4  | 2  | 2  | 1  | 230 | 1  | 5  | 2  | 16  |

**Figure 24.2** The number of groups of a given order up to 100.

### ■ EXAMPLE 6 Determination of the Groups of Order 99

Suppose that  $G$  is a group of order 99. Let  $H$  be a Sylow 3-subgroup of  $G$  and let  $K$  be a Sylow 11-subgroup of  $G$ . Since 1 is the only positive divisor of 99 that is equal to 1 modulo 11, we know from Sylow's Third Theorem and its corollary that  $K$  is normal in  $G$ . Similarly,  $H$  is normal in  $G$ . It follows, by the argument used in the proof of Theorem 24.6, that elements from  $H$  and  $K$  commute, and therefore  $G = H \times K$ . Since both  $H$  and  $K$  are Abelian,  $G$  is also Abelian. Thus,  $G$  is isomorphic to  $Z_{99}$  or  $Z_3 \oplus Z_{33}$ . ■

### ■ EXAMPLE 7 Determination of the Groups of Order 66

Suppose that  $G$  is a group of order 66. Let  $H$  be a Sylow 3-subgroup of  $G$  and let  $K$  be a Sylow 11-subgroup of  $G$ . Since 1 is the only positive divisor of 66 that is equal to 1 modulo 11, we know that  $K$  is normal in  $G$ . Thus,  $HK$  is a subgroup of  $G$  of order 33 (see Example 5 in Chapter 9 and Theorem 7.2). Since any group of order 33 is cyclic (Theorem 24.6), we may write  $HK = \langle x \rangle$ . Next, let  $y \in G$  and  $|y| = 2$ . Since  $\langle x \rangle$  has index 2 in  $G$ , we know it is normal. So  $yxy^{-1} = x^i$  for some  $i$  from 1 to 32. Then,  $yx = x^iy$  and, since every member of  $G$  is of the form  $x^s y^t$ , the structure of  $G$  is completely determined by the value of  $i$ . We claim that there are only four possibilities for  $i$ . To prove this, observe that  $|x^i| = |x|$ . Thus,  $i$  and 33 are relatively prime. But also, since  $y$  has order 2,

$$x = y^{-1}(yxy^{-1})y = y^{-1}x^iy = yx^iy^{-1} = (yxy^{-1})^i = (x^i)^i = x^{i^2}.$$

So  $x^{i^2-1} = e$  and therefore 33 divides  $i^2 - 1$ . From this it follows that 11 divides  $i \pm 1$ , and therefore  $i = 0 \pm 1$ ,  $i = 11 \pm 1$ ,  $i = 22 \pm 1$ , or  $i = 33 \pm 1$ . Putting this together with the other information we have

about  $i$ , we see that  $i = 1, 10, 23$ , or  $32$ . This proves that there are at most four groups of order 66.

To prove that there are exactly four such groups, we simply observe that  $Z_{66}$ ,  $D_{33}$ ,  $D_{11} \oplus Z_3$ , and  $D_3 \oplus Z_{11}$  each has order 66 and that no two are isomorphic. For example,  $D_{11} \oplus Z_3$  has 11 elements of order 2, whereas  $D_3 \oplus Z_{11}$  has only three elements of order 2. ■

### ■ EXAMPLE 8 The Only Group of Order 255 is $Z_{255}$

Let  $G$  be a group of order  $255 = 3 \cdot 5 \cdot 17$ , and let  $H$  be a Sylow 17-subgroup of  $G$ . By Sylow's Third Theorem,  $H$  is the only Sylow 17-subgroup of  $G$ , so  $N(H) = G$ . By Example 16 in Chapter 10,  $|N(H)/C(H)|$  divides  $|\text{Aut}(H)| = |\text{Aut}(Z_{17})|$ . By Theorem 6.5,  $|\text{Aut}(Z_{17})| = |U(17)| = 16$ . Since  $|N(H)/C(H)|$  must divide 255 and 16, we have  $|N(H)/C(H)| = 1$ . Thus,  $C(H) = G$ . This means that every element of  $G$  commutes with every element of  $H$ , and, therefore,  $H \subseteq Z(G)$ . Thus, 17 divides  $|Z(G)|$ , which in turn divides 255. So  $|Z(G)|$  is equal to 17, 51, 85, or 255 and  $|G/Z(G)|$  is equal to 15, 5, 3, or 1. But the only groups of order 15, 5, 3, or 1 are the cyclic ones, so we know that  $G/Z(G)$  is cyclic. Now the  $G/Z$  Theorem (Theorem 9.3) shows that  $G$  is Abelian, and the Fundamental Theorem of Finite Abelian Groups tells us that  $G$  is cyclic. ■

## Exercises

I have always grown from my problems and challenges, from the things that don't work out. That's when I've really learned.

Carol Burnett

1. Show that conjugacy is an equivalence relation on a group.
2. If  $a$  is a group element, prove that every element in  $\text{cl}(a)$  has the same order as  $a$ .
3. Let  $a$  be a group element of even order. Prove that  $a^2$  is not in  $\text{cl}(a)$ .
4. Calculate all conjugacy classes for the quaternions (see Exercise 54, Chapter 9).
5. Show that the function  $T$  defined in the proof of Theorem 24.1 is well-defined, is one-to-one, and maps the set of left cosets onto the conjugacy class of  $a$ .
6. Show that  $\text{cl}(a) = \{a\}$  if and only if  $a \in Z(G)$ .
7. Show that  $Z_2$  is the only group that has exactly two conjugacy classes.
8. What can you say about the number of elements of order 7 in a group of order  $168 = 8 \cdot 3 \cdot 7$ ?
9. Let  $H$  be a subgroup of a group  $G$ . Prove that the number of con-

jugates of  $H$  in  $G$  is  $|G:N(H)|$ . (This exercise is referred to in this chapter.)

10. Let  $H$  be a proper subgroup of a finite group  $G$ . Show that  $G$  is not the union of all conjugates of  $H$ .
11. If  $G$  is a group of odd order and  $x \in G$ , show that  $x^{-1}$  is not in  $\text{cl}(x)$ .
12. Determine the class equation for non-Abelian groups of orders 39 and 55.
13. Determine which of the equations below could be the class equation given in the proof of Theorem 24.2. For each part, provide your reasoning.
  - a.  $9 = 3 + 3 + 3$
  - b.  $21 = 1 + 1 + 3 + 3 + 3 + 3 + 7$
  - c.  $10 = 1 + 2 + 2 + 5$
  - d.  $18 = 1 + 3 + 6 + 8$
14. Exhibit a Sylow 2-subgroup of  $S_4$ . Describe an isomorphism from this group to  $D_4$ .
15. Suppose that  $G$  is a group of order 48. Show that the intersection of any two distinct Sylow 2-subgroups of  $G$  has order 8.
16. Find all the Sylow 3-subgroups of  $S_4$ .
17. Let  $K$  be a Sylow  $p$ -subgroup of a finite group  $G$ . Prove that if  $x \in N(K)$  and the order of  $x$  is a power of  $p$ , then  $x \in K$ . (This exercise is referred to in this chapter.)
18. Suppose that  $G$  is a group of order  $p^nm$ , where  $p$  is prime and  $p$  does not divide  $m$ . Show that the number of Sylow  $p$ -subgroups divides  $m$ .
19. Suppose that  $G$  is a group and  $|G| = p^nm$ , where  $p$  is prime and  $p > m$ . Prove that a Sylow  $p$ -subgroup of  $G$  must be normal in  $G$ .
20. Let  $H$  be a Sylow  $p$ -subgroup of  $G$ . Prove that  $H$  is the only Sylow  $p$ -subgroup of  $G$  contained in  $N(H)$ .
21. Suppose that  $G$  is a group of order 168. If  $G$  has more than one Sylow 7-subgroup, exactly how many does it have?
22. Show that every group of order 56 has a proper nontrivial normal subgroup.
23. What is the smallest composite (that is, nonprime and greater than 1) integer  $n$  such that there is a unique group of order  $n$ ?
24. Let  $G$  be a noncyclic group of order 21. How many Sylow 3-subgroups does  $G$  have?
25. Let  $G$  be a group of order  $pq$  where  $p$  and  $q$  are distinct primes and  $p < q$ . Prove that the Sylow  $q$ -subgroup is normal in  $G$ . (This exercise is referred to in this chapter.)
26. How many Sylow 5-subgroups of  $S_5$  are there? Exhibit two.

27. How many Sylow 3-subgroups of  $S_5$  are there? Exhibit five.
28. What are the possibilities for the number of elements of order 5 in a group of order 100?
29. What do the Sylow theorems tell you about any group of order 100?
30. Prove that a group of order 175 is Abelian.
31. Let  $G$  be a group with  $|G| = 595 = 5 \cdot 7 \cdot 17$ . Show that the Sylow 5-subgroup of  $G$  is normal in  $G$  and is contained in  $Z(G)$ .
32. Determine the number of Sylow 2-subgroups of  $D_{2m}$ , where  $m$  is an odd integer at least 3.
33. Generalize the argument given in Example 6 to obtain a theorem about groups of order  $p^2q$ , where  $p$  and  $q$  are distinct primes.
34. Prove that a group of order 375 has a subgroup of order 15.
35. Without using Theorem 24.6, prove that a group of order 15 is cyclic. (This exercise is referred to in the discussion about groups of order 30.)
36. Prove that a group of order 105 contains a subgroup of order 35.
37. Prove that a group of order 595 has a normal Sylow 17-subgroup.
38. Let  $G$  be a group of order 60. Show that  $G$  has exactly four elements of order 5 or exactly 24 elements of order 5. Which of these cases holds for  $A_5$ ?
39. Show that the center of a group of order 60 cannot have order 4.
40. Suppose that  $G$  is a group of order 60 and  $G$  has a normal subgroup  $N$  of order 2. Show that
  - a.  $G$  has normal subgroups of orders 6, 10, and 30.
  - b.  $G$  has subgroups of orders 12 and 20.
  - c.  $G$  has a cyclic subgroup of order 30.
41. Let  $G$  be a group of order 60. If the Sylow 3-subgroup is normal, show that the Sylow 5-subgroup is normal.
42. Show that if  $G$  is a group of order 168 that has a normal subgroup of order 4, then  $G$  has a normal subgroup of order 28.
43. Suppose that  $p$  is prime and  $|G| = p^n$ . Show that  $G$  has normal subgroups of order  $p^k$  for all  $k$  between 1 and  $n$  (inclusive).
44. Suppose that  $G$  is a group of order  $p^n$ , where  $p$  is prime, and  $G$  has exactly one subgroup for each divisor of  $p^n$ . Show that  $G$  is cyclic.
45. Suppose that  $p$  is prime and  $|G| = p^n$ . If  $H$  is a proper subgroup of  $G$ , prove that  $N(H) > H$ . (This exercise is referred to in Chapter 25.)
46. If  $H$  is a finite subgroup of a group  $G$  and  $x \in G$ , prove that  $|N(H)| = |N(xHx^{-1})|$ .

47. Let  $H$  be a Sylow 3-subgroup of a finite group  $G$  and let  $K$  be a Sylow 5-subgroup of  $G$ . If 3 divides  $|N(K)|$ , prove that 5 divides  $|N(H)|$ .
48. If  $H$  is a normal subgroup of a finite group  $G$  and  $|H| = p^k$  for some prime  $p$ , show that  $H$  is contained in every Sylow  $p$ -subgroup of  $G$ .
49. Suppose that  $G$  is a finite group and  $G$  has a unique Sylow  $p$ -subgroup for each prime  $p$ . Prove that  $G$  is the internal direct product of its nontrivial Sylow  $p$ -subgroups. If each Sylow  $p$ -subgroup is cyclic, is  $G$  cyclic? If each Sylow  $p$ -subgroup is Abelian, is  $G$  Abelian?
50. Suppose that  $G$  is a finite group and  $G$  has exactly one subgroup for each divisor of  $|G|$ . Prove that  $G$  is cyclic.
51. Let  $G$  be a finite group and let  $H$  be a normal Sylow  $p$ -subgroup of  $G$ . Show that  $\alpha(H) = H$  for all automorphisms  $\alpha$  of  $G$ .
52. If  $H$  is a Sylow  $p$ -subgroup of a group, prove that  $N(N(H)) = N(H)$ .
53. Let  $p$  be a prime and  $H$  and  $K$  be Sylow  $p$ -subgroups of a group  $G$ . Prove that  $|N(H)| = |N(K)|$ .
54. Let  $G$  be a group of order  $p^2q^2$ , where  $p$  and  $q$  are distinct primes,  $q \nmid p^2 - 1$ , and  $p \nmid q^2 - 1$ . Prove that  $G$  is Abelian. List three pairs of primes that satisfy these conditions.
55. Let  $H$  be a normal subgroup of a group  $G$ . Show that  $H$  is the union of the conjugacy classes in  $G$  of the elements of  $H$ . Is this true when  $H$  is not normal in  $G$ ?
56. Let  $G$  be a finite group and  $p$  be a prime that divides  $|G|$ . If  $H$  is a Sylow  $p$ -subgroup of  $N(H)$ , prove that  $H$  is a Sylow  $p$ -subgroup of  $G$ .
57. Show that a group of order 12 cannot have nine elements of order 2.
58. If  $|G| = 36$  and  $G$  is non-Abelian, prove that  $G$  has more than one Sylow 2-subgroup or more than one Sylow 3-subgroup.
59. Let  $G$  be a non-Abelian group of order  $pq$  where  $p$  and  $q$  are primes and  $p < q$ . Prove that  $G$  has exactly  $q + 1$  nontrivial proper subgroups.
60. Determine the groups of order 45.
61. Explain why a group of order  $4m$  where  $m$  is odd must have a subgroup isomorphic to  $Z_4$  or  $Z_2 \oplus Z_2$  but cannot have both a subgroup isomorphic to  $Z_4$  and a subgroup isomorphic to  $Z_2 \oplus Z_2$ . Show that  $S_4$  has a subgroup isomorphic to  $Z_4$  and a subgroup isomorphic to  $Z_2 \oplus Z_2$ .
62. Let  $p$  be the smallest prime that divides the order of a finite group  $G$ . If  $H$  is a Sylow  $p$ -subgroup of  $G$  and is cyclic, prove that  $N(H) = C(H)$ .
63. Let  $G$  be a group of order  $715 = 5 \cdot 11 \cdot 13$ . Let  $H$  be a Sylow 13-subgroup of  $G$  and  $K$  be a Sylow 11-subgroup of  $G$ . Prove that  $H$  is contained in  $Z(G)$ . Can the argument you used to prove that  $H$  is contained in  $Z(G)$  also be used to show that  $K$  is contained in  $Z(G)$ ?

## Computer Exercises

Software for the computer exercises in this chapter is available at the website:

**<http://www.d.umn.edu/~jgallian>**

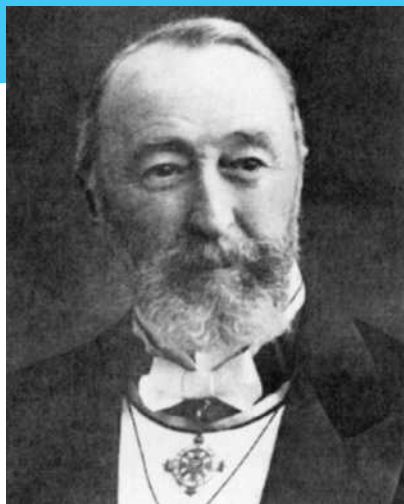
## Suggested Reading

J. A. Gallian and D. Moulton, “When Is  $Z_n$  the Only Group of Order  $n$ ?”  
*Elemente der Mathematik* 48 (1993): 118–120.

It is shown that  $Z_n$  is the only group of order  $n$  if and only if  $n$  and  $\phi(n)$  are relatively prime. The article can be downloaded at **<http://www.d.umn.edu/~jgallian/pq.pdf>**.

Sylow's Theorem is 100 years old. In the course of a century this remarkable theorem has been the basis for the construction of numerous theories.

L. A. SHEMETKOV



Author: Wolfgang Gaschütz, Source: Archives of the Mathematisches Forschungsinstitut Oberwolfach

LUDWIG SYLOW (pronounced “SEE-loe”) was born on December 12, 1832, in Christiania (now Oslo), Norway. While a student at Christiania University, Sylow won a gold medal for competitive problem solving. In 1855, he became a high school teacher; despite the long hours required by his teaching duties, Sylow found time to study the papers of Abel. During the school year 1862–1863, Sylow received a temporary appointment at Christiania University and gave lectures on Galois theory and permutation groups. Among his students that year was the great mathematician Sophus Lie (pronounced “Lee”), after whom Lie algebras and Lie groups are named. From 1873 to 1881, Sylow, with some help from Lie, prepared a new edition of Abel's works. In 1902, Sylow and Elling Holst published Abel's correspondence.

Sylow's spectacular theorems came in 1872. Upon learning of Sylow's discovery, C. Jordan called it “one of the essential points in the theory of permutations.” The results took on greater importance when the theory of abstract groups flowered in the late 19th century and early 20th century.

In 1869, Sylow was offered a professorship at Christiania University but turned it down. Upon Sylow's retirement from high school teaching at age 65, Lie mounted a successful campaign to establish a chair for Sylow at Christiania University. Sylow held this position until his death on September 7, 1918.

To find more information about Sylow, visit:

[http://www-groups.dcs.st-and  
.ac.uk/~history](http://www-groups.dcs.st-and.ac.uk/~history)

## 25 Finite Simple Groups

It is a widely held opinion that the problem of classifying finite simple groups is close to a complete solution. This will certainly be one of the great achievements of mathematics of this century.

Nathan Jacobson

It's supposed to be hard. If it wasn't hard, everyone would do it. The hard is what makes it great.

Jimmy Dugan from *A League of Their Own*

### Historical Background

We now come to the El Dorado of finite group theory—the simple groups. Simple group theory is a vast and difficult subject; we call it the El Dorado of group theory because of the enormous effort put forth by hundreds of mathematicians over many years to discover and classify all finite simple groups. Let's begin our discussion with the definition of a simple group and some historical background.

#### **Definition Simple Group**

A group is *simple* if its only normal subgroups are the identity subgroup and the group itself.

The notion of a simple group was introduced by Galois about 180 years ago. The simplicity of  $A_5$ , the group of even permutations on five symbols, played a crucial role in his proof that there is not a solution by radicals of the general fifth-degree polynomial (that is, there is no “quintic formula”). But what makes simple groups important in the theory of groups? They are important because they play a role in group theory somewhat analogous to that of primes in number theory or the elements in chemistry; that is, they serve as the building blocks for all groups. These building blocks may be determined in the following way. Given a finite group  $G$ , choose a proper normal subgroup  $G_1$  of  $G = G_0$  of largest order. Then the factor group  $G_0/G_1$  is simple, and we next choose a proper normal subgroup  $G_2$  of  $G_1$  of largest order. Then  $G_1/G_2$  is also simple, and we continue in this fashion until we arrive at  $G_n = \{e\}$ . The simple groups  $G_0/G_1, G_1/G_2, \dots$ ,

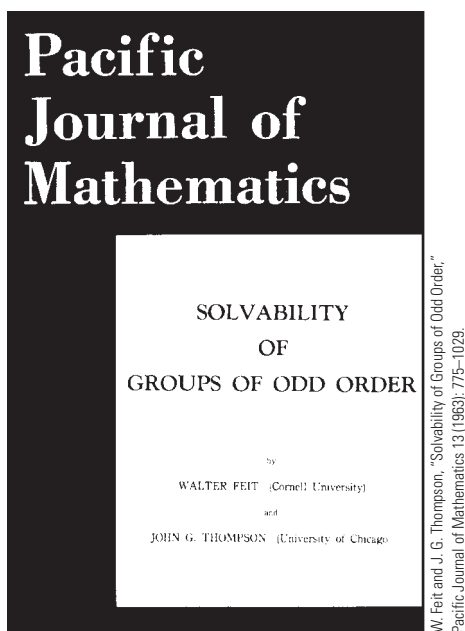


$G_{n-1}/G_n$  are called the *composition factors* of  $G$ . More than 100 years ago, Jordan and Hölder proved that these factors are independent of the choices of the normal subgroups made in the process described. In a certain sense, a group can be reconstructed from its composition factors, and many of the properties of a group are determined by the nature of its composition factors. This and the fact that many questions about finite groups can be reduced (by induction) to questions about simple groups make clear the importance of determining all finite simple groups.

Just which groups are the simple ones? The Abelian simple groups are precisely  $Z_n$ , where  $n = 1$  or  $n$  is prime. This follows directly from the corollary in Chapter 11. In contrast, it is extremely difficult to describe the non-Abelian simple groups. The best we can do here is to give a few examples and mention a few words about their discovery. It was Galois in 1831 who first observed that  $A_n$  is simple for all  $n \geq 5$ . The next discoveries were made by Jordan in 1870, when he found four infinite families of simple matrix groups over the field  $Z_p$ , where  $p$  is prime. One such family is the factor group  $SL(n, Z_p)/Z(SL(n, Z_p))$ , except when  $n = 2$  and  $p = 2$  or  $p = 3$ . Between the years 1892 and 1905, the American mathematician Leonard Dickson (see Chapter 22 for a biography) generalized Jordan's results to arbitrary finite fields and discovered several new infinite families of simple groups. About the same time, it was shown by G. A. Miller and F. N. Cole that a family of five groups first described by E. Mathieu in 1861 were in fact simple groups. Since these five groups were constructed by ad hoc methods that did not yield infinitely many possibilities, like  $A_n$  or the matrix groups over finite fields, they were called “sporadic.”

The next important discoveries came in the 1950s. In that decade, many new infinite families of simple groups were found, and the initial steps down the long and winding road that led to the complete classification of all finite simple groups were taken. The first step was Richard Brauer's observation that the centralizer of an element of order 2 was an important tool for studying simple groups. A few years later, John Thompson, in his Ph.D. dissertation, introduced the crucial idea of studying the normalizers of various subgroups of prime-power order.

In the early 1960s came the momentous Feit–Thompson Theorem, which says that a non-Abelian simple group must have even order. This property was first conjectured around 1900 by one of the pioneers of modern group theoretic methods, the Englishman William Burnside (see Chapter 29 for a biography). The proof of the Feit–Thompson Theorem filled an entire issue of a journal [1], 255 pages in all (see Figure 25.1). Writing in 2001 simple group theory expert Ronald Solomon said the theorem and its proof were “a moment in the evolution of finite group theory analogous to the emergence of fish onto dry land.”



Oh, what are the orders of all simple groups?  
 I speak of the honest ones, not of the loops.  
 It seems that old Burnside their orders has  
     guessed  
 Except for the cyclic ones, even the rest.

CHORUS: Finding all groups that are simple is no simple task.

Groups made up with permutes will  
     produce some more:  
 For  $A_n$  is simple, if  $n$  exceeds 4.  
 Then, there was Sir Matthew who came into  
     view  
 Exhibiting groups of an order quite new.

Still others have come on to study this thing.  
 Of Artin and Chevalley now we shall sing.  
 With matrices finite they made quite a list  
 The question is: Could there be others  
     they've missed?

Suzuki and Ree then maintained it's the  
     case

That these methods had not reached the end  
     of the chase.  
 They wrote down some matrices, just four by  
     four.  
 That made up a simple group. Why not make  
     more?

And then came the opus of Thompson and  
     Feit  
 Which shed on the problem remarkable light.  
 A group, when the order won't factor by two,  
 Is cyclic or solvable. That's what is true.

Suzuki and Ree had caused eyebrows to raise,  
 But the theoreticians they just couldn't faze.  
 Their groups were not new: if you added a  
     twist,  
 You could get them from old ones with a  
     flick of the wrist.

Still, some hardy souls felt a thorn in their  
     side.

Figure 25.1

For the five groups of Mathieu all reason  
defied;  
Not  $A_n$ , not twisted, and not Chevalley,  
They called them sporadic and filed them  
away.

Are Mathieu groups creatures of heaven or  
hell?  
Zvonimir Janko determined to tell.  
He found out [a new sporadic simple group]  
that nobody wanted to know:  
The masters had missed 1 7 5 5 6 0.

The floodgates were opened! New groups  
were the rage!

(And twelve or more sprouted, to greet the  
new age.)  
By Janko and Conway and Fischer and Held,  
McLaughlin, Suzuki, and Higman, and Sims.

No doubt you noted the last lines don't  
rhyme.  
Well, that is, quite simply, a sign of the time.  
There's chaos, not order, among simple  
groups;  
And maybe we'd better go back to the loops.

This result provided the impetus to classify the finite simple groups—that is, a program to discover all finite simple groups and *prove* that there are no more to be found. Throughout the 1960s, the methods introduced in the Feit–Thompson proof were generalized and improved with great success by many mathematicians. Moreover, between 1966 and 1975, 19 new sporadic simple groups were discovered. Despite many spectacular achievements, research in simple group theory in the 1960s was haphazard, and the decade ended with many people believing that the classification would never be completed. (The pessimists feared that the sporadic simple groups would foil all attempts. The anonymously written “song” in Figure 25.1 captures the spirit of the times.) Others, more optimistic, were predicting that it would be accomplished in the 1990s.

The 1970s began with Thompson receiving the Fields Medal for his fundamental contributions to simple group theory. This honor is among the highest forms of recognition that a mathematician can receive (more information about the Fields Medal is given near the end of this chapter). Within a few years, three major events took place that ultimately led to the classification. First, Thompson published what is regarded as the single most important paper in simple group theory—the  $N$ -group paper. Here, Thompson introduced many fundamental techniques and supplied a model for the classification of a broad family of simple groups. Second, Daniel Gorenstein produced an elaborate outline for the classification, which he delivered in a series of lectures at the University of Chicago in 1972. Here a program for the overall proof was laid out. The army of researchers now had a battle plan and a commander-in-chief. But this army still needed more and better weapons. Thus came the third critical development: the involvement of Michael

Aschbacher. In a dazzling series of papers, Aschbacher combined his own insight with the methods of Thompson, which had been generalized throughout the 1960s, and a geometric approach pioneered by Bernd Fischer to achieve one brilliant result after another in rapid succession. In fact, so much progress was made by Aschbacher and others that by 1976, it was clear to nearly everyone involved that enough techniques had been developed to complete the classification. Only details remained.

The 1980s were ushered in with Aschbacher following in the footsteps of Feit and Thompson by winning the American Mathematical Society's Cole Prize in algebra (see the last section of this chapter).

A week later, Robert L. Griess made the spectacular announcement that he had constructed the “Monster.”<sup>†</sup> The Monster is the largest of the sporadic simple groups. In fact, it has vastly more elements than there are atoms on the earth! Its order is

$$808,017,424,794,512,875,886,459,904,961,710,757,005,754, \\ 368,000,000,000$$

(hence, the name). This is approximately  $8 \times 10^{53}$ . The Monster is a group of rotations in 196,883 dimensions. Thus, each element can be expressed as a  $196,883 \times 196,883$  matrix.

At the annual meeting of the American Mathematical Society in 1981, Gorenstein announced that the “Twenty-Five Years’ War” to classify all the finite simple groups was over. Group theorists at long last had a list of all finite simple groups and a proof that the list was complete. The proof was spread out over hundreds of papers—both published and unpublished—and ran more than 10,000 pages in length. Because of the proof’s extreme length and complexity, and the fact that some key parts of it had not been published, there was some concern in the mathematics community that the classification was not a certainty. By the end of the decade, group theorists had concluded that there was indeed a gap in the unpublished work that would be difficult to rectify. In the mid-1990s, Aschbacher and Stephen Smith began work on this problem. In 2004, at the annual meeting of the American Mathematical Society, Aschbacher announced that he and Smith had completed the classification. Their monograph is over 1200 pages in length. Ronald Solomon, writing in *Mathematical Reviews*, called it “an amazing tour de force” and a “major milestone in the history of finite group theory.”

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<sup>†</sup>The name was coined by John H. Conway. Griess called the group the “Friendly Giant.” In 2010 the American Mathematical Society awarded Griess the Leroy P. Steele Seminal Contribution to Research Prize for his construction of the Monster.

Aschbacher concluded his remarks by saying that he would not bet his house that the proof is now error free.

Several people who played a central role in the classification are working on a “second generation” proof that will be much shorter and more comprehensible.

## Nonsimplicity Tests

In view of the fact that simple groups are the building blocks for all groups, it is surprising how scarce the non-Abelian simple groups are. For example,  $A_5$  is the only one whose order is less than 168; there are only five non-Abelian simple groups of order less than 1000 and only 56 of order less than 1,000,000. In this section, we give a few theorems that are useful in proving that a particular integer is not the order of a non-Abelian simple group. Our first such result is an easy arithmetic test that comes from combining Sylow’s Third Theorem and the fact that groups of prime-power order have nontrivial centers.

### ■ Theorem 25.1 Sylow Test for Nonsimplicity

*Let  $n$  be a positive integer that is not prime, and let  $p$  be a prime divisor of  $n$ . If 1 is the only divisor of  $n$  that is equal to 1 modulo  $p$ , then there does not exist a simple group of order  $n$ .*

**PROOF** If  $n$  is a prime-power, then a group of order  $n$  has a nontrivial center and, therefore, is not simple. If  $n$  is not a prime-power, then every Sylow subgroup is proper, and, by Sylow’s Third Theorem, we know that the number of Sylow  $p$ -subgroups of a group of order  $n$  is equal to 1 modulo  $p$  and divides  $n$ . Since 1 is the only such number, the Sylow  $p$ -subgroup is unique, and therefore, by the corollary to Sylow’s Third Theorem, it is normal. ■

How good is this test? Well, applying this criterion to all the nonprime integers between 1 and 200 would leave only the following integers as possible orders of finite non-Abelian simple groups: 12, 24, 30, 36, 48, 56, 60, 72, 80, 90, 96, 105, 108, 112, 120, 132, 144, 150, 160, 168, 180, and 192. (In fact, computer experiments have revealed that for large intervals, say, 500 or more, this test eliminates more than 90% of the nonprime integers as possible orders of simple groups. See [2] for more on this.)

Our next test rules out 30, 90, and 150.

### ■ Theorem 25.2 2 · Odd Test

*An integer of the form  $2 \cdot n$ , where  $n$  is an odd number greater than 1, is not the order of a simple group.*

**PROOF** Let  $G$  be a group of order  $2n$ , where  $n$  is odd and greater than 1. Recall from the proof of Cayley's Theorem (Theorem 6.1) that the mapping  $g \rightarrow T_g$  is an isomorphism from  $G$  to a permutation group on the elements of  $G$  [where  $T_g(x) = gx$  for all  $x$  in  $G$ ]. Since  $|G| = 2n$ , Cauchy's Theorem guarantees that there is an element  $g$  in  $G$  of order 2. Then, when the permutation  $T_g$  is written in disjoint cycle form, each cycle must have length 1 or 2; otherwise,  $|g| \neq 2$ . But  $T_g$  can contain no 1-cycles, because the 1-cycle  $(x)$  would mean  $x = T_g(x) = gx$ , so  $g = e$ . Thus, in cycle form,  $T_g$  consists of exactly  $n$  transpositions, where  $n$  is odd. Therefore,  $T_g$  is an odd permutation. This means that the set of even permutations in the image of  $G$  is a normal subgroup of index 2. (See Exercise 23 in Chapter 5 and Exercise 9 in Chapter 9.) Hence,  $G$  is not simple. ■

The next theorem is a broad generalization of Cayley's Theorem. We will make heavy use of its two corollaries.

### ■ Theorem 25.3 Generalized Cayley Theorem

*Let  $G$  be a group and let  $H$  be a subgroup of  $G$ . Let  $S$  be the group of all permutations of the left cosets of  $H$  in  $G$ . Then there is a homomorphism from  $G$  into  $S$  whose kernel lies in  $H$  and contains every normal subgroup of  $G$  that is contained in  $H$ .*

**PROOF** For each  $g \in G$ , define a permutation  $T_g$  of the left cosets of  $H$  by  $T_g(xH) = gxH$ . As in the proof of Cayley's Theorem, it is easy to verify that the mapping of  $\alpha: g \rightarrow T_g$  is a homomorphism from  $G$  into  $S$ .

Now, if  $g \in \text{Ker } \alpha$ , then  $T_g$  is the identity map, so  $H = T_g(H) = gH$ , and, therefore,  $g$  belongs to  $H$ . Thus,  $\text{Ker } \alpha \subseteq H$ . On the other hand, if  $K$  is normal in  $G$  and  $K \subseteq H$ , then for any  $k \in K$  and any  $x$  in  $G$ , there is an element  $k' \in K$  such that  $kx = xk'$ . Thus,

$$T_k(xH) = kxH = xk'H = xH$$

and, therefore,  $T_k$  is the identity permutation. This means that  $k \in \text{Ker } \alpha$ . We have proved, then, that every normal subgroup of  $G$  contained in  $H$  is also contained in  $\text{Ker } \alpha$ . ■

As a consequence of Theorem 25.3, we obtain the following very powerful arithmetic test for nonsimplicity.

### ■ Corollary 1 Index Theorem

*If  $G$  is a finite group and  $H$  is a proper subgroup of  $G$  such that  $|G|$  does not divide  $|G:H|$ !, then  $H$  contains a nontrivial normal subgroup of  $G$ . In particular,  $G$  is not simple.*

**PROOF** Let  $\alpha$  be the homomorphism given in Theorem 25.3. Then  $\text{Ker } \alpha$  is a normal subgroup of  $G$  contained in  $H$ , and  $G/\text{Ker } \alpha$  is isomorphic to a subgroup of  $S$ . Thus,  $|G/\text{Ker } \alpha| = |G|/|\text{Ker } \alpha|$  divides  $|S| = |G:H|$ !. Since  $|G|$  does not divide  $|G:H|$ !, the order of  $\text{Ker } \alpha$  must be greater than 1. ■

### ■ Corollary 2 Embedding Theorem

*If a finite non-Abelian simple group  $G$  has a subgroup of index  $n$ , then  $G$  is isomorphic to a subgroup of  $A_n$ .*

**PROOF** Let  $H$  be the subgroup of index  $n$ , and let  $S_n$  be the group of all permutations of the  $n$  left cosets of  $H$  in  $G$ . By the Generalized Cayley Theorem, there is a nontrivial homomorphism from  $G$  into  $S_n$ . Since  $G$  is simple and the kernel of a homomorphism is a normal subgroup of  $G$ , we see that the mapping from  $G$  into  $S_n$  is one-to-one, so that  $G$  is isomorphic to some subgroup of  $S_n$ . Recall from Exercise 23 in Chapter 5 that any subgroup of  $S_n$  consists of even permutations only or half even and half odd. If  $G$  were isomorphic to a subgroup of the latter type, the even permutations would be a normal subgroup of index 2 (see Exercise 9 in Chapter 9), which would contradict the fact that  $G$  is simple. Thus,  $G$  is isomorphic to a subgroup of  $A_n$ . ■

Using the Index Theorem with the largest Sylow subgroup for  $H$  reduces our list of possible orders of non-Abelian simple groups still further. For example, let  $G$  be any group of order  $80 = 16 \cdot 5$ . We may choose  $H$  to be a subgroup of order 16. Since 80 is not a divisor of  $5!$ , there is no simple group of order 80. The same argument applies to 12, 24, 36, 48, 96, 108, 160, and 192, leaving only 56, 60, 72, 105, 112, 120, 132, 144, 168, and 180 as possible orders of non-Abelian simple groups up to 200. Let's consider these orders. Quite often we may use a counting argument to eliminate an integer. Consider 56. By Sylow's Third Theorem, we know that a simple group of order  $56 = 8 \cdot 7$  would

contain eight Sylow 7-subgroups and seven Sylow 2-subgroups. Now, any two Sylow  $p$ -subgroups that have order  $p$  must intersect in only the identity. So the union of the eight Sylow 7-subgroups yields 48 elements of order 7, and the union of any two Sylow 2-subgroups gives at least  $8 + 8 - 4 = 12$  new elements. But there are only 56 elements in all. This contradiction shows that there is not a simple group of order 56. An analogous argument also eliminates the integers 105 and 132.

So, our list of possible orders of non-Abelian simple groups up to 200 is down to 60, 72, 112, 120, 144, 168, and 180. Of these, 60 and 168 do correspond to simple groups. The others can be eliminated with a bit of razzle-dazzle.

The easiest case to handle is  $112 = 2^4 \cdot 7$ . Suppose there were a simple group  $G$  of order 112. A Sylow 2-subgroup of  $G$  must have index 7. So, by the Embedding Theorem,  $G$  is isomorphic to a subgroup of  $A_7$ . But 112 does not divide  $|A_7|$ , which is a contradiction.

Another easy case is 72. This case was done in Example 5 in Chapter 24 but we eliminate it using the Index Theorem. Recall from Exercise 9 in Chapter 24 that if we denote the number of Sylow  $p$ -subgroups of a group  $G$  by  $n_p$ , then  $n_p = |G:N(H)|$ , where  $H$  is any Sylow  $p$ -subgroup of  $G$ , and  $n_p \bmod p = 1$ . It follows, then, that in a simple group of order 72, we have  $n_3 = 4$ , which is impossible, since 72 does not divide 4!

Next consider the possibility of a simple group  $G$  of order  $144 = 9 \cdot 16$ . By the Sylow theorems, we know that  $n_3 = 4$  or 16 and  $n_2 \geq 3$ . The Index Theorem rules out the case where  $n_3 = 4$ , so we know that there are 16 Sylow 3-subgroups. Now, if every pair of Sylow 3-subgroups had only the identity in common, a straightforward counting argument would produce more than 144 elements. So, let  $H$  and  $H'$  be a pair of Sylow 3-subgroups whose intersection has order 3. Then  $H \cap H'$  is a subgroup of both  $H$  and  $H'$  and, by the corollary to Theorem 24.2 (or by Exercise 45 in Chapter 24), we see that  $N(H \cap H')$  must contain both  $H$  and  $H'$  and, therefore, the set  $HH'$ . ( $HH'$  need not be a subgroup.) Thus,

$$|N(H \cap H')| \geq |HH'| = \frac{|H||H'|}{|H \cap H'|} = \frac{9 \cdot 9}{3} = 27.$$

Now, we have three arithmetic conditions on  $k = |N(H \cap H')|$ . We know that 9 divides  $k$ ;  $k$  divides 144; and  $k \geq 27$ . Clearly, then,  $k \geq 36$ , and so  $|G:N(H \cap H')| \leq 4$ . The Index Theorem now gives us the desired contradiction.

Finally, suppose that  $G$  is a non-Abelian simple group of order  $180 = 2^2 \cdot 3^2 \cdot 5$ . Then  $n_5 = 6$  or 36 and  $n_3 = 10$  ( $n_3 = 4$  is ruled out by the Index Theorem). First, assume that  $n_5 = 36$ . Then  $G$  has  $36 \cdot 4 = 144$



elements of order 5. Now, if each pair of the Sylow 3-subgroups intersects in only the identity, then there are 80 more elements in the group, which is a contradiction. So, we may assume that there are two Sylow 3-subgroups  $L_3$  and  $L'_3$  whose intersection has order 3. Then, as was the case for order 144, we have

$$|N(L_3 \cap L'_3)| \geq |L_3 L'_3| = \frac{9 \cdot 9}{3} = 27.$$

Thus,

$$|N(L_3 \cap L'_3)| = 9 \cdot k,$$

where  $k \geq 3$  and  $k$  divides 20. Clearly, then,

$$|N(L_3 \cap L'_3)| \geq 36$$

and therefore

$$|G:N(L_3 \cap L'_3)| \leq 5.$$

The Index Theorem now gives us another contradiction. Hence, we may assume that  $n_5 = 6$ . In this case, we let  $H$  be the normalizer of a Sylow 5-subgroup of  $G$ . By Sylow's Third Theorem, we have  $6 = |G:H|$ , so that  $|H| = 30$ . In Chapter 24, we proved that every group of order 30 has an element of order 15. On the other hand, since  $n_5 = 6$ ,  $G$  has a subgroup of index 6 and the Embedding Theorem tells us that  $G$  is isomorphic to a subgroup of  $A_6$ . But  $A_6$  has no element of order 15. (See Exercise 9 in Chapter 5.)

Unfortunately, the argument for 120 is fairly long and complicated. However, no new techniques are required to do it. We leave this as an exercise (Exercise 17). Some hints are given in the answer section.

## The Simplicity of $A_5$

Once 120 has been disposed of, we will have shown that the only integers between 1 and 200 that can be the orders of non-Abelian simple groups are 60 and 168. For completeness, we will now prove that  $A_5$ , which has order 60, is a simple group. A similar argument can be used to show that the factor group  $SL(2, Z_7)/Z(SL(2, Z_7))$  is a simple group of order 168. [This group is denoted by  $PSL(2, Z_7)$ .]

If  $A_5$  had a nontrivial proper normal subgroup  $H$ , then  $|H|$  would be equal to 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 10, 12, 15, 20, or 30. By Exercise 61 in Chapter 5,  $A_5$  has 24 elements of order 5, 20 elements of order 3, and no elements of order 15. Now, if  $|H|$  is equal to 3, 6, 12, or 15, then  $|A_5/H|$  is relatively prime to 3, and by Exercise 61 in Chapter 9,  $H$  would have to contain all 20 elements of order 3. If  $|H|$  is equal to 5, 10, or 20, then

$|A_5/H|$  is relatively prime to 5, and, therefore,  $H$  would have to contain the 24 elements of order 5. If  $|H| = 30$ , then  $|A_5/H|$  is relatively prime to both 3 and 5, and so  $H$  would have to contain all the elements of orders 3 and 5. Finally, if  $|H| = 2$  or  $|H| = 4$ , then  $|A_5/H| = 30$  or  $|A_5/H| = 15$ . But we know from our results in Chapter 24 that any group of order 30 or 15 has an element of order 15. However, since  $A_5$  contains no such element, neither does  $A_5/H$ . This proves that  $A_5$  is simple.

The simplicity of  $A_5$  was known to Galois in 1830, although the first formal proof was done by Jordan in 1870. A few years later, Felix Klein showed that the group of rotations of a regular icosahedron is simple and, therefore, isomorphic to  $A_5$  (see Exercise 27). Since then it has frequently been called the *icosahedral group*. Klein was the first to prove that there is a simple group of order 168.

The problem of determining which integers in a certain interval are possible orders for finite simple groups goes back to 1892, when Hölder went up to 200. His arguments for the integers 144 and 180 alone used up 10 pages. By 1975, this investigation had been pushed to well beyond 1,000,000. See [3] for a detailed account of this endeavor. Of course, now that all finite simple groups have been classified, this problem is merely a historical curiosity.

## The Fields Medal

Among the highest awards for mathematical achievement is the Fields Medal. Two to four such awards are bestowed at the opening session of the International Congress of Mathematicians, held once every four years. Although the Fields Medal is considered by many mathematicians to be the equivalent of the Nobel Prize, there are great differences between these awards. Besides the huge disparity in publicity and monetary value associated with the two honors, the Fields Medal is restricted to those under 40 years of age.<sup>†</sup> This tradition stems from John Charles Fields's stipulation, in his will establishing the medal, that the awards should be "an encouragement for further achievement." This restriction precluded Andrew Wiles from winning the Fields Medal for his proof of Fermat's Last Theorem.

More details about the Fields Medal can be found at <http://www.wikipedia.com>.

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<sup>†</sup>"Take the sum of human achievement in action, in science, in art, in literature—subtract the work of the men above forty, and while we should miss great treasures, even priceless treasures, we would practically be where we are today. . . . The effective, moving, vitalizing work of the world is done between the ages of twenty-five and forty." Sir William Osler (1849–1919), *Life of Sir William Osler*, vol. I, chap. 24 (The Fixed Period).



The Fields Medal

Three-minute video clips of the four recipients of the 2014 Fields medals talking about their work are available at [www.icm2014.org](http://www.icm2014.org).

## The Cole Prize

Approximately every five years, beginning in 1928, the American Mathematical Society awards one or two Cole Prizes for research in algebra and one or two Cole Prizes for research in algebraic number theory. The prize was founded in honor of Frank Nelson Cole on the occasion of his retirement as secretary of the American Mathematical Society. In view of the fact that Cole was one of the first people interested in simple groups, it is interesting to note that no fewer than six recipients of the prize—Dickson, Chevalley, Brauer, Feit, Thompson, and Aschbacher—have made fundamental contributions to simple group theory at some time in their careers. Recently the time between Cole Prizes was reduced to three years.

## Exercises

If you don't learn from your mistakes, there's no sense making them.

Herbert V. Prochnow

1. Prove that there is no simple group of order  $210 = 2 \cdot 3 \cdot 5 \cdot 7$ .
2. Prove that there is no simple group of order  $280 = 2^3 \cdot 5 \cdot 7$ .
3. Prove that there is no simple group of order  $216 = 2^3 \cdot 3^3$ .
4. Prove that there is no simple group of order  $300 = 2^2 \cdot 3 \cdot 5^2$ .
5. Prove that there is no simple group of order  $525 = 3 \cdot 5^2 \cdot 7$ .

6. Prove that there is no simple group of order  $540 = 2^2 \cdot 3^3 \cdot 5$ .
7. Prove that there is no simple group of order  $528 = 2^4 \cdot 3 \cdot 11$ .
8. Prove that there is no simple group of order  $315 = 3^2 \cdot 5 \cdot 7$ .
9. Prove that there is no simple group of order  $396 = 2^2 \cdot 3^2 \cdot 11$ .
10. Prove that there is no simple group of order  $n$ , where  $201 \leq n \leq 235$  and  $n$  is not prime.
11. Without using the Generalized Cayley Theorem or its corollaries, prove that there is no simple group of order 112.
12. Without using the 2 · Odd Test, prove that there is no simple group of order 210.
13. You may have noticed that all the “hard integers” are even. Choose three odd integers between 200 and 1000. Show that none of these is the order of a simple group unless it is prime.
14. Show that there is no simple group of order  $pqr$ , where  $p$ ,  $q$ , and  $r$  are primes ( $p$ ,  $q$ , and  $r$  need not be distinct).
15. Show that  $A_5$  does not contain a subgroup of order 30, 20, or 15.
16. Prove that  $A_6$  has no subgroup of order 120.
17. Prove that there is no simple group of order  $120 = 2^3 \cdot 3 \cdot 5$ . (This exercise is referred to in this chapter.)
18. Prove that if  $G$  is a finite group and  $H$  is a proper normal subgroup of largest order, then  $G/H$  is simple.
19. Suppose that  $H$  is a subgroup of a finite group  $G$  and that  $|H|$  and  $(|G:H| - 1)!$  are relatively prime. Prove that  $H$  is normal in  $G$ . What does this tell you about a subgroup of index 2 in a finite group?
20. Suppose that  $p$  is the smallest prime that divides  $|G|$ . Show that any subgroup of index  $p$  in  $G$  is normal in  $G$ .
21. Prove that the only nontrivial proper normal subgroup of  $S_5$  is  $A_5$ . (This exercise is referred to in Chapter 32.)
22. Prove that a simple group of order 60 has a subgroup of order 6 and a subgroup of order 10.
23. Show that  $PSL(2, Z_7) = SL(2, Z_7)/Z(SL(2, Z_7))$ , which has order 168, is a simple group. (This exercise is referred to in this chapter.)
24. Show that the permutations (12) and (12345) generate  $S_5$ .
25. Suppose that a subgroup  $H$  of  $S_5$  contains a 5-cycle and a 2-cycle. Show that  $H = S_5$ . (This exercise is referred to in Chapter 32.)
26. Suppose that  $G$  is a finite simple group and contains subgroups  $H$  and  $K$  such that  $|G:H|$  and  $|G:K|$  are prime. Show that  $|H| = |K|$ .
27. Show that (up to isomorphism)  $A_5$  is the only simple group of order 60. (This exercise is referred to in this chapter.)

28. Prove that a simple group cannot have a subgroup of index 4.
29. Prove that there is no simple group of order  $p^2q$ , where  $p$  and  $q$  are odd primes and  $q > p$ .
30. If a simple group  $G$  has a subgroup  $K$  that is a normal subgroup of two distinct maximal subgroups, prove that  $K = \{e\}$ .
31. Show that a finite group of even order that has a cyclic Sylow 2-subgroup is not simple.
32. Show that  $S_5$  does not contain a subgroup of order 40 or 30.

## Computer Exercises

Computer exercises for this chapter are available at the website:

**<http://www.d.umn.edu/~jgallian>**

## References

1. W. Feit and J. G. Thompson, "Solvability of Groups of Odd Order," *Pacific Journal of Mathematics* 13 (1963): 775–1029.
2. J. A. Gallian, "Computers in Group Theory," *Mathematics Magazine* 49 (1976): 69–73.
3. J. A. Gallian, "The Search for Finite Simple Groups," *Mathematics Magazine* 49 (1976): 163–179.

## Suggested Readings

K. David, "Using Commutators to Prove  $A_5$  Is Simple," *The American Mathematical Monthly* 94 (1987): 775–776.

This note gives an elementary proof that  $A_5$  is simple using commutators.

J. A. Gallian, "The Search for Finite Simple Groups," *Mathematics Magazine* 49 (1976): 163–179.

A historical account is given of the search for finite simple groups.

This article can be downloaded at **<http://www.d.umn.edu/~jgallian/simple.pdf>**

Martin Gardner, "The Capture of the Monster: A Mathematical Group with a Ridiculous Number of Elements," *Scientific American* 242 (6) (1980): 20–32.

This article gives an elementary introduction to groups and a discussion of simple groups, including the "Monster."

Daniel Gorenstein, "The Enormous Theorem," *Scientific American* 253 (6) (1985): 104–115.

You won't find an article on a complex subject better written for the layperson than this one. Gorenstein, the driving force behind the classification, uses concrete examples, analogies, and nontechnical terms to make the difficult subject matter of simple groups accessible.

Sandra M. Leps, " $PSL(2, Z_7)$  Is Simple, by Counting," *Pi Mu Epsilon Journal* 9 (1993): 576–578.

The author shows that the group  $SL(2, Z_7)/Z(SL(2, Z_7))$  of order 168 is simple using a counting argument.

Alma Steingart, "A Group Theory of Group Theory: Collaborative Mathematics and the 'Uninvention' of a 1000 page Proof," *Social Studies of Science*, (43) (2013): 905–926.

This non-technical article discusses the proof of the classification of finite simple groups and the community of finite simple group theorists who produced it. It quotes at length from oral interviews done by the author of this book in the early 1980s of many of the key people involved.

# Michael Aschbacher

Fresh out of graduate school, he [Aschbacher] had just entered the field, and from that moment he became the driving force behind my program. In rapid succession he proved one astonishing theorem after another. Although there were many other major contributors to this final assault, Aschbacher alone was responsible for shrinking my projected 30-year timetable to a mere 10 years.

DANIEL GORENSTEIN, *Scientific American*



Courtesy of Pam Aschbacher

MICHAEL ASCHBACHER was born on April 8, 1944, in Little Rock, Arkansas. Shortly after his birth, his family moved to Illinois, where his father was a professor of accounting and his mother was a high school English teacher. When he was nine years old, his family moved to East Lansing, Michigan; six years later, they moved to Los Angeles.

After high school, Aschbacher enrolled at the California Institute of Technology. In addition to his schoolwork, he passed the first four actuary exams and was employed for a few years as an actuary, full-time in the summers and part-time during the academic year. Two of the Caltech mathematicians who influenced him were Marshall Hall and Donald Knuth. In his senior year, Aschbacher took abstract algebra but showed little interest in the course. Accordingly, he received a grade of C.

In 1966, Aschbacher went to the University of Wisconsin for a Ph.D. degree. He completed his dissertation in 1969, and, after spending one year as an assistant professor at the University of Illinois, he returned to Caltech and quickly moved up to the rank of professor.

Aschbacher's dissertation work in the area of combinatorial geometries had led him to consider certain group theoretic questions. Gradually, he turned his attention more and more to purely group theoretic problems, particularly those bearing on the classification of finite simple groups. The 1980 Cole Prize Selection Committee said of one of his papers, "[It] lifted the subject to a new plateau and brought the classification within reach." Aschbacher has been elected to the National Academy of Sciences, the American Academy of Sciences, and the vice presidency of the American Mathematical Society. In 2011, Aschbacher received the \$75,000 Rolf Schock Prize from the Royal Swedish Academy of Sciences for "his fundamental contributions to one of the largest mathematical projects ever, the classification of finite simple groups." In 2012, he shared the \$100,000 Wolf Prize for his work in the theory of finite groups and shared the American Mathematical Society's Steele Prize for Exposition.

# Daniel Gorenstein

Gorenstein was one of the most influential mathematicians of the last few decades.

MICHAEL ASCHBACHER,  
*Notices of the American Mathematical Society*



Courtesy of the Clark University Archives

DANIEL GORENSTEIN was born in Boston on January 1, 1923. Upon graduating from Harvard in 1943 during World War II, Gorenstein was offered an instructorship at Harvard to teach mathematics to army personnel. After the war ended, he began graduate work at Harvard. He received his Ph.D. degree in 1951, working in algebraic geometry under Oscar Zariski. It was in his dissertation that he introduced the class of rings that is now named after him. In 1951, Gorenstein took a position at Clark University in Worcester, Massachusetts, where he stayed until moving to Northeastern University in 1964. From 1969 until his death on August 26, 1992, he was at Rutgers University.

In 1957, Gorenstein switched from algebraic geometry to finite groups, learning the basic material from I. N. Herstein while collaborating with him over the next few years. A milestone in Gorenstein's development as a group theorist came during 1960–1961, when he was invited to participate in a “Group Theory Year” at the University of Chicago.

It was there that Gorenstein, assimilating the revolutionary techniques then being developed by John Thompson, began his fundamental work that contributed to the classification of finite simple groups.

Through his pioneering research papers, his dynamic lectures, his numerous personal contacts, and his influential book on finite groups, Gorenstein became the leader in the 25-year effort, by hundreds of mathematicians, that led to the classification of the finite simple groups.

Among the honors received by Gorenstein are the Steele Prize from the American Mathematical Society and election to membership in the National Academy of Sciences and the American Academy of Arts and Sciences.

To find more information about Gorenstein, visit:

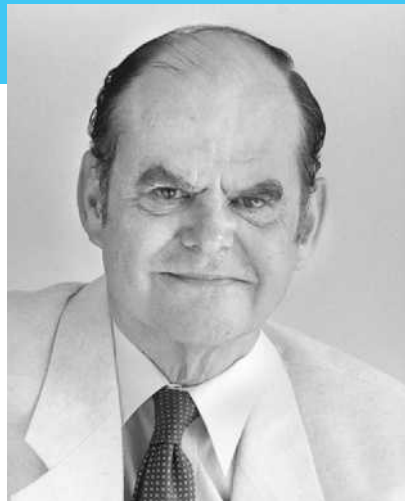
**<http://www.groups.dcs.st-and.ac.uk/~history/>**



# John Thompson

There seemed to be no limit to his power.

DANIEL GORENSTEIN



Courtesy of John Thompson

JOHN G. THOMPSON was born on October 13, 1932, in Ottawa, Kansas. In 1951, he entered Yale University as a divinity student, but he switched to mathematics in his sophomore year. In 1955, he began graduate school at the University of Chicago, he obtained his Ph.D. degree four years later. After one year on the faculty at Harvard, Thompson returned to Chicago. He remained there until 1968, when he moved to Cambridge University in England. In 1993, Thompson accepted an appointment at the University of Florida.

Thompson's brilliance was evident early. In his dissertation, he verified a 50-year-old conjecture about finite groups possessing a certain kind of automorphism. (An article about his achievement appeared in *The New York Times*.) The novel methods Thompson used in his dissertation foreshadowed the revolutionary ideas he would later introduce in the Feit–Thompson paper and the classification of minimal simple groups (simple groups that contain no proper non-Abelian simple subgroups). The assimilation and extension of Thompson's methods by others throughout

the 1960s and 1970s ultimately led to the classification of finite simple groups.

In the late 1970s, Thompson made significant contributions to coding theory, the theory of finite projective planes, and the theory of modular functions. His work on Galois groups is considered the most important in the field in the last half of the 20th century.

Among Thompson's many honors are the Cole Prize in algebra and the Fields Medal. He was elected to the National Academy of Sciences in 1967, the Royal Society of London in 1979, the Sylvester Medal in 1985, the Wolf Prize and the Poincaré Prize in 1992, the American Academy of Arts and Sciences in 1998, the National Medal of Science in 2000, and the De Morgan Medal in 2013. In 2008, he was a cowinner of the \$1,000,000 Abel Prize given by the Norwegian Academy of Science and Letters.

To find more information about Thompson, visit:

**<http://www-groups.dcs.st-and.ac.uk/~history/>**

# 26 Generators and Relations

One cannot escape the feeling that these mathematical formulae have an independent existence and an intelligence of their own, that they are wiser than we are, wiser even than their discoverers, that we get more out of them than we originally put into them.

Heinrich Hertz

I presume that to the uninitiated the formulae will appear cold and cheerless.

Benjamin Pierce

## Motivation

In this chapter, we present a convenient way to define a group with certain prescribed properties. Simply put, we begin with a set of elements that we want to generate the group, and a set of equations (called *relations*) that specify the conditions that these generators are to satisfy. Among all such possible groups, we will select one that is as large as possible. This will uniquely determine the group up to isomorphism.

To provide motivation for the theory involved, we begin with a concrete example. Consider  $D_4$ , the group of symmetries of a square. Recall that  $R = R_{90}$  and  $H$ , a reflection across a horizontal axis, generate the group. Observe that  $R$  and  $H$  are related in the following ways:

$$R^4 = H^2 = (RH)^2 = R_0 \quad (\text{the identity}). \quad (1)$$

Other relations between  $R$  and  $H$ , such as  $HR = R^3H$  and  $RHR = H$ , also exist, but they can be derived from those given in Equation (1). For example,  $(RH)^2 = R_0$  yields  $HR = R^{-1}H^{-1}$ , and  $R^4 = H^2 = R_0$  yields  $R^{-1} = R^3$  and  $H^{-1} = H$ . So,  $HR = R^3H$ . In fact, every relation between  $R$  and  $H$  can be derived from those given in Equation (1).

Thus,  $D_4$  is a group that is generated by a pair of elements  $a$  and  $b$  subject to the relations  $a^4 = b^2 = (ab)^2 = e$  and such that all other relations between  $a$  and  $b$  can be derived from these relations. This last

stipulation is necessary because the subgroup  $\{R_0, R_{180}, H, V\}$  of  $D_4$  is generated by the two elements  $a = R_{180}$  and  $b = H$  that satisfy the relations  $a^4 = b^2 = (ab)^2 = e$ . However, the “extra” relation  $a^2 = e$  satisfied by this subgroup cannot be derived from the original ones (since  $R_{90}^2 \neq R_0$ ). It is natural to ask whether this description of  $D_4$  applies to some other group as well. The answer is no. Any other group generated by two elements  $\alpha$  and  $\beta$  satisfying only the relations  $\alpha^4 = \beta^2 = (\alpha\beta)^2 = e$ , and those that can be derived from these relations, is isomorphic to  $D_4$ .

Similarly, one can show that the group  $Z_4 \oplus Z_2$  is generated by two elements  $a$  and  $b$  such that  $a^4 = b^2 = e$  and  $ab = ba$ , and any other relation between  $a$  and  $b$  can be derived from these relations. The purpose of this chapter is to show that this procedure can be reversed; that is, we can begin with any set of generators and relations among the generators and construct a group that is uniquely described by these generators and relations, subject to the stipulation that all other relations among the generators can be derived from the original ones.

## Definitions and Notation

We begin with some definitions and notation. For any set  $S = \{a, b, c, \dots\}$  of distinct symbols, we create a new set  $S^{-1} = \{a^{-1}, b^{-1}, c^{-1}, \dots\}$  by replacing each  $x$  in  $S$  by  $x^{-1}$ . Define the set  $W(S)$  to be the collection of all formal finite strings of the form  $x_1 x_2 \cdots x_k$ , where each  $x_i \in S \cup S^{-1}$ . The elements of  $W(S)$  are called *words from  $S$* . We also permit the string with no elements to be in  $W(S)$ . This word is called the *empty word* and is denoted by  $e$ .

We may define a binary operation on the set  $W(S)$  by juxtaposition; that is, if  $x_1 x_2 \cdots x_k$  and  $y_1 y_2 \cdots y_l$  belong to  $W(S)$ , then so does  $x_1 x_2 \cdots x_k y_1 y_2 \cdots y_l$ . Observe that this operation is associative and the empty word is the identity. Also, notice that a word such as  $aa^{-1}$  is not the identity, because we are treating the elements of  $W(S)$  as formal symbols with no implied meaning.

At this stage we have everything we need to make a group out of  $W(S)$  except inverses. Here a difficulty arises, since it seems reasonable that the inverse of the word  $ab$ , say, should be  $b^{-1}a^{-1}$ . But  $abb^{-1}a^{-1}$  is not the empty word! You may recall that we faced a similar obstacle long ago when we carried out the construction of the field of quotients of an integral domain. There we had formal symbols of the form  $a/b$  and we wanted the inverse of  $a/b$  to be  $b/a$ . But their product,  $ab/(ba)$ , was a formal symbol that was not the same as the formal symbol  $1/1$ , the identity. So, we proceed here as we did there—by way of equivalence classes.

**Definition Equivalence Classes of Words**

For any pair of elements  $u$  and  $v$  of  $W(S)$ , we say that  $u$  is related to  $v$  if  $v$  can be obtained from  $u$  by a finite sequence of insertions or deletions of words of the form  $xx^{-1}$  or  $x^{-1}x$ , where  $x \in S$ .

We leave it as an exercise to show that this relation is an equivalence relation on  $W(S)$ . (See Exercise 1.)

■ **EXAMPLE 1** Let  $S = \{a, b, c\}$ . Then  $acc^{-1}b$  is equivalent to  $ab$ ;  $aab^{-1}bbacc^{-1}$  is equivalent to  $aabac$ ; the word  $a^{-1}aabb^{-1}a^{-1}$  is equivalent to the empty word; and the word  $ca^{-1}b$  is equivalent to  $cc^{-1}caa^{-1}a^{-1}bbca^{-1}ac^{-1}b^{-1}$ . Note, however, that  $cac^{-1}b$  is not equivalent to  $ab$ . ■

## Free Group

### ■ Theorem 26.1 Equivalence Classes Form a Group

*Let  $S$  be a set of distinct symbols. For any word  $u$  in  $W(S)$ , let  $\bar{u}$  denote the set of all words in  $W(S)$  equivalent to  $u$  (that is,  $\bar{u}$  is the equivalence class containing  $u$ ). Then the set of all equivalence classes of elements of  $W(S)$  is a group under the operation  $\bar{u} \cdot \bar{v} = \overline{uv}$ .*

**PROOF** This proof is left to the reader. ■

The group defined in Theorem 26.1 is called a *free group on  $S$* . Theorem 26.2 shows why free groups are important.

### ■ Theorem 26.2 Universal Mapping Property

*Every group is a homomorphic image of a free group.*

**PROOF** Let  $G$  be a group and let  $S$  be a set of generators for  $G$ . (Such a set exists, because we may take  $S$  to be  $G$  itself.) Now let  $F$  be the free group on  $S$ . Unfortunately, since our notation for any word in  $W(S)$  also denotes an element of  $G$ , we have created a notational problem for ourselves. So, to distinguish between these two cases, we will denote the word  $x_1x_2 \cdots x_n$  in  $W(S)$  by  $(x_1x_2 \cdots x_n)_F$  and the product  $x_1x_2 \cdots x_n$  in  $G$  by  $(x_1x_2 \cdots x_n)_G$ . As before,  $\overline{x_1x_2 \cdots x_n}$  denotes the equivalence class in  $F$  containing the word  $(x_1x_2 \cdots x_n)_F$  in  $W(S)$ . Notice that  $\overline{x_1x_2 \cdots x_n}$  and  $(x_1x_2 \cdots x_n)_G$  are entirely different elements, since the operations on  $F$  and  $G$  are different.

Now consider the mapping from  $F$  into  $G$  given by

$$\phi(\overline{x_1 x_2 \cdots x_n}) = (x_1 x_2 \cdots x_n)_G.$$

[All we are doing is taking a product in  $F$  and viewing it as a product in  $G$ . For example, if  $G$  is the cyclic group of order 4 generated by  $a$ , then

$$\phi(\overline{aaaaa}) = (aaaaa)_G = a.]$$

Clearly,  $\phi$  is well-defined, for inserting or deleting expressions of the form  $xx^{-1}$  or  $x^{-1}x$  in elements of  $W(S)$  corresponds to inserting or deleting the identity in  $G$ . To check that  $\phi$  is operation-preserving, observe that

$$\begin{aligned} \phi(\overline{x_1 x_2 \cdots x_n} \overline{y_1 y_2 \cdots y_m}) &= \phi(\overline{x_1 x_2 \cdots x_n y_1 y_2 \cdots y_m}) \\ &= (x_1 x_2 \cdots x_n y_1 y_2 \cdots y_m)_G \\ &= (x_1 x_2 \cdots x_n)_G (y_1 y_2 \cdots y_m)_G. \end{aligned}$$

Finally,  $\phi$  is onto  $G$  because  $S$  generates  $G$ . ■

The following corollary is an immediate consequence of Theorem 26.2 and the First Isomorphism Theorem for Groups.

### ■ Corollary Universal Factor Group Property

*Every group is isomorphic to a factor group of a free group.*

## Generators and Relations

We have now laid the foundation for defining a group by way of generators and relations. Before giving the definition, we will illustrate the basic idea with an example.

**■ EXAMPLE 2** Let  $F$  be the free group on the set  $\{a, b\}$  and let  $N$  be the smallest normal subgroup of  $F$  containing the set  $\{a^4, b^2, (ab)^2\}$ . We will show that  $F/N$  is isomorphic to  $D_4$ . We begin by observing that the mapping  $\phi$  from  $F$  onto  $D_4$ , which takes  $a$  to  $R_{90}$  and  $b$  to  $H$  (horizontal reflection), defines a homomorphism whose kernel contains  $N$ . Thus,  $F/\text{Ker } \phi$  is isomorphic to  $D_4$ . On the other hand, we claim that the set

$$K = \{N, aN, a^2N, a^3N, bN, abN, a^2bN, a^3bN\}$$

of left cosets of  $N$  is  $F/N$  itself. To see this, notice that every member of  $F/N$  can be generated by starting with  $N$  and successively multiplying on the left by various combinations of  $a$ 's and  $b$ 's. So, it suffices to show that  $K$  is closed under multiplication on the left by  $a$  and  $b$ . It is trivial that  $K$  is closed under left multiplication by  $a$ . For  $b$ , we will do

only one of the eight cases. The others can be done in a similar fashion. Consider  $b(aN)$ . Since  $b^2, abab, a^4 \in N$  and  $Nb = bN$ , we have  $baN = baNb^2 = babNb = a^{-1}(abab)Nb = a^{-1}Nb = a^{-1}a^4Nb = a^3Nb = a^3bN$ . Upon completion of the other cases (Exercise 3), we know that  $F/N$  has at most eight elements. At the same time, we know that  $F/\text{Ker } \phi$  has exactly eight elements. Since  $F/\text{Ker } \phi$  is a factor group of  $F/N$  [indeed,  $F/\text{Ker } \phi \approx (F/N)/(\text{Ker } \phi/N)$ ], it follows that  $F/N$  also has eight elements and  $F/N = F/\text{Ker } \phi \approx D_4$ . ■

### Definition Generators and Relations

Let  $G$  be a group generated by some subset  $A = \{a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n\}$  and let  $F$  be the free group on  $A$ . Let  $W = \{w_1, w_2, \dots, w_t\}$  be a subset of  $F$  and let  $N$  be the smallest normal subgroup of  $F$  containing  $W$ . We say that  $G$  is given by the generators  $a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n$  and the relations  $w_1 = w_2 = \dots = w_t = e$  if there is an isomorphism from  $F/N$  onto  $G$  that carries  $a_iN$  to  $a_i$ .

The notation for this situation is

$$G = \langle a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n \mid w_1 = w_2 = \dots = w_t = e \rangle.$$

As a matter of convenience, we have restricted the number of generators and relations in our definition to be finite. This restriction is not necessary, however. Also, it is often more convenient to write a relation in implicit form. For example, the relation  $a^{-1}b^{-3}ab = e$  is often written as  $ab = b^3a$ . In practice, one does not bother writing down the normal subgroup  $N$  that contains the relations. Instead, one just manipulates the generators and treats anything in  $N$  as the identity, as our notation suggests. Rather than saying that  $G$  is given by

$$\langle a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n \mid w_1 = w_2 = \dots = w_t = e \rangle,$$

many authors prefer to say that  $G$  has the *presentation*

$$\langle a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n \mid w_1 = w_2 = \dots = w_t = e \rangle.$$

Notice that a free group is “free” of relations; that is, the equivalence class containing the empty word is the only relation. We mention in passing the fact that a subgroup of a free group is also a free group. Free groups are of fundamental importance in a branch of algebra known as combinatorial group theory.

■ **EXAMPLE 3** The discussion in Example 2 can now be summed up by writing

$$D_4 = \langle a, b \mid a^4 = b^2 = (ab)^2 = e \rangle. \quad \blacksquare$$

■ **EXAMPLE 4** The group of integers is the free group on one letter; that is,  $\mathbb{Z} \approx \langle a \rangle$ . (This is the only nontrivial Abelian group that is free.) ■

The next theorem formalizes the argument used in Example 2 to prove that the group defined there has eight elements.

■ **Theorem 26.3** Dyck's Theorem (1882)

*Let*

$$G = \langle a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n \mid w_1 = w_2 = \dots = w_t = e \rangle$$

*and let*

$$\overline{G} = \langle a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n \mid w_1 = w_2 = \dots = w_t = w_{t+1} = \dots = w_{t+k} = e \rangle.$$

*Then  $\overline{G}$  is a homomorphic image of  $G$ .*

**PROOF** See Exercise 5. ■

In words, Theorem 26.3 says that if you start with generators and relations for a group  $G$  and create a group  $\overline{G}$  by imposing additional relations, then  $\overline{G}$  is a homomorphic image of  $G$ .

■ **Corollary** Largest Group Satisfying Defining Relations

*If  $K$  is a group satisfying the defining relations of a finite group  $G$  and  $|K| \geq |G|$ , then  $K$  is isomorphic to  $G$ .*

**PROOF** See Exercise 5. ■

■ **EXAMPLE 5 Quaternions** Consider the group  $G = \langle a, b \mid a^2 = b^2 = (ab)^2 \rangle$ . What does  $G$  look like? Formally, of course,  $G$  is isomorphic to  $F/N$ , where  $F$  is free on  $\{a, b\}$  and  $N$  is the smallest normal subgroup of  $F$  containing  $b^{-2}a^2$  and  $(ab)^{-2}a^2$ . Now, let  $H = \langle b \rangle$  and  $S = \{H, aH\}$ . Then, just as in Example 2, it follows that  $S$  is closed under multiplication by  $a$  and  $b$  from the left. So, as in Example 2, we have  $G = H \cup aH$ . Thus, we can determine the elements of  $G$  once we know exactly how many elements there are in  $H$ . (Here again, the three relations come in.) To do this, first observe that  $b^2 = (ab)^2 = abab$  implies  $b = aba$ . Then  $a^2 = b^2 = (aba)(aba) = aba^2ba = ab^4a$  and therefore  $b^4 = e$ . Hence,  $H$  has at most four elements, and therefore  $G$  has at most eight—namely,  $e, b,$

$b^2, b^3, a, ab, ab^2$ , and  $ab^3$ . It is conceivable, however, that not all of these eight elements are distinct. For example,  $Z_2 \oplus Z_2$  satisfies the defining relations and has only four elements. Perhaps it is the largest group satisfying the relations. How can we show that the eight elements listed above are distinct? Well, consider the group  $\overline{G}$  generated by the matrices

$$A = \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ -1 & 0 \end{bmatrix} \quad \text{and} \quad B = \begin{bmatrix} 0 & i \\ i & 0 \end{bmatrix},$$

where  $i = \sqrt{-1}$ . Direct calculations show that in  $\overline{G}$ , the elements  $e, B, B^2, B^3, A, AB, AB^2$ , and  $AB^3$  are distinct and that  $\overline{G}$  satisfies the relations  $A^2 = B^2 = (AB)^2$ . So, it follows from the corollary to Dyck's Theorem that  $\overline{G}$  is isomorphic to  $G$  and therefore  $G$  has order 8. ■

The next example illustrates why, in Examples 2 and 5, it is necessary to show that the eight elements listed for the group are distinct.

■ **EXAMPLE 6** Let

$$G = \langle a, b \mid a^3 = b^9 = e, a^{-1}ba = b^{-1} \rangle.$$

Once again, we let  $H = \langle b \rangle$  and observe that  $G = H \cup aH \cup a^2H$ . Thus,

$$G = \{a^i b^j \mid 0 \leq i \leq 2, 0 \leq j \leq 8\},$$

and therefore  $G$  has at most 27 elements. But this time we will not be able to find some concrete group of order 27 satisfying the same relations that  $G$  does, for notice that  $b^{-1} = a^{-1}ba$  implies

$$b = (a^{-1}ba)^{-1} = a^{-1}b^{-1}a.$$

Hence,

$$\begin{aligned} b &= ebe = a^{-3}ba^3 = a^{-2}(a^{-1}ba)a^2 = a^{-2}b^{-1}a^2 \\ &= a^{-1}(a^{-1}b^{-1}a)a = a^{-1}ba = b^{-1}. \end{aligned}$$

So, the original three relations imply the additional relation  $b^2 = e$ . But  $b^2 = e = b^9$  further implies  $b = e$ . It follows, then, that  $G$  has at most three distinct elements—namely,  $e, a$ , and  $a^2$ . But  $Z_3$  satisfies the defining relations with  $a = 1$  and  $b = 0$ . So,  $|G| = 3$ . ■

We hope Example 6 convinces you of the fact that, once a list of the elements of the group given by a set of generators and relations has been obtained, one must further verify that this list has no duplications. Typically, this is accomplished by exhibiting a specific group that satisfies the given set of generators and relations and that has the same size as the list. Obviously, experience plays a role here.

Here is a fun example adapted from [1].



■ **EXAMPLE 7** Let  $G$  be the group with the 26 letters of the alphabet as generators. For relations we take strings  $A = B$ , where  $A$  and  $B$  are words in some fixed reference, say [2], and have the same pronunciation but different meanings (such words are called homophones). For example,  $buy = by = bye$ ,  $hour = our$ ,  $lead = led$ ,  $whole = hole$ . From these strings and cancellation, we obtain  $u = e = h = a = w = \emptyset$  ( $\emptyset$  is the identity string). With these examples in mind, we ask, What is the group given by these generators and relations? Surprisingly, the answer is the infinite cyclic group generated by  $v$ . To verify this, one must show that every letter except  $v$  is equivalent to  $\emptyset$  and that there are no two homophones that contain a different number of  $v$ 's. The former can easily be done with common words. For example, from  $inn = in$ ,  $plumb = plum$ , and  $knot = not$ , we see that  $n = b = k = \emptyset$ . From  $too = to$  we have  $o = \emptyset$ . That there are no two homophones in [2] that have a different number of  $v$ 's can be verified by simply checking all cases. In contrast, the reference *Handbook of Homophones* by W. C. Townsend (see <http://members.peak.org/~jeremy/dictionaryclassic/chapters/homophones.php>) lists *felt/veldt* as homophones. Of course, including these makes the group trivial. ■

## Classification of Groups of Order Up to 15

The next theorem illustrates the utility of the ideas presented in this chapter.

### ■ Theorem 26.4 Classification of Groups of Order 8 (Cayley, 1859)

*Up to isomorphism, there are only five groups of order 8:  $Z_8$ ,  $Z_4 \oplus Z_2$ ,  $Z_2 \oplus Z_2 \oplus Z_2$ ,  $D_4$ , and the quaternions.*

**PROOF** The Fundamental Theorem of Finite Abelian Groups takes care of the Abelian cases. Now, let  $G$  be a non-Abelian group of order 8. Also, let  $G_1 = \langle a, b \mid a^4 = b^2 = (ab)^2 = e \rangle$  and let  $G_2 = \langle a, b \mid a^2 = b^2 = (ab)^2 \rangle$ . We know from the preceding examples that  $G_1$  is isomorphic to  $D_4$  and  $G_2$  is isomorphic to the quaternions. Thus, it suffices to show that  $G$  must satisfy the defining relations for  $G_1$  or  $G_2$ . It follows from Exercise 47 in Chapter 2 and Lagrange's Theorem that  $G$  has an element of order 4; call it  $a$ . Then, if  $b$  is any element of  $G$  not in  $\langle a \rangle$ , we know that

$$G = \langle a \rangle \cup \langle a \rangle b = \{e, a, a^2, a^3, b, ab, a^2b, a^3b\}.$$

Consider the element  $b^2$  of  $G$ . Which of the eight elements of  $G$  can it be? Not  $b$ ,  $ab$ ,  $a^2b$ , or  $a^3b$ , by cancellation. Not  $a$ , for  $b^2$  commutes with  $b$  and  $a$  does not. Not  $a^3$ , for the same reason. Thus,  $b^2 = e$  or  $b^2 = a^2$ . Suppose  $b^2 = e$ . Since  $\langle a \rangle$  is a normal subgroup of  $G$ , we know that  $bab^{-1} \in \langle a \rangle$ . From this and the fact that  $|bab^{-1}| = |a|$ , we then conclude that  $bab^{-1} = a$  or  $bab^{-1} = a^{-1}$ . The first relation would mean that  $G$  is Abelian, so we know that  $bab^{-1} = a^{-1}$ . But then, since  $b^2 = e$ , we have  $(ab)^2 = e$ , and therefore  $G$  satisfies the defining relations for  $G_1$ .

Finally, if  $b^2 = a^2$  holds instead of  $b^2 = e$ , we can use  $bab^{-1} = a^{-1}$  to conclude that  $(ab)^2 = a(bab^{-1})b^2 = aa^{-1}b^2 = b^2$ , and therefore  $G$  satisfies the defining relations for  $G_2$ . ■

The classification of the groups of order 8, together with our results on groups of order  $p^2$ ,  $2p$ , and  $pq$  from Chapter 24, allows us to classify the groups of order up to 15, with the exception of those of order 12. We already know four groups of order 12—namely,  $Z_{12}$ ,  $Z_6 \oplus Z_2$ ,  $D_6$ , and  $A_4$ . An argument along the lines of Theorem 26.4 can be given to show that there is only one more group of order 12. This group, called the *dicyclic group of order 12* and denoted by  $Q_6$ , has presentation  $\langle a, b \mid a^6 = e, a^3 = b^2, b^{-1}ab = a^{-1} \rangle$ . Table 26.1 lists the groups of order at most 15. We use  $Q_4$  to denote the quaternions (see Example 5 in this chapter).

**Table 26.1** Classification of Groups of Order Up to 15

| Order | Abelian Groups                                   | Non-Abelian Groups |
|-------|--------------------------------------------------|--------------------|
| 1     | $Z_1$                                            |                    |
| 2     | $Z_2$                                            |                    |
| 3     | $Z_3$                                            |                    |
| 4     | $Z_4, Z_2 \oplus Z_2$                            |                    |
| 5     | $Z_5$                                            |                    |
| 6     | $Z_6$                                            | $D_3$              |
| 7     | $Z_7$                                            |                    |
| 8     | $Z_8, Z_4 \oplus Z_2, Z_2 \oplus Z_2 \oplus Z_2$ | $D_4, Q_4$         |
| 9     | $Z_9, Z_3 \oplus Z_3$                            |                    |
| 10    | $Z_{10}$                                         | $D_5$              |
| 11    | $Z_{11}$                                         |                    |
| 12    | $Z_{12}, Z_6 \oplus Z_2$                         | $D_6, A_4, Q_6$    |
| 13    | $Z_{13}$                                         |                    |
| 14    | $Z_{14}$                                         | $D_7$              |
| 15    | $Z_{15}$                                         |                    |

## Characterization of Dihedral Groups

As another nice application of generators and relations, we will now give a characterization of the dihedral groups that has been known for more than 100 years. For  $n \geq 3$ , we have used  $D_n$  to denote the group of symmetries of a regular  $n$ -gon. Imitating Example 2, one can show that  $D_n \approx \langle a, b \mid a^n = b^2 = (ab)^2 = e \rangle$  (see Exercise 9). By analogy, these generators and relations serve to define  $D_1$  and  $D_2$  also. (These are also called dihedral groups.) Finally, we define the infinite dihedral group  $D_\infty$  as  $\langle a, b \mid a^2 = b^2 = e \rangle$ . The elements of  $D_\infty$  can be listed as  $e, a, b, ab, ba, (ab)a, (ba)b, (ab)^2, (ba)^2, (ab)^2a, (ba)^2b, (ab)^3, (ba)^3, \dots$

### ■ Theorem 26.5 Characterization of Dihedral Groups

*Any group generated by a pair of elements of order 2 is dihedral.*

**PROOF** Let  $G$  be a group generated by a pair of distinct elements of order 2, say,  $a$  and  $b$ . We consider the order of  $ab$ . If  $|ab| = \infty$ , then  $G$  is infinite and satisfies the relations of  $D_\infty$ . We will show that  $G$  is isomorphic to  $D_\infty$ . By Dyck's Theorem,  $G$  is isomorphic to some factor group of  $D_\infty$ , say,  $D_\infty/H$ . Now, suppose  $h \in H$  and  $h \neq e$ . Since every element of  $D_\infty$  has one of the forms  $(ab)^i, (ba)^i, (ab)^ia$ , or  $(ba)^ib$ , by symmetry, we may assume that  $h = (ab)^i$  or  $h = (ab)^ia$ . If  $h = (ab)^i$ , we will show that  $D_\infty/H$  satisfies the relations for  $D_i$  given in Exercise 9. Since  $(ab)^i$  is in  $H$ , we have

$$H = (ab)^iH = (abH)^i,$$

so that  $(abH)^{-1} = (abH)^{i-1}$ . But

$$(ab)^{-1}H = b^{-1}a^{-1}H = baH,$$

and it follows that

$$aHabHaH = a^2HbHaH = eHbaH = baH = (abH)^{-1}.$$

Thus,

$$D_\infty/H = \langle aH, bH \rangle = \langle aH, abH \rangle$$

(see Exercise 7), and  $D_\infty/H$  satisfies the defining relations for  $D_i$  (use Exercise 9 with  $x = aH$  and  $y = abH$ ). In particular,  $G$  is finite—an impossibility.

If  $h = (ab)^ia$ , then

$$H = (ab)^iaH = (ab)^iHaH,$$

and therefore

$$(abH)^i = (ab)^iH = (aH)^{-1} = a^{-1}H = aH.$$

It follows that

$$\langle aH, bH \rangle = \langle aH, abH \rangle \subseteq \langle abH \rangle.$$

However,

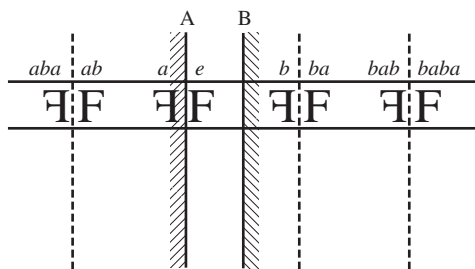
$$(abH)^{2i} = (aH)^2 = a^2H = H,$$

so that  $D_\infty/H$  is again finite. This contradiction forces  $H = \{e\}$  and  $G$  to be isomorphic to  $D_\infty$ .

Finally, suppose that  $|ab| = n$ . Since  $G = \langle a, b \rangle = \langle a, ab \rangle$ , we can show that  $G$  is isomorphic to  $D_n$  by proving that  $b(ab)b = (ab)^{-1}$ , which is the same as  $ba = (ab)^{-1}$  (see Exercise 9). But  $(ab)^{-1} = b^{-1}a^{-1} = ba$ , since  $a$  and  $b$  have order 2. ■

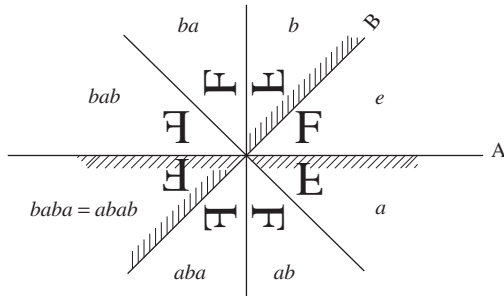
## Realizing the Dihedral Groups with Mirrors

A geometric realization of  $D_\infty$  can be obtained by placing two mirrors facing each other in a parallel position, as shown in Figure 26.1. If we let  $a$  and  $b$  denote reflections in mirrors  $A$  and  $B$ , respectively, then  $ab$ , viewed as the composition of  $a$  and  $b$ , represents a translation through twice the distance between the two mirrors to the left, and  $ba$  is the translation through the same distance to the right.



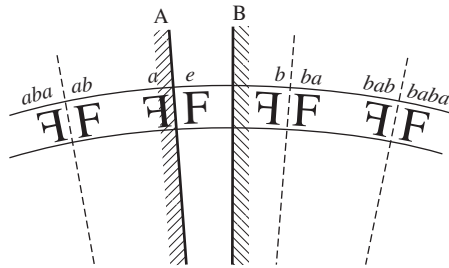
**Figure 26.1** The group  $D_\infty$ —reflections in parallel mirrors

The finite dihedral groups can also be realized with a pair of mirrors. For example, if we place a pair of mirrors facing each other at a  $45^\circ$  angle, we obtain the group  $D_4$ . Notice that in Figure 26.2, the effect of reflecting an object in mirror  $A$ , then mirror  $B$ , is a rotation of twice the angle between the two mirrors (that is,  $90^\circ$ ).



**Figure 26.2** The group  $D_4$ —reflections in mirrors at a  $45^\circ$  angle

In Figure 26.3, we see a portion of the pattern produced by reflections in a pair of mirrors set at a  $1^\circ$  angle. The corresponding group is  $D_{180}$ . In general, reflections in a pair of mirrors set at the angle  $180^\circ/n$  correspond to the group  $D_n$ . As  $n$  becomes larger and larger, the mirrors approach a parallel position. In the limiting case, we have the group  $D_\infty$ .



**Figure 26.3** The group  $D_{180}$ —reflections in mirrors at a  $1^\circ$  angle

We conclude this chapter by commenting on the advantages and disadvantages of using generators and relations to define groups. The principal advantage is that in many situations—particularly in knot theory, algebraic topology, and geometry—groups defined by way of generators and relations arise in a natural way. Within group theory itself, it is often convenient to construct examples and counterexamples with generators and relations. Among the disadvantages of defining a group by generators and relations is the fact that it is often difficult to decide whether or not the group is finite, or even whether or not a particular element is the identity. Furthermore, the same group can be defined with entirely different sets of generators and relations, and, given two groups defined by generators and relations, it is often extremely difficult to decide whether or not these two groups are isomorphic. Nowadays, these questions are frequently tackled with the aid of a computer.

## Exercises

It don't come easy.

Ringo Starr, "It Don't Come Easy," single

1. Let  $S$  be a set of distinct symbols. Show that the relation defined on  $W(S)$  in this chapter is an equivalence relation.
2. Let  $n$  be an even integer. Prove that  $D_n/Z(D_n)$  is isomorphic to  $D_{n/2}$ .
3. Verify that the set  $K$  in Example 2 is closed under multiplication on the left by  $b$ .
4. Show that  $\langle a, b \mid a^5 = b^2 = e, ba = a^2b \rangle$  is isomorphic to  $Z_2$ .
5. Prove Theorem 26.3 and its corollary.
6. Let  $G$  be the group  $\{\pm 1, \pm i, \pm j, \pm k\}$  with multiplication defined as in Exercise 54 in Chapter 9. Show that  $G$  is isomorphic to  $\langle a, b \mid a^2 = b^2 = (ab)^2 \rangle$ . (Hence, the name "quaternions.")
7. In any group, show that  $\langle a, b \rangle = \langle a, ab \rangle$ . (This exercise is referred to in the proof of Theorem 26.5.)
8. Let  $\alpha = (12)(34)$  and  $\beta = (24)$ . Show that the group generated by  $\alpha$  and  $\beta$  is isomorphic to  $D_4$ .
9. Prove that  $G = \langle x, y \mid x^2 = y^n = e, xyx = y^{-1} \rangle$  is isomorphic to  $D_n$ . (This exercise is referred to in the proof of Theorem 26.5.)
10. What is the minimum number of generators needed for  $Z_2 \oplus Z_2 \oplus Z_2$ ? Find a set of generators and relations for this group.
11. Suppose that  $x^2 = y^2 = e$  and  $yz = zxy$ . Show that  $xy = yx$ .
12. Let  $G = \langle a, b \mid a^2 = b^4 = e, ab = b^3a \rangle$ .
  - a. Express  $a^3b^2abab^3$  in the form  $b^i a^j$ , where  $0 \leq i \leq 1$  and  $0 \leq j \leq 3$ .
  - b. Express  $b^3abab^3a$  in the form  $b^i a^j$ , where  $0 \leq i \leq 1$  and  $0 \leq j \leq 3$ .
13. Let  $G = \langle a, b \mid a^2 = b^2 = (ab)^2 \rangle$ .
  - a. Express  $b^2abab^3$  in the form  $b^i a^j$ .
  - b. Express  $b^3abab^3a$  in the form  $b^i a^j$ .
14. Let  $G$  be the group defined by the following table. Show that  $G$  is isomorphic to  $D_n$ .

|    | 1  | 2      | 3      | 4      | 5      | 6      | ... | 2n |
|----|----|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|-----|----|
| 1  | 1  | 2      | 3      | 4      | 5      | 6      | ... | 2n |
| 2  | 2  | 1      | 2n     | 2n - 1 | 2n - 2 | 2n - 3 | ... | 3  |
| 3  | 3  | 4      | 5      | 6      | 7      | 8      | ... | 2  |
| 4  | 4  | 3      | 2      | 1      | 2n     | 2n - 1 | ... | 5  |
| 5  | 5  | 6      | 7      | 8      | 9      | 10     | ... | 4  |
| 6  | 6  | 5      | 4      | 3      | 2      | 1      | ... | 7  |
| ⋮  | ⋮  | ⋮      | ⋮      | ⋮      | ⋮      | ⋮      | ⋮   | ⋮  |
| 2n | 2n | 2n - 1 | 2n - 2 | 2n - 3 | 2n - 4 | 2n - 5 | ... | 1  |

15. Let  $G = \langle x, y \mid x = (xy)^3, y = (xy)^4 \rangle$ . To what familiar group is  $G$  isomorphic?
16. Let  $G = \langle z \mid z^6 = 1 \rangle$  and  $H = \langle x, y \mid x^2 = y^3 = 1, xy = yx \rangle$ . Show that  $G$  and  $H$  are isomorphic.
17. Let  $G = \langle x, y \mid x^8 = y^2 = e, yxyx^3 = e \rangle$ . Show that  $|G| \leq 16$ . Assuming that  $|G| = 16$ , find the center of  $G$  and the order of  $xy$ .
18. Confirm the classification given in Table 26.1 of all groups of orders 1 to 11.
19. Let  $G$  be defined by some set of generators and relations. Show that every factor group of  $G$  satisfies the relations defining  $G$ .
20. Let  $G = \langle s, t \mid sts = tst \rangle$ . Show that the permutations (23) and (13) satisfy the defining relations of  $G$ . Explain why this proves that  $G$  is non-Abelian.
21. In  $D_{12} = \langle x, y \mid x^2 = y^{12} = e, xyx = y^{-1} \rangle$ , prove that the subgroup  $H = \langle x, y^3 \rangle$  (which is isomorphic to  $D_4$ ) is not a normal subgroup.
22. Let  $G = \langle x, y \mid x^{2n} = e, x^n = y^2, y^{-1}xy = x^{-1} \rangle$ . Show that  $Z(G) = \{e, x^n\}$ . Assuming that  $|G| = 4n$ , show that  $G/Z(G)$  is isomorphic to  $D_n$ . (The group  $G$  is called the *dicyclic* group of order  $4n$ .)
23. Let  $G = \langle a, b \mid a^6 = b^3 = e, b^{-1}ab = a^3 \rangle$ . How many elements does  $G$  have? To what familiar group is  $G$  isomorphic?
24. Let  $G = \langle x, y \mid x^4 = y^4 = e, xyxy^{-1} = e \rangle$ . Show that  $|G| \leq 16$ . Assuming that  $|G| = 16$ , find the center of  $G$  and show that  $G/\langle y^2 \rangle$  is isomorphic to  $D_4$ .
25. Determine the orders of the elements of  $D_\infty$ .
26. Let  $G = \left\{ \begin{bmatrix} 1 & a & b \\ 0 & 1 & c \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \mid a, b, c \in \mathbb{Z}_2 \right\}$ . Prove that  $G$  is isomorphic to  $D_4$ .
27. Let  $G = \langle a, b, c, d \mid ab = c, bc = d, cd = a, da = b \rangle$ . Determine  $|G|$ .
28. Let  $G = \langle a, b \mid a^2 = e, b^2 = e, aba = bab \rangle$ . To what familiar group is  $G$  isomorphic?
29. Let  $G = \langle a, b \mid a^3 = e, b^2 = e, aba^{-1}b^{-1} = e \rangle$ . To what familiar group is  $G$  isomorphic?
30. Give an example of a non-Abelian group that has exactly three elements of finite order.
31. Referring to Example 7 in this chapter, show as many letters as you can that are equivalent to  $\emptyset$ .
32. Suppose that a group of order 8 has exactly five elements of order 2. Identify the group.

## References

1. J.-F. Mestre, R. Schoof, L. Washington, D. Zagier, “Quotient homophones des groupes libres [Homophonic Quotients of Free Groups],” *Experimental Mathematics* 2 (1993): 153–155.
2. H. C. Whitford, *A Dictionary of American Homophones and Homographs*, New York: Teachers College Press, 1966.

## Suggested Readings

Alexander H. Frey, Jr., and David Singmaster, *Handbook of Cubik Math*, Hillside, N.J.: Enslow, 1982.

This book is replete with the group theoretic aspects of the Magic Cube. It uses permutation group theory and generators and relations to discuss the solutions to the cube and related results. The book has numerous challenging exercises stated in group theoretic terms.

Lee Neuwirth, “The Theory of Knots,” *Scientific American* 240 (1979): 110–124.

This article shows how a group can be associated with a knotted string. Mathematically, a knot is just a one-dimensional curve situated in three-dimensional space. The theory of knots—a branch of topology—seeks to classify and analyze the different ways of embedding such a curve. Around the beginning of the 20th century, Henri Poincaré observed that important geometric characteristics of knots could be described in terms of group generators and relations—the so-called knot group. Among other knots, Neuwirth describes the construction of the knot group for the trefoil knot pictured. One set of generators and relations for this group is  $\langle x, y, z \mid xy = yz, zx = yz \rangle$ .



The trefoil knot

David Peifer, “An Introduction to Combinatorial Group Theory and the Word Problem,” *Mathematics Magazine* 70 (1997): 3–10.

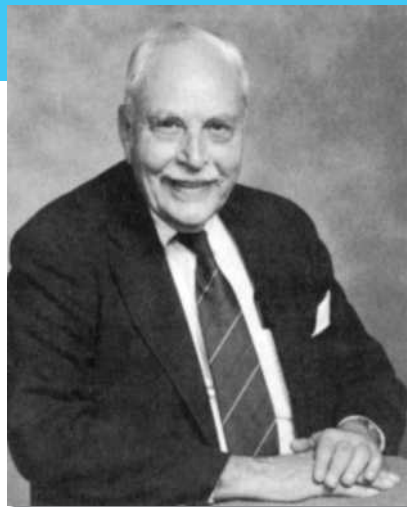
This article discusses some fundamental ideas and problems regarding groups given by presentations.



## Marshall Hall, Jr.

Professor Hall was a mathematician in the broadest sense of the word but with a predilection for group theory, geometry and combinatorics.

HANS ZASSENHAUS, *Notices of the American Mathematical Society*



Courtesy of Johnathan Hall

MARSHALL HALL, JR., was born on September 17, 1910, in St. Louis, Missouri. He demonstrated interest in mathematics at the age of 11 when he constructed a seven-place table of logarithms for the positive integers up to 1000. He completed a B.A. degree in 1932 at Yale. After spending a year at Cambridge University, where he worked with Philip Hall, Harold Davenport, and G. H. Hardy, he returned to Yale for his Ph.D. degree. At the outbreak of World War II, he joined Naval Intelligence and had significant success in deciphering both the Japanese codes and the German Enigma messages. These successes helped to turn the tide of the war. After the war, Hall had faculty appointments at the Ohio State University, Caltech, and Emory University. He died on July 4, 1990.

Hall's highly regarded books on group theory and combinatorial theory are classics. His mathematical legacy includes more than

120 research papers on group theory, coding theory, and design theory. His 1943 paper on projective planes ranks among the most cited papers in mathematics. Several fundamental concepts as well as a sporadic simple group are identified with Hall's name. One of Hall's most celebrated results is his solution to the "Burnside Problem" for exponent 6—that is, his proof that a finitely generated group in which the order of every element divides 6 must be finite. Hall influenced both John Thompson and Michael Aschbacher, two of finite group theory's greatest contributors. It was Hall who suggested Thompson's Ph.D. dissertation problem. Hall's Ph.D. students at Caltech included Donald Knuth and Robert McEliece.

To find more information about Hall, visit:

<http://www-groups.dcs.st-and.ac.uk/~history/>

# 27 Symmetry Groups

Physicists have exalted symmetry to the position of *the* central concept in their attempts to organize and explain an otherwise bewildering and complex universe.

Mario Livio, *The Equation That Could Not Be Solved*

I'm not good at math, but I do know that the universe is formed with mathematical principles whether I understand them or not, and I am going to let that guide me.

Bob Dylan, *Chronicles, Volume One*

## Isometries

In the early chapters of this book, we briefly discussed symmetry groups. In this chapter and the next, we examine this fundamentally important concept in some detail. It is convenient to begin such a discussion with the definition of an isometry (from the Greek *isometros*, meaning “equal measure”) in  $\mathbf{R}^n$ .

### Definition Isometry

An *isometry* of  $n$ -dimensional space  $\mathbf{R}^n$  is a function from  $\mathbf{R}^n$  onto  $\mathbf{R}^n$  that preserves distance.

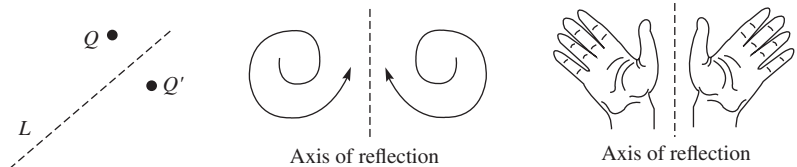
In other words, a function  $T$  from  $\mathbf{R}^n$  onto  $\mathbf{R}^n$  is an isometry if, for every pair of points  $p$  and  $q$  in  $\mathbf{R}^n$ , the distance from  $T(p)$  to  $T(q)$  is the same as the distance from  $p$  to  $q$ . With this definition, we may now make precise the definition of the symmetry group of an  $n$ -dimensional figure.

### Definition Symmetry Group of a Figure in $\mathbf{R}^n$

Let  $F$  be a set of points in  $\mathbf{R}^n$ . The *symmetry group* of  $F$  in  $\mathbf{R}^n$  is the set of all isometries of  $\mathbf{R}^n$  that carry  $F$  onto itself. The group operation is function composition.

It is important to realize that the symmetry group of an object depends not only on the object, but also on the space in which we view it. For example, the symmetry group of a line segment in  $\mathbf{R}^1$  has order 2, the symmetry group of a line segment considered as a set of points in  $\mathbf{R}^2$  has order 4, and the symmetry group of a line segment viewed as a set of points in  $\mathbf{R}^3$  has infinite order (see Exercise 9).

Although we have formulated our definitions for all finite dimensions, our chief interest will be the two-dimensional case. It has been known since 1831 that every isometry of  $\mathbf{R}^2$  is one of four types: rotation, reflection, translation, and glide-reflection (see [1, p. 46]). Rotation about a point in a plane needs no explanation. A *reflection across a line  $L$*  is that transformation that leaves every point of  $L$  fixed and takes every point  $Q$ , not on  $L$ , to the point  $Q'$  so that  $L$  is the perpendicular bisector of the line segment from  $Q$  to  $Q'$  (see Figure 27.1). The line  $L$  is called the *axis of reflection*. In an  $xy$ -coordinate plane, the transformation  $(x, y) \rightarrow (x, -y)$  is a reflection across the  $x$ -axis, whereas  $(x, y) \rightarrow (y, x)$  is a reflection across the line  $y = x$ . Some authors call an axis of reflective symmetry  $L$  a *mirror* because  $L$  acts like a two-sided mirror; that is, the image of a point  $Q$  in a mirror placed on the line  $L$  is, in fact, the image of  $Q$  under the reflection across the line  $L$ . Reflections are called *opposite* isometries because they reverse orientation. For example, the reflected image of a clockwise spiral is a counterclockwise spiral. Similarly, the reflected image of a right hand is a left hand. (See Figure 27.1.)



**Figure 27.1** Reflected images

A *translation* is simply a function that carries all points the same distance in the same direction. For example, if  $p$  and  $q$  are points in a plane and  $T$  is a translation, then the two directed line segments joining  $p$  to  $T(p)$  and  $q$  to  $T(q)$  have the same length and direction. A *glide-reflection* is the product of a translation and a reflection across the line containing the translation line segment. This line is called the *glide-axis*. In Figure 27.2, the arrow gives the direction and length of the translation, and is contained in the axis of reflection. A glide-reflection is also an opposite isometry. Successive footprints in wet sand are related by a glide-reflection.

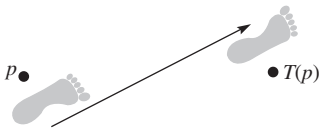
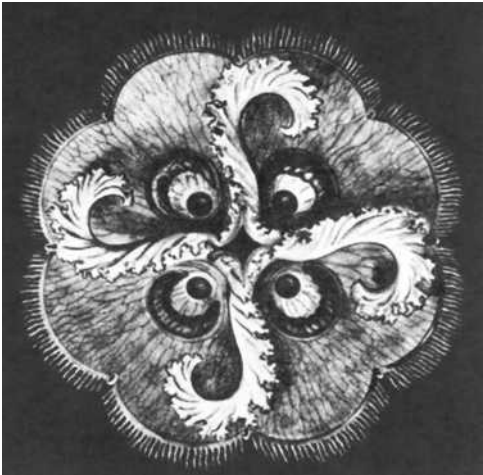


Figure 27.2 Glide-reflection

### Classification of Finite Plane Symmetry Groups

Our first goal in this chapter is to classify all finite plane symmetry groups. As we have seen in earlier chapters, the dihedral group  $D_n$  is the plane symmetry group of a regular  $n$ -gon. (For convenience, call  $D_2$  the plane symmetry group of a nonsquare rectangle and  $D_1$  the plane symmetry group of the letter “V.” In particular,  $D_2 \approx Z_2 \oplus Z_2$  and  $D_1 \approx Z_2$ .) The cyclic groups  $Z_n$  are easily seen to be plane symmetry groups also. Figure 27.3 is an illustration of an organism whose plane symmetry group consists of four rotations and is isomorphic to  $Z_4$ . The surprising fact is that the cyclic groups and dihedral groups are the only finite plane symmetry groups. The famous mathematician Hermann Weyl attributes the following theorem to Leonardo da Vinci (1452–1519).



From *Symmetry in Science and Art* by A.V. Shubnikov and V.A. Kopstik, Copyright 1974 Plenum Publishing Co.

Figure 27.3 *Aurelia insulinda*, an organism whose plane symmetry group is  $Z_4$

■ **Theorem 27.1**    Finite Symmetry Groups in the Plane

*The only finite plane symmetry groups are  $Z_n$  and  $D_n$ .*

**PROOF** Let  $G$  be a finite plane symmetry group of some figure. We first observe that  $G$  cannot contain a translation or a glide-reflection, because in either case  $G$  would be infinite. Now observing that the composition of two reflections preserves orientation, we know that such a composition is a translation or rotation. When the two reflections have parallel axes of reflection, there is no fixed point so the composition is a translation. Thus, every two reflections in  $G$  have reflection axes that intersect in some point. We claim that all reflections intersect in the same point. Suppose that  $f$  and  $f'$  are two distinct reflections in  $G$ . Then because  $ff'$  preserves orientation, we know that  $ff'$  is a rotation. We use the fact from geometry [2, p. 366] that a finite group of rotations must have a common center, say  $P$ . This means that any two reflections must intersect at point  $P$ . So, we have shown that all the elements of  $G$  have the common fixed point  $P$ .

For convenience, let us denote a rotation about  $P$  of  $\sigma$  degrees by  $R_\sigma$ . Now, among all rotations in  $G$ , let  $\beta$  be the smallest positive angle of rotation. (Such an angle exists, since  $G$  is finite and  $R_{360}$  belongs to  $G$ .) We claim that every rotation in  $G$  is some power of  $R_\beta$ . To see this, suppose that  $R_\sigma$  is in  $G$ . We may assume  $0^\circ < \sigma \leq 360^\circ$ . Then,  $\beta \leq \sigma$  and there is some integer  $t$  such that  $t\beta \leq \sigma < (t+1)\beta$ . But, then  $R_{\sigma-t\beta} = R_\sigma(R_\beta)^{-t}$  is in  $G$  and  $0 \leq \sigma - t\beta < \beta$ . Since  $\beta$  represents the smallest positive angle of rotation among the elements of  $G$ , we must have  $\sigma - t\beta = 0$ , and therefore,  $R_\sigma = (R_\beta)^t$ . This verifies the claim.

For convenience, let us say that  $|R_\beta| = n$ . Now, if  $G$  has no reflections, we have proved that  $G = \langle R_\beta \rangle \approx Z_n$ . If  $G$  has at least one reflection, say  $f$ , then

$$f, fR_\beta, f(R_\beta)^2, \dots, f(R_\beta)^{n-1}$$

are also reflections. Furthermore, this is the entire set of reflections of  $G$ . For if  $g$  is any reflection in  $G$ , then  $fg$  is a rotation, and so  $fg = (R_\beta)^k$  for some  $k$ . Thus,  $g = f^{-1}(R_\beta)^k = f(R_\beta)^k$ . So

$$G = \{R_0, R_\beta, (R_\beta)^2, \dots, (R_\beta)^{n-1}, f, fR_\beta, f(R_\beta)^2, \dots, f(R_\beta)^{n-1}\},$$

and  $G$  is generated by the pair of reflections  $f$  and  $fR_\beta$ . Hence, by our characterization of the dihedral groups (Theorem 26.5),  $G$  is the dihedral group  $D_n$ . ■

## Classification of Finite Groups of Rotations in $\mathbb{R}^3$

One might think that the set of all possible finite symmetry groups in three dimensions would be much more diverse than is the case for two dimensions. Surprisingly, this is not the case. For example, moving to

three dimensions introduces only three new groups of rotations. This observation was first made by the physicist and mineralogist Auguste Bravais in 1849, in his study of possible structures of crystals.

### ■ Theorem 27.2 Finite Groups of Rotations in $\mathbb{R}^3$

*Up to isomorphism, the finite groups of rotations in  $\mathbb{R}^3$  are  $Z_n$ ,  $D_n$ ,  $A_4$ ,  $S_4$ , and  $A_5$ .*

Theorem 27.2, together with the Orbit-Stabilizer Theorem (Theorem 7.3), makes easy work of determining the group of rotations of an object in  $\mathbb{R}^3$ .

■ **EXAMPLE 1** We determine the group  $G$  of rotations of the solid in Figure 27.4, which is composed of six congruent squares and eight congruent equilateral triangles. We begin by singling out any one of the squares. Obviously, there are four rotations that map this square to itself, and the designated square can be rotated to the location of any of the other five. So, by the Orbit-Stabilizer Theorem (Theorem 7.4), the rotation group has order  $4 \cdot 6 = 24$ . By Theorem 27.2,  $G$  is one of  $Z_{24}$ ,  $D_{12}$ , and  $S_4$ . But each of the first two groups has exactly two elements of order 4, whereas  $G$  has more than two. So,  $G$  is isomorphic to  $S_4$ . ■

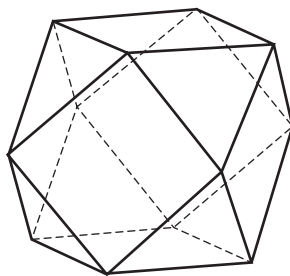
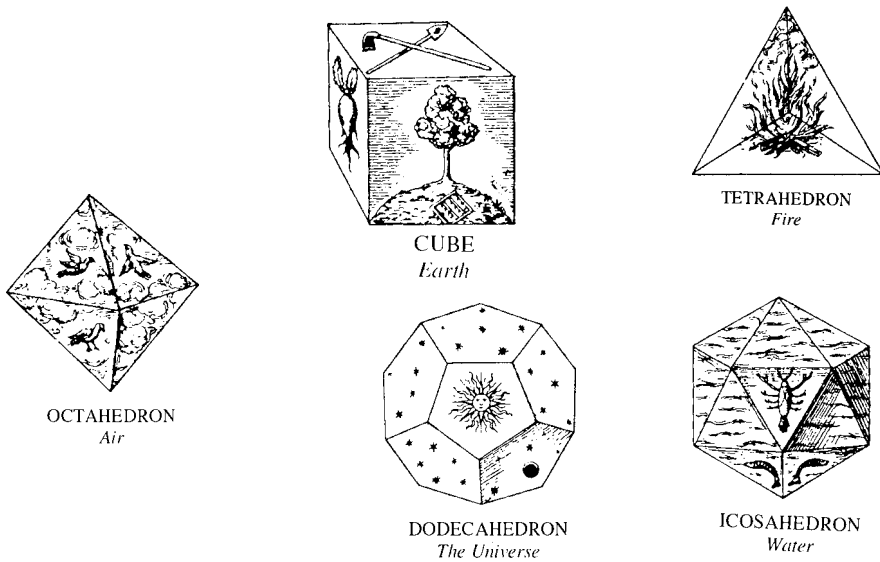


Figure 27.4

The group of rotations of a tetrahedron (the *tetrahedral group*) is isomorphic to  $A_4$ ; the group of rotations of a cube or an octahedron (the *octahedral group*) is isomorphic to  $S_4$ ; the group of rotations of a dodecahedron or an icosahedron (the *icosahedral group*) is isomorphic to  $A_5$ . (Coxeter [1, pp. 271–273] specifies which portions of the polyhedra are being permuted in each case.) These five solids are illustrated in Figure 27.5.



**Figure 27.5** The five regular solids as depicted by Johannes Kepler in *Harmonices Mundi*, Book II (1619)

## Exercises

Perhaps the most valuable result of all education is the ability to make yourself do the thing you have to do, when it ought to be done, whether you like it or not.

Thomas Henry Huxley, “Technical Education”

1. Show that an isometry of  $\mathbf{R}^n$  is one-to-one.
2. Show that the translations of  $\mathbf{R}^n$  form a group.
3. Exhibit a plane figure whose plane symmetry group is  $Z_5$ .
4. Show that the group of rotations in  $\mathbf{R}^3$  of a 3-prism (that is, a prism with equilateral ends, as in the following figure) is isomorphic to  $D_3$ .



5. What is the order of the (entire) symmetry group in  $\mathbf{R}^3$  of a 3-prism?
6. What is the order of the symmetry group in  $\mathbf{R}^3$  of a 4-prism (a box with square ends that is not a cube)?
7. What is the order of the symmetry group in  $\mathbf{R}^3$  of an  $n$ -prism?

8. Show that the symmetry group in  $\mathbf{R}^3$  of a box of dimensions  $2'' \times 3'' \times 4''$  is isomorphic to  $Z_2 \oplus Z_2 \oplus Z_2$ .
  9. Describe the symmetry group of a line segment viewed as
    - a. a subset of  $\mathbf{R}^1$ .
    - b. a subset of  $\mathbf{R}^2$ .
    - c. a subset of  $\mathbf{R}^3$ .
- (This exercise is referred to in this chapter.)
10. (From the “Ask Marilyn” column in *Parade Magazine*, December 11, 1994.)\* The letters of the alphabet can be sorted into the following categories:
    1. FGJLNPQRSZ
    2. BCDEK
    3. AMTUVWY
    4. HIOX

What defines the categories?

11. Exactly how many elements of order 4 does the group in Example 1 have?
12. Why is inversion [that is,  $\phi(x, y) = (-x, -y)$ ] not listed as one of the four kinds of isometries in  $\mathbf{R}^2$ ?
13. Explain why inversion through a point in  $\mathbf{R}^3$  cannot be realized by a rotation in  $\mathbf{R}^3$ .
14. Reflection across a line  $L$  in  $\mathbf{R}^3$  is the isometry that takes each point  $Q$  to the point  $Q'$  with the property that  $L$  is a perpendicular bisector of the line segment joining  $Q$  and  $Q'$ . Describe a rotation that has this same effect.
15. In  $\mathbf{R}^2$ , a rotation fixes a point; in  $\mathbf{R}^3$ , a rotation fixes a line. In  $\mathbf{R}^4$ , what does a rotation fix? Generalize these observations to  $\mathbf{R}^n$ .
16. Show that an isometry of a plane preserves angles.
17. Show that an isometry of a plane is completely determined by the image of three noncollinear points.
18. Suppose that an isometry of a plane leaves three noncollinear points fixed. Which isometry is it?
19. Suppose that an isometry of a plane fixes exactly one point. What type of isometry must it be?
20. Suppose that  $A$  and  $B$  are rotations of  $180^\circ$  about the points  $a$  and  $b$ , respectively. What is  $A$  followed by  $B$ ? How is the composite motion related to the points  $a$  and  $b$ ?

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## References

1. H. S. M. Coxeter, *Introduction to Geometry*, 2nd ed., New York: Wiley, 1969.
2. Marvin Jay Greenberg, *Euclidean and Non-Euclidean Geometries: Development and History*, 3rd ed., New York: W. H. Freeman, 1993.

## Suggested Readings<sup>†</sup>

Lorraine Foster, “On the Symmetry Group of the Dodecahedron,” *Mathematics Magazine* 63 (1990): 106–107.

It is shown that the group of rotations of a dodecahedron and the group of rotations of an icosahedron are both  $A_5$ .

Andrew Watson, “The Mathematics of Symmetry,” *New Scientist* (October 1990): 45–50.

This article discusses how chemists use group theory to understand molecular structure and how physicists use it to study the fundamental forces and particles.

## Suggested Website

**<http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Symmetry>**

This website has a wealth of material about symmetry. Included are essays, photos, links, and references.

<sup>†</sup>See also the Suggested Readings for Chapter 1.

# 28 Frieze Groups and Crystallographic Groups

Symmetry and group theory have an uncanny way of directing physicists to the right path.

Mario Livio, *The Equation That Could Not Be Solved*

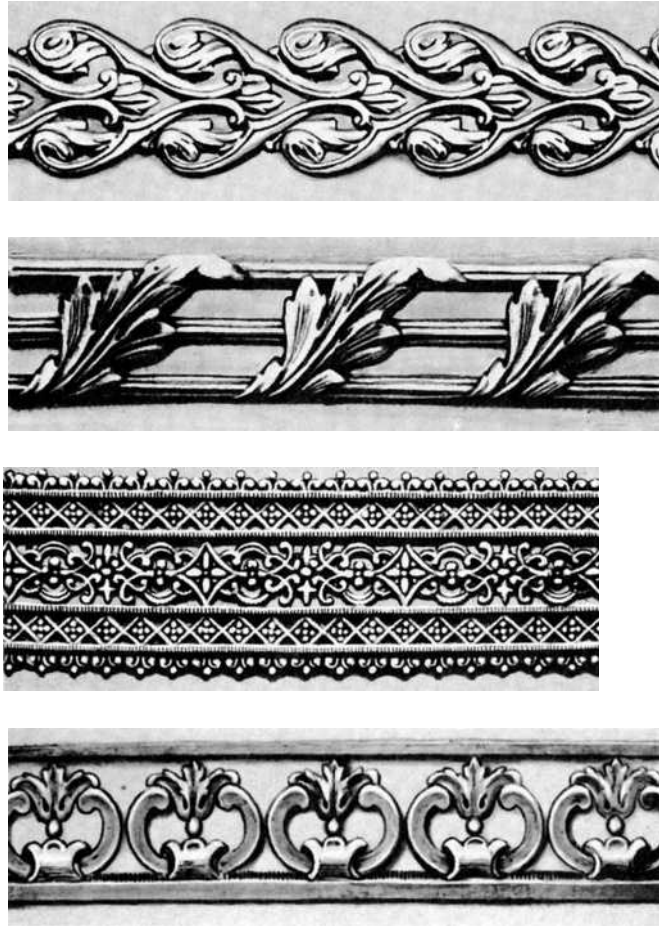
Group theory is the bread and butter of crystallography.

Mario Livio, *The Equation That Could Not Be Solved*

## The Frieze Groups

In this chapter, we discuss an interesting collection of infinite symmetry groups that arise from periodic designs in a plane. There are two types of such groups. The *discrete frieze groups* are the plane symmetry groups of patterns whose subgroups of translations are isomorphic to  $\mathbb{Z}$ . These kinds of designs are the ones used for decorative strips and for patterns on jewelry, as illustrated in Figure 28.1. In mathematics, familiar examples include the graphs of  $y = \sin x$ ,  $y = \tan x$ ,  $y = |\sin x|$ , and  $|y| = \sin x$ . After we analyze the discrete frieze groups, we examine the discrete symmetry groups of plane patterns whose subgroups of translations are isomorphic to  $\mathbb{Z} \oplus \mathbb{Z}$ .

In previous chapters, it was our custom to view two isomorphic groups as the same group, since we could not distinguish between them algebraically. In the case of the frieze groups, we will soon see that, although some of them are isomorphic as groups (that is, algebraically the same), geometrically they are quite different. To emphasize this difference, we will treat them separately. In each of the following cases, the given pattern extends infinitely far in both directions. A proof that there are exactly seven types of frieze patterns is given in the appendix to [6].



*Symmetry in Science and Art* by A. V. Shubnikov & V.A. Kupstik © 1974 Plenum Publishing Company

**Figure 28.1** Frieze patterns

The symmetry group of pattern I (Figure 28.2) consists of translations only. Letting  $x$  denote a translation to the right of one unit (that is, the distance between two consecutive R's), we may write the symmetry group of pattern I as

$$F_1 = \{x^n \mid n \in \mathbb{Z}\}.$$



**Figure 28.2** Pattern I

The group for pattern II (Figure 28.3), like that of pattern I, is infinitely cyclic. Letting  $x$  denote a glide-reflection, we may write the symmetry group of pattern II as

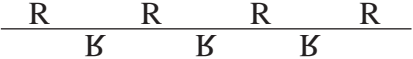
$$F_2 = \{x^n \mid n \in \mathbb{Z}\}.$$


Figure 28.3 Pattern II

Notice that the translation subgroup of pattern II is just  $\langle x^2 \rangle$ . The symmetry group for pattern III (Figure 28.4) is generated by a translation  $x$  and a reflection  $y$  across the dashed vertical line. (There are infinitely many axes of reflective symmetry, including those midway between consecutive pairs of opposite-facing R's. Any one will do.) The entire group (the operation is function composition) is

$$F_3 = \{x^n y^m \mid n \in \mathbb{Z}, m = 0 \text{ or } 1\}.$$


Figure 28.4 Pattern III

Note that the two elements  $xy$  and  $y$  have order 2, they generate  $F_3$ , and their product  $(xy)y = x$  has infinite order. Thus, by Theorem 26.5,  $F_3$  is the infinite dihedral group. A geometric fact about pattern III worth mentioning is that the distance between consecutive pairs of vertical reflection axes is half the length of the smallest translation vector.

In pattern IV (Figure 28.5), the symmetry group  $F_4$  is generated by a translation  $x$  and a rotation  $y$  of  $180^\circ$  about a point  $p$  midway between consecutive R's (such a rotation is often called a *half-turn*). This group, like  $F_3$ , is also infinite dihedral. (Another rotation point lies between a top and bottom R. As in pattern III, the distance between consecutive points of rotational symmetry is half the length of the smallest translation vector.) Therefore,

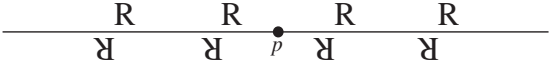
$$F_4 = \{x^n y^m \mid n \in \mathbb{Z}, m = 0 \text{ or } m = 1\}.$$


Figure 28.5 Pattern IV

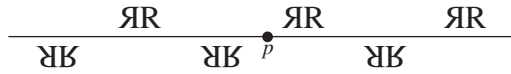


Figure 28.6 Pattern V

The symmetry group  $F_5$  for pattern V (Figure 28.6) is yet another infinite dihedral group generated by a glide-reflection  $x$  and a rotation  $y$  of  $180^\circ$  about the point  $p$ . Notice that pattern V has vertical reflection symmetry  $xy$ . The rotation points are midway between the vertical reflection axes. Thus,

$$F_5 = \{x^n y^m \mid n \in \mathbb{Z}, m = 0 \text{ or } m = 1\}.$$

The symmetry group  $F_6$  for pattern VI (Figure 28.7) is generated by a translation  $x$  and a horizontal reflection  $y$ . The group is

$$F_6 = \{x^n y^m \mid n \in \mathbb{Z}, m = 0 \text{ or } m = 1\}.$$

Note that, since  $x$  and  $y$  commute,  $F_6$  is not infinite dihedral. In fact,  $F_6$  is isomorphic to  $\mathbb{Z} \oplus \mathbb{Z}_2$ . Pattern VI is invariant under a glide-reflection also, but in this case the glide-reflection is called *trivial*, since the axis of the glide-reflection is also an axis of reflection. (Conversely, a glide-reflection is *nontrivial* if its glide-axis is not an axis of reflective symmetry for the pattern.)

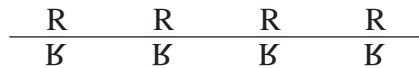


Figure 28.7 Pattern VI

The symmetry group  $F_7$  of pattern VII (Figure 28.8) is generated by a translation  $x$ , a horizontal reflection  $y$ , and a vertical reflection  $z$ . It is isomorphic to the direct product of the infinite dihedral group and  $\mathbb{Z}_2$ . The product of  $y$  and  $z$  is a  $180^\circ$  rotation. Therefore,

$$F_7 = \{x^n y^m z^k \mid n \in \mathbb{Z}, m = 0 \text{ or } m = 1, k = 0 \text{ or } k = 1\}.$$

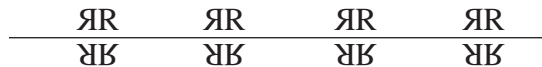


Figure 28.8 Pattern VII

The preceding discussion is summarized in Figure 28.9. Figure 28.10 provides an identification algorithm for the frieze patterns.

In describing the seven frieze groups, we have not explicitly said how multiplication is done algebraically. However, each group element corresponds to some isometry, so multiplication is the same as function

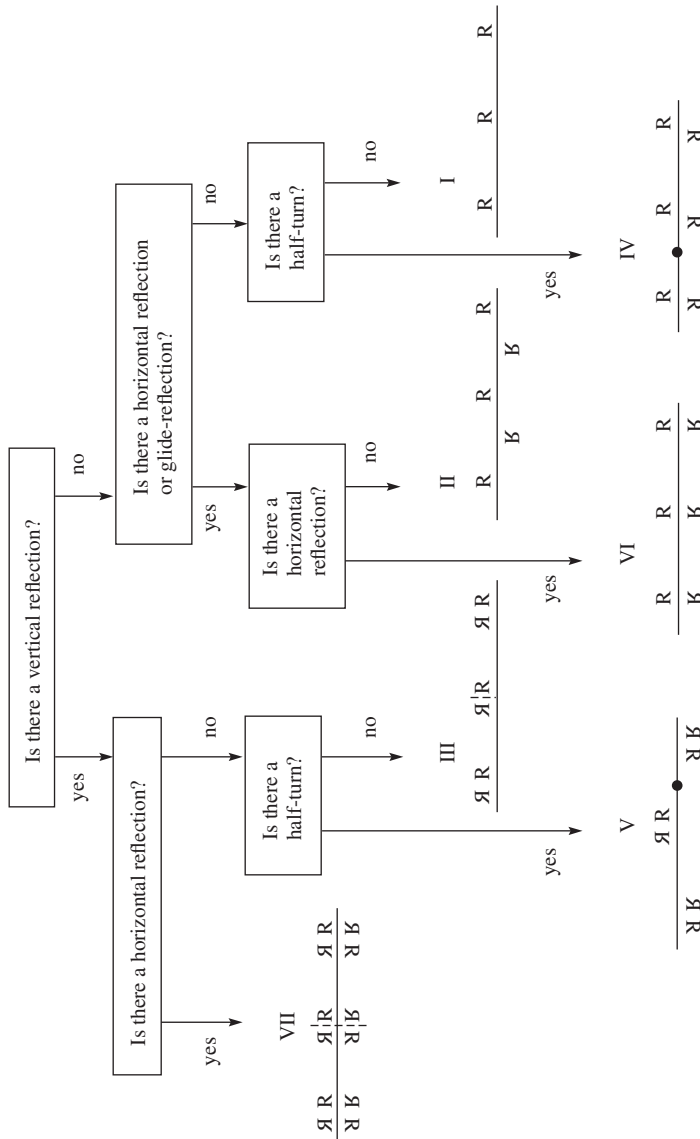
| Pattern |                                                                                                                                                  | Generators                                                                                         | Group isomorphism class |
|---------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------|
| I       | $\begin{array}{cccc} x^{-1} & e & x & x^2 \\ \hline R & R & R & R \end{array}$                                                                   | $x = \text{translation}$                                                                           | $Z$                     |
| II      | $\begin{array}{ccc} x^{-2} & e & x^2 \\ \hline R & R & R \\ & \mathcal{B} & \mathcal{B} \\ & x^{-1} & x \end{array}$                             | $x = \text{glide-reflection}$                                                                      | $Z$                     |
| III     | $\begin{array}{ccc} x^{-1}y & y & xy \\ \hline x^{-1}R & yR & xyR \end{array}$                                                                   | $x = \text{translation}$<br>$y = \text{vertical reflection}$                                       | $D_\infty$              |
| IV      | $\begin{array}{ccc} x^{-1} & e & x \\ \hline R & R & R \\ \mathcal{R} & \bullet & \mathcal{R} \\ y & & xy \\ & & x^2y \end{array}$               | $x = \text{translation}$<br>$y = \text{rotation of } 180^\circ$                                    | $D_\infty$              |
| V       | $\begin{array}{ccc} x^{-1}y & e & xy \\ \hline yR & & yR \end{array}$                                                                            | $x = \text{glide-reflection}$<br>$y = \text{rotation of } 180^\circ$                               | $D_\infty$              |
| VI      | $\begin{array}{ccc} x^{-1} & e & x \\ \hline R & R & R \\ \mathcal{B} & \mathcal{B} & \mathcal{B} \\ x^{-1}y & y & xy \end{array}$               | $x = \text{translation}$<br>$y = \text{horizontal reflection}$                                     | $Z \oplus Z_2$          |
| VII     | $\begin{array}{ccc} x^{-1}z & z & xz \\ \hline x^{-1}R & zR & xzR \\ \mathcal{R} & \mathcal{R} & \mathcal{R} \\ x^{-1}yz & yz & xyz \end{array}$ | $x = \text{translation}$<br>$y = \text{horizontal reflection}$<br>$z = \text{vertical reflection}$ | $D_\infty \oplus Z_2$   |

**Figure 28.9** The seven frieze patterns and their groups of symmetries

composition. Thus, we can always use the geometry to determine the product of any particular string of elements.

For example, we know that every element of  $F_7$  can be written in the form  $x^n y^m z^k$ . So, just for fun, let's determine the appropriate values for  $n$ ,  $m$ , and  $k$  for the element  $g = x^{-1} y z x z$ . We may do this simply by looking at the effect that  $g$  has on pattern VII. For convenience, we will pick out a particular  $R$  in the pattern and trace the action of  $g$  one step at a time. To distinguish this  $R$ , we enclose it in a shaded box. Also, we draw the axis of the vertical reflection  $z$  as a dashed line segment. See Figure 28.11.

Now, comparing the starting position of the shaded  $R$  with its final position, we see that  $x^{-1} y z x z = x^{-2} y$ . Exercise 7 suggests how one may arrive at the same result through purely algebraic manipulation.



**Figure 28.10** Recognition chart for frieze patterns.  
Adapted from [6, p. 83].\*

\*Adaptation of figure from Dorothy K. Washburn and Donald W. Crowe. *Symmetries of Culture: Theory and Practice of Plane Pattern Analysis*. Copyright © 1988 by the University of Washington Press. Used by permission.

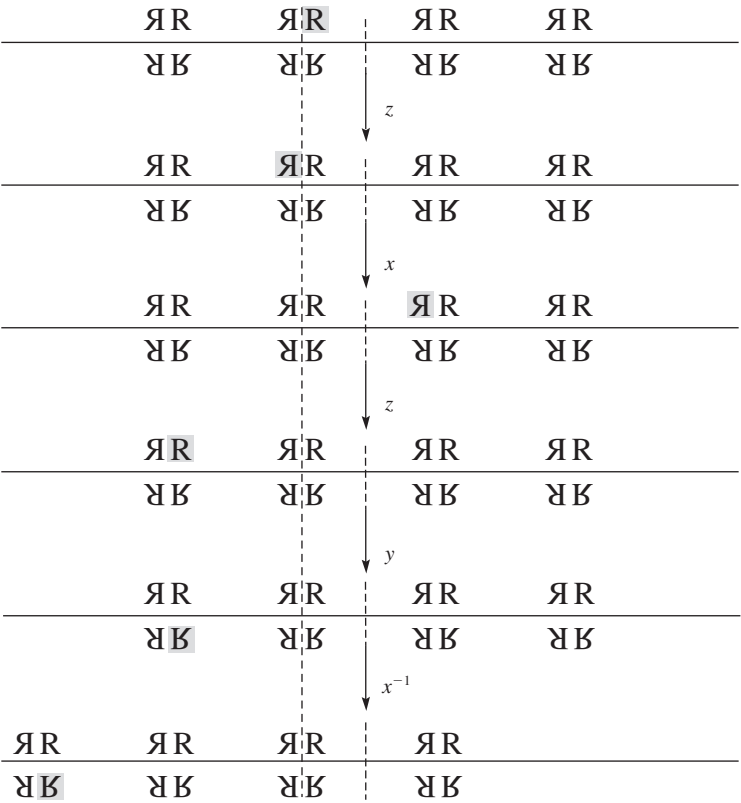


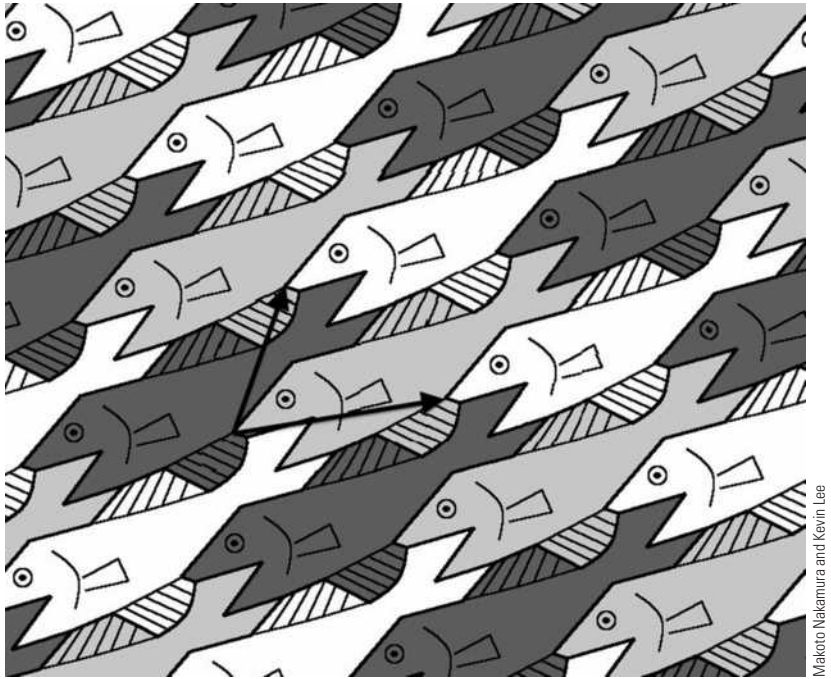
Figure 28.11

### The Crystallographic Groups

The seven frieze groups catalog all symmetry groups that leave a design invariant under all multiples of just one translation. However, there are 17 additional kinds of discrete plane symmetry groups that arise from infinitely repeating designs in a plane. These groups are the symmetry groups of plane patterns whose subgroups of translations are isomorphic to  $\mathbb{Z} \oplus \mathbb{Z}$ . Consequently, the patterns are invariant under linear combinations of two linearly independent translations. These 17 groups were first studied by 19th-century crystallographers and are often called the *plane crystallographic groups*. Another term occasionally used for these groups is *wallpaper groups*.

Our approach to the crystallographic groups will be geometric. It is adapted from the excellent article by Schattschneider [5] and the monograph by Crowe [1]. Our goal is to enable the reader to determine which of the 17 plane symmetry groups corresponds to a given periodic pattern. We begin with some examples.





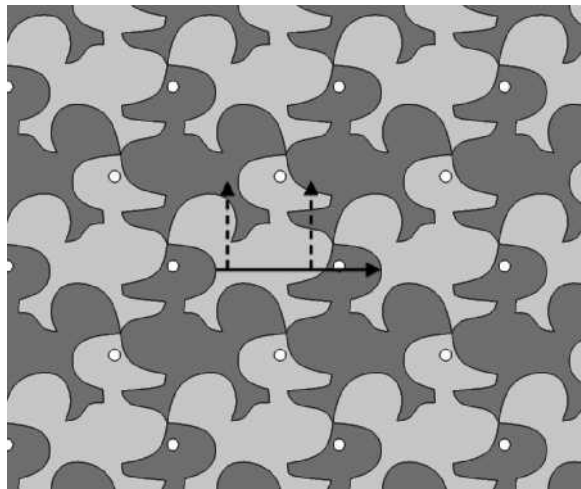
**Figure 28.12** Fish3 by Makoto Nakamura, adapted by Kevin Lee. Design with symmetry group  $p1$  (disregarding shading). The inserted arrows are translation vectors.

The simplest of the 17 crystallographic groups contains translations only. In Figure 28.12, we present an illustration of a representative pattern for this group (imagine the pattern repeated to fill the entire plane). The crystallographic notation for it is  $p1$ . (This notation is explained in [5].)

The symmetry group of the pattern in Figure 28.13 contains translations and glide-reflections. This group has no (nonzero) rotational or reflective symmetry. The crystallographic notation for it is  $pg$ .

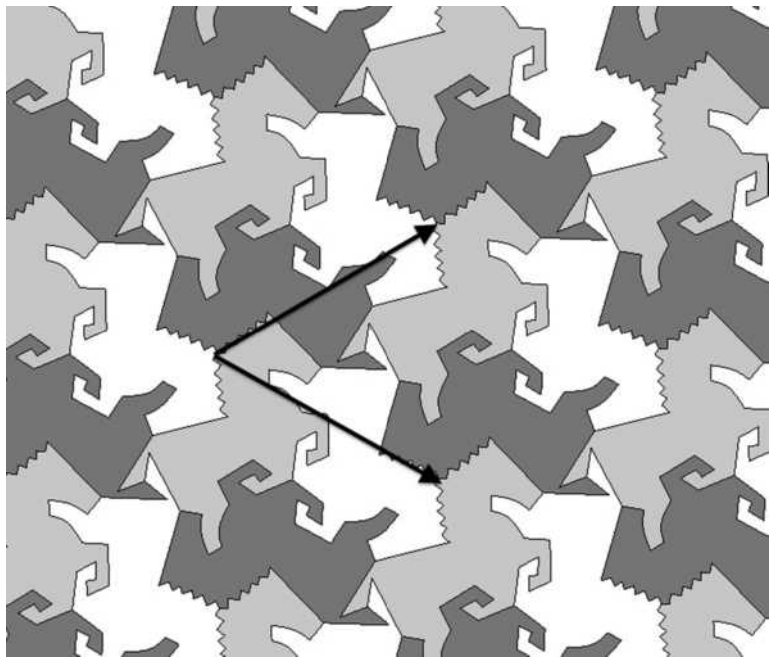
Figure 28.14 has translational symmetry and threefold rotational symmetry (that is, the figure can be rotated  $120^\circ$  about certain points and be brought into coincidence with itself). The notation for this group is  $p3$ .

Representative patterns for all 17 plane crystallographic groups, together with their notations, are given in Figures 28.15 and 28.16. Figure 28.17 uses a triangle motif to illustrate the 17 classes of symmetry patterns.



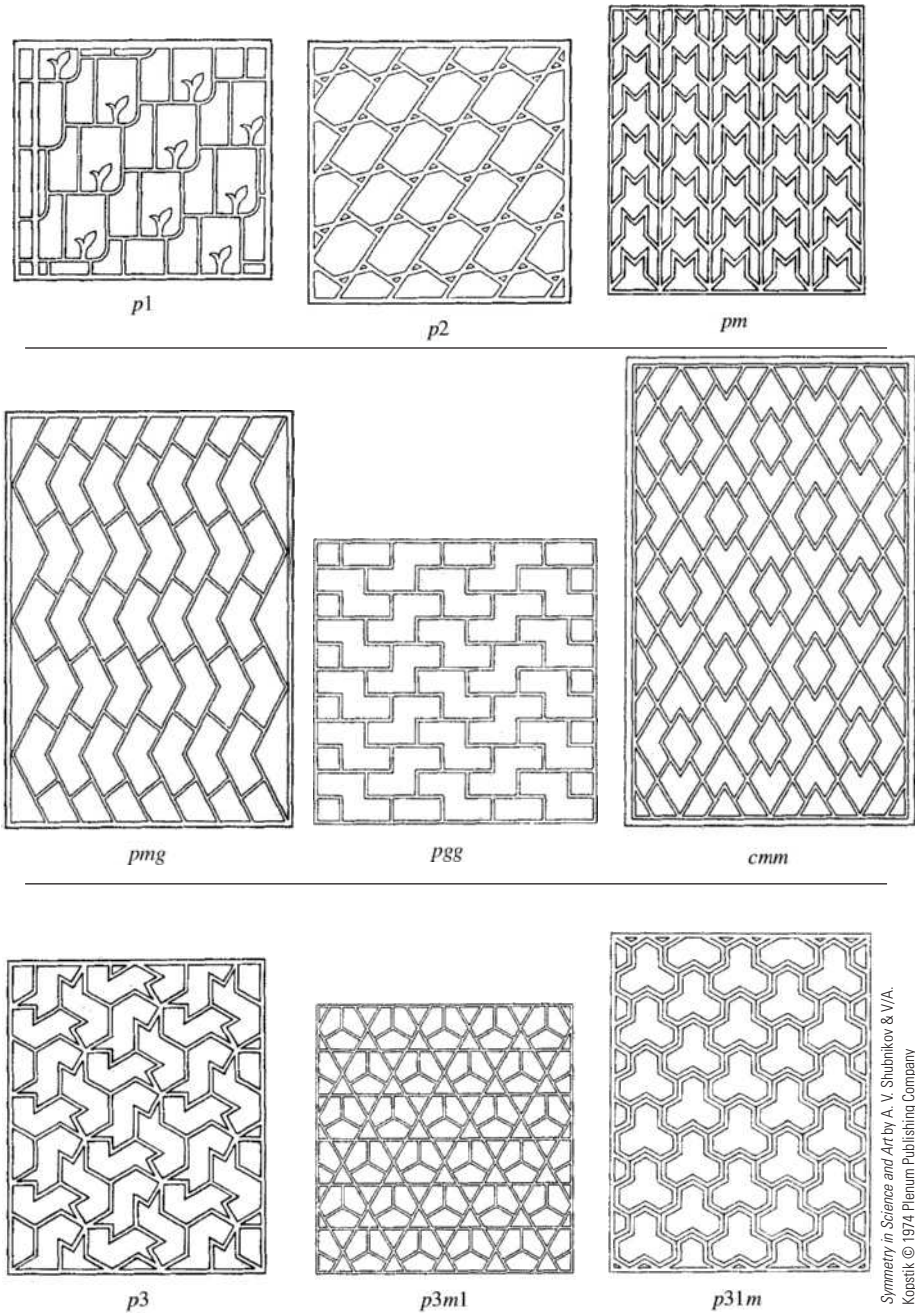
Makoto Nakamura and Kevin Lee

**Figure 28.13** Fish5 by Makoto Nakamura, adapted by Kevin Lee. Design with symmetry group  $pg$  (disregarding shading). The solid arrow is the translation vector. The dashed arrows are the glide-reflection vectors.



Makoto Nakamura and Kevin Lee

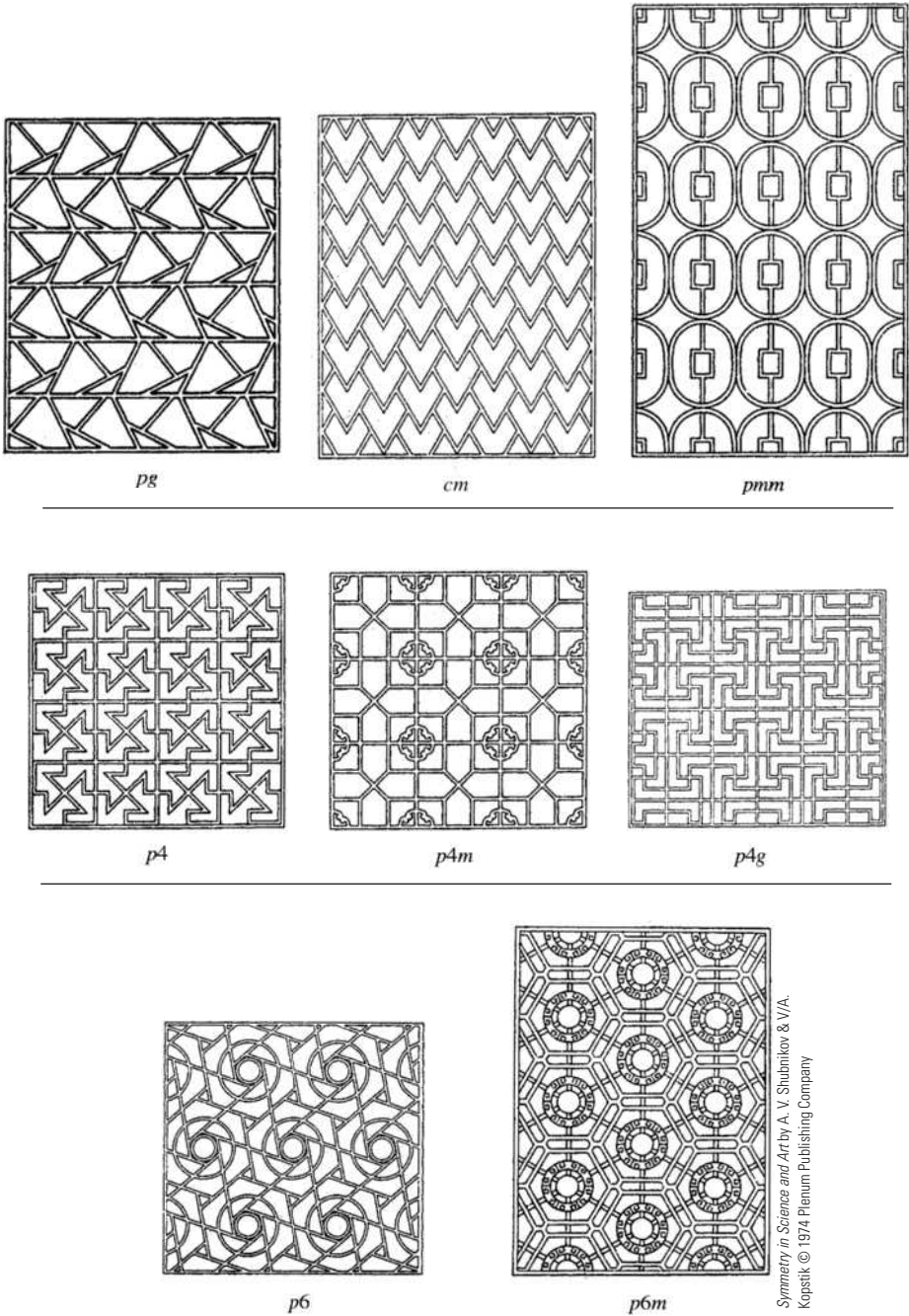
**Figure 28.14** Horses1 by Makoto Nakamura, adapted by Kevin Lee. Design with symmetry group  $p3$  (disregarding shading). The inserted arrows are translation vectors.



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**Figure 28.15** The plane symmetry groups

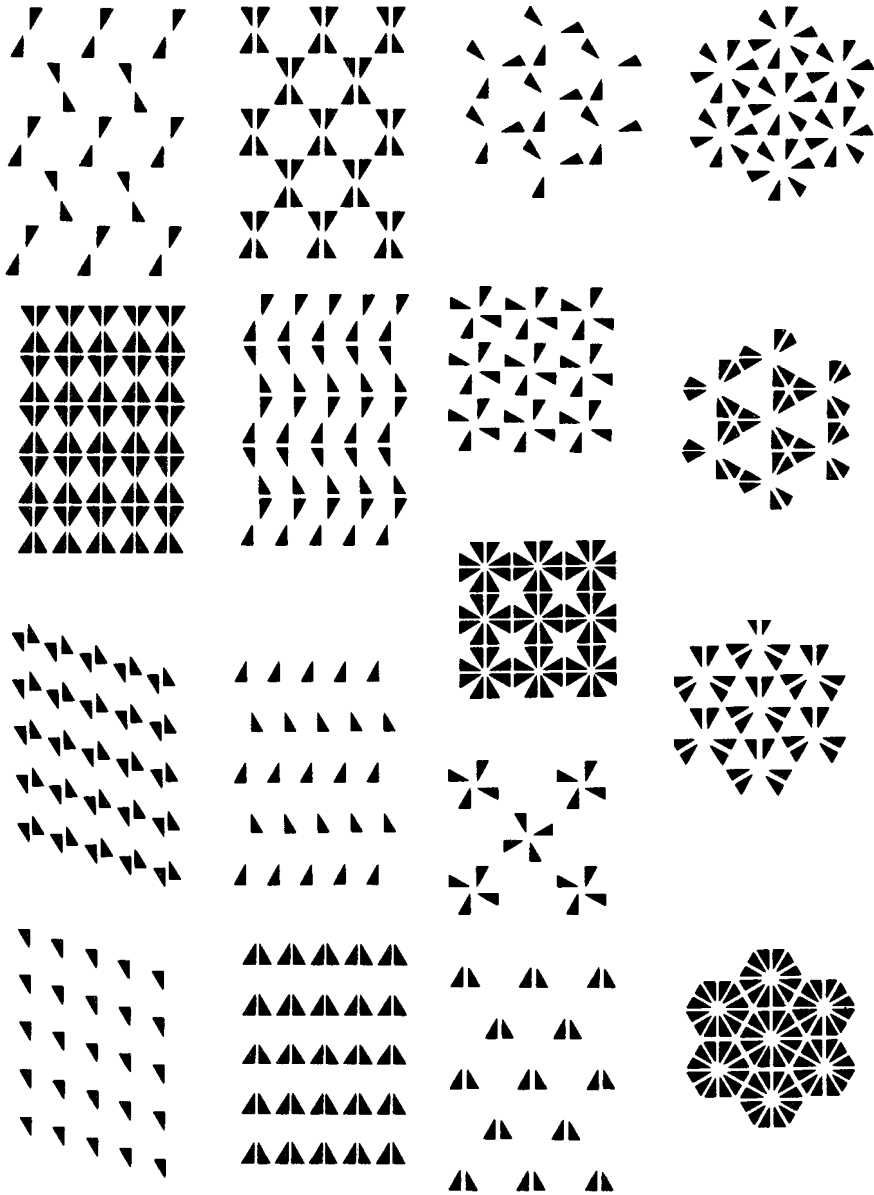
All designs in Figures 28.15 and 28.16 except *pm*, *p3*, and *pg* are found in [2]. The designs for *p3* and *pg* are based on elements of Chinese lattice designs found in [2]; the design for *pm* is based on a weaving pattern from Hawaii, found in [3].



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**Figure 28.16** The plane symmetry groups





**Figure 28.17** The 17 plane periodic patterns formed using a triangle motif

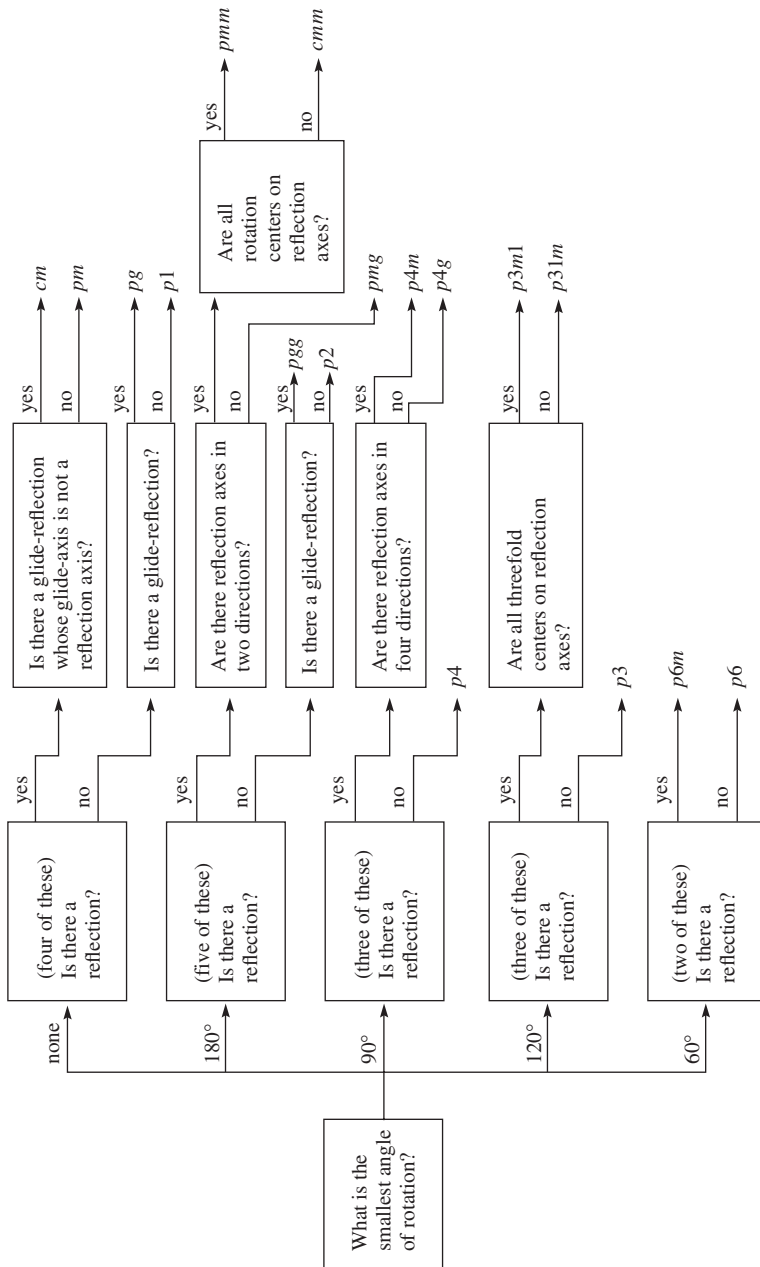
## Identification of Plane Periodic Patterns

To decide which of the 17 classes any particular plane periodic pattern belongs to, we may use the flowchart presented in Figure 28.18. This is done by determining the rotational symmetry and whether or not the pattern has reflection symmetry or nontrivial glide-reflection symmetry. These three pieces of information will narrow the list of candidates to at most two. The final test, if necessary, is to determine the locations of the centers of rotation.

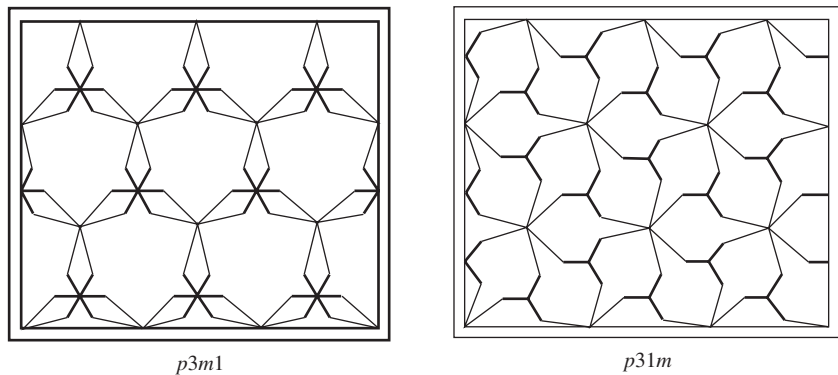
For example, consider the two patterns in Figure 28.19 generated in a hockey stick motif. Both patterns have a smallest positive rotational symmetry of  $120^\circ$ ; both have reflectional and nontrivial glide-reflectional symmetry. Now, according to Figure 28.18, these patterns must be of type  $p3m1$  or  $p31m$ . But notice that the pattern on the left has all its threefold centers of rotation on the reflection axis, whereas in the pattern on the right the points where the three blades meet are not on a reflection axis. Thus, the left pattern is  $p3m1$ , and the right pattern is  $p31m$ .

Table 28.1 (reproduced from [5, p. 443]) can also be used to determine the type of periodic pattern and contains two other features that are often useful. A *lattice of points* of a pattern is a set of images of any particular point acted on by the translation group of the pattern. A *lattice unit* of a pattern whose translation subgroup is generated by  $u$  and  $v$  is a parallelogram formed by a point of the pattern and its image under  $u$ ,  $v$ , and  $u + v$ . The possible lattices for periodic patterns in a plane, together with lattice units, are shown in Figure 28.20. A *generating region* (or *fundamental region*) of a periodic pattern is the smallest portion of the lattice unit whose images under the full symmetry group of the pattern cover the plane. Examples of generating regions for the patterns represented in Figures 28.12, 28.13, and 28.14 are given in Figure 28.21. In Figure 28.21, the portion of the lattice unit with vertical bars is the generating region. The only symmetry pattern in which the lattice unit and the generating region coincide is the  $p1$  pattern illustrated in Figure 28.12. Table 28.1 tells what proportion of the lattice unit constitutes the generating region of each plane periodic pattern.

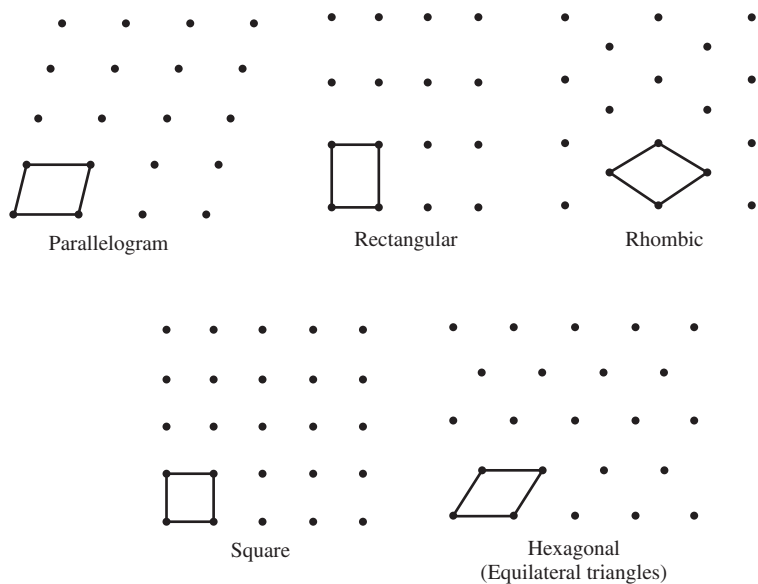
Notice that Table 28.1 reveals that the only possible  $n$ -fold rotational symmetries occur when  $n = 1, 2, 3, 4$ , and  $6$ . This fact is commonly called the *crystallographic restriction*. The first proof of this was given by the Englishman W. Barlow over 100 years ago. The information in Table 28.1 can also be used in reverse to create patterns with a specific symmetry group. The patterns in Figure 28.19 were made in this way.



**Figure 28.18** Identification flowchart for symmetries of plane periodic patterns



**Figure 28.19** Patterns generated in a hockey stick motif



**Figure 28.20** Possible lattices for plane periodic patterns

In sharp contrast to the situation for finite symmetry groups, the transition from two-dimensional crystallographic groups to three-dimensional crystallographic groups introduces a great many more possibilities, since the motif is repeated indefinitely by three independent translations. Indeed, there are 230 three-dimensional crystallographic groups (often called *space groups*). These were independently determined by Fedorov, Schönflies, and Barlow in the 1890s. David Hilbert, one of the leading mathematicians of the 20th century, focused attention on the crystallographic groups in his



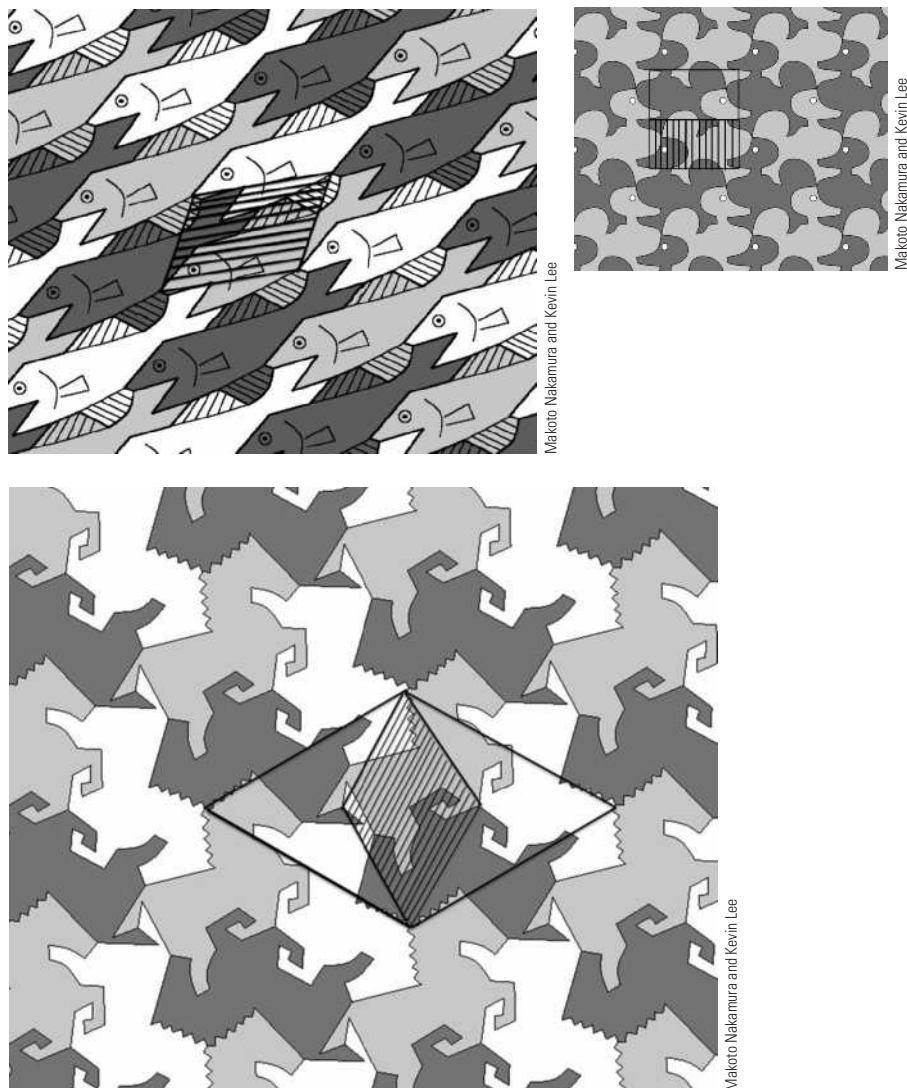
**Table 28.1** Identification Chart for Plane Periodic Patterns<sup>a</sup>

| Type        | Lattice       | Highest Order of Rotation | Reflections | Nontrivial Glide-Reflections | Generating Region   | Helpful Distinguishing Properties            |
|-------------|---------------|---------------------------|-------------|------------------------------|---------------------|----------------------------------------------|
| <i>p1</i>   | Parallelogram | 1                         | No          | No                           | 1 unit              |                                              |
| <i>p2</i>   | Parallelogram | 2                         | No          | No                           | $\frac{1}{2}$ unit  |                                              |
| <i>pm</i>   | Rectangular   | 1                         | Yes         | No                           | $\frac{1}{2}$ unit  |                                              |
| <i>pg</i>   | Rectangular   | 1                         | No          | Yes                          | $\frac{1}{2}$ unit  |                                              |
| <i>cm</i>   | Rhombic       | 1                         | Yes         | Yes                          | $\frac{1}{2}$ unit  |                                              |
| <i>pmm</i>  | Rectangular   | 2                         | Yes         | No                           | $\frac{1}{4}$ unit  |                                              |
| <i>pmg</i>  | Rectangular   | 2                         | Yes         | Yes                          | $\frac{1}{4}$ unit  | Parallel reflection axes                     |
| <i>pgg</i>  | Rectangular   | 2                         | No          | Yes                          | $\frac{1}{4}$ unit  |                                              |
| <i>cmm</i>  | Rhombic       | 2                         | Yes         | Yes                          | $\frac{1}{4}$ unit  | Perpendicular reflection axes                |
| <i>p4</i>   | Square        | 4                         | No          | No                           | $\frac{1}{4}$ unit  |                                              |
| <i>p4m</i>  | Square        | 4                         | Yes         | Yes                          | $\frac{1}{8}$ unit  | Fourfold centers on reflection axes          |
| <i>p4g</i>  | Square        | 4                         | Yes         | Yes                          | $\frac{1}{8}$ unit  | Fourfold centers not on reflection axes      |
| <i>p3</i>   | Hexagonal     | 3                         | No          | No                           | $\frac{1}{3}$ unit  |                                              |
| <i>p3m1</i> | Hexagonal     | 3                         | Yes         | Yes                          | $\frac{1}{6}$ unit  | All threefold centers on reflection axes     |
| <i>p31m</i> | Hexagonal     | 3                         | Yes         | Yes                          | $\frac{1}{6}$ unit  | Not all threefold centers on reflection axes |
| <i>p6</i>   | Hexagonal     | 6                         | No          | No                           | $\frac{1}{6}$ unit  |                                              |
| <i>p6m</i>  | Hexagonal     | 6                         | Yes         | Yes                          | $\frac{1}{12}$ unit |                                              |

<sup>a</sup>A rotation through an angle of  $360^\circ/n$  is said to have order  $n$ . A glide-reflection is nontrivial if its glide-axis is not an axis of reflective symmetry for the pattern.

famous lecture in 1900 at the International Congress of Mathematicians in Paris. One of 23 problems he posed was whether or not the number of crystallographic groups in  $n$  dimensions is always finite. This was answered affirmatively by L. Bieberbach in 1910. We mention in passing that in four dimensions, there are 4783 symmetry groups for infinitely repeating patterns.

As one might expect, the crystallographic groups are fundamentally important in the study of crystals. In fact, a crystal is defined as a rigid body in which the component particles are arranged in a pattern that repeats in three directions (the repetition is caused by the chemical



**Figure 28.21** A lattice unit and generating region for the patterns in Figures 28.12, 28.13, and 28.14. Generating regions are shaded with bars.

bonding). A grain of salt and a grain of sugar are two examples of common crystals. In crystalline materials, the motif units are atoms, ions, ionic groups, clusters of ions, or molecules.

Perhaps it is fitting to conclude this chapter by recounting two episodes in the history of science in which an understanding of symmetry groups was crucial to a great discovery. In 1912, Max von Laue, a young German physicist, hypothesized that a narrow beam of x-rays directed onto a crystal with a photographic film behind it would be deflected

(the technical term is “diffracted”) by the unit cell (made up of atoms or ions) and would show up on the film as spots. (See Figure 1.3.) Shortly thereafter, two British scientists, Sir William Henry Bragg and his 22-year-old son William Lawrence Bragg, who was a student, noted that von Laue’s diffraction spots, together with the known information about crystallographic space groups, could be used to calculate the shape of the internal array of atoms. This discovery marked the birth of modern mineralogy. From the first crystal structures deduced by the Braggs to the present, x-ray diffraction has been the means by which the internal structures of crystals are determined. Von Laue was awarded the Nobel Prize in physics in 1914, and the Braggs were jointly awarded the Nobel Prize in physics in 1915.

Our second episode took place in the early 1950s, when a handful of scientists were attempting to learn the structure of the DNA molecule—the basic genetic material. One of these was a graduate student named Francis Crick; another was an x-ray crystallographer, Rosalind Franklin. On one occasion, Crick was shown one of Franklin’s research reports and an x-ray diffraction photograph of DNA. At this point, we let Horace Judson [4, pp. 165–166], our source, continue the story.

Crick saw in Franklin’s words and numbers something just as important, indeed eventually just as visualizable. There was drama, too: Crick’s insight began with an extraordinary coincidence. Crystallographers distinguish 230 different space groups, of which the face-centered monoclinic cell with its curious properties of symmetry is only one—though in biological substances a fairly common one. The principal experimental subject of Crick’s dissertation, however, was the x-ray diffraction of the crystals of a protein that was of exactly the same space group as DNA. So Crick saw at once the symmetry that neither Franklin nor Wilkins had comprehended, that Perutz, for that matter, hadn’t noticed, that had escaped the theoretical crystallographer in Wilkins’ lab, Alexander Stokes—namely, that the molecule of DNA, rotated a half turn, came back to congruence with itself. The structure was dyadic, one half matching the other half in reverse.

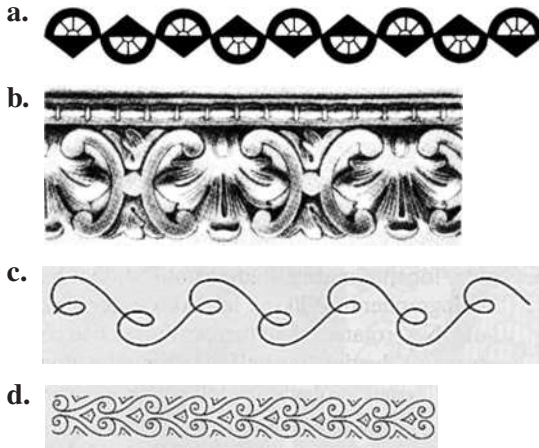
This was a crucial fact. Shortly thereafter, James Watson and Crick built an accurate model of DNA. In 1962, Watson, Crick, and Maurice Wilkins received the Nobel Prize in medicine and physiology for their discovery. The opinion has been expressed that, had Franklin correctly recognized the symmetry of the DNA molecule, she might have been the one to unravel the mystery and receive the Nobel Prize [4, p. 172].

# Exercises

You can see a lot just by looking.

Yogi Berra

1. Show that the frieze group  $F_6$  is isomorphic to  $Z \oplus Z_2$ .
2. How many nonisomorphic frieze groups are there?
3. In the frieze group  $F_7$ , write  $x^2yzxz$  in the form  $x^n y^m z^k$ .
4. In the frieze group  $F_7$ , write  $x^{-3}zxyz$  in the form  $x^n y^m z^k$ .
5. In the frieze group  $F_7$ , show that  $yz = zy$  and  $xy = yx$ .
6. In the frieze group  $F_7$ , show that  $zxz = x^{-1}$ .
7. Use the results of Exercises 5 and 6 to do Exercises 3 and 4 through symbol manipulation only (that is, without referring to the pattern). (This exercise is referred to in this chapter.)
8. Prove that in  $F_7$  the cyclic subgroup generated by  $x$  is a normal subgroup.
9. Quote a previous result that tells why the subgroups  $\langle x, y \rangle$  and  $\langle x, z \rangle$  must be normal in  $F_7$ .
10. Look up the word *frieze* in an ordinary dictionary. Explain why the frieze groups are appropriately named.
11. Determine which of the seven frieze groups is the symmetry group of each of the following patterns.

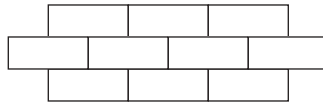


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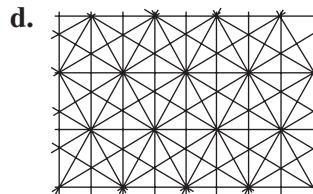
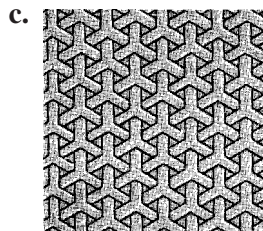
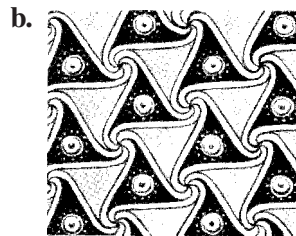
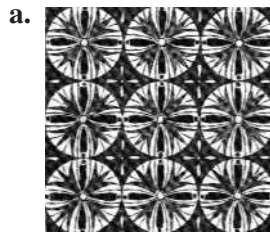


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12. Determine the frieze group corresponding to each of the following patterns.
- $y = \sin x$
  - $y = |\sin x|$
  - $|y| = \sin x$
  - $y = \tan x$
  - $y = \csc x$
13. Determine the symmetry group of the tessellation of the plane exemplified by the brickwork shown.

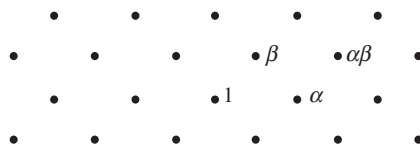


14. Determine the plane symmetry group for each of the patterns in Figure 28.17.
15. Determine which of the 17 crystallographic groups is the symmetry group of each of the following patterns.



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16. In the following figure, there is a point labeled 1. Let  $\alpha$  be the translation of the plane that carries the point labeled 1 to the point labeled  $\alpha$ , and let  $\beta$  be the translation of the plane that carries the point labeled 1 to the point labeled  $\beta$ . The image of 1 under the composition of  $\alpha$  and  $\beta$  is labeled  $\alpha\beta$ . In the corresponding fashion, label the remaining points in the figure in the form  $\alpha^i\beta^j$ .



17. The patterns made by automobile tire treads in the snow are frieze patterns. An extensive study of automobile tires revealed that only five of the seven frieze patterns occur. Speculate on which two patterns do not occur and give a possible reason why they do not.
18. Locate a nontrivial glide-reflection axis of symmetry in the *cm* pattern in Figure 28.16.
19. Determine which of the frieze groups is the symmetry group of each of the following patterns.
- $\cdots D D D D \cdots$
  - $\cdots V \wedge V \wedge \cdots$
  - $\cdots L L L L \cdots$
  - $\cdots V V V V \cdots$
  - $\cdots N N N N \cdots$
  - $\cdots H H H H \cdots$
  - $\cdots L \top L \top \cdots$
20. Locate a nontrivial glide-reflection axis of symmetry in the pattern third from the left in the bottom row in Figure 28.17.

## References

1. Donald Crowe, *Symmetry, Rigid Motions, and Patterns*, Arlington, Va.: COMAP, 1986.
2. Daniel S. Dye, *A Grammar of Chinese Lattice*, Harvard-Yenching Institute Monograph Series, vol. VI, Cambridge, Mass.: Harvard University Press, 1937. (Reprinted as *Chinese Lattice Designs*, New York: Dover, 1974.)

3. Owen Jones, *The Grammar of Ornament*, New York: Van Nostrand Reinhold, 1972. (Reproduction of the same title, first published in 1856 and reprinted in 1910 and 1928.)
4. Horace Freeland Judson, *The Eighth Day of Creation*, New York: Simon and Schuster, 1979.
5. D. Schattschneider, “The Plane Symmetry Groups: Their Recognition and Notation,” *The American Mathematical Monthly* 85 (1978): 439–450.
6. D. K. Washburn and D. W. Crowe, *Symmetries of Culture: Theory and Practice of Plane Pattern Analysis*, Seattle: University of Washington Press, 1988.

## Suggested Readings

S. Garfunkel et al., *For All Practical Purposes*, 9th ed., New York: W. H. Freeman, 2012.

This book has a well-written, richly illustrated chapter on symmetry in art and nature.

W. G. Jackson, “Symmetry in Automobile Tires and the Left-Right Problem,” *Journal of Chemical Education* 69 (1992): 624–626.

This article uses automobile tires as a tool for introducing and explaining the symmetry terms and concepts important in chemistry.

C. MacGillivray, *Fantasy and Symmetry—The Periodic Drawings of M. C. Escher*, New York: Harry N. Abrams, 1976.

This is a collection of Escher’s periodic drawings together with a mathematical discussion of each one.

D. Schattschneider, *Visions of Symmetry*, New York: Harry Abrams, 2004.

A loving, lavish, encyclopedic book on the drawings of M. C. Escher.

H. von Baeyer, “Impossible Crystals,” *Discover* 11 (2) (1990): 69–78.

This article tells how the discovery of nonperiodic tilings of the plane led to the discovery of quasicrystals. The x-ray diffraction patterns of quasicrystals exhibit fivefold symmetry—something that had been thought to be impossible.

## Suggested Websites

**<http://www.mcescher.com/>**

This is the official website for the artist M. C. Escher. It features many of his prints and most of his 136 symmetry drawings.

**<http://britton.disted.camosun.bc.ca/jbsymteslk.htm>**

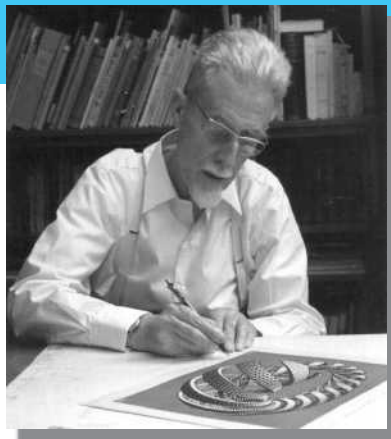
This spectacular website on symmetry and tessellations has numerous activities and links to many other sites on related topics. It is a wonderful website for K–12 teachers and students.



## M. C. Escher

I never got a pass mark in math. The funny thing is I seem to latch on to mathematical theories without realizing what is happening.

M. C. ESCHER



© Bruno Ernst

M. C. ESCHER was born on June 17, 1898, in the Netherlands. His artistic work prior to 1937 was dominated by the representation of visible reality, such as landscapes and buildings. Gradually, he became less and less interested in the visible world and became increasingly absorbed in an inventive approach to space. He studied the abstract space-filling patterns used in the Moorish mosaics in the Alhambra in Spain. He also studied the mathematician George Pólya's paper on the 17 plane crystallographic groups. Instead of the geometric motifs used by the Moors and Pólya, Escher preferred to use animals, plants, or people in his space-filling prints.

Escher was fond of incorporating various mathematical ideas into his works. Among these are infinity, Möbius bands, stellations,

deformations, reflections, Platonic solids, spirals, and the hyperbolic plane.

Although Escher originals are now quite expensive, it was not until 1951 that he derived a significant portion of his income from his prints. Today, Escher is widely known and appreciated as a graphic artist. His prints have been used to illustrate ideas in hundreds of scientific works. Despite this popularity among scientists, however, Escher has never been held in high esteem in traditional art circles. Escher died on March 27, 1972, in the Netherlands.

To find more information about Escher and his art, visit the official website of M. C. Escher:

**<http://www.mcescher.com/>**

# George Pólya

Thank you, Professor Pólya, for all your beautiful contributions to mathematics, to science, to education, and to humanity.

*A toast from FRANK HARARY on the occasion of Pólya's 90th birthday*

GEORGE PÓLYA was born in Budapest, Hungary, on December 13, 1887. He received a teaching certificate from the University of Budapest in languages before turning to philosophy, mathematics, and physics.

In 1912, he was awarded a Ph.D. in mathematics. Horrified by Hitler and World War II, Pólya came to the United States in 1940. After two years at Brown University, he went to Stanford University, where he remained until his death in 1985 at the age of 97.

In 1924, Pólya published a paper in a crystallography journal in which he classified the plane symmetry groups and provided a full-page illustration of the corresponding 17 periodic patterns. B. G. Escher, a geologist, sent a copy of the paper to his artist brother, M. C. Escher, who used Pólya's black-and-white geometric patterns as a guide for making his own interlocking colored patterns featuring birds, reptiles, and fish.



Courtesy of G.L. Alexanderson/Santa Clara University

Pólya contributed to many branches of mathematics, and his collected papers fill four large volumes. Pólya is also famous for his books on problem solving and for his teaching. One of his books has sold more than 1,000,000 copies. The Society for Industrial and Applied Mathematics, the London Mathematical Society, and the Mathematical Association of America have prizes named after Pólya.

Pólya taught courses and lectured around the country into his 90s. He never learned to drive a car and took his first plane trip at age 75. He was married for 67 years and had no children.

For more information about Pólya, visit:

**[http://www-groups.dcs  
.st-and.ac.uk/~history/](http://www-groups.dcs.st-and.ac.uk/~history/)**

## John H. Conway

He's definitely world class, yet he has this kind of childlike enthusiasm.

RONALD GRAHAM



Princeton University

JOHN H. CONWAY ranks among the most original and versatile contemporary mathematicians. Conway was born in Liverpool, England, on December 26, 1937, and grew up in a rough neighborhood. As a youngster, he was often beaten up by older boys and did not do well in high school. Nevertheless, his mathematical ability earned him a scholarship to Cambridge University, where he excelled.

A pattern that uses repeated shapes to cover a flat surface without gaps or overlaps is called a *tiling*. In 1975, Oxford physicist Roger Penrose invented an important new way of tiling the plane with two shapes. Unlike patterns whose symmetry group is one of the 17 plane crystallographic groups, Penrose patterns can be neither translated nor rotated to coincide with themselves. Many of the remarkable properties of the Penrose patterns were discovered by Conway. In 1993, Conway discovered a new prism that can be

used to fill three-dimensional space without gaps or overlaps.

Conway has made many significant contributions to number theory, group theory, game theory, knot theory, and combinatorics. Among his most important discoveries are three simple groups, which are now named after him. (Simple groups are the basic building blocks of all groups.) Conway is fascinated by games and puzzles. He invented the game Life and the game Sprouts. Conway has received numerous prestigious honors. In 1987 he joined the faculty at Princeton University, where his title is John von Neumann Distinguished Professor of Mathematics.

For more information about Conway, visit:

<http://www-groups.dcs.st-and.ac.uk/~history/>

# 29 Symmetry and Counting

Let us pause to slake our thirst one last time at symmetry's bubbling spring.

Timothy Ferris, *Coming of Age in the Milky Way*

Whenever you can, count.

Francis Galton, (1822–1911)

## Motivation

Permutation groups naturally arise in many situations involving symmetric designs or arrangements. Consider, for example, the task of coloring the six vertices of a regular hexagon so that three are black and three are white. Figure 29.1 shows the  $\binom{6}{3} = 20$  possibilities. However, if these designs appeared on one side of hexagonal ceramic tiles, it would be nonsensical to count the designs shown in Figure 29.1(a) as different, since all six designs shown there can be obtained from one of them by rotating. (A manufacturer would make only one of the six.) In this case, we say that the designs in Figure 29.1(a) are *equivalent* under the group of rotations of the hexagon. Similarly, the designs in Figure 29.1(b) are equivalent under the group of rotations, as are the designs in Figure 29.1(c) and those in Figure 29.1(d). And, since no design from Figure 29.1(a)–(d) can be obtained from a design in a different part by rotation, we see that the designs within each part of the figure are equivalent to each other but nonequivalent to any design in another part of the figure. However, the designs in Figure 29.1(b) and (c) are equivalent under the dihedral group  $D_6$ , since the designs in Figure 29.1(b) can be reflected to yield the designs in Figure 29.1(c). For example, for purposes of arranging three black beads and three white beads to form a necklace, the designs shown in Figure 29.1(b) and (c) would be considered equivalent.

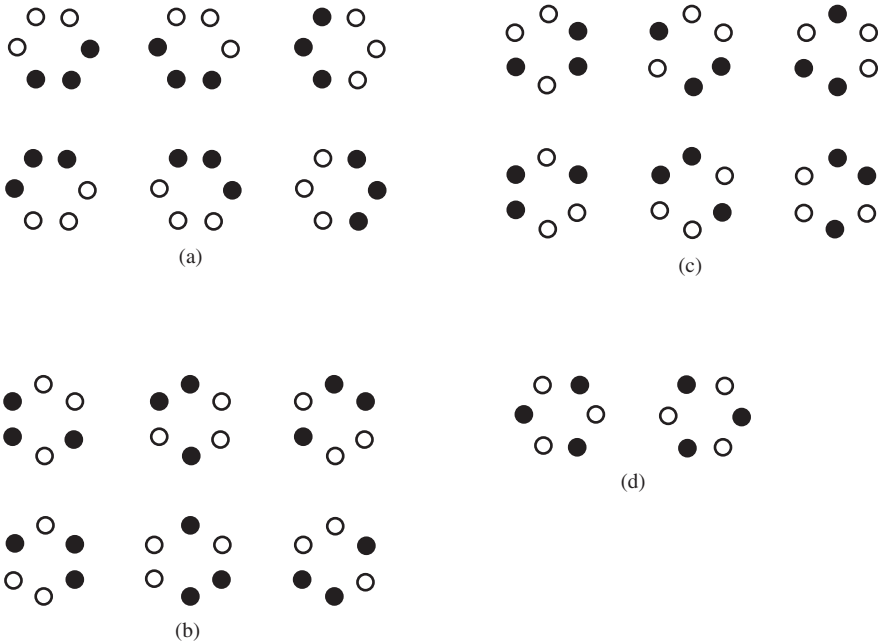


Figure 29.1

In general, we say that two designs (arrangements of beads)  $A$  and  $B$  are *equivalent under a group*  $G$  of permutations of the arrangements if there is an element  $\phi$  in  $G$  such that  $\phi(A) = B$ . That is, two designs are equivalent under  $G$  if they are in the same orbit of  $G$ . It follows, then, that the number of nonequivalent designs under  $G$  is simply the number of orbits of designs under  $G$ . (The set being permuted is the set of all possible designs or arrangements.)

Notice that the designs in Figure 29.1 divide into four orbits under the group of rotations but only three orbits under the group  $D_6$ , since the designs in Figure 29.1(b) and (c) form a single orbit under  $D_6$ . Thus, we could obtain all 20 tile designs from just four tiles, but we could obtain all 20 necklaces from just three of them.

## Burnside's Theorem

Although the problems we have just posed are simple enough to solve by observation, more complicated ones require a more sophisticated approach. Such an approach was provided by Georg Frobenius in 1887. Frobenius's theorem did not become widely known until it appeared in the classic book on group theory by William Burnside in 1911. By an accident of history, Frobenius's theorem has come to be known as

Burnside's Theorem. Before stating this theorem, we recall some notation introduced in Chapter 7 and introduce new notation. If  $G$  is a group of permutations on a set  $S$  and  $i \in S$ , then  $\text{stab}_G(i) = \{\phi \in G \mid \phi(i) = i\}$  and  $\text{orb}_G(i) = \{\phi(i) \mid \phi \in G\}$ . For any set  $X$ , we use  $|X|$  to denote the number of elements in  $X$ .

**Definition Elements Fixed by  $\phi$**

For any group  $G$  of permutations on a set  $S$  and any  $\phi$  in  $G$ , we let  $\text{fix}(\phi) = \{i \in S \mid \phi(i) = i\}$ . This set is called the *elements fixed by  $\phi$*  (or more simply, “fix of  $\phi$ ”).

**Theorem 29.1 Burnside's Theorem**

*If  $G$  is a finite group of permutations on a set  $S$ , then the number of orbits of elements of  $S$  under  $G$  is*

$$\frac{1}{|G|} \sum_{\phi \in G} |\text{fix}(\phi)|.$$

**PROOF** Let  $n$  denote the number of pairs  $(\phi, i)$ , with  $\phi \in G$ ,  $i \in S$ , and  $\phi(i) = i$ . We begin by counting these pairs in two ways. First, for each particular  $\phi$  in  $G$ , the number of such pairs is exactly  $|\text{fix}(\phi)|$ . So,

$$n = \sum_{\phi \in G} |\text{fix}(\phi)|. \quad (1)$$

Second, for each particular  $i$  in  $S$ , observe that  $|\text{stab}_G(i)|$  is exactly the number of pairs  $(\phi, i)$  for which  $\phi(i) = i$ . So,

$$n = \sum_{i \in S} |\text{stab}_G(i)|. \quad (2)$$

It follows from Exercise 43 in Chapter 7 that if  $s$  and  $t$  are in the same orbit of  $G$ , then  $\text{orb}_G(s) = \text{orb}_G(t)$ , and thus by the Orbit-Stabilizer Theorem (Theorem 7.4) we have  $|\text{stab}_G(s)| = |G|/|\text{orb}_G(s)| = |G|/|\text{orb}_G(t)| = |\text{stab}_G(t)|$ . So, if we choose  $s \in S$  and sum over  $\text{orb}_G(s)$ , we have

$$\sum_{t \in \text{orb}_G(s)} |\text{stab}_G(t)| = |\text{orb}_G(s)| |\text{stab}_G(s)| = |G|. \quad (3)$$

Finally, by summing over all the elements of  $G$ , one orbit at a time, it follows from Equations (1), (2), and (3) that

$$\sum_{\phi \in G} |\text{fix}(\phi)| = \sum_{i \in S} |\text{stab}_G(i)| = |G| \cdot (\text{number of orbits}),$$

and the result follows. ■

## Applications

To illustrate how to apply Burnside's Theorem, let us return to the ceramic tile and necklace problems. In the case of counting hexagonal tiles with three black vertices and three white vertices, the objects being permuted are the 20 possible designs, whereas the group of permutations is the group of six rotational symmetries of a hexagon. Obviously, the identity fixes all 20 designs. We see from Figure 29.1 that rotations of  $60^\circ$ ,  $180^\circ$ , or  $300^\circ$  fix none of the 20 designs. Finally, Figure 29.2 shows  $\text{fix}(\phi)$  for the rotations of  $120^\circ$  and  $240^\circ$ . These data are collected in Table 29.1.



**Figure 29.2** Tile designs fixed by  $120^\circ$  rotation and  $240^\circ$  rotation

**Table 29.1**

| Element                 | Number of Designs Fixed by Element |
|-------------------------|------------------------------------|
| Identity                | 20                                 |
| Rotation of $60^\circ$  | 0                                  |
| Rotation of $120^\circ$ | 2                                  |
| Rotation of $180^\circ$ | 0                                  |
| Rotation of $240^\circ$ | 2                                  |
| Rotation of $300^\circ$ | 0                                  |

So, applying Burnside's Theorem, we obtain the number of orbits under the group of rotations as

$$\frac{1}{6} (20 + 0 + 2 + 0 + 2 + 0) = 4.$$

Now let's use Burnside's Theorem to count the number of necklace arrangements consisting of three black beads and three white beads. (For the purposes of analysis, we may arrange the beads in the shape of a regular hexagon.) For this problem, two arrangements are equivalent if they are in the same orbit under  $D_6$ . Figure 29.3 shows the arrangements fixed



**Figure 29.3** Bead arrangements fixed by the reflection across a diagonal

Table 29.2

| Type of Element                    | Number of<br>Elements<br>of This<br>Type | Number of<br>Arrangements<br>Fixed by Type<br>of Element |
|------------------------------------|------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| Identity                           | 1                                        | 20                                                       |
| Rotation of order 2 (180°)         | 1                                        | 0                                                        |
| Rotation of order 3 (120° or 240°) | 2                                        | 2                                                        |
| Rotation of order 6 (60° or 300°)  | 2                                        | 0                                                        |
| Reflection across diagonal         | 3                                        | 4                                                        |
| Reflection across side bisector    | 3                                        | 0                                                        |

by a reflection across a diagonal. Table 29.2 summarizes the information needed to apply Burnside’s Theorem.

So, there are

$$\frac{1}{12} (1 \cdot 20 + 1 \cdot 0 + 2 \cdot 2 + 2 \cdot 0 + 3 \cdot 4 + 3 \cdot 0) = 3$$

nonequivalent ways to string three black beads and three white beads on a necklace.

Now that we have gotten our feet wet on a few easy problems, let’s try a more difficult one. Suppose that we have the colors red (R), white (W), and blue (B) that can be used to color the edges of a regular tetrahedron (see Figure 5.1). First, observe that there are  $3^6 = 729$  colorings without regard to equivalence. How shall we decide when two colorings of the tetrahedron are nonequivalent? Certainly, if we were to pick up a tetrahedron colored in a certain manner, rotate it, and put it back down, we would think of the tetrahedron as being positioned differently rather than as being colored differently (just as if we picked up a die labeled in the usual way and rolled it, we would not say that the die is now differently labeled). So, our permutation group for this problem is just the group of 12 rotations of the tetrahedron shown in Figure 5.1 and is isomorphic to  $A_4$ . (The group consists of the identity; eight elements of order 3, each of which fixes one vertex; and three elements of order 2, each of which fixes no vertex.) Every rotation permutes the 729 colorings, and to apply Burnside’s Theorem we must determine the size of  $\text{fix}(\phi)$  for each of the 12 rotations of the group.

Clearly, the identity fixes all 729 colorings. Next, consider the element (234) of order 3, shown in the bottom row, second from the left in Figure 5.1. Suppose that a specific coloring is fixed by this element (that is,



**Table 29.3** Nine Colorings Fixed by (234)

| Edge | Colorings |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |
|------|-----------|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 12   | R         | R | R | W | W | W | B | B | B |
| 13   | R         | R | R | W | W | W | B | B | B |
| 14   | R         | R | R | W | W | W | B | B | B |
| 23   | R         | W | B | W | R | B | B | R | W |
| 34   | R         | W | B | W | R | B | B | R | W |
| 24   | R         | W | B | W | R | B | B | R | W |

the tetrahedron appears to be colored the same before and after this rotation). Since (234) carries edge 12 to edge 13, edge 13 to edge 14, and edge 14 to edge 12, these three edges must agree in color (edge  $ij$  is the edge joining vertex  $i$  and vertex  $j$ ). The same argument shows that the three edges 23, 34, and 42 also must agree in color. So,  $|\text{fix}(234)| = 3^2$ , since there are three choices for each of these two sets of three edges. The nine columns in Table 29.3 show the possible colorings of the two sets of three edges. The analogous analysis applies to the other seven elements of order 3.

Now consider the rotation (12)(34) of order 2. (See the second tetrahedron in the top row in Figure 5.1.) Since edges 12 and 34 are fixed, they may be colored in any way and will appear the same after the rotation (12)(34). This yields  $3 \cdot 3$  choices for those two edges. Since edge 13 is carried to edge 24, these two edges must agree in color. Similarly, edges 23 and 14 must agree. So, we have three choices for the pair of edges 13 and 24 and three choices for the pair of edges 23 and 14. This means that we have  $3 \cdot 3 \cdot 3 \cdot 3$  ways to color the tetrahedron that will be equivalent under (12)(34). (Table 29.4 gives the complete list of 81 colorings.) So,  $|\text{fix}((12)(34))| = 3^4$ , and the other two elements of order 2 yield the same results.

Now that we have analyzed the three types of group elements, we can apply Burnside's Theorem. In particular, the number of distinct

**Table 29.4** 81 Colorings Fixed by (12)(34) (X and Y can be any of R, W, and B)

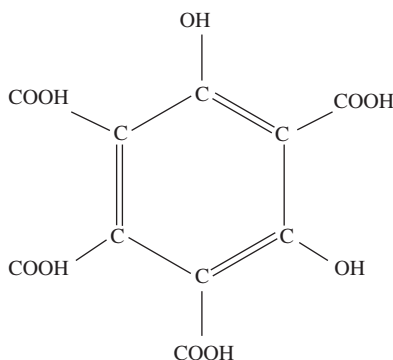
| Edge | Colorings |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |
|------|-----------|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 12   | X         | X | X | X | X | X | X | X | X |
| 34   | Y         | Y | Y | Y | Y | Y | Y | Y | Y |
| 13   | R         | R | R | W | W | W | B | B | B |
| 24   | R         | R | R | W | W | W | B | B | B |
| 23   | R         | W | B | W | R | B | B | R | W |
| 14   | R         | W | B | W | R | B | B | R | W |

colorings of the edges of a tetrahedron with three colors is

$$\frac{1}{12} (1 \cdot 3^6 + 8 \cdot 3^2 + 3 \cdot 3^4) = 87.$$

Surely it would be a difficult task to solve this problem without Burnside's Theorem.

Just as surely, you are wondering who besides mathematicians are interested in counting problems such as the ones we have discussed. Well, chemists are. Indeed, one set of benzene derivatives can be viewed as six carbon atoms arranged in a hexagon with one of the three radicals  $\text{NH}_2$ ,  $\text{COOH}$ , or  $\text{OH}$  attached at each carbon atom. See Figure 29.4 for one example.



**Figure 29.4** A benzene derivative

So Burnside's Theorem enables a chemist to determine the number of benzene molecules (see Exercise 4). Another kind of molecule considered by chemists is visualized as a regular tetrahedron with a carbon atom at the center and any of the four radicals  $\text{HOCH}_2$  (hydroxymethyl),  $\text{C}_2\text{H}_5$  (ethyl),  $\text{Cl}$  (chlorine), or  $\text{H}$  (hydrogen) at the four vertices. Again, the number of such molecules can be easily counted using Burnside's Theorem.

## Group Action

Our informal approach to counting the number of objects that are considered nonequivalent can be made formal as follows. If  $G$  is a group and  $S$  is a set of objects, we say that  $G$  acts on  $S$  if there is a homomorphism  $\gamma$  from  $G$  to  $\text{sym}(S)$ , the group of all permutations on  $S$ . (The homomorphism is sometimes called the *group action*.) For convenience, we denote the image of  $g$  under  $\gamma$  as  $\gamma_g$ . Then two objects  $x$  and  $y$  in  $S$  are viewed as equivalent under the action of  $G$  if and only if  $\gamma_g(x) = y$  for some  $g$  in  $G$ .

Notice that when  $\gamma$  is one-to-one, the elements of  $G$  may be regarded as permutations on  $S$ . On the other hand, when  $\gamma$  is not one-to-one, the elements of  $G$  may still be regarded as permutations on  $S$ , but there are distinct elements  $g$  and  $h$  in  $G$  such that  $\gamma_g$  and  $\gamma_h$  induce the same permutation on  $S$  [that is,  $\gamma_g(x) = \gamma_h(x)$  for all  $x$  in  $S$ ]. Thus, a group acting on a set is a natural generalization of the permutation group concept.

As an example of group action, let  $S$  be the two diagonals of a square and let  $G$  be  $D_4$ , the group of symmetries of the square. Then  $\gamma_{R_0}, \gamma_{R_{180}}, \gamma_{D'}, \gamma_{D''}$  are the identity;  $\gamma_{R_{90}}, \gamma_{R_{270}}, \gamma_{H'}, \gamma_V$  interchange the two diagonals; and the mapping  $g \rightarrow \gamma_g$  from  $D_4$  to  $\text{sym}(S)$  is a group homomorphism. As a second example, note that  $GL(n, F)$ , the group of invertible  $n \times n$  matrices with entries from a field  $F$ , acts on the set  $S$  of  $n \times 1$  column vectors with entries from  $F$  by multiplying the vectors on the left by the matrices. In this case, the mapping  $g \rightarrow \gamma_g$  from  $GL(n, F)$  to  $\text{sym}(S)$  is a one-to-one homomorphism.

We have used group actions several times in this text without calling them that. The proof of Cayley's Theorem (Theorem 6.1) has a group  $G$  acting on the elements of  $G$ ; the proofs of Sylow's Second Theorem and Third Theorem (Theorems 24.4 and 24.5) have a group acting on the set of conjugates of a Sylow  $p$ -subgroup; and the proof of the Generalized Cayley Theorem (Theorem 25.3) has  $G$  acting on the left cosets of a subgroup  $H$ .

## Exercises

The greater the difficulty, the more glory in surmounting it.

Epicurus

1. Determine the number of ways in which the four corners of a square can be colored with two colors. (It is permissible to use a single color on all four corners.)
2. Determine the number of different necklaces that can be made using 13 white beads and 3 black beads.
3. Determine the number of ways in which the vertices of an equilateral triangle can be colored with five colors so that at least two colors are used.
4. A benzene molecule can be modeled as six carbon atoms arranged in a regular hexagon in a plane. At each carbon atom, one of three radicals  $\text{NH}_2$ ,  $\text{COOH}$ , or  $\text{OH}$  can be attached. How many such compounds are possible? (Make no distinction between single and double bonds between the atoms.)

5. Suppose that in Exercise 4 we permit only  $\text{NH}_2$  and  $\text{COOH}$  for the radicals. How many compounds are possible?
6. Determine the number of ways in which the faces of a regular dodecahedron (regular 12-sided solid) can be colored with three colors.
7. Determine the number of ways in which the edges of a square can be colored with six colors so that no color is used on more than one edge.
8. Determine the number of ways in which the edges of a square can be colored with six colors with no restriction placed on the number of times a color can be used.
9. Determine the number of different 11-bead necklaces that can be made using two colors.
10. Determine the number of ways in which the faces of a cube can be colored with three colors.
11. Suppose a cake is cut into six identical pieces. How many ways can we color the cake with  $n$  colors assuming that each piece receives one color?
12. How many ways can the five points of a five-pointed crown be painted if three colors of paint are available?
13. Let  $G$  be a finite group and let  $\text{sym}(G)$  be the group of all permutations on  $G$ . For each  $g$  in  $G$ , let  $\phi_g$  denote the element of  $\text{sym}(G)$  defined by  $\phi_g(x) = gxg^{-1}$  for all  $x$  in  $G$ . Show that  $G$  acts on itself under the action  $g \rightarrow \phi_g$ . Give an example in which the mapping  $g \rightarrow \phi_g$  is not one-to-one.
14. Let  $G$  be a finite group, let  $H$  be a subgroup of  $G$ , and let  $S$  be the set of left cosets of  $H$  in  $G$ . For each  $g$  in  $G$ , let  $\gamma_g$  denote the element of  $\text{sym}(S)$  defined by  $\gamma_g(xH) = gxH$ . Show that  $G$  acts on  $S$  under the action  $g \rightarrow \gamma_g$ .
15. For a fixed square, let  $L_1$  be the perpendicular bisector of the top and bottom of the square and let  $L_2$  be the perpendicular bisector of the left and right sides. Show that  $D_4$  acts on  $\{L_1, L_2\}$  and determine the kernel of the mapping  $g \rightarrow \gamma_g$ .

## Suggested Readings

Doris Schattschneider, "Escher's Combinatorial Patterns," *Electronic Journal of Combinatorics* 4(2) (1997): R17.

This article discusses a combinatorial problem concerning generating periodic patterns that the artist M. C. Escher posed and solved in an algorithmic way. The problem can also be solved by using Burnside's Theorem. The article can be downloaded free from the website <http://www.combinatorics.org/>

## William Burnside

In one of the most abstract domains of thought, he [Burnside] has systematized and amplified its range so that, there, his work stands as a landmark in the widening expanse of knowledge. Whatever be the estimate of Burnside made by posterity, contemporaries salute him as a Master among the mathematicians of his own generation.

A. R. FORSYTH



By permission of the Master and Fellows of Pembroke College in the University of Oxford

WILLIAM BURNSIDE was born on July 2, 1852, in London. After graduating from Cambridge University in 1875, Burnside was appointed lecturer at Cambridge, where he stayed until 1885. He then accepted a position at the Royal Naval College at Greenwich and spent the rest of his career in that post.

Burnside wrote more than 150 research papers in many fields. He is best remembered, however, for his pioneering work in group theory and his classic book *Theory of Groups*, which first appeared in 1897. Because of Burnside's emphasis on the abstract approach, many consider him to be the first pure group theorist.

One mark of greatness in a mathematician is the ability to pose important and challenging problems—problems that open up new areas of research for future generations. Here, Burnside excelled. It was he who first conjectured that a group  $G$  of odd

order has a series of normal subgroups,  $G = G_0 \geq G_1 \geq G_2 \geq \cdots \geq G_n = \{e\}$ , such that  $G_i/G_{i+1}$  is Abelian. This extremely important conjecture was finally proved more than 50 years later by Feit and Thompson in a 255-page paper (see Chapter 25 for more on this). In 1994, Efim Zelmanov received the Fields Medal for his work on a variation of one of Burnside's conjectures.

Burnside was elected a Fellow of the Royal Society and awarded two Royal Medals. He served as president of the Council of the London Mathematical Society and received its De Morgan Medal. Burnside died on August 21, 1927.

To find more information about Burnside, visit:

<http://www-groups.dcs.st-and.ac.uk/~history/>

# 30 Cayley Digraphs of Groups

The important thing in science is not so much to obtain new facts as to discover new ways of thinking about them.

Sir William Lawrence Bragg, *Beyond Reductionism*

The changing of a vague difficulty into a specific, concrete form is a very essential element in thinking.

J. P. Morgan

## Motivation

In this chapter, we introduce a graphical representation of a group given by a set of generators and relations. The idea was originated by Cayley in 1878. Although this topic is not usually covered in an abstract algebra book, we include it for five reasons: It provides a method of visualizing a group; it connects two important branches of modern mathematics—groups and graphs; it has many applications to computer science; it gives a review of some of our old friends—cyclic groups, dihedral groups, direct products, and generators and relations; and, most importantly, it is fun!

Intuitively, a directed graph (or digraph) is a finite set of points, called *vertices*, and a set of arrows, called *arcs*, connecting some of the vertices. Although there is a rich and important general theory of directed graphs with many applications, we are interested only in those that arise from groups.

## The Cayley Digraph of a Group

### **Definition** Cayley Digraph of a Group

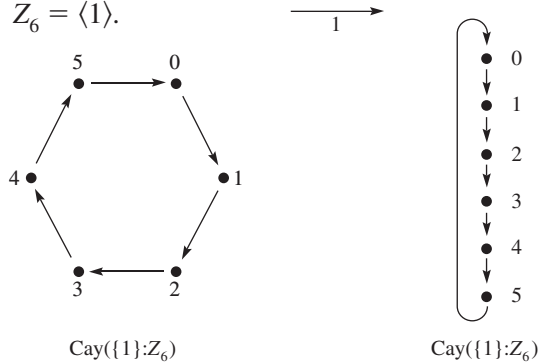
Let  $G$  be a finite group and let  $S$  be a set of generators for  $G$ . We define a digraph  $\text{Cay}(S;G)$ , called the *Cayley digraph of  $G$  with generating set  $S$* , as follows.

1. Each element of  $G$  is a vertex of  $\text{Cay}(S;G)$ .
2. For  $x$  and  $y$  in  $G$ , there is an arc from  $x$  to  $y$  if and only if  $xs = y$  for some  $s \in S$ .

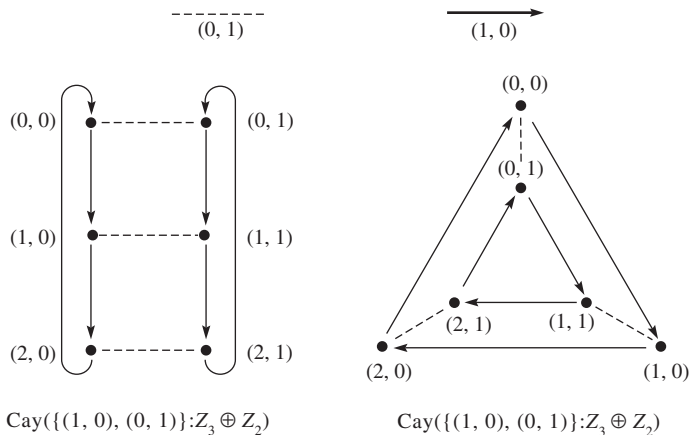
To tell from the digraph which particular generator connects two vertices, Cayley proposed that each generator be assigned a color, and that the arrow joining  $x$  to  $xs$  be colored with the color assigned to  $s$ . He called the resulting figure the *color graph of the group*. This terminology is still used occasionally. Rather than use colors to distinguish the different generators, we will use solid arrows, dashed arrows, and dotted arrows. In general, if there is an arc from  $x$  to  $y$ , there need not be an arc from  $y$  to  $x$ . An arrow emanating from  $x$  and pointing to  $y$  indicates that there is an arc from  $x$  to  $y$ .

Following are numerous examples of Cayley digraphs. Note that there are several ways to draw the digraph of a group given by a particular generating set. However, it is not the appearance of the digraph that is relevant but the manner in which the vertices are connected. These connections are uniquely determined by the generating set. Thus, distances between vertices and angles formed by the arcs have no significance. (In the digraphs below, a headless arrow joining two vertices  $x$  and  $y$  indicates that there is an arc from  $x$  to  $y$  and an arc from  $y$  to  $x$ . This occurs when the generating set contains both an element and its inverse. For example, a generator of order 2 is its own inverse.)

■ **EXAMPLE 1**  $Z_6 = \langle 1 \rangle$ .



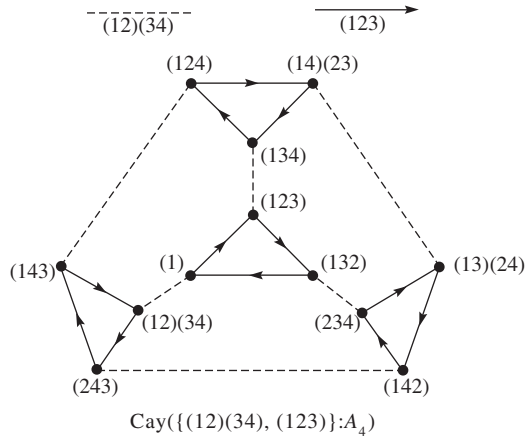
■ **EXAMPLE 2**  $Z_3 \oplus Z_2 = \langle (1, 0), (0, 1) \rangle$ .



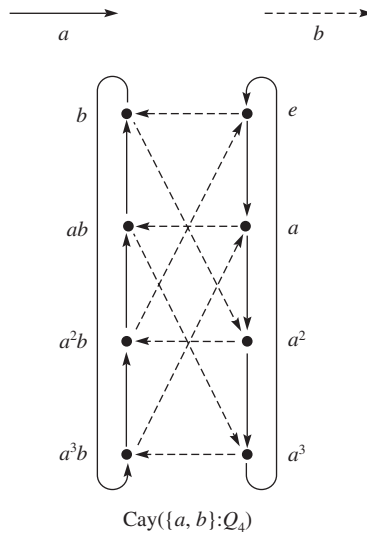




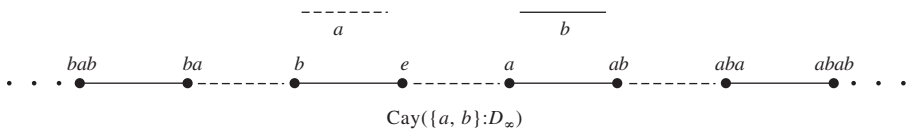
■ **EXAMPLE 6**  $A_4 = \langle (12)(34), (123) \rangle$ .



■ **EXAMPLE 7**  $Q_4 = \langle a, b \mid a^4 = e, a^2 = b^2, b^{-1}ab = a^3 \rangle$ .



■ **EXAMPLE 8**  $D_\infty = \langle a, b \mid a^2 = b^2 = e \rangle$ .



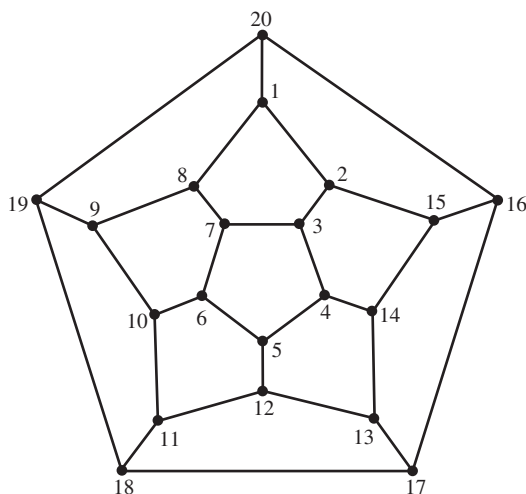
The Cayley digraph provides a quick and easy way to determine the value of any product of the generators and their inverses. Consider, for example, the product  $ab^3ab^{-2}$  from the group given in Example 7. To reduce this to one of the eight elements used to label the vertices, we need

only begin at the vertex  $e$  and follow the arcs from each vertex to the next as specified in the given product. Of course,  $b^{-1}$  means traverse the  $b$  arc in reverse. (Observations such as  $b^{-3} = b$  also help.) Tracing the product through, we obtain  $b$ . Similarly, one can verify or discover other relations among the generators.

## Hamiltonian Circuits and Paths

Now that we have these directed graphs, what is it that we care to know about them? One question about directed graphs that has been the object of much research was popularized by the Irish mathematician Sir William Hamilton in 1859, when he invented a puzzle called “Around the World.” His idea was to label the 20 vertices of a regular dodecahedron with the names of famous cities. One solves this puzzle by starting at any particular city (vertex) and traveling “around the world,” moving along the arcs in such a way that each other city is visited exactly once before returning to the original starting point. One solution to this puzzle is given in Figure 30.1, where the vertices are visited in the order indicated.

Obviously, this idea can be applied to any digraph; that is, one starts at some vertex and attempts to traverse the digraph by moving along



**Figure 30.1** Around the World.

arcs in such a way that each vertex is visited exactly once before returning to the starting vertex. (To go from  $x$  to  $y$ , there must be an arc from  $x$  to  $y$ .) Such a sequence of arcs is called a *Hamiltonian circuit* in the digraph. A sequence of arcs that passes through each vertex exactly

once without returning to the starting point is called a *Hamiltonian path*. In the rest of this chapter, we concern ourselves with the existence of Hamiltonian circuits and paths in Cayley digraphs.

Figures 30.2 and 30.3 show a Hamiltonian path for the digraph given in Example 2 and a Hamiltonian circuit for the digraph given in Example 7, respectively.

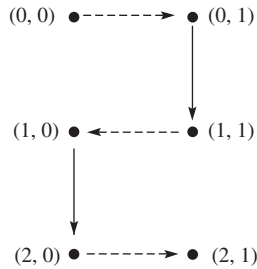
Is there a Hamiltonian circuit in

$$\text{Cay}(\{(1, 0), (0, 1)\}; \mathbb{Z}_3 \oplus \mathbb{Z}_2)?$$

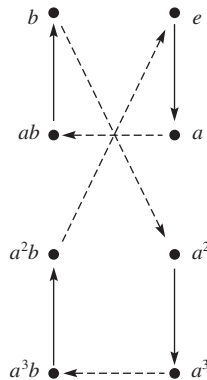
More generally, let us investigate the existence of Hamiltonian circuits in

$$\text{Cay}(\{(1, 0), (0, 1)\}; \mathbb{Z}_m \oplus \mathbb{Z}_n),$$

where  $m$  and  $n$  are relatively prime and both are greater than 1. Visualize the Cayley digraph as a rectangular grid coordinatized with  $\mathbb{Z}_m \oplus \mathbb{Z}_n$ , as



**Figure 30.2** Hamiltonian path in  $\text{Cay}(\{(1, 0), (0, 1)\}; \mathbb{Z}_3 \oplus \mathbb{Z}_2)$  from  $(0, 0)$  to  $(2, 1)$ .



**Figure 30.3** Hamiltonian circuit in  $\text{Cay}(\{a, b\}; \mathbb{Q}_4)$ .

in Figure 30.4. Suppose there is a Hamiltonian circuit in the digraph and  $(a, b)$  is some vertex from which the circuit exits horizontally. (Clearly, such a vertex exists.) Then the circuit must exit  $(a - 1, b + 1)$  horizontally

also, for otherwise the circuit passes through  $(a, b + 1)$  twice—see Figure 30.5. Repeating this argument again and again, we see that the circuit exits horizontally from each of the vertices  $(a, b)$ ,  $(a - 1, b + 1)$ ,  $(a - 2, b + 2)$ ,  $\dots$ , which is just the coset  $(a, b) + \langle(-1, 1)\rangle$ . But when  $m$  and  $n$  are relatively prime,  $\langle(-1, 1)\rangle$  is the entire group. Obviously, there cannot be a Hamiltonian circuit consisting entirely of horizontal moves. Let us record what we have just proved.

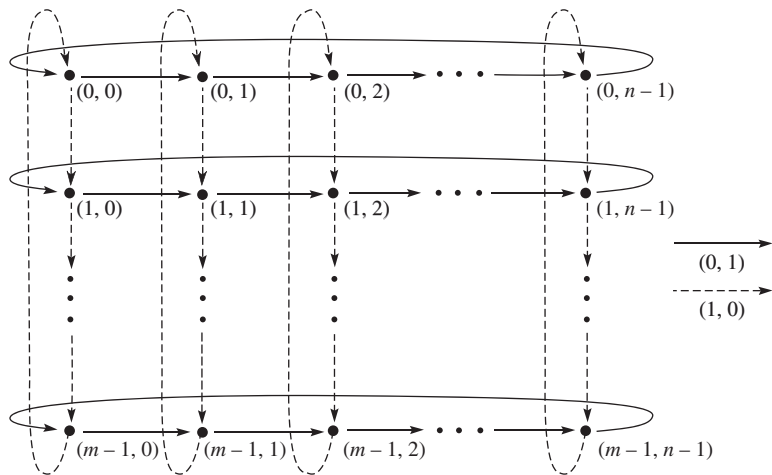


Figure 30.4  $\text{Cay}(\{(1, 0), (0, 1)\}; \mathbb{Z}_m \oplus \mathbb{Z}_n)$ .

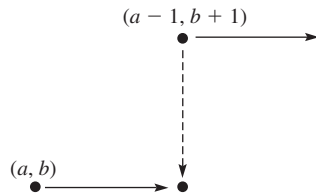


Figure 30.5

**Theorem 30.1** A Necessary Condition

*$\text{Cay}(\{(1, 0), (0, 1)\}; \mathbb{Z}_m \oplus \mathbb{Z}_n)$  does not have a Hamiltonian circuit when  $m$  and  $n$  are relatively prime and greater than 1.*

What about when  $m$  and  $n$  are not relatively prime? In general, the answer is somewhat complicated, but the following special case is easy to prove.

# Theorem 30.2 A Sufficient Condition

$\text{Cay}(\{(1, 0), (0, 1)\}; \mathbb{Z}_m \oplus \mathbb{Z}_n)$  has a Hamiltonian circuit when  $n$  divides  $m$ .

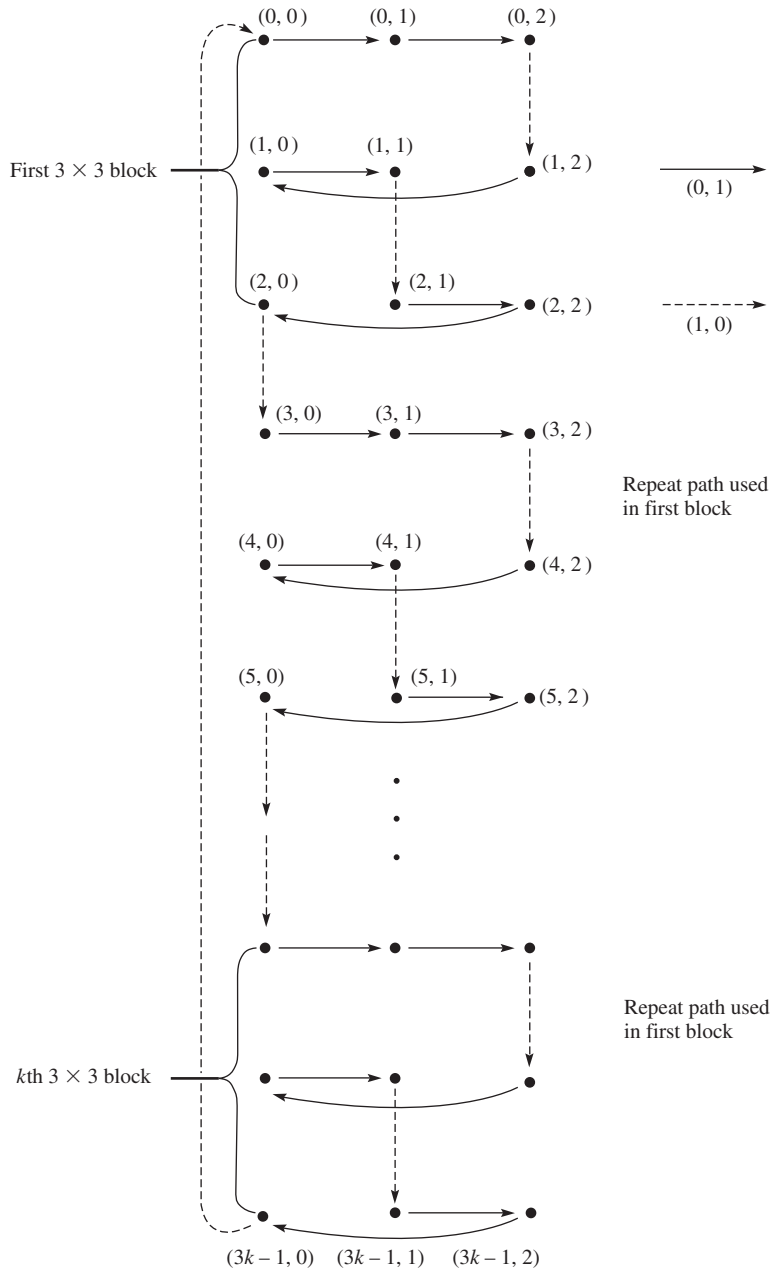


Figure 30.6  $\text{Cay}(\{(1, 0), (0, 1)\}; \mathbb{Z}_{3k} \oplus \mathbb{Z}_3)$ .

**PROOF** Say  $m = kn$ . Then we may think of  $Z_m \oplus Z_n$  as  $k$  blocks of size  $n \times n$ . (See Figure 30.6 for an example.) Start at  $(0, 0)$  and cover the vertices of the top block as follows. Use the generator  $(0, 1)$  to move horizontally across the first row to the end. Then use the generator  $(1, 0)$  to move vertically to the point below, and cover the remaining points in the second row by moving horizontally. Keep this process up until the point  $(n - 1, 0)$ —the lower left-hand corner of the first block—has been reached. Next, move vertically to the second block and repeat the process used in the first block. Keep this up until the bottom block is covered. Complete the circuit by moving vertically back to  $(0, 0)$ . ■

Notice that the circuit given in the proof of Theorem 30.2 is easy to visualize but somewhat cumbersome to describe in words. A much more convenient way to describe a Hamiltonian path or circuit is to specify the starting vertex and the sequence of generators in the order in which they are to be applied. In Example 5, for instance, we may start at  $(1)$  and alternate the generators  $(12)$  and  $(13)$  until we return to  $(1)$ . In Example 3, we may start at  $R_0$  and successively apply  $R_{90}, R_{90}, R_{90}, H, R_{90}, R_{90}, R_{90}, H$ . When  $k$  is a positive integer and  $a, b, \dots, c$  is a sequence of group elements, we use  $k * (a, b, \dots, c)$  to denote the concatenation of  $k$  copies of the sequence  $(a, b, \dots, c)$ . Thus,  $2 * (R_{90}, R_{90}, R_{90}, H)$  and  $2 * (3 * R_{90}, H)$  both mean  $R_{90}, R_{90}, R_{90}, H, R_{90}, R_{90}, R_{90}, H$ . With this notation, we may conveniently denote the Hamiltonian circuit given in Theorem 30.2 as

$$m * ((n - 1) * (0, 1), (1, 0)).$$

We leave it as an exercise (Exercise 11) to show that if  $x_1, x_2, \dots, x_n$  is a sequence of generators determining a Hamiltonian circuit starting at some vertex, then the same sequence determines a Hamiltonian circuit for any starting vertex.

From Theorem 30.1, we know that there are some Cayley digraphs of Abelian groups that do not have any Hamiltonian circuits. But Theorem 30.3 shows that each of these Cayley digraphs does have a Hamiltonian path. There are some Cayley digraphs for *non-Abelian* groups that do not even have Hamiltonian paths, but we will not discuss them here.

### ■ Theorem 30.3 Abelian Groups Have Hamiltonian Paths

*Let  $G$  be a finite Abelian group, and let  $S$  be any (nonempty<sup>†</sup>) generating set for  $G$ . Then  $\text{Cay}(S; G)$  has a Hamiltonian path.*

<sup>†</sup>If  $S$  is the empty set, it is customary to define  $\langle S \rangle$  as the identity group. We prefer to ignore this trivial case.

**PROOF** We use induction on  $|S|$ . If  $|S| = 1$ , say,  $S = \{a\}$ , then the digraph is just a circle labeled with  $e, a, a^2, \dots, a^{m-1}$ , where  $|a| = m$ . Obviously, there is a Hamiltonian path for this case. Now assume that  $|S| > 1$ . Choose some  $s \in S$ . Let  $T = S - \{s\}$ —that is,  $T$  is  $S$  with  $s$  removed—and set  $H = \langle s_1, s_2, \dots, s_{n-1} \rangle$  where  $S = \{s_1, s_2, \dots, s_n\}$  and  $s = s_n$ . (Notice that  $H$  may be equal to  $G$ .)

Because  $|T| < |S|$  and  $H$  is a finite Abelian group, the induction hypothesis guarantees that there is a Hamiltonian path  $(a_1, a_2, \dots, a_k)$  in  $\text{Cay}(T:H)$ . We will show that

$$(a_1, a_2, \dots, a_k, s, a_1, a_2, \dots, a_k, s, \dots, a_1, a_2, \dots, a_k, s, a_1, a_2, \dots, a_k),$$

where  $a_1, a_2, \dots, a_k$  occurs  $|G|/|H|$  times and  $s$  occurs  $|G|/|H| - 1$  times, is a Hamiltonian path in  $\text{Cay}(S:G)$ .

Because  $S = T \cup \{s\}$  and  $T$  generates  $H$ , the coset  $Hs$  generates the factor group  $G/H$ . (Since  $G$  is Abelian, this group exists.) Hence, the cosets of  $H$  are  $H, Hs, Hs^2, \dots, Hs^n$ , where  $n = |G|/|H| - 1$ . Starting from the identity element of  $G$ , the path given by  $(a_1, a_2, \dots, a_k)$  visits each element of  $H$  exactly once [because  $(a_1, a_2, \dots, a_k)$  is a Hamiltonian path in  $\text{Cay}(T:H)$ ]. The generator  $s$  then moves us to some element of the coset  $Hs$ . Starting from there, the path  $(a_1, a_2, \dots, a_k)$  visits each element of  $Hs$  exactly once. Then,  $s$  moves us to the coset  $Hs^2$ , and we visit each element of this coset exactly once. Continuing this process, we successively move to  $Hs^3, Hs^4, \dots, Hs^n$ , visiting each vertex in each of these cosets exactly once. Because each vertex of  $\text{Cay}(S:G)$  is in exactly one coset  $Hs^i$ , this implies that we visit each vertex of  $\text{Cay}(S:G)$  exactly once. Thus, we have a Hamiltonian path. ■

We next look at Cayley digraphs with three generators.

■ **EXAMPLE 9** Let

$$D_3 = \langle r, f \mid r^3 = f^2 = e, rf = fr^2 \rangle.$$

Then a Hamiltonian circuit in

$$\text{Cay}(\{(r, 0), (f, 0), (e, 1)\} : D_3 \oplus \mathbb{Z}_6)$$

is given in Figure 30.7. ■

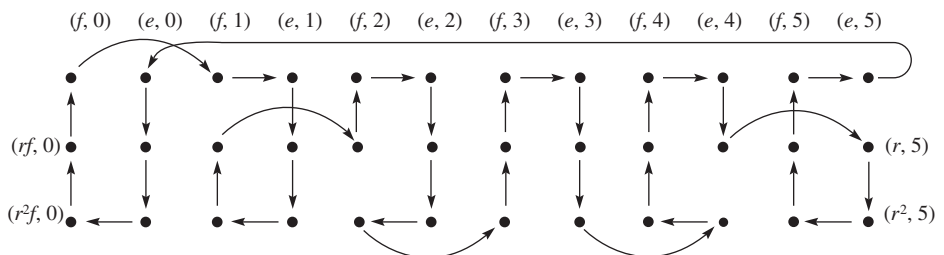


Figure 30.7

Although it is not easy to prove, it is true that

$$\text{Cay}(\{(r, 0), (f, 0), (e, 1)\}:D_n \oplus Z_m)$$

has a Hamiltonian circuit for all  $n$  and  $m$ . (See [3].) Example 10 shows the circuit for this digraph when  $m$  is even.

■ **EXAMPLE 10** Let

$$D_n = \langle r, f \mid r^n = f^2 = e, rf = fr^{-1} \rangle.$$

Then a Hamiltonian circuit in

$$\text{Cay}(\{(r, 0), (f, 0), (e, 1)\}:D_n \oplus Z_m)$$

with  $m$  even is traced in Figure 30.8. The sequence of generators that traces the circuit is

$$m * [(n - 1) * (r, 0), (f, 0), (n - 1) * (r, 0), (e, 1)]. \quad \blacksquare$$

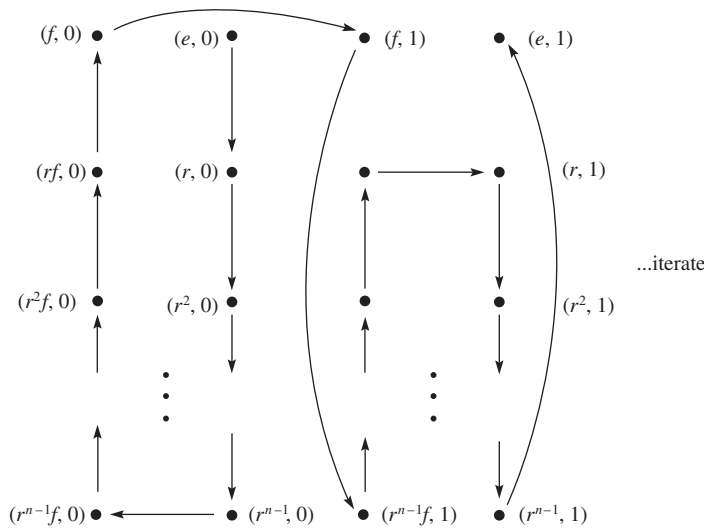


Figure 30.8

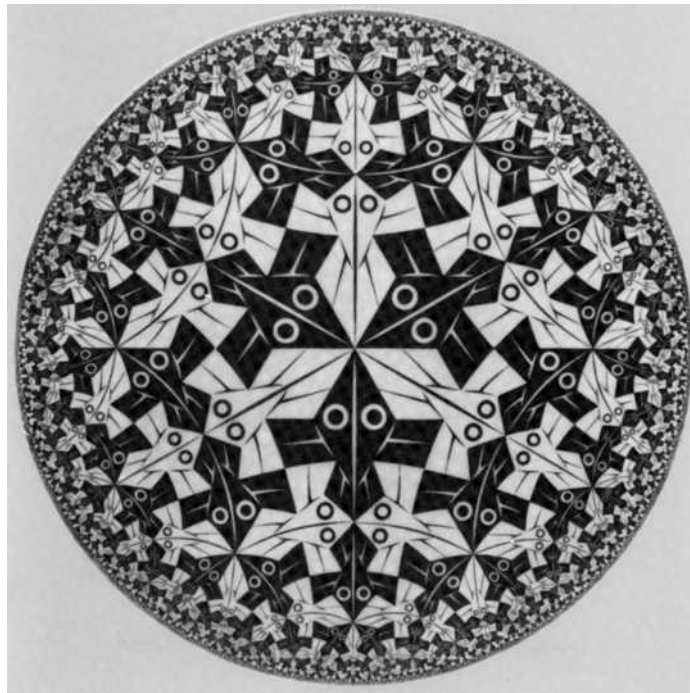
### Some Applications

Cayley digraphs are natural models for interconnection networks in computer designs, and Hamiltonicity is an important property in relation to sorting algorithms on such networks. One particular Cayley digraph that is used to design and analyze interconnection networks of parallel machines is the symmetric group  $S_n$  with the set of all transpositions as the generating set. Hamiltonian paths and circuits in Cayley digraphs



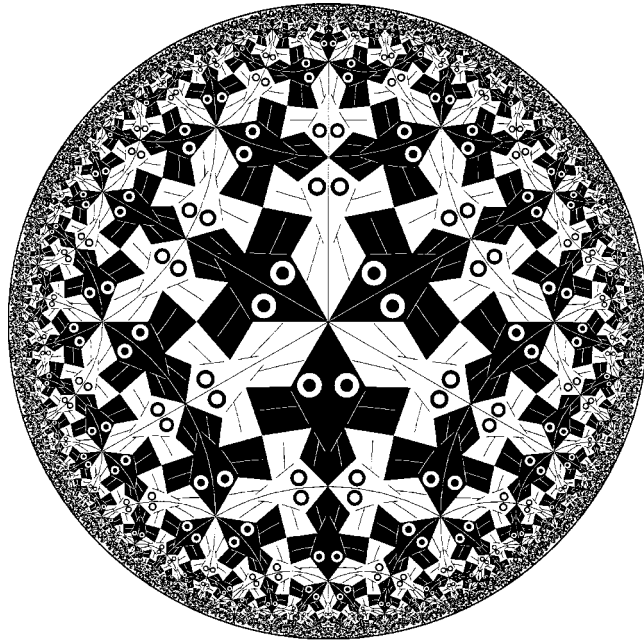
arise in a variety of group theory contexts. A Hamiltonian path in a Cayley digraph of a group is simply an ordered listing of the group elements without repetition. The vertices of the digraph are the group elements, and the arcs of the path are generators of the group. In 1948, R. A. Rankin used these ideas (although not the terminology) to prove that certain bell-ringing exercises could not be done by the traditional methods employed by bell ringers. (See [1, Chap. 22] for the group theoretic aspects of bell ringing.) In 1981, Hamiltonian paths in Cayley digraphs were used in an algorithm for creating computer graphics of Escher-type repeating patterns in the hyperbolic plane [2]. This program can produce repeating hyperbolic patterns in color from among various infinite classes of symmetry groups. The program has now been improved so that the user may choose from many kinds of color symmetry. The 2003 Mathematics Awareness Month poster featured one such image (see <http://www.mathaware.org/mam/03/index.html>). Two Escher drawings and their computer-drawn counterparts are given in Figures 30.9 through 30.12.

In this chapter, we have shown how one may construct a directed graph from a group. It is also possible to associate a group—called the *automorphism group*—with every directed graph. In fact, several of the 26 sporadic simple groups were first constructed in this way.



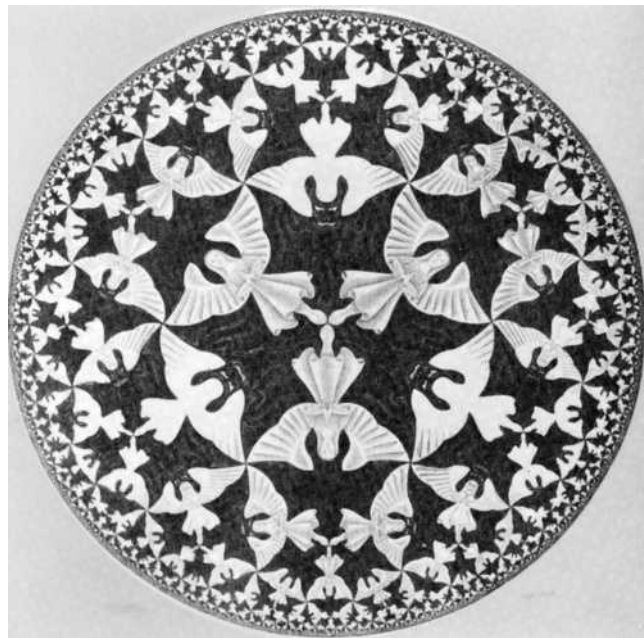
M.C. Escher's Circle Limit I © 2004 The M.C. Escher Company-Baam Holland. All rights reserved.

**Figure 30.9** M. C. Escher's *Circle Limit I*.



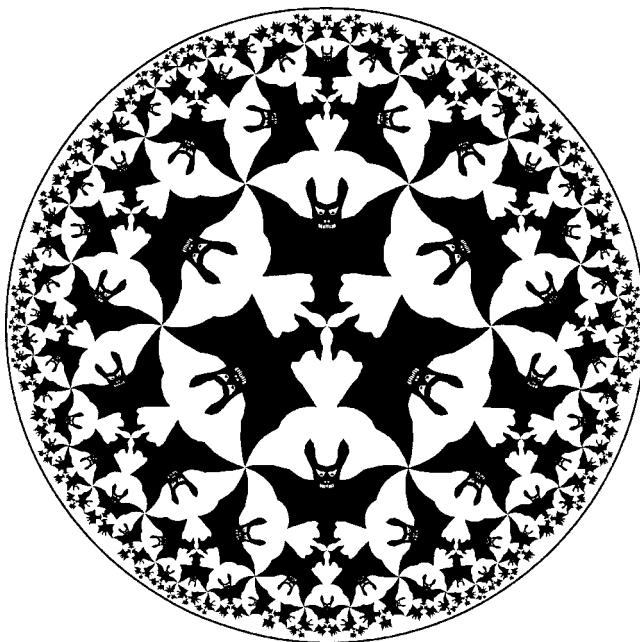
M.C. Escher's Circle Limit I © 2004 The M.C. Escher Company-Baam Holland. All rights reserved.

**Figure 30.10** A computer duplication of the pattern of M. C. Escher's *Circle Limit I* [2]. The program used a Hamiltonian path in a Cayley digraph of the underlying symmetry group.



M.C. Escher's Circle Limit IV © 2004 The M.C. Escher Company-Baam Holland. All rights reserved.

**Figure 30.11** M. C. Escher's *Circle Limit IV*.



M.C. Escher's Circle Limit IV © 2004 The M.C. Escher Company-Baam Holland. All rights reserved.

**Figure 30.12** A computer drawing inspired by the pattern of M. C. Escher's *Circle Limit IV* [2]. The program used a Hamiltonian path in a Cayley digraph of the underlying symmetry group.

## Exercises

A mathematician is a machine for turning coffee into theorems.

Paul Erdős

1. Find a Hamiltonian circuit in the digraph given in Example 7 different from the one in Figure 30.3.
2. Find a Hamiltonian circuit in

$$\text{Cay}(\{(a, 0), (b, 0), (e, 1)\}; \mathcal{Q}_4 \oplus \mathbb{Z}_2).$$

3. Find a Hamiltonian circuit in

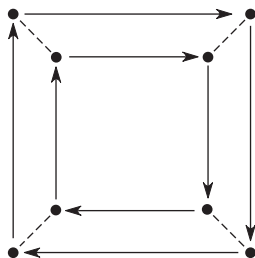
$$\text{Cay}(\{(a, 0), (b, 0), (e, 1)\}; \mathcal{Q}_4 \oplus \mathbb{Z}_m)$$

where  $m$  is even.

4. Write the sequence of generators for each of the circuits found in Exercises 1, 2, and 3.
5. Use the Cayley digraph in Example 7 to evaluate the product  $a^3ba^{-1}ba^3b^{-1}$ .
6. Let  $x$  and  $y$  be two vertices of a Cayley digraph. Explain why two paths from  $x$  to  $y$  in the digraph yield a group relation—that is, an

equation of the form  $a_1 a_2 \cdots a_m = b_1 b_2 \cdots b_n$ , where the  $a_i$ 's and  $b_j$ 's are generators of the Cayley digraph.

7. Use the Cayley digraph in Example 7 to verify the relation  $aba^{-1}b^{-1}a^{-1}b^{-1} = a^2ba^3$ .
8. Identify the following Cayley digraph of a familiar group.



9. Let  $D_4 = \langle r, f \mid r^4 = e = f^2, rf = fr^{-1} \rangle$ . Verify that

$$6 * [3 * (r, 0), (f, 0), 3 * (r, 0), (e, 1)]$$

is a Hamiltonian circuit in

$$\text{Cay}(\{(r, 0), (f, 0), (e, 1)\}; D_4 \oplus Z_6).$$

10. Draw a picture of  $\text{Cay}(\{2, 5\}; Z_8)$ .
11. If  $s_1, s_2, \dots, s_n$  is a sequence of generators that determines a Hamiltonian circuit beginning at some vertex, explain why the same sequence determines a Hamiltonian circuit beginning at any point. (This exercise is referred to in this chapter.)
12. Show that the Cayley digraph given in Example 7 has a Hamiltonian path from  $e$  to  $a$ .
13. Show that there is no Hamiltonian path in

$$\text{Cay}(\{(1, 0), (0, 1)\}; Z_3 \oplus Z_2)$$

from  $(0, 0)$  to  $(2, 0)$ .

14. Draw  $\text{Cay}(\{2, 3\}; Z_6)$ . Is there a Hamiltonian circuit in this digraph?
15. **a.** Let  $G$  be a group of order  $n$  generated by a set  $S$ . Show that a sequence  $s_1, s_2, \dots, s_{n-1}$  of elements of  $S$  is a Hamiltonian path in  $\text{Cay}(S; G)$  if and only if, for all  $i$  and  $j$  with  $1 \leq i \leq j < n$ , we have  $s_i s_{i+1} \cdots s_j \neq e$ .  
**b.** Show that the sequence  $s_1 s_2 \cdots s_n$  is a Hamiltonian circuit if and only if  $s_1 s_2 \cdots s_n = e$ , and that whenever  $1 \leq i \leq j < n$ , we have  $s_i s_{i+1} \cdots s_j \neq e$ .
16. Let  $D_4 = \langle a, b \mid a^2 = b^2 = (ab)^4 = e \rangle$ . Draw  $\text{Cay}(\{a, b\}; D_4)$ . Why is it reasonable to say that this digraph is undirected?
17. Let  $D_n$  be as in Example 10. Show that  $2 * [(n-1) * r, f]$  is a Hamiltonian circuit in  $\text{Cay}(\{r, f\}; D_n)$ .

18. Let  $Q_8 = \langle a, b \mid a^8 = e, a^4 = b^2, b^{-1}ab = a^{-1} \rangle$ . Find a Hamiltonian circuit in  $\text{Cay}(\{a, b\}; Q_8)$ .
19. Let  $Q_8$  be as in Exercise 18. Find a Hamiltonian circuit in

$$\text{Cay}(\{(a, 0), (b, 0), (e, 1)\}; Q_8 \oplus Z_5).$$

20. Prove that the Cayley digraph given in Example 6 does not have a Hamiltonian circuit. Does it have a Hamiltonian path?
21. Find a Hamiltonian circuit in

$$\text{Cay}(\{(R_{90}, 0), (H, 0), (R_0, 1)\}; D_4 \oplus Z_3).$$

Does this circuit generalize to the case  $D_{n+1} \oplus Z_n$  for all  $n \geq 3$ ?

22. Let  $Q_8$  be as in Exercise 18. Find a Hamiltonian circuit in

$$\text{Cay}(\{(a, 0), (b, 0), (e, 1)\}; Q_8 \oplus Z_m) \text{ for all even } m.$$

23. Find a Hamiltonian circuit in

$$\text{Cay}(\{(a, 0), (b, 0), (e, 1)\}; Q_4 \oplus Z_3).$$

24. Find a Hamiltonian circuit in

$$\text{Cay}(\{(a, 0), (b, 0), (e, 1)\}; Q_4 \oplus Z_m) \text{ for all odd } m \geq 3.$$

25. Write the sequence of generators that describes the Hamiltonian circuit in Example 9.
26. Let  $D_n$  be as in Example 10. Find a Hamiltonian circuit in

$$\text{Cay}(\{(r, 0), (f, 0), (e, 1)\}; D_4 \oplus Z_5).$$

Does your circuit generalize to the case  $D_n \oplus Z_{n+1}$  for all  $n \geq 4$ ?

27. Prove that  $\text{Cay}(\{(0, 1), (1, 1)\}; Z_m \oplus Z_n)$  has a Hamiltonian circuit for all  $m$  and  $n$  greater than 1.
28. Suppose that a Hamiltonian circuit exists for  $\text{Cay}(\{(1, 0), (0, 1)\}; Z_m \oplus Z_n)$  and that this circuit exits from vertex  $(a, b)$  vertically. Show that the circuit exits from every member of the coset  $(a, b) + \langle (1, -1) \rangle$  vertically.
29. Let  $D_2 = \langle r, f \mid r^2 = f^2 = e, rf = fr^{-1} \rangle$ . Find a Hamiltonian circuit in  $\text{Cay}(\{(r, 0), (f, 0), (e, 1)\}; D_2 \oplus Z_3)$ .
30. Let  $Q_8$  be as in Exercise 18. Find a Hamiltonian circuit in  $\text{Cay}(\{(a, 0), (b, 0), (e, 1)\}; Q_8 \oplus Z_3)$ .
31. In  $\text{Cay}(\{(1, 0), (0, 1)\}; Z_4 \oplus Z_5)$ , find a sequence of generators that visits exactly one vertex twice and all others exactly once and returns to the starting vertex.
32. In  $\text{Cay}(\{(1, 0), (0, 1)\}; Z_4 \oplus Z_5)$ , find a sequence of generators that visits exactly two vertices twice and all others exactly once and returns to the starting vertex.

33. Find a Hamiltonian circuit in  $\text{Cay}(\{(1, 0), (0, 1)\}; Z_4 \oplus Z_6)$ .
34. Let  $G$  be the digraph obtained from  $\text{Cay}(\{(1, 0), (0, 1)\}; Z_3 \oplus Z_5)$  by deleting the vertex  $(0, 0)$ . [Also, delete each arc to or from  $(0, 0)$ .] Prove that  $G$  has a Hamiltonian circuit.
35. Prove that the digraph obtained from  $\text{Cay}(\{(1, 0), (0, 1)\}; Z_4 \oplus Z_7)$  by deleting the vertex  $(0, 0)$  has a Hamiltonian circuit.
36. Let  $G$  be a finite group generated by  $a$  and  $b$ . Let  $s_1, s_2, \dots, s_n$  be the arcs of a Hamiltonian circuit in the digraph  $\text{Cay}(\{a, b\}; G)$ . We say that the vertex  $s_1 s_2 \cdots s_i$  *travels by*  $a$  if  $s_{i+1} = a$ . Show that if a vertex  $x$  travels by  $a$ , then every vertex in the coset  $x\langle ab^{-1} \rangle$  travels by  $a$ .
37. A finite group is called *Hamiltonian* if all of its subgroups are normal. (One non-Abelian example is  $Q_4$ .) Show that Theorem 30.3 can be generalized to include all Hamiltonian groups.
38. (Factor Group Lemma) Let  $S$  be a generating set for a group  $G$ , let  $N$  be a cyclic normal subgroup of  $G$ , and let

$$\bar{S} = \{sN \mid s \in S\}.$$

If  $(a_1 N, \dots, a_r N)$  is a Hamiltonian circuit in  $\text{Cay}(\bar{S}; G/N)$  and the product  $a_1 \cdots a_r$  generates  $N$ , prove that

$$|N| * (a_1, \dots, a_r)$$

is a Hamiltonian circuit in  $\text{Cay}(S; G)$ .

## References

1. F. J. Budden, *The Fascination of Groups*, Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 1972.
2. Douglas Dunham, John Lindgren, and David Witte, "Creating Repeating Hyperbolic Patterns," *Computer Graphics* 15 (1981): 215–223.
3. David Witte, Gail Letzter, and Joseph A. Gallian, "On Hamiltonian Circuits in Cartesian Products of Cayley Digraphs," *Discrete Mathematics* 43 (1983): 297–307.

## Suggested Readings

Frank Budden, "Cayley Graphs for Some Well-Known Groups," *The Mathematical Gazette* 69 (1985): 271–278.

This article contains the Cayley graphs of  $A_4$ ,  $Q_4$ , and  $S_4$  using a variety of generators and relations.

E. L. Burrows and M. J. Clark, "Pictures of Point Groups," *Journal of Chemical Education* 51 (1974): 87–90.

Chemistry students may be interested in reading this article. It gives a comprehensive collection of the Cayley digraphs of groups important to chemists.

Douglas Dunham, John Lindgren, and David Witte, “Creating Repeating Hyperbolic Patterns,” *Computer Graphics* 15 (1981): 215–223.

In this beautifully illustrated paper, a process for creating repeating patterns of the hyperbolic plane is described. The paper is a blend of group theory, geometry, and art.

Joseph A. Gallian, “Circuits in Directed Grids,” *The Mathematical Intelligencer* 13 (1991): 40–43.

This article surveys research done on variations of the themes discussed in this chapter.

Joseph A. Gallian and David Witte, “Hamiltonian Checkerboards,” *Mathematics Magazine* 57 (1984): 291–294.

This paper gives some additional examples of Hamiltonian circuits in Cayley digraphs. It is available at <http://www.d.umn.edu/~jgallian/checker.pdf>

Henry Levinson, “Cayley Diagrams,” in *Mathematical Vistas: Papers from the Mathematics Section*, New York Academy of Sciences, J. Malkevitch and D. McCarthy, eds., 1990: 62–68.

This richly illustrated article presents Cayley digraphs of many of the groups that appear in this text.

A. T. White, “Ringing the Cosets,” *The American Mathematical Monthly* 94 (1987): 721–746.

This article analyzes the practice of bell ringing by way of Cayley digraphs.

## Suggested Website

<http://www.d.umn.edu/~ddunham/>

This website has copies of several articles that describe the mathematics involved in creating Escher-like repeating patterns in the hyperbolic plane as shown in Figure 30.10.

## Suggested DVD

*N is a Number*, Mathematical Association of America, 58 minutes.

In this documentary, Erdős discusses politics, death, and mathematics. Many of Erdős’s collaborators and friends comment on his work and life. It is available for purchase at <http://www.amazon.com>

## Suggested Software

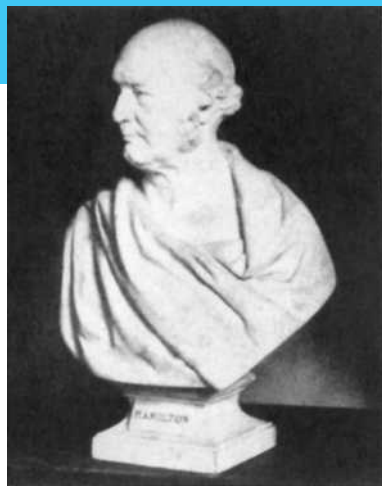
Group Explorer is mathematical visualization software that allows users to explore dozens of Cayley digraphs of finite groups visually and interactively. This free software is available at **<http://sourceforge.net/projects/groupeexplorer>**



# William Rowan Hamilton

After Isaac Newton, the greatest mathematician of the English-speaking peoples is William Rowan Hamilton.

SIR EDMUND WHITTAKER,  
*Scientific American*



Stock Montage

WILLIAM ROWAN HAMILTON was born on August 3, 1805, in Dublin, Ireland. At three, he was skilled at reading and arithmetic. At five, he read and translated Latin, Greek, and Hebrew; at 14, he had mastered 14 languages, including Arabic, Sanskrit, Hindustani, Malay, and Bengali.

In 1833, Hamilton provided the first modern treatment of complex numbers. In 1843, he made what he considered his greatest discovery—the algebra of quaternions. The quaternions represent a natural generalization of the complex numbers with three numbers  $i$ ,  $j$ , and  $k$  whose squares are  $-1$ . With these, rotations in three and four dimensions can be algebraically treated. Of greater significance, however, is the fact that the quaternions are noncommutative under multiplication. This was the first ring to be discovered in

which the commutative property does not hold. The essential idea for the quaternions suddenly came to Hamilton after 15 years of fruitless thought!

Today Hamilton's name is attached to several concepts, such as the Hamiltonian function, which represents the total energy in a physical system; the Hamilton–Jacobi differential equations; and the Cayley–Hamilton Theorem from linear algebra. He also coined the terms *vector*, *scalar*, and *tensor*.

In his later years, Hamilton was plagued by alcoholism. He died on September 2, 1865, at the age of 60.

For more information about Hamilton, visit:

**[http://www-groups.dcs  
.st-and.ac.uk/~history/](http://www-groups.dcs.st-and.ac.uk/~history/)**

## Paul Erdős

Paul Erdős is a socially helpless Hungarian who has thought about more mathematical problems than anyone else in history.

*The Atlantic Monthly*

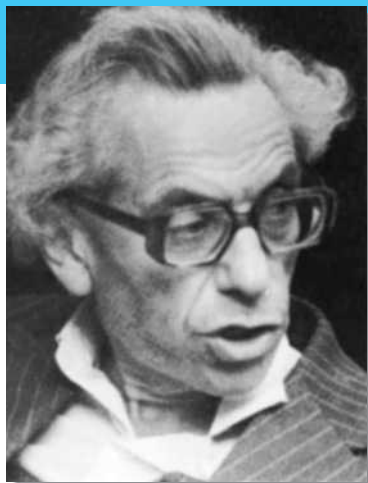


Photo by Seymour Schuster, Carleton College

PAUL ERDŐS (pronounced AIR-dish) was one of the best-known and most highly respected mathematicians of the 20th century. Unlike most of his contemporaries, who have concentrated on theory building, Erdős focused on problem solving and problem posing. The problems and methods of solution of Erdős—like those of Euler, whose solutions to special problems pointed the way to much of the mathematical theory we have today—have helped pioneer new theories, such as combinatorial and probabilistic number theory, combinatorial geometry, probabilistic and transfinite combinatorics, and graph theory.

Erdős was born on March 26, 1913, in Hungary. Both of his parents were high school mathematics teachers. Erdős, a Jew, left Hungary in 1934 at the age of 21 because of the rapid rise of anti-Semitism in Europe. For the rest of his life he traveled incessantly, rarely pausing more than a month in any one place, giving lectures for small honoraria and staying with fellow mathematicians. He had little property and no fixed address. All that he owned he carried with him in a medium-sized suitcase, frequently visiting

as many as 15 places in a month. His motto was, “Another roof, another proof.” Even in his eighties, he put in 19-hour days doing mathematics.

Erdős wrote more than 1500 research papers. He coauthored papers with more than 500 people. These people are said to have Erdős number 1. People who do not have Erdős number 1, but who have written a paper with someone who does, are said to have Erdős number 2, and so on, inductively.

Erdős received the Cole Prize in number theory from the American Mathematical Society, the Wolf Prize for lifelong contributions, and was elected to the U.S. National Academy of Sciences. Erdős died of a heart attack on September 20, 1996.

For more information about Erdős, visit:

[http://www-groups.dcs.st-and  
.ac.uk/~history/](http://www-groups.dcs.st-and.ac.uk/~history/)

<http://www.oakland.edu/enp>

# 31 Introduction to Algebraic Coding Theory

There is no branch of mathematics, however abstract, which may not some day be applied to phenomena of the real world.

Nikolai Lobatchevsky

Damn it, if the machine can detect an error, why can't it locate the position of the error and correct it?

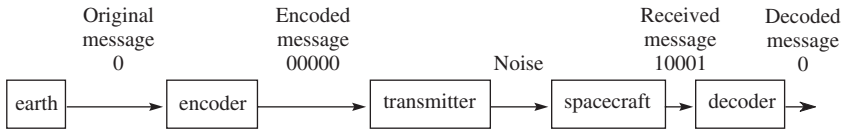
Richard W. Hamming

## Motivation

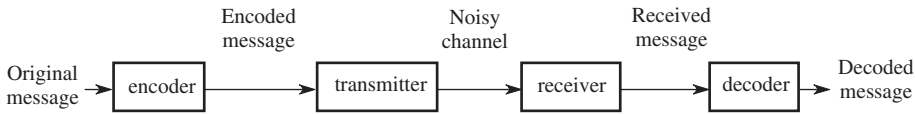
One of the most interesting and important applications of finite fields has been the development of algebraic coding theory. This theory, which originated in the late 1940s, was created in response to practical communication problems. (Algebraic coding has nothing to do with secret codes.) Algebraic codes are now used in compact disc and DVD players, fax machines, digital televisions, and bar code scanners, and are essential to computer maintenance.

To motivate this theory, imagine that we wish to transmit one of two possible signals to a spacecraft approaching Mars. If the proposed landing site appears unfavorable, we will command the craft to orbit the planet; otherwise, we will command the craft to land. The signal for orbiting will be a 0, and the signal for landing will be a 1. But it is possible that some sort of interference (called *noise*) could cause an incorrect message to be received. To decrease the chance of this happening, redundancy is built into the transmission process. For example, if we wish the craft to orbit Mars, we could send five 0s. The craft's onboard computer is programmed to take any five-digit message received and decode the result by majority rule. So, if 00000 is sent and 10001 is received, the computer decides that 0 was the intended message. Notice that, for the computer to make the wrong decision, at least three errors must occur during transmission. If we assume that errors occur independently, it is

less likely that three errors will occur than that two or fewer errors will occur. For this reason, this decision process is frequently called the *maximum-likelihood decoding* procedure. Our particular situation is illustrated in Figure 31.1. The general coding procedure is illustrated in Figure 31.2.



**Figure 31.1** Encoding and decoding by fivefold repetition.



**Figure 31.2** General encoding-decoding.

In practice, the means of transmission are telephone, radiowave, microwave, or even a magnetic disk. The noise might be human error, crosstalk, lightning, thermal noise, or deterioration of a disk. Throughout this chapter, we assume that errors in transmission occur independently. Different methods are needed when this is not the case.

Now, let's consider a more complicated situation. This time, assume that we wish to send a sequence of 0s and 1s of length 500. Further, suppose that the probability that an error will be made in the transmission of any particular digit is .01. If we send this message directly, without any redundancy, the probability that it will be received error-free is  $(.99)^{500}$ , or approximately .0066.

On the other hand, if we adopt a threefold repetition scheme by sending each digit three times and decoding each block of three digits received by majority rule, we can do much better. For example, the sequence 1011 is encoded as 111000111111. If the received message is 011000001110, the decoded message is 1001. Now, what is the probability that our 500-digit message will be error-free? Well, if a 1, say, is sent, it will be decoded as a 0 if and only if the block received is 001, 010, 100, or 000. The probability that this will occur is

$$\begin{aligned}
 & (.01)(.01)(.99) + (.01)(.99)(.01) + (.99)(.01)(.01) + (.01)(.01)(.01) \\
 & = (.01)^2[3(.99) + .01] \\
 & = .000298 < .0003.
 \end{aligned}$$

Thus, the probability that any particular digit in the sequence will be decoded correctly is greater than .9997, and it follows that the probability that the entire 500-digit message will be decoded correctly is greater than  $(.9997)^{500}$ , or approximately .86—a dramatic improvement over .0066.

This example illustrates the three basic features of a code. There is a set of messages, a method of encoding these messages, and a method of decoding the received messages. The encoding procedure builds some redundancy into the original messages; the decoding procedure corrects or detects certain prescribed errors. Repetition codes have the advantage of simplicity of encoding and decoding, but they are too inefficient. In a fivefold repetition code, 80% of all transmitted information is redundant. The goal of coding theory is to devise message encoding and decoding methods that are reliable, efficient, and reasonably easy to implement.

Before plunging into the formal theory, it is instructive to look at a sophisticated example.

■ **EXAMPLE 1 Hamming (7, 4) Code**

This time, our message set consists of all possible 4-tuples of 0's and 1's (that is, we wish to send a sequence of 0's and 1's of length 4). Encoding will be done by viewing these messages as  $1 \times 4$  matrices with entries from  $\mathbb{Z}_2$  and multiplying each of the 16 messages on the right by the matrix

$$G = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 1 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 & 0 & 1 & 0 & 1 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & 0 & 1 & 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 1 & 0 & 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix}.$$

(All arithmetic is done modulo 2.) The resulting 7-tuples are called *code words*. (See Table 31.1.)

**Table 31.1**

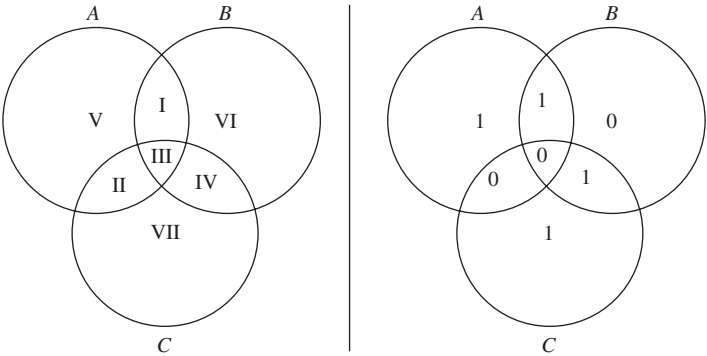
| Message | Encoder $G$ | Code Word | Message | Encoder $G$ | Code Word |
|---------|-------------|-----------|---------|-------------|-----------|
| 0000    | →           | 0000000   | 0110    | →           | 0110010   |
| 0001    | →           | 0001011   | 0101    | →           | 0101110   |
| 0010    | →           | 0010111   | 0011    | →           | 0011100   |
| 0100    | →           | 0100101   | 1110    | →           | 1110100   |
| 1000    | →           | 1000110   | 1101    | →           | 1101000   |
| 1100    | →           | 1100011   | 1011    | →           | 1011010   |
| 1010    | →           | 1010001   | 0111    | →           | 0111001   |
| 1001    | →           | 1001101   | 1111    | →           | 1111111   |

Notice that the first four digits of each code word constitute just the original message corresponding to the code word. The last three digits of the code word constitute the redundancy features. For this code, we use the *nearest-neighbor* decoding method (which, in the case that the errors occur independently, is the same as the maximum-likelihood decoding procedure). For any received word  $v$ , we assume that the word sent is the code word  $v'$  that differs from  $v$  in the fewest number of positions. If the choice of  $v'$  is not unique, we can decide not to decode or arbitrarily choose one of the code words closest to  $v$ . (The first option is usually selected when retransmission is practical.)

Once we have decoded the received word, we can obtain the message by deleting the last three digits of  $v'$ . For instance, suppose that 1000 were the intended message. It would be encoded and transmitted as  $u = 1000110$ . If the received word were  $v = 1100110$  (an error in the second position), it would still be decoded as  $u$ , since  $v$  and  $u$  differ in only one position, whereas  $v$  and any other code word would differ in at least two positions. Similarly, the intended message 1111 would be encoded as 1111111. If, instead of this, the word 0111111 were received, our decoding procedure would still give us the intended message 1111. ■

The code in Example 1 is one of an infinite class of important codes discovered by Richard Hamming in 1948. The Hamming codes are the most widely used codes.

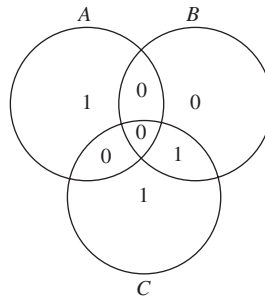
The Hamming (7, 4) encoding scheme can be conveniently illustrated with the use of a Venn diagram, as shown in Figure 31.3. Begin by placing the four message digits in the four overlapping regions I, II,



**Figure 31.3** Venn diagram of the message 1001 and the encoded message 1001101.

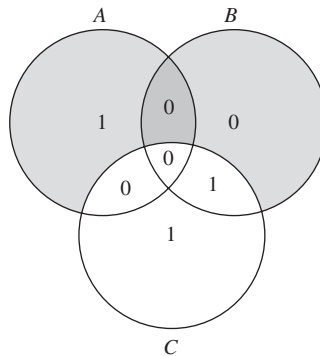
III, and IV, with the digit in position 1 in region I, the digit in position 2 in region II, and so on. For regions V, VI, and VII, assign 0 or 1 so that the total number of 1s in each circle is even.

Consider the Venn diagram of the received word 0001101:



How may we detect and correct an error? Well, observe that each of the circles  $A$  and  $B$  has an odd number of 1s. This tells us that something is wrong. At the same time, we note that circle  $C$  has an even number of 1s. Thus, the portion of the diagram that is in both  $A$  and  $B$  but not in  $C$  is the source of the error. See Figure 31.4.

Quite often, codes are used to detect errors rather than correct them. This is especially appropriate when it is easy to retransmit a message. If a received word is not a code word, we have detected an error. For example, computers are designed to use a parity check for numbers. Inside the computer, each number is represented by a string of 0's and 1's. If there is an even number of 1's in this representation, a 0 is attached to the string; if there is an odd number of 1's in the representation, a 1 is attached to the string. Thus, each number stored in the computer memory has an even number of 1's. Now, when the computer reads a



**Figure 31.4** Circles  $A$  and  $B$  but not  $C$  have wrong parity.

number from memory, it performs a parity check. If the read number has an odd number of 1's, the computer will know that an error has been made, and it will reread the number. Note that an even number of errors will not be detected by a parity check.

The methods of error detection introduced in Chapters 0 and 5 are based on the same principle. An extra character is appended to a string of numbers so that a particular condition is satisfied. If we find that such a string does not satisfy that condition, we know that an error has occurred.

## Linear Codes

We now formalize some of the ideas introduced in the preceding discussion.

### Definition Linear Code

An  $(n, k)$  linear code over a finite field  $F$  is a  $k$ -dimensional subspace  $V$  of the vector space

$$F^n = \underbrace{F \oplus F \oplus \cdots \oplus F}_{n \text{ copies}}$$

over  $F$ . The members of  $V$  are called the *code words*. When  $F$  is  $\mathbb{Z}_2$ , the code is called *binary*.

One should think of an  $(n, k)$  linear code over  $F$  as a set of  $n$ -tuples from  $F$ , where each  $n$ -tuple has two parts: the message part, consisting of  $k$  digits; and the redundancy part, consisting of the remaining  $n - k$  digits. Note that an  $(n, k)$  linear code over a finite field  $F$  of order  $q$  has  $q^k$  code words, since every member of the code is uniquely expressible as a linear combination of the  $k$  basis vectors with coefficients from  $F$ . The set of  $q^k$  code words is closed under addition and scalar multiplication by members of  $F$ . Also, since errors in transmission may occur in any of the  $n$  positions, there are  $q^n$  possible vectors that can be received. Where there is no possibility of confusion, it is customary to denote an  $n$ -tuple  $(a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n)$  more simply as  $a_1 a_2 \cdots a_n$ , as we did in Example 1.

### EXAMPLE 2 The set

{0000000, 0010111, 0101011, 1001101,  
1100110, 1011010, 0111100, 1110001}

is a  $(7, 3)$  binary code. ■



■ **EXAMPLE 3** The set  $\{0000, 0101, 1010, 1111\}$  is a  $(4, 2)$  binary code. ■

Although binary codes are by far the most important ones, other codes are occasionally used.

■ **EXAMPLE 4** The set

$$\{0000, 0121, 0212, 1022, 1110, 1201, 2011, 2102, 2220\}$$

is a  $(4, 2)$  linear code over  $Z_3$ . A linear code over  $Z_3$  is called a *ternary code*. ■

To facilitate our discussion of the error-correcting and error-detecting capability of a code, we introduce the following terminology.

#### **Definitions** Hamming Distance, Hamming Weight

The *Hamming distance* between two vectors in  $F^n$  is the number of components in which they differ. The *Hamming weight* of a vector is the number of nonzero components of the vector. The *Hamming weight* of a linear code is the minimum weight of any nonzero vector in the code.

We will use  $d(u, v)$  to denote the Hamming distance between the vectors  $u$  and  $v$ , and  $\text{wt}(u)$  for the Hamming weight of the vector  $u$ .

■ **EXAMPLE 5** Let  $s = 0010111$ ,  $t = 0101011$ ,  $u = 1001101$ , and  $v = 1101101$ . Then,  $d(s, t) = 4$ ,  $d(s, u) = 4$ ,  $d(s, v) = 5$ ,  $d(u, v) = 1$ ; and  $\text{wt}(s) = 4$ ,  $\text{wt}(t) = 4$ ,  $\text{wt}(u) = 4$ ,  $\text{wt}(v) = 5$ . ■

The Hamming distance and Hamming weight have the following important properties.

#### ■ **Theorem 31.1** Properties of Hamming Distance and Hamming Weight

*For any vectors  $u, v$ , and  $w$ ,  $d(u, v) \leq d(u, w) + d(w, v)$  and  $d(u, v) = \text{wt}(u - v)$ .*

**PROOF** To prove that  $d(u, v) = \text{wt}(u - v)$ , simply observe that both  $d(u, v)$  and  $\text{wt}(u - v)$  equal the number of positions in which  $u$  and  $v$  differ. To prove that  $d(u, v) \leq d(u, w) + d(w, v)$ , note that if  $u$  and  $v$  differ in the  $i$ th position and  $u$  and  $w$  agree in the  $i$ th position, then  $w$  and  $v$  differ in the  $i$ th position. ■

With the preceding definitions and Theorem 31.1, we can now explain why the codes given in Examples 1, 2, and 4 will correct any single error, but the code in Example 3 will not.

### ■ Theorem 31.2 Correcting Capability of a Linear Code

*If the Hamming weight of a linear code is at least  $2t + 1$ , then the code can correct any  $t$  or fewer errors. Alternatively, the same code can detect any  $2t$  or fewer errors.*

**PROOF** We will use nearest-neighbor decoding; that is, for any received vector  $v$ , we will assume that the corresponding code word sent is a code word  $v'$  such that the Hamming distance  $d(v, v')$  is a minimum. (If there is more than one such  $v'$ , we do not decode.) Now, suppose that a transmitted code word  $u$  is received as the vector  $v$  and that at most  $t$  errors have been made in transmission. Then, by the definition of distance between  $u$  and  $v$ , we have  $d(u, v) \leq t$ . If  $w$  is any code word other than  $u$ , then  $w - u$  is a nonzero code word. Thus, by assumption,

$$2t + 1 \leq \text{wt}(w - u) = d(w, u) \leq d(w, v) + d(v, u) \leq d(w, v) + t,$$

and it follows that  $t + 1 \leq d(w, v)$ . So, the code word closest to the received vector  $v$  is  $u$ , and therefore  $v$  is correctly decoded as  $u$ .

To show that the code can detect  $2t$  errors, we suppose that a transmitted code word  $u$  is received as the vector  $v$  and that at least one error, but no more than  $2t$  errors, was made in transmission. Because only code words are transmitted, an error will be detected whenever a received word is not a code word. But  $v$  cannot be a code word, since  $d(v, u) \leq 2t$ , whereas we know that the minimum distance between distinct code words is at least  $2t + 1$ . ■

■ **EXAMPLE 6** Since the binary code  $\{000, 001, 010, 100, 110, 101, 011, 111\}$  has weight  $1 = 2t + 1$ , it will not detect any error ( $t = 0$ ).

Since the binary code  $\{000, 0101, 1010, 1111\}$  has weight  $2 = 2t + 1$ , it will not correct every 1 error ( $t = 1/2$ ) but it will detect any 1 error.

Since the binary code  $\{00000, 10011, 01010, 11001, 00101, 10110, 01111, 11100\}$  has weight  $3 = 2t + 1$ , it will correct any 1 error ( $t = 1$ ) or it will detect any 2 or fewer errors.

Since the binary code  $\{0000000, 0010111, 0101011, 1001101, 1100110, 1011010, 0111100, 1110001\}$  has weight  $4 = 2t + 1$ , it will correct any 1 error ( $t = 3/2$ ) or it will detect any 3 or fewer errors. ■

Theorem 31.2 is often misinterpreted to mean that a linear code with Hamming weight  $2t + 1$  can correct any  $t$  errors *and* detect any  $2t$  or fewer errors simultaneously. This is not the case. The user must choose one or the other role for the code. Consider, for example, the Hamming (7, 4) code given in Table 31.1. By inspection, the Hamming weight of the code is  $3 = 2 \cdot 1 + 1$ , so we may elect either to correct any single error or to detect any one or two errors. To understand why we can't do both, consider the received word 0001010. The intended message could have been 0000000, in which case two errors were made (likewise for the intended messages 1011010 and 0101110), or the intended message could have been 0001011, in which case one error was made. But there is no way for us to know which of these possibilities occurred. If our choice were error correction, we would assume—perhaps mistakenly—that 0001011 was the intended message. If our choice were error detection, we simply would not decode. (Typically, one would request retransmission.)

On the other hand, if we write the Hamming weight of a linear code in the form  $2t + s + 1$ , we can correct any  $t$  errors *and* detect any  $t + s$  or fewer errors. Thus, for a code with Hamming weight 5, our options include the following:

1. Detect any four errors ( $t = 0, s = 4$ ).
2. Correct any one error and detect any two or three errors ( $t = 1, s = 2$ ).
3. Correct any two errors ( $t = 2, s = 0$ ).

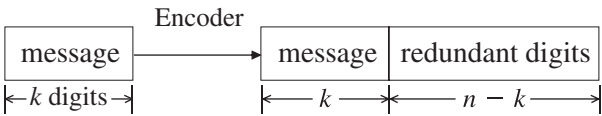
■ **EXAMPLE 7** Since the Hamming weight of the linear code given in Example 2 is 4, it will correct any single error and detect any two errors ( $t = 1, s = 1$ ) or detect any three errors ( $t = 0, s = 3$ ). ■

It is natural to wonder how the matrix  $G$  used to produce the Hamming code in Example 1 was chosen. Better yet, in general, how can one find a matrix  $G$  that carries a subspace  $V$  of  $F^k$  to a subspace of  $F^n$  in such a way that for any  $k$ -tuple  $v$  in  $V$ , the vector  $vG$  will agree with  $v$  in the first  $k$  components and build in some redundancy in the last  $n - k$  components? Such a matrix is a  $k \times n$  matrix of the form

$$\left[ \begin{array}{cccc|ccc} 1 & 0 & \cdots & 0 & a_{11} & \cdots & a_{1n-k} \\ 0 & 1 & \cdots & 0 & \cdot & & \cdot \\ \cdot & \cdot & & \cdot & \cdot & & \cdot \\ \cdot & \cdot & & \cdot & \cdot & & \cdot \\ \cdot & \cdot & & \cdot & \cdot & & \cdot \\ 0 & 0 & \cdots & 1 & a_{k1} & \cdots & a_{kn-k} \end{array} \right]$$

where the  $a_{ij}$ 's belong to  $F$ . A matrix of this form is called the *standard generator matrix* (or *standard encoding matrix*) for the resulting code.

Any  $k \times n$  matrix whose rows are linearly independent will transform  $F^k$  to a  $k$ -dimensional subspace of  $F^n$  that could be used to build redundancy, but using the standard generator matrix has the advantage that the original message constitutes the first  $k$  components of the transformed vectors. An  $(n, k)$  linear code in which the  $k$  information digits occur at the beginning of each code word is called a *systematic code*. Schematically, we have the following.



Notice that, by definition, a standard generator matrix produces a systematic code.

■ **EXAMPLE 8** From the set of messages

$$\{000, 001, 010, 100, 110, 101, 011, 111\},$$

we may construct a  $(6, 3)$  linear code over  $Z_2$  with the standard generator matrix

$$G = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 & 1 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 & 1 & 0 & 1 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & 1 & 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix}.$$

The resulting code words are given in Table 31.2. Since the minimum weight of any nonzero code word is 3, this code will correct any single error or detect any double error. ■

**Table 31.2**

| Message | Encoder $G$ | Code Word |
|---------|-------------|-----------|
| 000     | →           | 000000    |
| 001     | →           | 001111    |
| 010     | →           | 010101    |
| 100     | →           | 100110    |
| 110     | →           | 110011    |
| 101     | →           | 101001    |
| 011     | →           | 011010    |
| 111     | →           | 111100    |

■ **EXAMPLE 9** Here we take a set of messages as

$$\{00, 01, 02, 10, 11, 12, 20, 21, 22\},$$

and we construct a  $(4, 2)$  linear code over  $\mathbb{Z}_3$  with the standard generator matrix

$$G = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 2 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 & 2 & 2 \end{bmatrix}.$$

The resulting code words are given in Table 31.3. Since the minimum weight of the code is 3, it will correct any single error or detect any double error. ■

**Table 31.3**

| Message | Encoder $G$ | Code Word |
|---------|-------------|-----------|
| 00      | →           | 0000      |
| 01      | →           | 0122      |
| 02      | →           | 0211      |
| 10      | →           | 1021      |
| 11      | →           | 1110      |
| 12      | →           | 1202      |
| 20      | →           | 2012      |
| 21      | →           | 2101      |
| 22      | →           | 2220      |

## Parity-Check Matrix Decoding

Now that we can conveniently encode messages with a standard generator matrix, we need a convenient method for decoding the received messages. Unfortunately, this is not as easy to do; however, in the case where at most one error per code word has occurred, there is a fairly simple method for decoding. (When more than one error occurs in a code word, our decoding method fails.)

To describe this method, suppose that  $V$  is a systematic linear code over the field  $F$  given by the standard generator matrix  $G = [I_k \mid A]$ , where  $I_k$  represents the  $k \times k$  identity matrix and  $A$  is the  $k \times (n - k)$  matrix obtained from  $G$  by deleting the first  $k$  columns of  $G$ . Then, the  $n \times (n - k)$  matrix

$$H = \begin{bmatrix} -A \\ I_{n-k} \end{bmatrix},$$

where  $-A$  is the negative of  $A$  and  $I_{n-k}$  is the  $(n - k) \times (n - k)$  identity matrix, is called the *parity-check matrix* for  $V$ . (In the literature, the transpose of  $H$  is called the parity-check matrix, but  $H$  is much more convenient for our purposes.) The decoding procedure is:

1. For any received word  $w$ , compute  $wH$ .
2. If  $wH$  is the zero vector, assume that no error was made.
3. If there is exactly one instance of a nonzero element  $s \in F$  and a row  $i$  of  $H$  such that  $wH$  is  $s$  times row  $i$ , assume that the sent word was  $w - (0 \dots s \dots 0)$ , where  $s$  occurs in the  $i$ th component. If there is more than one such instance, do not decode.
- 3'. When the code is binary, category 3 reduces to the following: If  $wH$  is the  $i$ th row of  $H$  for exactly one  $i$ , assume that an error was made in the  $i$ th component of  $w$ . If  $wH$  is more than one row of  $H$ , do not decode.
4. If  $wH$  does not fit into either category 2 or category 3, we know that at least two errors occurred in transmission and we do not decode.

■ **EXAMPLE 10** Consider the Hamming (7, 4) code given in Example 1. The generator matrix is

$$G = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 1 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 & 0 & 1 & 0 & 1 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & 0 & 1 & 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 1 & 0 & 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

and the corresponding parity-check matrix is

$$H = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 & 0 \\ 1 & 0 & 1 \\ 1 & 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}.$$

Now, if the received vector is  $v = 0000110$ , we find  $vH = 110$ . Since this is the first row of  $H$  and no other row, we assume that an error has been made in the first position of  $v$ . Thus, the transmitted code word is assumed to be  $1000110$ , and the corresponding message is assumed to be  $1000$ . Similarly, if  $w = 1011111$  is the received word, then  $wH = 101$ , and we assume that an error has been made in the second position. So, we assume that  $1111111$  was sent and that  $1111$  was the intended message. If

the encoded message 1001101 is received as  $z = 1001011$  (with errors in the fifth and sixth positions), we find  $zH = 110$ . Since this matches the first row of  $H$ , we decode  $z$  as 0001011 and incorrectly assume that the message 0001 was intended. On the other hand, nearest-neighbor decoding would yield the same incorrect result. ■

Notice that when only one error was made in transmission, the parity-check decoding procedure gave us the originally intended message. We will soon see under what conditions this is true, but first we need an important fact relating a code given by a generator matrix and its parity-check matrix.

### ■ Lemma Orthogonality Relation

*Let  $C$  be a systematic  $(n, k)$  linear code over  $F$  with a standard generator matrix  $G$  and parity-check matrix  $H$ . Then, for any vector  $v$  in  $F^n$ , we have  $vH = 0$  (the zero vector) if and only if  $v$  belongs to  $C$ .*

**PROOF** First note that, since  $H$  has rank  $n - k$ , we may think of  $H$  as a linear transformation from  $F^n$  onto  $F^{n-k}$ . Therefore, it follows from the dimension theorem for linear transformations that  $n = n - k + \dim(\text{Ker } H)$ , so that  $\text{Ker } H$  has dimension  $k$ . (Alternatively, one can use a group theory argument to show that  $|\text{Ker } H| = |F|^k$ .) Then, since the dimension of  $C$  is also  $k$ , it suffices to show that  $C \subseteq \text{Ker } H$ . To do this, let  $G = [I_k \mid A]$ , so that  $H = \begin{bmatrix} -A \\ I_{n-k} \end{bmatrix}$ . Then,

$$GH = [I_k \mid A] \begin{bmatrix} -A \\ I_{n-k} \end{bmatrix} = -A + A = [0] \quad (\text{the zero matrix}).$$

Now, by definition, any vector  $v$  in  $C$  has the form  $mG$ , where  $m$  is a message vector. Thus,  $vH = (mG)H = m(GH) = m[0] = 0$  (the zero vector). ■

Because of the way  $H$  was defined, the parity-check matrix method correctly decodes any received word in which no error has been made. But it will do more.

### ■ Theorem 31.3 Parity-Check Matrix Decoding

*Parity-check matrix decoding will correct any single error if and only if the rows of the parity-check matrix are nonzero and no one row is a scalar multiple of any other row.*

**PROOF** For simplicity's sake, we prove only the binary case. In this special situation, the condition on the rows is that they are nonzero and distinct. So, let  $H$  be the parity-check matrix, and let's assume that this condition holds for the rows. Suppose that the transmitted code word  $w$  was received with only one error, and that this error occurred in the  $i$ th position. Denoting the vector that has a 1 in the  $i$ th position and 0's elsewhere by  $e_i$ , we may write the received word as  $w + e_i$ . Now, using the Orthogonality Lemma, we obtain

$$(w + e_i)H = wH + e_iH = 0 + e_iH = e_iH.$$

But this last vector is precisely the  $i$ th row of  $H$ . Thus, if there was exactly one error in transmission, we can use the rows of the parity-check matrix to identify the location of the error, provided that these rows are distinct. (If two rows, say, the  $i$ th and  $j$ th, are the same, we know that the error occurred in either the  $i$ th position or the  $j$ th position, but we do not know in which.)

Conversely, suppose that the parity-check matrix method correctly decodes all received words in which at most one error has been made in transmission. If the  $i$ th row of the parity-check matrix  $H$  were the zero vector and if the code word  $u = 0 \cdots 0$  were received as  $e_i$ , we would find  $e_iH = 0 \cdots 0$ , and we would erroneously assume that the vector  $e_i$  was sent. Thus, no row of  $H$  is the zero vector. Now, suppose that the  $i$ th row of  $H$  and the  $j$ th row of  $H$  are equal and  $i \neq j$ . Then, if some code word  $w$  is transmitted and the received word is  $w + e_i$  (that is, there is a single error in the  $i$ th position), we find

$$(w + e_i)H = wH + e_iH = i\text{th row of } H = j\text{th row of } H.$$

Thus, our decoding procedure tells us not to decode. This contradicts our assumption that the method correctly decodes all received words in which at most one error has been made. ■

## Coset Decoding

There is another convenient decoding method that utilizes the fact that an  $(n, k)$  linear code  $C$  over a finite field  $F$  is a subgroup of the additive group of  $V = F^n$ . This method was devised by David Slepian in 1956 and is called *coset decoding* (or *standard decoding*). To use this method, we proceed by constructing a table, called a *standard array*. The first row of the table is the set  $C$  of code words, beginning in column 1 with the identity  $0 \cdots 0$ . To form additional rows of the table, choose an element  $v$  of  $V$  not listed in the table thus far. Among all the elements of the coset  $v + C$ , choose one of minimum weight, say,  $v'$ . Complete the next row of the table by placing under the column headed by the code word  $c$  the vector  $v' + c$ . Continue this process until all the vectors in  $V$  have been listed in the table. [Note that an  $(n, k)$  linear code over a field with  $q$



elements will have  $|V:C| = q^{n-k}$  rows.] The words in the first column are called the *coset leaders*. The decoding procedure is simply to decode any received word  $w$  as the code word at the head of the column containing  $w$ .

■ **EXAMPLE 11** Consider the  $(6, 3)$  binary linear code

$$C = \{000000, 100110, 010101, 001011, 110011, 101101, 011110, 111000\}.$$

The first row of a standard array is just the elements of  $C$ . Obviously, 100000 is not in  $C$  and has minimum weight among the elements of  $100000 + C$ , so it can be used to lead the second row. Table 31.4 is the completed table.

**Table 31.4** A Standard Array for a  $(6, 3)$  Linear Code

| Coset<br>Leaders | Words  |        |        |        |        |        |        |
|------------------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|
|                  |        |        |        |        |        |        |        |
| 000000           | 100110 | 010101 | 001011 | 110011 | 101101 | 011110 | 111000 |
| 100000           | 000110 | 110101 | 101011 | 010011 | 001101 | 111110 | 011000 |
| 010000           | 110110 | 000101 | 011011 | 100011 | 111101 | 001110 | 101000 |
| 001000           | 101110 | 011101 | 000011 | 111011 | 100101 | 010110 | 110000 |
| 000100           | 100010 | 010001 | 001111 | 110111 | 101001 | 011010 | 111100 |
| 000010           | 100100 | 010111 | 001001 | 110001 | 101111 | 011100 | 111010 |
| 000001           | 100111 | 010100 | 001010 | 110010 | 101100 | 011111 | 111001 |
| 100001           | 000111 | 110100 | 101010 | 010010 | 001100 | 111111 | 011001 |

If the word 101001 is received, it is decoded as 101101, since 101001 lies in the column headed by 101101. Similarly, the received word 011001 is decoded as 111000. ■

Recall that the first method of decoding that we introduced was the nearest-neighbor method; that is, any received word  $w$  is decoded as the code word  $c$  such that  $d(w, c)$  is a minimum, provided that there is only one code word  $c$  such that  $d(w, c)$  is a minimum. The next result shows that in this situation, coset decoding is the same as nearest-neighbor decoding.

#### ■ Theorem 31.4 Coset Decoding Is Nearest-Neighbor Decoding

*In coset decoding, a received word  $w$  is decoded as a code word  $c$  such that  $d(w, c)$  is a minimum.*

**PROOF** Let  $C$  be a linear code, and let  $w$  be any received word. Suppose that  $v$  is the coset leader for the coset  $w + C$ . Then,  $w + C = v + C$ , so  $w = v + c$  for some  $c$  in  $C$ . Thus, using coset decoding,  $w$  is decoded

as  $c$ . Now, if  $c'$  is any code word, then  $w - c' \in w + C = v + C$ , so that  $\text{wt}(w - c') \geq \text{wt}(v)$ , since the coset leader  $v$  was chosen as a vector of minimum weight among the members of  $v + C$ .

Therefore,

$$d(w, c') = \text{wt}(w - c') \geq \text{wt}(v) = \text{wt}(w - c) = d(w, c).$$

So, using coset decoding,  $w$  is decoded as a code word  $c$  such that  $d(w, c)$  is a minimum. ■

Recall that in our description of nearest-neighbor decoding, we stated that if the choice for the nearest neighbor of a received word  $v$  is not unique, then we can decide not to decode or to decode  $v$  arbitrarily from among those words closest to  $v$ . In the case of coset decoding, the decoded value of  $v$  is always uniquely determined by the coset leader of the row containing the received word. Of course, this decoded value may not be the word that was sent.

When we know a parity-check matrix for a linear code, coset decoding can be considerably simplified.

### Definition Syndrome

If an  $(n, k)$  linear code over  $F$  has parity-check matrix  $H$ , then, for any vector  $u$  in  $F^n$ , the vector  $uH$  is called the *syndrome*<sup>†</sup> of  $u$ .

The importance of syndromes stems from the following property.

### ■ Theorem 31.5 Same Coset—Same Syndrome

*Let  $C$  be an  $(n, k)$  linear code over  $F$  with a parity-check matrix  $H$ . Then, two vectors of  $F^n$  are in the same coset of  $C$  if and only if they have the same syndrome.*

**PROOF** Two vectors  $u$  and  $v$  are in the same coset of  $C$  if and only if  $u - v$  is in  $C$ . So, by the Orthogonality Lemma,  $u$  and  $v$  are in the same coset if and only if  $0 = (u - v)H = uH - vH$ . ■

We may now use syndromes for decoding any received word  $w$ :

1. Calculate  $wH$ , the syndrome of  $w$ .
2. Find the coset leader  $v$  such that  $wH = vH$ .
3. Assume that the vector sent was  $w - v$ .

With this method, we can decode any received word with a table that has only two rows—one row of coset leaders and another row with the corresponding syndromes.

<sup>†</sup>This term was coined by D. Hagelbarger in 1959.

■ **EXAMPLE 12** Consider the code given in Example 11. The parity-check matrix for this code is

$$H = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 & 0 \\ 1 & 0 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}.$$

The list of coset leaders and corresponding syndromes is the following.

|              |        |        |        |        |        |        |        |        |
|--------------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|
| Coset leader | 000000 | 100000 | 010000 | 001000 | 000100 | 000010 | 000001 | 100001 |
| Syndromes    | 000    | 110    | 101    | 011    | 100    | 010    | 001    | 111    |

So, to decode the received word  $w = 101001$ , we compute  $wH = 100$ . Since the coset leader  $v = 000100$  has 100 as its syndrome, we assume that  $w - 000100 = 101101$  was sent. If the received word is  $w' = 011001$ , we compute  $w'H = 111$  and assume  $w' - 100001 = 111000$  was sent because 100001 is the coset leader with syndrome 111. Notice that these answers are in agreement with those obtained by using the standard-array method of Example 11. ■

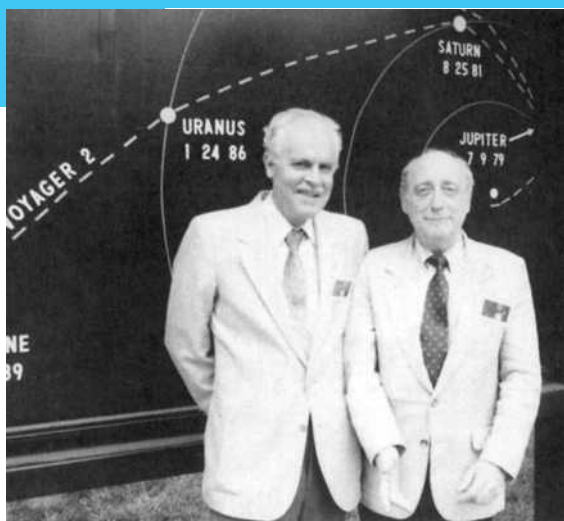
The term *syndrome* is a descriptive term. In medicine, it is used to designate a collection of symptoms that typify a disorder. In coset decoding, the syndrome typifies an error pattern.

In this chapter, we have presented algebraic coding theory in its simplest form. A more sophisticated treatment would make substantially greater use of group theory, ring theory, and especially finite-field theory. For example, Gorenstein (see Chapter 25 for a biography) and Zierler, in 1961, made use of the fact that the multiplicative subgroup of a finite field is cyclic. They associated each digit of certain codes with a field element in such a way that an algebraic equation would be derived whose zeros determined the locations of the errors.

In some instances, two error-correcting codes are employed. The European Space Agency space probe Giotto, which came within 370 miles of the nucleus of Halley’s Comet in 1986, had two error-correcting codes built into its electronics. One code checked for independently occurring errors, and another—a so-called Reed–Solomon code—checked for bursts of errors. Giotto achieved an error-detection rate of 0.999999. Reed–Solomon codes are also used on compact discs. They can correct thousands of consecutive errors.

## The Ubiquitous Reed–Solomon Codes\*

Irving Reed and Gustave Solomon monitor the encounter of *Voyager II* with Neptune at the Jet Propulsion Laboratory in 1989.



SIAM NEWS, January 1993, Volume 25, Number 1, pages 1 and 11

We conclude this chapter with an adapted version of an article by Barry A. Cipra about the Reed–Solomon codes [1]. It was the first in a series of articles called “Mathematics That Counts” in *SIAM News*, the news journal of the Society for Industrial and Applied Mathematics. The articles highlight developments in mathematics that have led to products and processes of substantial benefit to industry and the public.

In this “Age of Information,” no one need be reminded of the importance not only of speed but also of accuracy in the storage, retrieval, and transmission of data. Machines *do* make errors, and their non-man-made mistakes can turn otherwise flawless programming into worthless, even dangerous, trash. Just as architects design buildings that will remain standing even through an earthquake, their computer counterparts have come up with sophisticated techniques capable of counteracting digital disasters.

The idea for the current error-correcting techniques for everything from computer hard disk drives to CD players was first introduced in 1960 by Irving Reed and Gustave

Solomon, then staff members at MIT’s Lincoln Laboratory. . . .

“When you talk about CD players and digital audio tape and now digital television, and various other digital imaging systems that are coming—all of those need Reed–Solomon [codes] as an integral part of the system,” says Robert McEliece, a coding theorist in the electrical engineering department at Caltech.

Why? Because digital information, virtually by definition, consists of strings of “bits”—0s and 1s—and a physical device, no matter how capably manufactured, may occasionally confuse the two. *Voyager II*, for example, was transmitting data at incredibly low power—barely a whisper—over tens of millions of

\*Adapted version of an article called, “The Ubiquitous Reed–Solomon Codes” in *SIAM News*, the news journal of the Society for Industrial and Applied Mathematics, by Barry A. Cipra. Reprinted from *SIAM News*, Volume 26-1, January 1993.

miles. Disk drives pack data so densely that a read/write head can (almost) be excused if it can't tell where one bit stops and the next 1 (or 0) begins. Careful engineering can reduce the error rate to what may sound like a negligible level—the industry standard for hard disk drives is 1 in 10 billion—but given the volume of information processing done these days, that “negligible” level is an invitation to daily disaster. Error-correcting codes are a kind of safety net—mathematical insurance against the vagaries of an imperfect material world.

In 1960, the theory of error-correcting codes was only about a decade old. The basic theory of reliable digital communication had been set forth by Claude Shannon in the late 1940s. At the same time, Richard Hamming introduced an elegant approach to single-error correction and double-error detection. Through the 1950s, a number of researchers began experimenting with a variety of error-correcting codes. But with their SIAM journal paper, McEliece says, Reed and Solomon “hit the jackpot.”

The payoff was a coding system based on groups of bits—such as bytes—rather than individual 0s and 1s. That feature makes Reed–Solomon codes particularly good at dealing with “bursts” of errors: six consecutive bit errors, for example, can affect at most two bytes. Thus, even a double-error-correction version of a Reed–Solomon code can provide a comfortable safety factor. . . .

Mathematically, Reed–Solomon codes are based on the arithmetic of finite fields. Indeed, the 1960 paper begins by defining a code as “a mapping from a vector space of dimension  $m$  over a finite field  $K$  into a vector space of higher dimension over the same field.” Starting from a “message”  $(a_0, a_1, \dots, a_{m-1})$ , where each  $a_k$  is an element of the field  $K$ , a Reed–Solomon code produces  $(P(0), P(g), P(g^2), \dots, P(g^{N-1}))$ , where  $N$  is the number of elements in  $K$ ,  $g$  is a generator of the (cyclic) group of nonzero elements in  $K$ , and  $P(x)$  is the polynomial  $a_0 + a_1x + \dots + a_{m-1}x^{m-1}$ . If  $N$  is greater than  $m$ , then the values of  $P$  over-determine the polynomial, and the properties of finite fields guarantee that the coefficients of

$P$ —i.e., the original message—can be recovered from any  $m$  of the values. . . .

In today's byte-sized world, for example, it might make sense to let  $K$  be the field of order  $2^8$ , so that each element of  $K$  corresponds to a single byte (in computerese, there are four bits to a nibble and two nibbles to a byte). In that case,  $N = 2^8 = 256$ , and hence messages up to 251 bytes long can be recovered even if two errors occur in transmitting the values  $P(0), P(g), \dots, P(g^{255})$ . That's a lot better than the 1255 bytes required by the say-everything-five-times approach.

Despite their advantages, Reed–Solomon codes did not go into use immediately—they had to wait for the hardware technology to catch up. “In 1960, there was no such thing as fast digital electronics”—at least not by today's standards, says McEliece. The Reed–Solomon paper “suggested some nice ways to process data, but nobody knew if it was practical or not, and in 1960 it probably wasn't practical.”

But technology did catch up, and numerous researchers began to work on implementing the codes. . . . Many other bells and whistles (some of fundamental theoretic significance) have also been added. Compact discs, for example, use a version of a Reed–Solomon code.

Reed was among the first to recognize the significance of abstract algebra as the basis for error-correcting codes. “In hindsight it seems obvious,” he told *SIAM News*. However, he added, “coding theory was not a subject when we published that paper.” The two authors knew they had a nice result; they didn't know what impact the paper would have.

Three decades later, the impact is clear. The vast array of applications, both current and pending, has settled the question of the practicality and significance of Reed–Solomon codes. “It's clear they're practical, because everybody's using them now,” says Elwyn Berlekamp. Billions of dollars in modern technology depend on ideas that stem from Reed and Solomon's original work. In short, says McEliece, “it's been an extraordinarily influential paper.”

## Exercises

The New Testament offers the basis for modern computer coding theory, in the form of an affirmation of the binary number system.

“But let your communication be yea, yea; nay, nay: for whatsoever is more than these cometh of evil.”

Anonymous

1. Find the Hamming weight of each code word in Table 31.1.
2. Find the Hamming distance between the following pairs of vectors:  $\{1101, 0111\}$ ,  $\{0220, 1122\}$ ,  $\{11101, 00111\}$ .
3. Referring to Example 1, use the nearest-neighbor method to decode the received words 0000110 and 1110100.
4. For any vector space  $V$  and any  $u, v, w$  in  $F^n$ , prove that the Hamming distance has the following properties.
  - a.  $d(u, v) = d(v, u)$  (symmetry).
  - b.  $d(u, v) = 0$  if and only if  $u = v$ .
  - c.  $d(u, v) = d(u + w, v + w)$  (translation invariance).
5. Determine the  $(6, 3)$  binary linear code with generator matrix

$$G = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 & 1 & 0 & 1 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & 1 & 1 & 0 \end{bmatrix}.$$

6. Show that for binary vectors,  $\text{wt}(u + v) \geq \text{wt}(u) - \text{wt}(v)$  and equality occurs if and only if for all  $i$  the  $i$ th component of  $u$  is 1 whenever the  $i$ th component of  $v$  is 1.
7. If the minimum weight of any nonzero code word is 2, what can we say about the error-detecting capability of the code?
8. Suppose that  $C$  is a linear code with Hamming weight 3 and that  $C'$  is one with Hamming weight 4. What can  $C'$  do that  $C$  can't?
9. Let  $C$  be a binary linear code. Show that the code words of even weight form a subcode of  $C$ . (A *subcode* of a code is a subset of the code that is itself a code.)
10. Let

$$C = \{0000000, 1110100, 0111010, 0011101, 1001110, \\ 0100111, 1010011, 1101001\}.$$

What is the error-correcting capability of  $C$ ? What is the error-detecting capability of  $C$ ?

11. Suppose that the parity-check matrix of a binary linear code is

$$H = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \\ 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}.$$

Can the code correct any single error?

12. Use the generator matrix

$$G = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 & 2 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

to construct a  $(4, 2)$  ternary linear code. What is the parity-check matrix for this code? What is the error-correcting capability of this code? What is the error-detecting capability of this code? Use parity-check decoding to decode the received word 1201.

13. Find all code words of the  $(7, 4)$  binary linear code whose generator matrix is

$$G = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 1 & 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 & 0 & 1 & 0 & 1 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & 0 & 1 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 1 & 0 & 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix}.$$

Find the parity-check matrix of this code. Will this code correct any single error?

14. Show that in a binary linear code, either all the code words end with 0, or exactly half end with 0. What about the other components?
15. Suppose that a code word  $v$  is received as the vector  $u$ . Show that coset decoding will decode  $u$  as the code word  $v$  if and only if  $u - v$  is a coset leader.
16. Consider the binary linear code

$$C = \{00000, 10011, 01010, 11001, 00101, 10110, 01111, 11100\}.$$

Construct a standard array for  $C$ . Use nearest-neighbor decoding to decode 11101 and 01100. If the received word 11101 has exactly one error, can we determine the intended code word? If the received word 01100 has exactly one error, can we determine the intended code word?

17. Construct a (6, 3) binary linear code with generator matrix

$$G = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 & 1 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 & 0 & 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & 1 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}.$$

Decode each of the received words

001001, 011000, 000110, 100001

by the following methods:

- a. Nearest-neighbor method.
  - b. Parity-check matrix method.
  - c. Coset decoding using a standard array.
  - d. Coset decoding using the syndrome method.
18. Suppose that the minimum weight of any nonzero code word in a linear code is 6. Discuss the possible options for error correction and error detection.
19. Using the code and the parity-check matrix given in Example 10, show that parity-check matrix decoding cannot detect any multiple errors (that is, two or more errors).
20. Suppose that the last row of a standard array for a binary linear code is

10000 00011 11010 01001 10101 00110 11111 01100.

Determine the code.

21. How many code words are there in a (6, 4) ternary linear code? How many possible received words are there for this code?
22. If the parity-check matrix for a binary linear code is

$$H = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix},$$

will the code correct any single error? Why?



23. Suppose that the parity-check matrix for a ternary code is

$$H = \begin{bmatrix} 2 & 1 \\ 2 & 2 \\ 1 & 2 \\ 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}.$$

Can the code correct all single errors? Give a reason for your answer.

24. Prove that for nearest-neighbor decoding, the converse of Theorem 31.2 is true.
25. Can a  $(6, 3)$  binary linear code be double-error-correcting using the nearest-neighbor method? Do not assume that the code is systematic.
26. Prove that there is no  $2 \times 5$  standard generator matrix  $G$  that will produce a  $(5, 2)$  linear code over  $Z_3$  capable of detecting all possible triple errors.
27. Why can't the nearest-neighbor method with a  $(4, 2)$  binary linear code correct all single errors?
28. Suppose that one row of a standard array for a binary code is  
000100 110000 011110 111101 101010 001001 100111 010011.  
Determine the row that contains 100001.
29. Use the field  $F = Z_2[x]/\langle x^2 + x + 1 \rangle$  to construct a  $(5, 2)$  linear code that will correct any single error.
30. Find the standard generator matrix for a  $(4, 2)$  linear code over  $Z_3$  that encodes 20 as 2012 and 11 as 1100. Determine the entire code and the parity-check matrix for the code. Will the code correct all single errors?
31. Assume that  $C$  is an  $(n, k)$  binary linear code and that, for each position  $i = 1, 2, \dots, n$ , the code  $C$  has at least one vector with a 1 in the  $i$ th position. Show that the average weight of a code word is  $n/2$ .
32. Let  $C$  be an  $(n, k)$  linear code over  $F$  such that the minimum weight of any nonzero code word is  $2t + 1$ . Show that not every vector of weight  $t + 1$  in  $F^n$  can occur as a coset leader.
33. Let  $C$  be an  $(n, k)$  binary linear code over  $F = Z_2$ . If  $v \in F^n$  but  $v \notin C$ , show that  $C \cup (v + C)$  is a linear code.
34. Let  $C$  be a binary linear code. Show that either every member of  $C$  has even weight or exactly half the members of  $C$  have even weight. (Compare with Exercise 23 in Chapter 5.)
35. Let  $C$  be an  $(n, k)$  linear code. For each  $i$  with  $1 \leq i \leq n$ , let  $C_i = \{v \in C \mid \text{the } i\text{th component of } v \text{ is } 0\}$ . Show that  $C_i$  is a subcode of  $C$ .

## Reference

1. Barry A. Cipra, “The Ubiquitous Reed-Solomon Codes,” *SIAM News* 26 (January 1993): 1, 11.

## Suggested Readings

Norman Levinson, “Coding Theory: A Counterexample to G. H. Hardy’s Conception of Applied Mathematics,” *The American Mathematical Monthly* 77 (1970): 249–258.

The eminent mathematician G. H. Hardy insisted that “real” mathematics was almost wholly useless. In this article, the author argues that coding theory refutes Hardy’s notion. Levinson uses the finite field of order 16 to construct a linear code that can correct any three errors.

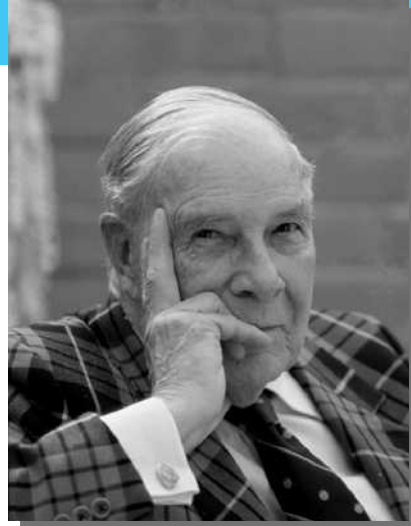
T. M. Thompson, *From Error-Correcting Codes Through Sphere Packings, to Simple Groups*, Washington, D.C.: The Mathematical Association of America, 1983.

Chapter 1 of this award-winning book gives a fascinating historical account of the origins of error-correcting codes.

## Richard W. Hamming

For introduction of error-correcting codes, pioneering work in operating systems and programming languages, and the advancement of numerical computation.

*Citation for the Piore  
Award, 1979*



Courtesy of Louis Bachrach

RICHARD W. HAMMING was born in Chicago, Illinois, on February 11, 1915. He graduated from the University of Chicago with a B.S. degree in mathematics. In 1939, he received an M.A. degree in mathematics from the University of Nebraska and, in 1942, a Ph.D. in mathematics from the University of Illinois.

During the latter part of World War II, Hamming was at Los Alamos, where he was involved in computing atomic-bomb designs. In 1946, he joined Bell Telephone Laboratories, where he worked in mathematics, computing, engineering, and science.

In 1950, Hamming published his famous paper on error-detecting and error-correcting codes. This work started a branch of information theory. The Hamming codes are used in many modern computers. Hamming's work in the field of numerical analysis has also been of fundamental importance.

Hamming received numerous prestigious awards, including the Turing Prize from the Association for Computing Machinery, the Piore Award from the Institute of Electrical and Electronics Engineers (IEEE), and the Oender Award from the University of Pennsylvania. In 1986 the IEEE Board of Directors established the Richard W. Hamming Medal "for exceptional contributions to information sciences, systems and technology" and named Hamming as its first recipient. Hamming died of a heart attack on January 7, 1998, at age 82.

To find more information about Hamming, visit:

**[http://www-groups.dcs.st-and  
.ac.uk/~history/](http://www-groups.dcs.st-and.ac.uk/~history/)**

## Jessie MacWilliams

She was a mathematician who was instrumental in developing the mathematical theory of error-correcting codes from its early development and whose Ph.D. thesis includes one of the most powerful theorems in coding theory.

VERA PLESS, *SIAM News*



Courtesy Walter MacWilliams

An important contributor to coding theory was Jessie MacWilliams. She was born in 1917 in England. After studying at Cambridge University, MacWilliams came to the United States in 1939 to attend Johns Hopkins University. After one year at Johns Hopkins, she went to Harvard for a year.

In 1955, MacWilliams became a programmer at Bell Labs, where she learned about coding theory. Although she made a major discovery about codes while a programmer, she could not obtain a promotion to a math research position without a Ph.D. degree. She completed some of the requirements for the Ph.D. while working full-time at Bell Labs and looking after her family. She then returned to Harvard for a year (1961–1962), where she finished her degree. Interestingly, both MacWilliams and her daughter Ann were studying mathematics at Harvard at the same time.

MacWilliams returned to Bell Labs, where she remained until her retirement in 1983. The Institute of Electrical and Electronics Engineers published an issue of its journal *IEEE on Information Theory Transactions* containing papers dedicated to her in 1983. While at Bell Labs, she made many contributions to the subject of error-correcting codes, including *The Theory of Error-Correcting Codes*, written jointly with Neil Sloane. One of her results of great theoretical importance is known as the MacWilliams Identity. She died on May 27, 1990, at the age of 73.

To find more information about MacWilliams, visit:

**[http://www.awm-math.org/  
noetherbrochure/  
MacWilliams80.html](http://www.awm-math.org/noetherbrochure/MacWilliams80.html)**

## Vera Pless

Vera Pless is a leader in the field of coding theory.



Courtesy Vera Pless

VERA PLESS was born on March 5, 1931, to Russian immigrants on the West Side of Chicago. She accepted a scholarship to attend the University of Chicago at age 15. The program at Chicago emphasized great literature but paid little attention to physics and mathematics. At age 18, with no more than one precalculus course in mathematics, she entered the prestigious graduate program in mathematics at Chicago, where, at that time, there were no women on the mathematics faculty or even women colloquium speakers. After passing her master's exam, she took a job as a research associate at Northwestern University while pursuing a Ph.D. there. In 1957, she obtained her degree.

Over the next several years, Pless stayed at home to raise her children while teaching

part-time at Boston University. When she decided to work full-time, she found that women were not welcome at most colleges and universities. One person told her outright, "I would never hire a woman." Fortunately, there was an Air Force Lab in the area that had a group working on error-correcting codes. Although she had never even heard of coding theory, she was hired because of her background in algebra. When the lab discontinued basic research, she took a position as a research associate at MIT in 1972. In 1975, she went to the University of Illinois–Chicago, where she remained until her retirement.

During her career, Pless wrote more than 100 research papers, authored a widely used textbook on coding theory, and had 11 Ph. D. students.

# 32 An Introduction to Galois Theory

It [Galois's work] is now considered as one of the pillars of modern mathematics.

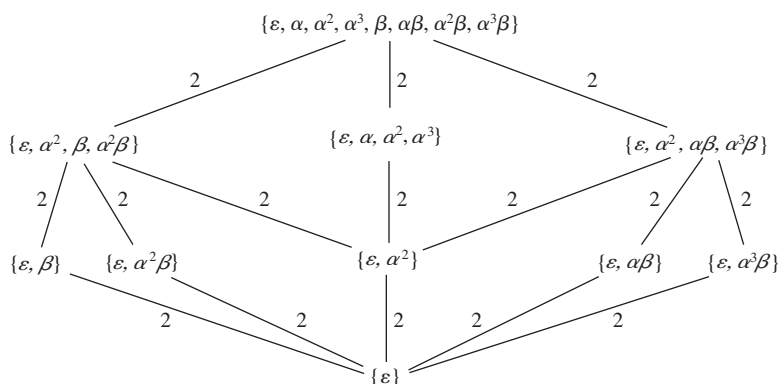
Edward Frenkel, *Love and Math*

Today 'Galois groups' are ubiquitous in the literature, and the group idea has proved to be perhaps the most versatile in all mathematics, clarifying many a deep mystery. "When in doubt," the great André Weil advised, look for the group. "That's the *cherchez la femme* of mathematics."

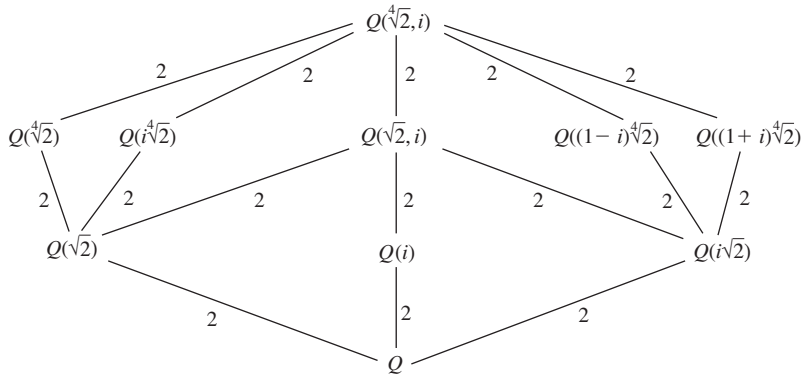
Jim Holt, *The New York Review of Books*, December 5, 2013

## Fundamental Theorem of Galois Theory

The Fundamental Theorem of Galois Theory is one of the most elegant theorems in mathematics. Look at Figures 32.1 and 32.2. Figure 32.1 depicts the lattice of subgroups of the group of field automorphisms of



**Figure 32.1** Lattice of subgroups of the group of field automorphisms of  $\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt[4]{2}, i)$ , where  $\alpha: i \rightarrow i$  and  $\sqrt[4]{2} \rightarrow -i\sqrt[4]{2}$ ,  $\beta: i \rightarrow -i$ , and  $\sqrt[4]{2} \rightarrow \sqrt[4]{2}$ .



**Figure 32.2** Lattice of subfields of  $Q(\sqrt[4]{2}, i)$ .

$Q(\sqrt[4]{2}, i)$ . The integer along an upward lattice line from a group  $H_1$  to a group  $H_2$  is the index of  $H_1$  in  $H_2$ . Figure 32.2 shows the lattice of subfields of  $Q(\sqrt[4]{2}, i)$ . The integer along an upward line from a field  $K_1$  to a field  $K_2$  is the degree of  $K_2$  over  $K_1$ . Notice that the lattice in Figure 32.2 is the lattice of Figure 32.1 turned upside down. This is only one of many relationships between these two lattices. The Fundamental Theorem of Galois Theory relates the lattice of subfields of an algebraic extension  $E$  of a field  $F$  to the subgroup structure of the group of automorphisms of  $E$  that send each element of  $F$  to itself. This relationship was discovered in the process of attempting to solve a polynomial equation  $f(x) = 0$  by radicals.

Before we can give a precise statement of the Fundamental Theorem of Galois Theory, we need some terminology and notation.

### **Definitions** Automorphism, Galois Group, Fixed Field of $H$

Let  $E$  be an extension field of the field  $F$ . An *automorphism* of  $E$  is a ring isomorphism from  $E$  onto  $E$ . The *Galois group* of  $E$  over  $F$ ,  $\text{Gal}(E/F)$ , is the set of all automorphisms of  $E$  that take every element of  $F$  to itself. If  $H$  is a subgroup of  $\text{Gal}(E/F)$ , the set

$$E_H = \{x \in E \mid \phi(x) = x \text{ for all } \phi \in H\}$$

is called the *fixed field* of  $H$ .

It is easy to show that the set of automorphisms of  $E$  forms a group under composition. We leave as exercises (Exercises 3 and 5) the verifications that the automorphism group of  $E$  fixing  $F$  is a subgroup of the automorphism group of  $E$  and that, for any subgroup  $H$  of  $\text{Gal}(E/F)$ , the fixed field  $E_H$  of  $H$  is a subfield of  $E$ . Be careful not to misinterpret  $\text{Gal}(E/F)$  as something that has to do with factor rings or factor groups. It does not.

The following examples will help you assimilate these definitions. In each example, we simply indicate how the automorphisms are defined. We leave to the reader the verifications that the mappings are indeed automorphisms.

■ **EXAMPLE 1** Consider the extension  $Q(\sqrt{2})$  of  $Q$ . Since

$$Q(\sqrt{2}) = \{a + b\sqrt{2} \mid a, b \in Q\}$$

and any automorphism of a field containing  $Q$  must act as the identity on  $Q$  (Exercise 1), an automorphism  $\phi$  of  $Q(\sqrt{2})$  is completely determined by  $\phi(\sqrt{2})$ . Thus,

$$2 = \phi(2) = \phi(\sqrt{2}\sqrt{2}) = (\phi(\sqrt{2}))^2,$$

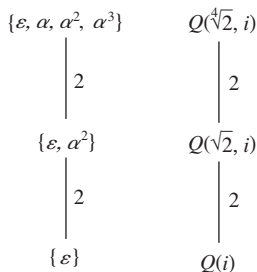
and therefore  $\phi(\sqrt{2}) = \pm\sqrt{2}$ . This proves that the group  $\text{Gal}(Q(\sqrt{2})/Q)$  has two elements, the identity mapping and the mapping that sends  $a + b\sqrt{2}$  to  $a - b\sqrt{2}$ . ■

■ **EXAMPLE 2** Consider the extension  $Q(\sqrt[3]{2})$  of  $Q$ . An automorphism  $\phi$  of  $Q(\sqrt[3]{2})$  is completely determined by  $\phi(\sqrt[3]{2})$ . By an argument analogous to that in Example 1, we see that  $\phi(\sqrt[3]{2})$  must be a cube root of 2. Since  $Q(\sqrt[3]{2})$  is a subset of the real numbers and  $\sqrt[3]{2}$  is the only real cube root of 2, we must have  $\phi(\sqrt[3]{2}) = \sqrt[3]{2}$ . Thus,  $\phi$  is the identity automorphism and  $\text{Gal}(Q(\sqrt[3]{2})/Q)$  has only one element. Obviously, the fixed field of  $\text{Gal}(Q(\sqrt[3]{2})/Q)$  is  $Q(\sqrt[3]{2})$ . ■

■ **EXAMPLE 3** Consider the extension  $Q(\sqrt[4]{2}, i)$  of  $Q(i)$ . Any automorphism  $\phi$  of  $Q(\sqrt[4]{2}, i)$  fixing  $Q(i)$  is completely determined by  $\phi(\sqrt[4]{2})$ . Since

$$2 = \phi(2) = \phi((\sqrt[4]{2})^4) = (\phi(\sqrt[4]{2}))^4,$$

we see that  $\phi(\sqrt[4]{2})$  must be a fourth root of 2. Thus, there are at most four possible automorphisms of  $Q(\sqrt[4]{2}, i)$  fixing  $Q(i)$ . If we define an



**Figure 32.3** Lattice of subgroups of  $\text{Gal}(Q(\sqrt[4]{2}, i)/Q(i))$  and lattice of subfields of  $Q(\sqrt[4]{2}, i)$  containing  $Q(i)$ .



automorphism  $\alpha$  such that  $\alpha(i) = i$  and  $\alpha(\sqrt[4]{2}) = i\sqrt[4]{2}$ , then  $\alpha \in \text{Gal}(Q(\sqrt[4]{2}, i)/Q(i))$  and  $\alpha$  has order 4. Thus,  $\text{Gal}(Q(\sqrt[4]{2}, i)/Q(i))$  is a cyclic group of order 4. The fixed field of  $\{\varepsilon, \alpha^2\}$  (where  $\varepsilon$  is the identity automorphism) is  $Q(\sqrt{2}, i)$ . The lattice of subgroups of  $\text{Gal}(Q(\sqrt[4]{2}, i)/Q(i))$  and the lattice of subfields of  $Q(\sqrt[4]{2}, i)$  containing  $Q(i)$  are shown in Figure 32.3. As in Figures 32.1 and 32.2, the integers along the lines of the group lattice represent the index of a subgroup in the group above it, and the integers along the lines of the field lattice represent the degree of the extension of a field over the field below it. ■

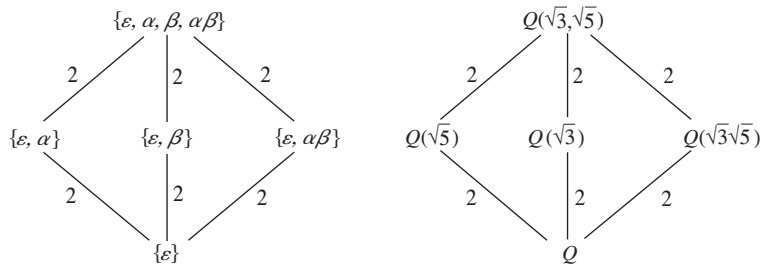
■ **EXAMPLE 4** Consider the extension  $Q(\sqrt{3}, \sqrt{5})$  of  $Q$ . Since

$$Q(\sqrt{3}, \sqrt{5}) = \{a + b\sqrt{3} + c\sqrt{5} + d\sqrt{3}\sqrt{5} \mid a, b, c, d \in Q\},$$

any automorphism  $\phi$  of  $Q(\sqrt{3}, \sqrt{5})$  is completely determined by the two values  $\phi(\sqrt{3})$  and  $\phi(\sqrt{5})$ . This time there are four automorphisms.

| $\varepsilon$                   | $\alpha$                         | $\beta$                          | $\alpha\beta$                    |
|---------------------------------|----------------------------------|----------------------------------|----------------------------------|
| $\sqrt{3} \rightarrow \sqrt{3}$ | $\sqrt{3} \rightarrow -\sqrt{3}$ | $\sqrt{5} \rightarrow \sqrt{5}$  | $\sqrt{5} \rightarrow -\sqrt{5}$ |
| $\sqrt{5} \rightarrow \sqrt{5}$ | $\sqrt{5} \rightarrow \sqrt{5}$  | $\sqrt{5} \rightarrow -\sqrt{5}$ | $\sqrt{5} \rightarrow -\sqrt{5}$ |

Obviously,  $\text{Gal}(Q(\sqrt{3}, \sqrt{5})/Q)$  is isomorphic to  $Z_2 \oplus Z_2$ . The fixed field of  $\{\varepsilon, \alpha\}$  is  $Q(\sqrt{5})$ , the fixed field of  $\{\varepsilon, \beta\}$  is  $Q(\sqrt{3})$ , and the fixed field of  $\{\varepsilon, \alpha\beta\}$  is  $Q(\sqrt{3}\sqrt{5})$ . The lattice of subgroups of  $\text{Gal}(Q(\sqrt{3}, \sqrt{5})/Q)$  and the lattice of subfields of  $Q(\sqrt{3}, \sqrt{5})$  are shown in Figure 32.4. ■



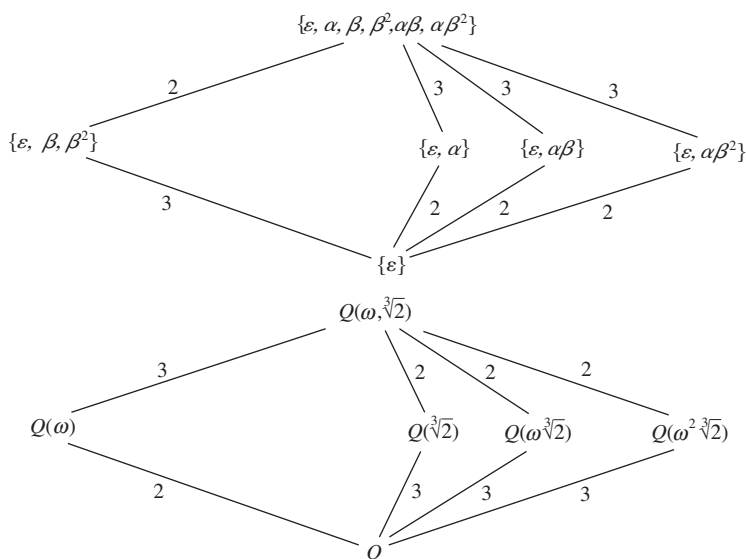
**Figure 32.4** Lattice of subgroups of  $\text{Gal}(Q(\sqrt{3}, \sqrt{5})/Q)$  and lattice of subfields of  $Q(\sqrt{3}, \sqrt{5})$ .

Example 5 is a bit more complicated than our previous examples. In particular, the automorphism group is non-Abelian.

■ **EXAMPLE 5** Direct calculations show that  $\omega = -1/2 + i\sqrt{3}/2$  satisfies the equations  $\omega^3 = 1$  and  $\omega^2 + \omega + 1 = 0$ . Now, consider the extension  $Q(\omega, \sqrt[3]{2})$  of  $Q$ . We may describe the automorphisms of  $Q(\omega, \sqrt[3]{2})$  by specifying how they act on  $\omega$  and  $\sqrt[3]{2}$ . There are six in all.

| $\varepsilon$                                                        | $\alpha$                                                               | $\beta$                                                                    | $\beta^2$                                                                    | $\alpha\beta$                                                                  | $\alpha\beta^2$                                                              |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| $\omega \rightarrow \omega$<br>$\sqrt[3]{2} \rightarrow \sqrt[3]{2}$ | $\omega \rightarrow \omega^2$<br>$\sqrt[3]{2} \rightarrow \sqrt[3]{2}$ | $\omega \rightarrow \omega$<br>$\sqrt[3]{2} \rightarrow \omega\sqrt[3]{2}$ | $\omega \rightarrow \omega$<br>$\sqrt[3]{2} \rightarrow \omega^2\sqrt[3]{2}$ | $\omega \rightarrow \omega^2$<br>$\sqrt[3]{2} \rightarrow \omega^2\sqrt[3]{2}$ | $\omega \rightarrow \omega^2$<br>$\sqrt[3]{2} \rightarrow \omega\sqrt[3]{2}$ |

Since  $\alpha\beta \neq \beta\alpha$ , we know that  $\text{Gal}(Q(\omega, \sqrt[3]{2})/Q)$  is isomorphic to  $S_3$ . (See Theorem 7.2.) The lattices of subgroups and subfields are shown in Figure 32.5.



**Figure 32.5** Lattice of subgroups of  $\text{Gal}(Q(\omega, \sqrt[3]{2})/Q)$  and lattice of subfields of  $Q(\omega, \sqrt[3]{2})$ , where  $\omega = -1/2 + i\sqrt{3}/2$ .

The lattices in Figure 32.5 have been arranged so that each nontrivial proper field occupying the same position as some group is the fixed field of that group. For instance,  $Q(\omega\sqrt[3]{2})$  is the fixed field of  $\{\varepsilon, \alpha\beta\}$ . ■

The preceding examples show that, in certain cases, there is an intimate connection between the lattice of subfields between  $E$  and  $F$  and the lattice of subgroups of  $\text{Gal}(E/F)$ . In general, if  $E$  is an extension of  $F$ , and we let  $\mathcal{F}$  be the lattice of subfields of  $E$  containing  $F$  and let  $\mathcal{G}$  be the lattice of subgroups of  $\text{Gal}(E/F)$ , then for each  $K$  in  $\mathcal{F}$ , the group  $\text{Gal}(E/K)$  is in  $\mathcal{G}$ , and for each  $H$  in  $\mathcal{G}$ , the field  $E_H$  is in  $\mathcal{F}$ . Thus, we may define a mapping  $g: \mathcal{F} \rightarrow \mathcal{G}$  by  $g(K) = \text{Gal}(E/K)$  and a mapping  $f: \mathcal{G} \rightarrow \mathcal{F}$  by  $f(H) = E_H$ . It is easy to show that if  $K$  and  $L$  belong to  $\mathcal{F}$  and  $K \subseteq L$ , then  $g(K) \supseteq g(L)$ . Similarly, if  $G$  and  $H$  belong to  $\mathcal{G}$  and  $G \subseteq H$ , then  $f(G) \supseteq f(H)$ . Thus,  $f$  and  $g$  are inclusion-reversing mappings between  $\mathcal{F}$  and  $\mathcal{G}$ . We leave it to the reader to show that for any  $K$

in  $\mathcal{F}$ , we have  $(fg)(K) \supseteq K$ , and for any  $G$  in  $\mathcal{G}$ , we have  $(gf)(G) \supseteq G$ . When  $E$  is an arbitrary extension of  $F$ , these inclusions may be strict. However, when  $E$  is a suitably chosen extension of  $F$ , the Fundamental Theorem of Galois Theory, Theorem 32.1, says that  $f$  and  $g$  are inverses of each other, so that the inclusions are equalities. In particular,  $f$  and  $g$  are inclusion-reversing isomorphisms between the lattices  $\mathcal{F}$  and  $\mathcal{G}$ . A stronger result than that given in Theorem 32.1 is true, but our theorem illustrates the fundamental principles involved. The student is referred to [1, p. 285] for additional details and proofs.

### ■ Theorem 32.1 Fundamental Theorem of Galois Theory

*Let  $F$  be a field of characteristic 0 or a finite field. If  $E$  is the splitting field over  $F$  for some polynomial in  $F[x]$ , then the mapping from the set of subfields of  $E$  containing  $F$  to the set of subgroups of  $\text{Gal}(E/F)$  given by  $K \rightarrow \text{Gal}(E/K)$  is a one-to-one correspondence. Furthermore, for any subfield  $K$  of  $E$  containing  $F$ ,*

1.  $[E:K] = |\text{Gal}(E/K)|$  and  $[K:F] = |\text{Gal}(E/F)| / |\text{Gal}(E/K)|$ . [The index of  $\text{Gal}(E/K)$  in  $\text{Gal}(E/F)$  equals the degree of  $K$  over  $F$ .]
2. If  $K$  is the splitting field of some polynomial in  $F[x]$ , then  $\text{Gal}(E/K)$  is a normal subgroup of  $\text{Gal}(E/F)$  and  $\text{Gal}(K/F)$  is isomorphic to  $\text{Gal}(E/F)/\text{Gal}(E/K)$ .
3.  $K = E_{\text{Gal}(E/K)}$ . [The fixed field of  $\text{Gal}(E/K)$  is  $K$ .]
4. If  $H$  is a subgroup of  $\text{Gal}(E/F)$ , then  $H = \text{Gal}(E/E_H)$ . [The automorphism group of  $E$  fixing  $E_H$  is  $H$ .]

Generally speaking, it is much easier to determine a lattice of subgroups than a lattice of subfields. For example, it is usually quite difficult to determine, directly, how many subfields a given field has, and it is often difficult to decide whether or not two extensions are the same. The corresponding questions about groups are much more tractable. Hence, the Fundamental Theorem of Galois Theory can be a great labor-saving device. Here is an illustration. [Recall from Chapter 20 that if  $f(x) \in F[x]$  and the zeros of  $f(x)$  in some extension of  $F$  are  $a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n$ , then  $F(a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n)$  is the splitting field of  $f(x)$  over  $F$ .]

■ **EXAMPLE 6** Let  $\omega = \cos(2\pi/7) + i \sin(2\pi/7)$ , so that  $\omega^7 = 1$ , and consider the field  $Q(\omega)$ . How many subfields does it have and what are they? First, observe that  $Q(\omega)$  is the splitting field of  $x^7 - 1$  over  $Q$ , so that we may apply the Fundamental Theorem of Galois Theory. A simple calculation shows that the automorphism  $\phi$  that sends  $\omega$  to  $\omega^3$  has order 6. Thus,

$$[Q(\omega):Q] = |\text{Gal}(Q(\omega)/Q)| \geq 6.$$

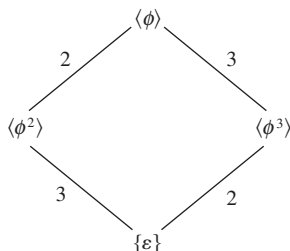
Also, since

$$x^7 - 1 = (x - 1)(x^6 + x^5 + x^4 + x^3 + x^2 + x + 1)$$

and  $\omega$  is a zero of  $x^7 - 1$ , we see that

$$|\text{Gal}(Q(\omega)/Q)| = [Q(\omega):Q] \leq 6.$$

Thus,  $\text{Gal}(Q(\omega)/Q)$  is a cyclic group of order 6. So, the lattice of subgroups of  $\text{Gal}(Q(\omega)/Q)$  is trivial to compute. See Figure 32.6.



**Figure 32.6** Lattice of subgroups of  $\text{Gal}(Q(\omega)/Q)$ , where  $\omega = \cos(2\pi/7) + i\sin(2\pi/7)$ .

This means that  $Q(\omega)$  contains exactly two proper extensions of  $Q$ : one of degree 3 corresponding to the fixed field of  $\langle\phi^3\rangle$  and one of degree 2 corresponding to the fixed field of  $\langle\phi^2\rangle$ . To find the fixed field of  $\langle\phi^3\rangle$ , we must find a member of  $Q(\omega)$  that is not in  $Q$  and that is fixed by  $\phi^3$ . Experimenting with various possibilities leads us to discover that  $\omega + \omega^{-1}$  is fixed by  $\phi^3$  (see Exercise 9), and it follows that  $Q \subset Q(\omega + \omega^{-1}) \subseteq Q(\omega)_{\langle\phi^3\rangle}$ . Since  $[Q(\omega)_{\langle\phi^3\rangle}:Q] = 3$  and  $[Q(\omega + \omega^{-1}):Q]$  divides  $[Q(\omega)_{\langle\phi^3\rangle}:Q]$ , we see that  $Q(\omega + \omega^{-1}) = Q(\omega)_{\langle\phi^3\rangle}$ . A similar argument shows that  $Q(\omega^3 + \omega^5 + \omega^6)$  is the fixed field of  $\langle\phi^2\rangle$ . Thus, we have found all subfields of  $Q(\omega)$ . ■

**EXAMPLE 7** Consider the extension  $E = \text{GF}(p^n)$  of  $F = \text{GF}(p)$ . Let us determine  $\text{Gal}(E/F)$ . By Corollary 2 of Theorem 22.2,  $E$  has the form  $F(b)$  for some  $b$  where  $b$  is the zero of an irreducible polynomial  $p(x)$  of the form  $x^n + a_{n-1}x^{n-1} + \cdots + a_1x + a_0$ , where  $a_{n-1}, a_{n-2}, \dots, a_0$  belong to  $F$ . Since any field automorphism  $\phi$  of  $E$  must take 1 to itself, it follows that  $\phi$  acts as the identity on  $F$ . Thus,  $p(b) = 0$  implies that  $p(\phi(b)) = 0$ . And because  $p(x)$  has at most  $n$  zeros, we know that there are at most  $n$  possibilities for  $\phi(b)$ . On the other hand, by Exercise 49 in Chapter 13, we know that the mapping  $\sigma(a) = a^p$  for all  $a \in E$  is an automorphism of  $E$ , and it follows from the fact that  $E^*$  is cyclic (Theorem 22.2) that the

group  $\langle \sigma \rangle$  has order  $n$  (see Exercise 11 in Chapter 22). Thus,  $\text{Gal}(\text{GF}(p^n)/\text{GF}(p)) \approx Z_n$ . ■

## Solvability of Polynomials by Radicals

For Galois, the elegant correspondence between groups and fields given by Theorem 32.1 was only a means to an end. Galois sought to solve a problem that had stymied mathematicians for centuries. Methods for solving linear and quadratic equations were known thousands of years ago (the quadratic formula). In the 16th century, Italian mathematicians developed formulas for solving any third- or fourth-degree equation. Their formulas involved only the operations of addition, subtraction, multiplication, division, and extraction of roots (radicals). For example, the equation

$$x^3 + bx + c = 0$$

has the three solutions

$$\begin{aligned} & A + B, \\ & -(A + B)/2 + (A - B)\sqrt{-3}/2, \\ & -(A + B)/2 - (A - B)\sqrt{-3}/2, \end{aligned}$$

where

$$A = \sqrt[3]{\frac{-c}{2} + \sqrt{\frac{b^3}{27} + \frac{c^2}{4}}} \quad \text{and} \quad B = \sqrt[3]{\frac{-c}{2} - \sqrt{\frac{b^3}{27} + \frac{c^2}{4}}}.$$

The formulas for the general cubic  $x^3 + ax^2 + bx + c = 0$  and the general quartic (fourth-degree polynomial) are even more complicated, but nevertheless can be given in terms of radicals of rational expressions of the coefficients.

Both Abel and Galois proved that there is no general solution of a fifth-degree equation by radicals. In particular, there is no “quintic formula.” Before discussing Galois’s method, which provided a group theoretic criterion for the solution of an equation by radicals and led to the modern-day Galois theory, we need a few definitions.

### Definition Solvable by Radicals

Let  $F$  be a field, and let  $f(x) \in F[x]$ . We say that  $f(x)$  is *solvable by radicals over  $F$*  if  $f(x)$  splits in some extension  $F(a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n)$  of  $F$  and there exist positive integers  $k_1, \dots, k_n$  such that  $a_1^{k_1} \in F$  and  $a_i^{k_i} \in F(a_1, \dots, a_{i-1})$  for  $i = 2, \dots, n$ .

So, a polynomial in  $F[x]$  is solvable by radicals if we can obtain all of its zeros by adjoining  $n$ th roots (for various  $n$ ) to  $F$ . In other words, each zero of the polynomial can be written as an expression (usually a messy one) involving elements of  $F$  combined by the operations of addition, subtraction, multiplication, division, and extraction of roots.

■ **EXAMPLE 8** Let  $\omega = \cos(2\pi/8) + i \sin(2\pi/8) = \sqrt{2}/2 + i\sqrt{2}/2$ . Then  $x^8 - 3$  splits in  $Q(\omega, \sqrt[8]{3})$ ,  $\omega^8 \in Q$ , and  $(\sqrt[8]{3})^8 \in Q \subset Q(\omega)$ . Thus,  $x^8 - 3$  is solvable by radicals over  $Q$ . Although the zeros of  $x^8 - 3$  are most conveniently written in the form  $\sqrt[8]{3}$ ,  $\sqrt[8]{3} \omega$ ,  $\sqrt[8]{3} \omega^2$ ,  $\dots$ ,  $\sqrt[8]{3} \omega^7$ , the notion of solvable by radicals is best illustrated by writing them in the form

$$\begin{aligned} \pm \sqrt[8]{3}, \pm \sqrt{-1} \sqrt[8]{3}, \pm \sqrt[8]{3} \left( \frac{\sqrt{2}}{2} + \frac{\sqrt{-1}\sqrt{2}}{2} \right), \\ \pm \sqrt[8]{3} \left( \frac{\sqrt{2}}{2} - \frac{\sqrt{-1}\sqrt{2}}{2} \right). \quad \blacksquare \end{aligned}$$

Thus, the problem of solving a polynomial equation for its zeros can be transformed into a problem about field extensions. At the same time, we can use the Fundamental Theorem of Galois Theory to transform a problem about field extensions into a problem about groups. This is exactly how Galois showed that there are fifth-degree polynomials that cannot be solved by radicals, and this is exactly how we will do it. Before giving an example of such a polynomial, we need some additional group theory.

### Definition Solvable Group

We say that a group  $G$  is *solvable* if  $G$  has a series of subgroups

$$\{e\} = H_0 \subset H_1 \subset H_2 \subset \cdots \subset H_k = G,$$

where, for each  $0 \leq i < k$ ,  $H_i$  is normal in  $H_{i+1}$  and  $H_{i+1}/H_i$  is Abelian.

Obviously, Abelian groups are solvable. So are the dihedral groups and any group whose order has the form  $p^n$ , where  $p$  is a prime (see Exercises 28 and 29). The monumental Feit–Thompson Theorem (see Chapter 25) says that every group of odd order is solvable. In a certain sense, solvable groups are almost Abelian. On the other hand, it follows directly from the definitions that any non-Abelian simple group is not solvable. In particular,  $A_5$  is not solvable. It follows from Exercise 21 in Chapter 25 that  $S_5$  is not solvable. Our goal is to connect the notion of solvability of polynomials by radicals to that of solvable groups. The next theorem is a step in this direction.

### ■ Theorem 32.2 Condition for $\text{Gal}(E/F)$ to be Solvable

*Let  $F$  be a field of characteristic 0 and let  $a \in F$ . If  $E$  is the splitting field of  $x^n - a$  over  $F$ , then the Galois group  $\text{Gal}(E/F)$  is solvable.*

**PROOF** We first handle the case where  $F$  contains a primitive  $n$ th root of unity  $\omega$ . Let  $b$  be a zero of  $x^n - a$  in  $E$ . Then the zeros of  $x^n - a$  are  $b, \omega b, \omega^2 b, \dots, \omega^{n-1} b$ , and therefore  $E = F(b)$ . In this case, we claim that  $\text{Gal}(E/F)$  is Abelian and hence solvable. To see this, observe that any automorphism in  $\text{Gal}(E/F)$  is completely determined by its action on  $b$ . Also, since  $b$  is a zero of  $x^n - a$ , we know that any element of  $\text{Gal}(E/F)$  sends  $b$  to another zero of  $x^n - a$ . That is, any element of  $\text{Gal}(E/F)$  takes  $b$  to  $\omega^i b$  for some  $i$ . Let  $\phi$  and  $\sigma$  be two elements of  $\text{Gal}(E/F)$ . Then, since  $\omega \in F$ ,  $\phi$  and  $\sigma$  fix  $\omega$  and  $\phi(b) = \omega^j b$  and  $\sigma(b) = \omega^k b$  for some  $j$  and  $k$ . Thus,

$$(\sigma\phi)(b) = \sigma(\phi(b)) = \sigma(\omega^j b) = \sigma(\omega^j)\sigma(b) = \omega^j \omega^k b = \omega^{j+k} b,$$

whereas

$$(\phi\sigma)(b) = \phi(\sigma(b)) = \phi(\omega^k b) = \phi(\omega^k)\phi(b) = \omega^k \omega^j b = \omega^{k+j} b,$$

so that  $\sigma\phi$  and  $\phi\sigma$  agree on  $b$  and fix the elements of  $F$ . This shows that  $\sigma\phi = \phi\sigma$ , and therefore  $\text{Gal}(E/F)$  is Abelian.

Now suppose that  $F$  does not contain a primitive  $n$ th root of unity. Let  $\omega$  be a primitive  $n$ th root of unity and let  $b$  be a zero of  $x^n - a$  in  $E$ . The case where  $a = 0$  is trivial, so we may assume that  $b \neq 0$ . Since  $\omega b$  is also a zero of  $x^n - a$ , we know that both  $b$  and  $\omega b$  belong to  $E$ , and therefore  $\omega = \omega b/b$  is in  $E$  as well. Thus,  $F(\omega)$  is contained in  $E$ , and  $F(\omega)$  is the splitting field of  $x^n - 1$  over  $F$ . Analogously to the case above, for any automorphisms  $\phi$  and  $\sigma$  in  $\text{Gal}(F(\omega)/F)$  we have  $\phi(\omega) = \omega^j$  for some  $j$  and  $\sigma(\omega) = \omega^k$  for some  $k$ . Then,

$$\begin{aligned} (\sigma\phi)(\omega) &= \sigma(\phi(\omega)) = \sigma(\omega^j) = (\sigma(\omega))^j = (\omega^k)^j \\ &= (\omega^j)^k = (\phi(\omega))^k = \phi(\omega^k) = \phi(\sigma(\omega)) = (\phi\sigma)(\omega). \end{aligned}$$

Since elements of  $\text{Gal}(F(\omega)/F)$  are completely determined by their action on  $\omega$ , this shows that  $\text{Gal}(F(\omega)/F)$  is Abelian.

Because  $E$  is the splitting field of  $x^n - a$  over  $F(\omega)$  and  $F(\omega)$  contains a primitive  $n$ th root of unity, we know from the case we have already done that  $\text{Gal}(E/F(\omega))$  is Abelian and, by Part 2 of Theorem 32.1, the series

$$\{e\} \subseteq \text{Gal}(E/F(\omega)) \subseteq \text{Gal}(E/F)$$

is a normal series. Finally, since both  $\text{Gal}(E/F(\omega))$  and

$$\text{Gal}(E/F)/\text{Gal}(E/F(\omega)) \approx \text{Gal}(F(\omega)/F)$$

are Abelian,  $\text{Gal}(E/F)$  is solvable. ■

To reach our main result about polynomials that are solvable by radicals, we need two important facts about solvable groups.

### ■ Theorem 32.3 Factor Group of a Solvable Group Is Solvable

*A factor group of a solvable group is solvable.*

**PROOF** Suppose that  $G$  has a series of subgroups

$$\{e\} = H_0 \subset H_1 \subset H_2 \subset \cdots \subset H_k = G,$$

where, for each  $0 \leq i < k$ ,  $H_i$  is normal in  $H_{i+1}$  and  $H_{i+1}/H_i$  is Abelian. If  $N$  is any normal subgroup of  $G$ , then

$$\{e\} = H_0N/N \subset H_1N/N \subset H_2N/N \subset \cdots \subset H_kN/N = G/N$$

is the requisite series of subgroups that guarantees that  $G/N$  is solvable. (See Exercise 31.) ■

### ■ Theorem 32.4 $N$ and $G/N$ Solvable Implies $G$ Is Solvable

*Let  $N$  be a normal subgroup of a group  $G$ . If both  $N$  and  $G/N$  are solvable, then  $G$  is solvable.*

**PROOF** Let a series of subgroups of  $N$  with Abelian factors be

$$N_0 \subset N_1 \subset \cdots \subset N_t = N$$

and let a series of subgroups of  $G/N$  with Abelian factors be

$$N/N = H_0/N \subset H_1/N \subset \cdots \subset H_s/N = G/N.$$

Then the series

$$N_0 \subset N_1 \subset \cdots \subset N_t = H_0 \subset H_1 \subset \cdots \subset H_s = G$$

has Abelian factors (see Exercise 33). ■

We are now able to make the critical connection between solvability of polynomials by radicals and solvable groups.



## ■ Theorem 32.5 (Galois) Solvable by Radicals Implies Solvable Group

*Let  $F$  be a field of characteristic 0 and let  $f(x) \in F[x]$ . Suppose that  $f(x)$  splits in  $F(a_1, a_2, \dots, a_t)$ , where  $a_1^{n_1} \in F$  and  $a_i^{n_i} \in F(a_1, \dots, a_{i-1})$  for  $i = 2, \dots, t$ . Let  $E$  be the splitting field for  $f(x)$  over  $F$  in  $F(a_1, a_2, \dots, a_t)$ . Then the Galois group  $\text{Gal}(E/F)$  is solvable.*

**PROOF** We use induction on  $t$ . For the case  $t = 1$ , we have  $F \subseteq E \subseteq F(a_1)$ . Let  $a = a_1^{n_1}$  and let  $L$  be a splitting field of  $x^{n_1} - a$  over  $F$ . Then  $F \subseteq E \subseteq L$ , and both  $E$  and  $L$  are splitting fields of polynomials over  $F$ . By part 2 of Theorem 32.1,  $\text{Gal}(E/F) \approx \text{Gal}(L/F)/\text{Gal}(L/E)$ . It follows from Theorem 32.2 that  $\text{Gal}(L/F)$  is solvable, and from Theorem 32.3 we know that  $\text{Gal}(L/F)/\text{Gal}(L/E)$  is solvable. Thus,  $\text{Gal}(E/F)$  is solvable.

Now suppose  $t > 1$ . Let  $a = a_1^{n_1} \in F$ , let  $L$  be a splitting field of  $x^{n_1} - a$  over  $E$ , and let  $K \subseteq L$  be the splitting field of  $x^{n_1} - a$  over  $F$ . Then  $L$  is a splitting field of  $(x^{n_1} - a)f(x)$  over  $F$ , and  $L$  is a splitting field of  $f(x)$  over  $K$ . Since  $F(a_1) \subseteq K$ , we know that  $f(x)$  splits in  $K(a_2, \dots, a_t)$ , so the induction hypothesis implies that  $\text{Gal}(L/K)$  is solvable. Also, Theorem 32.2 asserts that  $\text{Gal}(K/F)$  is solvable, which, from Theorem 32.1, tells us that  $\text{Gal}(L/F)/\text{Gal}(L/K)$  is solvable. Hence, Theorem 32.4 implies that  $\text{Gal}(L/F)$  is solvable. So, by part 2 of Theorem 32.1 and Theorem 32.3, we know that the factor group  $\text{Gal}(L/F)/\text{Gal}(L/E) \approx \text{Gal}(E/F)$  is solvable. ■

It is worth remarking that the converse of Theorem 32.3 is true also; that is, if  $E$  is the splitting field of a polynomial  $f(x)$  over a field  $F$  of characteristic 0 and  $\text{Gal}(E/F)$  is solvable, then  $f(x)$  is solvable by radicals over  $F$ .

It is known that every finite group is a Galois group over some field. However, one of the major unsolved problems in algebra, first posed by Emmy Noether, is determining which finite groups can occur as Galois groups over  $\mathbb{Q}$ . Many people suspect that the answer is “all of them.” It is known that every solvable group is a Galois group over  $\mathbb{Q}$ . John Thompson has recently proved that certain kinds of simple groups, including the Monster, are Galois groups over  $\mathbb{Q}$ . The article by Ian Stewart listed among this chapter’s suggested readings provides more information on this topic.

## Insolvability of a Quintic

We will finish our introduction to Galois theory by explicitly exhibiting a polynomial that has integer coefficients and that is not solvable by radicals over  $\mathbb{Q}$ .

Consider  $g(x) = 3x^5 - 15x + 5$ . By Eisenstein's Criterion (Theorem 17.4),  $g(x)$  is irreducible over  $\mathbb{Q}$ . Since  $g(x)$  is continuous and  $g(-2) = -61$  and  $g(-1) = 17$ , we know that  $g(x)$  has a real zero between  $-2$  and  $-1$ . A similar analysis shows that  $g(x)$  also has real zeros between  $0$  and  $1$  and between  $1$  and  $2$ .

Each of these real zeros has multiplicity 1, as can be verified by long division or by appealing to Theorem 20.6. Furthermore,  $g(x)$  has no more than three real zeros, because Rolle's Theorem from calculus guarantees that between each pair of real zeros of  $g(x)$  there must be a zero of  $g'(x) = 15x^4 - 15$ . So, for  $g(x)$  to have four real zeros,  $g'(x)$  would have to have three real zeros, and it does not. Thus, the other two zeros of  $g(x)$  are nonreal complex numbers, say,  $a + bi$  and  $a - bi$ . (See Exercise 65 in Chapter 15.)

Now, let's denote the five zeros of  $g(x)$  by  $a_1, a_2, a_3, a_4, a_5$ . Since any automorphism of  $K = \mathbb{Q}(a_1, a_2, a_3, a_4, a_5)$  is completely determined by its action on the  $a$ 's and must permute the  $a$ 's, we know that  $\text{Gal}(K/\mathbb{Q})$  is isomorphic to a subgroup of  $S_5$ , the symmetric group on five symbols. Since  $a_1$  is a zero of an irreducible polynomial of degree 5 over  $\mathbb{Q}$ , we know that  $[\mathbb{Q}(a_1):\mathbb{Q}] = 5$ , and therefore 5 divides  $[K:\mathbb{Q}]$ . Thus, the Fundamental Theorem of Galois Theory tells us that 5 also divides  $|\text{Gal}(K/\mathbb{Q})|$ . So, by Cauchy's Theorem (corollary to Theorem 24.3), we may conclude that  $\text{Gal}(K/\mathbb{Q})$  has an element of order 5. Since the only elements in  $S_5$  of order 5 are the 5-cycles, we know that  $\text{Gal}(K/\mathbb{Q})$  contains a 5-cycle. The mapping from  $\mathbb{C}$  to  $\mathbb{C}$ , sending  $a + bi$  to  $a - bi$ , is also an element of  $\text{Gal}(K/\mathbb{Q})$ . Since this mapping fixes the three real zeros and interchanges the two complex zeros of  $g(x)$ , we know that  $\text{Gal}(K/\mathbb{Q})$  contains a 2-cycle. But, the only subgroup of  $S_5$  that contains both a 5-cycle and a 2-cycle is  $S_5$ . (See Exercise 25 in Chapter 25.) So,  $\text{Gal}(K/\mathbb{Q})$  is isomorphic to  $S_5$ . Finally, since  $S_5$  is not solvable (see Exercise 27), we have succeeded in exhibiting a fifth-degree polynomial that is not solvable by radicals.

## Exercises

Seeing much, suffering much, and studying much are the three pillars of learning.

Benjamin Disraeli

1. Let  $E$  be an extension field of  $\mathbb{Q}$ . Show that any automorphism of  $E$  acts as the identity on  $\mathbb{Q}$ . (This exercise is referred to in this chapter.)
2. Determine the group of field automorphisms of  $\text{GF}(4)$ .
3. Let  $E$  be an extension field of the field  $F$ . Show that the automorphism group of  $E$  fixing  $F$  is indeed a group. (This exercise is referred to in this chapter.)

4. Given that the automorphism group of  $Q(\sqrt{2}, \sqrt{5}, \sqrt{7})$  is isomorphic to  $Z_2 \oplus Z_2 \oplus Z_2$ , determine the number of subfields of  $Q(\sqrt{2}, \sqrt{5}, \sqrt{7})$  that have degree 4 over  $Q$ .
5. Let  $E$  be an extension field of a field  $F$  and let  $H$  be a subgroup of  $\text{Gal}(E/F)$ . Show that the fixed field of  $H$  is indeed a field. (This exercise is referred to in this chapter.)
6. Let  $E$  be the splitting field of  $x^4 + 1$  over  $Q$ . Find  $\text{Gal}(E/Q)$ . Find all subfields of  $E$ . Find the automorphisms of  $E$  that have fixed fields  $Q(\sqrt{2})$ ,  $Q(\sqrt{-2})$ , and  $Q(i)$ . Is there an automorphism of  $E$  whose fixed field is  $Q$ ?
7. Let  $f(x) \in F[x]$  and let the zeros of  $f(x)$  be  $a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n$ . If  $K = F(a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n)$ , show that  $\text{Gal}(K/F)$  is isomorphic to a group of permutations of the  $a_i$ 's. [When  $K$  is the splitting field of  $f(x)$  over  $F$ , the group  $\text{Gal}(K/F)$  is called the *Galois group of  $f(x)$* .]
8. Show that the Galois group of a polynomial of degree  $n$  has order dividing  $n!$
9. Referring to Example 6, show that the automorphism  $\phi$  has order 6. Show that  $\omega + \omega^{-1}$  is fixed by  $\phi^3$  and  $\omega^3 + \omega^5 + \omega^6$  is fixed by  $\phi^2$ . (This exercise is referred to in this chapter.)
10. Let  $E = Q(\sqrt{2}, \sqrt{5})$ . What is the order of the group  $\text{Gal}(E/Q)$ ? What is the order of  $\text{Gal}(Q(\sqrt{10})/Q)$ ?
11. Suppose that  $F$  is a field of characteristic 0 and  $E$  is the splitting field for some polynomial over  $F$ . If  $\text{Gal}(E/F)$  is isomorphic to  $Z_{20} \oplus Z_2$ , determine the number of subfields  $L$  of  $E$  there are such that  $L$  contains  $F$  and
  - a.  $[L:F] = 4$ .
  - b.  $[L:F] = 25$ .
  - c.  $\text{Gal}(E/L)$  is isomorphic to  $Z_5$ .
12. Determine the Galois group of  $x^2 - 10x + 21$  over  $Q$ . (See Exercise 7 for the definition).
13. Determine the Galois group of  $x^2 + 9$  over  $\mathbf{R}$ . (See Exercise 7 for the definition).
14. Suppose that  $F$  is a field of characteristic 0 and  $E$  is the splitting field for some polynomial over  $F$ . If  $\text{Gal}(E/F)$  is isomorphic to  $D_6$ , prove that there are exactly three fields  $L$  such that  $E \supseteq L \supseteq F$  and  $[E:L] = 6$ .
15. Suppose that  $E$  is the splitting field for some polynomial over  $\text{GF}(p)$ . If  $\text{Gal}(E/\text{GF}(p)) = p^6$ , how many fields are there strictly between  $E$  and  $\text{GF}(p)$ ?
16. Let  $p$  be a prime. Suppose that  $|\text{Gal}(E/F)| = p^2$ . Draw all possible subfield lattices for fields between  $E$  and  $F$ .

17. Suppose that  $F$  is a field of characteristic 0 and  $E$  is the splitting field for some polynomial over  $F$ . If  $\text{Gal}(E/F)$  is isomorphic to  $A_4$ , show that there is no subfield  $K$  of  $E$  such that  $[K:F] = 2$ .
18. Determine the Galois group of  $x^3 - 1$  over  $\mathbb{Q}$  and  $x^3 - 2$  over  $\mathbb{Q}$ . (See Exercise 7 for the definition.)
19. Suppose that  $K$  is the splitting field of some polynomial over a field  $F$  of characteristic 0. If  $[K:F] = p^2q$ , where  $p$  and  $q$  are distinct primes, show that  $K$  has subfields  $L_1$ ,  $L_2$ , and  $L_3$  such that  $[K:L_1] = p$ ,  $[K:L_2] = p^2$ , and  $[K:L_3] = q$ .
20. Suppose that  $E$  is the splitting field of some polynomial over a field  $F$  of characteristic 0. If  $\text{Gal}(E/F)$  is isomorphic to  $D_5$ , draw the subfield lattice for the fields between  $E$  and  $F$ .
21. Suppose that  $F \subset K \subset E$  are fields and  $E$  is the splitting field of some polynomial in  $F[x]$ . Show, by means of an example, that  $K$  need not be the splitting field of some polynomial in  $F[x]$ .
22. Suppose that  $E$  is the splitting field of some polynomial over a field  $F$  of characteristic 0. If  $[E:F]$  is finite, show that there is only a finite number of fields between  $E$  and  $F$ .
23. Suppose that  $E$  is the splitting field of some polynomial over a field  $F$  of characteristic 0. If  $\text{Gal}(E/F)$  is an Abelian group of order 10, draw the subfield lattice for the fields between  $E$  and  $F$ .
24. Let  $\omega$  be a nonreal complex number such that  $\omega^5 = 1$ . If  $\phi$  is the automorphism of  $\mathbb{Q}(\omega)$  that carries  $\omega$  to  $\omega^4$ , find the fixed field of  $\langle \phi \rangle$ .
25. Determine the isomorphism class of the group  $\text{Gal}(\text{GF}(64)/\text{GF}(2))$ .
26. Determine the isomorphism class of the group  $\text{Gal}(\text{GF}(729)/\text{GF}(9))$ .

*Exercises 27, 28, and 29 are referred to in this chapter.*

27. Show that  $S_5$  is not solvable.
28. Show that the dihedral groups are solvable.
29. Show that a group of order  $p^n$ , where  $p$  is prime, is solvable.
30. Show that  $S_n$  is solvable when  $n \leq 4$ .
31. Complete the proof of Theorem 32.3 by showing that the given series of groups satisfies the definition for solvability.
32. Show that a subgroup of a solvable group is solvable.
33. Let  $N$  be a normal subgroup of  $G$  and let  $K/N$  be a normal subgroup of  $G/N$ . Prove that  $K$  is a normal subgroup of  $G$ . (This exercise is referred to in this chapter.)
34. Show that any automorphism of  $\text{GF}(p^n)$  acts as the identity on  $\text{GF}(p)$ .

35. If  $G$  is a finite solvable group, show that there exist subgroups of  $G$

$$\{e\} = H_0 \subset H_1 \subset H_2 \subset \cdots \subset H_n = G$$

such that  $H_{i+1}/H_i$  has prime order.

36. Show that the polynomial  $x^5 - 6x + 3$  over  $\mathbb{Q}$  is not solvable by radicals.

## Reference

1. G. Ehrlich, *Fundamental Concepts of Abstract Algebra*, Boston: PWS-Kent, 1991.

## Suggested Readings

Tony Rothman, “The Short Life of Évariste Galois,” *Scientific American*, April (1982): 136–149.

This article gives an elementary discussion of Galois’s proof that the general fifth-degree equation cannot be solved by radicals. The article also goes into detail about Galois’s controversial life and death. In this regard, Rothman refutes several accounts given by other Galois biographers.

Ian Stewart, “The Duellist and the Monster,” *Nature* 317 (1985): 12–13.

This nontechnical article discusses recent work of John Thompson pertaining to the question of “which groups can occur as Galois groups.”

## Suggested Website

<http://www-groups.dcs.st-and.ac.uk/~history/>

Find more information about the history of quadratic, cubic, and quartic equations at this site.

## Philip Hall

He [Hall] was preeminent as a group theorist and made many fundamental discoveries; the conspicuous growth of interest in group theory in the 20th century owes much to him.

J. E. ROSEBLADE



Author: Konrad Jacobs, Source: Archives of the Mathematisches Forschungsinstitut Oberwolfach

PHILIP HALL was born on April 11, 1904, in London. Abandoned by his father shortly after birth, Hall was raised by his mother, a dressmaker. He demonstrated academic prowess early by winning a scholarship to Christ's Hospital, where he had several outstanding mathematics teachers. At Christ's Hospital, Hall won a medal for the best English essay, the gold medal in mathematics, and a scholarship to King's College, Cambridge.

Although abstract algebra was a field neglected at King's College, Hall studied Burnside's book *Theory of Groups* and some of Burnside's later papers. After graduating in 1925, he stayed on at King's College for further study and was elected to a fellowship in 1927. That same year, Hall discovered a major "Sylow-like" theorem about solvable groups: If a solvable group has order  $mn$ , where  $m$  and  $n$  are relatively prime, then every subgroup whose order divides  $m$  is contained in a group of order  $m$  and all subgroups of order  $m$  are conjugate. Over the next three decades, Hall developed a general

theory of finite solvable groups that had a profound influence on John Thompson's spectacular achievements of the 1960s. In the 1930s, Hall also developed a general theory of groups of prime-power order that has become a foundation of modern finite group theory. In addition to his fundamental contributions to finite groups, Hall wrote many seminal papers on infinite groups.

Among the concepts that have Hall's name attached to them are Hall subgroups, Hall algebras, Hall–Littlewood polynomials, Hall divisors, the marriage theorem from graph theory, and the Hall commutator collecting process. Beyond his own discoveries, Hall had an enormous influence on algebra through his research students. No fewer than one dozen have become eminent mathematicians in their own right. Hall died on December 30, 1982.

To find more information about Hall, visit:

<http://www-groups.dcs.st-and.ac.uk/~history/>

# 33 Cyclotomic Extensions

“... To regard old problems from a new angle requires creative imagination and marks real advances in science.”

Albert Einstein

Innovation is taking two things that already exist and putting them together in a new way.

Tom Freston

## Motivation

For the culminating chapter of this book, it is fitting to choose a topic that ties together results about groups, rings, fields, geometric constructions, and the history of mathematics. The so-called *cyclotomic extensions* is such a topic. We begin with the history.

The ancient Greeks knew how to construct regular polygons of 3, 4, 5, 6, 8, 10, 12, 15, and 16 sides with a straightedge and compass. And, given a construction of a regular  $n$ -gon, it is easy to construct a regular  $2n$ -gon. The Greeks attempted to fill in the gaps (7, 9, 11, 13, 14, 17, . . .) but failed. More than 2200 years passed before anyone was able to advance our knowledge of this problem beyond that of the Greeks. Incredibly, Gauss, at age 19, showed that a regular 17-gon is constructible, and shortly thereafter he completely solved the problem of exactly which  $n$ -gons are constructible. It was this discovery of the constructibility of the 17-sided regular polygon that induced Gauss to dedicate his life to the study of mathematics. Gauss was so proud of this accomplishment that he requested that a regular 17-sided polygon be engraved on his tombstone.

Gauss was led to his discovery of the constructible polygons through his investigation of the factorization of polynomials of the form  $x^n - 1$  over  $\mathbb{Q}$ . In this chapter, we examine the factors of  $x^n - 1$  and show how Galois theory can be used to determine which regular  $n$ -gons are constructible with a straightedge and compass. The irreducible factors of  $x^n - 1$  are important in number theory and combinatorics.

## Cyclotomic Polynomials

Recall from Example 2 in Chapter 16 that the complex zeros of  $x^n - 1$  are  $1, \omega = \cos(2\pi/n) + i \sin(2\pi/n), \omega^2, \omega^3, \dots, \omega^{n-1}$ . Thus, the splitting field of  $x^n - 1$  over  $\mathbb{Q}$  is  $\mathbb{Q}(\omega)$ . This field is called the  *$n$ th cyclotomic extension* of  $\mathbb{Q}$ , and the irreducible factors of  $x^n - 1$  over  $\mathbb{Q}$  are called the *cyclotomic polynomials*.

Since  $\omega = \cos(2\pi/n) + i \sin(2\pi/n)$  generates a cyclic group of order  $n$  under multiplication, we know from Corollary 3 of Theorem 4.2 that the generators of  $\langle \omega \rangle$  are the elements of the form  $\omega^k$ , where  $1 \leq k \leq n$  and  $\gcd(n, k) = 1$ . These generators are called the *primitive  $n$ th roots of unity*. Recalling that we use  $\phi(n)$  to denote the number of positive integers less than or equal to  $n$  and relatively prime to  $n$ , we see that for each positive integer  $n$  there are precisely  $\phi(n)$  primitive  $n$ th roots of unity. The polynomials whose zeros are the  $\phi(n)$  primitive  $n$ th roots of unity have a special name.

### Definition Cyclotomic Polynomial

For any positive integer  $n$ , let  $\omega_1, \omega_2, \dots, \omega_{\phi(n)}$  denote the primitive  $n$ th roots of unity. The  *$n$ th cyclotomic polynomial* over  $\mathbb{Q}$  is the polynomial  $\Phi_n(x) = (x - \omega_1)(x - \omega_2) \cdots (x - \omega_{\phi(n)})$ .

In particular, note that  $\Phi_n(x)$  is monic and has degree  $\phi(n)$ . In Theorem 33.2 we will prove that  $\Phi_n(x)$  has integer coefficients, and in Theorem 33.3 we will prove that  $\Phi_n(x)$  is irreducible over  $\mathbb{Z}$ .

■ **EXAMPLE 1**  $\Phi_1(x) = x - 1$ , since 1 is the only zero of  $x - 1$ .  $\Phi_2(x) = x + 1$ , since the zeros of  $x^2 - 1$  are 1 and  $-1$ , and  $-1$  is the only primitive root.  $\Phi_3(x) = (x - \omega)(x - \omega^2)$ , where  $\omega = \cos(2\pi/3) + i \sin(2\pi/3) = (-1 + i\sqrt{3})/2$ , and direct calculations show that  $\Phi_3(x) = x^2 + x + 1$ . Since the zeros of  $x^4 - 1$  are  $\pm 1$  and  $\pm i$  and only  $i$  and  $-i$  are primitive,  $\Phi_4(x) = (x - i)(x + i) = x^2 + 1$ . ■

In practice, one does not use the definition of  $\Phi_n(x)$  to compute it. Instead, one uses the formulas given in the exercises and makes recursive use of the following result.

### Theorem 33.1 $x^n - 1 = \prod_{d|n} \Phi_d(x)$

For every positive integer  $n$ ,  $x^n - 1 = \prod_{d|n} \Phi_d(x)$ , where the product runs over all positive divisors  $d$  of  $n$ .



Before proving this theorem, let us be sure that the statement is clear. For  $n = 6$ , for instance, the theorem asserts that  $x^6 - 1 = \Phi_1(x)\Phi_2(x)\Phi_3(x)\Phi_6(x)$ , since 1, 2, 3, and 6 are the positive divisors of 6.

**PROOF** Since both polynomials in the statement are monic, it suffices to show that they have the same zeros and that all zeros have multiplicity 1. Let  $\omega = \cos(2\pi/n) + i \sin(2\pi/n)$ . Then  $\langle \omega \rangle$  is a cyclic group of order  $n$ , and  $\langle \omega \rangle$  contains all the  $n$ th roots of unity. From Theorem 4.3 we know that for each  $j$ ,  $|\omega^j|$  divides  $n$  so that  $(x - \omega^j)$  appears as a factor in  $\Phi_{|\omega^j|}(x)$ . On the other hand, if  $x - \alpha$  is a linear factor of  $\Phi_d(x)$  for some divisor  $d$  of  $n$ , then  $\alpha^d = 1$ , and therefore  $\alpha^n = 1$ . Thus,  $x - \alpha$  is a factor of  $x^n - 1$ . Finally, since no zero of  $x^n - 1$  can be a zero of  $\Phi_d(x)$  for two different  $d$ 's, the result is proved. ■

Before we illustrate how Theorem 33.1 can be used to calculate  $\Phi_n(x)$  recursively, we state an important consequence of the theorem.

### ■ Theorem 33.2 $\Phi_d(x)$ has Integer Coefficients

*For every positive integer  $n$ ,  $\Phi_n(x)$  has integer coefficients.*

**PROOF** The case  $n = 1$  is trivial. By induction, we may assume that  $g(x) = \prod_{d|n, d < n} \Phi_d(x)$  has integer coefficients. From Theorem 33.1 we know that  $x^n - 1 = \Phi_n(x)g(x)$ , and, because  $g(x)$  is monic, we may carry out the division in  $\mathbb{Z}[x]$  (see Exercise 49 in Chapter 16). Thus,  $\Phi_n(x) \in \mathbb{Z}[x]$ . ■

Now let us do some calculations. If  $p$  is a prime, we have from Theorem 33.1 that  $x^p - 1 = \Phi_1(x)\Phi_p(x) = (x - 1)\Phi_p(x)$ , so that  $\Phi_p(x) = (x^p - 1)/(x - 1) = x^{p-1} + x^{p-2} + \cdots + x + 1$ . From Theorem 33.1 we have

$$x^6 - 1 = \Phi_1(x)\Phi_2(x)\Phi_3(x)\Phi_6(x),$$

so that  $\Phi_6(x) = (x^6 - 1)/((x - 1)(x + 1)(x^2 + x + 1))$ . So, by long division,  $\Phi_6(x) = x^2 - x + 1$ . Similarly,  $\Phi_{10}(x) = (x^{10} - 1)/((x - 1)(x + 1)(x^4 + x^3 + x^2 + x + 1)) = x^4 - x^3 + x^2 - x + 1$ .

The exercises provide shortcuts that often make long division unnecessary. The values of  $\Phi_n(x)$  for all  $n$  up to 15 are shown in Table 33.1. The software for the computer exercises provides the values for  $\Phi_n(x)$  for all values of  $n$  up to 1000. Judging from Table 33.1, one might be led to conjecture that 1 and  $-1$  are the only nonzero coefficients of the

**Table 33.1** The Cyclotomic Polynomials  $\Phi_n(x)$  up to  $n = 15$ 

| $n$ | $\Phi_n(x)$                                                                        |
|-----|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1   | $x - 1$                                                                            |
| 2   | $x + 1$                                                                            |
| 3   | $x^2 + x + 1$                                                                      |
| 4   | $x^2 + 1$                                                                          |
| 5   | $x^4 + x^3 + x^2 + x + 1$                                                          |
| 6   | $x^2 - x + 1$                                                                      |
| 7   | $x^6 + x^5 + x^4 + x^3 + x^2 + x + 1$                                              |
| 8   | $x^4 + 1$                                                                          |
| 9   | $x^6 + x^3 + 1$                                                                    |
| 10  | $x^4 - x^3 + x^2 - x + 1$                                                          |
| 11  | $x^{10} + x^9 + x^8 + x^7 + x^6 + x^5 + x^4 + x^3 + x^2 + x + 1$                   |
| 12  | $x^4 - x^2 + 1$                                                                    |
| 13  | $x^{12} + x^{11} + x^{10} + x^9 + x^8 + x^7 + x^6 + x^5 + x^4 + x^3 + x^2 + x + 1$ |
| 14  | $x^6 - x^5 + x^4 - x^3 + x^2 - x + 1$                                              |
| 15  | $x^8 - x^7 + x^5 - x^4 + x^3 - x + 1$                                              |

cyclotomic polynomials. However, it has been shown that every integer is a coefficient of some cyclotomic polynomial.

The next theorem reveals why the cyclotomic polynomials are important.

■ **Theorem 33.3** (Gauss)  $\Phi_n(x)$  is Irreducible Over  $\mathbb{Z}$

*The cyclotomic polynomials  $\Phi_n(x)$  are irreducible over  $\mathbb{Z}$ .*

**PROOF** Let  $f(x) \in \mathbb{Z}[x]$  be a monic irreducible factor of  $\Phi_n(x)$ . Because  $\Phi_n(x)$  is monic and has no multiple zeros, it suffices to show that every zero of  $\Phi_n(x)$  is a zero of  $f(x)$ .

Since  $\Phi_n(x)$  divides  $x^n - 1$  in  $\mathbb{Z}[x]$ , we may write  $x^n - 1 = f(x)g(x)$ , where  $g(x) \in \mathbb{Z}[x]$ . Let  $\omega$  be a primitive  $n$ th root of unity that is a zero of  $f(x)$ . Then  $f(x)$  is the minimal polynomial for  $\omega$  over  $\mathbb{Q}$ . Let  $p$  be any prime that does not divide  $n$ . Then, by Corollary 3 of Theorem 4.2,  $\omega^p$  is also a primitive  $n$ th root of unity, and therefore  $0 = (\omega^p)^n - 1 = f(\omega^p)g(\omega^p)$ , and so  $f(\omega^p) = 0$  or  $g(\omega^p) = 0$ . Suppose  $f(\omega^p) \neq 0$ . Then  $g(\omega^p) = 0$ , and so  $\omega$  is a zero of  $g(x^p)$ . Thus, from Theorem 21.3,  $f(x)$  divides  $g(x^p)$  in  $\mathbb{Q}[x]$ . Since  $f(x)$  is monic,  $f(x)$  actually divides  $g(x^p)$  in  $\mathbb{Z}[x]$  (see Exercise 49 in Chapter 16). Say  $g(x^p) = f(x)h(x)$ , where  $h(x) \in \mathbb{Z}[x]$ . Now let  $\bar{g}(x)$ ,  $\bar{f}(x)$ , and  $\bar{h}(x)$  denote the polynomials in  $\mathbb{Z}_p[x]$  obtained from  $g(x)$ ,  $f(x)$ , and  $h(x)$ , respectively, by reducing each coefficient modulo  $p$ . Since this reduction process is a ring homomorphism from  $\mathbb{Z}[x]$  to  $\mathbb{Z}_p[x]$  (see Exercise 11 in Chapter 16), we

have  $\bar{g}(x^p) = \bar{f}(x)\bar{h}(x)$  in  $Z_p[x]$ . From Exercise 33 in Chapter 16 and Corollary 5 of Theorem 7.1, we then have  $(\bar{g}(x))^p = \bar{g}(x^p) = \bar{f}(x)\bar{h}(x)$ , and since  $Z_p[x]$  is a unique factorization domain, it follows that  $\bar{g}(x)$  and  $\bar{f}(x)$  have an irreducible factor in  $Z_p[x]$  in common; call it  $m(x)$ . Thus, we may write  $\bar{f}(x) = k_1(x)m(x)$  and  $\bar{g}(x) = k_2(x)m(x)$ , where  $k_1(x), k_2(x) \in Z_p[x]$ . Then, viewing  $x^n - 1$  as a member of  $Z_p[x]$ , we have  $x^n - 1 = \bar{f}(x)\bar{g}(x) = k_1(x)k_2(x)(m(x))^2$ . In particular,  $x^n - 1$  has a multiple zero in some extension of  $Z_p$ . But because  $p$  does not divide  $n$ , the derivative  $nx^{n-1}$  of  $x^n - 1$  is not 0, and so  $nx^{n-1}$  and  $x^n - 1$  do not have a common factor of positive degree in  $Z_p[x]$ . Since this contradicts Theorem 20.5, we must have  $f(\omega^p) = 0$ .

We reformulate what we have thus far proved as follows: If  $\beta$  is any primitive  $n$ th root of unity that is a zero of  $f(x)$  and  $p$  is any prime that does not divide  $n$ , then  $\beta^p$  is a zero of  $f(x)$ . Now let  $k$  be any integer between 1 and  $n$  that is relatively prime to  $n$ . Then we can write  $k = p_1 p_2 \cdots p_r$  where each  $p_i$  is a prime that does not divide  $n$  (repetitions are permitted). It follows then that each of  $\omega, \omega^{p_1}, (\omega^{p_1})^{p_2}, \dots, (\omega^{p_1 p_2 \cdots p_{r-1}})^{p_r} = \omega^k$  is a zero of  $f(x)$ . Since every zero of  $\Phi_n(x)$  has the form  $\omega^k$ , where  $k$  is between 1 and  $n$  and is relatively prime to  $n$ , we have proved that every zero of  $\Phi_n(x)$  is a zero of  $f(x)$ . This completes the proof. ■

Of course, Theorems 33.3 and 33.1 give us the factorization of  $x^n - 1$  as a product of irreducible polynomials over  $\mathcal{Q}$ . But Theorem 33.1 is also useful for finding the irreducible factorization of  $x^n - 1$  over  $Z_p$ . The next example provides an illustration. Irreducible factors of  $x^n - 1$  over  $Z_p$  are used to construct error-correcting codes.

■ **EXAMPLE 2** We determine the irreducible factorization of  $x^6 - 1$  over  $Z_2$  and  $Z_3$ . From Table 33.1, we have  $x^6 - 1 = (x - 1)(x + 1)(x^2 + x + 1)(x^2 - x + 1)$ . Taking all the coefficients on both sides mod 2, we obtain the same expression, but we must check that these factors are irreducible over  $Z_2$ . Since  $x^2 + x + 1$  has no zeros in  $Z_2$ , it is irreducible over  $Z_2$  (see Theorem 17.1). Finally, since  $-1 = 1$  in  $Z_2$ , we have the irreducible factorization  $x^6 - 1 = (x + 1)^2(x^2 + x + 1)^2$ . Over  $Z_3$ , we again start with the factorization  $x^6 - 1 = (x - 1)(x + 1)(x^2 + x + 1)(x^2 - x + 1)$  over  $Z$  and view the coefficients mod 3. Then 1 is a zero of  $x^2 + x + 1$  in  $Z_3$ , and by long division we obtain  $x^2 + x + 1 = (x - 1)(x + 2) = (x + 2)^2$ . Similarly,  $x^2 - x + 1 = (x - 2)(x + 1) = (x + 1)^2$ . So, the irreducible factorization of  $x^6 - 1$  over  $Z_3$  is  $(x + 1)^3 \cdot (x + 2)^3$ . ■

We next determine the Galois group of the cyclotomic extensions of  $\mathcal{Q}$ .

### ■ Theorem 33.4 $\text{Gal}(Q(\omega)/Q) \approx U(n)$

*Let  $\omega$  be a primitive  $n$ th root of unity. Then  $\text{Gal}(Q(\omega)/Q) \approx U(n)$ .*

**PROOF** Since  $1, \omega, \omega^2, \dots, \omega^{n-1}$  are all the  $n$ th roots of unity,  $Q(\omega)$  is the splitting field of  $x^n - 1$  over  $Q$ . For each  $k$  in  $U(n)$ ,  $\omega^k$  is a primitive  $n$ th root of unity, and by the lemma preceding Theorem 20.4, there is a field automorphism of  $Q(\omega)$ , which we denote by  $\phi_k$ , that carries  $\omega$  to  $\omega^k$  and acts as the identity on  $Q$ . Moreover, these are all the automorphisms of  $Q(\omega)$ , since any automorphism must map a primitive  $n$ th root of unity to a primitive  $n$ th root of unity. Next, observe that for every  $r, s \in U(n)$ ,

$$(\phi_r \phi_s)(\omega) = \phi_r(\omega^s) = (\phi_r(\omega))^s = (\omega^r)^s = \omega^{rs} = \phi_{rs}(\omega).$$

This shows that the mapping from  $U(n)$  onto  $\text{Gal}(Q(\omega)/Q)$  given by  $k \rightarrow \phi_k$  is a group homomorphism. Clearly, the mapping is an isomorphism, since  $\omega^r \neq \omega^s$  when  $r, s \in U(n)$  and  $r \neq s$ . ■

The next example uses Theorem 33.4 and the results of Chapter 8 to demonstrate how to determine the Galois group of cyclotomic extensions.

■ **EXAMPLE 3** Let  $\alpha = \cos(2\pi/9) + i \sin(2\pi/9)$  and let  $\beta = \cos(2\pi/15) + i \sin(2\pi/15)$ . Then

$$\text{Gal}(Q(\alpha)/Q) \approx U(9) \approx Z_6$$

and

$$\text{Gal}(Q(\beta)/Q) \approx U(15) \approx U(5) \oplus U(3) \approx Z_4 \oplus Z_2. \quad \blacksquare$$

## The Constructible Regular $n$ -gons

As an application of the theory of cyclotomic extensions and Galois theory, we determine exactly which regular  $n$ -gons are constructible with a straightedge and compass. But first we prove a technical lemma.

### ■ Lemma $Q(\cos(2\pi/n)) \subseteq Q(\omega)$

*Let  $n$  be a positive integer and let  $\omega = \cos(2\pi/n) + i \sin(2\pi/n)$ . Then  $Q(\cos(2\pi/n)) \subseteq Q(\omega)$ .*

**PROOF** Observe that from  $(\cos(2\pi/n) + i \sin(2\pi/n))(\cos(2\pi/n) - i \sin(2\pi/n)) = \cos^2(2\pi/n) + \sin^2(2\pi/n) = 1$ , we have  $\cos(2\pi/n) - i \sin(2\pi/n) = 1/\omega$ . Moreover,  $(\omega + 1/\omega)/2 = (2\cos(2\pi/n))/2 = \cos(2\pi/n)$ . Thus,  $\cos(2\pi/n) \in Q(\omega)$ . ■

### ■ Theorem 33.5 (Gauss, 1796) Constructibility Criteria for a Regular $n$ -gon

*It is possible to construct the regular  $n$ -gon with a straightedge and compass if and only if  $n$  has the form  $2^k p_1 p_2 \cdots p_t$ , where  $k \geq 0$  and the  $p_i$ 's are distinct primes of the form  $2^m + 1$ .*

**PROOF** If it is possible to construct a regular  $n$ -gon, then we can construct the angle  $2\pi/n$  and therefore the number  $\cos(2\pi/n)$ . By the results of Chapter 23, we know that  $\cos(2\pi/n)$  is constructible only if  $[Q(\cos(2\pi/n)):Q]$  is a power of 2. To determine when this is so, we will use Galois theory.

Let  $\omega = \cos(2\pi/n) + i \sin(2\pi/n)$ . Then  $|\text{Gal}(Q(\omega)/Q)| = [Q(\omega):Q] = \phi(n)$ . By the lemma on the preceding page,  $Q(\cos(2\pi/n)) \subseteq Q(\omega)$ , and by Theorem 32.1 we know that

$$\begin{aligned} [Q(\cos(2\pi/n)):Q] &= |\text{Gal}(Q(\omega)/Q)| / |\text{Gal}(Q(\omega)/Q(\cos(2\pi/n)))| \\ &= \phi(n) / |\text{Gal}(Q(\omega)/Q(\cos(2\pi/n)))|. \end{aligned}$$

Recall that the elements  $\sigma$  of  $\text{Gal}(Q(\omega)/Q)$  have the property that  $\sigma(\omega) = \omega^k$  for  $1 \leq k \leq n$ . That is,  $\sigma(\cos(2\pi/n) + i \sin(2\pi/n)) = \cos(2\pi k/n) + i \sin(2\pi k/n)$ . If such a  $\sigma$  belongs to  $\text{Gal}(Q(\omega)/Q(\cos(2\pi/n)))$ , then we must have  $\cos(2\pi k/n) = \cos(2\pi/n)$ . Clearly, this holds only when  $k = 1$  and  $k = n - 1$ . So,  $|\text{Gal}(Q(\omega)/Q(\cos(2\pi/n)))| = 2$ , and therefore  $[Q(\cos(2\pi/n)):Q] = \phi(n)/2$ . Thus, if an  $n$ -gon is constructible, then  $\phi(n)/2$  must be a power of 2. Of course, this implies that  $\phi(n)$  is a power of 2.

Write  $n = 2^k p_1^{n_1} p_2^{n_2} \cdots p_t^{n_t}$ , where  $k \geq 0$ , the  $p_i$ 's are distinct odd primes, and the  $n_i$ 's are positive. Then  $\phi(n) = |U(n)| = |U(2^k)| |U(p_1^{n_1})| |U(p_2^{n_2})| \cdots |U(p_t^{n_t})| = 2^{k-1} p_1^{n_1-1} (p_1 - 1) p_2^{n_2-1} (p_2 - 1) \cdots p_t^{n_t-1} (p_t - 1)$  must be a power of 2. Clearly, this implies that each  $n_i = 1$  and each  $p_i - 1$  is a power of 2. This completes the proof that the condition in the statement is necessary.

To prove that the condition given in Theorem 33.5 is also sufficient, suppose that  $n$  has the form  $2^k p_1 p_2 \cdots p_t$ , where the  $p_i$ 's are distinct odd primes of the form  $2^m + 1$ , and let  $\omega = \cos(2\pi/n) + i \sin(2\pi/n)$ . By Theorem 33.3,  $Q(\omega)$  is a splitting field of an irreducible polynomial over  $Q$ , and therefore, by the Fundamental Theorem of Galois Theory,  $\phi(n) = [Q(\omega):Q] = |\text{Gal}(Q(\omega)/Q)|$ . Since  $\phi(n)$  is a power of 2 and  $\text{Gal}(Q(\omega)/Q)$  is an Abelian group, it follows by induction (see Exercise 15) that there is a series of subgroups

$$H_0 \subset H_1 \subset \cdots \subset H_t = \text{Gal}(Q(\omega)/Q),$$

where  $H_0$  is the identity,  $H_1$  is the subgroup of  $\text{Gal}(Q(\omega)/Q)$  of order 2 that fixes  $\cos(2\pi/n)$ , and  $|H_{i+1}:H_i| = 2$  for  $i = 0, 1, 2, \dots, t-1$ . By the

Fundamental Theorem of Galois Theory, we then have a series of subfields of the real numbers

$$Q = E_{H_t} \subset E_{H_{t-1}} \subset \cdots \subset E_{H_1} = Q(\cos(2\pi/n)),$$

where  $[E_{H_{i-1}}:E_{H_i}] = 2$ . So, for each  $i$ , we may choose  $\beta_i \in E_{H_{i-1}}$  such that  $E_{H_{i-1}} = E_{H_i}(\beta_i)$ . Then  $\beta_i$  is a zero of a polynomial of the form  $x^2 + b_i x + c_i \in E_{H_i}[x]$ , and it follows that  $E_{H_{i-1}} = E_{H_i}(\sqrt{b_i^2 - 4c_i})$ . Thus, it follows from Exercise 3 in Chapter 23 that every element of  $Q(\cos(2\pi/n))$  is constructible. ■

It is interesting to note that Gauss did not use Galois theory in his proof. In fact, Gauss gave his proof 15 years before Galois was born.

Some authors write the expression  $2^m + 1$  in the statement of Theorem 33.5 in the form  $2^{2^k} + 1$ . These expressions are equivalent since if a prime  $p > 2$  can be written in the form  $2^m + 1$  then  $m$  must be a power of 2 (see Exercise 21).

## Exercises

Difficulties should act as a tonic. They should spur us to greater exertion.

B. C. Forbes

1. Determine the minimal polynomial for  $\cos(\pi/3) + i \sin(\pi/3)$  over  $Q$ .
2. Factor  $x^{12} - 1$  as a product of irreducible polynomials over  $Z$ .
3. Factor  $x^8 - 1$  as a product of irreducible polynomials over  $Z_2$ ,  $Z_3$ , and  $Z_5$ .
4. For any  $n > 1$ , prove that the sum of all the  $n$ th roots of unity is 0.
5. For any  $n > 1$ , prove that the product of the  $n$ th roots of unity is  $(-1)^{n+1}$ .
6. Let  $\omega$  be a primitive 12th root of unity over  $Q$ . Find the minimal polynomial for  $\omega^4$  over  $Q$ .
7. Let  $F$  be a finite extension of  $Q$ . Prove that there are only a finite number of roots of unity in  $F$ .
8. For any  $n > 1$ , prove that the irreducible factorization over  $Z$  of  $x^{n-1} + x^{n-2} + \cdots + x + 1$  is  $\prod \Phi_d(x)$ , where the product runs over all positive divisors  $d$  of  $n$  greater than 1.
9. If  $2^n + 1$  is prime for some  $n \geq 1$ , prove that  $n$  is a power of 2. (Primes of the form  $2^n + 1$  are called *Fermat primes*.)
10. Prove that  $\Phi_n(0) = 1$  for all  $n > 1$ .

11. Prove that if a field contains the  $n$ th roots of unity for  $n$  odd, then it also contains the  $2n$ th roots of unity.
12. Let  $m$  and  $n$  be relatively prime positive integers. Prove that the splitting field of  $x^{mn} - 1$  over  $\mathbb{Q}$  is the same as the splitting field of  $(x^m - 1)(x^n - 1)$  over  $\mathbb{Q}$ .
13. Prove that  $\Phi_{2n}(x) = \Phi_n(-x)$  for all odd integers  $n > 1$ .
14. Prove that if  $p$  is a prime and  $k$  is a positive integer, then  $\Phi_{p^k}(x) = \Phi_p(x^{p^{k-1}})$ . Use this to find  $\Phi_8(x)$  and  $\Phi_{27}(x)$ .
15. Prove the assertion made in the proof of Theorem 33.5 that there exists a series of subgroups  $H_0 \subset H_1 \subset \cdots \subset H_t$  with  $|H_{i+1}:H_i| = 2$  for  $i = 0, 1, 2, \dots, t-1$ . (This exercise is referred to in this chapter.)
16. Prove that  $x^9 - 1$  and  $x^7 - 1$  have isomorphic Galois groups over  $\mathbb{Q}$ . (See Exercise 7 in Chapter 32 for the definition.)
17. Let  $p$  be a prime that does not divide  $n$ . Prove that  $\Phi_{pn}(x) = \Phi_n(x^p)/\Phi_n(x)$ .
18. Prove that the Galois groups of  $x^{10} - 1$  and  $x^8 - 1$  over  $\mathbb{Q}$  are not isomorphic.
19. Let  $E$  be the splitting field of  $x^5 - 1$  over  $\mathbb{Q}$ . Show that there is a unique field  $K$  with the property that  $\mathbb{Q} \subset K \subset E$ .
20. Let  $E$  be the splitting field of  $x^6 - 1$  over  $\mathbb{Q}$ . Show that there is no field  $K$  with the property that  $\mathbb{Q} \subset K \subset E$ .
21. If  $p > 2$  is a prime of the form  $2^m + 1$ , prove that  $m$  is a power of 2.
22. Let  $\omega = \cos(2\pi/15) - i \sin(2\pi/15)$ . Find the three elements of  $\text{Gal}(\mathbb{Q}(\omega)/\mathbb{Q})$  of order 2.

## Computer Exercises

Computer exercises for this chapter are available at the website:

<http://www.d.umn.edu/~jgallian>

# Carl Friedrich Gauss

He [Gauss] lives everywhere in mathematics.

E. T. BELL, *Men of Mathematics*



The Granger Collection, New York

CARL FRIEDRICH GAUSS, considered by many to be the greatest mathematician who has ever lived, was born in Brunswick, Germany, on April 30, 1777. While still a teenager, he made many fundamental discoveries. Among these were the method of “least squares” for handling statistical data, and a proof that a 17-sided regular polygon can be constructed with a straightedge and compass (this result was the first of its kind since discoveries by the Greeks 2000 years earlier). In his Ph.D. dissertation in 1799, he proved the Fundamental Theorem of Algebra.

Throughout his life, Gauss largely ignored the work of his contemporaries and, in fact, made enemies of many of them. Young mathematicians who sought encouragement

from him were usually rebuffed. Despite this fact, Gauss had many outstanding students, including Eisenstein, Riemann, Kummer, Dirichlet, and Dedekind.

Gauss died in Göttingen at the age of 77 on February 23, 1855. At Brunswick, there is a statue of him. Appropriately, the base is in the shape of a 17-point star. In 1989, Germany issued a bank note (see page 117) depicting Gauss and the Gaussian distribution.

To find more information about Gauss, visit:

**[http://www-groups.dcs  
.st-and.ac.uk/~history/](http://www-groups.dcs.st-and.ac.uk/~history/)**



# Manjul Bhargava

We are watching him [Bhargava] very closely. He is going to be a superstar. He's amazingly mature mathematically. He is changing the subject in a fundamental way.

PETER SARNAK



Office of Communications, Princeton University

MANJUL BHARGAVA was born in Canada on August 8, 1974, and grew up in Long Island, New York. After graduating from Harvard in 1996, Bhargava went to Princeton to pursue his Ph.D. under the direction of Andrew Wiles (see biography after Chapter 18). Bhargava investigated a “composition law” first formulated by Gauss in 1801 for combining two quadratic equations (equations in a form such as  $x^2 + 3xy + 6y^2 = 0$ ) in a way that was very different from normal addition and revealed a lot of information about number systems. Bhargava tackled an aspect of the problem in which no progress had been made in more than 200 years. He not only broke new ground in that area but also discovered 13 more composition laws and developed a coherent mathematical framework to explain them. He then applied his theory of composition to solve a number of fundamental problems concerning the distribution of extension fields of the rational numbers and of other, related algebraic objects. What made Bhargava’s work especially remarkable is that he was able to explain all his revolutionary ideas using only elementary mathematics. In commenting on Bhargava’s results, Wiles said, “He did it in a way that Gauss himself could have understood and appreciated.”

Among Bhargava’s many awards are the Blumenthal Award for the Advancement of Research in Pure Mathematics, the SASTRA Ramanujan Prize, the Cole Prize in number theory (see page 415), the Fermat Prize, the Infosys Prize, election to the National Academy of Sciences, and the Fields Medal (see page 414). In 2002 he was named one of Popular Science magazine’s “Brilliant 10,” in celebration of scientists who are shaking up their fields.

In addition to doing mathematics, Bhargava is an accomplished tabla player who has studied with the world’s most distinguished tabla masters. He performs extensively in the New York and Boston areas. To hear him play the tabla, visit

<http://www.npr.org/templates/story/story.php?storyId=4111253>

To find more information about Bhargava, visit

<http://www.wikipedia.org>  
and

<http://www.d.umn.edu/~jgallian/manjulMH4.pdf>



# Selected Answers

Failures, repeated failures, are finger posts on the road to achievement. One fails forward toward success.

C. S. Lewis

For some exercises only partial answers are provided. Many of the proofs given below are merely sketches. In these cases, the student should supply the complete proof.

## Chapter 0

In short, if we adhere to the standard of perfection in all our endeavors, we are left with nothing but mathematics and the White Album.

DANIEL GILBERT,  
*Stumbling on Happiness*

1.  $\{1, 2, 3, 4\}; \{1, 3, 5, 7\}; \{1, 5, 7, 11\}; \{1, 3, 7, 9, 11, 13, 17, 19\}; \{1, 2, 3, 4, 6, 7, 8, 9, 11, 12, 13, 14, 16, 17, 18, 19, 21, 22, 23, 24\}$
3. 12, 2, 2, 10, 1, 0, 4, 5
5. By using 0 as an exponent if necessary, we may write  $a = p_1^{m_1} \cdots p_k^{m_k}$  and  $b = p_1^{n_1} \cdots p_k^{n_k}$ , where the  $p$ 's are distinct primes and the  $m$ 's and  $n$ 's are nonnegative. Then  $\text{lcm}(a, b) = p_1^{s_1} \cdots p_k^{s_k}$ , where  $s_i = \max(m_i, n_i)$ , and  $\text{gcd}(a, b) = p_1^{t_1} \cdots p_k^{t_k}$ , where  $t_i = \min(m_i, n_i)$ . Then  $\text{lcm}(a, b) \cdot \text{gcd}(a, b) = p_1^{m_1+n_1} \cdots p_k^{m_k+n_k} = ab$ .
7. Write  $a = nq_1 + r_1$  and  $b = nq_2 + r_2$ , where  $0 \leq r_1, r_2 < n$ . We may assume that  $r_1 \geq r_2$ . Then  $a - b = n(q_1 - q_2) + (r_1 - r_2)$ , where  $r_1 - r_2 \geq 0$ . If  $a \bmod n = b \bmod n$ , then  $r_1 = r_2$  and  $n$  divides  $a - b$ . If  $n$  divides  $a - b$ , then by the uniqueness of the remainder, we have  $r_1 - r_2 = 0$ .
9. Use Exercise 7.
11. Use Theorem 0.2.
13. By Theorem 0.2 there are integers  $s$  and  $t$  such that  $ms + nt = 1$ . Then  $m(sr) + n(tr) = r$ .
15. Let  $p$  be a prime greater than 3. By the division algorithm, we can write  $p$  in the form  $6n + r$ , where  $r$  satisfies  $0 \leq r < 6$ . Now observe that  $6n, 6n + 2, 6n + 3$ , and  $6n + 4$  are not prime.
17. Since  $st$  divides  $a - b$ , both  $s$  and  $t$  divide  $a - b$ . The converse is true when  $\text{gcd}(s, t) = 1$ .
19. Use Euclid's Lemma and the Fundamental Theorem of Arithmetic.
21. Use proof by contradiction.
23.  $\frac{-30}{41} + \frac{-17}{41}i$
25.  $x \text{ NAND } y$  is 1 if and only if both inputs are 0;  $x \text{ XNOR } y$  is 1 if and only if both inputs are the same.
27. Let  $S$  be a set with  $n + 1$  elements and pick some  $a$  in  $S$ . By induction,  $S$  has  $2^n$  subsets that do not contain  $a$ . But there is a one-to-one correspondence between the subsets of  $S$  that do not contain  $a$  and those that do. So, there are  $2 \cdot 2^n = 2^{n+1}$  subsets in all.
29. Consider  $n = 200! + 2$ .
31. Say  $p_1 p_2 \cdots p_r = q_1 q_2 \cdots q_s$ , where the  $p$ 's and  $q$ 's are primes. By the Generalized Euclid's Lemma,  $p_1$  divides some  $q_i$ , say  $q_1$  (we may relabel the  $q$ 's if necessary). Then  $p_1 = q_1$  and  $p_2 \cdots p_r = q_2 \cdots q_s$ . Repeating this argument at each step, we obtain  $p_2 = q_2, \dots, p_r = q_r$  and  $r = s$ .

33. Suppose that  $S$  is a set that contains  $a$  and whenever  $n \geq a$  belongs to  $S$ , then  $n + 1 \in S$ . We must prove that  $S$  contains all integers greater than or equal to  $a$ . Let  $T$  be the set of all integers greater than  $a$  that are not in  $S$  and suppose that  $T$  is not empty. Let  $b$  be the smallest integer in  $T$  (if  $T$  has no negative integers,  $b$  exists because of the Well Ordering Principle; if  $T$  has negative integers, it can have only a finite number of them so that there is a smallest one). Then  $b - 1 \in S$ , and therefore  $b = (b - 1) + 1 \in S$ .
35. For  $n = 1$ , observe that  $1^3 + 2^3 + 3^3 = 36$ . Assume that  $n^3 + (n + 1)^3 + (n + 2)^3 = 9m$  for some integer  $m$ . We must prove that  $(n + 1)^3 + (n + 2)^3 + (n + 3)^3$  is a multiple of 9. Using the induction hypothesis we have that  $(n + 1)^3 + (n + 2)^3 + (n + 3)^3 = 9m - n^3 + (n + 3)^3 = 9m - n^3 + n^3 + 3 \cdot n^2 \cdot 3 + 3 \cdot n \cdot 9 + 3^3 = 9m + 9n^2 + 27n + 27$ .
37. The statement is true for any divisor of  $8^3 - 4 = 508$ .
39. 6 P.M.
41. Observe that the number with the decimal representation  $a_9a_8 \dots a_1a_0$  is  $a_9 \cdot 10^9 + a_8 \cdot 10^8 + \dots + a_1 \cdot 10 + a_0$ . Then use Exercise 9 and the fact that  $a_i 10^i \bmod 9 = a_i \bmod 9$  to deduce that the check digit is  $(a_9 + a_8 + \dots + a_1 + a_0) \bmod 9$ .
43. For the case in which the check digit is not involved, see the answer to Exercise 41. If a transposition involving the check digit  $c = (a_1 + a_2 + \dots + a_{10}) \bmod 9$  goes undetected, then  $a_{10} = (a_1 + a_2 + \dots + a_9 + c) \bmod 9$ . Substitution yields  $2(a_1 + a_2 + \dots + a_9) \bmod 9 = 0$ . Therefore, modulo 9, we have  $10(a_1 + a_2 + \dots + a_9) = a_1 + a_2 + \dots + a_9 = 0$ . It follows that  $c = a_{10}$ . In this case the transposition does not yield an error.
45. Say the number is  $a_8a_7 \dots a_1a_0 = a_8 \cdot 10^8 + a_7 \cdot 10^7 + \dots + a_1 \cdot 10 + a_0$ . Then the error is undetected if and only if  $(a_i 10^i - a'_i 10^i) \bmod 7 = 0$ . Multiplying both sides by  $5^i$  and noting that  $50 \bmod 7 = 1$ , we obtain  $(a_i - a'_i) \bmod 7 = 0$ .
47. 4
51. Cases where  $(2a - b - c) \bmod 11 = 0$  are undetected.
53. The check digit would be the same.
55. 4302311568

57. 2. Since  $\beta$  is one-to-one,  $\beta(\alpha(a_1)) = \beta(\alpha(a_2))$  implies that  $\alpha(a_1) = \alpha(a_2)$ ; and since  $\alpha$  is one-to-one,  $a_1 = a_2$ .
3. Let  $c \in C$ . There is a  $b$  in  $B$  such that  $\beta(b) = c$  and an  $a$  in  $A$  such that  $\alpha(a) = b$ . Thus,  $(\beta\alpha)(a) = \beta(\alpha(a)) = \beta(b) = c$ .
4. Since  $\alpha$  is one-to-one and onto, we may define  $\alpha^{-1}(x) = y$  if and only if  $\alpha(y) = x$ . Then  $\alpha^{-1}(\alpha(a)) = a$  and  $\alpha(\alpha^{-1}(b)) = b$ .
59. No.  $(1, 0) \in R$  and  $(0, -1) \in R$ , but  $(1, -1) \notin R$ .
61.  $a$  belongs to the same subset as  $a$ . If  $a$  and  $b$  belong to the subset  $A$ , then  $b$  and  $a$  also belong to  $A$ . If  $a$  and  $b$  belong to the subset  $A$  and  $b$  and  $c$  belong to the subset  $B$ , then  $A = B$ , since the distinct subsets of  $P$  are disjoint. So,  $a$  and  $c$  belong to  $A$ .
63. The last digit of  $3^{100}$  is the value of  $3^{100} \bmod 10$ . Observe that  $3^{100} \bmod 10$  is the same as  $((3^4 \bmod 10)^{25} \bmod 10$  and  $3^4 \bmod 10 = 1$ . Similarly, the last digit of  $2^{100}$  is the value of  $2^{100} \bmod 10$ . Observe that  $2^5 \bmod 10 = 2$  so that  $2^{100} \bmod 10$  is the same as  $(2^5 \bmod 10)^{20} \bmod 10 = 2^{20} \bmod 10 = (2^5)^4 \bmod 10 = 2^4 \bmod 10 = 6$ .
65. Apply  $\gamma^{-1}$  to both sides of  $\alpha\gamma = \beta\gamma$ .

## Chapter 1

When solving problems, dig at the roots instead of just hacking at the leaves.

ANTHONY J. D'ANGELO,  
*The College Blue Book*

1. Three rotations— $0^\circ$ ,  $120^\circ$ ,  $240^\circ$ —and three reflections across lines from vertices to midpoints of opposite sides. See the back inside cover for a picture.
3. **a.**  $V$  **b.**  $R_{270}$  **c.**  $R_0$  **d.**  $R_0, R_{180}, H, V, D, D'$  **e.** none
5.  $D_n$  has  $n$  rotations of the form  $k(360^\circ/n)$ , where  $k = 0, \dots, n - 1$ . In addition,  $D_n$  has  $n$  reflections. When  $n$  is odd, the axes of reflection are the lines from the vertices to the midpoints of the opposite sides. When  $n$  is even, half of the axes of reflection are obtained by joining opposite vertices; the other half, by joining midpoints of opposite sides.
7. A rotation followed by a rotation either fixes every point (and so is the identity) or fixes only the center of rotation. However, a reflection fixes a line.

9. Observe that  $1 \cdot 1 = 1$ ;  $1(-1) = -1$ ;  $(-1)1 = -1$ ;  $(-1)(-1) = 1$ . These relationships also hold when 1 is replaced by “rotation” and  $-1$  is replaced by “reflection.”
11. Thinking geometrically and observing that even powers of elements of a dihedral group do not change orientation, we note that each of  $a$ ,  $b$  and  $c$  appears an even number of times in the expression. So, there is no change in orientation. Thus, the expression is a rotation.
13. In  $D_4$ ,  $HD = DV$  but  $H \neq V$ .
15.  $R_0, R_{180}, H, V$
17. See answer for Exercise 15.
19. In each case, the group is  $D_6$ .
21. First observe that squaring  $R_0, R_{180}$  or any reflection gives  $R_0$  and squaring  $R_{90}$  or  $R_{270}$  gives  $R_{180}$ . Thus  $X^2Y = Y$  or  $X^2Y = R_{180}Y$ . Since  $Y \neq R_{90}$  we have  $X^2Y = R_{180}Y$  and  $X^2Y = R_{90}$ . Thus  $R_{180}Y = R_{90}$ . Solving for  $Y$  gives  $Y = R_{270}$ .
23.  $180^\circ$  rotational symmetry
25. Their only symmetry is the identity.

## Chapter 2

There are no secrets to success. It is the result of preparation, hard work, and learning from failure.

COLIN POWELL

1. **c, d**
3. none
5.  $7; 13; n - 1; \frac{3}{13} + \frac{2}{13}i$
7. Does not contain the identity; closure fails.
9. Under multiplication modulo 4, 2 does not have an inverse. Under multiplication modulo 5, each element has an inverse.
11.  $a^{11}, a^6, a^4, a$ .
13. **a.**  $2a + 3b$  **b.**  $-2a + 2(-b + c)$  **c.**  $-3(a + 2b) + 2c = 0$
15. Observe that  $a^5 = e$  implies that  $a^{-2} = a^3$  and  $b^7 = e$  implies that  $b^{14} = e$  and therefore  $b^{-11} = b^3$ . Thus,  $a^{-2}b^{-11} = a^3b^3$ . Moreover,  $(a^2b^4)^{-2} = ((a^2b^4)^{-1})^2 = (b^{-4}a^{-2})^2 = (b^3a^3)^2 = b^3a^3b^3a^3$ .
17. Since the inverse of an element in  $G$  is in  $G$ ,  $H \subseteq G$ . Let  $g$  belong to  $G$ . Then  $g^{-1}$  belongs to  $H$  and therefore  $(g^{-1})^{-1} = g$  belongs to  $G$ . So,  $G \subseteq H$ .
19. Use the fact that  $\det(AB) = (\det A)(\det B)$ .
21. 29

23. For  $n \geq 0$ , use induction. For  $n < 0$ , note that  $e = (ab)^0 = (ab)^n(ab)^{-n} = (ab)^na^{-n}b^{-n}$  so that  $a^n b^n = (ab)^n$ . In a non-Abelian group  $(ab)^n$  need not equal  $a^n b^n$ .
25. Use the Socks–Shoes Property.
27. For the case  $n > 0$ , use induction. For  $n < 0$ , note that  $e = (a^{-1}ba)^n(a^{-1}ba)^{-n} = (a^{-1}ba)^n(a^{-1}b^{-n}a)$  and solve for  $(a^{-1}ba)^n$ .
29.  $\{1, 3, 5, 9, 13, 15, 19, 23, 25, 27, 39, 45\}$
31. Suppose  $x$  appears in a row labeled with  $a$  twice; say,  $x = ab$  and  $x = ac$ . Then cancellation yields  $b = c$ . But we use distinct elements to label the columns.
33. Use Exercise 31.
35.  $a^{-1}cb^{-1}; aca^{-1}$
37. If  $x^3 = e$  and  $x \neq e$ , then  $(x^{-1})^3 = e$  and  $x \neq x^{-1}$ . So nonidentity solutions come in pairs. If  $x^2 \neq e$ , then  $x^{-1} \neq x$  and  $(x^{-1})^2 \neq e$ . So solutions to  $x^2 \neq e$  come in pairs.
39. Observe that  $aa^{-1}b = ba^{-1}a$ .
41. If  $F_1F_2 = R_0$ , then  $F_1F_1 = F_1F_2$  and by cancellation  $F_1 = F_2$ .
43. Since  $FR^k$  is a reflection we know that  $(FR^k)(FR^k) = R_0$ . So  $R^kFR^k = F^{-1} = F$ .
45. **a.**  $R^3$  **b.**  $R$  **c.**  $R^5F$
47. Since  $a^2 = b^2 = (ab)^2 = e$ , we have  $aabb = abab$ . Now cancel on the left and right.
49. The matrix  $\begin{bmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{bmatrix}$  is in  $GL(2, Z_2)$  if and only if  $ad \neq bc$ . This happens when  $a$  and  $d$  are 1 and at least 1 of  $b$  and  $c$  is 0, and when  $b$  and  $c$  are 1 and at least 1 of  $a$  and  $d$  is 0.  $\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$  and  $\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$  do not commute.
51. Let  $a$  be any element in  $G$  and write  $x = ea$ . Then  $a^{-1}x = a^{-1}(ea) = (a^{-1}e)a = a^{-1}a = e$ . Then solving for  $x$  we obtain  $x = ae = a$ .

## Chapter 3

Success is the ability to go from one failure to another with no loss of enthusiasm.

SIR WINSTON CHURCHILL

1.  $|Z_{12}| = 12$ ;  $|U(10)| = 4$ ;  $|U(12)| = 4$ ;  
 $|U(20)| = 8$ ;  $|D_4| = 8$   
 In  $Z_{12}$ ,  $|0| = 1$ ;  $|1| = |5| = |7| = |11| = 12$ ;  
 $|2| = |10| = 6$ ;  $|3| = |9| = 4$ ;  $|4| = |8| = 3$ ;  
 $|6| = 2$ .  
 In  $U(10)$ ,  $|1| = 1$ ;  $|3| = |7| = 4$ ;  $|9| = 2$ .

- In  $U(12)$ ,  $|1| = 1$ ;  $|5| = 2$ ;  $|7| = 2$ ;  $|11| = 2$ .  
 In  $U(20)$ ,  $|1| = 1$ ;  $|3| = |7| = |13| = |17| = 4$ ;  $|9| = |11| = |19| = 2$ .  
 In  $D_4$ ,  $|R_0| = 1$ ;  $|R_{90}| = |R_{270}| = 4$ ;  $|R_{180}| = |H| = |V| = |D| = |D'| = 2$ .  
 In each case, notice that the order of the element divides the order of the group.
3. In  $Q$ ,  $|0| = 1$  and all other elements have infinite order. In  $Q^*$ ,  $|1| = 1$ ,  $|-1| = 2$ , and all other elements have infinite order.
  5. Each is the inverse of the other.
  7.  $(a^4c^{-2}b^4)^{-1} = b^{-4}c^2a^{-4} = b^3c^2a^2$
  9.  $D_4$ ;  $D_4$ ; it contains  $\{R_0, R_{180}, H, V\}$
  11. If  $n$  is a positive integer, the real solutions of  $x^n = 1$  are 1 when  $n$  is odd and  $\pm 1$  when  $n$  is even. So, the only elements of finite order in  $R^*$  are  $\pm 1$ .
  13. By Exercise 27 of Chapter 2 we have  $e = (xax^{-1})^n = xa^n x^{-1}$  if and only if  $a^n = e$ .
  15. Suppose  $G = H \cup K$ . Pick  $h \in H$  with  $h \notin K$ . Pick  $k \in K$  with  $k \notin H$ . Then,  $hk \in G$  but  $hk \notin H$  and  $hk \notin K$ .  $U(8) = \{1, 3\} \cup \{1, 5\} \cup \{1, 7\}$ .
  17.  $U_4(20) = \{1, 9, 13, 17\}$ ;  $U_5(20) = \{1, 11\}$ ;  $U_5(30) = \{1, 11\}$ ;  $U_{10}(30) = \{1, 11\}$ . To prove that  $U_k(n)$  is a subgroup, it suffices to show that it is closed. Suppose that  $a$  and  $b$  belong to  $U_k(n)$ . We must show that in  $U(n)$ ,  $ab \bmod k = 1$ . That is,  $(ab \bmod n) \bmod k = 1$ . Let  $n = kt$  and  $ab = qn + r$  where  $0 \leq r < n$ . Then  $(ab \bmod n) \bmod k = r \bmod k = (ab - qn) \bmod k = (ab - qkt) \bmod k = ab \bmod k = (a \bmod k)(b \bmod k) = 1 \cdot 1 = 1$ .  $H$  is not a subgroup because  $7 \in H$  but  $7 \cdot 7 = 9$  is not  $1 \bmod 3$ .
  19. Suppose that  $m < n$  and  $a^m = a^n$ . Then  $e = a^n a^{-m} = a^{n-m}$ . This contradicts the assumption that  $a$  has infinite order.
  21. If  $a$  has infinite order, then  $e, a, a^2, \dots$  are all distinct and belong to  $G$ , so  $G$  is infinite. If  $|a| = n$ , then  $e, a, a^2, \dots, a^{n-1}$  are distinct and belong to  $G$ .
  23. By brute force, show that  $k^4 = 1$  for all  $k$ .
  25. By Exercise 24, either every element of  $H$  is even or exactly half are even. Since  $H$  has odd order the latter cannot occur.
  27. By Exercise 26, either every element of  $H$  is a rotation or exactly half are rotations. Since  $H$  has odd order the latter cannot occur.
  29. Since  $n$  is even,  $D_n$  contains  $R_{180}$ . Let  $F$  be any reflection in  $D_n$ . Then the set  $\{R_0, R_{180}, F, R_{180}F\}$  is closed and therefore is a subgroup of  $D_n$ .
  31.  $\langle 2 \rangle, \langle 3 \rangle, \langle 6 \rangle$
  33. Suppose that  $H$  is a subgroup of  $D_3$  of order 4. Since  $D_3$  has only two elements of order 2,  $H$  must contain  $R_{120}$  or  $R_{240}$ . By closure, it follows that  $H$  must contain  $R_0$ ,  $R_{120}$ , and  $R_{240}$  as well as some reflection  $F$ . But then  $H$  must also contain the reflection  $R_{120}F$ .
  35. If  $x \in Z(G)$ , then  $x \in C(a)$  for all  $a$ , so  $x \in \bigcap_{a \in G} C(a)$ . If  $x \in \bigcap_{a \in G} C(a)$ , then  $xa = ax$  for all  $a$  in  $G$ , so  $x \in Z(G)$ .
  37. The case that  $k = 0$  is trivial. Let  $x \in C(a)$ . If  $k$  is positive, then by induction on  $k$ ,  $xa^{k+1} = xaa^k = axa^k = aa^k x = a^{k+1}x$ . The case where  $k$  is negative now follows from Exercise 34. In a group, if  $x$  commutes with  $a$ , then  $x$  commutes with all powers of  $a$ . If  $x$  commutes with  $a^k$  for some  $k$ , then  $x$  need not commute with  $a$ .
  39. In  $Z_6$ ,  $H = \{0, 1, 3, 5\}$  is not closed.
  41. a. First observe that because  $\langle S \rangle$  is a subgroup of  $G$  containing  $S$ , it is a member of the intersection. So,  $H \subseteq \langle S \rangle$ . On the other hand, since  $H$  is a subgroup of  $G$  and  $H$  contains  $S$ , by definition  $\langle S \rangle \subseteq H$ .  
 b. Let  $K = \{s_1^{n_1} s_2^{n_2} \dots s_m^{n_m} \mid m \geq 1, s_i \in S, n_i \in \mathbb{Z}\}$ . Then because  $K$  satisfies the subgroup test and contains  $S$ , we have  $\langle S \rangle \subseteq K$ . On the other hand, if  $L$  is any subgroup of  $G$  that contains  $S$ , then  $L$  also contains  $K$  by closure. Thus, by part a,  $H = \langle S \rangle$  contains  $K$ .
  43. Mimic the proof of Theorem 3.5.
  45. No. In  $D_4$ ,  $C(R_{180}) = D_4$ . Yes. Elements in the center commute with all elements.
  47. For the first part, see Example 4. For the second part, use  $D_4$ .
  49. Let  $G$  be a group of even order. Observe that for each element  $x$  of order greater than 2  $x$  and  $x^{-1}$  are distinct elements of the same order. So, because elements of order greater than 2 come in pairs, there is an even

number of elements of order greater than 2 (possibly 0). This means that the number of elements of order 1 or 2 is even. Since the identity is the unique element of order 1, it follows that the number of order 2 is odd.

51. First observe that  $(a^d)^{n/d} = a^n = e$ , so  $|a^d|$  is at most  $n/d$ . Moreover, there is no positive integer  $t < n/d$  such that  $(a^d)^t = a^{dt} = e$ , for otherwise  $|\alpha| \neq n$ .

53. Note that  $\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}^n = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & n \\ 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$ .

55. For any positive integer  $n$ , a rotation of  $360^\circ/n$  has order  $n$ . A rotation of  $\sqrt{2}^\circ$  has infinite order.

57. Inscribe a regular  $n$ -gon in a circle. Then every element of  $D_n$  is a symmetry of the circle.

59. Let  $|g| = m$  and write  $m = nq + r$ , where  $0 \leq r < n$ . Then  $g^r = g^{m-nq} = g^m(g^n)^{-q} = (g^n)^{-q}$  belongs to  $H$ . So,  $r = 0$ .

61.  $1 \in H$ . Let  $a, b \in H$ . Then  $(ab^{-1})^2 = a^2(b^2)^{-1}$ , which is the product of two rationals. 2 can be replaced by any positive integer.

63.  $\{1, 9, 11, 19\}$

65. Let  $\begin{bmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{bmatrix}$  and  $\begin{bmatrix} a' & b' \\ c' & d' \end{bmatrix}$  belong to  $H$ . It

suffices to show that  $a - a' + b - b' + c - c' + d - d' = 0$ . This follows from  $a + b + c + d = 0 = a' + b' + c' + d'$ . If 0 is replaced by 1,  $H$  is not a subgroup.

67. If  $2^a$  and  $2^b \in K$ , then  $2^a(2^b)^{-1} = 2^{a-b} \in K$ , since  $a - b \in H$ .

69.  $\begin{bmatrix} 2 & 0 \\ 0 & 2 \end{bmatrix}^{-1} = \begin{bmatrix} \frac{1}{2} & 0 \\ 0 & \frac{1}{2} \end{bmatrix}$  is not in  $H$ .

71. If  $a + bi$  and  $c + di \in H$ , then  $(a + bi)(c + di)^{-1} = (ac + bd) + (bc - ad)i$  and  $(ac + bd)^2 + (bc - ad)^2 = 1$ , so that  $H$  is a subgroup.  $H$  is the unit circle in the complex plane.

73. Since  $ee = e$  is in  $HZ(G)$ , it is nonempty. Let  $h_1z_1$  and  $h_2z_2$  belong to  $HZ(G)$ . Then  $h_1z_1(h_2z_2)^{-1} = h_1z_1z_2^{-1}h_2^{-1} = h_1h_2^{-1}z_1z_2^{-1} \in HZ(G)$ .

75. Use Exercise 74.

77. Use Theorem 0.2.

## Chapter 4

A mistake is to commit a misunderstanding

BOB DYLAN

1. For  $Z_6$ , generators are 1 and 5; for  $Z_8$ , generators are 1, 3, 5, and 7; for  $Z_{20}$ , generators are 1, 3, 7, 9, 11, 13, 17, and 19.

3.  $\langle 20 \rangle = \{20, 10, 0\}$ ;  $\langle 10 \rangle = \{10, 20, 0\}$ ;  $\langle a^{20} \rangle = \{a^{20}, a^{10}, a^0\}$ ;  $\langle a^{10} \rangle = \{a^{10}, a^{20}, a^0\}$

5.  $\langle 3 \rangle = \{3, 9, 7, 1\}$ ;  $\langle 7 \rangle = \{7, 9, 3, 1\}$

7.  $U(8)$  or  $D_3$

9. Six subgroups; generators are the divisors of 20. Six subgroups; generators are  $a^k$ , where  $k$  is a divisor of 20.

11. By definition,  $a^{-1} \in \langle a \rangle$ . So,  $\langle a^{-1} \rangle \subseteq \langle a \rangle$ . By definition,  $a = (a^{-1})^{-1} \in \langle a^{-1} \rangle$ . So,  $\langle a \rangle \subseteq \langle a^{-1} \rangle$ .

13.  $\langle 21 \rangle \cap \langle 10 \rangle = \langle 18 \rangle = \langle 6 \rangle$  In the general case  $\langle a^m \rangle \cap \langle a^n \rangle = \langle a^k \rangle$ , where  $k = \text{lcm}(m, n) \bmod 24$ .

15.  $|g|$  divides 12 is equivalent to  $g^{12} = e$ . So, if  $a^{12} = e$  and  $b^{12} = e$ , then  $(ab^{-1})^{12} = a^{12}(b^{12})^{-1} = ee^{-1} = e$ . The same argument works when 12 is replaced by any integer (see Exercise 47 of Chapter 3).

17.  $|a|$  is infinite or  $|a|$  is finite and  $\gcd(|a|, 2) = \gcd(|a|, 12)$

19. one

21. a.  $|a|$  divides 12. b.  $|a|$  divides  $m$ . c. By Theorem 4.3,  $|a| = 1, 2, 3, 4, 6, 8, 12$ , or 24. If  $|a| = 2$ , then  $a^8 = (a^2)^4 = e^4 = e$ . A similar argument eliminates all other possibilities except 24.

23. Yes, by Theorem 4.3. The subgroups of  $Z$  are of the form  $\langle n \rangle = \{0, \pm n, \pm 2n, \pm 3n, \dots\}$ ,  $n = 0, 1, 2, 3, \dots$ . The subgroups of  $\langle a \rangle$  are of the form  $\langle a^n \rangle$  for  $n = 0, 1, 2, 3, \dots$ .

25. For the first part, apply Theorem 4.3 to the subgroup of rotations;  $D_n$  has  $n$  elements of order 2 when  $n$  is odd and  $n + 1$  elements of order 2 when  $n$  is even.

27. See Example 15 of Chapter 2.

29. 1000000, 3000000, 5000000, 7000000; by Theorem 4.3,  $\langle 1000000 \rangle$  is the unique subgroup of order 8, and only those on the list are generators.  $a^{1000000}, a^{3000000}, a^{5000000}, a^{7000000}$ ; by Theorem 4.3,  $\langle a^{1000000} \rangle$  is the unique subgroup of order 8, and only those on the list are generators.

31. Let  $G = \{a_1, a_2, \dots, a_k\}$ . Now let  $|a_i| = n_i$ . Consider  $n = n_1n_2 \cdots n_k$ .

33. The lattice is a vertical line with successive terms from top to bottom  $\langle p^0 \rangle, \langle p^1 \rangle, \langle p^2 \rangle, \dots, \langle p^{n-1} \rangle, \langle 0 \rangle$ .

35. Suppose that  $a/b$  generates are positive rationals under multiplication. Because

- $\langle a/b \rangle = \langle (a/b)^{-1} \rangle = \langle b/a \rangle$  we may assume that  $1 < a/b$ . Then from  $1 < a/b < (a/b)^2 < (a/b)^3 < \dots$ , we see that  $\langle a/b \rangle$  does not contain any rational number  $k$  strictly between  $a/b$  and  $(a/b)^2$ .
37. For 6, use  $Z_2$ . For  $n$ , use  $Z_{2^{n-1}}$ .
39. Suppose that  $|ab| = n$ . Then  $(ab)^n = e$  implies that  $b^n = a^{-n} \in \langle a \rangle$ , which is finite. Thus  $b^n = e$ .
41. 50; 104
43. all divisors of 60
45. The argument given in the proof of the corollary to Theorem 4.4 shows that in an infinite group, the number of elements of finite order  $n$  is a multiple of  $\phi(n)$  or there is an infinite number of elements of order  $n$ .
47. It follows from Example 15 in Chapter 2 and Example 12 in Chapter 0 that the group  $H = \langle \cos(360^\circ/n) + i \sin(360^\circ/n) \rangle$  is a cyclic group of order  $n$  and every member of this group satisfies  $x^n - 1 = 0$ . Moreover, since every element of order  $n$  satisfies  $x^n - 1 = 0$  and there can be at most  $n$  such elements, all complex numbers of order  $n$  are in  $H$ . Thus, by Theorem 4.4,  $C^*$  has exactly  $\phi(n)$  elements of order  $n$ .
49. Let  $x \in Z(G)$  and  $|x| = p$  where  $p$  is prime. Say  $y \in G$  with  $|y| = q$  where  $q$  is prime. Then  $(xy)^{pq} = e$  and therefore  $|xy| = 1, p$ , or  $q$ . If  $|xy| = 1$ , then  $p = q$ . If  $|xy| = p$ , then  $e = (xy)^p = y^p$  and  $q$  divides  $p$ . Thus,  $q = p$ . A similar argument applies if  $|xy| = q$ .
51. An infinite cyclic group does not have an element of prime order. A finite cyclic group can have only one subgroup for each divisor of its order. A subgroup of order  $p$  has exactly  $p - 1$  elements of order  $p$ . Another element of order  $p$  would give another subgroup of order  $p$ .
53.  $1 \cdot 4, 3 \cdot 4, 7 \cdot 4, 9 \cdot 4; x^4, (x^4)^3, (x^4)^7, (x^4)^9$
55. 1 of order 1; 33 of order 2; 2 of order 3; 10 of order 11; 20 of order 33
57. 1, 2, 10, 20. In general, if an Abelian group contains cyclic subgroups of order  $m$  and  $n$  where  $m$  and  $n$  are relatively prime, then it contains subgroups of order  $d$  for each divisor  $d$  of  $mn$ .
59. Say  $a$  and  $b$  are distinct elements of order 2. If  $a$  and  $b$  commute, then  $ab$  is a third element of order 2. If  $a$  and  $b$  do not commute, then  $aba$  is a third element of order 2.

61. Use Exercise 34 of Chapter 3 and Theorem 4.3.
63. 1 and 2
65. Observe that among the integers from 1 to  $p^n$ , the  $p^{n-1}$  integers  $p, 2p, 3p, \dots, p^{n-1}p$  are exactly the ones that are not relatively prime to  $p$ .
67. 12 or 60; 48
69. 3; 2; 6
71. Since  $(ab)^{80} = (a^5)^{16}(b^{16})^5 = ee = e$  we know that  $|ab|$  divides 80. The two cases  $|ab|$  divides 16 and  $|ab|$  divides 40 both lead to a contradiction. So  $|ab| = 80$ .
73. 54; 16; 48
75. Since  $m$  and  $n$  are relatively prime, it suffices to show both  $m$  and  $n$  divide  $k$ . By Corollary 2 of Theorem 4.1, it is enough to show that  $a^k = e$ . Note that  $a^k \in \langle a \rangle \cap \langle b \rangle$ , and since  $\langle a \rangle \cap \langle b \rangle$  is a subgroup of both  $\langle a \rangle$  and  $\langle b \rangle$ , we know that  $|\langle a \rangle \cap \langle b \rangle|$  must divide both  $|\langle a \rangle|$  and  $|\langle b \rangle|$ . Thus,  $|\langle a \rangle \cap \langle b \rangle| = 1$ .
77. First note that  $x \neq e$ . If  $x^3 = x^5$ , then  $x^2 = e$ . By Corollary 2 Theorem 4.1 and Theorem 4.3 we then have  $|x|$  divides both 2 and 15. Thus  $|x| = 1$  and  $x = e$ . If  $x^3 = x^9$ , then  $x^6 = e$  and therefore  $|x|$  divides 6 and 15. This implies that  $|x| = 3$ . Then  $|x^{13}| = |x(x^3)^4| = |x| = 3$ . If  $x^5 = x^9$ , then  $x^4 = e$  and  $|x|$  divides both 4 and 15, and therefore  $x = e$ .

## Chapter 5

Mistakes are often the best teachers.

JAMES A. FROUDE

1. a.  $\alpha^{-1} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 & 4 & 5 & 6 \\ 2 & 1 & 3 & 5 & 4 & 6 \end{bmatrix}$   
b.  $\beta\alpha = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 & 4 & 5 & 6 \\ 1 & 6 & 2 & 3 & 4 & 5 \end{bmatrix}$   
c.  $\alpha\beta = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 & 4 & 5 & 6 \\ 6 & 2 & 1 & 5 & 3 & 4 \end{bmatrix}$
3. a. (15)(234) b. (124)(35)(6) c. (1423)
5. a. 3 b. 12 c. 6 d. 6 e. 12 f. 2
7. 12
9. For  $S_6$ , the possible orders are 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6; for  $A_6$ , 1, 2, 3, 4, 5; for  $A_7$ , 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7.
11. (12345)(678)(9,10)(11,12)
13. Let  $\alpha(x_1) = \alpha(x_2)$ . Then  $x_1 = \alpha(\alpha(x_1)) = \alpha(\alpha(x_2)) = x_2$ . For any  $s$  in  $S$ , we have  $\alpha(\alpha(s)) = s$ .
15. even; odd



17. An even number of 2-cycles followed by an even number of 2-cycles gives an even number of 2-cycles in all. So the Finite Subgroup Test is verified.
19. Suppose that  $\alpha$  can be written as a product of  $m$  2-cycles and  $\beta$  can be written as a product of  $n$  2-cycles. Then  $\alpha\beta$  can be written as a product of  $m + n$  2-cycles. Now observe that  $m + n$  is even if and only if  $m$  and  $n$  are both even or both odd.
21. the number of odd cycles in the product is even.
23. Suppose  $H$  contains at least one odd permutation,  $\sigma$ . Imitate the proof of Theorem 5.7 with  $\sigma$  in place of (12).
25. The identity is even; the set is not closed.
27.  $(8 \cdot 7 \cdot 6 \cdot 5 \cdot 4 \cdot 3 \cdot 2 \cdot 1)/(2 \cdot 2 \cdot 2 \cdot 2 \cdot 4!)$
29. 180; 75
31. In  $S_7$ ,  $\beta = (2457136)$ . In  $S_9$ ,  $\beta = (2457136)$  or  $\beta = (2457136)(89)$ .
33. Since  $l(a_1a_2a_3a_4)(a_5a_6) = 4$  such an  $x$  would have order 8. But the elements in  $S_{10}$  of order 8 are 8-cycles or the disjoint product of 8-cycle and a 2-cycle. In both cases the square of such an element is the product of two 4-cycles.
35. Let  $\alpha, \beta \in \text{stab}(a)$ . Then  $\alpha\beta(a) = \alpha(\beta(a)) = \alpha(a) = a$ . Also,  $\alpha(a) = a$  implies  $\alpha^{-1}(\alpha(a)) = \alpha^{-1}(a)$  or  $a = \alpha^{-1}(a)$ .
37.  $m$  is a multiple of 6 but not a multiple of 30.
39.  $\langle (1234) \rangle; \{ (1), (12), (34), (12)(34) \}$ .
41. Let  $\alpha = (123)$  and  $\beta = (145)$ .
43.  $(123)(12) \neq (12)(123)$  in  $S_n$  ( $n \geq 3$ ).
45. The Finite Subgroup Test shows that  $H$  is a subgroup.  $|H| = 2(n-2)!$ .
47. Theorem 5.2 shows that disjoint cycles commute. For the other half, we may assume that the two cycles are  $(ab)$  and  $(ad)$ . Then observe that  $(ab)(ad) = (adb)$  and  $(ad)(ab) = (abd)$ .
49.  $R_0, R_{180}, H, V$
51. The permutation corresponding to the rotation of  $360/n$  degrees,  $(1, 2, \dots, n)$ , is an even permutation so all rotations are even.
53. Cycle decomposition shows that any nonidentity element of  $A_5$  is a 5-cycle, a 3-cycle, or a product of a pair of disjoint 2-cycles. Then, observe that there are  $(5 \cdot 4 \cdot 3 \cdot 2 \cdot 1)/5 = 24$  group elements of the form  $(abcde)$ ,  $(5 \cdot 4 \cdot 3)/3 = 20$  group elements of the form  $(abc)$ , and  $(5 \cdot 4 \cdot 3 \cdot 2)/(2 \cdot 2 \cdot 2) = 15$  group elements of the form  $(ab)(cd)$ .
55. If  $\alpha$  has odd order  $k$  and  $\alpha$  is an odd permutation, then  $\varepsilon = \alpha^k$  would be odd.
57. Hint:  $(13)(12) = (123)$  and  $(12)(34) = (324)(132)$ .
59. Verifying that  $a * \sigma(b) \neq b * \sigma(a)$  is done by examining all cases. To prove the general case, observe that  $\sigma^i(a) * \sigma^{i+1}(b) \neq \sigma^i(b) * \sigma^{i+1}(a)$  can be written in the form  $\sigma^i(a) * \sigma(\sigma^i(b)) \neq \sigma^i(b) * \sigma(\sigma^i(a))$ , which is the case already done. If a transposition were not detected, then  $\sigma(a_1) * \dots * \sigma^i(a_i) * \sigma^{i+1}(a_{i+1}) * \dots * \sigma^n(a_n) = \sigma(a_1) * \dots * \sigma^i(a_{i+1}) * \sigma^{i+1}(a_i) * \dots * \sigma^n(a_n)$ , which implies  $\sigma^i(a_i) * \sigma^{i+1}(a_{i+1}) = \sigma^i(a_{i+1}) * \sigma^{i+1}(a_i)$ .
61. By Theorem 5.4 it is enough to prove that every 2-cycle can be expressed as a product of elements of the form  $(1k)$ . To this end, observe that if  $a \neq 1, b \neq 1$ , then  $(ab) = (1a)(1b)(1a)$ .
63. By case-by-case analysis,  $H$  is a subgroup for  $n = 1, 2, 3$ , and 4. For  $n \geq 5$ , observe that  $(12)(34)$  and  $(12)(35)$  belong to  $H$  but their product does not.
65. The product of an element of  $Z(A_4)$  of order 2 and an element of  $A_4$  of order 3 would have order 6. But  $A_4$  has no element of order 6.
67. TAAKTPKSTOOPEDN

## Chapter 6

Think and you won't sink.

B. C. FORBES, Epigrams

- Try  $n \rightarrow 2n$ .
- $\phi(xy) = \sqrt{xy} = \sqrt{x}\sqrt{y} = \phi(x)\phi(y)$ .
- Try  $1 \rightarrow 1, 3 \rightarrow 5, 5 \rightarrow 7, 7 \rightarrow 11$ .
- $D_{12}$  has elements of order 12 and  $S_4$  does not.
- Since  $T_e(x) = ex = x$  for all  $x$ ,  $T_e$  is the identity. For the second part, observe that  $T_g \circ (T_g)^{-1} = T_e = T_{gg^{-1}} = T_g \circ T_{g^{-1}}$  and cancel.
- $3\bar{a} - 2\bar{b}$ .
- For any  $x$  in the group, we have  $(\phi_g \phi_h)(x) = \phi_g(\phi_h(x)) = \phi_g(hxh^{-1}) = ghxh^{-1}g^{-1} = (gh)x(gh)^{-1} = \phi_{gh}(x)$ .
- $\phi_{R_{90}}$  and  $\phi_{R_0}$  disagree on  $H$ ;  $\phi_{R_{90}}$  and  $\phi_H$  disagree on  $R_{90}$ ;  $\phi_{R_{90}}$  and  $\phi_D$  disagree on  $R_{90}$ . The remaining cases are similar.
- Let  $\alpha \in \text{Aut}(G)$ . We show that  $\alpha^{-1}$  is operation-preserving:  $\alpha^{-1}(xy) = \alpha^{-1}(x)\alpha^{-1}(y)$  if and only if  $\alpha(\alpha^{-1}(xy)) = \alpha(\alpha^{-1}(x)\alpha^{-1}(y))$ , that is, if and only if  $xy = \alpha(\alpha^{-1}(x))\alpha(\alpha^{-1}(y)) = xy$ . So  $\alpha^{-1}$  is operation-preserving. That  $\text{Inn}(G)$  is a group follows from the equation  $\phi_g \phi_h = \phi_{gh}$ .

19. Since  $b = \phi(a) = a\phi(1)$ , it follows that  $\phi(1) = a^{-1}b$  and therefore  $\phi(x) = a^{-1}bx$ . [Here  $a^{-1}$  is the multiplicative inverse of  $a \bmod n$ , which exists because  $a \in U(n)$ .]
21. Note that both  $H$  and  $K$  are isomorphic to the group of all permutations on four symbols, which is isomorphic to  $S_4$ . The same is true when 5 is replaced by  $n$ , since both  $H$  and  $K$  are isomorphic to  $S_{n-1}$ .
23. Recall that, when  $n$  is even,  $Z(D_n) = \{R_0, R_{180}\}$ . Since  $R_{180}$  and  $\phi(R_{180})$  are not the identity and belong to  $Z(D_n)$ , they must be equal.
25.  $Z_{60}$  contains cyclic subgroups of orders 12 and 20, and any cyclic group that has subgroups of orders 12 and 20 must be divisible by 12 and 20. So, 60 is the smallest order of any cyclic group that has subgroups isomorphic to  $Z_{12}$  and  $Z_{20}$ .
27. See Example 15 of Chapter 2.
29. That  $\alpha$  is one-to-one follows from the fact that  $r^{-1}$  exists modulo  $n$ . The operation-preserving condition is Exercise 9 in Chapter 0.
31. Use property 2 of Theorem 6.2.
33. The inverse of a one-to-one function is one-to-one. For any  $g \in G$ , we have  $\phi^{-1}(\phi(g)) = g$ , and therefore  $\phi^{-1}$  is onto. To verify that  $\phi^{-1}$  is operation-preserving, see the answer to Exercise 15 of this chapter.
35.  $T_g(x) = T_g(y)$  if and only if  $gx = gy$  or  $x = y$ . This shows that  $T_g$  is a one-to-one function. Let  $y \in G$ . Then  $T_g(g^{-1}y) = y$ , so that  $T_g$  is onto.
37. Apply the appropriate definitions.
39. See Exercise 35 in Chapter 4.
41. Try  $a + bi \rightarrow \begin{bmatrix} a & -b \\ b & a \end{bmatrix}$ .
43. Yes, by Cayley's Theorem.
45. Observe that  $\phi_g(y) = gyg^{-1}$  and  $\phi_{zg}(y) = zgy(zg)^{-1} = zgyg^{-1}z^{-1} = gyg^{-1}$  since  $z \in Z(G)$ . So,  $\phi_g = \phi_{zg}$ .
47.  $\phi_g = \phi_h$  implies  $gxg^{-1} = hxh^{-1}$  for all  $x$ . This implies  $h^{-1}gx(h^{-1}g)^{-1} = x$ , and therefore  $h^{-1}g \in Z(G)$ .
49. By Exercise 47  $\phi_\alpha = \phi_\beta$  implies  $\beta^{-1}\alpha$  is in  $Z(S_n)$  and by Exercise 58 in Chapter 5,  $Z(S_n) = \{e\}$ .
51. Since both  $\phi$  and  $\gamma$  take  $e$  to itself,  $H$  is not empty. Assume  $a$  and  $b$  belong to  $H$ . Then  $\phi(ab^{-1}) = \phi(a)\phi(b^{-1}) = \phi(a)\phi(b)^{-1} = \gamma(a)\gamma(b)^{-1} = \gamma(a)\gamma(b^{-1}) = \gamma(ab^{-1})$ . Thus,  $ab^{-1}$  is in  $H$ .

53. Since  $\phi(e) = e = e^{-1}$ ,  $H$  is not empty. Assume that  $a$  and  $b$  belong to  $H$ . Then  $\phi(ab) = \phi(a)\phi(b) = a^{-1}b^{-1} = b^{-1}a^{-1} = (ab)^{-1}$ , and  $H$  is closed under multiplication. Moreover, because  $\phi(a^{-1}) = \phi(a)^{-1} = (a^{-1})^{-1}$ , we have that  $H$  is closed under inverses.
55. Since  $-1$  is the unique element of  $C^*$  of order 2,  $\phi(-1) = -1$ . Since  $i$  and  $-i$  are the only elements of  $C^*$  of order 4,  $\phi(i) = i$  or  $-i$ .
57.  $Z_{120}$ ,  $D_{60}$ ,  $S_5$ ,  $Z_{120}$  is Abelian, the other two are not.  $D_{60}$  has an element of order 60 and  $S_5$  does not.
59. Observe that  $D = R_{90}V$  and  $H = R_{90}D$ .
61.  $T_{R_{90}} = (R_0R_{90}R_{180}R_{270})(HD'VD); T_D = (R_0D)(R_{90}V)(R_{180}D')(R_{270}H)$ .
63. Consider the mapping  $\phi(x) = x^2$  and note that 2 is not in the image.
65. Use the fact that if  $a > 0$ , then  $a = \sqrt{a}\sqrt{a}$ . For the second part, use the first part together with the fact that the inverse of an automorphism is an automorphism.
67. Say  $\phi$  is an isomorphism from  $Q$  to  $\mathbf{R}^+$  and  $\phi$  takes 1 to  $a$ . It follows that the integer  $r$  maps to  $a^r$  and the rational  $r/s$  maps to  $a^{r/s}$ . But  $a^{r/s} \neq a^r$  for any  $r/s$ .

## Chapter 7

Use missteps as stepping stones to deeper understanding and greater achievement.

SUSAN TAYLOR

- $H, 1 + H, 2 + H$
- a. yes b. yes c. no
- $8/2 = 4$ , so there are four cosets. Let  $H = \{1, 11\}$ . The cosets are  $H, 7H, 13H, 19H$ .
- $\langle a_4 \rangle, a\langle a_4 \rangle$
- $H = \{\alpha_1, \alpha_2, \alpha_3, \alpha_4\}$ ,  $\alpha_5H = \{\alpha_5, \alpha_8, \alpha_6, \alpha_7\}$ ,  $\alpha_9H = \{\alpha_9, \alpha_{11}, \alpha_{12}, \alpha_{10}\}$ . There are six left cosets of  $H$  is  $S_4$ .
- Let  $ga$  belong to  $g(H \cap K)$ , where  $a$  is in  $H \cap K$ . Then by definition  $ga$  is in  $gH \cap gK$ . Now let  $x \in gH \cap gK$ . Then  $x = gh$  for some  $h \in H$ , and  $x = gk$  for some  $k \in K$ . Cancellation then gives  $h = k$ . Thus,  $x \in g(H \cap K)$ .
- Suppose that  $h \in H$  and  $h < 0$ . Then  $h\mathbf{R}^+ \subseteq hH = H$ . But  $h\mathbf{R}^+$  is the set of all negative real numbers. Thus,  $H = \mathbf{R}^*$ .
- 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 10, 12, 15, 20, 30, 60
- Use Lagrange's Theorem (Theorem 7.1) and Corollary 3.

19. By Exercise 18, we have  $5^6 \bmod 7 = 1$ . So, using mod 7, we have  $5^{15} = 5^6 \cdot 5^6 \cdot 5^2 \cdot 5 = 1 \cdot 1 \cdot 4 \cdot 5 = 6$ ;  $7^{13} \bmod 11 = 2$ .
21. Use Corollary 4 of Lagrange's Theorem (Theorem 7.1) together with Theorem 0.2.
23. First observe that for all  $n \geq 3$  the subgroup of rotations of  $D_n$  is isomorphic to  $Z_n$ . If  $n$  is even let  $F$  be any reflection in  $D_n$ . Then the set  $\{R_0, R_{180}, F, FR_{180}\}$  is closed and therefore a subgroup of order 4. Now suppose that  $D_n$  has a subgroup  $K$  of order 4. If  $K$  is cyclic then it has a rotation of order 4 and therefore 4 divides  $n$ . If  $K$  is not cyclic, then it has three elements of order 2. Since there is only one rotation of order 2,  $K$  must contain two reflections  $F_1$  and  $F_2$ . But then  $F_1F_2$  is a rotation and has order 2 so  $n$  is even.
25. Since  $G$  has odd order, no element can have order 2. Thus, for each  $x \neq e$ , we know that  $x \neq x^{-1}$ . So, we can write the product of all the elements in the form  $ea_1a_1^{-1}a_2a_2^{-1} \cdots a_na_n^{-1} = e$ .
27. Let  $H$  be the subgroup of order  $p$  and  $K$  be the subgroup of order  $q$ . Then  $H \cup K$  has  $p + q - 1 < pq$  elements. Let  $a$  be any element in  $G$  that is not in  $H \cup K$ . By Lagrange's Theorem,  $|a| = p, q$ , or  $pq$ . But  $|a| \neq p$ , for if so, then  $\langle a \rangle = H$ . Similarly,  $|a| \neq q$ .
29. 1, 3, 11, 33. If some  $x$  has order 33, then  $|x^{11}| = 3$ . Otherwise, use the Corollary to Theorem 4.4.
31. No. Observe that by Lagrange's Theorem, the elements of a group of order 55 must have orders 1, 5, 11, or 55; then use the corollary of Theorem 4.4.
33. Observe that  $|G:H| = |G|/|H|$ ,  $|G:K| = |G|/|K|$ , and  $|K:H| = |K|/|H|$ .
35. Since the reflections in a dihedral group have order 2, the generators of the subgroups of orders 12 and 20 must be rotations. The smallest rotation subgroup of a dihedral group that contains rotations of orders 12 and 20 must have order divisible by 12 and 20 and therefore must be a multiple of 60. So,  $D_{60}$  is the smallest such dihedral group.
37. Let  $a$  have order 3 and  $b$  be an element of order 3 not in  $\langle a \rangle$ . Then  $\langle a \rangle \langle b \rangle$  is a subgroup of  $G$  of order 9. Now use Lagrange's Theorem.
39. Since  $|H \cap K|$  is a common divisor of 24 and 20 it must divide 4. But groups of orders 1, 2 and 4 are Abelian.
41. Let  $a \in G$  and  $|a| = 5$ . Then the set  $\langle a \rangle H$  has exactly  $5 \cdot |H|/|\langle a \rangle \cap H|$  elements and  $|\langle a \rangle \cap H|$  divides  $|\langle a \rangle| = 5$ . It follows that  $|\langle a \rangle \cap H| = 5$  and therefore  $\langle a \rangle \cap H = \langle a \rangle$ .
43. Certainly,  $a \in \text{orb}_G(a)$ . Now suppose that  $c \in \text{orb}_G(a) \cap \text{orb}_G(b)$ . Then  $c = \alpha(a)$  and  $c = \beta(b)$  for some  $\alpha$  and  $\beta$ , and therefore  $(\beta^{-1}\alpha)(a) = b$ . So, if  $x \in \text{orb}_G(b)$ , then  $x = \gamma(b) = (\gamma\beta^{-1}\alpha)(a)$  for some  $\gamma$ . This proves that  $\text{orb}_G(b) \subseteq \text{orb}_G(a)$ . By symmetry,  $\text{orb}_G(a) \subseteq \text{orb}_G(b)$ .
45. a.  $\text{stab}_G(1) = \{(1), (24)(56)\}$ ;  $\text{orb}_G(1) = \{1, 2, 3, 4\}$   
 b.  $\text{stab}_G(3) = \{(1), (24)(56)\}$ ;  $\text{orb}_G(3) = \{3, 4, 1, 2\}$   
 c.  $\text{stab}_G(5) = \{(1), (12)(34), (13)(24), (14)(23)\}$ ;  $\text{orb}_G(5) = \{5, 6\}$
47. Consider the mapping from  $G$  to  $G$  defined by  $\phi(x) = x^2$  and let  $|G| = 2k + 1$ . Use the observation that  $x = xe = x^{2k+1} = x^{2k+2} = (x^2)^{k+1}$  to prove that  $\phi$  is one-to-one and Exercise 12 of Chapter 5 to show that  $\phi$  is onto.
49. Use Theorem 7.2.
51. Suppose that  $H$  is a subgroup of  $A_5$  of order 30. We claim that  $H$  contains all 20 elements of  $A_5$  that have order 3. To verify this, assume that there is some  $\alpha$  in  $A_5$  of order 3 that is not in  $H$ . Then  $A_5 = H \cup \alpha H$ . It follows that  $\alpha^2 H = H$  or  $\alpha^2 = \alpha H$ . Since the latter implies that  $\alpha \in H$ , we have that  $\alpha^2 H = H$ , which implies that  $\alpha^2 \in H$ . But then  $\langle \alpha \rangle = \langle \alpha^2 \rangle \subseteq H$ , which is a contradiction of our assumption that  $\alpha$  is not in  $H$ . The same argument, shows that  $H$  must contain all 24 elements of order 5. Since  $|H| = 30$ , we have a contradiction.
53. Observe that  $\alpha(a_i) = a_{i+1}$ ,  $\alpha^2(a_i) = a_{i+2}, \dots$ ,  $\alpha^k(a_i) = a_i$ , where all subscripts are taken mod  $k$ .
55. If  $H$  is a subgroup of  $S_5$  of order 60 other than  $A_5$ , then it follows from Theorem 7.2 that  $|A_5 \cap H| = 30$ , which contradicts Exercise 51.
57. Suppose that  $B \in G$  and  $\det(B) = 2$ . Then  $\det(A^{-1}B) = 1$ , so that  $A^{-1}B \in H$  and therefore  $B \in AH$ . Conversely, for any  $Ah \in AH$  we have  $\det(Ah) = \det(A)\det(h) = 2 \cdot 1 = 2$ .
59. It is the set of all permutations that carry face 2 to face 1.
61.  $aH = bH$  if and only if  $\det(a) = \pm \det(b)$ .
63. Closure of the set follows from using  $\alpha\beta^2 = \beta^2\alpha^3$ .
65. 50

## Chapter 8

Practice isn't the thing you do when you're good.  
It's the thing you do that makes you good.

MALCOLM GLADWELL

1. Closure and associativity in the product follow from the closure and associativity in each component. The identity in the product is the  $n$ -tuple with the identity in each component. The inverse of  $(g_1, g_2, \dots, g_n)$  is  $(g_1^{-1}, g_2^{-1}, \dots, g_n^{-1})$ .
3. Use  $g \rightarrow (g, e_H)$  and  $h \rightarrow (e_G, h)$ .
5. To show that  $Z \oplus Z$  is not cyclic, note that  $(a, b + 1) \notin \langle (a, b) \rangle$ .
7. Use  $(g_1, g_2) \rightarrow (g_2, g_1)$ . In general,  $G_1 \oplus G_2 \cdots \oplus G_n$  is isomorphic to the external direct product of any rearrangement of  $G_1, G_2, \dots, G_n$ .
9. Look at  $Z_6 \oplus Z_2$ .
11. There are 12 elements of order 4. Observe by Theorem 4.4 that as long as  $d$  divides  $n$ , the number of elements of order  $d$  in a cyclic group depends only on  $d$ . So, in both  $Z_{8000000}$  and  $Z_4$  there are  $\phi(4) = 2$  elements of order 4 and  $\phi(2) = 1$  element of order 2. Similarly for  $Z_m \oplus Z_n$ .
13.  $Z_{n^2}$  and  $Z_n \oplus Z_n$ .
15. Try  $a + bi \rightarrow (a, b)$ .
17. Use Exercise 3 and Theorem 4.3.
19.  $\langle m/r \rangle \oplus \langle n/s \rangle$
21. Since  $\langle (g, h) \rangle \subseteq \langle g \rangle \oplus \langle h \rangle$ , a necessary and sufficient condition for equality is that  $\text{lcm}(|g|, |h|) = |\langle g, h \rangle| = |\langle g \rangle \oplus \langle h \rangle| = |g||h|$ . This is equivalent to  $\text{gcd}(|g|, |h|) = 1$ .
23. In the general case there are  $(3^n - 1)/2$ .
25. Map  $\begin{bmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{bmatrix}$  to  $(a, b, c, d)$ . Let  $\mathbf{R}^k$  denote  $\mathbf{R} \oplus \mathbf{R} \oplus \cdots \oplus \mathbf{R}$  ( $k$  factors). Then the group of  $m \times n$  matrices under addition is isomorphic to  $\mathbf{R}^{mn}$ .
27.  $(g, g)(h, h)^{-1} = (gh^{-1}, gh^{-1})$ . When  $G = \mathbf{R}$ ,  $G \oplus G$  is the plane and  $H$  is the line  $y = x$ .
29.  $\langle (3, 0) \rangle, \langle (3, 1) \rangle, \langle (3, 2) \rangle, \langle (0, 1) \rangle$
31.  $\text{lcm}(6, 10, 15) = 30$ ;  $\text{lcm}(n_1, n_2, \dots, n_k)$ .
33.  $\{0, 400\} \oplus \{0, 50, 100, 150\}$
35. Compare the number of elements of order 2 in each group.
37. The mapping  $\phi(3^m 6^n) = (m, n)$  is an isomorphism. The mapping  $\phi(3^m 9^n) = (m, n)$  is not well-defined, since  $\phi(3^{290}) \neq \phi(3^{91})$ .
39. In both cases they are the same.
41.  $U_5(35) = \{1, 6, 11, 16, 26, 31\}$ ;  $U_7(35) = \{1, 8, 22, 29\}$ .
43.  $\mathbf{C}^*$  has only one element of order 2, whereas  $Z_2 \oplus Z_2$  has three elements of order 2.
45. 12
47.  $\text{Aut}(U(25)) \approx \text{Aut}(Z_{20}) \approx U(20) \approx U(4) \oplus U(5) \approx Z_2 \oplus Z_4$
49.  $2^k - 1$ ;  $2^t - 1$ , where  $t$  is the number of the integers  $n_1, n_2, \dots, n_k$  that are even.
51.  $\phi(18) = 6$ ; 0 ( $Z_2 \oplus Z_3 \oplus Z_3$  is not cyclic).
53. Since  $(2, 0)$  has order 2, it must map to an element in  $Z_{12}$  of order 2. The only such element in  $Z_{12}$  is 6. The isomorphism defined by  $(1, 1)x \rightarrow 5x$  with  $x = 6$  takes  $(2, 0)$  to 6. Since  $(1, 0)$  has order 4, it must map to an element in  $Z_{12}$  of order 4. The only such elements in  $Z_{12}$  are 3 and 9. The first case occurs for the isomorphism defined by  $(1, 1)x \rightarrow 7x$  with  $x = 9$  [recall that  $(1, 1)$  is a generator of  $Z_4 \oplus Z_3$ ]; the second case occurs for the isomorphism defined by  $(1, 1)x \rightarrow 5x$  with  $x = 9$ .
55. Since  $a \in Z_m$  and  $b \in Z_n$ , we know that  $|a|$  divides  $m$  and  $|b|$  divides  $n$ . So,  $|(a, b)| = \text{lcm}(|a|, |b|)$  divides  $\text{lcm}(m, n)$ .
57.  $Z, Z_3, Z_4, Z_6$
59. Observe that every nonidentity element of  $Z_p \oplus Z_p$  has order  $p$  and each subgroup of order  $p$  contains  $p - 1$  of them. So, there are exactly  $(p^2 - 1)/(p - 1) = p + 1$  subgroups of order  $p$ .
61. Look at  $Z \oplus Z_2$ .
63.  $U(165) \approx U(11) \oplus U(15) \approx U(5) \oplus U(33) \approx U(3) \oplus U(55) \approx U(3) \oplus U(5) \oplus U(11)$
65. Mimic the analysis for elements of order 12 in  $U(105)$  in this chapter. The number is 14.
67. 60.
69. They are both isomorphic to  $Z_4 \oplus Z_{10}$ .
71.  $U_{125}(1000) = \{1, 251, 501, 751\}$ .
73. Since  $U(pq) \approx U(p) \oplus U(q) \approx Z_{p-1} \oplus Z_{q-1}$  if follows that  $k = \text{lcm}(p - 1, q - 1)$ .
75.  $|U(200)| = 80$ ;  $|U(50) \oplus U(4)| = 40$ .
77.  $U_8(40) \approx U(5) \approx Z_4$
79. None. Because  $\text{gcd}(18, 12) = 6$ , Step 3 of the Sender part of the algorithm fails.
81. Because the block 2505 exceeds the modulus 2263, sending  $2505^e \bmod 2263$  is the same as sending  $242^e \bmod 2263$  which decodes as 242 instead of 2505.

**Chapter 9**

There's a mighty big difference between good, sound reasons and reasons that sound good.

BURTON HILLIS

1. No.
3.  $HR_{90} = R_{270}H$ ;  $DR_{270} = R_{90}D$ ;  $R_{90}V = VR_{270}$
5. Say  $i < j$  and let  $h \in H_i \cap H_j$ . Then  $h \in H_1H_2 \cdots H_i \cdots H_{j-1} \cap H_j = \{e\}$ .
7. Recall that if  $A$  and  $B$  are matrices, then  $\det(ABA^{-1}) = (\det A)(\det B)(\det A)^{-1}$ .
9. Let  $x \in G$ . If  $x \in H$ , then  $xH = H = Hx$ . If  $x \notin H$ , then  $xH$  is the set of elements in  $G$ , not in  $H$ . But  $Hx$  is also the set of elements in  $G$ , not in  $H$ .
11. Let  $G = \langle a \rangle$ . Then  $G/H = \langle aH \rangle$
13. in  $H$ .
15. 2
17.  $H = \{0 + \langle 20 \rangle, 4 + \langle 20 \rangle, 8 + \langle 20 \rangle, 12 + \langle 20 \rangle, 16 + \langle 20 \rangle\}$ ;  $G/H = \{0 + \langle 20 \rangle + H, 1 + \langle 20 \rangle + H, 2 + \langle 20 \rangle + H, 3 + \langle 20 \rangle + H\}$
19. Observe that in a group  $G$  if  $|a| = 2$  and  $\{e, a\}$  is a normal subgroup then  $xax^{-1} = a$  for all  $x$  in  $G$ . Thus  $a \in Z(G)$ . So, the only normal subgroup of order 2 in  $D_n$  is  $\{R_0, R_{180}\}$  when  $n$  is even.
21. By Theorem 9.5, the group has an element  $a$  of order 3 and an element  $b$  of order 11. Then  $|ab| = 33$ .
23.  $|G_1||G_2|/|H_1||H_2|$ .
25.  $Z_4 \oplus Z_2$ .
27. Yes; no
29. The subgroups would have orders 2 or 4 and therefore are Abelian. But the internal direct products of Abelian groups are Abelian.
31. Certainly, every nonzero real number is of the form  $\pm r$ , where  $r$  is a positive real number. Real numbers commute, and  $\mathbf{R}^+ \cap \{1, -1\} = \{1\}$ .
33. No. If  $G = H \times K$ , then  $|g| = \text{lcm}(|h|, |k|)$ , provided that  $|h|$  and  $|k|$  are finite. If  $|h|$  or  $|k|$  is infinite, so is  $|g|$ .
35. For the first question, note that  $\langle 3 \rangle \cap \langle 6 \rangle = \{1\}$  and  $\langle 3 \rangle \langle 6 \rangle \cap \langle 10 \rangle = \{1\}$ . For the second question, observe that  $12 = 3^{-1}6^2$ . So  $\langle 3 \rangle \langle 6 \rangle \cap \langle 12 \rangle \neq \{1\}$ .
37. Say  $|g| = n$ . Then  $(gH)^n = g^nH = eH = H$ . Now use Corollary 2 to Theorem 4.1.
39. Let  $x$  belong to  $G$  and  $h$  belong to  $H$ . Then  $xhx^{-1}H = (xh)x^{-1}H = (xh)Hx^{-1}H = xhHx^{-1}H = xHx^{-1}H = xH = H$ , so  $xhx^{-1}$  belongs to  $H$ .
41. Suppose that  $H$  is a proper subgroup of  $Q$  of index  $n$ . Then  $Q/H$  is a finite group of order  $n$ . By Corollary 4 of Theorem 7.1, we know that for every  $x$  in  $Q$  we have  $nx$  is in  $H$ . Now observe that the function  $f(x) = nx$  maps  $Q$  onto  $Q$ . So,  $Q \subseteq H$ .
43. Take  $G = Z_6$ ,  $H = \{0, 3\}$ ,  $a = 1$ , and  $b = 9$ .
45. Use Lagrange's Theorem and Exercise 9 of this chapter.
47. By Lagrange,  $|H \cap K|$  divides both 63 and 45. If  $|H \cap K| = 9$ , then  $H \cap K$  is Abelian by Theorem 9.7. If  $|H \cap K| = 3$ , then  $H \cap K$  is cyclic by the Corollary of Theorem 7.1. If  $|H \cap K| = 1$ , then  $H \cap K = \{e\}$ .
49. Use the  $G/Z$  Theorem.
51. Suppose that  $K$  is a normal subgroup of  $G$  and let  $gH \in G/H$  and  $kH \in K/H$ . Then  $gHkH(gH)^{-1} = gHkHg^{-1}H = gkg^{-1}H \in K/H$ . Now suppose that  $K/H$  is a normal subgroup of  $G/H$  and let  $g \in G$  and  $k \in K$ . Then  $gkg^{-1}H = gHkHg^{-1}H = gHkH(gH)^{-1} \in K/H$  so  $gkg^{-1} \in K$ .
53. Say  $H$  has index  $n$ . Then  $(\mathbf{R}^*)^n = \{x^n \mid x \in \mathbf{R}^*\} \subseteq H$ . If  $n$  is odd, then  $(\mathbf{R}^*)^n = \mathbf{R}^*$ ; if  $n$  is even, then  $(\mathbf{R}^*)^n = \mathbf{R}^+$ . So,  $H = \mathbf{R}^*$  or  $H = \mathbf{R}^+$ .
55. Use Exercise 9 and observe that  $VK \neq KV$ .
57. Look at  $S_3$ .
59. Let  $N = \langle a \rangle$ ,  $H = \langle a^k \rangle$ , and  $x \in G$ . Then,  $x(a^k)^m x^{-1} = (xa^m x^{-1})^k = (a^r)^k = (a^k)^r \in H$ .
61.  $\gcd(|x|, |G/H|) = 1$  implies  $\gcd(|xH|, |G/H|) = 1$ . But  $|xH|$  divides  $|G/H|$ . Thus  $|xH| = 1$  and therefore  $xH = H$ .
63. Observe that for every positive integer  $n$ ,  $(1 + i)^n$  is not a real number. So,  $(1 + i)\mathbf{R}^*$  has infinite order.
65. Use Theorems 9.4 and 9.3.
67. Say  $|gH| = n$ . Then  $|g| = nt$  (by Exercise 37) and  $|g^t| = n$ . For the second part, consider  $Z/\langle k \rangle$ .
69. Use Theorem 9.3 and Theorem 7.3.
71. If  $A_5$  had a normal subgroup of order 2 then, by Exercise 70, it would have an element of the form  $(ab)(cd)$  that commutes with every element of  $A_5$ . Try  $(abc)$ .

## Chapter 10

It's always helpful to learn from your mistakes, because then your mistakes seem worthwhile.

GARRY MARSHALL

1. Note that  $\det(AB) = (\det A)(\det B)$ .
3. Note that  $(f + g)' = f' + g'$ .
5. Observe that  $(xy)^r = x^r y^r$ . Odd values of  $r$  yield an isomorphism. For even values of  $r$  the kernel is  $\{1, -1\}$ .
7.  $(\sigma\phi)(g_1 g_2) = \sigma(\phi(g_1 g_2)) = \sigma(\phi(g_1)\phi(g_2)) = \sigma(\phi(g_1))\sigma(\phi(g_2)) = (\sigma\phi)(g_1)(\sigma\phi)(g_2)$ . Ker  $\phi$  is a normal subgroup of Ker  $\sigma\phi$ .  $|H/K| = |\text{Ker } \sigma\phi : \text{Ker } \phi|$ .
9.  $\phi((g, h)(g', h')) = \phi((gg', hh')) = gg' = \phi((g, h))\phi((g', h'))$ . The kernel is  $\{(e, h) \mid h \in H\}$ .
11. Consider  $\phi: Z \oplus Z \rightarrow Z_a \oplus Z_b$  given by  $\phi((x, y)) = (x \bmod a, y \bmod b)$  and use Theorem 10.3.
13.  $(a, b) \rightarrow b$  is a homomorphism from  $A \oplus B$  onto  $B$  with kernel  $A \oplus \{e\}$ .
15. 3, 13, 23
17. Suppose  $\phi$  is such a homomorphism. By Theorem 10.3,  $\text{Ker } \phi = \langle(8, 1)\rangle$ ,  $\langle(0, 1)\rangle$ , or  $\langle(8, 0)\rangle$ . In these cases,  $(1, 0) + \text{Ker } \phi$  has order either 16 or 8. So,  $(Z_{16} \oplus Z_2)/\text{Ker } \phi$  is not isomorphic to  $Z_4 \oplus Z_4$ .
19. Since  $|\text{Ker } \phi|$  is not 1 and divides 17,  $\phi$  is the trivial map.
21.  $\langle 5 \rangle$
23.  $|\phi^{-1}(H)| = |H| |\text{Ker } \phi|$ .
25. 4 onto; 10 to
27. For each  $k$  with  $0 \leq k \leq n - 1$ , the mapping  $1 \rightarrow k$  determines a homomorphism.
29. Use Theorem 10.3 and properties 5, 7, and 8 of Theorem 10.2.
31.  $\phi^{-1}(7) = 7 \text{ Ker } \phi = \{7, 17\}$
33.  $11 \text{ Ker } \phi$
35.  $\phi((a, b) + (c, d)) = \phi((a + c, b + d)) = (a + c) - (b + d) = a - b + c - d = \phi((a, b)) + \phi((c, d))$ .  $\text{Ker } \phi = \{(a, a) \mid a \in Z\}$ .  $\phi^{-1}(3) = \{(a + 3, a) \mid a \in Z\}$ .
37. Use the property of complex numbers that  $|xy| = |x||y|$  and the First Isomorphism Theorem.
39.  $\phi(xy) = (xy)^6 = x^6 y^6 = \phi(x)\phi(y)$ .  $\text{Ker } \phi = \langle \cos 60^\circ + i \sin 60^\circ \rangle$ .
41. Show that the mapping from  $K$  to  $KN/N$  given by  $k \rightarrow kN$  is an onto homomorphism with kernel  $K \cap N$ .
43. Since the eight elements of  $A_4$  of order 3 must map to an element of order that divides 3, by Lagrange's Theorem, each of them must map to the identity. But then the kernel has at least 8 elements and its order and divides 12. So, the kernel has order 12.
45.  $D_4, \{e\}, Z_2, Z_2 \oplus Z_2$
47. It is divisible by 10. 10 can be replaced by any positive integer.
49. It is infinite. Look at  $Z$ .
51. Let  $\gamma$  be the natural homomorphism from  $G$  onto  $G/N$ . Let  $\bar{H}$  be a subgroup of  $G/N$  and let  $\gamma^{-1}(\bar{H}) = H$ . Then  $H$  is a subgroup of  $G$  and  $H/N = \gamma(H) = \gamma(\gamma^{-1}(\bar{H})) = \bar{H}$ .
53. The mapping  $g \rightarrow \phi_g$  is a homomorphism with kernel  $Z(G)$ .
55.  $(f + g)(3) = f(3) + g(3)$ . The kernel is the set of elements in  $Z[x]$  whose graphs pass through the point  $(3, 0)$ . 3 can be replaced by any integer.
57. Let  $g$  belong to  $G$ . Since  $\phi(g)$  belongs to  $Z_2 \oplus Z_2 = \langle(1, 0)\rangle \cup \langle(0, 1)\rangle \cup \langle(1, 1)\rangle$ , it follows that  $G = \phi^{-1}(\langle(1, 0)\rangle) \cup \phi^{-1}(\langle(0, 1)\rangle) \cup \phi^{-1}(\langle(1, 1)\rangle)$ . Moreover, each of these three subgroups is proper and by property 8 of Theorem 10.2 normal.
59. Note that if  $z \in Z(G)$  then for all  $x \in G$ , we have  $\phi(x)\phi(z) = \phi(xz) = \phi(zx) = \phi(z)\phi(x)$ . Since  $\phi$  is onto  $H$ , we have  $\phi(z) \in Z(H)$ .
61. Mimic Example 17.
63. Let  $\phi$  be a homomorphism from  $S_3$  to  $G$ . Since  $|\phi(S_3)|$  must divide 6, we have that  $|\phi(S_3)| = 1, 2, 3$ , or 6. In the first case,  $\phi$  maps every element to 0. If  $|\phi(S_3)| = 2$ , then  $n$  is even and  $\phi$  maps the even permutations to 0 and the odd permutations to an element of order 2. The case that  $|\phi(S_3)| = 3$  cannot occur, because it implies that  $\text{Ker } \phi$  is a normal subgroup of order 2, whereas  $S_3$  has no normal subgroup of order 2. The case that  $|\phi(S_3)| = 6$  cannot occur, because it implies that  $\phi$  is an isomorphism from a non-Abelian group to an Abelian group.
65.  $\phi(zw) = z^2 w^2 = \phi(z)\phi(w)$ .  $\text{Ker } \phi = \{1, -1\}$  and, because  $\phi$  is onto  $\mathbf{C}^*$  we have by Theorem 10.3,  $\mathbf{C}^*/\{1, -1\}$  is isomorphic to  $\mathbf{C}^*$ .  
When  $\mathbf{C}^*$  is replaced by  $\mathbf{R}^*$  we have that  $\phi$  is onto  $\mathbf{R}^+$  and by Theorem 10.3,  $\mathbf{R}^*/\{1, -1\}$  is isomorphic to  $\mathbf{R}^+$ .



**Chapter 11**

Ever tried. Ever failed. No matter. Try again. Fail again. Fail better.

SAMUEL BECKETT

1.  $n = 4$ ;  $Z_4, Z_2 \oplus Z_2$
3.  $n = 36$ ;  $Z_9 \oplus Z_4, Z_3 \oplus Z_3 \oplus Z_4, Z_9 \oplus Z_2 \oplus Z_2, Z_3 \oplus Z_3 \oplus Z_2 \oplus Z_2$
5. The only Abelian groups of order 45 are  $Z_{45}$  and  $Z_3 \oplus Z_3 \oplus Z_5$ . In the first group,  $|3| = 15$ ; in the second one,  $|(1, 1, 1)| = 15$ .  $Z_3 \oplus Z_3 \oplus Z_5$  does not have an element of order 9.
7.  $Z_9 \oplus Z_3 \oplus Z_4; Z_9 \oplus Z_3 \oplus Z_2 \oplus Z_2$
9.  $Z_4 \oplus Z_2 \oplus Z_3 \oplus Z_5$
11. By the Fundamental Theorem, any finite Abelian group  $G$  is isomorphic to some direct product of cyclic groups of prime-power order. Now go across the direct product and, for each distinct prime you have, pick off the largest factor of the prime power. Next, combine all of these into one factor (you can do this, since the subscripts are relatively prime). Let us call the order of this new factor  $n_1$ . Now repeat this process with the remaining original factors and call the order of the resulting factor  $n_2$ . Then  $n_2$  divides  $n_1$ , since each prime-power divisor of  $n_2$  is also a prime-power divisor of  $n_1$ . Continue in this fashion. Example: If

$$G \approx Z_{27} \oplus Z_3 \oplus Z_{125} \oplus Z_{25} \oplus Z_4 \oplus Z_2 \oplus Z_2,$$

then

$$G \approx Z_{27 \cdot 125 \cdot 4} \oplus Z_{3 \cdot 25 \cdot 2} \oplus Z_2.$$

Now note that 2 divides  $3 \cdot 25 \cdot 2$  and  $3 \cdot 25 \cdot 2$  divides  $27 \cdot 125 \cdot 4$ .

13.  $Z_2 \oplus Z_2$
15. a. 1 b. 1 c. 1 d. 1 e. 1 f. There is a unique Abelian group of order  $n$  if and only if  $n$  is not divisible by the square of any prime.
17. This is equivalent to asking how many Abelian groups of order 16 have no elements of order 8. From the Fundamental Theorem of Finite Abelian Groups the only choices are  $Z_4 \oplus Z_4, Z_4 \oplus Z_2 \oplus Z_2$ , and  $Z_2 \oplus Z_2 \oplus Z_2 \oplus Z_2$ .
19.  $Z_2 \oplus Z_2$
21.  $Z_3 \oplus Z_3$
23.  $n$  is square-free (no prime factor of  $n$  occurs more than once).

25. Among the first 11 elements in the table, there are nine elements of order 4. None of the other isomorphism classes has this many.
27.  $Z_4 \oplus Z_2 \oplus Z_2$ ; one internal direct product is  $\langle 7 \rangle \times \langle 101 \rangle \times \langle 199 \rangle$ .
29. 3; 6; 12
31.  $Z_4 \oplus Z_4$
33. Use Theorems 11.1, 8.1, and 4.3.
35.  $|\langle a \rangle K| = |a||K|/|\langle a \rangle \cap K| = |a||K| = |\bar{a}||\bar{K}|p = |\bar{G}|p = |G|$
37. By the Fundamental Theorem of Finite Abelian Groups, it suffices to show that every group of the form  $Z_{p_1^{n_1}} \oplus Z_{p_2^{n_2}} \oplus \cdots \oplus Z_{p_k^{n_k}}$  is a subgroup of a  $U$ -group. Consider first a group of the form  $Z_{p_1^{n_1}} \oplus Z_{p_2^{n_2}}$  ( $p_1$  and  $p_2$  need not be distinct). By Dirichlet's Theorem, for some  $s$  and  $t$  there are distinct primes  $q$  and  $r$  such that  $q = tp_1^{n_1} + 1$  and  $r = sp_2^{n_2} + 1$ . Then  $U(qr) = U(q) \oplus U(r) \approx Z_{tp_1^{n_1}} \oplus Z_{sp_2^{n_2}}$ , and this latter group contains a subgroup isomorphic to  $Z_{p_1^{n_1}} \oplus Z_{p_2^{n_2}}$ . The general case follows in the same way.
39. Look at  $D_4$ .

**Chapter 12**

Mistakes are the portals of discovery.

JAMES JOYCE

1. For any  $n > 1$ , the ring  $M_2(Z_n)$  of  $2 \times 2$  matrices with entries from  $Z_n$  is a finite noncommutative ring. The set  $M_2(2Z)$  of  $2 \times 2$  matrices with even integer entries is an infinite noncommutative ring that does not have a unity.
3. In  $\mathbf{R}$ , consider  $\{n\sqrt{2} \mid n \in \mathbf{Z}\}$ .
5. The proofs given for a group apply to a ring as well.
7. In  $Z_p$ , nonzero elements have multiplicative inverses. Use them.
9. If  $a$  and  $b$  belong to the intersection, then they belong to each member of the intersection. Thus,  $a - b$  and  $ab$  belong to each member of the intersection. So,  $a - b$  and  $ab$  belong to the intersection.
11. Rule 3:  $0 = 0(-b) = (a + (-a))(-b) = a(-b) + (-a)(-b) = -(ab) + (-a)(-b)$ . So,  $ab = (-a)(-b)$ .  
Rule 4:  $a(b - c) = a(b + (-c)) = ab + a(-c) = ab + (-ac) = ab - ac$ .  
Rule 5: Use rule 2.  
Rule 6: Use rule 3.

13. *Hint:*  $Z$  is a cyclic group under addition, and every subgroup of a cyclic group is cyclic.
15. For positive  $m$  and  $n$ , observe that  $(m \cdot a)(n \cdot b) = (a + a + \cdots + a)(b + b + \cdots + b) = (ab + ab + \cdots + ab)$ , where the last term has  $mn$  summands. Similar arguments apply in the remaining cases.
17. From Exercise 15, we have  $(n \cdot a)(m \cdot a) = (nm) \cdot a^2 = (mn) \cdot a^2 = (m \cdot a)(n \cdot a)$ .
19. Let  $a, b$  belong to the center. Then  $(a - b)x = ax - bx = xa - xb = x(a - b)$ . Also,  $(ab)x = a(bx) = a(xb) = (ax)b = (xa)b = x(ab)$ .
21.  $(x_1, \dots, x_n)(a_1, \dots, a_n) = (x_1, \dots, x_n)$  for all  $x_i$  in  $R_i$  if and only if  $x_i a_i = x_i$  for all  $x_i$  in  $R_i$  and  $i = 1, \dots, n$ .
23.  $\{1, -1, i, -i\}$
25.  $f(x) = 1$  and  $g(x) = -1$ .
27. If  $a$  is a unit, then  $b = a(a^{-1}b)$ .
29. Consider  $a^{-1} - a^{-2}b$ .
31. Try the ring  $M_2(\mathbb{Z})$ .
33. Note that  $2x = (2x)^3 = 8x^3 = 8x$ .
35. For  $Z_6$ , use  $n = 3$ . For  $Z_{10}$ , use  $n = 5$ . Say  $m = p^2t$ , where  $p$  is a prime. Then  $(pt)^n = 0$  in  $Z_m$ , since  $m$  divides  $(pt)^n$ .
37. Every subgroup of  $Z_n$  is closed under multiplication.
39.  $ara - asa = a(r - s)a$ .  $(ara)(asa) = ara^2sa = arsa$ .  $a1a = a^2 = 1$ , so  $1 \in S$ .
41. The Subring Test is satisfied.
43. Look at  $(1, 0, 1)$  and  $(0, 1, 1)$ .
45. Observe that  $n \cdot 1 - m \cdot 1 = (n - m) \cdot 1$ . Also,  $(n \cdot 1)(m \cdot 1) = (nm) \cdot ((1)(1)) = (nm) \cdot 1$ .
47.  $\{m/2^n \mid m \in \mathbb{Z}, n \in \mathbb{Z}^+\}$
49.  $(a + b)(a - b) = a^2 + ba - ab - b^2 = a^2 - b^2$  if and only if  $ba - ab = 0$ .
51.  $Z_2 \oplus Z_2; Z_2 \oplus Z_2 \oplus \cdots$  (infinitely many copies)
53. If  $(a, b)$  is a zero-divisor in  $R \oplus S$  then there is a  $(c, d) \neq (0, 0)$  such that  $(a, b)(c, d) = (0, 0)$ . Thus  $ac = 0$  and  $bd = 0$ . So,  $a$  or  $b$  is a zero-divisor or exactly one of  $a$  or  $b$  is 0. Conversely, if  $a$  is a zero-divisor in  $R$  then there is a  $c \neq 0$  in  $R$  such that  $ac = 0$ . In this case  $(a, b)(c, 0) = (0, 0)$ . A similar argument applies if  $b$  is a zero-divisor. If  $a = 0$  and  $b \neq 0$  then  $(a, b)(x, 0) = (0, 0)$  where  $x$  is any nonzero element in  $A$ . A similar argument applies if  $a \neq 0$  and  $b = 0$ .

55. Fix some  $a$  in  $R$ ,  $a \neq 0$ . Then there is a  $b$  in  $R$  such that  $ab = a$ . Now if  $x$  in  $R$  and  $x \neq 0$  then there is an element  $c$  in  $R$  such that  $ac = x$ . Then  $xb = acb = c(ab) = ca = x$ . Thus  $b$  is the unity. To show that every nonzero element  $r$  of  $R$  has an inverse note that since  $rR = R$  there is an element  $s$  in  $R$  such that  $rs = b$ .
57. Let  $a \in R$ . Then  $0 = ab^2 - ab = (ab - a)b$  so that  $ab - a = 0$ . Similarly,  $ba - a = 0$ .

## Chapter 13

Work now or wince later.

B. C. FORBES, *Epigrams*

1. The verifications for Examples 1–6 follow from elementary properties of real and complex numbers. For Example 7, note that 
$$\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 \end{bmatrix}.$$
 For Example 8, note that  $(1, 0)(0, 1) = (0, 0)$ .
3. Let  $ab = 0$  and  $a \neq 0$ . Then  $ab = a \cdot 0$ , so  $b = 0$ .
5. Let  $k \in \mathbb{Z}_n$ . If  $\gcd(k, n) = 1$ , then  $k$  is a unit. If  $\gcd(k, n) = d > 1$ , write  $k = sd$ . Then  $k(n/d) = sd(n/d) = sn = 0$ .
7. Let  $s \in R$ ,  $s \neq 0$ . Consider the set  $S = \{sr \mid r \in R\}$ . If  $S = R$ , then  $sr = 1$  (the unity) for some  $r$ . If  $S \neq R$ , then there are distinct  $r_1$  and  $r_2$  such that  $sr_1 = sr_2$ . In this case,  $s(r_1 - r_2) = 0$ . To see what happens when the “finite” condition is dropped, consider  $\mathbb{Z}$ .
9. Take  $a = (1, 1, 0)$ ,  $b = (1, 0, 1)$ , and  $c = (0, 1, 1)$ .
11.  $(a_1 + b_1\sqrt{d}) - (a_2 + b_2\sqrt{d}) = (a_1 - a_2) + (b_1 - b_2)\sqrt{d}$ ;  $(a_1 + b_1\sqrt{d})(a_2 + b_2\sqrt{d}) = (a_1a_2 + b_1b_2d) + (a_1b_2 + a_2b_1)\sqrt{d}$ . Thus, the set is a ring. Since  $\mathbb{Z}[\sqrt{d}]$  is a subring of the ring of complex numbers, it has no zero-divisors.
13. The even integers.
15.  $(1 - a)(1 + a + a^2 + \cdots + a^{n-1}) = 1 + a + a^2 + \cdots + a^{n-1} - a - a^2 - \cdots - a^n = 1 - a^n = 1 - 0 = 1$ .
17. Suppose  $a \neq 0$  and  $a^n = 0$  (where we take  $n$  to be as small as possible). Then  $a \cdot 0 = 0 = a^n = a \cdot a^{n-1}$ , so by cancellation,  $a^{n-1} = 0$ .



19. If  $a^2 = a$  and  $b^2 = b$ , then  $(ab)^2 = a^2b^2 = ab$ . The other cases are similar.
21. Let  $f(x) = x$  on  $[-1, 0]$ ,  $f(x) = 0$  on  $(0, 1]$ ,  $g(x) = 0$  on  $[-1, 0]$ , and  $g(x) = x$  on  $(0, 1]$ . Then  $f(x)$  and  $g(x)$  are in  $R$  and  $f(x)g(x) = 0$  on  $[-1, 1]$ .
23. Suppose that  $a$  is an idempotent and  $a^n = 0$ . By the previous exercise,  $a = 0$ .
25.  $(3 + 4i)^2 = 3 + 4i$ .
27.  $a^2 = a$  implies  $a(a - 1) = 0$ . So if  $a$  is a unit,  $a - 1 = 0$  and  $a = 1$ .
29. See Theorems 3.1 and 12.3.
31. Note that  $ab = 1$  implies  $aba = a$ . Thus  $0 = aba - a = a(ba - 1)$ . So,  $ba - 1 = 0$ .
33. A subdomain of an integral domain  $D$  is a subset of  $D$  that is an integral domain under the operations of  $D$ . To show that  $P$  is a subdomain, show that it is a subring and contains 1. Every subdomain contains 1 and is closed under addition and subtraction, so every subdomain contains  $P$ .  $|P| = \text{char } D$  when  $\text{char } D$  is prime and  $|P|$  is infinite when  $\text{char } D$  is 0.
35. Use Theorems 13.3, 13.4, and 7.1 (Lagrange's Theorem).
37. By Exercise 36, 1 is the only element of an integral domain that is its own multiplicative inverse if and only if  $1 = -1$ . This is true only for fields of characteristic 2.
39. a. Since  $a^3 = b^3$ ,  $a^6 = b^6$ . Then  $a = b$  because we can cancel  $a^5$  from both sides (since  $a^5 = b^5$ ).  
b. Use the fact that there exist integers  $s$  and  $t$  such that  $1 = sn + tm$ , but remember that you cannot use negative exponents in a ring.
41.  $(1 - a)^2 = 1 - 2a + a^2 = 1 - 2a + a = 1 - a$ .
43.  $\mathbb{Z}_8$
45. Let  $S = \{a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n\}$  be the nonzero elements of the ring. First show that  $S = \{a_1a_1, a_1a_2, \dots, a_1a_n\}$ . Thus,  $a_1 = a_1a_i$  for some  $i$ . Then  $a_i$  is the unity, for if  $a_k$  is any element of  $S$ , we have  $a_1a_k = a_1a_ia_k$ , so that  $a_1(a_k - a_ia_k) = 0$ .
47. Say  $|x| = n$  and  $|y| = m$  with  $n < m$ . Consider  $(nx)y = x(ny)$ .
49. a. Use the Binomial Theorem.  
b. Use part a and induction.  
c. Look at  $\mathbb{Z}_4$ .
51. Use Theorems 13.4 and 9.5 and Exercise 47.
53.  $n \begin{bmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 \end{bmatrix}$  for all members of  $M_2(R)$  if and only if  $na = 0$  for all  $a$  in  $R$ .
55. Use Exercise 54.
57. a. 2    b. 2, 3    c. 2, 3, 6, 11    d. 2, 3, 9, 10
59. 2
61. See Example 10.
63. Use Exercise 29 and part a of Exercise 49.
65. Choose  $a \neq 0$  and  $a \neq 1$  and consider  $1 + a$ .
67.  $\phi(x) = \phi(x \cdot 1) = \phi(x) \cdot \phi(1)$ , so  $\phi(1) = 1$ . Also,  $1 = \phi(1) = \phi(xx^{-1}) = \phi(x) \phi(x^{-1})$ .
69. Since a field of order 27 has characteristic 3, we have  $3a = 0$  for all  $a$ . From this, we have  $6a = 0$  and  $5a = -a$ .

## Chapter 14

The paradox of excellence is that it is built upon the foundations of necessary failure.

MATTHEW SYED

1. Let  $r_1a$  and  $r_2a$  belong to  $\langle a \rangle$ . Then  $r_1a - r_2a = (r_1 - r_2)a \in \langle a \rangle$ . If  $r \in R$  and  $r_1a \in \langle a \rangle$ , then  $r(r_1a) = (rr_1)a \in \langle a \rangle$ .
3. Clearly,  $I$  is not empty. Now observe that  $(r_1a_1 + \dots + r_na_n) - (s_1a_1 + \dots + s_na_n) = (r_1 - s_1)a_1 + \dots + (r_n - s_n)a_n \in I$ . Also, if  $r \in R$ , then  $r(r_1a_1 + \dots + r_na_n) = (rr_1)a_1 + \dots + (rr_n)a_n \in I$ . That  $I \subseteq J$  follows from closure under addition and multiplication by elements from  $R$ .
5. Let  $a + bi, c + di \in S$ . Then  $(a + bi) - (c + di) = a - c + (b - d)i$  and  $b - d$  is even. Also,  $(a + bi)(c + di) = ac - bd + (ad + cb)i$  and  $ad + cb$  is even. Finally,  $(1 + 2i)(1 + i) = -1 + 3i \notin S$ .
7. Since  $ar_1 - ar_2 = a(r_1 - r_2)$  and  $(ar_1)r = a(r_1r)$ ,  $4R = \{\dots, -16, -8, 0, 8, 16, \dots\}$ .
9. If  $n$  is prime, use Euclid's Lemma (Chapter 0). If  $n$  is not prime, say  $n = st$  where  $s < n$  and  $t < n$ ; then  $st$  belongs to  $n\mathbb{Z}$  but  $s$  and  $t$  do not.
11. a.  $a = 1$     b.  $a = 2$     c.  $a = \gcd(m, n)$
13. a.  $a = 12$   
b.  $a = 48$ . To see this, note that every element of  $\langle 6 \rangle \langle 8 \rangle$  has the form  $6t_18k_1 + 6t_28k_2 + \dots + 6t_n8k_n = 48s \in \langle 48 \rangle$ . So,  $\langle 6 \rangle \langle 8 \rangle \subseteq \langle 48 \rangle$ . Also, since  $48 \in \langle 6 \rangle \langle 8 \rangle$ , we have  $\langle 48 \rangle \subseteq \langle 6 \rangle \langle 8 \rangle$ .  
c.  $a = mn$

15. Let  $r \in R$ . Then  $r = 1r \in A$ .
17. Let  $u \in I$  be a unit and let  $r \in R$ . Then  $r = r(u^{-1}u) = (ru^{-1})u \in I$ .
19. Observe that  $\langle 2 \rangle$  and  $\langle 3 \rangle$  are the only nontrivial ideals of  $Z_6$ , so both are maximal. More generally,  $Z_{pq}$ , where  $p$  and  $q$  are distinct primes, has exactly two maximal ideals.
21. Clearly,  $I$  is closed under subtraction. Also, if  $b_1, b_2, b_3$ , and  $b_4$  are even, then every entry of  $\begin{bmatrix} a_1 & a_2 \\ a_3 & a_4 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} b_1 & b_2 \\ b_3 & b_4 \end{bmatrix}$  is even.
23. Use the observation that every member of  $R$  can be written in the form  $\begin{bmatrix} 2q_1 + r_1 & 2q_2 + r_2 \\ 2q_3 + r_3 & 2q_4 + r_4 \end{bmatrix}$ . Then note that  $\begin{bmatrix} 2q_1 + r_1 & 2q_2 + r_2 \\ 2q_3 + r_3 & 2q_4 + r_4 \end{bmatrix} + I = \begin{bmatrix} r_1 & r_2 \\ r_3 & r_4 \end{bmatrix} + I$ .
25.  $(br_1 + a_1) - (br_2 + a_2) = b(r_1 - r_2) + (a_1 - a_2) \in B$ ;  $r'(br + a) = b(r'r) + r'a \in B$  since  $r'a$  is in  $A$ .
27. Use Exercise 17.
29. Let  $I = \langle 3, x^2 + 1 \rangle$ . Using the condition that  $3 + I = 0 + I$  we see that when adding and multiplying in  $Z[x]/I$  we may treat the coset representatives  $Z[x]/I$  as members of  $Z_3[x]$ . Then we see that  $Z[x]/I = \{0 + I, 1 + I, 2 + I, x + I, x + 1 + I, x + 2 + I, 2x + I, 2x + 1 + I, 2x + 2 + I\}$ . Moreover,  $1 + I$  and  $2 + I$  are their own inverses;  $(x + I)(2x + I) = 2x^2 + I = 1 + I$ ;  $(x + 1 + I)(x + 2 + I) = 1 + I$ ;  $(2x + 1 + I)(2x + 2 + I) = 1 + I$ .
31. Since every element of  $\langle x \rangle$  has the form  $xg(x)$ , we have  $\langle x \rangle \subseteq I$ . If  $f(x) \in I$ , then  $f(x) = a_n x^n + \cdots + a_1 x = x(a_n x^{n-1} + \cdots + a_1) \in \langle x \rangle$ .
33. Suppose  $f(x) + A \neq A$ . Then  $f(x) + A = f(0) + A$  and  $f(0) \neq 0$ . Thus,  $(f(x) + A)^{-1} = \frac{1}{f(0)} + A$ . This shows that  $R/A$  is a field. Now use Theorem 14.4.
35. Since  $(3 + i)(3 - i) = 10$ ,  $10 + \langle 3 + i \rangle = 0 + \langle 3 + i \rangle$ . Also,  $i + \langle 3 + i \rangle = -3 + \langle 3 + i \rangle = 7 + \langle 3 + i \rangle$ . So,  $Z[i]/\langle 3 + i \rangle = \{k + \langle 3 + i \rangle \mid k = 0, 1, \dots, 9\}$ , since  $1 + \langle 3 + i \rangle$  has additive order 10.
37. Use Theorems 14.3 and 14.4.
39. Since every  $f(x)$  in  $\langle x, 2 \rangle$  has the form  $f(x) = xg(x) + 2h(x)$ , we have  $f(0) = 2h(0)$ , so that  $f(x) \in I$ . If  $f(x) \in I$ , then  $f(x) = a_n x^n + \cdots + a_1 x + 2k = x(a_n x^{n-1} + \cdots + a_1) + 2k \in \langle x, 2 \rangle$ .  $I$  is prime and maximal.  $Z[x]/I$  has two elements.
41.  $3x + 1 + I$
43. Every ideal is a subgroup. Every subgroup of a cyclic group is cyclic.
45. Let  $I$  be any ideal of  $R \oplus S$  and let  $I_R = \{r \in R \mid (r, s) \in I \text{ for some } s \in S\}$  and  $I_S = \{s \in S \mid (r, s) \in I \text{ for some } r \in R\}$ . Then  $I_R$  is an ideal of  $R$  and  $I_S$  is an ideal of  $S$ . Let  $I_R = \langle r \rangle$  and  $I_S = \langle s \rangle$ . Since, for any  $(a, b) \in I$  there are elements  $a' \in R$  and  $b' \in S$  such that  $(a, b) = (a'r, b's) = (a', b')(r, s)$ , we have that  $I = \langle (r, s) \rangle$ .
47. Say  $b, c \in \text{Ann}(A)$ . Then  $(b - c)a = ba - ca = 0 - 0 = 0$ . Also,  $(rb)a = r(ba) = r \cdot 0 = 0$ .
49. a.  $\langle 3 \rangle$  b.  $\langle 3 \rangle$  c.  $\langle 3 \rangle$
51. Suppose  $(x + N(\langle 0 \rangle))^n = 0 + N(\langle 0 \rangle)$ . We must show that  $x \in N(\langle 0 \rangle)$ . We know that  $x^n + N(\langle 0 \rangle) = 0 + N(\langle 0 \rangle)$ , so that  $x^n \in N(\langle 0 \rangle)$ . Then, for some  $m$ ,  $(x^n)^m = 0$ , and therefore  $x \in N(\langle 0 \rangle)$ .
53. The set  $Z_2[x]/\langle x^2 + x + 1 \rangle$  has only four elements and each of the nonzero ones has a multiplicative inverse. For example,  $(x + \langle x^2 + x + 1 \rangle)(x + 1 + \langle x^2 + x + 1 \rangle) = 1 + \langle x^2 + x + 1 \rangle$ .
55.  $x + 2 + \langle x^2 + x + 1 \rangle$  is not zero, but its square is.
57. If  $f$  and  $g \in A$ , then  $(f - g)(0) = f(0) - g(0)$  is even and  $(f \cdot g)(0) = f(0) \cdot g(0)$  is even.  $f(x) = \frac{1}{2} \in R$  and  $g(x) = 2 \in A$ , but  $f(x)g(x) \notin A$ .
59. Hint: Any ideal of  $R/I$  has the form  $A/I$ , where  $A$  is an ideal of  $R$ .
61. In  $Z$ ,  $\langle 2 \rangle \cap \langle 3 \rangle = \langle 6 \rangle$  is not prime.
63. According to Theorem 13.3 we need only determine the additive order of  $1 + \langle 2 + i \rangle$ . Since  $5(1 + \langle 2 + i \rangle) = 5 + \langle 2 + i \rangle = (2 + i)(2 - i) + \langle 2 + i \rangle = 0 + \langle 2 + i \rangle$ , we know that  $1 + \langle 2 + i \rangle$  has order 5.
65. The set  $K$  of all polynomials whose coefficients are even is closed under subtraction and multiplication by elements from  $Z[x]$  and therefore  $K$  is an ideal. By Theorem 14.3 to show that  $K$  is prime it suffices to show that  $Z[x]/K$  has no zero-divisors. Suppose that

$f(x) + K$  and  $g(x) + K$  are nonzero elements of  $Z[x]/K$ . Since  $K$  absorbs all terms that have even coefficients we may assume that  $f(x) = a_m x^m + \cdots + a_0$  and  $g(x) = b_n x^n + \cdots + b_0$  are in  $Z[x]$  and  $a_m$  and  $b_n$  are odd integers. Then  $(f(x) + K)(g(x) + K) = a_m b_n x^{m+n} + \cdots + a_0 b_0 + K$  and  $a_m b_n$  is odd. So,  $f(x)g(x) + K$  is nonzero.

67. Use the fact that  $R/I$  is an integral domain to show that  $R/I = \{I, 1 + I\}$ .
69.  $\langle x \rangle \subset \langle x, 2^n \rangle \subset \langle x, 2^{n-1} \rangle \subset \cdots \subset \langle x, 2 \rangle$
71. Taking  $r = 1$  and  $s = 0$  shows that  $a \in I$ . Taking  $r = 0$  and  $s = 1$  shows that  $b \in I$ . If  $J$  is any ideal that contains  $a$  and  $b$ , then it contains  $I$  because of the closure conditions.

## Chapter 15

For every problem there is a solution which is simple, clean and wrong.

H. L. MENCKEN

- Property 3:  $\phi(A)$  is a subgroup because  $\phi$  is a group homomorphism. Let  $s \in S$  and  $\phi(r) = s$ . Then  $s\phi(a) = \phi(r)\phi(a) = \phi(ra)$  and  $\phi(a)s = \phi(a)\phi(r) = \phi(ar)$ .  
Property 4: Let  $a$  and  $b$  belong to  $\phi^{-1}(B)$  and  $r$  belong to  $R$ . Then  $\phi(a)$  and  $\phi(b)$  are in  $B$ . So,  $\phi(a) - \phi(b) = \phi(a) + \phi(-b) = \phi(a - b) \in B$ . Thus,  $a - b \in \phi^{-1}(B)$ . Also,  $\phi(ra) = \phi(r)\phi(a) \in B$  and  $\phi(ar) = \phi(a)\phi(r) \in B$ . So,  $ra$  and  $ar \in \phi^{-1}(B)$ .
- We already know the mapping is an isomorphism of groups. Let  $\Phi(x + \text{Ker } \phi) = \phi(x)$ . Note that  $\Phi((r + \text{Ker } \phi)(s + \text{Ker } \phi)) = \Phi(rs + \text{Ker } \phi) = \phi(rs) = \phi(r)\phi(s) = \Phi(r + \text{Ker } \phi)\Phi(s + \text{Ker } \phi)$ .
- $\phi(2 + 4) = \phi(1) = 5$ , whereas  $\phi(2) + \phi(4) = 0 + 0 = 0$ .
- Observe that  $(x + y)/1 = x/1 + y/1$  and  $(xy)/1 = (x/1)(y/1)$ .
- $a = \phi(1) = \phi(1 \cdot 1) = \phi(1)\phi(1) = aa = a^2$ . For the example look at  $Z_6$ .
- If  $a$  and  $b$  ( $b \neq 0$ ) belong to every member of the collection, then so do  $a - b$  and  $ab^{-1}$ . Thus, by Exercise 29 in Chapter 13, the intersection is a subfield.
- Apply the definition.
- Multiplication is not preserved.
- Yes.
- The set of all polynomials passing through the point  $(1, 0)$ .
- For  $Z_6$  to  $Z_6$ ,  $1 \rightarrow 0$ ,  $1 \rightarrow 1$ ,  $1 \rightarrow 3$ , and  $1 \rightarrow 4$  each define a homomorphism. For  $Z_{20}$  to  $Z_{30}$ ,  $1 \rightarrow 0$ ,  $1 \rightarrow 6$ ,  $1 \rightarrow 15$ , and  $1 \rightarrow 21$  each define a homomorphism.
- The zero map and the identity map.
- Use Exercise 24.
- Say 1 is the unity of  $R$ . Let  $s = \phi(r)$  be any element of  $S$ . Then  $\phi(1)s = \phi(1)\phi(r) = \phi(1r) = \phi(r) = s$ . Similarly,  $s\phi(1) = s$ .
- Observe that an idempotent must map to an idempotent. So,  $(1, 0)$  and  $(0, 1)$  must map to 0 or 1. It follows that  $(a, b) \rightarrow a$ ,  $(a, b) \rightarrow b$ , and  $(a, b) \rightarrow 0$  are the only ring homomorphisms.
- Say  $m = a_k a_{k-1} \cdots a_1 a_0$  and  $n = b_k b_{k-1} \cdots b_1 b_0$ . Then  $m - n = (a_k - b_k)10^k + (a_{k-1} - b_{k-1})10^{k-1} + \cdots + (a_1 - b_1)10 + (a_0 - b_0)$ . Now use the test for divisibility by 9.
- Use the appropriate divisibility tests.
- Mimic Example 8.
- Observe that the mapping  $\phi$  from  $Z_n[x]$  is isomorphic to  $Z_n$  given by  $\phi(f(x)) = f(0)$  is a ring-homomorphism onto  $Z_n$  with kernel  $\langle x \rangle$  and use Theorem 15.3.
- The ring homomorphism from  $Z \oplus Z$  to  $Z$  given by  $\phi(a, b) = a$  takes  $(1, 0)$  to 1. Or define  $\phi$  from  $Z_6$  to  $Z_6$  by  $\phi(x) = 3x$  and let  $R = Z_6$  and  $S = \phi(Z_6)$ . Then 3 is a zero-divisor in  $R$  and  $\phi(3) = 3$  is the unity of  $S$ .
- Observe that  $(2 \cdot 10^{75} + 2) \bmod 3 = 1$  and  $(10^{100} + 1) \bmod 3 = 2 = -1 \bmod 3$ .
- This follows directly from Theorem 13.3 and Theorem 10.1, part 3.
- No. The kernel must be an ideal.
- a. Suppose  $ab \in \phi^{-1}(A)$ . Then  $\phi(a)\phi(b) \in A$ , so that  $a \in \phi^{-1}(A)$  or  $b \in \phi^{-1}(A)$ .  
b. Consider the natural homomorphism from  $R$  to  $S/A$ . Then use Theorems 15.3 and 14.4.
- a.  $\phi((a, b) + (a', b')) = \phi((a + a', b + b')) = a + a' = \phi((a, b)) + \phi((a', b'))$ , so  $\phi$  preserves addition. Also,  $\phi((a, b)(a', b')) = \phi((aa', bb')) = aa' = \phi((a, b))\phi((a', b'))$ .  
b.  $\phi(a) = \phi(b)$  implies that  $(a, 0) = (b, 0)$ , which implies that  $a = b$ .  $\phi(a + b) = (a + b, 0) = (a, 0) + (b, 0) = \phi(a) + \phi(b)$ . Also,  $\phi(ab) = (ab, 0) = (a, 0)(b, 0) = \phi(a)\phi(b)$ .
- Use  $(r, s) \rightarrow (s, r)$ .
- Observe that  $x^4 = 1$  has two solutions in  $\mathbf{R}$  but four in  $\mathbf{C}$ .
- Use Exercises 46 and 52.
- If  $a/b = a'/b'$  and  $c/d = c'/d'$ , then  $ab' = ba'$  and  $cd' = dc'$ . So,  $acb'd' = (ab')$

$$\begin{aligned}(cd') &= (ba')(dc') = bda'c'. \text{ Thus, } ac/bd \\ &= a'c'/b'd' \text{ and therefore } (a/b)(c/d) = \\ &= (a'/b')(c'/d').\end{aligned}$$

57. First note that any field containing  $Z$  and  $i$  must contain  $Q[i]$ . Then prove  $(a + bi)/(c + di) \in Q[i]$ .
59. The subfield of  $E$  is  $\{ab^{-1} \mid a, b \in D, b \neq 0\}$ .
61. Reflexive and symmetric properties follow from the commutativity of  $D$ . For transitivity, assume  $a/b \equiv c/d$  and  $c/d \equiv e/f$ . Then  $adf = (bc)f = b(cf) = bde$ , and cancellation yields  $af = be$ .
63. Try  $ab^{-1} \rightarrow alb$ .
65. The mapping  $a + bi \rightarrow a - bi$  is a ring isomorphism of  $C$ .
67. Certainly the unity 1 is contained in every subfield. So, if a field has characteristic  $p$ , the subfield  $\{0, 1, \dots, p-1\}$  is contained in every subfield. If a field has characteristic 0, then  $\{(m \cdot 1)(n \cdot 1)^{-1} \mid m, n \in Z, n \neq 0\}$  is a subfield contained in every subfield. This subfield is isomorphic to  $Q$  [map  $(m \cdot 1)(n \cdot 1)^{-1}$  to  $m/n$ ].
69. The mapping  $\phi(x) = (x \bmod m, x \bmod n)$  from  $Z_{mn}$  to  $Z_m \oplus Z_n$  is a ring isomorphism.

## Chapter 16

You know my methods. Apply them!

SHERLOCK HOLMES,

*The Hound of the Baskervilles\**

- $f + g = 3x^4 + 2x^3 + 2x + 2$ ;  $f \cdot g = 2x^7 + 3x^6 + x^5 + 2x^4 + 3x^2 + 2x + 2$ .
- 1, 2, 4, 5
- Write  $f(x) = (x - a)q(x) + r(x)$ . Since  $\deg(x - a) = 1$ ,  $\deg r(x) = 0$  or  $r(x) = 0$ . So  $r(x)$  is a constant. Also,  $f(a) = r(a)$ .
- $x^3 + 1$  and  $x^3 + x^2 + x + 1$
- $4x^2 + 3x + 6$  is the quotient and  $6x + 2$  is the remainder.
- Let  $f(x), g(x) \in R[x]$ . By inserting terms with the coefficient 0, we may write
 
$$f(x) = a_n x^n + \cdots + a_0$$
 and
 
$$g(x) = b_n x^n + \cdots + b_0.$$
 Then
 
$$\phi(f(x) + g(x)) = \phi(a_n + b_n)x^n + \cdots + \phi(a_0 + b_0)$$

$$\begin{aligned}&= (\phi(a_n) + \phi(b_n))x^n + \cdots + \phi(a_0) + \phi(b_0) \\ &= (\phi(a_n)x^n + \cdots + \phi(a_0)) + (\phi(b_n)x^n + \cdots \\ &\quad + \phi(b_0)) \\ &= \phi(f(x)) + \phi(g(x)).\end{aligned}$$

Multiplication is done similarly.

- Use Corollary 1 of Theorem 16.2.
- It is its own inverse.
- No. See Exercise 19.
- If  $f(x) = a_n x^n + \cdots + a_0$  and  $g(x) = b_m x^m + \cdots + b_0$ , then  $f(x) \cdot g(x) = a_n b_m x^{m+n} + \cdots + a_0 b_0$ .
- Let  $m$  be the multiplicity of  $b$  in  $q(x)$ . Then we may write  $f(x) = (x - a)^n (x - b)^m q'(x)$ , where  $q'(x)$  is in  $F[x]$  and  $q'(b) \neq 0$ . This means that  $b$  is a zero of  $f(x)$  of multiplicity at least  $m$ . If  $b$  is a zero of  $f(x)$  greater than  $m$ , then  $b$  is a zero of  $g(x) = f(x)/(x - b)^m = (x - a)^n q'(x)$ . But then  $0 = g(b) = (b - a)^n q'(b)$ , and therefore  $q'(b) = 0$ .
- Hint:*  $F[x]$  is a PID. So  $\langle f(x), g(x) \rangle = \langle a(x) \rangle$  for some  $a(x) \in F[x]$ . Thus,  $a(x)$  divides both  $f(x)$  and  $g(x)$ . This means that  $a(x)$  is a constant.
- If  $f(x) \neq g(x)$ , then  $\deg[f(x) - g(x)] < \deg p(x)$ . But the minimum degree of any member of  $\langle p(x) \rangle$  is  $\deg p(x)$ .
- Start with  $(x - 1/2)(x + 1/3)$  and clear fractions.
- "Long divide"  $x - a$  into  $f(x)$  and induct on  $\deg f(x)$ .
- By Theorem 16.5,  $I = \langle x - 1 \rangle$ .
- Use Corollary 2 of Theorem 15.5 and Exercise 11 in this chapter.
- For any  $a$  in  $U(p)$ ,  $a^{p-1} = 1$ , so every member of  $U(p)$  is a zero of  $x^{p-1} - 1$ . Now use the Factor Theorem and a degree argument.
- $C(x)$  (field of quotients of  $C[x]$ )
- Use Exercise 38.
- Observe that, modulo 101,  $(50!)^2 = (50!)(-1)(-2) \cdots (-50) = (50!)(100)(99) \cdots (51) = 100!$  and use Exercise 36.
- Take  $R = Z$  and  $I = \langle 2 \rangle$ .
- Use Theorem 16.3.
- Write  $f(x) = (x - a)g(x)$ . Use the product rule to compute  $f'(x)$ .
- Say  $\deg g(x) = m$ ,  $\deg h(x) = n$ , and  $g(x)$  has leading coefficient  $a$ . Let  $k(x) = g(x) - ax^{m-n}h(x)$ . Then  $\deg k(x) < \deg g(x)$  and  $h(x)$  divides  $k(x)$  in  $Z[x]$  by induction. So,  $h(x)$  divides  $k(x) + ax^{m-n}h(x) = g(x)$  in  $Z[x]$ .
- If  $f(x)$  takes on only finitely many values, then there is at least one  $a$  in  $Z$  with the property

that  $f(x) = a$  for infinitely many  $x$  in  $\mathbb{Z}$ . But then  $g(x) = f(x) - a$  has infinitely many zeros. This contradicts Corollary 3 of Theorem 16.2.

53. Use Theorem 15.3, Theorem 14.4, and Example 13 in Chapter 14.
55. Let  $f(x) = a_n x^n + a_{n-1} x^{n-1} + \cdots + a_1 x + a_0$  and assume that  $p/q$  is a zero of  $f(x)$ , where  $p$  and  $q$  are integers and  $n$  is even. We may assume that  $p$  and  $q$  are relatively prime. Substituting  $p/q$  for  $x$  and clearing fractions, we have  $a_n p^n + a_{n-1} p^{n-1} q + \cdots + a_1 p q^{n-1} = -a_0 q^n$ . If  $p$  is even, then the left side is even. If  $p$  is odd, then each summand on the left side is odd and since there is an even number of summands, the left side is still even. Because  $a_0$  is odd, we then have that  $q$  is even. It follows that  $a_1 p^n = -(a_{n-1} p^{n-1} q + \cdots + a_1 p q^{n-1} + a_0 q^n)$  is even, since the right side is divisible by  $q$ . This implies that  $p$  is even. This contradicts the assumption that  $p$  and  $q$  are relatively prime.
57. Consider the remainder when  $x^{43}$  is divided by  $x^2 + x + 1$ .
59. Observe that every term of  $f(a)$  has the form  $c_i a^i$  and  $c_i a^i \bmod m = c_i b^i \bmod m$ . To prove the second statement, assume that there is some integer  $k$  such that  $f(k) = 0$ . If  $k$  is even, then because  $k \bmod 2 = 0$ , we have by the first statement  $0 = f(k) \bmod 2 = f(0) \bmod 2$  so that  $f(0)$  is even. This shows that  $k$  is not even. If  $k$  is odd, then  $k \bmod 2 = 1$ , so by the first statement  $f(k) = 0$  is odd. This contradiction completes the proof.
61. A solution to  $x^{25} - 1 = 0$  in  $\mathbb{Z}_{37}$  is a solution to  $x^{25} = 1$  in  $U(37)$ . So, by Corollary 2 of Theorem 4.1,  $|x|$  divides 25. Moreover, we must also have that  $|x|$  divides  $|U(37)| = 36$ .

## Chapter 17

Experience enables you to recognize a mistake when you make it again.

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1. Use Theorem 17.1.
3. If  $f(x)$  is not primitive, then  $f(x) = ag(x)$ , where  $a$  is an integer greater than 1. Then  $a$  is not a unit in  $\mathbb{Z}[x]$  and  $f(x)$  is reducible.
5. a. If  $f(x) = g(x)h(x)$ , then  $af(x) = ag(x)h(x)$ .

b. If  $f(x) = g(x)h(x)$ , then  $f(ax) = g(ax)h(ax)$ .

c. If  $f(x) = g(x)h(x)$ , then  $f(x+a) = g(x+a)h(x+a)$ .

d. Try  $a = 1$ .

7. Suppose that  $r + 1/r = 2k + 1$  where  $k$  is an integer. Then  $r^2 - 2kr - r + 1 = 0$ . It follows from Exercise 4 of this chapter that  $r$  is an integer. But the mod 2 irreducibility test shows that the polynomial  $x^2 - (2k+1)x + 1$  is irreducible over  $\mathbb{Q}$  and an irreducible quadratic polynomial cannot have a zero in  $\mathbb{Q}$ .
9. Use part a Exercise 5 and clear fractions.
11. Find an irreducible polynomial  $p(x)$  of degree 2 over  $\mathbb{Z}_5$ . Then  $\mathbb{Z}_5[x]/\langle p(x) \rangle$  is a field of order 25.
13. Note that  $-1$  is a zero. No, since 4 is not a prime.
15. Let  $f(x) = x^4 + 1$  and  $g(x) = f(x+1) = x^4 + 4x^3 + 6x^2 + 4x + 2$ . Then  $f(x)$  is irreducible over  $\mathbb{Q}$  if  $g(x)$  is. Eisenstein's Criterion shows that  $g(x)$  is irreducible over  $\mathbb{Q}$ . To see that  $x^4 + 1$  is reducible over  $\mathbb{R}$ , observe that  $x^8 - 1 = (x^4 + 1)(x^4 - 1)$ , so any complex zero of  $x^4 + 1$  is a complex zero of  $x^8 - 1$ . Also note that the complex zeros of  $x^4 + 1$  must have order 8 (when considered as an element of  $\mathbb{C}$ ). Let  $\omega = \sqrt{2}/2 + i\sqrt{2}/2$ . Then Example 2 in Chapter 16 tells us that the complex zeros of  $x^4 + 1$  are  $\omega, \omega^3, \omega^5$ , and  $\omega^7$ , so  $x^4 + 1 = (x - \omega)(x - \omega^3)(x - \omega^5)(x - \omega^7)$ . But we may pair these factors up as  $((x - \omega)(x - \omega^7))((x - \omega^3)(x - \omega^5)) = (x^2 - \sqrt{2}x + 1)(x^2 + \sqrt{2}x + 1)$  to factor using reals (see DeMoivre's Theorem, Example 12 in Chapter 0).

17. If there is an  $a$  in  $\mathbb{Z}_p$  such that  $a^2 = -1$ , then  $x^4 + 1 = (x^2 + a)(x^2 - a)$ .

If there is an  $a$  in  $\mathbb{Z}_p$  such that  $a^2 = 2$ , then  $x^4 + 1 = (x^2 + ax + 1)(x^2 - ax + 1)$ .

If there is an  $a$  in  $\mathbb{Z}_p$  such that  $a^2 = -2$ , then  $x^4 + 1 = (x^2 + ax - 1)(x^2 - ax - 1)$ .

To show that one of these three cases must occur, consider the group homomorphism from  $\mathbb{Z}_p^*$  to itself given by  $x \rightarrow x^2$ . Since the kernel is  $\{1, -1\}$ , the image  $H$  has index 2 (we may assume that  $p \neq 2$ ). Suppose that neither  $-1$  nor  $2$  belongs to  $H$ . Then, since there is only one coset other than  $H$ , we have  $-1H = 2H$ . Thus,  $H = (-1H)(-1H) = (-1H)(2H) = -2H$ , so that  $-2$  is in  $H$ .

19.  $(x+3)(x+5)(x+6)$
21. 1 has multiplicity 1, 3 has multiplicity 2.
23. a. Consider the number of distinct expressions of the form  $(x-c)(x-d)$ .  
b. Reduce the problem to the case considered in part a.
25. Use Exercise 24, and imitate Example 10.
27. Map  $Z_3[x]$  onto  $Z_3[i]$  by  $f(x) \rightarrow f(i)$ . This is a ring homomorphism with kernel  $\langle x^2 + 1 \rangle$ .
29.  $x^2 + 1, x^2 + x + 2, x^2 + 2x + 2$
31. We know that  $a_n(r/s)^n + a_{n-1}(r/s)^{n-1} + \cdots + a_0 = 0$ . So  $a_n r^n + s a_{n-1} r^{n-1} + \cdots + s^n a_0 = 0$ . This shows that  $s \mid a_n r^n$  and  $r \mid s^n a_0$ . Now use Euclid's Lemma and the fact that  $r$  and  $s$  are relatively prime.
33. Suppose that  $p(x)$  can be written in the form  $g(x)h(x)$  where  $\deg g(x) < \deg p(x)$  and  $\deg h(x) < \deg p(x)$  with  $g(x), h(x) \in F[x]$ . By Theorem 14.4  $F[x]/\langle p(x) \rangle$  is a field with  $0 + \langle p(x) \rangle = p(x) + \langle p(x) \rangle = g(x)h(x) + \langle p(x) \rangle = (g(x) + \langle p(x) \rangle)(h(x) + \langle p(x) \rangle)$ . Thus  $g(x) + \langle p(x) \rangle = 0 + \langle p(x) \rangle$  or  $h(x) + \langle p(x) \rangle = 0 + \langle p(x) \rangle$ . This implies that  $g(x) \in \langle p(x) \rangle$  or  $h(x) \in \langle p(x) \rangle$ . In either case we have contradicted Theorem 16.4.
35. Since  $(f+g)(a) = f(a) + g(a)$  and  $(f \cdot g)(a) = f(a)g(a)$ , the mapping is a homomorphism. Clearly,  $p(x)$  belongs to the kernel. By Theorem 17.5,  $\langle p(x) \rangle$  is a maximal ideal, so the kernel is  $\langle p(x) \rangle$ .
37. The mapping  $a \rightarrow a + \langle p(x) \rangle$  is an isomorphism.
39.  $f(x)$  is primitive.
41. The analysis is identical except that  $0 \leq q, r, t, u \leq n$ . Now, just as when  $n = 2$ , we have  $q = r = t = 1$ , but this time  $0 \leq u \leq n$ . However, when  $u > 2$ ,  $P(x) = x(x+1)(x^2+x+1)(x^2-x+1)^u$  has  $(-u+2)x^{2u+3}$  as one of its terms. Since the coefficient of  $x^{2u+3}$  represents the number of dice with the label  $2u+3$ , the coefficient cannot be negative. Thus,  $u \leq 2$ , as before.
43. Although the probability of rolling any particular sum is the same with either pair of dice, the probability of rolling doubles is different (1/6 with ordinary dice, 1/9 with Sicherman dice). Thus, the probability of going to jail is different. Other probabilities are also affected. For example, if in jail one cannot land on Virginia by rolling a pair of

2's with Sicherman dice, but one is twice as likely to land on St. James with a pair of 3's with the Sicherman dice as with ordinary dice.

## Chapter 18

If you have great talents, industry will improve them; if you have but moderate abilities, industry will supply their deficiency.

SIR JOSHUA REYNOLDS

1.  $|a^2 - db^2| = 0$  implies  $a^2 = db^2$ . Thus,  $a = 0 = b$ , since otherwise  $d = 1$  or  $d$  is divisible by the square of a prime.
2.  $N((a + b\sqrt{d})(a' + b'\sqrt{d})) = N(aa' + dbb' + (ab' + a'b)\sqrt{d}) = (aa' + dbb')^2 - d(ab' + a'b)^2 = |a^2a'^2 + d^2b^2b'^2 - da^2b'^2 - da'^2b^2| = |a^2 - db^2||a'^2 - db'^2| = N(a + b\sqrt{d})N(a' + b'\sqrt{d})$ .
3. If  $xy = 1$ , then  $1 = N(1) = N(xy) = N(x)N(y)$  and  $N(x) = 1 = N(y)$ . If  $N(a + b\sqrt{d}) = 1$ , then  $\pm 1 = a^2 - db^2 = (a + b\sqrt{d})(a - b\sqrt{d})$  and  $a + b\sqrt{d}$  is a unit.
4. This property follows directly from properties 2 and 3.
5. Let  $I = \cup I_i$ . Let  $a, b \in I$  and  $r \in R$ . Then  $a \in I_i$  for some  $i$  and  $b \in I_j$  for some  $j$ . Thus,  $a, b \in I_k$ , where  $k = \max\{i, j\}$ . So,  $a - b \in I_k \subseteq I$  and  $ra, ar \in I_k \subseteq I$ .
6. Clearly,  $\langle ab \rangle \subseteq \langle b \rangle$ . If  $\langle ab \rangle = \langle b \rangle$ , then  $b = rab$ , so that  $1 = ra$  and  $a$  is a unit. If  $a$  is a unit then  $b = a^{-1}(ab) \in \langle ab \rangle$ . Thus  $\langle b \rangle \subseteq \langle ab \rangle$ .
7. Say  $x = a + bi$  and  $y = c + di$ . Then  $xy = (ac - bd) + (bc + ad)i$ .  
So  
 $d(xy) = (ac - bd)^2 + (bc + ad)^2 = (ac)^2 + (bd)^2 + (bc)^2 + (ad)^2$ .  
On the other hand,  
 $d(x)d(y) = (a^2 + b^2)(c^2 + d^2) = a^2c^2 + b^2d^2 + b^2c^2 + a^2d^2$ .
8. Suppose  $a = bu$ , where  $u$  is a unit. Then  $d(b) \leq d(bu) = d(a)$ . Also,  $d(a) \leq d(au^{-1}) = d(b)$ .
9.  $m = 0$  and  $n = -1$  give  $q = -i, r = -2 - 2i$ .
10.  $3 \cdot 7$  and  $(1 + 2\sqrt{-5})(1 - 2\sqrt{-5})$ . Mimic Example 8 to show that these are irreducible.
11. Observe that  $10 = 2 \cdot 5$  and  $10 = (2 - \sqrt{-6})(2 + \sqrt{-6})$  and mimic Example 8. A PID is a UFD.



17. Suppose  $3 = \alpha\beta$ , where  $\alpha, \beta \in \mathbb{Z}[i]$  and neither is a unit. Then  $9 = d(3) = d(\alpha)d(\beta)$ , so that  $d(\alpha) = 3$ . But there are no integers such that  $a^2 + b^2 = 3$ . Observe that  $2 = -i(1 + i)^2$  and  $5 = (1 + 2i)(1 - 2i)$ .
19. Use Exercise 1 with  $d = -1, 5$  and  $1 + 2i$ ;  $13$  and  $3 + 2i$ ;  $17$  and  $4 + i$ .
21. Mimic Example 1.
23.  $(-1 + \sqrt{5})(1 + \sqrt{5}) = 4 = 2 \cdot 2$ . Now use Exercise 22.
25. Use the fact that  $x$  is a unit if and only if  $N(x) = 1$ .
27.  $1 = N(ab) = N(a)N(b)$ , so that  $N(a) = 1 = N(b)$ .
29. Suppose that  $bc = pt$  in  $\mathbb{Z}_n$ . Then there exists an integer  $k$  such that  $bc = pt + kn$ . This implies that  $p$  divides  $bc$  in  $\mathbb{Z}$ , and by Euclid's Lemma we know that  $p$  divides  $b$  or  $p$  divides  $c$ .
31. See Example 3.
33.  $p | (a_1 a_2 \cdots a_{n-1}) a_n$  implies that  $p | a_1 a_2 \cdots a_{n-1}$  or  $p | a_n$ . Thus, by induction,  $p$  divides some  $a_i$ .
35. Use Exercise 10 and Theorem 14.4.
37. Suppose  $R$  satisfies the ascending chain condition and there is an ideal  $I$  of  $R$  that is not finitely generated. Then pick  $a_1 \in I$ . Since  $I$  is not finitely generated,  $\langle a_1 \rangle$  is a proper subset of  $I$ , so we may choose  $a_2 \in I$  but  $a_2 \notin \langle a_1 \rangle$ . As before,  $\langle a_1, a_2 \rangle$  is proper, so we may choose  $a_3 \in I$  but  $a_3 \notin \langle a_1, a_2 \rangle$ . Continuing in this fashion, we obtain a chain of infinite length  $\langle a_1 \rangle \subset \langle a_1, a_2 \rangle \subset \langle a_1, a_2, a_3 \rangle \subset \cdots$ .
- Now suppose every ideal of  $R$  is finitely generated and there is a chain  $I_1 \subset I_2 \subset I_3 \subset \cdots$ . Let  $I = \bigcup I_i$ . Then  $I = \langle a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n \rangle$ . Since  $I = \bigcup I_i$ , each  $a_i$  belongs to some member of the union, say  $I_{i'}$ . Letting  $k = \max \{i' \mid i = 1, \dots, n\}$ , we see that all  $a_i \in I_k$ . Thus,  $I \subseteq I_k$  and the chain has length at most  $k$ .
39. Say  $I = \langle a + bi \rangle$ . Then  $a^2 + b^2 + I = (a + bi)(a - bi) + I = I$  and  $a^2 + b^2 \in I$ . For any  $c, d \in \mathbb{Z}$ , let  $c = q_1(a^2 + b^2) + r_1$  and  $d = q_2(a^2 + b^2) + r_2$ , where  $0 \leq r_1, r_2 < a^2 + b^2$ . Then  $c + di + I = r_1 + r_2 i + I$ .
41.  $N(6 + 2\sqrt{-7}) = 64 = N(1 + 3\sqrt{-7})$ . For the other part, use Exercise 25.
43. Theorem 18.1 shows that primes are irreducible. So, assume that  $a$  is an irreducible in a UFD  $R$  and that  $a | bc$  in  $R$ . We must show that  $a | b$  or  $a | c$ . Since  $a | bc$ , there is an element  $d$  in  $R$  such that  $bc = ad$ . Now replace

$b, c$ , and  $d$  by their factorizations as a product of irreducibles and use uniqueness.

45. See Exercise 21 in Chapter 0.

47.  $13 = (2 + 3i)(2 - 3i)$ ;  $5 + i = (1 + i)(3 - 2i)$

## Chapter 19

When I was young I observed that nine out of every ten things I did were failures, so I did ten times more work.

GEORGE BERNARD SHAW

1.  $\mathbb{R}^n$  has basis  $\{(1, 0, \dots, 0), (0, 1, 0, \dots, 0), \dots, (0, 0, \dots, 1)\}$ ;  $M_2(\mathbb{Q})$  has basis  $\left\{ \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 \end{bmatrix}, \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ 0 & 0 \end{bmatrix}, \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 0 \\ 1 & 0 \end{bmatrix}, \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \right\}$ ;  $\mathbb{Z}_p[x]$  has basis  $\{1, x, x^2, \dots\}$ ;  $\mathbb{C}$  has basis  $\{1, i\}$ .
3.  $(a_2 x^2 + a_1 x + a_0) + (a_2' x^2 + a_1' x + a_0') = (a_2 + a_2')x^2 + (a_1 + a_1')x + (a_0 + a_0')$  and  $a(a_2 x^2 + a_1 x + a_0) = aa_2 x^2 + aa_1 x + aa_0$ . A basis is  $\{1, x, x^2\}$ . Yes.
5. Linearly dependent, since  $-3(2, -1, 0) - (1, 2, 5) + (7, -1, 5) = (0, 0, 0)$ .
7. Suppose  $au + b(u + v) + c(u + v + w) = 0$ . Then  $(a + b + c)u + (b + c)v + cw = 0$ . Since  $\{u, v, w\}$  are linearly independent, we obtain  $c = 0$ ,  $b + c = 0$ , and  $a + b + c = 0$ . So,  $a = b = c = 0$ .
9. If the set is linearly independent, it is a basis. If not, then delete one of the vectors that is a linear combination of the others (see Exercise 8). This new set still spans  $V$ . Repeat this process until you obtain a linearly independent subset. Since the set is finite, you will eventually obtain a linearly independent set that still spans  $V$ .
11. Let  $u_1, u_2, u_3$  be a basis for  $U$  and  $w_1, w_2, w_3$  be a basis for  $W$ . Use the fact that  $u_1, u_2, u_3, w_1, w_2, w_3$  are linearly dependent over  $F$ . In general, if  $\dim U + \dim W > \dim V$ , then  $U \cap W \neq \{0\}$ .
13. no
15. yes; 2
17.  $\begin{bmatrix} a & a + b \\ a + b & b \end{bmatrix} + \begin{bmatrix} a' & a' + b' \\ a' + b' & b' \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} a + a' & a + b + a' + b' \\ a + b + a' + b' & b + b' \end{bmatrix}$  and  $c \begin{bmatrix} a & a + b \\ a + b & a \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} ac & ac + bc \\ ac + bc & bc \end{bmatrix}$ .
19. Suppose  $B$  is a basis. Then every member of  $V$  is some linear combination of elements of

$B$ . If  $a_1v_1 + \cdots + a_nv_n = a'_1v_1 + \cdots + a'_nv_n$ , where  $v_i \in B$ , then  $(a_1 - a'_1)v_1 + \cdots + (a_n - a'_n)v_n = 0$  and  $a_i - a'_i = 0$  for all  $i$ . Conversely, if every member of  $V$  is a unique linear combination of elements of  $B$ , certainly  $B$  spans  $V$ . Also, if  $a_1v_1 + \cdots + a_nv_n = 0$ , then  $a_1v_1 + \cdots + a_nv_n = 0v_1 + \cdots + 0v_n$  and  $a_i = 0$  for all  $i$ .

21. Since  $w_1 = a_1u_1 + a_2u_2 + \cdots + a_nu_n$  and  $a_1 \neq 0$ , we have  $u_1 = a_1^{-1}(w_1 - a_2u_2 - \cdots - a_nu_n)$ , and therefore  $u_1 \in \langle w_1, u_2, \dots, u_n \rangle$ . Clearly,  $u_2, \dots, u_n \in \langle w_1, u_2, \dots, u_n \rangle$ . Hence every linear combination of  $u_1, \dots, u_n$  is in  $\langle w_1, u_2, \dots, u_n \rangle$ .
23.  $\{(1, 0, 1, 1), (0, 1, 0, 1)\}$
25. Study the proof of Theorem 19.1.
27. If  $V$  and  $W$  are vector spaces over  $F$ , then the mapping must preserve addition and scalar multiplication. That is,  $T: V \rightarrow W$  must satisfy  $T(u + v) = T(u) + T(v)$  for all vectors  $u$  and  $v$  in  $V$ , and  $T(au) = aT(u)$  for all vectors  $u$  in  $V$  and scalars  $a$  in  $F$ . A vector space isomorphism from  $V$  to  $W$  is a one-to-one linear transformation from  $V$  onto  $W$ .
29. Suppose  $v$  and  $u$  belong to the kernel and  $a$  is a scalar. Then  $T(v + u) = T(v) + T(u) = 0 + 0 = 0$  and  $T(av) = aT(u) = a \cdot 0 = 0$ .
31. Let  $\{v_1, v_2, \dots, v_n\}$  be a basis for  $V$ . Map  $a_1v_1 + a_2v_2 + \cdots + a_nv_n$  to  $(a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n)$ .
33. No, for 1 is not in the span of such a set.
35. Write  $a_1f + a_2f' + \cdots + a_nf^{(n)} = 0$  and take the derivative  $n$  times to get  $a_1 = 0$ . Similarly, get all other  $a \cdot s = 0$ . So, the set is linearly independent and has the same dimension as  $P_n$ .
37. Suppose that  $V = \bigcup_{i=1}^n V_i$  where  $n$  is minimal and  $F$  is the field. Then no  $V_i$  is the union of the other  $V_j$ 's for otherwise  $n$  is not minimal. Pick  $v_1 \in V_1$  so that  $v_1 \notin V_j$  for all  $j \neq 1$ . Pick  $v_2 \in V_2$  so that  $v_2 \notin V_j$  for all  $j \neq 2$ . Consider the infinite set  $L = \{v_1 + av_2 \mid a \in F\}$ . We claim that each member of  $L$  is contained in at most one  $V_i$ . To verify this suppose both  $u = v_1 + av_2$  and  $w = v_1 + bv_2$  belong to some  $V_i$ . Then  $u - w = (a - b)v_2 \in V_i \cup V_2$ . By the way that  $v_2$  was chosen this implies that  $i = 2$ . Also,  $bu - aw = (b - a)v_1 \in V_i \cup V_1$ , which implies that  $i = 1$ . This contradiction establishes the claim. Finally, since each

member of  $L$  belongs to at most one  $V_i$ , the union of the  $V_i$  has at most  $n$  elements of  $L$ . But the union of the  $V_i$  is  $V$  and  $V$  contains  $L$ .

## Chapter 20

All things are difficult before they are easy.

THOMAS FULLER

1.  $\{a5^{2/3} + b5^{1/3} + c \mid a, b, c \in \mathbb{Q}\}$ .
3.  $\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{-3})$
5.  $\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{-3})$
7. Since  $ac + b \in F(c)$  we have  $F(ac + b) \subseteq F(c)$ . But  $c = a^{-1}(ac + b) - a^{-1}b$ , so  $F(c) \subseteq F(ac + b)$ .
9.  $a^5 = a^2 + a + 1$ ;  $a^{-2} = a^2 + a + 1$ ;  $a^{100} = a^2$
11. The set of all expressions of the form
- $$(a_n\pi^n + a_{n-1}\pi^{n-1} + \cdots + a_0)/(b_m\pi^m + b_{m-1}\pi^{m-1} + \cdots + b_0),$$
- where  $b_m \neq 0$ .
13.  $x^7 - x = x(x^6 - 1) = x(x^3 + 1)(x^3 - 1) = x(x - 1)^3(x + 1)^3$ ;  $x^{10} - x = x(x^9 - 1) = x(x - 1)^9$  (see Exercise 49 in Chapter 13).
15. Hint: Use Exercise 49 in Chapter 13.
17.  $a = 4/3$ ,  $b = 2/3$ ,  $c = 5/6$
19. Use the fact that  $1 + i = -(4 - i) + 5$  and  $4 - i = 5 - (1 + i)$ .
21. If the zeros of  $f(x)$  are  $a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n$ , then the zeros of  $f(x + a)$  are  $a_1 - a, a_2 - a, \dots, a_n - a$ . Now use Exercise 20.
23.  $\mathbb{Q}$  and  $\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{2})$
25. 64
27. Let  $F = \mathbb{Z}_3[x]/\langle x^3 + 2x + 1 \rangle$  and denote the cosets  $x + \langle x^3 + 2x + 1 \rangle$  by  $\beta$  and  $2 + \langle x^3 + 2x + 1 \rangle$  by  $2$ . Then  $x^3 + 2x + 1 = (x - \beta)(x - \beta - 1)(x + 2\beta + 1)$ .
29. Suppose that  $\phi: \mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{-3}) \rightarrow \mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{3})$  is an isomorphism. Since  $\phi(1) = 1$ , we have  $\phi(-3) = -3$ . Then  $-3 = \phi(-3) = \phi(\sqrt{-3}\sqrt{-3}) = [\phi(\sqrt{-3})]^2$ . This is impossible, since  $\phi(\sqrt{-3})$  is a real number.
31. Use long division.
33. Use Theorem 20.5.
35. Use Theorem 20.5.
37. Let  $K$  be the intersection of all subfields of  $E$  that contain  $F$  and the set  $\{a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n\}$ . It follows from the subfield test given in Exercise 29 Chapter 13 that  $K$  is a subfield of  $E$  and, by the definition, that  $K$  contains  $F$



and the set  $\{a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n\}$ . Since  $F(a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n)$  is the smallest such field we have  $F(a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n) \subseteq K$ . Moreover, since the field  $F(a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n)$  is one member of the intersection we have  $K \subseteq F(a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n)$ . This proves that  $K = F(a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n)$ .

39. Since  $|(Z_2[x]/\langle f(x) \rangle)^*| = 31$ , every nonidentity is a generator.
41. Use the Fundamental Theorem of Field Theory (Theorem 20.1) and the Factor Theorem (Corollary 2 of Theorem 16.2).
43. Mimic the argument given in Example 9 of this chapter.

## Chapter 21

A good proof is one which makes us wiser.

YU. MANIN

1. It follows from Theorem 21.1 that if  $p(x)$  and  $q(x)$  are both monic irreducible polynomials in  $F[x]$  with  $p(a) = q(a) = 0$ , then  $\deg p(x) = \deg q(x)$ . If  $p(x) \neq q(x)$ , then  $(p - q)(a) = p(a) - q(a) = 0$  and  $\deg(p(x) - q(x)) < \deg p(x)$ , contradicting Theorem 21.1. To prove Theorem 21.3, use the Division Algorithm for  $F[x]$  (Theorem 16.2).
3. Note that  $[Q(\sqrt[n]{2}):Q] = n$  and use Theorem 21.5.
5. Use Exercise 4.
7. Suppose  $Q(\sqrt{a}) = Q(\sqrt{b})$ . If  $\sqrt{b} \in Q$ , then  $\sqrt{a} \in Q$  and we may take  $c = \sqrt{a}/\sqrt{b}$ . If  $\sqrt{b} \notin Q$ , then  $\sqrt{a} \notin Q$ . Write  $\sqrt{a} = r + s\sqrt{b}$ . It follows that  $r = 0$  and  $a = bs^2$ . The other direction follows from Exercise 20 in Chapter 20.
9. Observe that  $[F(a):F]$  must divide  $[E:F]$ .
11. Pick  $a$  in  $K$  but not in  $F$ . Now use Theorem 21.5.
13. Mimic Example 5.
15. Mimic Example 6.
17. Suppose  $E_1 \cap E_2 \neq F$ . Then  $[E_1:E_1 \cap E_2][E_1 \cap E_2:F] = [E_1:F]$  implies  $[E_1:E_1 \cap E_2] = 1$ , so that  $E_1 = E_1 \cap E_2$ . Similarly,  $E_2 = E_1 \cap E_2$ .
19. Observe that  $F(a) = F(1 + a^{-1})$ .
21. We need only show that if  $a \in R$ , then  $a^{-1} \in R$ . But  $a^{-1} \in F(a) \subseteq R$  (see Theorem 20.3).
23. Every element of  $F(a)$  can be written in the form  $f(a)/g(a)$ , where  $f(x), g(x) \in F[x]$ . If  $f(a)/g(a)$  is algebraic and not a member of  $F$ , then there is some  $h(x) \in F[x]$  such that  $h(f(a)/g(a)) = 0$ . By clearing fractions and collecting like powers of  $a$ , we obtain a polynomial in  $a$  with coefficients from  $F$  equal to 0. But then  $a$  would be algebraic over  $F$ .
25. Note that  $a$  is a zero of  $x^3 - a^3$  over  $F(a^3)$ . For the second part, take  $F = Q, a = 1$ ;  $F = Q, a = (-1 + i\sqrt{3})/2$ ;  $F = Q, a = 3\sqrt{2}$ .
27.  $E$  must be an algebraic extension of  $R$ , so that  $E \subseteq C$ . But then  $[C:E][E:R] = [C:R] = 2$ .
29. Let  $a$  be a zero of  $p(x)$  in some extension of  $F$ . First note  $[E(a):E] \leq [F(a):F] = \deg p(x)$ . Then observe that  $[E(a):F(a)][F(a):F] = [E(a):F] = [E(a):E][E:F]$ . This implies that  $\deg p(x)$  divides  $[E(a):E]$ , so that  $\deg p(x) = [E(a):E]$ . It now follows from Theorem 20.3 that  $p(x)$  is irreducible over  $E$ .
31. Hint: If  $\alpha + \beta$  and  $\alpha\beta$  are algebraic, then so is  $\sqrt{(\alpha + \beta)^2 - 4\alpha\beta}$ .
33.  $\sqrt{b^2 - 4ac}$
35. Use the Factor Theorem.
37. Say  $a$  is a generator of  $F^*$ . If  $\text{char } F = 0$ , then the prime subfield of  $F$  is isomorphic to  $Q$ . Since  $Q^*$  is not cyclic, we have that  $F = Z_p(a)$ , and it suffices to show that  $a$  is algebraic over  $Z_p$ . If  $a \in Z_p$ , we are done. Otherwise,  $1 + a = a^k$  for some  $k \neq 0$ . If  $k > 0$ , we are done. If  $k < 0$ , then  $a^{-k} + a^{1-k} = 1$  and we are done.
39. If  $[K:F] = n$ , then there are elements  $v_1, v_2, \dots, v_n$  in  $K$  that constitute a basis for  $K$  over  $F$ . The mapping  $a_1v_1 + \dots + a_nv_n \rightarrow (a_1, \dots, a_n)$  is a vector space isomorphism from  $K$  to  $F^n$ . If  $K$  is isomorphic to  $F^n$ , then the  $n$  elements in  $K$  corresponding to  $(1, 0, \dots, 0), (0, 1, \dots, 0), \dots, (0, 0, \dots, 1)$  in  $F^n$  constitute a basis for  $K$  over  $F$ .
41. Observe that  $[F(a, b):F(a)] = [F(a)(b):F(a)] \leq [F(b):F] \leq [F(a)(b):F(b)][F(b):F] = [F(a)(b):F] = [F(a, b):F]$ .
43. Observe that  $K = F(a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n)$ , where  $a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n$  are the zeros of the polynomial. Now use Theorem 21.5.
45. Elements of  $Q(\pi)$  have the form  $(a_m\pi^m + a_{m-1}\pi^{m-1} + \dots + a_0)/(b_n\pi^n + b_{n-1}\pi^{n-1} + \dots + b_0)$ , where the  $a$ 's and  $b$ 's are rational numbers. So, if  $\sqrt{2} \in Q(\pi)$ , we have an expression of the form  $2(b_n\pi^n + b_{n-1}\pi^{n-1} + \dots + b_0)^2 = (a_m\pi^m + a_{m-1}\pi^{m-1} + \dots + a_0)^2$ .

Equating the lead terms of both sides, we have  $2b_n^2\pi^{2n} = a_m^2\pi^{2m}$ . But then we have  $m = n$ , and  $\sqrt{2}$  is equal to the rational number  $a_m/b_n$ .

47. If  $f(a^m) = 0$  for some polynomial  $f(x)$  in  $F[x]$ , then  $a$  is a zero of  $g(x) = f(x^m)$  which is in  $F[x]$ .

49. Use Exercise 47.

## Chapter 22

Difficulties strengthen the mind, as labor does the body.

SENECA

1.  $[\text{GF}(729):\text{GF}(9)] = 3$ ;  $[\text{GF}(64):\text{GF}(8)] = 2$
3. The lattice of subfields of  $\text{GF}(64)$  looks like Figure 21.3 with  $\text{GF}(2)$  at the bottom,  $\text{GF}(64)$  at the top, and  $\text{GF}(4)$  and  $\text{GF}(8)$  on the sides.
5. From  $\alpha^3 + \alpha^2 + 1 = 0$  we obtain  $\alpha^3 = \alpha^2 + 1$  and  $\alpha^4 = \alpha^3 + \alpha = \alpha^2 + \alpha + 1$ . From  $(\alpha + 1)x + \alpha = \alpha^2 + 1$  we have  $(\alpha + 1)x = \alpha^2 + \alpha + 1$ . By Exercise 4 we know that the multiplicative inverse of  $\alpha + 1$  is  $\alpha^2$ . So, we have reduced the problem to  $x = \alpha^4 + \alpha^3 + \alpha^2 = \alpha^2 + \alpha$ .
7.  $2\alpha + 1$
9. Use Theorem 22.2.
11. The only possibilities for  $f(x)$  are  $x^3 + x + 1$  and  $x^3 + x^2 + 1$ . See Exercise 8 in Chapter 20 for the first case. See Example 2 in this chapter for the second case.
13. Use Exercise 44 in Chapter 15 and Corollary 4 of Lagrange's Theorem (Theorem 7.1).
15. Use the fact that if  $g(x)$  is an irreducible factor of  $x^8 - x$  over  $Z_2$  and  $\deg g(x) = m$ , then the field  $Z_2[x]/\langle g(x) \rangle$  has order  $2^m$  and is a subfield of  $\text{GF}(8)$ . Now use Theorem 22.3.
17. Since  $\text{GF}(2^n)^*$  is a cyclic group of order  $2^n - 1$  we seek the smallest  $n$  such that  $2^n - 1$  is divisible by 5. By observation,  $n = 4$ .
19. Direct calculations show that given  $x^3 + 2x + 1 = 0$ , we have  $x^2 \neq 1$  and  $x^{13} \neq 1$ .
21. Direct calculations show that  $x^{13} = 1$ , whereas  $(2x)^2 \neq 1$  and  $(2x)^{13} \neq 1$ . Thus,  $2x$  is a generator.
23. First observe that for any field  $F$ , the set  $F^*$  is a group under multiplication. Now use Theorem 22.2 and Theorem 4.3.

25. Find a quadratic irreducible polynomial  $p(x)$  over  $Z_3$ ; then  $Z_3[x]/\langle p(x) \rangle$  is a field of order 9.

27. Let  $a, b \in K$ . Then, by Exercise 49b in Chapter 13,  $(a - b)^{p^m} = a^{p^m} - b^{p^m} = a - b$ . Also,  $(ab)^{p^m} = a^{p^m} b^{p^m} = ab$ . So,  $K$  is a subfield.
29. Consider  $x^{p^n-1} - 1$  and use Corollary 4 of Lagrange's Theorem (Theorem 7.1).
31. Structurally identical
33. Consider  $g(x) = x^2 - a$ . Note that  $|\text{GF}(p)[x]/\langle g(x) \rangle| = p^2$ , so that  $g(x)$  has a zero in  $\text{GF}(p^2)$ . Now use Theorem 22.3.
35. Use Exercise 13.
37. Since  $F^*$  is a cyclic group of order 124, it has a unique element of order 2.
39. See the solution for Exercise 27.
41. If  $b^{p-1} = a$  then for every  $c \neq 0$  in  $Z_p$  then  $(bc)^{p-1} = b^{p-1}c^{p-1} = b^{p-1} = a$ . There cannot be any others because the polynomial  $x^{p-1} - a$  has at most  $p - 1$  solutions in a field. (See Theorem 16.3.)
43. Use Corollary 2 of Theorem 22.2.
45. Consider the field of quotients of  $Z_p[x]$ . The polynomial  $f(x) = x$  is not the image of any element.
47. Observe that  $p - 1 = -1$  has multiplicative order 2 and  $a^{(p^n-1)/2}$  is the unique element in  $\langle a \rangle$  of order 2.
49. Since  $p \bmod 4 = 1$ , we have  $p^n \bmod 4 = 1$ , and  $\text{GF}(p^n)^*$  is a cyclic group of order  $p^n - 1$ .

## Chapter 23

Why, sometimes I've believed as many as six impossible things before breakfast.

LEWIS CARROLL

1. To construct  $a + b$ , first construct  $a$ . Then use a straightedge and compass to extend  $a$  to the right by marking off the length of  $b$ . To construct  $a - b$ , use the compass to mark off a length of  $b$  from the right endpoint of a line of length  $a$ .
3. Let  $y$  denote the length of the hypotenuse of the right triangle with base 1, and let  $x$  denote the length of the hypotenuse of the right triangle with base  $|c|$ . Then  $y^2 = 1 + d^2$ ,  $y^2 + x^2 = (1 + |c|)^2$ , and  $|c|^2 + d^2 = x^2$ . So,  $1 + 2|c| + |c|^2 = 1 + d^2 + |c|^2 + d^2$ , which simplifies to  $|c| = d^2$ .
5. Use  $\sin^2 \theta + \cos^2 \theta = 1$ .

7. Use  $\cos 2\theta = 2 \cos^2 \theta - 1$ .
9. Use  $\sin(\alpha - \beta) = \sin \alpha \cos \beta - \cos \alpha \sin \beta$  and Exercise 8.
11. Solving two linear equations with coefficients from  $F$  involves only the operations of  $F$ .
13. Use Theorem 17.1 and Exercise 27 in Chapter 17.
15. If so, then an angle of  $40^\circ$  is constructible. Now use Exercise 10.
17. This amounts to showing that  $\sqrt{\pi}$  is not constructible. But if  $\sqrt{\pi}$  is constructible, so is  $\pi$ . However,  $[Q(\pi):Q]$  is infinite.
19. No, since  $[Q(\sqrt[3]{3}):Q] = 3$ .
21. No, since  $[Q(\sqrt[3]{\pi}):Q]$  is infinite.

## Chapter 24

Difficulty, my brethren, is the nurse of greatness.

WILLIAM CULLEN BRYANT

1.  $a = eae^{-1}$ ;  $cac^{-1} = b$  implies  $a = c^{-1}bc = c^{-1}b(c^{-1})^{-1}$ ;  $a = bxc^{-1}$  and  $b = ycy^{-1}$  imply  $a = xycy^{-1}x^{-1} = xyc(xy)^{-1}$ .
3. Note that  $|a^2| = |a|/2$  and appeal to Exercise 2.
5. Observe that  $T(xC(a)) = xax^{-1} = yay^{-1} = T(yC(a))$  if and only if  $y^{-1}xa = ay^{-1}x$ , which is true if and only if  $y^{-1}x \in C(a)$ , which in turn is true if and only if  $yC(a) = xC(a)$ . This proves that  $T$  is well-defined and one-to-one.  $T$  is onto by definition.
7. Say  $\text{cl}(e)$  and  $\text{cl}(a)$  are the only two conjugacy classes of a group  $G$  of order  $n$ . Then  $\text{cl}(a)$  has  $n - 1$  elements all of the same order, say  $m$ . If  $m = 2$ , then it follows from Exercise 47 in Chapter 2 that  $G$  is Abelian. But then  $\text{cl}(a) = \{a\}$  and so  $n = 2$ . If  $m > 2$ , then  $\text{cl}(a)$  has at most  $n - 2$  elements, since conjugation of  $a$  by  $e, a$ , and  $a^2$  each yields  $a$ .
9. Consider the correspondence  $T$  from the left cosets of  $N(H)$  in  $G$  to the conjugates of  $H$  in  $G$  given by  $T(xN(H)) = xHx^{-1}$ .
11. Say  $\text{cl}(x) = \{x, g_1xg_1^{-1}, g_2xg_2^{-1}, \dots, g_kxg_k^{-1}\}$ . If  $x^{-1} = g_ixg_i^{-1}$ , then for each  $g_jxg_j^{-1}$  in  $\text{cl}(x)$ , we have  $(g_jxg_j^{-1})^{-1} = g_jx^{-1}g_j^{-1} = g_j(g_ixg_i^{-1})g_j^{-1} \in \text{cl}(x)$ . Because  $|G|$  has odd order,  $g_jxg_j^{-1} \neq (g_jxg_j^{-1})^{-1}$ . It follows that  $|\text{cl}(x)|$  is even. But  $|\text{cl}(x)|$  divides  $|G|$ .
13. Part a is not possible by the corollary of Theorem 24.2. Part b is not possible because it implies that the center would have order 2, and 2 does not divide 21. Part c is the class equation for  $D_5$ . Part d is not possible because of Corollary 1 of Theorem 24.1.
15. Use Theorem 7.2.
17. Use Example 5 of Chapter 9 and Theorem 7.2.
19. Use Theorem 24.5 and its corollary.
21. 8
23. 15
25. The number of Sylow  $q$ -subgroups has the form  $1 + qk$  and divides  $p$ . So,  $k = 0$ .
27. 10;  $\langle(123)\rangle$ ,  $\langle(234)\rangle$ ,  $\langle(134)\rangle$ ,  $\langle(345)\rangle$ ,  $\langle(245)\rangle$
29. A group of order 100 has 1, 5, or 25 subgroups of order 4; exactly one subgroup of order 25 (which is normal); at least one subgroup of order 5; and at least one subgroup of order 2.
31. Let  $H$  be a Sylow 5-subgroup. Since the number of Sylow 5-subgroups is  $1 \pmod{5}$  and divides  $7 \cdot 17$ , the only possibility is 1. So,  $H$  is normal in  $G$ . Then by the N/C Theorem (Example 16 of Chapter 10),  $|G/C(H)|$  divides both 4 and  $|G|$ . Thus  $C(H) = G$ .
33. If  $p$  does not divide  $q - 1$ , and  $q$  does not divide  $p^2 - 1$ , then a group of order  $p^2q$  is Abelian.
35. Sylow's Third Theorem implies that the Sylow 3- and Sylow 5-subgroups are unique. Pick any  $x$  not in the union of these. Then  $|x| = 15$ .
37. By Sylow's Third Theorem,  $n_{17} = 1$  or 35. Assume  $n_{17} = 35$ . Then the union of the Sylow 17-subgroups has 561 elements. By Sylow's Third Theorem,  $n_5 = 1$ . Thus, we may form a cyclic subgroup of order 85 (Exercise 57 in Chapter 9 and Theorem 24.6). But then there are 64 elements of order 85. This gives too many elements.
39. Use the  $G/Z$  Theorem (Theorem 9.3) and Theorem 24.6.
41. Let  $H$  be the Sylow 3-subgroup and suppose that the Sylow 5-subgroups are not normal. By Sylow, there must be six Sylow 5-subgroups, call them  $K_1, \dots, K_6$ . These subgroups have 24 elements of order 5. Also, each of the cyclic subgroups  $HK_1, \dots, HK_6$  has eight generators. Thus, there are 48 elements of order 15, which results in more than 60 elements in the group.
43. By Theorem 24.2 and Theorem 9.5,  $Z(G)$  has an element  $x$  of order  $p$ . By induction,

the group  $G/\langle x \rangle$  has normal subgroups of order  $p^k$  for every  $k$  between 1 and  $n - 1$ , inclusively. Now use Exercise 51 in Chapter 9 and Exercise 51 of Chapter 10.

45. Pick  $x \in Z(G)$  such that  $|x| = p$ . If  $x \in H$ , by induction,  $N(H/\langle x \rangle) > H/\langle x \rangle$ , say  $y\langle x \rangle \in N(H/\langle x \rangle)$  but not  $H/\langle x \rangle$ . Now show  $y \in N(H)$  but not  $H$ . If  $x \notin H$ , then  $x \in N(H)$ , so that  $N(H) > H$ .
47. Since 3 divides  $|N(K)|$  we know that  $N(K)$  has a subgroup  $H_1$  of order 3. Then, by Example 5 in Chapter 9, and Theorem 24.6,  $H_1K$  is a cyclic group of order 15. Thus,  $K \subseteq N(H_1)$  and therefore 5 divides  $|N(H_1)|$ . And since  $H$  and  $H_1$  are conjugates it follows from Exercise 46 that 5 divides  $|N(H)|$ .
49. Sylow's Third Theorem shows that all the Sylow subgroups are normal. Then Theorem 7.2 and Example 5 of Chapter 9 ensure that  $G$  is the internal direct product of its Sylow subgroups.  $G$  is cyclic because of Theorem 9.6 and Corollary 1 of Theorem 8.2.  $G$  is Abelian because of Theorem 9.6 and Exercise 4 in Chapter 8.
51. Automorphisms preserve order.
53. That  $|N(H)| = |N(K)|$  follows directly from the last part of Sylow's Third Theorem and Exercise 9.
55. Normality of  $H$  implies  $\text{cl}(h) \subseteq H$  for  $h$  in  $H$ . Now observe that  $h \in \text{cl}(h)$ . This is true only when  $H$  is normal.
57. Suppose that  $G$  is a group of order 12 that has nine elements of order 2. By the Sylow theorems,  $G$  has three Sylow 2-subgroups whose union contains the identity and the nine elements of order 2. If  $H$  and  $K$  are both Sylow 2-subgroups, then by Theorem 7.2,  $|H \cap K| = 2$ . Thus, the union of the three Sylow 2-subgroups has at most seven elements of order 2, since there are three in  $H$ , two more in  $K$  that are not in  $H$ , and at most two more that are in the third but not in  $H$  or  $K$ .
59. By Lagrange's Theorem any nontrivial proper subgroup of  $G$  has order  $p$  or  $q$ . It follows from Theorem 24.5 and its corollary that there is exactly one subgroup of order  $q$  which is normal (for otherwise there would be  $(q + 1)(q - 1) = q^2 - 1$  elements of order  $q$ ). On the other hand, there cannot be a normal subgroup of order  $p$  for then  $G$  would be an internal direct product of a cy-

clic group of  $q$  and a cyclic group of order  $p$ , which is Abelian. So, by Theorem 24.5 there must be exactly  $q$  subgroups of order  $p$ .

61. Note that any subgroup of order 4 in a group of order  $4m$  where  $m$  is odd is a Sylow 2-subgroup. By Sylow's Third Theorem, the Sylow 2-subgroups are conjugate and therefore isomorphic.  $S_4$  contains both the subgroups  $\langle (1234) \rangle$  and  $\{(1), (12), (34), (12)(34)\}$ .
63. By Sylow's Third Theorem, the number of Sylow 13-subgroups is equal to 1 mod 13 and divides 55. This means that there is only one Sylow 13-subgroup, so it is normal in  $G$ . Thus  $|N(H)/C(H)| = 715/|C(H)|$  divides both 55 and 12. This forces  $715/|C(H)| = 1$  and therefore  $C(H) = G$ . This proves that  $H$  is contained in  $Z(G)$ . Applying the same argument to  $K$ , we get that  $K$  is normal in  $G$  and  $|N(K)/C(K)| = 715/|C(K)|$  divides both 65 and 10. This forces  $715/|C(K)| = 1$  or 5. In the latter case,  $K$  is not contained in  $Z(G)$ .

## Chapter 25

Sweet are the uses of adversity.

WILLIAM SHAKESPEARE, *As You Like It*

1. Use the 2 · Odd Test.
3. Use the Index Theorem.
5. Suppose  $G$  is a simple group of order 525. Let  $L_7$  be a Sylow 7-subgroup of  $G$ . It follows from Sylow's theorems that  $|N(L_7)| = 35$ . Let  $L$  be a subgroup of  $N(L_7)$  of order 5. Since  $N(L_7)$  is cyclic (Theorem 24.6),  $N(L) \geq N(L_7)$ , so that 35 divides  $|N(L)|$ . But  $L$  is contained in a Sylow 5-subgroup (Theorem 24.4), which is Abelian (see the corollary to Theorem 24.2). Thus, 25 divides  $|N(L)|$  as well. It follows that 175 divides  $|N(L)|$ . The Index Theorem now yields a contradiction.
7.  $n_{11} = 12$ . Use the  $N/C$  Theorem (Example 16 in Chapter 10) to show that there is an element of order 22; then use the Embedding Theorem and observe that  $A_{12}$  has no element of order 22.
9. Suppose that there is a simple group of order 396 and  $L_{11}$  is a Sylow 11-subgroup. Use the  $N/C$  Theorem given in Example 16 of Chapter 10 to show that  $C(L_{11})$  has an element of order 33, whereas  $A_{12}$  does not.

11. If we can find a pair of distinct Sylow 2-subgroups  $A$  and  $B$  such that  $|A \cap B| = 8$ , then  $N(A \cap B) \geq AB$ , so that  $N(A \cap B) = G$ . Now let  $H$  and  $K$  be any distinct pair of Sylow 2-subgroups. Then  $16 \cdot 16/|H \cap K| = |HK| \leq 112$  (Theorem 7.2), so that  $|H \cap K|$  is at least 4. If  $|H \cap K| = 8$ , we are done. So, assume  $|H \cap K| = 4$ . Then  $N(H \cap K)$  picks up at least 8 elements from  $H$  and at least 8 from  $K$  (see Exercise 45 in Chapter 24). Thus,  $|N(H \cap K)| \geq 16$  and is divisible by 8. So,  $|N(H \cap K)| = 16, 56$ , or  $112$ . Since the latter two cases yield normal subgroups, we may assume  $|N(H \cap K)| = 16$ . If  $N(H \cap K) = H$ , then  $|H \cap K| = 8$ , since  $N(H \cap K)$  contains at least 8 elements from  $K$ . So, we may assume that  $N(H \cap K) \neq H$ . Then, we may take  $A = N(H \cap K)$  and  $B = H$ .
15. Use the Index Theorem.
17. By Sylow's third theorem we know that number of Sylow 5-subgroups is 6. This means that 6 is the index of the normalizer of a Sylow 5-subgroup. But then, by embedding theorem,  $G$  is isomorphic to a subgroup of  $A_6$  of order 120. This contradicts Exercise 16.
19. Let  $\alpha$  be as in the proof of the Generalized Cayley Theorem. Then  $\text{Ker } \alpha \leq H$  and  $|G/\text{Ker } \alpha|$  divides  $|G:H|!$ . Now show  $|\text{Ker } \alpha| = |H|$ . A subgroup of index 2 is normal.
21. Since  $A_5$  is simple, if  $H$  is a proper normal subgroup of  $S_5$ , then  $H \cap A_5 = A_5$  or  $\{\varepsilon\}$ . But  $H \cap A_5 = A_5$  implies  $H = A_5$ , whereas  $H \cap A_5 = \{\varepsilon\}$  implies  $H = \{\varepsilon\}$  or  $|H| = 2$ . (See Exercise 23 in Chapter 5.) Now use Exercise 70 in Chapter 9 and Exercise 58 in Chapter 5.
23. By direct computation, show that  $PSL(2, Z_7)$  has more than four Sylow 3-subgroups, more than one Sylow 7-subgroup, and more than one Sylow 2-subgroup. *Hint:* Observe that  $\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 4 \\ 1 & 5 \end{bmatrix}$  has order 3. Now use conjugation to find four other subgroups of order 3; observe that  $\begin{bmatrix} 5 & 5 \\ 1 & 4 \end{bmatrix} = 7$  and use conjugation to find another subgroup of order 7; observe that  $\begin{bmatrix} 5 & 1 \\ 3 & 5 \end{bmatrix} = 4$  and use conjugation to find six more elements of order 4 (which guarantees that more than one Sylow 2-subgroup exists). Now argue as we did to show that  $A_5$  is simple. In the cases that the supposed normal subgroup  $N$  has order 2 or 4, show that in  $G/N$ , the Sylow 7-subgroup is normal. But then,  $G$  has a normal subgroup of order 14 or 28, which were already ruled out.
25. Mimic Exercise 24.
27. Suppose there is a simple group of order 60 that is not isomorphic to  $A_5$ . The Index Theorem implies  $n_2 \neq 1$  or 3, and the Embedding Theorem implies  $n_2 \neq 5$ . Thus,  $n_2 = 15$ . Counting shows that there must be two Sylow 2-subgroups whose intersection has order 2. Now mimic the argument used in showing that there is no simple group of order 144 to show that the normalizer of this intersection has index 5, 3, or 1, but the Embedding Theorem and the Index Theorem rule these out.
29. Suppose there is such a simple group  $G$ . Since the number of Sylow  $q$ -subgroups is 1 modulo  $q$  and divides  $p^2$ , it must be  $p^2$ . Thus there are  $p^2(q-1)$  elements of order  $q$  in  $G$ . These elements, together with the  $p^2$  elements in one Sylow  $p$ -subgroup, account for all  $p^2q$  elements in  $G$ . Thus, there cannot be another Sylow  $p$ -subgroup. But then the Sylow  $p$ -subgroup is normal in  $G$ .
31. Consider the right regular representation of  $G$ . Let  $g$  be a generator of the Sylow 2-subgroup and suppose that  $|G| = 2^k n$  where  $n$  is odd. Then every cycle of the permutation  $T_g$  in the right regular representation of  $G$  has length  $2^k$ . This means that there are exactly  $n$  such cycles. Since each cycle is odd and there is an odd number of them,  $T_g$  is odd. This means that the set of even permutations in the regular representations has index 2 and is therefore normal. (See Exercise 23 in Chapter 5 and Exercise 9 in Chapter 9).

## Chapter 26

If you make a mistake, make amends.

LOU HOLTZ

1.  $u$  is related to  $u$  because  $u$  is obtained from itself by no insertions; if  $v$  can be obtained from  $u$  by inserting or deleting words of the form  $xx^{-1}$  or  $x^{-1}x$ , then  $u$  can be obtained from  $v$  by reversing the procedure; if  $u$  can be obtained from  $v$  and  $v$  can be obtained from  $w$ , then  $u$  can be obtained from  $w$  by obtaining first  $v$  from  $w$  and then  $u$  from  $v$ .

3.  $b(a^2N) = b(aN)a = a^3bNa = a^3b(aN)$   
 $= a^3a^3bN$   
 $= a^6bN = a^6Nb = a^2Nb = a^2bN$   
 $b(a^3N) = b(a^2N)a = a^2bNa = a^2b(aN)$   
 $= a^2a^3bN$   
 $= a^5bN = a^5Nb = aNb = abN$   
 $b(bN) = b^2N = N$   
 $b(abN) = baNb = a^3bNb = a^3b^2N = a^3N$   
 $b(a^2bN) = ba^2Nb = a^2bNb = a^2b^2N = a^2N$   
 $b(a^3bN) = ba^3Nb = abNb = ab^2N = aN$
5. Let  $F$  be the free group on  $\{a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n\}$ . Let  $N$  be the smallest normal group containing  $\{w_1, w_2, \dots, w_l\}$  and let  $M$  be the smallest normal subgroup containing  $\{w_1, w_2, \dots, w_l, w_{l+1}, \dots, w_{l+k}\}$ . Then  $F/N \approx G$  and  $F/M \approx \bar{G}$ . The homomorphism from  $F/N$  to  $F/M$  given by  $aN \rightarrow aM$  induces a homomorphism from  $G$  onto  $\bar{G}$ . To prove the corollary, observe that the theorem shows that  $K$  is a homomorphic image of  $G$ , so  $|K| \leq |G|$ .
7. Clearly,  $a$  and  $ab$  belong to  $\langle a, b \rangle$ , so  $\langle a, ab \rangle \subseteq \langle a, b \rangle$ . Now show that  $a$  and  $b$  belong to  $\langle a, ab \rangle$ .
9. Show that  $|G| \leq 2n$  and that  $D_n$  satisfies the relations that define  $G$ .
11. Since  $x^2 = y^2 = e$ , we have  $(xy)^{-1} = y^{-1}x^{-1} = yx$ . Also,  $xy = z^{-1}yz$ , so  $(xy)^{-1} = (z^{-1}yz)^{-1} = z^{-1}y^{-1}z = z^{-1}yz = xy$ .
13. a.  $b^6$    b.  $b^7a$
15. First observe that since  $xy = (xy)^3(xy)^4 = (xy)^7 = (xy)^4(xy)^3 = yx$ ,  $x$  and  $y$  commute. Also, since  $y = (xy)^4 = (xy)^3xy = x(xy) = x^2y$  we know that  $x^2 = e$ . Then  $y = (xy)^4 = x^4y^4 = y^4$  and therefore,  $y^3 = e$ . This shows that  $|G| \leq 6$ . But  $Z_6$  satisfies the defining relations with  $x = 3$  and  $y = 2$ . So,  $G \approx Z_6$ .
17. Note that  $xyx^3 = e$  implies that  $xyx^{-1} = x^5$  and therefore  $\langle x \rangle$  is normal. So,  $G = \langle x \rangle \cup y\langle x \rangle$  and  $|G| \leq 16$ . Use  $y^2 = e$  and  $xyx^3 = e$ , to prove that  $x^2 \in Z(G)$ . Then prove  $G$  is not Abelian and use Theorem 9.3 to show that  $|Z(G)| \neq 8$ . Thus,  $Z(G) = \langle x^2 \rangle$ . Finally, prove that  $(xy)^2 = x^{-2}$ , so that  $|xy| = 8$ .
19. Use the fact that the mapping from  $G$  onto  $G/N$  given by  $x \rightarrow xN$  is a homomorphism.
21. For  $H$  to be a normal subgroup we must have  $xyx^{-1} \in H = \{e, y^3, y^6, y^9, x, xy^3, xy^6, xy^9\}$ . But  $xyx^{-1} = yxy^{11} = (yxy)y^{10} = xy^{10}$ .
23. 6; the given relations imply that  $a^2 = e$ .  $G$  is isomorphic to  $Z_6$ .
25. 1, 2, and  $\infty$

27.  $ab = c \Rightarrow abc^{-1} = e$   
 $cd = a \Rightarrow (abc^{-1})cd = ae \Rightarrow bd = e \Rightarrow d = b^{-1}$   
 $da = b \Rightarrow bda = b^2 \Rightarrow ea = b^2 \Rightarrow a = b^2$   
 $ab = c \Rightarrow b^3 = c$   
 So  $G = \langle b \rangle$ .  
 $bc = d \Rightarrow bb^3 = b^{-1} \Rightarrow b^5 = e$ . So  $|G| = 1$  or 5.  
 But  $Z_5$  satisfies the defining relations with  $a = 1, b = 3, c = 4$ , and  $d = 2$ .

29.  $Z_6$ 

## Chapter 27

If at first you don't succeed—that makes you about average.

BRADENTON, [Florida] *Herald*

- If  $T$  is a distance-preserving function and the distance between points  $a$  and  $b$  is positive, then the distance between  $T(a)$  and  $T(b)$  is positive.
- See Figure 1.5.
- 12
- $4n$
- a.  $Z_2$    b.  $Z_2 \oplus Z_2$    c.  $G \oplus Z_2$ , where  $G$  is the plane symmetry group of a circle (see Exercise 55 of Chapter 3).
- 6
- An inversion in  $\mathbf{R}^3$  leaves only a single point fixed, whereas a rotation leaves a line fixed.
- In  $\mathbf{R}^4$ , a plane is fixed. In  $\mathbf{R}^n$ , a hyperplane of dimension  $n - 2$  is fixed.
- Create a coordinate system for the plane. Let  $T$  be an isometry;  $p, q$ , and  $r$  the three noncollinear points; and  $s$  any other point in the plane. Then the quadrilateral determined by  $T(p), T(q), T(r)$ , and  $T(s)$  is congruent to the one formed by  $p, q, r$ , and  $s$ . Thus,  $T(s)$  is uniquely determined by  $T(p), T(q)$ , and  $T(r)$ .
- a rotation

## Chapter 28

The thing that counts is not what we know but the ability to use what we know.

LEO L. SPEARS

- Try  $x^n y^m \rightarrow (n, m)$ .
- $xy$
- Use Figure 28.9.
- $x^2 y z x z = x^2 y x^{-1} = x^2 x^{-1} y = xy$ ;  $x^{-3} z x y z = x^{-3} x^{-1} y = x^{-4} y$



9. A subgroup of index 2 is normal.
11. a. V b. I c. II d. VI e. VII f. III
13. *cmm*
15. a.  $p4m$  b.  $p3$  c.  $p31m$  d.  $p6m$
17. The principal purpose of tire tread design is to carry water away from the tire. Patterns I and III do not have horizontal reflective symmetry. Thus, these designs would not carry water away equally on both halves of the tire.
19. a. VI b. V c. I d. III e. IV f. VII g. IV

## Chapter 29

Failure is the key to success; each mistake teaches us something.

MORIHEI UESHIBA

1. 6
3. 30
5. 13
7. 45
9. 126
11.  $\frac{1}{6}(n^6 + 2 \cdot n + 2 \cdot n^2 + n^3)$
13. For the first part, see Exercise 13 in Chapter 6. For the second part, try  $D_4$ .
15.  $R_0, R_{180}, H, V$  act as the identity and  $R_{90}, R_{270}, D, D'$  interchange  $L_1$  and  $L_2$ .

## Chapter 30

I am not bound to please thee with my answers.

SHAKESPEARE, *The Merchant of Venice*

1.  $4 * (b, a)$
3.  $(m/2) * \{3 * [(a, 0), (b, 0)], (a, 0), (e, 1), 3 * (a, 0), (b, 0), 3 * (a, 0), (e, 1)\}$
5.  $a^3b$
7. Both yield paths from  $e$  to  $a^3b$ .
11. Say we start at  $x$ . Then we know the vertices  $x, xs_1, xs_1s_2, \dots, xs_1s_2 \cdots s_{n-1}$  are distinct and  $x = xs_1s_2 \cdots s_n$ . So if we apply the same sequence beginning at  $y$ , then cancellation shows that  $y, ys_1, ys_1s_2, \dots, ys_1s_2 \cdots s_{n-1}$  are distinct and  $y = ys_1s_2 \cdots s_n$ .
13. If there were a Hamiltonian path from  $(0, 0)$  to  $(2, 0)$ , there would be a Hamiltonian circuit in the digraph, since  $(2, 0) + (1, 0) = (0, 0)$ . This contradicts Theorem 30.1.

15. a. If  $s_1, s_2, \dots, s_{n-1}$  traces a Hamiltonian path and  $s_1s_{i+1} \cdots s_j = e$ , then the vertex  $s_1s_2 \cdots s_{i-1}$  appears twice. Conversely, if  $s_1s_{i+1} \cdots s_j \neq e$ , then the sequence  $e, s_1, s_1s_2, \dots, s_1s_2 \cdots s_{n-1}$  yields the  $n$  vertices (otherwise, cancellation gives a contradiction).
- b. This follows directly from part a.
17. The sequence traces the digraph in a clockwise fashion.
19. Abbreviate  $(a, 0)$ ,  $(b, 0)$ , and  $(e, 1)$  by  $a, b$ , and  $1$ , respectively. A circuit is  $4 * (4 * 1, a), 3 * a, b, 7 * a, 1, b, 3 * a, b, 6 * a, 1, a, b, 3 * a, b, 5 * a, 1, a, a, b, 3 * a, b, 4 * a, 1, 3 * a, b, 3 * a, b, 3 * a, b$ .
21. Abbreviate  $(R_{90}, 0)$ ,  $(H, 0)$ , and  $(R_0, 1)$  by  $R, H$ , and  $1$ , respectively. A circuit is  $3 * (R, 1, 1), H, 2 * (1, R, R), R, 1, R, R, 1, H, 1, 1$ .
23. Abbreviate  $(a, 0)$ ,  $(b, 0)$ , and  $(e, 1)$  by  $a, b$ , and  $1$ , respectively. A circuit is  $2 * (1, 1, a), a, b, 3 * a, 1, b, b, a, b, b, 1, 3 * a, b, a, a$ .
25. Abbreviate  $(r, 0)$ ,  $(f, 0)$ , and  $(e, 1)$  by  $r, f$ , and  $1$ , respectively. Then the sequence is  $r, r, f, r, r, 1, f, r, r, f, r, 1, r, f, r, r, f, 1, r, r, f, r, r, 1, r, f, r, r, f, 1, r, r, f, r, f, 1$ .
27.  $m * [(n-1) * (0, 1), (1, 1)]$
29. Abbreviate  $(r, 0)$ ,  $(f, 0)$ , and  $(e, 1)$  by  $r, f$ , and  $1$ , respectively. A circuit is  $1, r, 1, 1, f, r, 1, r, 1, r, f, 1$ .
31.  $5 * [3 * (1, 0), (0, 1)], (1, 0)$
33.  $12 * [(1, 0), (0, 1)]$
35. Letting  $V$  denote a vertical move and  $H$  a horizontal move and starting at  $(1, 0)$  a circuit is  $V, V, H, 6 * (V, V, V, H)$ .
37. In the proof of Theorem 30.3, we used the hypothesis that  $G$  is Abelian in two places: We needed  $H$  to satisfy the induction hypothesis, and we needed to form the factor group  $G/H$ . Now, if we assume only that  $G$  is Hamiltonian, then  $H$  also is Hamiltonian and  $G/H$  exists.

## Chapter 31

We must view with profound respect the infinite capacity of the human mind to resist the introduction of useful knowledge.

THOMAS R. LOUNSBURY

1.  $\text{wt}(0001011) = 3; \text{wt}(0010111) = 4; \text{wt}(0100101) = 3$ ; etc.
3. 1000110; 1110100

5. 000000, 100011, 010101, 001110, 110110, 101101, 011011, 111000
7. By using  $t = 1/2$  in the proof of Theorem 31.2 we have that all single errors can be detected.
9. Observe that a vector has even weight if and only if it can be written as a sum of an even number of vectors of weight 1.
11. No, by Theorem 31.3.
13. 0000000, 1000111, 0100101, 0010110, 0001011, 1100010, 1010001, 1001100, 0110011, 0101110, 0011101, 1110100, 1101001, 1011010, 0111000, 1111111;

$$H = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 & 1 \\ 1 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix};$$

yes.

15. Suppose that  $u$  is decoded as  $v$  and that  $x$  is the coset leader of the row containing  $u$ . Coset decoding means  $v$  is at the head of the column containing  $u$ . So,  $x + v = u$  and  $x = u - v$ . Now suppose  $u - v$  is a coset leader and  $u$  is decoded as  $y$ . Then  $y$  is at the head of the column containing  $u$ . Since  $v$  is a code word,  $u = u - v + v$  is in the row containing  $u - v$ . Thus,  $u - v + y = u$  and  $y = v$ .
17. 000000, 100110, 010011, 001101, 110101, 101011, 011110, 111000;

$$H = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}.$$

001001 is decoded as 001101 by all four methods.

011000 is decoded as 111000 by all four methods.

000110 is decoded as 100110 by all four methods.

Since there are no code words whose distance from 100001 is 1 and three whose distance is 2, the nearest-neighbor method will not decode or will arbitrarily choose a code word; parity-check matrix decoding does not decode 100001; the standard-array and syndrome methods decode 100001 as 000000, 110101, or 101011, depending on which of 100001, 010100, or 001010 is a coset leader.

19. For any received word  $w$ , there are only eight possibilities for  $wH$ . But each of these eight possibilities satisfies condition 2 or the first portion of condition 3' of the decoding procedure, so decoding assumes that no error was made or one error was made.
21. There are  $3^4$  code words and  $3^6$  possible received words.
23. No; row 3 is twice row 1.
25. No. For if so, nonzero code words would be all words with weight at least 5. But this set is not closed under addition.
27. Use Exercise 24, together with the fact that the set of code words is closed under addition.
29. Abbreviate the coset  $a + \langle x^2 + x + 1 \rangle$  with  $a$ . The following generating matrix will produce the desired code:

$$\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 1 & 1 & x \\ 0 & 1 & x & x+1 & x+1 \end{bmatrix}.$$

31. Use Exercise 14.
33. Let  $c, c' \in C$ . Then,  $c + (v + c') = v + c + c' \in v + C$  and  $(v + c) + (v + c') = c + c' \in C$ , so the set  $C \cup (v + C)$  is closed under addition.
35. If the  $i$ th component of both  $u$  and  $v$  is 0, then so is the  $i$ th component of  $u - v$  and  $au$ , where  $a$  is a scalar.

## Chapter 32

Wisdom rises upon the ruins of folly.

THOMAS FULLER, *Gnomologia*

1. Note that  $\phi(1) = 1$ . Thus  $\phi(n) = n$ . Also,  $1 = \phi(1) = \phi(nm^{-1}) = \phi(n)\phi(n^{-1}) = n\phi(n^{-1})$ , so that  $1/n = \phi(1/n)$ .
3. If  $\alpha$  and  $\beta$  are automorphisms of  $E$  fixing  $F$ , so are  $\alpha^{-1}$  and  $\alpha\beta$ .



5. If  $a$  and  $b$  are fixed by elements of  $H$ , so are  $a + b$ ,  $a - b$ ,  $a \cdot b$ , and  $a/b$ .
7. It suffices to show that each member of  $\text{Gal}(K/F)$  defines a permutation on the  $a_i$ 's. Let  $\alpha \in \text{Gal}(K/F)$  and write

$$\begin{aligned} f(x) &= c_n x^n + c_{n-1} x^{n-1} + \cdots + c_0 \\ &= c_n (x - a_1)(x - a_2) \cdots (x - a_n). \end{aligned}$$

Then  $f(x) = \alpha(f(x)) = c_n (x - \alpha(a_1))(x - \alpha(a_2)) \cdots (x - \alpha(a_n))$ . Thus,  $f(a_i) = 0$  implies  $a_i = \alpha(a_j)$  for some  $j$ , so that  $\alpha$  permutes the  $a_i$ 's.

9. Observe that  $\phi^6(\omega) = \omega^{729} = \omega$  whereas  $\phi^3(\omega) = \omega^{27} = \omega^{-1}$  and  $\phi^2(\omega) = \omega^9 = \omega^2$ .  $\phi^3(\omega + \omega^{-1}) = \omega^{27} + \omega^{-27} = \omega^{-1} + \omega$ ;  $\phi^2(\omega^3 + \omega^5 + \omega^6) = \omega^{27} + \omega^{45} + \omega^{54} = \omega^6 + \omega^3 + \omega^5$ .
11. a.  $Z_{20} \oplus Z_2$  has three subgroups of order 10.  
b. 25 does not divide 40, so there are none.  
c.  $Z_{20} \oplus Z_2$  has one subgroup of order 5.
13. The splitting field over  $\mathbf{R}$  is  $\mathbf{R}(\sqrt{-3})$ . The Galois group is the identity and the mapping  $a + b\sqrt{-3} \rightarrow a - b\sqrt{-3}$ .
15. Use Theorem 23.3.
17. Recall that  $A_4$  has no subgroup of order 6. (See Example 5 in Chapter 7.)
19. Use Sylow's First Theorem.
21. Let  $\omega$  be a primitive cube root of 1. Then  $Q \subset Q(\sqrt[3]{2}) \subset Q(\omega, \sqrt[3]{2})$  and  $Q(\omega, \sqrt[3]{2})$  is not the splitting field of a polynomial in  $Q[x]$ .
23. Use the lattice of  $Z_{10}$ .
25.  $Z_6$  (Be sure you know why the group is cyclic.)
27. See Exercise 21 in Chapter 25.
29. Use Exercise 43 in Chapter 24.
31. Use Exercise 42 in Chapter 10.
33. Since  $K/N \triangleleft G/N$ , for any  $x \in G$  and  $k \in K$ , there is a  $k' \in K$  such that  $k'N = (xN)(kN)(xN)^{-1} = xNkNx^{-1}N = xkx^{-1}N$ . So,  $xkx^{-1} = k'n$  for some  $n \in N$ . And since  $N \subseteq K$ , we have  $k'n \in K$ .
35. Since  $G$  is solvable there is a series  $\{e\} = K_0 \subset K_1 \subset \cdots \subset K_m = G$  such that  $K_{i+1}/K_i$  is Abelian. Now there is a series
- $$\frac{K_i}{K_i} = \frac{L_0}{K_i} \subset \frac{L_1}{K_i} \subset \cdots \subset \frac{L_i}{K_i} = \frac{K_{i+1}}{K_i},$$
- where  $|L_{j+1}/K_i|/|L_j/K_i|$  is prime. Then  $K_i = L_0 \subset L_1 \subset L_2 \subset \cdots \subset L_i = K_{i+1}$  and each  $|L_{j+1}/L_j|$  is prime (see Exercise 42 of Chapter 10). We may repeat this process for each  $i$ .

## Chapter 33

All wish to possess knowledge, but few, comparatively speaking, are willing to pay the price.

JUVENAL

1.  $x^2 - x + 1$
3. Over  $Z$ ,  $x^8 - 1 = (x - 1)(x + 1)(x^2 + 1)(x^4 + 1)$ . Over  $Z_2$ ,  $x^2 + 1 = (x + 1)^2$  and  $x^4 + 1 = (x + 1)^4$ . So, over  $Z_2$ ,  $x^8 - 1 = (x + 1)^8$ . Over  $Z_3$ ,  $x^2 + 1$  is irreducible, but  $x^4 + 1$  factors into irreducibles as  $(x^2 + x + 2)(x^2 - x - 1)$ . So,  $x^8 - 1 = (x - 1)(x + 1)(x^2 + 1)(x^2 + x + 2)(x^2 - x - 1)$ . Over  $Z_5$ ,  $x^2 + 1 = (x - 2)(x + 2)$ ,  $x^4 + 1 = (x^2 + 2)(x^2 - 2)$ , and these last two factors are irreducible. So,  $x^8 - 1 = (x - 1)(x + 1)(x - 2)(x + 2)(x^2 + 2)(x^2 - 2)$ .
5. Let  $\omega$  be a primitive  $n$ th root of unity. We must prove  $\omega^2 \cdots \omega^n = (-1)^{n+1}$ . Observe that  $\omega \omega^2 \cdots \omega^n = \omega^{n(n+1)/2}$ . When  $n$  is odd,  $\omega^{n(n+1)/2} = (\omega^n)^{(n+1)/2} = 1^{(n+1)/2} = 1$ . When  $n$  is even,  $(\omega^{n/2})^{n+1} = (-1)^{n+1} = -1$ .
7. If  $[F:Q] = n$  and  $F$  has infinitely many roots of unity, then there is no finite bound on their multiplicative orders. Let  $\omega$  be a primitive  $m$ th root of unity in  $F$  such that  $\phi(m) > n$ . Then  $[Q(\omega):Q] = \phi(m)$ . But  $F \supseteq Q(\omega) \supseteq Q$  implies  $[Q(\omega):Q] \leq n$ .
9. Let  $2^n + 1 = q$ . Then  $2 \in U(q)$  and  $2^n = q - 1 = -1$  in  $U(q)$  implies that  $|2| = 2n$ . So, by Lagrange's Theorem,  $2n$  divides  $|U(q)| = q - 1 = 2^n$ .
11. Let  $\omega$  be a primitive  $n$ th root of unity. Then  $2n$ th roots of unity are  $\pm 1, \pm \omega, \dots, \pm \omega^{n-1}$ . These are distinct, since  $-1 = (-\omega)^n$ , whereas  $1 = (\omega)^n$ .
13. First observe that  $\deg \Phi_{2n}(x) = \phi(2n) = \phi(n)$  and  $\deg \Phi_n(-x) = \deg \Phi_n(x) = \phi(n)$ . Thus, it suffices to show that every zero of  $\Phi_n(-x)$  is a zero of  $\Phi_{2n}(x)$ . But the fact that  $\omega$  is a zero of  $\Phi_n(-x)$  means that  $|\omega| = n$ , and because  $n$  is odd, this implies that  $|\omega| = 2n$ .
15. Let  $G = \text{Gal}(Q(\omega)/Q)$  and  $H_1$  be the subgroup of  $G$  of order 2 that fixes  $\cos(\frac{2\pi}{n})$ . Then, by induction,  $G/H_1$  has a series of subgroups  $H_1/H_1 \subset H_2/H_1 \subset \cdots \subset H_i/H_1 = G/H_1$ , so that  $|H_{i+1}/H_1 : H_i/H_1| = 2$ . Now observe that  $|H_{i+1}/H_1 : H_i/H_1| = |H_{i+1}/H_i|$ .

- 17.** Instead, prove that  $\Phi_n(x)\Phi_{pn}(x) = \Phi_n(x^p)$ . Since both sides are monic and have degree  $p\phi(n)$ , it suffices to show that every zero of  $\Phi_n(x)\Phi_{pn}(x)$  is a zero of  $\Phi_n(x^p)$ . If  $\omega$  is a zero of  $\Phi_n(x)$ , then  $|\omega| = n$ . By Theorem 4.2,  $|\omega^p| = n$  also. Thus,  $\omega$  is a zero of  $\Phi_n(x^p)$ . If  $\omega$  is a zero of  $\Phi_{pn}(x)$ , then  $|\omega| = pn$  and therefore  $|\omega^p| = n$ .
- 19.** Use Theorem 33.4 and Theorem 32.1.

- 21.** Suppose that a prime  $p = 2^m + 1$  and  $m$  is not a power of 2. Then  $m = st$  where  $s$  is an odd integer greater than 1 (the case where  $m = 1$  is trivial). Let  $n = 2^t + 1$ . Then  $1 < n < p$  and  $2^t \bmod n = -1$ . Now looking at  $p \bmod n$  and replacing  $2^t$  with  $-1$ , we have  $(2^t)^s + 1 = (-1)^s + 1 = 0$ . This means that  $n$  divides the prime  $p$ , which is a contradiction.

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## Cayley Tables

### Cayley Table for the Alternating Group $A_4$ of Even Permutations of $\{1, 2, 3, 4\}$

(In this table, the permutations of  $A_4$  are designated as  $\alpha_1, \alpha_2, \dots, \alpha_{12}$  and an entry  $k$  inside the table represents  $\alpha_k$ . For example,  $\alpha_3 \alpha_8 = \alpha_6$ .)

|                       | $\alpha_1$ | $\alpha_2$ | $\alpha_3$ | $\alpha_4$ | $\alpha_5$ | $\alpha_6$ | $\alpha_7$ | $\alpha_8$ | $\alpha_9$ | $\alpha_{10}$ | $\alpha_{11}$ | $\alpha_{12}$ |
|-----------------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|---------------|---------------|---------------|
| $(1) = \alpha_1$      | 1          | 2          | 3          | 4          | 5          | 6          | 7          | 8          | 9          | 10            | 11            | 12            |
| $(12)(34) = \alpha_2$ | 2          | 1          | 4          | 3          | 6          | 5          | 8          | 7          | 10         | 9             | 12            | 11            |
| $(13)(24) = \alpha_3$ | 3          | 4          | 1          | 2          | 7          | 8          | 5          | 6          | 11         | 12            | 9             | 10            |
| $(14)(23) = \alpha_4$ | 4          | 3          | 2          | 1          | 8          | 7          | 6          | 5          | 12         | 11            | 10            | 9             |
| $(123) = \alpha_5$    | 5          | 8          | 6          | 7          | 9          | 12         | 10         | 11         | 1          | 4             | 2             | 3             |
| $(243) = \alpha_6$    | 6          | 7          | 5          | 8          | 10         | 11         | 9          | 12         | 2          | 3             | 1             | 4             |
| $(142) = \alpha_7$    | 7          | 6          | 8          | 5          | 11         | 10         | 12         | 9          | 3          | 2             | 4             | 1             |
| $(134) = \alpha_8$    | 8          | 5          | 7          | 6          | 12         | 9          | 11         | 10         | 4          | 1             | 3             | 2             |
| $(132) = \alpha_9$    | 9          | 11         | 12         | 10         | 1          | 3          | 4          | 2          | 5          | 7             | 8             | 6             |
| $(143) = \alpha_{10}$ | 10         | 12         | 11         | 9          | 2          | 4          | 3          | 1          | 6          | 8             | 7             | 5             |
| $(234) = \alpha_{11}$ | 11         | 9          | 10         | 12         | 3          | 1          | 2          | 4          | 7          | 5             | 6             | 8             |
| $(124) = \alpha_{12}$ | 12         | 10         | 9          | 11         | 4          | 2          | 1          | 3          | 8          | 6             | 5             | 7             |

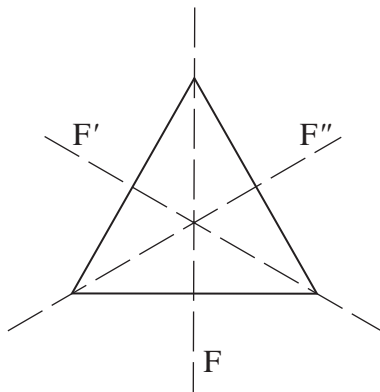
### Cayley Table for the Quaternion Group

|        | $e$    | $a$    | $a^2$  | $a^3$  | $b$    | $ba$   | $ba^2$ | $ba^3$ |
|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|
| $e$    | $e$    | $a$    | $a^2$  | $a^3$  | $b$    | $ba$   | $ba^2$ | $ba^3$ |
| $a$    | $a$    | $a^2$  | $a^3$  | $e$    | $ba^3$ | $b$    | $ba$   | $ba^2$ |
| $a^2$  | $a^2$  | $a^3$  | $e$    | $a$    | $ba^2$ | $ba^3$ | $b$    | $ba$   |
| $a^3$  | $a^3$  | $e$    | $a$    | $a^2$  | $ba$   | $ba^2$ | $ba^3$ | $b$    |
| $b$    | $b$    | $ba$   | $ba^2$ | $ba^3$ | $a^2$  | $a^3$  | $e$    | $a$    |
| $ba$   | $ba$   | $ba^2$ | $ba^3$ | $b$    | $a$    | $a^2$  | $a^3$  | $e$    |
| $ba^2$ | $ba^2$ | $ba^3$ | $b$    | $ba$   | $e$    | $a$    | $a^2$  | $a^3$  |
| $ba^3$ | $ba^3$ | $b$    | $ba$   | $ba^2$ | $a^3$  | $e$    | $a$    | $a^2$  |

## Cayley Tables

Cayley Table for the Dihedral Group of Order 6

|           | $R_0$     | $R_{120}$ | $R_{240}$ | $F$       | $F'$      | $F''$     |
|-----------|-----------|-----------|-----------|-----------|-----------|-----------|
| $R_0$     | $R_0$     | $R_{120}$ | $R_{240}$ | $F$       | $F'$      | $F''$     |
| $R_{120}$ | $R_{120}$ | $R_{240}$ | $R_0$     | $F'$      | $F''$     | $F$       |
| $R_{240}$ | $R_{240}$ | $R_0$     | $R_{120}$ | $F''$     | $F$       | $F'$      |
| $F$       | $F$       | $F''$     | $F'$      | $R_0$     | $R_{240}$ | $R_{120}$ |
| $F'$      | $F'$      | $F$       | $F''$     | $R_{120}$ | $R_0$     | $R_{240}$ |
| $F''$     | $F''$     | $F'$      | $F$       | $R_{240}$ | $R_{120}$ | $R_0$     |



Cayley Table for the Dihedral Group of Order 8

|           | $R_0$     | $R_{90}$  | $R_{180}$ | $R_{270}$ | $H$       | $V$       | $D$       | $D'$      |
|-----------|-----------|-----------|-----------|-----------|-----------|-----------|-----------|-----------|
| $R_0$     | $R_0$     | $R_{90}$  | $R_{180}$ | $R_{270}$ | $H$       | $V$       | $D$       | $D'$      |
| $R_{90}$  | $R_{90}$  | $R_{180}$ | $R_{270}$ | $R_0$     | $D'$      | $D$       | $H$       | $V$       |
| $R_{180}$ | $R_{180}$ | $R_{270}$ | $R_0$     | $R_{90}$  | $V$       | $H$       | $D'$      | $D$       |
| $R_{270}$ | $R_{270}$ | $R_0$     | $R_{90}$  | $R_{180}$ | $D$       | $D'$      | $V$       | $H$       |
| $H$       | $H$       | $D$       | $V$       | $D'$      | $R_0$     | $R_{180}$ | $R_{90}$  | $R_{270}$ |
| $V$       | $V$       | $D'$      | $H$       | $D$       | $R_{180}$ | $R_0$     | $R_{270}$ | $R_{90}$  |
| $D$       | $D$       | $V$       | $D'$      | $H$       | $R_{270}$ | $R_{90}$  | $R_0$     | $R_{180}$ |
| $D'$      | $D'$      | $H$       | $D$       | $V$       | $R_{90}$  | $R_{270}$ | $R_{180}$ | $R_0$     |

